



2026 Summary Plan Description



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Introduction

Microsoft provides industry-leading benefits to help you and your family get and stay well, prepare for your future, and enjoy life's journey. Whether you are expecting a new child, looking for some legal advice for a new home, or managing a health condition, Microsoft is here to support you with benefits and resources to help you live life well.

This Summary Plan Description (SPD) provides details of the health and welfare benefits available to eligible employees and their eligible dependents, as described in this SPD. Other summary plan descriptions address health and welfare benefits that may be offered to other employees and their eligible dependents.

About the SPD

This document is intended to serve as a Summary Plan Description (SPD) as defined by the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 (ERISA) for such programs described within that are governed by ERISA. The terms and conditions of the Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan (Plan) are set forth in this SPD, in the Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan wrap document (the "Welfare Plan"), the Benefits@Microsoft Program, the Microsoft Healthcare Reimbursement Plan, the Microsoft Dental and Vision Care Reimbursement Plan, the Microsoft Dependent Care Reimbursement Plan, and in the insurance policies and other component plan documents incorporated into the Welfare Plan. The Welfare Plan together with this SPD and the other incorporated documents constitute the written instruments under which the Plan is established and maintained. Where there is an inconsistency or ambiguity between the terms of the Welfare Plan and the terms of a certificate of coverage for insured benefits, the terms of the certificate of coverage control when describing specific benefits that are covered or insurance-related terms. Where there is an inconsistency or ambiguity between the terms of the Welfare Plan and this SPD, the terms of the Welfare Plan control.

This document was last updated as of July 1, 2026.

Receipt of this document is not a contract

While Microsoft provides a benefit program for its employees and their eligible dependents, this benefit program does not constitute a contract of or inducement for employment with Microsoft, nor does it mean future employment for Microsoft is guaranteed.

Benefits may be amended or terminated

While Microsoft expects to continue the benefits described in this document, benefits, including employer contributions, may be added, changed, and/or discontinued by Microsoft at any time. You will be notified

of any benefits changes. The benefits featured in this document are listed in the Table of Contents above. The terms of this Plan can be amended in writing only, and cannot be altered, in any manner, by oral statements.

Nothing in this SPD shall be construed to require continuation of this Plan with respect to existing or future participants, dependents, or beneficiaries.

COBRA enrollees

This SPD generally applies to active employees and dependents, as well as individuals who are enrolled in continuation coverage for certain health-related benefits under the Plan through the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA). For COBRA enrollees, there are notations throughout this SPD that call out which benefits or features apply to you. For example:

The following notation generally indicates that a particular section applies to COBRA enrollees:

✓ *COBRA enrollees*

The following notation generally indicates that a particular section does not apply to COBRA enrollees:

✗ *COBRA enrollees*

Summary of what's available

Below is a summary of benefits available for active employees/dependents and COBRA enrollees. For detailed information, refer to each section of this SPD.

Benefit	Active employees/dependents	COBRA enrollees
.Medical and prescription drugs.	Yes	Yes
.Vision.	Yes	Yes
.Dental.	Yes	Yes
.Flexible spending accounts.	Yes	Yes, but see section for details
Wellbeing at Microsoft.	Yes	Yes
.Employee and dependent life insurance.	Yes	No
.Accidental death & dismemberment.	Yes	No
.Long-term disability.	Yes	No
Group legal plan.	Yes	No
.Group legal survivor support.	Yes	No

Section I: Who's eligible

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✓ COBRA enrollees – see section [For COBRA enrollees](#) for applicable information

For employees

You are eligible for the benefits described in this SPD if you are a full- or part-time employee on the Microsoft U.S. payroll, and are not an intern, visiting researcher, or employee of a Microsoft retail store. For additional details, review the full definition of [eligible employee](#) and the explanation of [workers who are not eligible](#) for coverage.

 You are on the **Microsoft U.S. payroll** if you are paid from the Microsoft Payroll department located in the United States and Microsoft withholds and pays U.S. employment taxes on your payroll amounts.

If you meet the following criteria, you are eligible to participate only in the Hawaii Only Plan (Premera) for medical coverage, even if you do not meet the definition of an eligible employee set forth earlier:

- An employee of Microsoft on the Microsoft U.S. payroll
- Reside in Hawaii

 *Additional eligibility requirements may apply to certain benefits. Review the benefit sections of this SPD for more information.*

If you are rehired by Microsoft

If you are rehired by Microsoft (and again become an eligible employee) during the same plan year and within 30 days of your previous termination of employment, your election in effect at the time of termination will be reinstated. You will not be permitted to make new benefit elections solely based upon the termination and rehire. If more than 30 days have passed since your previous termination of employment, you must reenroll as a new hire and make new benefit elections.

If you transfer from another Microsoft plan

If you transfer directly from another plan sponsored by Microsoft without a lapse in coverage, the benefits of this plan will begin without any loss.

If both you and your spouse/domestic partner, or the other parent of one or more of your children, work for Microsoft

Certain rules apply if both you and your spouse, domestic partner, or the other parent of one or more of your children (regardless of your marital or domestic partnership status) work for Microsoft and are both eligible for Microsoft benefit coverage:

- For medical, vision, and dental benefits you may elect *one* of the following coverage options, but not both:
 - You may enroll in your own coverage, OR
 - You may enroll as a dependent in your spouse's/domestic partner's Microsoft coverage.
- For life insurance and accidental death and dismemberment (AD&D) benefits you have *two* coverage options:
 - You may enroll in your own coverage, AND
 - You may also be enrolled for dependent coverage through your spouse/domestic partner
- If a child is an eligible dependent of two Microsoft employees, regardless of those employees' current legal marital or domestic partnership status, only one employee can claim the child under child life insurance. Therefore, only one employee should enroll in child life insurance. An eligible child of two Microsoft employees can be enrolled only under one employee's medical, dental and vision coverage. If such employees have two children, for example, one employee could cover one child and the other employee could cover the other child on their plan.



If you and your spouse/domestic partner both work for Microsoft and enroll for coverage in the Health Savings Plan (Premiera), be sure to review the additional rules that apply to Health Savings Account contributions and eligibility. Review the [Health Savings Account](#) section for more information.

If both you and your parent (or the spouse/domestic partner of your parent) work for Microsoft

Certain rules apply if both you and your parent (or the spouse/domestic partner of your parent) work for Microsoft, and you are eligible for Microsoft benefit coverage both as an employee and as a dependent child:

- For medical, vision, and dental benefits you may elect one coverage option, but not both:
 - You may enroll in your own coverage, OR
 - You may enroll as a dependent in your parent's (or the spouse/domestic partner of your parent's) Microsoft coverage.
- For life insurance and accidental death and dismemberment (AD&D) benefits you have two coverage options:
 - You may enroll in your own coverage, AND
 - You may also be enrolled for dependent coverage through your parent (or the spouse/domestic partner of your parent)

Workers who are not eligible for coverage

The following persons are not eligible to participate as employees in the plan under this SPD even if they meet the definition of an eligible employee:

- Interns and visiting researchers
- Cooperatives
- Apprentices
- Nonresident aliens receiving no U.S. source income from Microsoft
- Employees covered by a collective bargaining agreement resulting from negotiations with Microsoft in which retirement benefits were the subject of good faith bargaining and participation in this plan was not provided for
- Persons providing services to Microsoft pursuant to an agreement between Microsoft and any other individual or entity, such as a staff leasing organization (leased employees)
- Temporary workers engaged through or employed by temporary or leasing agencies
- Workers who hold themselves out to Microsoft as being independent contractors or as being employed by or engaged through another company while providing services to Microsoft
- Project-based employees. For purposes of the plan, a project-based employee is one who is hired to work on a project or series of projects, is employed for a limited term, and has signed a Project-Based Employment Agreement.
- All other workers who Microsoft does not classify as being either a full-time or part-time employee on the Microsoft U.S. payroll, even if that classification is later determined to be incorrect or is retroactively revised.

For dependents

If you enroll for coverage, you may also enroll your eligible dependents for medical, vision, dental, dependent life insurance, and accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D) coverage under the plan.

Your eligible dependents include your:

Spouse	You must be lawfully married (whether the same or opposite sex of the employee) and not legally separated. You will be considered lawfully married if either of the following is true: • You were married in a state, possession, or territory of the U.S. and you are recognized as lawfully married by that state, possession, or territory of the U.S.; or • You were married in a foreign jurisdiction and the laws of at least one state, possession, or territory of the U.S. would recognize you as lawfully married. In no event will the Plan recognize more than one spouse at any time.
Domestic partner	You and your domestic partner (either of the same or opposite sex) must meet all of the following requirements: • You are each other's sole domestic partner and intend to remain so indefinitely • Neither of you is legally married • You are both at least 18 years of age and are mentally competent to consent to contract

Section I: Who's eligible

Your eligible dependents include your:

- You are not related by blood to a degree of closeness that would prohibit legal marriage in the state in which you legally reside
 - You reside together in the same residence and intend to do so indefinitely (excepting a temporary residence change of not more than 90 days during which you and your domestic partner reside in separate homes)
 - You are mutually responsible (financially and legally) for each other's common welfare
- For life and accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D), a domestic partner includes any person who satisfies the requirements for being a domestic partner, registered domestic partner, or civil union partner of an eligible employee under the law of your jurisdiction of residence.

Dependent children under age 26

Includes your:

- Biological child and/or your spouse's/domestic partner's biological child
- Child for whom you or your spouse/domestic partner has been named legal guardian as appointed by the courts (or recognized as guardian by the state of residence)
- Legally adopted child, or child who has been placed with you for adoption, but not a foster child

A child's eligibility as a dependent child under age 26 does not rely on the child's financial dependency (on you or any other person), residency with you or with any other person, student status, employment, eligibility for other health plan coverage, or any combination of these factors.

Incapacitated dependent children age 26 or over

An incapacitated dependent resides with the employee for more than half of the year, and is unable to sustain employment due to a developmental or physical disability that existed before the child reached age 26. The individual is chiefly dependent on the employee (or the employee's spouse or domestic partner) for support.

Proof of incapacity must be submitted to the plan administrator:

- For Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington (KFHPWA), or Delta Dental of Washington (DDWA), within 90 days of the latest of the child's 26th birthday, your date of hire, or the date that you enroll the child in coverage if the child is already over age 26, and then annually thereafter
- For Kaiser Permanente, within 60 days after receiving notice from Kaiser



You will be required to provide evidence of your partnership in connection with enrollment of a new domestic partner, a plan audit of dependent eligibility or a claim for benefits. You will need to sign the [Microsoft Affidavit of Domestic Partnership](#) before a notary and provide to the plan's benefit administrator, Businessolver at the time of your domestic partner's enrollment under the plan.



Important note about tax consequences of domestic partner benefits

Domestic partners generally do not qualify as spouses or dependents for federal income tax purposes. Therefore, the value of company-provided medical, dental, and vision coverage that relate to your domestic partner, or your domestic partner's children, generally will be considered imputed income and will be taxable to you on each paycheck that the benefits are maintained. This value is subject to change from year to year as the underlying benefit values change. Tax and other withholdings will be made from your paycheck and the value of those benefits will be included in your Form W-2. During any period in which domestic partner benefits that have an imputed income are maintained by you, but you are not receiving a paycheck from the company, the company reserves the right to collect income and the employee FICA tax liability directly from you. These rules will not apply if your domestic partner satisfies the requirements to be considered your tax dependent under the Internal Revenue Code or state tax laws governing state income tax.



You will be required to provide evidence of your partnership in connection with enrollment of a new domestic partner, a plan audit of dependent eligibility or a claim for benefits. You will need to sign the [Microsoft Affidavit of Domestic Partnership](#) before a notary and provide to the plan's benefit administrator, Businessolver at the time of your domestic partner's enrollment under the plan.



Coverage for a child may be provided as the result of a Qualified Medical Child Support Order (QMCSO). This is an order or judgment from a court or administrative body directing the plan to cover the child of a member as required by applicable law. Once the Plan confirms the QMCSO, coverage will begin the first day of the pay period in which the Plan receives the order unless another date is specified in the order. For more information, or to request the requirements for whether an order meets the requirements of a QMCSO, call the Microsoft QMCSO Service Center (833) 253-4929.

Family members who are not eligible for coverage

The following is a list of dependents who are commonly mistaken as eligible dependents. This is not an all-inclusive list but rather common examples of ineligible dependents:

- Legally separated spouse, regardless of whether you are subject to a court order or agreement requiring you to provide them with health care coverage
- Divorced spouse, regardless of whether you are subject to a court order or agreement requiring you to provide them with health care coverage
- Parents, except as otherwise may be listed elsewhere in the SPD, regardless of whether they live with you and/or depend on you for financial support
- Grandparents, regardless of whether they live with you and/or depend on you for financial support
- Siblings, regardless of whether they live with you and/or depend on you for financial support
- Nieces, nephews, and grandchildren, regardless of whether they live with you and/or depend on you for financial support unless they meet the dependent eligibility definition described above
- Roommates
- Foster children
- Any person who is on active duty in the armed forces
- Anyone else who does not meet the definition of an eligible dependent
- Anyone for whom you fail to provide proof of eligible dependent status, if required or requested

Dependent Eligibility Verification (DEV)

All new hires and employees who add or change dependents due to a [Qualified Life Event \(QLE\)](#) must submit documentation at the time of enrollment **within 31 days of the dependent entry date** in order to newly enroll in coverage or to keep coverage active. There is no grace period after the 31 days, but late submissions will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis

Accepted documents

- **Preferred Method**
First page of your Form 1040 (tax form) from the current year or prior year.

For example: for 2026, you can submit tax returns from 2024 or 2025.

- Only the first full page with the relevant information that shows full name and relationship to the employee is required.
- This one tax form can be used to verify more than one dependent (it will verify all your dependents if they are listed on the form).
- All financial SSN information should be redacted prior to upload.
- **Spouses**
In lieu of a Form 1040, Marriage Certificates dated within the last three years.
 - **If beyond three years:** Additional documentation showing cohabitation dated within the last 6 months (example: Government issued Utility Bill, bank statement, mortgage statement, etc.).
- **Domestic Partners**
A signed and notarized [Affidavit of Domestic Partnership](#) dated within the last three (3) years.
 - **If beyond three (3) years:** Additional documentation showing cohabitation dated within the last 6 months (example: Government issued Utility Bill, bank statement, mortgage statement, etc.).
- **Dependent Children:**
In lieu of a Form 1040, Birth Certificates

Some dependents may require additional documentation:

- **Tax-Dependent Domestic Partner**
Microsoft may use the DEV process to confirm IRS tax dependent status when you enroll a Domestic Partner as a tax dependent to ensure appropriate tax withholding.
Note: Coverage for Domestic Partners who are not your tax dependents can result in imputed income).
- **Child of a Domestic Partner (DP)**
Two processes of eligibility need to be confirmed. First verifying the relationship of the Domestic Partner to the employee, and second, verifying the relationship of the child to the Domestic Partner.
- **Children under 26 who are not IRS tax eligible dependents**
Since they may not appear on your Form 1040 tax return, you'll need to provide documentation such as a birth certificate or a prior year's Form 1040 showing them as your dependent child.
- **Non-dependent children due to divorce decree**
You can use a combination of the tax return form for any child dependents you can claim and then a birth certificate for those you cannot.
- **Domestic partner changed to spouse**
A Marriage Certificate is required to update your Domestic Partner to Spouse.



Confidentiality reminder: To protect your privacy, only employee and dependent names are needed on your submitted documents. You should black out Social Security Numbers (SSNs) and financial details, as they are not required. For reference, [here](#) is a sample Form 1040 that has been redacted to hide SSNs and non-required financial information.



Document translation: If you are submitting documents in a language other than English or Spanish, please ensure the document is translated from the original copy to English and certified before submission.

Be sure to submit non-restricted, clear copies of your documents—PDF or JPEG files are recommended to ensure timely review and processing.

If your documentation is insufficient, you will receive a resubmit email notification.

Important note: A resubmit request does not extend your original deadline.

When eligibility ends

Your eligibility for Microsoft benefits described in this SPD ends with the last day of your employment at Microsoft or the last day before you fail to satisfy the eligible employee requirements outlined above.

Eligibility for your dependents ends when your eligibility ends, or earlier if your dependent no longer meets the definition of an eligible dependent. Dependent children remain covered on the plan through the end of the month in which they turn 26.

In the event of your death, eligibility for your covered dependents ends:

- The end of the month if you die before the 15th of the month
- The 15th of the next month if you die on or after the 15th of the month



Review the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section for information on when coverage ends and your options for continuing coverage.

For COBRA enrollees

You are eligible for the benefits described in the applicable sections of this SPD if and to the extent that you are enrolled in continuation coverage under COBRA, as described in [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#).



You may be required to provide evidence of your partnership in connection with a plan audit of dependent eligibility or a claim for benefits. If desired, you may sign the Microsoft Affidavit of Domestic Partnership before a notary and retain the affidavit in your records. To access this form, go to <http://cobra.me.microsoft.com>. > Reference Center > Microsoft Affidavit of Domestic Partnership.

Leaves of absence

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Leaves of absence section does not apply*

Health benefits

You may be eligible for medical, prescription drug, vision, and dental benefits while you are on an approved leave of absence as designated by the applicable Microsoft leave of absence policy. Medical, prescription drug, vision, dental, and wellbeing benefits continue for up to 12 weeks of approved personal leave.

-  To learn more about coverage during an approved leave of absence, review the [leave of absence policies](#) on the Benefits site.
-  *Your coverage will remain in effect while you are on a leave of absence that complies with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA).*

If your eligibility for health benefits ends while you are on leave of absence (for example, a personal leave of more than 12 weeks is approved), you and your dependents may be eligible to continue coverage through COBRA provisions. Review the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section for more information.

Other benefits

Your eligibility for other benefits during a leave of absence is described below.

Benefit	Eligibility on leave
Health Savings Account	Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential-administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. You may withdraw HSA funds on a tax-free basis for eligible health care expenses at any time, including during a paid or unpaid leave of absence.
General Purpose and Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA	Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential-administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. However, if you are returning from FMLA Leave and you did not continue coverage while on leave, you can instead resume your participation at a reduced level and resume contributions in effect before the FMLA Leave. You may be reimbursed for eligible health care expenses during a paid or unpaid leave of absence.
Dependent care FSA	Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential-administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. Your eligibility to be reimbursed for eligible dependent care expenses depends upon your particular leave situation. For more information, refer to IRS Publication 503.
Spring Health (employee assistance program (EAP))	You and eligible dependents are eligible for Spring Health EAP coverage while you are on an approved leave of absence, provided that you remain an eligible employee.

Section I: Who's eligible

Benefit	Eligibility on leave
Employee and dependent life insurance	You are eligible for employee and dependent life insurance coverage while you are on an approved leave of absence. Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential-administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work.
Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)	You are eligible for AD&D insurance coverage while you are on an approved leave of absence with the exception of Prudential administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work.
Long-term disability (LTD)	Tax withholdings on imputed income for LTD continue while you are on paid leave of absence. Taxes are not withheld on imputed income for LTD benefits while on an approved long-term disability leave. If you are on short-term disability leave administered by Prudential or unpaid leave, taxes on imputed income for LTD that would have otherwise been withheld during that period will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work.
Group Legal	You are eligible for group legal while you are on an approved leave of absence. Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential-administered short-term disability leave and Prudential insured long-term disability leave. For those leave types, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work.
Supplemental LTD	You are eligible for supplemental long-term disability insurance coverage while you are on an approved leave of absence. Payroll deductions will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence, with the exception of Prudential administered short-term disability leave. For Prudential administered short-term disability leave, unless you change your election, payroll deductions that otherwise would have been taken during the leave period will be deducted from your first paycheck (or paychecks, as necessary) upon your return to work. For unpaid leaves, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period similarly will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. If you remain disabled under the MetLife supplemental LTD policy for 90 consecutive days, MetLife will waive future supplemental disability premiums while you continue receiving benefits.

If you have other health coverage (Coordination of Benefits)

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COBRA enrollees – the Coordination of Benefits section applies

How Coordination of Benefits (COB) works

If you or your covered dependents have health benefit coverage through another employer, a government plan or Medicare, your Microsoft health plan will coordinate payments to ensure the total paid by both plans will not exceed the total amount charged. Review the following section, COB with other health plans, for more information.

If you or your covered dependents receive payments for health care from other sources, such as motor vehicle or liability insurance, your Microsoft health plan will seek to be reimbursed for benefits paid under the plan or take over your right to receive payments from the other party—this is called subrogation. Review the [COB with other types of insurance](#) section for more information.

Your Microsoft medical, prescription drugs, and dental benefits are subject to these provisions.

Examples

- Mike works for Microsoft. Mike's wife, Lee, is covered as a dependent on Mike's Microsoft medical plan but also has coverage under Lee's own employer's medical plan. Lee's plan would provide primary coverage for Lee and would coordinate benefits with Mike's plan.
- Jen is in a car accident. Jen is injured in the accident and incurs health care expenses that will be paid by the other driver's vehicle insurance. The Microsoft plan will process any remaining expenses after the vehicle insurance has been exhausted per the plan guidelines.

COB with other health plans

The Microsoft health plan will coordinate coverage with other health plans, including:

- Medicare Part A or B
- A plan sponsored by one or more employers or employee organizations
- A government-sponsored program other than workers' compensation

One health plan determines eligible benefits first and is considered primary and then the other health plan determines its share of the remaining balance and is considered secondary. Microsoft uses certain rules to determine which plan is primary and which is secondary, as described below.



Health plans provide medical, prescription drug, dental, or vision coverage.

The primary plan is the health plan that pays benefits first.

The secondary plan is the health plan that pays the balance for eligible expenses, subject to its plan benefits and limitations.



Due to IRS regulations, specific rules apply to the Health Savings Account if you have other plan coverage. Review the [Health Savings Account](#) section of this SPD for more information.

If both you and your spouse/domestic partner work for Microsoft

If both you and your spouse/domestic partner are employed by Microsoft, you may not enroll for employee coverage and also be enrolled as a dependent on your spouse/domestic partner's health care coverage. You can each enroll in your own separate coverage with Microsoft or one of you can enroll as a dependent under your spouse's/domestic partner's coverage. Children may be enrolled as a dependent only on one Microsoft employee's coverage.

If your spouse/domestic partner is eligible for coverage through another plan

If you enroll your spouse/domestic partner who is eligible for health coverage through their employer, you must notify Microsoft of your decision to coordinate coverage between that plan and the Microsoft plan when you enroll. Your spouse/domestic partner can do one of the following:

- Enroll in their employer's health plan and use Microsoft coverage as the secondary plan at no charge
- Waive the coverage available through their employer and enroll as a dependent on your Microsoft plan; in this case, you will pay \$250 per month to use the Microsoft plan as your spouse's/domestic partner's primary coverage.



This policy affects only employees whose spouse/domestic partner is eligible for medical coverage (not applicable for dental and vision coverage) through their employer. It does not affect the following groups:

- Employees who do not have a spouse/domestic partner
- Employees whose spouse/domestic partner is not employed
- Employees whose spouse's/domestic partner's employer does not provide a health plan
- Employees whose spouse/domestic partner is not eligible for their employer's health plan
- Eligible dependent children enrolled in a Microsoft health plan
- Employees and spouses/domestic partners who are both employed by Microsoft, and one is enrolled as a dependent on the other's plan

When Microsoft is primary or secondary

Microsoft uses the following rules to determine if the Microsoft plan is primary or secondary to other coverage.

Medicare

In most cases, the Microsoft plan is primary to Medicare, except if you have been eligible for Medicare due to end stage renal disease for more than 30 months. If you have COBRA continuation coverage under the Microsoft plan, however, Medicare is primary, except if you have been eligible for Medicare due to end stage renal disease for no more than 30 months. Medicare is also primary if and when you have been on a leave of absence and receiving disability benefits under the plan for at least 6 months. Your Microsoft plan will coordinate benefits with Medicare as required by federal law.



Visit the online guide Medicare and Other Health Benefits or call the Medicare Coordination of Benefits Contractor (COBC) at (855) 798-2627 (TTY users should call (855) 797-2627) for information about how Medicare coordinates coverage with other health plans.

Other plans

For Microsoft employees, the Microsoft plan (other than through COBRA) is always primary to other coverage, including coverage under your spouse/domestic partner's plan, COBRA, Medicaid, or TRICARE medical. COBRA coverage under the Microsoft plan is always secondary to coverage under your spouse/domestic partner's current employer's plan. Any no-fault medical coverage for motor vehicles and boats, including Medical Payment (MEDPAY), Personal Injury Protection (PIP), Medical Premises (Medprem) for homeowners' or commercial properties or excess accident and athletic policies, will be primary to the Microsoft plan.

For your spouse/domestic partner who has other coverage, the Microsoft plan is secondary unless the following conditions apply:

- If your dependent's other coverage is under COBRA, Medicaid, or TRICARE medical, the Microsoft plan is primary
- If your dependent's other coverage is under a retiree plan which has a COB provision, the Microsoft plan is primary



Kaiser Permanente will coordinate benefits with the other coverage under the coordination of benefits rules of the California Department of Managed Health Care, which are incorporated in the Evidence of Coverage.

If your dependent child has coverage through another plan

For adult dependent children covered as a subscriber under their own plan or as a dependent on a spouse/domestic partner's plan, the Microsoft plan will be secondary. In addition, if an adult dependent child is also covered on more than one parent's plan, the rules below will apply for determining the remaining order of liability.

If your dependent child is covered under both parents' plans, order of liability rules apply. For purposes of applying these order of liability rules, a stepparent's plan that covers the child but not a parent will be deemed to cover a parent. Unless a court decree states otherwise, the rules below apply for dependent children covered by Microsoft and another plan. If a dependent child is covered by individuals other than parents or stepparents, these rules will apply as if those individuals were the parents. When the rules below do not establish an order, the plan that has covered the parent for the longest period of time is the primary payer.

- Birthday Rule - When the parents are married or living together, whether or not they were ever married, the plan of the parent whose birthday falls earlier in the year is primary. If both parents have the same birthday, the plan that has covered the parent the longest is primary.
- When the parents are divorced, separated, or not living together, whether or not they were ever married:
 - If a court decree makes one parent responsible for the child's health care expenses or coverage, that plan is primary.
 - If a court decree assigns one parent primary financial responsibility for the child but doesn't mention responsibility for health care expenses, the plan of the parent with financial responsibility is primary.
 - If a court decree makes both parents responsible for the child's health care expenses or coverage, the birthday rule determines which plan is primary.
 - If a court decree requires joint custody without making one parent responsible for the child's health care expenses or coverage, the birthday rule determines which plan is primary.
 - If there is no court decree allocating responsibility for the child's expenses or coverage, the rules below apply:
 - The plan covering the custodial parent, first
 - The plan covering the spouse/domestic partner of the custodial parent, second
 - The plan covering the non-custodial parent, third
 - The plan covering the spouse/domestic partner of the non-custodial parent, last
- If a child is covered by individuals other than parents or stepparents, the above rules apply as if those individuals were the parents.
- When the rules above do not establish an order, the plan that has covered the parent for the longest period of time is the primary payer.

 *A child of two Microsoft employees can be enrolled under only one employee's coverage.*

How Microsoft pays for secondary coverage

You and your dependents, as applicable, must follow the rules of the primary plan in order to receive secondary coverage under the Microsoft plan. When coverage for a particular item or service is denied or reduced under the primary plan, due to a failure to follow the rules of that plan, the Microsoft plan will pay nothing, even if the Microsoft plan *otherwise* generally provides coverage for that item or service.

Example

Lisa works for Microsoft and Lisa's husband, Joe, is covered as a dependent on Lisa's plan. Joe's coverage through Joe's own employer is Joe's primary plan. Joe's primary plan requires a referral to be obtained before accessing specialty care or the plan pays nothing. If Joe doesn't seek a referral, neither Joe's primary plan nor the Microsoft plan will pay for the charge. Joe cannot bypass this referral requirement and submit a charge to the Microsoft plan as the secondary payer, even if the Microsoft plan does not have the same requirement for obtaining a referral.

 *Remember to tell your health care provider whether your Microsoft plan is primary or secondary to other coverage. This will prevent delays in receiving payment for your benefits.*

If the Microsoft plan is secondary, it will pay its share of any remaining costs within plan guidelines after the primary plan has paid and the deductible in the Microsoft plan, if applicable, has been met. The plan administrator (Premera, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington, Kaiser Permanente, or Delta Dental of Washington) will review the allowable charge for the primary plan and the amount the primary plan paid.

The Microsoft plan will pay, in total, the lesser of:

- The total amount the Microsoft plan would have paid if it were primary
- The allowable charge for the Microsoft plan
- The remaining balance of your provider's bill for services covered by the Microsoft plan

Payments made by the primary plan will count toward the Microsoft plan's deductible and coinsurance limits, if applicable, up to the allowed amount under the Microsoft plan.

Example

Milo works for Microsoft and has a domestic partner named Bo, who is covered as a dependent under Milo's plan. Bo's coverage through Bo's own employer is Bo's primary plan. Bo has a procedure that is billed at \$1,000. Bo's primary plan has an allowed amount of \$900 for this service and pays the provider. The Microsoft plan has an allowed amount of only \$700, so it does not pay any of the cost. However, \$700 will be applied to the deductible for Milo's and Bo's coverage in the Microsoft plan, if they had not yet met their deductible yet on the Microsoft plan.

How to submit a claim for secondary coverage

When obtaining care, your dependents with secondary coverage under the Microsoft plan will need to do the following:

- Present their employer's plan ID card as primary insurance
- If the provider bills secondary insurance, present the Microsoft plan ID card as well
- If the provider does not bill secondary insurance, submit the following documents to your plan administrator (Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington, Kaiser Permanente, or Delta Dental of Washington):
 - An Explanation of Benefits (EOB) statement from the primary plan
 - For medical services, an itemized bill from the provider, noting the remaining costs after payment from the primary plan
 - For prescriptions, a copy of the pharmacy receipt that includes the drug name and amount paid



Make sure to submit all claims within 12 months, even if no additional payment will be made. This will ensure that your spouse's/domestic partner's claims are applied to your deductible.

The Microsoft plan will not pay a claim submitted more than 365 days from the date of service. Employee and/or dependents will have 365 days from the date of the primary insurance Explanation of Benefits (EOB) to submit claims to the plan administrator (Premera, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington, Kaiser Permanente, Surest, or Delta Dental of Washington) for consideration. If you cannot submit the claim in a timely manner due to circumstances beyond your control, the claim will be considered by the plan administrator for payment when submitted as a formal appeal.

If your coverage under the Kaiser Permanente plan is determined to be secondary, Kaiser Permanente might be able to establish a Benefit Reserve Account for you. You may draw on the Benefit Reserve Account during a calendar year to pay for your out-of-pocket expenses for services that are partially covered by either of your coverages during that calendar year. If you are entitled to a Benefit Reserve Account, Kaiser Permanente will provide you with detailed information about this account.



For assistance with COB, contact your administrator:

.Premera.	(800) 676-1411	.Premera Claim Reimbursement Request Form .External Review Request Form .Prescription Claim Form.
Surest	(866) 222-1298	Surest Member Reimbursement Claim Form
Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington	(888) 901-4636	.Medical, Prescription and Vision Claim Form.
.Kaiser. .Permanente	(800) 464-4000	Log on to .kp.org to process your claims
	.Kaiser Permanente group numbers: .Northern California: 603873 .Southern California: 231325	
Delta Dental of Washington (DDWA)	(833) 642-8800	DDWA Reimbursement form

COB with other types of insurance (Subrogation)

If another party may be liable or legally responsible to pay for a member's care, typically through another insurance plan, the Microsoft plan will seek to be reimbursed for amounts paid. The Microsoft plan may choose to:

- Subrogate—that is, take over—the member's right to receive payments from the other party. The member or the member's legal representative will transfer to the plan any rights the member might have to take legal action arising from the illness, sickness, or bodily injury to recover any sums paid under the plan on your behalf or that of your covered dependent. This is the plan's right of subrogation.
- Recover from the member or the member's legal representative any benefits paid under the plan from any payment you or your covered dependent is entitled to receive from the other party. This is the plan's right of reimbursement.

Examples

- Felicia was injured in a car accident. Felicia received payment for related health care expenses through the other driver's auto insurance policy. In this instance, the Microsoft plan may be able to recover medical expenses paid on the member's behalf from the auto insurer.
- Moliike became ill from food poisoning and received a payment from the restaurant for related health care expenses through a liability policy. In this instance, the Microsoft plan may be able to recover medical expenses paid on the member's behalf from the liability policy.



The **other party** or other parties are defined to include, but not limited to, any of the following:

The party or parties who caused the illness, sickness, or bodily injury

The insurer or other indemnifier of the party or parties who caused the illness, sickness, or bodily injury

The member's own insurer (for example, in the case of Uninsured Motorist [UM], Underinsured Motorist [UIM], medical payments, or no-fault coverage, or, in the case of Personal Injury Protection – PIP, Medical Payments, or Med Pay)

A workers' compensation insurer

Any other person, entity, policy, or plan that is liable or legally responsible in relation to the illness, sickness, or bodily injury

Other types of insurance that may provide health coverage might include but are not limited to:

- Personal Injury Protection (PIP) coverage
- Motor vehicle medical (Medpay) or motor vehicle no-fault coverage
- Workers' compensation, labor and industry, or similar coverage
- Any excess insurance coverage
- Medical premises coverage
- Commercial liability coverage
- Boat coverage
- Homeowner policy
- School and/or athletic policies
- Other types of liability or insurance coverage

Right of reimbursement and subrogation

The following rules apply to the Microsoft plan's right of reimbursement and subrogation:

- The Plan has a first priority with respect to its right to reimbursement or subrogation.
- The Plan has the right to 100% reimbursement in a lump sum.
- The Plan is not subject to any state laws or equitable doctrine, including but not limited to the common fund doctrine, which would purport to require the Plan to reduce its recovery by any portion of a covered person's attorneys' fees, and costs.
- The Plan's right to first priority shall not be reduced due to the member's negligence or the member's not being made whole, or attorney's fees and costs, or due to any common fund doctrine.
- Reimbursement must be made to the Microsoft plan, regardless of whether the judgment, settlement, or other payments allocate any specified amount to reimbursement for medical expenses and

regardless of whether such expenses are paid prior to or after the date of such judgment, settlement, or otherwise, and regardless whether the covered person made claim for medical expenses as part of any claim or demand.

- The Plan's recovery and reimbursement amount are recoverable even if the Participant's recovery funds have been commingled with other assets and the Plan may recover from any available funds without the need to trace the source of the funds.
- The Microsoft plan may seek reimbursement from any recovery, whether by settlement, judgment, mediation, arbitration, or any other recovery made by or on behalf of:
 - A covered dependent
 - The estate of any covered member, or
- Any incapacitated member
- The Plan requires the Participant's legal representative or estate to cooperate fully with the Plan and not take any actions that would prejudice the Plan's right of reimbursement.
- The Plan Administrator, in its sole discretion, or the Plan Administrator's delegate, in the exercise of its fiduciary authority, may determine whether to pursue the Plan's rights to reimbursement or subrogation.
- The Plan shall have the right to join or intervene in any suit or claim against a responsible third party brought by Participant or on the Participant's behalf.
- No Participant or his/her representatives may assign any rights or causes of action that they might have against a third-party tortfeasor, person, or entity, which would grant the covered individual the right to recover medical expenses or other damages, without the express, prior written consent of the Plan. The Plan's subrogation and reimbursement rights apply even if the Participant or covered individual has died as a result of their personal injuries and is asserting a wrongful death or survivor claim against the third party under the laws of any state. The Plan's right to recover by subrogation or reimbursement shall apply to any settlements, recoveries, or causes of action owned or obtained by a decedent, minor, incompetent, or disabled person.

Reimbursement will not exceed:

- The amount of benefits paid by the plan for the illness, sickness, or bodily injury, plus the amount of all future benefits that may become payable under the plan that result from the illness, sickness, or bodily injury. The plan will have the right to offset or recover such benefits from the amount received from the other party, and/or
- The amount recovered from the other party, or parties

If the member recovers payments from any of the sources identified above and fails to reimburse the Microsoft plan, the Microsoft plan may reduce future benefits by the amount received from the other party, or parties.

Working with the Microsoft health plan

The member or the member's legal representative must:

- Notify the Microsoft plan in writing whenever benefits are paid under the Plan that arise out of any injury, sickness or other condition that provides or may provide the Plan subrogation or reimbursement rights.

- Notify the Microsoft plan in writing of any terms or conditions offered in a settlement before accepting any settlement or recovery on a claim against the other party
- Notify the other party of the Microsoft plan's interest in the settlement established by this provision
- Cooperate fully with the Microsoft plan in asserting its subrogation and reimbursement rights
- Provide all information and sign and return all documents necessary to exercise the Microsoft plan's right under this provision within 14 business days of receiving a request from the Microsoft plan

If the member or the member's legal representative fails to cooperate fully as described above, they will be personally liable to the Microsoft plan for the amount paid on the member's behalf.

In the event that the Plan advances moneys or provides benefits for an injury, sickness, or other conditions, and the member recovers moneys or benefits from a third party in the amount of the moneys or benefits advanced; or in the event that there is a disagreement regarding reimbursement of the Plan's subrogation amount at the time of settlement, the Plan has an equitable lien in connection with such amounts and the member or the member's legal representative agrees to hold any recovered funds in trust or in a segregated account for the benefit of the Plan until the Plan's subrogation and reimbursement rights are fully determined.

Other Reimbursements

If you receive any payment, reimbursement, or refund from any party for any item or service that previously was furnished to you and covered by the Plan, you must notify the Plan as soon as possible. The Plan will have the right to recover from you any and all amounts paid, reimbursed, or refunded that previously were paid or reimbursed by the Plan. To the extent that any such amounts previously were paid by you (e.g., deductibles, coinsurance, or copayments), the Plan still may need to adjust your deductible and/or coinsurance or out of pocket maximum amounts as necessary to account for the subsequent payment, reimbursement, or refund to you.

Noncompliance

If the Participant receives a recovery but does not promptly segregate the recovery funds and reimburse the Plan in full from those funds, the Plan shall be entitled to take action to recover the reimbursement amount. Such action shall include, but shall not be limited to:

- a. Initiating an action against the Participant and/or the Participant's attorneys to compel compliance with this Section;
- b. Withholding or suspending benefits payable to or on behalf of the Participant and the Participant's eligible Dependents until the Participant complies or until the reimbursement amount has been fully paid to the Plan; or
- c. Initiating other appropriate actions.

If the Participant does not reimburse the Plan after receiving the recovery, the Participant shall be responsible for paying the Plan a reasonable interest per month on the reimbursement amount until the Plan receives reimbursement in full.

Conclusion of Claim

Once a Participant has settled or received an award or judgment or any type of recovery on a claim or suit against a responsible third party, the Participant shall hold any proceeds of a recovery in trust until the Plan's rights and interests in such Recovery have been resolved and satisfied.

Section I: Who's eligible



The Microsoft plan administrator has the exclusive responsibility and complete discretionary authority to control the operation and administration of this Plan, with all powers necessary to enable it to properly carry out such responsibility, including, but not limited to, the power to construe and interpret the terms of this summary plan description and any other Plan documentation.

Section II: Enrollment

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When you may enroll or make changes



COBRA enrollees – for more information about how to enroll, as well as a link to the COBRA enrollment tool, go to [.Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

You may make benefit elections for you and your eligible dependents using the Benefits Enrollment tool at the following times:

- As a new employee, within 30 calendar days of your hire date
- During the annual open enrollment period in November for coverage effective the following January 1
- If you experience a [qualifying life event](#), you can make limited changes to your benefits during the year

Otherwise, you cannot make changes to your benefit elections until the next annual open enrollment period. The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year.



You may use the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#) at any time to review your benefits information and update your beneficiary designations. The Benefits Enrollment tool lists your benefit options, the amount Microsoft pays for your coverage, and the amount (if any) you pay.



You may make changes to your Health Savings Account (“HSA”) contributions at any time on the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#). Changes to your HSA contributions are effective on the first day of the month following the change.

How to enroll

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COBRA enrollees – the How to enroll section does not apply

Charge for spouse/domestic partner medical coverage

When you enroll your eligible spouse/domestic partner for benefits, you will need to indicate whether they are also eligible for medical coverage through their employer.

There is no charge if your spouse/domestic partner is not eligible for other medical coverage. However, if they are eligible and waive that coverage, there is an additional charge of \$250 per month for coverage in a Microsoft medical plan.

The charge does not apply if your spouse/domestic partner enrolls for coverage through their employer and you enroll them as a dependent in a Microsoft medical plan. The Microsoft plan will coordinate payments to ensure the total paid by both plans will not exceed the total amount charged. Review the [Coordination of Benefits](#) section for more information.

If you do not indicate whether your spouse/domestic partner is eligible for other coverage when you enroll, you will automatically be charged the additional \$250 per month. If you and your spouse or eligible domestic partner are both employed by Microsoft and one of you waives coverage and is enrolled as a dependent under the other employee’s coverage, there is no additional charge.

Note: Changes to your enrollment status that require the addition or removal of the \$250 per month charge for spouse/domestic partner medical coverage will apply prospectively only, for pay periods following the date that you finalize the election change in the Benefits Enrollment tool.

Taxes and your benefits

Certain benefits will be recorded as taxable income, or imputed income, in your paycheck and W-2 statement according to Internal Revenue Service (IRS) regulation, including:

- The value of medical, vision, and dental coverage for your domestic partner and children of your domestic partner who are not your tax dependents
- Microsoft contributions to employee life insurance coverage above \$50,000
- Perks+, or PRO Club membership
- The value of long-term disability coverage

In addition, in certain limited states, Microsoft contributions and your payroll contributions to your Health Savings Account (with the Health Savings Plan) may be taxable at the state level. Consult with your personal tax adviser for more information.

Waiving coverage

You may waive coverage by signing on to the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#) and electing the waive coverage option during your enrollment period.

If you decide to waive medical or dental coverage, the next opportunity for you to change your coverage options will be during the next annual open enrollment period, unless you experience a qualifying status change as described in the [Qualifying life events](#) section. The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year. Changes made during the open enrollment period will take effect on January 1st.

What Microsoft pays for coverage

Microsoft contributes to the cost of your benefit coverage as follows:

Benefit	Microsoft contributions
Medical and prescription drug	Microsoft provides coverage with no monthly premium costs for you and your eligible dependents Microsoft contributes to your Health Savings Account if you're enrolled in the Health Savings Plan (Premera)
Vision	Microsoft provides coverage with no monthly premium costs for you and your eligible dependents
Dental	Microsoft provides coverage with no monthly premium costs for you and your eligible dependents
Spring Health, employee assistance program (EAP)	Microsoft provides coverage for you and your eligible dependents
Life	Microsoft provides employee life insurance coverage equal to three times your annual base pay up to a maximum 10 times your annual base pay, up to a maximum of \$4,000,000, whichever is less.
Long-term disability	Microsoft provides long-term disability coverage equal to 60% of your pre-disability monthly earnings up to a maximum of \$15,000 per month
Perks+	• Microsoft provides the Perks+ benefit, which is considered taxable income to you. • The Perks+ benefit allows for up to \$1,500* in reimbursement of program eligible, employee only expenses. • If you live in Washington State, you can choose to enroll in Perks+, or the PRO Club. If you elect PRO Club as your Perks+ option for 2026, Microsoft will pay an annual amount of \$1715.72 toward your PRO Club membership. You will be responsible for a \$67 per month cost share., withheld on an after-tax basis from your paycheck. This translates into an annual membership value of \$2,514.25 (\$1715.72 paid by Microsoft plus \$798.54 paid by you). The amount Microsoft pays for your PRO Club benefit is also considered taxable income. Assuming a 22 percent supplemental tax rate, \$377.46 (based on \$1715.72) is the amount of imputed income you'd pay annually. Supplemental tax rate will vary based on your income. Consult your tax advisor for specific information.

* New hires and employees newly eligible for Perks+ receive \$1,500 if first hired/eligible between January 1 – June 30, \$750 if first hired/eligible between July 1 – September 30, or \$375 if first hired/eligible between October 1 – December 31.

First-time enrollment

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COBRA enrollees – the First-time (new hire) enrollment section does not apply

When to enroll

You have 30 days from your hire date to make your benefit elections or waive coverage using the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#). If you do not enroll within this 30-day enrollment period, you will automatically be enrolled in default coverage as described below.



During the enrollment process, you will need to designate beneficiaries for your life, accidental death & dismemberment, and long-term disability benefits.

When coverage begins

You're eligible for benefits on your hire date, and benefit coverage begins as follows:

Benefit	Coverage begins
Medical (including prescription drug)	Your hire date
Vision	Your hire date
Dental	Your hire date
Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)	Your hire date
Health Savings Account (HSA)	If your coverage under the Health Savings Plan begins on the first day of the month, your HSA will be effective the same day. If your medical coverage begins after the first day of the month, your HSA becomes effective on the first day of the following month.
Spring Health (EAP)	Your hire date
Employee and dependent life insurance	Your enrollment date (subject to satisfactory evidence of insurability (EOI) and active at work requirements for life insurance).
Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)	Your enrollment date
Long-term disability (LTD)	Your enrollment date
Group legal	Your enrollment date

Benefit	Coverage begins
Perks+	Your hire date

If you take no action (default coverage)

If you do not enroll or waive benefits through the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#), you will be enrolled only in the default coverage as summarized below. The costs of default coverage are paid in full by Microsoft and some coverage will result in taxable income to you. Note that default coverage covers only the employee and does not provide coverage for your dependents.



You have 30 days from your hire date to make your benefit coverage elections. Otherwise, your next opportunity to make changes is the annual open enrollment period or if you have a [qualifying life event](#). The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year.

Benefit	Default coverage	Taxable income
Medical and prescription drug	Surest Health Plan for employees whose principal residence is outside King County, WA, Snohomish County, WA, or Hawaii; Health Connect Plan (Premera) for employees whose principal residence is in King or Snohomish County, WA; or, Hawaii Only Plan (Premera) for employees whose principal residence is in Hawaii	No
Vision	EyeMed Vision	No
Dental	Dental Plus	No
Life	Three times your annual base pay*	Yes
Long-term disability	60% coverage level	Yes
Perks+	Reimbursement up to \$1,500**	Yes

* The minimum coverage amount you may elect is \$50,000. Maximum default is \$750,000 – the highest amount allowable without evidence of insurability. The value of Microsoft contributions to employee life insurance coverage above \$50,000 is taxable income.

**New hires and employees newly eligible for Perks+ receive \$1,500 if first hired/eligible between January 1 – June 30, \$750 if first hired/eligible between July 1 – September 30, or \$375 if first hired/eligible between October 1 – December 31.

Open enrollment

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COBRA enrollees – the Open enrollment section does apply. For more information as well as a link to the COBRA enrollment tool, go to [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

When to enroll

The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year. Open Enrollment is your annual opportunity to make changes to your benefit elections, including adding or deleting coverage for your dependents. You may review and submit any changes to your elections in the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#).

If you are an employee on leave during the open enrollment period for the entirety or only a portion of open enrollment, you will be notified of open enrollment by mail. You must submit any changes to your benefit elections via the Benefits Enrollment tool or the enclosed enrollment form before the end of the enrollment period.

Typically, you cannot make changes to your benefit elections outside the annual open enrollment period. However, you can make certain coverage changes during the calendar year if you have a [qualifying life event](#).



Removing a dependent during Open Enrollment is not a COBRA qualifying event so COBRA coverage will not be made available to the dropped dependent when they lose coverage on January 1st. However, if you remove a dependent from coverage during Open Enrollment in anticipation of a future qualifying event (such as a divorce, legal separation, annulment, or dissolution of domestic partnership), the dependent will be deemed to have been enrolled in Microsoft benefits coverage on the day before the qualifying event, and therefore may become eligible for COBRA coverage after the qualifying event.

When coverage begins

The changes you make during open enrollment are effective the following January 1.

If you take no action

If you do not make changes to your benefit elections during Open Enrollment through the Benefits Enrollment tool, your current coverage will continue uninterrupted, except your participation in the

flexible spending accounts (FSAs) will only continue automatically to the extent you have a carryover from the prior plan year.

Life event enrollment

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COBRA enrollees – for qualifying life event changes, call the Microsoft COBRA Service Center at (833) 253-4929. For additional information, go to the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

When to enroll

You can make certain benefit changes outside of open enrollment if you have a qualifying life event as described below. The benefit changes must be consistent with the qualifying life event you experience, as required by Federal law. You may make changes to your Health Savings Account ("HSA") contributions at any time, whether or not you have experienced a qualifying life event. New HSA contribution elections are effective the first day of the month following the change.

If you experience one of these status changes, you must make any changes to your benefit elections using the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#) or by contacting Benefits within:

- 30 days of the event that produced the change in status, or
- 60 days of the event for divorce or legal separation, or
- 90 days of the event for a marriage, the establishment of a domestic partnership, birth, legal adoption (or placement for adoption), or legal guardianship of a child or a child of a domestic partner



You may not change your elections in the following benefits outside of the annual open enrollment period:

- Long-term disability (LTD)
- Group legal
- Perks+



For active employees, removing a dependent during Open Enrollment is not a COBRA qualifying event so COBRA coverage will not be made available to the dropped dependent when they lose coverage on January 1st. However, if you remove a dependent from coverage during Open Enrollment in anticipation of a future qualifying event (such as a divorce, legal separation, annulment, or dissolution of domestic partnership), the dependent will be **deemed** to have been enrolled in Microsoft benefits coverage on the day before the qualifying event, and therefore may become eligible for COBRA coverage after the qualifying event.

Qualifying life events

Special enrollment events

Under the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA), you may change your medical (including prescription drug and vision) coverage if you lose other coverage or acquire a spouse or dependent. Though not required by HIPAA, Microsoft allows coverage changes for other benefits, such as dental, General Purpose and Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA, dependent care FSA, and arrangements for domestic partners and their children if they are otherwise eligible for coverage. These special enrollment events include:

- Your marriage or establishment of your domestic partnership
- The birth or legal adoption (or placement for adoption) of a child, or a child of your domestic partner
- You or your spouse/domestic partner being named legal guardian of a child as appointed by the courts (or recognized as guardian by the state of residence)
- You or your eligible dependent becomes eligible for assistance under a Medicaid or state child health plan
- The loss of other health coverage by you or your eligible dependent, if not currently enrolled in Microsoft coverage, due to:
 - The exhaustion of COBRA coverage
 - The loss of eligibility due to change in employment
 - The end of employer contributions, resulting in a higher cost of coverage
 - The loss of eligibility for coverage under a Medicaid or state child health plan

If you experience a special enrollment event, you may make the following changes, as long as these changes are due to and consistent with the reason for the status change:

- Add medical (including prescription drug and vision) or dental coverage for yourself or your eligible dependents

- **Note:** Adding eligible dependents to your plan or changing your medical plan may result in an increase to your annual deductible and coinsurance maximum. If you have questions, please contact AskHR@microsoft.com.

- Change medical coverage options
- Begin, increase, decrease, or end participation in the flexible spending accounts (FSAs)
- Add or delete dependent life insurance coverage, except for the special enrollment events of you or your eligible dependent becoming eligible for assistance under a Medicaid or state child health plan, or the loss of other health coverage by you or your eligible dependent
- Increase/decrease employee life insurance coverage, but only in the events of your marriage, establishment of your domestic partnership, the birth or legal adoption (or placement for adoption) of a child, or a child of your domestic partner, or you or your spouse/domestic partner being named legal guardian of a child as appointed by the courts (or recognized as guardian by the state of residence)

Add or change between employee and family tier, and/or change the coverage amount, for accidental death and dismemberment (AD&D) coverage, but only in the event of your marriage, establishment of your domestic partnership, birth, legal adoption (or placement for adoption) of a child, or a child of your domestic partner, or you or your spouse/domestic partner being named legal guardian of a child as appointed by the courts (or recognized as guardian by the state of residence).

Changes to your benefit elections for these life events will take effect as of the date that you make the election change, except as follows:

- Changes to your medical, dental, and Spring Health employee assistance program coverage will take effect as of the date of the special enrollment event (marriage, birth, legal adoption, etc.).
Note: Changes to your enrollment status that require the addition or removal of the \$250 per month charge for spouse/domestic partner medical coverage will apply prospectively only, for pay periods following the date that you make the election change in the Benefits Enrollment tool.
- Changes to add one or more dependents to General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA coverage will take effect as of the date of the special enrollment event (marriage, birth, legal adoption, etc.), meaning eligible expenses incurred by the newly added dependent(s) after that date may be reimbursed from the FSA. However, any change in the amount of your FSA election, and resulting payroll contributions, will take effect prospectively only, for pay periods following the date that you make the election change.
- Changes to your employee HSA contributions will take effect as of the first day of the month following the date that you make the election change

Example

Birgit is enrolled in employee only medical coverage on the Health Savings Plan. Birgit has a baby, and within 90 days of the birth adds the baby to medical coverage on the Health Savings Plan, moving to employee +1 coverage. That new plan tier (employee +1) begins on the baby's date of birth, which means Birgit's annual deductible and coinsurance maximum will increase effective as of the baby's date of birth due to the tier change from employee only to employee +1 coverage.

Example

Example

Yukio is enrolled in medical coverage on the Health Connect Plan with their spouse Chiyo. Yukio has a baby and within 90 days of the birth adds the baby to their medical coverage. Yukio uses this qualifying event to switch from the Health Connect Plan to the Health Savings Plan. Because Yukio, Chiyo, and their baby are now enrolled in medical coverage, Yukio has employee +2 coverage on the Health Savings Plan. The new coverage begins on the baby's date of birth, so the applicable Health Savings Plan benefits (including the Health Savings Plan deductible and co-insurance maximum) also begin that day. However, any cost sharing expenses that Yukio and Chiyo incurred under the Health Connect Plan for the year, prior to the baby's birth, will be credited to the applicable Health Savings Plan deductible and coinsurance maximum for the remainder of the year.

Other life events

If you experience any of the following life events, you may be eligible to make limited benefit changes for yourself or your eligible dependents.

- A divorce, legal separation, or an annulment, or the dissolution of your domestic partnership
- The death of an eligible dependent
- A change in dependent child's status such that they satisfy, or no longer satisfy, the requirements for dependent status
- A change in employment for you or your spouse/domestic partner, even if this change does not affect your eligibility for coverage (gain or loss of job, change in hours worked, taking, or returning from unpaid leave)
- A change of residence for you or your eligible dependent (for example, an interstate transfer that results in a change of eligibility for a medical plan)
- You or your eligible dependent become eligible for Medicare or Medicaid
- The issuance of a qualified medical child support order (QMCSO) with respect to the health coverage for your eligible dependent child
- A significant change in dependent care cost or coverage for you or your spouse/domestic partner



You may be eligible (but not required) to make limited changes for certain life events, but you are required to remove your spouse or domestic partner dependent in the case of a divorce, legal separation, annulment, or the dissolution of your domestic partnership.

If you experience one of these other life events listed above, you may make changes to the following benefits, as long as these changes are due to and consistent with the reason for the status change:

- Add medical (including prescription drug and vision) or dental coverage for yourself
- Add or delete medical (including prescription drug and vision) or dental coverage for your eligible dependents
- Begin, increase, decrease, or end participation in the flexible spending account (FSA). (If you increase your FSA contribution, you may not be reimbursed for eligible expenses beyond your prior contribution if they occurred before the change.)
- Add or delete dependent life insurance coverage, *except* for the special enrollment events of a change of residence for you or your eligible dependent; you or your eligible dependent becoming eligible for Medicare or Medicaid; issuance of a QMCSO with respect to the health coverage for your eligible

dependent child; or a significant change in dependent care cost or coverage for you or your spouse/domestic partner

- Increase/decrease employee life insurance coverage, but only in the event of your divorce, legal separation, or annulment, or the dissolution of your domestic partnership
- Add or change between employee and family tier, and/or change the coverage amount, for accidental death and dismemberment (AD&D) coverage, except for the special enrollment events of you or your eligible dependent becoming eligible for Medicare or Medicaid, issuance of a QMCSO with respect to the health coverage for your eligible dependent child, or a significant change in dependent care cost or coverage for you or your spouse/domestic partner.
- Change from PRO Club to Perks+* if you move residences out of the eligible area (Washington State) for PRO Club.

Changes to your benefit elections for these life events will take effect as of the date of the election. The one exception is for changes due to a divorce, legal separation, annulment, or the dissolution of your domestic partnership, which will take effect as of the date of the qualifying event.

*If you become newly eligible for Perks+ between January 1 – June 30 your reimbursement limit is \$1,500. If you become newly eligible between July 1 – September 30 your reimbursable limit is \$750 and if you become newly eligible between October 1 – December 31 your reimbursement limit will be \$375.



In addition to the rules above, if you are in a domestic partnership you may make changes to the dependent care or General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA if the change in status affects you or your child or children, but not if the change in status affects your domestic partner or your domestic partner's child or children who are not your tax dependents.

We reserve the right to request or require that you provide documentation proving the qualifying event that supports any benefit change you make under this section.

Examples of consistency rule

The benefit changes you make must be due to and consistent with the reason for the status change, as demonstrated in the following examples. The Benefits Enrollment tool will request information about your life event to determine which benefit changes meet IRS requirements.

Example

Jodi's (a Microsoft employee) family is covered by benefits through Jodi's spouse's employer. If eligibility for coverage through Jodi's spouse's employer is terminated due to Jodi's spouse losing their job, the following changes may be made to Jodi's Microsoft benefits:

- Enroll or change coverage in medical and dental
- Enroll or increase coverage in the General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA
- Change or stop coverage in the dependent care FSA
- Enroll, change, or stop spouse life insurance coverage.
- Enroll for child life insurance if not previously enrolled
- Enroll or change from employee only to family AD&D coverage.

Changes are not permitted for long-term disability, group legal, or Perks+ outside of the annual open enrollment period.

Example

Terika and their partner adopt a baby. Terika may make the following changes to their Microsoft benefits:

- Enroll or change medical plans, and add dependents
- Enroll in dental, and add dependents
- Enroll or increase coverage in the General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA
- Enroll or increase coverage in the dependent care FSA
- Enroll or change child life insurance coverage
- Increase/decrease employee life insurance coverage, or add dependent life insurance coverage for the baby
- Enroll or change from employee only to family AD&D

Changes are not permitted for long-term disability, group legal, or Perks+ outside of the annual open enrollment period.

Example

Joe contributes to the dependent care flexible spending account (FSA) for their stepchild who lives with Joe. If Joe's spouse changes from full-time to part-time work, and loses eligibility for medical and dental coverage, Joe can:

- Change the contribution amount to the dependent care FSA
- Enroll or add dependents to the medical and dental plans
- Enroll or increase General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA coverage

Changes are not permitted for long-term disability, group legal, or Perks+ outside of the annual open enrollment period.

Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

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Surest Health Plan	250	Deleted: 249



COBRA enrollees – the Medical and prescription drugs section applies

Introduction

Microsoft provides comprehensive medical, vision, and prescription drug coverage for you and your family to help you get and stay well. This introduction provides an overview of these options and common plan terms and conditions. For specific information on the plans available refer to the section on each plan option.

You may not assign your legal rights or rights to any payments under this Plan, nor may you use your right to benefits as security or collateral. The designation of an authorized representative to act on your behalf will not constitute an assignment of benefits under the plan. Notwithstanding the foregoing, the Plan may choose to remit payments directly to health care providers with respect to covered services rendered to you, but only as a convenience to Participants. Health care providers are not, and shall not be construed as, either "participants" or "beneficiaries" under this Plan and have no rights to receive benefits from the Plan under any circumstances.

Your plan options

All Microsoft employees are eligible to enroll themselves and their eligible dependents for medical coverage, which includes prescription drug coverage. Microsoft pays the cost of covering you and your eligible dependents on these plans, which means you pay no premiums for coverage.

Where you live determines which plans are available to you—the Health Savings Plan and Surest Health Plan are national plans (except Hawaii), and the HMO and Hawaii Only plans are available only in specific states.

	Health Savings Plan (Premera)	Surest Health Plan	Hawaii Only Plan (Premera)	Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington HMO Plan	Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan
Eligible employees	Employees in all states except Hawaii	Employees in all states except Hawaii	Employees in Hawaii	Employees in Washington	Employees in California

If you enroll in a Premera plan and you live in an area with few or no Premera in-network providers, you will be enrolled for Access coverage in the Health Savings Plan. Access coverage provides in-network coverage for care with providers and facilities outside the Premera network. Network availability is determined by the Premera and national Blue Cross Blue Shield standard criteria. This coverage will remain in effect until a provider network is established in your area.

All of our medical plans cover services as long as they are medically necessary and provided by an eligible provider. All of the benefits for each medical plan are subject to the plan's exclusions and limitations and

each benefit may have additional eligibility criteria and exclusions and limitations. Review the following sections for each medical plan for more information on what is covered.



Visit the [vision](#) section for information about your vision coverage.



Medically necessary services or supplies meet certain criteria, including:

- It is essential to the diagnosis or the treatment of an illness, accidental injury, or condition that is harmful or threatening to the patient's life or health, unless it is provided for preventive services when specified as covered under the plan
- It is appropriate for the medical condition as specified in accordance with authoritative medical or scientific literature and generally accepted standards of medical practice

Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

How the plans work

All of the Microsoft medical plans cover preventive care at 100% with in-network providers. For other care, you pay a share of the costs up to an annual maximum amount.

Each medical plan features a comprehensive network of providers and facilities where you may receive care at lower, negotiated rates. The HMO plans do not typically cover out-of-network care. The Health Savings Plan,

Surest Health Plan, and Hawaii Only Plan cover in- or out-of-network care but provide more value if you use in-network providers.

In-network vs. out-of-network care

If you enroll in the Health Savings Plan, Surest Health Plan, or Hawaii Only Plan you receive the highest level of coverage and have the lowest out-of-pocket costs if you seek care from any of the providers or facilities in your medical plan's network. Additional advantages of staying in-network include:

- Your provider files claims for you directly with Premiera and Surest
- Lower, negotiated rates for care and prescriptions, called the allowable charge
- Your provider accepts the allowable charge as payment in full; you are not charged any additional costs



The **allowable charge** generally is the negotiated amount that in-network providers have agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. Out-of-network providers may not accept the allowable charge as payment in full.

Note: The Plan will not discriminate against a health care professional or facility that acts within the scope of its license or certification under applicable state laws when choosing in-network health care professionals and facilities.

Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

If you obtain care from an out-of-network provider or facility, services generally are covered at a lower out-of-network benefit level. Except as provided under Federal Surprise Billing Protection, the allowable charge is the least of the three amounts shown below:

- An amount that is no less than the lowest amount we pay for the same or similar service from a comparable in-network provider
- 125% of the fee schedule determined by the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (Medicare), if available
- The provider's billed charges
- The repriced amount, for claims that are repriced in accordance with Premiera's procedures (Premiera only)

The allowable charge may be adjusted pursuant to the plan administrator's payment policies. For more information or assistance in determining whether or how your plan administrator's payment policies may impact the allowable charge for a particular claim, contact their customer service at:

- Premiera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411
- Surest Customer Service at (866) 222-1298

Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Additional considerations include:

- You may have to pay the provider and submit a claim for reimbursement
- Coverage under the plan is limited to the allowable charge; you are responsible for any amount the provider charges above the allowable charge, where applicable

Below is an example of how much you can save through the negotiated rates that you receive with in-network providers.

Out-of-network charge, subject to deductible	In-network charge (allowable charge), subject to deductible	In-network provider savings
\$150	\$100	\$50

Federal No Surprise Billing Protection

Out-of-network providers generally have the right to charge you more than the Plan's allowed amount or allowable charge for a covered service. This is called "balance billing." However, Federal law protects you from balance billing for the following types of services:

- Emergency Care from an out-of-network hospital or independent freestanding emergency department.
- Out-of-network air ambulance services
- Any services from an out-of-network provider at an in-network hospital, hospital outpatient department, critical access hospital, or outpatient surgical center, provided that the out-of-network provider may balance bill you if the provider gives you advance notice and you provide your written consent, except for the following services (for which balance billing is never permitted):

Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

- Assistant Surgeon
- Anesthesia
- Pathology
- Radiology
- Laboratory
- Hospitalist Care

Solely for purposes of determining your cost-sharing obligations for these services, the allowed amount or allowable charge is the lesser of (1) the out-of-network provider's or facility's billed charges, or (2) the Plan's median in-network rate for the same or similar service provided in the same or similar specialty in the same geographic area (or any other amount specified for this purpose under applicable law).

Please Note: These balance billing protections do not apply to any other service from an out-of-network provider or facility. If the service is not listed above, the provider or facility may bill you for, and you may be required to pay, any amounts in excess of the plan's allowed amount for the service (and any amounts that you pay in excess of the allowed amount will not count toward any applicable deductible, coinsurance, or out-of-pocket maximum).

Plan comparison

The table below compares the four medical plans on various characteristics. For complete details, review the following sections on each medical plan.

	Health Savings Plan (Premera)	Hawaii Only Plan (Premera)	Surest Health Plan	Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington HMO Plan	Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan
Deciding where to get care	- You decide each time you need medical care whether to use providers who are in-network or providers who are out-of-network - When you need care, you can choose your doctors, including specialists. You do not need a referral to receive care.		- You decide each time you need medical care whether to use providers who are in-network or providers who are out-of-network - When you need care, you can choose your doctors, including specialists. You do not need a referral to receive care.	- You will be required to select a Primary Care Provider for each covered family member. - Your Primary Care Provider directs your care, including referrals to specialists.	
In-network vs. out-of-network	- Your out-of-pocket costs vary depending on whether you use in-network providers or out-of-network providers. - Your costs are lower when you use an in-network provider.		- Your out-of-pocket costs vary depending on whether you use in-network providers or out-of-network providers. - Your costs are lower when you use an in-network provider.	Benefits are generally available only when utilizing the services of the HMO network providers. With few exceptions, out-of-network care is not covered.	

Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

	Health Savings Plan (Premera)	Hawaii Only Plan (Premera)	Surest Health Plan	Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington HMO Plan	Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan
Cost sharing	- Preventative care is covered and paid in full, when using in-network providers. - You pay 100% of your eligible expenses for medical care and prescriptions until you spend up to the amount of the deductible. - If you reach the deductible, then you begin to pay a portion of the cost, called coinsurance, up to the coinsurance maximum. The coinsurance amount you pay depends on whether you seek care in or out-of-network. - If you meet your deductible and then you reach your coinsurance maximum, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses for the rest of the year.		- Preventative care is covered and paid in full, when using in-network providers. - For most services, you pay a flat copayment - If you meet your annual out-of-pocket maximum, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses for the rest of the year.	- Preventive care from an HMO network provider is covered and paid in full. - For most services, you pay a flat copayment - If you have an inpatient hospital stay, you pay 10% of the cost - If you meet your out-of-pocket maximum, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses for the rest of the year.	- Preventive care from an HMO network provider is covered and paid in full. - For most services, you pay a flat copayment - If you have an inpatient hospital stay, you pay 10% of the cost - Coinsurance and most copayments are limited by an annual out-of-pocket maximum
Filing a claim	- If using in-network benefits, your provider will file claims to the health plan on your behalf. - If using out-of-network benefits, you may be required to file a claim for reimbursement of the medical expenses.		- If using in-network benefits, your provider will file claims to the health plan on your behalf. - If using out-of-network benefits, you may be required to file a claim for reimbursement of the medical expenses.	Generally, no claim forms required.	
Coverage out of the country	- Urgent or emergent services will be paid as emergency care. - Non-emergent facility and professional services are considered out-of-network and covered at 70% of billed charges. Standard deductible and coinsurance apply.		- Urgent or emergent services will be paid as emergency care. Members must submit a medical claim reimbursement form. - Non-emergent services will be processed as out-of-network based on billed charges.	Emergency situations that occur outside the country are covered as in-network. There is also a \$2000 benefit per member per year for non-emergent claims incurred outside the area.	

Section III: Medical and prescription drugs



Deductible is the amount of covered medical costs you must pay each calendar year before the Plan begins to pay its share of allowable charges.

Copayment is a fixed, up-front dollar amount that you're required to pay for certain covered services.

Coinsurance The percentage of the allowable charge that you are required to pay for certain covered services.

Out-of-pocket maximum is the most you could pay each plan year for covered services and supplies.



If you leave Microsoft, you may be eligible to continue your health coverage. For more information, visit the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Health Savings Plan (Premera)

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How the plan works

The Health Savings Plan provides comprehensive medical coverage and the flexibility to see any provider you choose.

This plan features a Microsoft-funded [Health Savings Account](#) that you can use to cover eligible health care expenses. Here's how they work together:

- The **Health Savings Plan** is your **health coverage**, and provides coverage for health care that you might need during the year
- The **Health Savings Account** is a **custodial/bank account** that comes with certain tax benefits when you use it to pay for health care expenses now, or in the future

Where you can get care

With the Health Savings Plan, you have the flexibility to visit the provider or facility you choose and still have coverage. However, providers in the nationwide Premera Blue Cross Blue Shield network feature certain advantages, including:

- Your provider files claims directly with Premera
- Lower, negotiated rates for care and prescriptions
- The highest coverage levels

If you seek care with an out-of-network provider or facility, your out-of-pocket costs will be higher, and you may have to pay the provider and then submit a claim for reimbursement.

Review the [What you pay](#) section for information on coverage levels.

Finding an in-network provider

In Washington State, you can maximize your savings by using providers and facilities in the Premera network. In California, we have made an arrangement for you as a Premera Blue Cross member with Anthem Blue Cross. In order for you to maximize your in-network savings for services received in California, you will need to choose only Anthem Blue Cross network providers.

Note: Blue Shield of California network providers are not considered in-network for purposes of the Health Savings Plan, unless (and to the extent) that they are also Anthem Blue Cross network providers.

Outside of Washington and California, you may use any Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield provider throughout the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands under the [BlueCard®](#) Program. Your Premera identification card tells contracting providers that you are covered through this inter-plan arrangement. It's important to note that receiving services through BlueCard does not change covered benefits, benefit levels, or any stated residence requirements of this plan.

Visit the online Premera Medical Directory to find an in-network provider in the United States or call Premera Blue Cross at (800) 676-1411.

Active employees go here...

Active dependents or COBRA enrollees go here...

[Premera Medical Directory](#).

[Premera.com](#).



Additionally, both active employees and COBRA enrollees also have access to the [Embold Health Provider Guide](#), a tool that helps you find highly rated healthcare providers in your area and insurance network. Embold uses healthcare claims data to score how well a doctor makes the correct diagnosis, chooses the right treatment plan, and delivers the best health outcome. These scores are developed using common and accepted measures in the medical community.

Travel outside the United States

If you are traveling outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands and need care, you may be able to take advantage of [Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core](#), which provides referrals to doctors and other health care providers.



Call (800) 810-BLUE (2583) for Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core referrals to health care providers outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands.

If you are not using a Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core provider, you will need to submit claim forms to Premera for reimbursement of services received outside the United States. When you submit a claim, clearly detail the services received, diagnosis (including standard medical procedure and diagnosis code, or English nomenclature), dates of service, and the names and credentials for the attending provider. Benefits reimbursement will be calculated in U.S. dollars.

Care received outside the United States will be covered as long as the services are:

- Medically necessary
- Provided by a licensed provider performing within the scope of their license and practice
- Not deemed experimental or investigational based on the terms of this plan or medical standards in the United States

Services received outside the United States that are considered urgent or emergent including services received on a cruise ship will be paid as [emergency care](#). Non-emergent facility and professional services are considered out-of-network and covered at 70% of billed charges. Standard deductible and coinsurance would apply. Virtual Care services with a provider located outside of the United States are not covered.



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.



Review the [What you pay](#) section for information on coverage levels.

Filling a prescription

Depending on your needs, you may fill your prescription at a retail pharmacy, pharmacy home delivery, or specialty pharmacy. Review the [prescription drug](#) benefit for more information on what is covered.



Microsoft reserves the right to change pharmacy networks at any time. Such changes will take effect on the date set by the Company, even if this information has not been revised to show the changes.

Coverage	Up to a 90-day supply for generic maintenance medication ; all others are up to a 30-day supply*	Up to 90-day supply* only when using Express Scripts Pharmacy Home Delivery	Up to a 30-day supply* Additional clinical support for members using specialty drugs
In-network pharmacies	Express Scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf To find an Express Scripts retail pharmacy, call (800) 676-1411	Express Scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf	Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy** will bill the plan on your behalf
Out-of-network pharmacies	You will need to submit a prescription reimbursement form, with your receipt, for reimbursement	Not covered	Not covered

* Unless the drug maker's packaging limits the supply in some other way.

** Contact Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy at (877) 223-6447 or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy at (800) 689-6592 to get started.

The dispensing limits (or days' supply) for drugs dispensed at retail and specialty pharmacies, and through the mail-order pharmacy benefit, are described in the chart above.

Members are allowed two retail grace fills for specialty drugs before being required to utilize Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and

- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Generic maintenance medications have a common indication for the treatment of a chronic disease (such as diabetes, high cholesterol, or hypertension). Indications are obtained from the product labeling. They are used for diseases when the duration of the therapy can reasonably be expected to exceed one year. A generic prescription drug is manufactured and distributed after the brand-name drug patent of the innovator company has expired and is available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions. Generic drugs have obtained an AB rating from the U.S. Food and Drug Administration and are considered by the FDA to be therapeutically equivalent to the brand-name product.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for some services and prescriptions to determine that coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Refer to the specific plan benefit for additional details.

What you pay

You pay nothing for preventive care when you use in-network providers. When you receive care or prescription drugs in other situations, such as for the treatment of illnesses, injuries, and chronic conditions, you pay a portion of the cost up to an annual maximum amount. That annual amount, called your out-of-pocket maximum, includes a deductible and coinsurance. If you use in-network providers, you'll receive the lower Premera-negotiated rate, called the allowable charge, and higher coverage levels. Examples of how the plan pays for in- and out-of-network care follow on the next page.

Premera utilizes medical and payment policies in administering coverage under this plan. The medical policies generally are used to further define medical necessity, experimental and investigative status, and other aspects for specific procedures, drugs, biologic agents, devices, and other items and services and levels of care. These medical policies are available at <http://premera.com> or by calling Customer Service. The payment policies are used to define provider billing and payment rules and adjustments that can apply in various different settings and circumstances. These payment policies are available to you by

calling Customer Service and to your provider by calling Customer Service or going to <http://premera.com> and logging into Premera's provider portal.

What you pay					
	Deductible	+	Coinurance	=	Out-of-pocket maximum
	You pay 100% of your eligible expenses for medical care and prescriptions until you spend up to the amount of the deductible. Only the Premera allowable charge is applied to your deductible if you seek out-of-network care. You pay nothing for in-network preventive care. If you reach the deductible, then you begin to pay a portion of the cost, called coinsurance, up to the coinsurance maximum. The coinsurance amount you pay depends on where you seek care: • In-network, you pay 10% • Out-of-network, you generally pay 30% of the allowable charge plus the difference between the provider's bill and the allowable charge; only the allowable charge is applied to your coinsurance maximum If you meet your deductible and then you reach your coinsurance maximum, you have reached your out-of-pocket maximum. From that point forward, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses and you pay nothing for in-network health care services for the rest of the year. You will still be responsible for the difference between the provider's bill and the allowable charge if you seek out-of-network care.				
Employee only	\$1,750		\$1,000		\$2,750
Employee + 1	\$3,500		\$2,000		\$5,500
Employee + 2 or more	\$4,375		\$2,500		\$6,875



The **allowable charge** is defined differently for in-network and out-of-network providers.

- For in-network providers, the allowable charge is the negotiated amount that the provider has agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service.
- For out-of-network providers, the allowable charge is the lowest of three amounts, as outlined in the definition of "allowable charge" in the Glossary. If you choose to use out-of-network providers, you may be responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

Example

Jakob needs to visit an allergist. Jakob can choose an in-network or an out-of-network provider. Both charge \$115. Assume the allowable charge is \$100 for both the in-network and out-of-network provider. The in-network provider accepts Premera's allowable charge of \$100 as full payment. Jakob hasn't yet met the deductible, so Jakob will pay the allowable charge of \$100 to the in-network provider. The out-of-network provider does not have the negotiated agreement with Premera, so Jakob would pay the full \$115, and only the allowable charge of \$100 would apply to Jakob's deductible.

Example

Mimi needs to see a podiatrist. The visit costs \$125. Mimi has met the deductible, so will pay just \$10 for the visit if an in-network provider is used, with a \$100 allowable charge ($\$100 \times 10\%$ coinsurance). If Mimi visits an out-of-network provider, for whom the allowable charge is also \$100, Mimi would pay \$55:

- 30% of the \$100 Premera allowable charge ($\$100 \times 30\%$ coinsurance = \$30)
- Plus, the difference between the out-of-network provider's bill and the allowable charge ($\$125 - \$100 = \$25$)

Example

Kunji has an ear infection. The provider visit costs \$175 and assume the allowable charge is \$150 for both an in-network and out-of-network provider. Kunji has met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year, so will pay nothing if Kunji visits the in-network provider.

If Kunji visits the out-of-network provider, Kunji's cost will be \$25, the difference between the out-of-network provider's bill and the allowable charge ($\$175 - \$150 = \$25$).

Expenses covered at 100% NOT applied to the deductible or coinsurance maximum

The following services are covered by the plan at 100% and do not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum.

- [Preventive care](#)
- Care received through the 24-session [Spring Health Employee Assistance Program \(EAP\) benefit](#).
- Care received through Family Health and Reproductive Support (Maven).

Certain other expenses are your responsibility to pay and do not count toward the annual deductible or coinsurance maximum. They include:

- Expenses incurred while the member was not covered under the plan
- Expenses for services, supplies, settings, or providers that are not covered under this plan
- Expenses in excess of annual or lifetime benefit maximums that apply to certain plan benefits. Amounts for out-of-network care in excess of the allowable charge for the service or supply.
- Coinsurance for services covered under the [Weight Management program](#).

Additionally, charges for medical services received during business travel that are applied to the deductible or coinsurance are not reimbursable business expenses.



Review information on how to track your deductible and/or coinsurance.

Active employees go here...

Active dependents and COBRA enrollees go here...

[.My Dashboard](#) on the Benefits site[.Premera.com](#)

Out-of-network care with in-network coverage

You may seek out-of-network care and receive in-network coverage levels in the following situations:

Emergency care	Benefits are provided regardless of network status	Go to the nearest emergency facility
You cannot find the provider specialty that you need in the Premera network	If the Premera network does not include a provider specialty (such as a speech therapist) anywhere in your state, treatment at out-of-network providers may be paid at the in-network level	To confirm this coverage is available, contact Premera at (800) 676-1411
Your provider's contract with Premera is ending (continuity of care)	If you are receiving ongoing treatment for certain serious and complex medical conditions or illnesses, or pregnancy, are undergoing institutional or inpatient care, or are scheduled for nonelective surgery, you may be eligible to continue to receive in-network benefits for the current course of treatment, for up to 90 days.	To confirm this continued in-network coverage is available, and the length of the available in-network coverage extension, contact Premera at (800) 676-1411 prior to the end of your provider's contract with Premera

Annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums

There is no overall annual or lifetime maximum in the Health Savings Plan. However, annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums apply to certain benefits. Review the [What the plan covers](#) section for details on annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums.



A **lifetime benefit maximum** is the most a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

An annual or other benefit maximum is the most a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member for services within a specified time period. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Example

There is a \$6,000 weight management program benefit maximum for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options.

Example

There is a \$10,000 hearing hardware maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan.

Utilization Management

All benefits under this plan are limited to covered services that are medically necessary and as set forth under Plan Benefits. Premera or its designee may review a member's medical records for the purpose of verifying delivery and coverage of services and items. Based on a prospective, concurrent, or retrospective review, Premera may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not medically necessary or do not meet all criteria specified in this SPD. Such determination shall be based on established clinical criteria as described in Premera's medical policies. The medical policies are on Premera's website. You or your provider may review them at premera.com. You or your provider may also request a copy of the criteria used to make a medical necessity decision for a particular condition or procedure. To obtain this information by mail, send your request to Medical Policies Coordinator, 7001 220th Street SW MS 438, Mountlake Terrace, WA 98043-2160.

Premera will not deny coverage retroactively for services it has previously authorized and that have already been provided to the member except in the case of fraud or an intentional misrepresentation of a material fact.

What the plan covers

The tables below summarize what the Health Savings Plan covers, including what the plan pays for in-network and out-of-network care.



Services and supplies must be medically necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#).



CTRL+Click on the benefits below to access more information.

Common benefits

These are the most commonly used benefits in the Health Savings Plan.

Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Preventive Care Including well-child care through age 18, routine gynecological exams, immunizations and preventive prescription drugs (See the Preventive Care Services list and Preventive Drug list)	Preventive services: 100% Preventive prescription drugs: 100%	Preventive services: 100% of allowable charges Preventive prescription drugs: 100%
Prescription drugs Including brand-name preventive with available generic equivalent (see the Health Savings Plan Drug Formulary and preventive care above)	90% after deductible	90% after deductible* *Home delivery and Specialty medications are not covered.

Common benefits		
These are the most commonly used benefits in the Health Savings Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Physician services Including specialists and second surgical opinions rendered in the office, hospital, or other medical facility	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Diagnostic services Benefits are provided for diagnostic services (including lab and imaging services) for health conditions or symptoms.	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Hospital inpatient care Including semi-private room and board, anesthesia, supporting services, testing, supplies, and intensive or coronary care	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Hospital outpatient care/ambulatory surgical care center. Including minor surgery, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia, and pre-admission testing	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Urgent Care.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Rehabilitation – Physical, Occupational and Speech Therapies	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Contraception Contraceptive devices and injections administered by a physician. Prescription forms of contraception are covered under preventive care.	100%	100%
Maternity care (Other than hospital inpatient or outpatient care)	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible

Common benefits		
These are the most commonly used benefits in the Health Savings Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Family Health and Reproductive Support (Maven)	Free virtual care and on-demand support (through Maven Clinic) for navigating family planning, parenting, perimenopause, and menopause.	Not applicable
Mental health counseling, mental health inpatient and outpatient services, and chemical dependency treatment	Outpatient services are available through the Premera network and through Spring Health (administrator for the employee assistance program): Spring Health: - Provides up to 24 Spring Health sessions per calendar year at no cost to the member - Up to two (2) of the 24 sessions may be used for medication management. - Services received beyond the EAP session limit are covered at 90% after the deductible under the Premera plan when provided by Spring Health. Outpatient services are available through Premera at 90% after deductible.	Not applicable
	90% after deductible for inpatient and outpatient services	90% of allowable charges, after deductible for inpatient and outpatient services

Other benefits		
The Health Savings Plan also covers these additional benefits.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Ambulance (Ground or Water)	90% after deductible	90% after deductible
Air Ambulance	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	Combined 24-visit limit per member per calendar year	

Other benefits		
The Health Savings Plan also covers these additional benefits.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
.Diabetes health education.	100%	100% of allowable charges
.Emergency room care and professional services.	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Hearing care and hardware.	Exams: 90% after deductible	Exams: 70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	Hardware: 90% after deductible; \$10,000 maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options	
.Home health care.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Hospice care.	90% after deductible	90% after deductible
.Medical equipment and supplies	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Nutritional therapy.	100%	100% of allowable charges
	First 12 visits per member per calendar year, calendar year visit limit waived for nutritional therapy for a diagnosed eating disorder or diabetes.	
.Skilled nursing facility.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	120-day limit per member per calendar year	
.Surgical weight loss treatment Covered when criteria listed in the Premera Medical Policy on Surgery for Morbid Obesity are met	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Transplants.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
.Vision therapy.	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	32-visit maximum, per member, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options	

Specialized benefits		
Microsoft provides these unique benefits to you through the Health Savings Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Fertility and Family Building Benefit	90% after deductible for coverage, within the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network, of generally two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KHPWA health plan options and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy	Not applicable
Gender Affirming Surgical Services	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Weight Management program Including comprehensive and clinically based weight management programs approved by Premera for the treatment of obesity	80% of charges up to a \$6,000 maximum for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KHPWA health plan options. Deductible and coinsurance maximum do not apply. The 20% coinsurance you pay will not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum and will continue after the deductible and coinsurance are met.	Not applicable

Plan benefits



The following pages provide details on what the plan covers. The plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), including the requirement of medical necessity, apply to these benefits.

24-Hour Nurse Line

The Microsoft 24-Hour Nurse Line is a confidential health-care information service for you and your dependents. The Nurse Line is available 24 hours a day, seven days a week. It provides useful, easy-to-understand health-care information that will help you to make appropriate health-care decisions.

The 24-Hour Nurse Line cannot diagnose illnesses, prescribe treatment, or give medical advice, but they can do the following:

- Provide information, coaching, and support regarding a wide range of health issues, including:
 - Aches and pains
 - Diabetes
 - High blood pressure
 - Illnesses and infections
 - Infant care
 - Immunizations
- Provide information about Microsoft-sponsored health programs such as:
 - Disability leave
 - Ergonomic assistance
 - On-site flu shots
 - On-site mammogram screenings
 - Smoking cessation
 - Weight management
- Offer suggestions about appropriate next steps or available resources.

The average call to the 24-Hour Nurse Line lasts approximately five minutes, so that you can obtain information quickly and can move on to the next step, as advised by the 24-Hour Nurse Line nurse.

The 24-Hour Nurse Line is a service provided by Premera Blue Cross. All Microsoft covered employees and their dependents can access the 24-Hour Nurse Line. The 24-Hour Nurse Line cannot be accessed while traveling outside of the United States.

Accessing the 24-Hour Nurse Line

The toll-free phone number for the 24-Hour Nurse Line is a consolidated phone line. From this one number, Microsoft covered employees and their dependents can access several health-care services, such as the 24-Hour Nurse Line staff of nurses, a professional counselor with the Microsoft Counseling, Assistance, Referral and Education Services (CARES) Employee Assistance Program and health-care coverage information. When you call, listen carefully to the entire greeting before you make your selection.



You can reach an experienced, registered nurse 24 hours a day, seven days a week by calling one of the following options:

- (800) 676-1411
- For deaf or hard-of-hearing access (TTY), call (800) 676-1411 then provide the number 711

Ambulance

Ground or Water

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Air

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers licensed surface (ground or water) and air ambulance transportation to the nearest medical facility equipped to treat the condition when any other mode of transportation would endanger the member's health or safety. This benefit is limited to the member that requires transportation.

For air ambulance services, please see [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) for special rules that apply to out-of-network air ambulance services.

Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers behavioral interventions based on the principles of Applied Behavioral Analysis (ABA) through eligible providers.

Who is eligible

This benefit is available for members who are diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder (*Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, 5th Edition / DSM-5*), or with any of the following Pervasive Developmental Disorders (*International Classification of Diseases, 10th Revision, Clinical Modification / ICD-10-CM*):

- Autistic Disorder
- Childhood Disintegrative Disorder
- Asperger's Syndrome
- Rett's Syndrome
- Other Pervasive Development Disorder/Atypical Autism
- Pervasive Developmental Disorder unspecified

Eligible providers

Licensed providers — Medical doctors (MD); doctors of osteopathic medicine (DO); nurse practitioners (NP, ANP, ARNP, etc.); and master's-level or above mental health clinicians and occupational, physical, and speech therapists, provided that they are providing the ABA services within the scope of their practice and licensure.

Board Certified Behavioral Analysts — BCBAs are certified by the Behavior Analyst Certification Board. These providers have master's or doctoral degrees. For ABA services, typically a BCBA functions as a "Program Manager." The Program Manager conducts behavioral assessments, including functional analyses, and provides behavior analytic interpretations of the results. The Program Manager also designs

and periodically reviews behavior analytic interventions (program development and treatment planning) and may supervise Therapy Assistants. Therapy Assistant services must be billed by the Program Manager.

Covered services

Services must be ordered by the member's treating physician to be covered. Program Manager benefits are available for time used to evaluate the member and document findings and progress reports, and to create and update treatment plans; and time used to train and evaluate the work of the Therapy Assistants working directly with the member to implement the treatment plan.

In most cases, Therapy Assistants will provide the implementation portion of the treatment plan. Therapy Assistant time may be covered for face-to-face, in-person or virtual visits with the member to perform the tasks described in the treatment plan and to document outcomes, and for time to meet with the Program Manager for training and to discuss treatment plan issues. Therapy Assistant services that are billed by a Program Manager will be paid at the Therapy Assistant rate.

ABA services are not covered for the following:

- Babysitting or doing household chores
- Time spent under the care of any other professional
- Travel time
- Home schooling in academics or other academic tutoring
- Activity therapy, such as music, dance or art therapies

Out of network providers

You may be billed for charges assessed above the allowable charges since these providers generally have not agreed to offer discounts to members covered by this plan. Any amounts you pay for charges in excess of allowable charges, will not count towards satisfying any deductible requirements, or the coinsurance maximum that applies under this plan.



The **allowable charge** is defined differently for in-network and out-of-network providers. For in-network providers, the allowable charge is the negotiated amount that the provider has agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. For out-of-network providers, the allowable charge is the lowest of three amounts, as outlined in the definition of "allowable charge" in the Glossary. If you choose to use out-of-network providers, you may be responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Services for this treatment that do not meet criteria described above are subject to retrospective denial of benefits.

Additional exclusions and limitations for autism/ABA therapy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- This benefit is not provided for rehabilitation services (which apply under the [rehabilitation](#) benefit) or mental health services (which apply under the [mental health and chemical dependency](#) benefit).
- Benefits for services provided by volunteers, childcare providers, family members and benefits paid for by state, local and federal agencies will not be covered. Volunteer services or services provided by a family member of the child receiving the services by or through a school, books and other training aids will also not be covered.
- Other unspecified developmental disorders or delays, or any other delay or disorder in a child's motor, speech, cognitive, or social development, are not covered under this benefit.
- This benefit covers only the allowable fees for eligible services performed by the provider and those providing interventions based on principles of ABA and/or related structured behavioral programs under the supervision of the provider. Other expenses associated with providing the treatment, such as the tuition, program fees, travel, meals, and lodging of the provider, expenses of those working under the provider's supervision, the member, and their family members, will not be covered.

Cancer Support (Personalized by Thyme Care)

Microsoft provides access to Thyme Care at no cost to all employees and their eligible dependents aged 18 and older with a suspected or confirmed cancer diagnosis who are covered under a Microsoft U.S. Premera health plan. Thyme Care is a 24/7 evidence-based virtual cancer advocacy and navigation program offering individualized support in-between visits with your oncologist.

If you have cancer, or are caring for someone with cancer, Thyme Care provides:

- **24/7 access:** A Thyme Care expert is available anytime through confidential calls. You can also use Thyme Care Connect or text them for support with your questions or concerns.
- **On-demand nurse support:** Whether you're concerned about potential side effects, need help understanding test results or medications, or simply want more guidance. Thyme Care can translate what the doctors are telling you and provide information to help plan for the road ahead.
- **Collaborative care focused on you:** Thyme Care takes care of your needs between visits and keeps your doctors and care teams updated, so you can rest assured that all the details are connected and nothing gets lost.

- **Support beyond the clinic:** Get connected to the support and services you need. These may include financial help, transportation, in-home care, food assistance or community groups dedicated to supporting cancer patients.
- **Evidence-based resources:** Receive clinically informed content tailored to you with trusted information and expert tips on preparing for treatment, handling worries, talking to doctors, strategies for improving your sleep, exercise routine, and emotional well-being.
- **Support for life after cancer treatment:** Regular check-ins provide tips on ongoing care and helpful wellness information, including sleep, nutrition, exercise, mindfulness, and getting back to normal.

Navigate cancer with confidence. With Thyme Care, you can:

- Learn about your diagnosis and treatment options
- Address urgent concerns and unexpected challenges
- Manage symptoms and side effects
- Get emotional and mental health support
- Identify financial assistance and get help with insurance navigation
- Find in-network doctors or get help seeking a second opinion
- Connect with other helpful Microsoft benefits

To enroll:

Visit thymecare.com/Microsoft and click "Enroll Now" then follow the steps to get started.

If you have any issues or questions, call the Thyme Care team at 1-833-849-6300, and they can help you set up your account.

Thyme Care does not diagnose oncologic conditions or provide cancer-directed therapies, treatments, or prescription of medications.

Thyme Care will not share your medical records or medical information with anyone, including Microsoft or your health plan, unless you specifically authorize such disclosure.

Chemotherapy and Radiation Therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers the following services:

- Outpatient chemotherapy and radiation therapy services, including proton beam radiation therapy when medically necessary
- FDA approved scalp cooling devices (such as DigniCap and Paxman Scalp Cooling System) may be considered medically necessary when used during chemotherapy to prevent hair loss.
- Supplies, solutions, and drugs (See the [Prescription Drugs](#) benefit for oral chemotherapy drugs)

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Childbirth / Maternity Classes

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers childbirth and pregnancy educational classes, including pre-pregnancy planning, pregnancy, childbirth, and Lamaze, breastfeeding, and infant education classes. The benefit is for covered employees and dependents only, although a spouse/domestic partner not covered on the medical plan can attend with the covered individual.

Additional exclusions and limitations for childbirth / maternity classes

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), exercise classes, such as maternity yoga, are excluded from this benefit.

Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 24 visits per member per calendar year chiropractic, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy (combined)

This benefit covers (1) chiropractic services from a licensed chiropractor or other provider licensed to perform chiropractic services, (2) acupuncture services provided, when medically necessary to relieve pain or to treat a covered illness, injury, or condition from a licensed acupuncturist or other provider licensed to perform acupuncture, and (3) medical massage therapy from a provider licensed to perform medical massage therapy, with a physician's prescription. To be covered, these services must be rendered to restore or improve a previously normal physical function and delivered within the provider's scope of practice guidelines.

These covered services must be [medically necessary](#) and will be covered only when the provider is providing the service within the scope of their state license.

These covered services (chiropractic services, acupuncture, medical massage therapy) will accrue cumulatively toward the 24-visit annual maximum. For example, if you visit a chiropractor for covered services 20 times in a calendar year, you will have four visits available for covered medical massage and/or acupuncture services in that calendar year. Covered Massage Therapy services are limited to a maximum of one hour per day.

Clinical Trials

This plan covers the routine costs of a qualified clinical trial. Routine costs are the medically necessary care that is normally covered under this plan for a member who is not enrolled in a clinical trial. The trial must be appropriate for the health condition according to the trial protocol and participating provider or information submitted by the member, and the member must be enrolled in the trial at the time of treatment for which coverage is requested.

Benefits are based on the type of service received. For example, benefits for an office visit are covered under the Professional Visits and Services benefit and lab tests are covered under the Diagnostic Services benefit.

A qualified clinical trial is a phase I, II, III or IV clinical trial that is conducted on the prevention, detection or treatment of cancer or other life-threatening diseases or conditions. The trial must also be funded or approved by a federal body, such as the National Institutes of Health (NIH), the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention; the Agency for Health Care Research and Quality; the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services; a cooperative group or center of any of the above entities or the Department of Defense (DOD) or the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA); the VA, DOD, and Department of Energy if peer-reviewed and approved as per the Secretary of HHS; or a qualified private research entity that meets the standards for NIH support grant eligibility.

Routine patient costs in connection with a "clinical trial" does not include expenses for:

- Costs for treatment that are not primarily for the care of the patient (such as lab tests performed solely to collect data for the trial)
- The investigational item, device, or service itself
- A service that is clearly not consistent with widely accepted and established standards of care for a particular condition

Those interested in this coverage are encouraged to contact customer service at (800) 676-1411 before enrolling in a clinical trial. Customer service can help the member or provider verify that the clinical trial is a qualified clinical trial.

Contraception

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100%

This benefit covers FDA-approved contraceptive devices and injections for contraceptive purposes for women when prescribed by a physician. Included are diaphragms, IUDs, and Depo Provera injections. Removal of contraceptive devices by a physician is also covered. This benefit also covers office visits and consultations related to contraception management.

All FDA-approved single-source brand and generic birth control medications are covered under the [preventive care](#) benefit at 100%.

Dental services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers certain services from a dental provider that would otherwise be covered by this plan if performed by a physician, as long as these services are provided within the scope of the dental provider's license.



Review the [Dental plan](#) section for information on your dental benefits.

Covered services

This benefit covers treatment of serious dental issues, such as a fractured jaw, excision of a tumor or cyst of the mouth, and incision or drainage of an abscess or cyst of the mouth, when not part of the dentition (gums, teeth, teeth supporting structure).

Hospital or outpatient facility fees and skilled observation for anesthesia administration related to dental treatments may be covered by the medical benefit when the following criteria are met.

Dental treatment in a hospital or outpatient facility is required because of any of the following:

- A physician has determined that the member's medical condition would place them at undue risk if the dental treatment were performed in a dental office. Some examples, though not all inclusive, are:
 - Cardiac conditions
 - Chronic respiratory disease, such as emphysema
 - Hemophilia or other blood disease
 - History of allergy to local anesthesia
 - Severe anemia
 - Severe hypertension
 - Uncontrolled diabetes
- The severity of the dental condition prevents treatment in the dental office setting.
- General anesthesia in a dental office, hospital or outpatient facility is required because of any of the following:
 - The member has a physical or mental disability and cannot be managed with local anesthesia, intravenous (IV) or non-intravenous conscious sedation.
 - The member has tried and failed other means of patient management (including premedication) in the office setting.
 - Other means of patient management are contraindicated for the member.

Orthodontia services may be eligible for payment under the medical plan for dependents born with cleft/lip palate or other severe craniofacial anomalies. To qualify for benefits the condition must meet medically necessary criteria in Premera's medical policy addressing orthodontia for repair of cleft palate and other severe congenital anomalies.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for dental services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Services or supplies not medically necessary for diagnosis, care, or treatment of a disease, illness, or injury
- Dental care and services of a dentist, except as provided in the dental benefit. Hospital and physician services in support of all other dental care are covered only if the care meets two conditions: (1) adequate dental treatment cannot be rendered without the use of the hospital, and (2) the member has a health problem that makes it medically necessary to do the dental work at the hospital.
- Dental services for accidental injuries to the oral and maxillofacial region are covered only when the needed corrective dental repairs are certified in writing by the dental care provider as dentally necessary and are directly related to the accidental injury. Covered dental services include the repair or replacement of existing crowns, inlays, onlays, bridgework, and dentures. The treatment must be started within one year from the date of the accident.
- Benefits for services or supplies for treatment of temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction or myofascial pain dysfunction (MPD); benefits may be available under the Microsoft temporomandibular dysfunction benefit
- The medical plan does not cover any other preventive or restorative dental procedures, regardless of origin of condition

Teladoc Health Condition Management – Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs Diabetes health education

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

This benefit covers outpatient self-management training and education for diabetes, including medical nutritional therapy by a dietitian or nutritionist with expertise in diabetes.

Teladoc Health Condition Management - Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: n/a

Teladoc Health Condition Management for Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs provide monitoring and health management support to individuals within the programs. If you qualify and enroll in any of the programs, you will receive the following benefits:

Diabetes Management

For members 13 and older who have Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A blood glucose meter that uses cellular technology to automatically upload blood sugar readings to a personal online account.
- A lancing device and unlimited lancets at no cost to you.
- Unlimited test strips for this meter at no cost to you. You can reorder test strips using the meter or online. The strips will be sent to you directly.
- Real-time feedback and tips based on your blood sugar readings that can help keep your levels within a healthy range.
- Coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail, or the program manager's mobile app.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Diabetes Prevention

For members 18 and older who meet pre-diabetes criteria followed by the Centers for Disease Control. The program's duration is 12 months, with an additional 12 months of access for maintenance. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A cellular-connected scale that uploads readings to a personal online account.
- Real-time tips and personalized feedback on health, nutrition, or lifestyle changes to help you learn and improve.
- Unlimited coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail, or the mobile app.
- Complete CDC-recognized weight management curriculum based on in-app content and online resources.
- Periodic review of plan, self-monitoring data, and feedback from expert coach.
- Experiential learning missions covering nutrition, activity, motivation, sleep, and stress management.
- A mobile app, and device for tracking weight, steps, and achievement of health goals for food and physical activity.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Hypertension

For members 18 and older who have hypertension. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A cellular-enabled blood pressure cuff that uploads blood pressure readings to a personal online account.

- Real-time tips and personalized feedback based on your blood pressure readings that can help keep your pressure within a healthy range.
- Unlimited coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail, or the mobile app. Access to online information.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Additional support

If you are 18 and older who qualify for more than one of the above programs you may be eligible for additional tools and devices to help you live healthier:

- For members with hypertension, a connected blood pressure monitors to help track your numbers.
- Members who qualify for the Diabetes Prevention or the Weight Loss Program may receive a smart scale

These programs are available to you and your eligible dependents who qualify. The full cost of these programs will be covered by the Plan. To learn more, see if you qualify and enroll, go to teladochealth.com/microsoft-ccm, or call Premera customer service.

Diagnostic Services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Benefits are provided for diagnostic services (including lab and imaging services) for health conditions or symptoms. Included in the coverage are charges for the test or scan itself and charges to interpret the results. Some examples of what's covered under this benefit are:

- Diagnostic imaging and scans (including x-ray, MRI, PET, CAT, and EKGs)
- Services that are medically necessary to diagnose infertility
- Laboratory services
- Pathology tests

Diagnostic surgeries, including scope insertion procedures, can only be covered under the Surgical Services benefit.



Prior authorization is strongly recommended for some diagnostic services. Some examples of these include but are not limited to: Genetic Testing, CAT scan, and MRI. Have your provider contact Premera to see if your service needs this pre-service review.

Emergency room care and professional services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers hospital emergency room and provider charges for an emergent condition—regardless of the network status—including related services and supplies, such as diagnostic imaging (including X-ray) and laboratory services, and surgical dressings and drugs furnished by and used while at the hospital.

Following discharge from the emergency room or hospital, eligible services will be paid based on the contracting status of the provider.

Regardless of network status, after being treated in the emergency department for an emergent condition and admitted to a hospital inpatient care (as defined by the [hospital inpatient care](#) benefit), along with provider charges, will be covered at the in-network level.

For emergency substance abuse treatment, see the [mental health and chemical dependency treatment](#) benefit.

Please see the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

Hearing care and hardware

Hearing exams and testing

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers one routine hearing examination and one routine hearing test (or screening) per member each calendar year.

Hearing exam services include:

- Examination of the inner ear and exterior of the ear
- Observation and evaluation of hearing, such as whispered voice and tuning fork
- Case history and recommendations
- The use of calibrated equipment

Hearing hardware

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Limit: up to \$10,000 maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options

This benefit covers one FDA approved hearing hardware (either an over-the-counter or prescribed hearing aid) up to a maximum benefit of \$10,000 per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options.

Before obtaining a prescribed hearing aid, you must be examined by a licensed physician (M.D. or D.O.) or audiologist (CCC-A or CCC-MSPA).

Benefits cover the following:

- The hearing aid(s) (monaural or binaural) prescribed as a result of an exam or an FDA approved over-the-counter hearing aid(s) (monaural or binaural)
- Ear mold(s)
- Hearing aid rental while the primary unit is being repaired
- The initial batteries, cords, and other necessary ancillary equipment
- A follow-up consultation within 30 days following delivery of the prescribed hearing aid with either the prescribing physician or audiologist
- Repairs, servicing, and alteration of hearing aid equipment

Additional exclusions and limitations for hearing care and hardware

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Hearing aids purchased before your effective date of coverage under this plan
- A prescription or over-the-counter hearing aid, for any reason, more often than once in a period of three consecutive calendar years during which you are continuously enrolled in one or more Premera-administered health plan options
- Batteries or other ancillary equipment other than that obtained upon purchase of the hearing aid
- A prescription hearing aid that exceeds the specifications prescribed for correction of hearing loss
- Expenses incurred after your coverage ends under this plan unless a prescribed hearing aid was ordered before that date and was delivered within 90 days after the date your coverage ended
- Charges in excess of this benefit; these expenses are also not eligible for coverage under other benefits of this plan

Home health care and Nursing care

In-home care, other than Hospice Care and Respite Care (non-hospice), can be broken into two categories for purposes of benefit coverage:

Benefit	Description	Care Duration	Coverage
Home health care	Short-duration, intermittent care to complete specific tasks by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, social worker (MSW)	The length of home health care visits varies depending on the tasks to be accomplished, but typically these visits last up to 2 hours.	In-network: 90%, deductible applies Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Benefit	Description	Care Duration	Coverage
	working for home health agency, or a certified respiratory therapist.		
Nursing care	Longer-duration, skilled hourly nursing care in the home by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN).	Generally needed for more than 4 hours per day.	In-network: 90%, deductible applies Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Read below for additional in-home care coverage details.

Home health care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers home visits for short-duration, intermittent care to complete specific tasks by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, social worker (MSW) working for home health agency, or a certified respiratory therapist. The length of home health care visits varies depending on the tasks to be accomplished, but typically these visits last up to 2 hours. The benefit includes the cost of a home health aide when acting under the direct supervision of one of the before-mentioned therapists and while performing services specifically ordered by the doctor in the treatment plan. The benefit also includes disposable medical supplies and eligible medication prescribed by a physician when provided by the home health care agency.



Intermittent care is care provided due to the medically predictable recurring need for skilled home health care services.

Home health care services provided and billed by a Medicare-approved or state-licensed home health care agency for treatment of an illness or injury are covered. The services must be part of a formal written treatment plan prescribed by your doctor.

One postpartum home health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center will be eligible for coverage.

Additional exclusions and limitations for home health care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Normal living expenses, such as food, clothing, and household supplies; housekeeping services, except for those of a home health aide as prescribed by the plan of care; and transportation services
- Materials such as handrails and ramps
- Services performed by family members and volunteer workers
- Psychiatric care

- Unnecessary and inappropriate services
- Maintenance or [custodial care](#).
- Diversional therapy
- Services or supplies not included in the written treatment plan
- Over-the-counter drugs, solutions, and nutritional supplements
- Dietary assistance, such as Meals on Wheels
- Services provided to someone other than the ill or injured enrollee

Nursing care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

This benefit covers longer-duration, skilled hourly nursing care in the home by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN) working under a licensed home health agency. Skilled hourly nursing care is provided in lieu of hospitalization and generally is needed for more than 4 hours per day. The nurse who is providing the care cannot be a permanent resident in the member's home.



Skilled nursing care is provided by a registered nurse (RN), or licensed practical nurse (LPN) and the care must require the technical proficiency, scientific skills, and knowledge of an RN or LPN. The need for skilled nursing is determined by the condition of the patient, the nature of the services required, and the complexity or technical aspects of the services provided. Nursing care is not skilled simply because an RN or LPN delivers it or because a physician orders it.

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for nursing care to determine if coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Hospice care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

The hospice care benefit allows a terminally ill member to remain at home or to use the services of a hospice center instead of using hospital inpatient services. The plan covers services provided through a

state-licensed hospice or other hospice program that meets the standards of the National Hospice and Palliative Care Organization. The services must be part of a written treatment plan prescribed by a licensed physician.

This benefit covers visits for intermittent care by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, a certified respiratory therapist or a Master of Social Work. Also included is the cost of a home health aide who acts under the direct supervision of one of the before-mentioned therapists and who is performing services specifically ordered by the member's doctor in the treatment plan. The benefit also includes disposable medical supplies and medications prescribed by the physician, and the rental of durable medical equipment.

In addition, the hospice care benefit covers care in a hospice, and up to 672 hours of respite care for each six-month period of hospice care. The respite care provision allows family members of the terminally ill patient an opportunity to recover from the emotionally and physically demanding tasks of caring for the patient.



Hospice care is a coordinated program of palliative and supportive care for dying members by an interdisciplinary team of professionals and volunteers centering primarily in the member's home.

Intermittent care is care provided due to the medically predictable recurring need for skilled home health care services.

Respite care is continuing to provide care in the temporary absence of the member's primary caregiver or caregivers.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospice care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Bereavement or pastoral counseling
- Financial or legal counseling, including real-estate planning or drafting of a will
- Funeral arrangements
- Diversional therapy
- Services that are not related solely to the member, such as transportation, house cleaning, or sitter services

Hospital inpatient care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers the following inpatient medical and surgical services:

- Room and board, including general duty nursing and special diets
- Use of an intensive care or coronary care unit equipped and operated according to generally recognized hospital standards
- Operating room, surgical supplies, hospital anesthesia services and supplies, drugs, dressings, equipment, and oxygen

- Diagnostic and therapeutic services
- Blood, blood derivatives, and their administration

Regardless of network status, after being treated in the emergency department for an emergent condition and admitted to a hospital, inpatient care (as defined by the hospital inpatient care benefit), along with provider charges for that emergent condition, will be covered at the in-network level.

Please see [the Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency and non-emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

For substance abuse treatment, see the [mental health and chemical dependency treatment](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospital inpatient care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Hospital admissions for diagnostic purposes only, unless the services cannot be provided without the use of inpatient hospital facilities, or unless the member's medical condition makes inpatient care medically necessary
- Any days of inpatient care that exceed the length of stay required to treat the member's condition

Hospital outpatient care and ambulatory surgical center care

In-network: 90% deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers operating, procedure, and recovery rooms; plus, services and supplies, such as diagnostic imaging (including X-ray) and laboratory services, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia and its administration, surgical dressings and drugs, furnished by and used while at the hospital or ambulatory surgical center.

Please see [the Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency and non-emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

Fertility

In-network: 90% after deductible for coverage, within the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network

Out-of-network: not applicable

Limit: Up to two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Microsoft health plan options, and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy, subject to certain restrictions described below



*Members must contact their **Progyny Patient Care Advocate** at (888) 203-5066 to confirm eligibility and utilize a Progyny Network Provider to access the benefit.*

This benefit covers services to assist in achieving a pregnancy for Microsoft employees and their enrolled spouse/domestic partner regardless of reason or origin of condition.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit allows for:

- Two (2) Smart Cycles per household, with an additional Smart Cycle available if the first two do not result in a successful pregnancy, for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options, subject to the restrictions described below for certain members who received infertility benefits of less than \$15,000 under the Health Savings Plan prior to 2018. Coverage is subject to all applicable plan copay, coinsurance, and deductible requirements.
- One (1) Smart Cycle per household, with an additional Smart Cycle available if the first does not result in a successful pregnancy, for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options, for members who (1) have been enrolled continuously in one or more Premera-administered health plan options (such as the Health Savings Plan) since before 2018, and (2) incurred \$15,000 or more in infertility benefits under the Plan during such continuous enrollment period prior to 2018. Coverage is subject to all applicable plan copay, coinsurance, and deductible requirements.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit may be used to receive full coverage for the following treatments and procedures:

- Two consultations per calendar year
- Diagnostic testing
- Transvaginal ultrasounds
- Intrauterine insemination (also known as artificial insemination)
- In vitro fertilization (IVF)
- Gamete intra-fallopian transplant (GIFT)
- Intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI)
- Pre-implantation genetic screening (PGS)
- Pre-implantation genetic diagnosis (PGD)
- Embryo assessment and transfer
- Services used to preserve fertility such as cryopreservation of eggs, sperm and/or embryos. This includes oncofertility preservation.
- Up to four years of storage (egg, embryo, sperm) with annual renewal and eligibility verification
- Purchase of donor tissue (sperm, eggs) as follows:
 - Previously frozen donor sperm or donor oocytes (eggs) from a donor agency intended for the use and transfer into a covered female member (one egg cohort purchase constitutes one SMART Cycle, and one donor sperm purchase constitutes ¼ SMART Cycle). You will be required to pay for the donor sperm or oocytes out of pocket and submit the eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.
 - A fresh donor recipient cycle, whereby the egg donor undergoes an egg retrieval procedure at an in-network Progyny provider to allow for a fresh embryo transfer into a covered female member

(one fresh donor recipient cycle constitutes one SMART Cycle). The treatment must occur at an in-network Progyny provider, or else you may be required to pay all expenses up front, out of pocket. If an in-network provider is not contracted for the fresh donor recipient cycle, Progyny will pursue a special case agreement. If a special case agreement request is denied, you will pay for the donor services out of pocket but may submit eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.

Medication prescribed for fertility treatment will be fulfilled by a Progyny Rx specialty pharmacy and delivered next day to ensure accurate timing with treatment. All medications, compounds, ancillary medication and equipment required for treatment are included in the shipment of medications. Progyny Rx coverage also includes the UnPack It Call where a trained pharmacy clinician will explain drug administration and storage guidelines.

Additional exclusions and limitations for infertility

The following exclusions apply to this benefit:

- Fees paid to donors for their participation in any service
- Testing and treatment for potential surrogates that would not otherwise be covered for a member enrolled in the Plan
- Home ovulation prediction kits
- Services and supplies furnished for a dependent child (under age 26) except for oncofertility preservation due to cancer or medical treatments
- Services and supplies furnished by a provider outside the Progyny network, except as otherwise provided
- Fertility Services following a voluntary sterilization procedure

Maternity care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers maternity benefits provided for you, your enrolled spouse/domestic partner, and your eligible dependent children.

For women's preventive care visits during and after pregnancy, see the preventive care benefit. If the physician bills the delivery together with the routine (preventive) prenatal care, 40% of the allowed amount applies to the preventive prenatal care benefit and 60% of the allowed amount applies to the maternity care benefit.

The home health care benefit covers one postpartum health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center.

Benefits are for maternity care in a hospital, alternative birthing center, or at home, including:

- Prenatal testing when required to diagnose conditions of the unborn child
- Services of a licensed nurse or midwife (non-medical service, such as non-medical services performed by a doula are not covered)
- Miscarriages and terminations of pregnancy

- Hospital nursery care for benefits-eligible infant while the mother is hospitalized and receiving benefits; services are covered under the hospital services benefit
- Male circumcision by a physician or mohel for a benefits-eligible dependent; services are covered under the physician services benefit
- One postpartum home health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center
- Home births include an allowance of up to \$500 for eligible supplies and/or equipment used for home delivery, for example, birthing packs, birthing tubs, monitoring devices, local anesthetics, and comfort aids. Services for the newborn including hospital services and professional services are covered under the hospital services and physician services benefit.
- Birth doula services are allowed up to a maximum benefit of \$1,000 per pregnancy, after the deductible is met. Before seeking doula services, you must first be examined by a licensed physician, registered nurse or midwife and have a confirmed pregnancy.
 - Covered doula services include:
 - In person, phone, and email support throughout the pregnancy and post-partum
 - Birth support
 - Lactation support
 - Doula services are not covered for the following:
 - Babysitting or doing household chores
 - Travel time
 - Any other services not listed as covered doula services, above
- Eligible providers: Doula's must be licensed in states that require a license. Otherwise, if the state does not require a license, then the doula must have a current certification under a recognized doula certification organization (examples include DONA International and PALS Doulas). Eligible doulas do not have to be an in-network provider.
- Exclusions: apprentice doulas

Medical equipment and supplies (durable medical supplies)

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Covered services

This benefit covers charges for durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies (DME). Benefits cover rental or purchase (including shipping and handling fees) of DME for treatment of an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition. Rental equipment will not be reimbursed above the purchase price of the equipment. The Plan reserves the right to require a period of rental prior to covering the purchase of equipment. Benefits for DME purchases will be reduced by any prior Plan benefits for renting the same equipment, unless (and to the extent that) the Plan required such prior rental.

Allowed charges to repair or replace covered items are also covered due to a change in the injury, illness, disease, or medical condition, the growth of a child, or when worn out by normal use. Replacement is covered only if needed due to a change in the member's physical condition or if it is less costly to replace than to repair existing equipment or to rent similar equipment.

No more than one item of DME per year will be covered for the same or similar purpose, and in order to be covered, the equipment and accessories to operate it must be:

- Made to withstand prolonged use
- Made for and mainly used in the treatment of an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition
- Suited for use in the home

This list of covered DME includes, but is not limited to:

- Braces
- Crutches
- Wheelchairs
- Wheelchair seat lift mechanism and/or a power seat elevation device when a member meets the applicable medical necessity requirements for a power wheelchair
- Prostheses
- Post-mastectomy bras/forms: Post-mastectomy bras are limited to two every six months (replacements within this 6-month period are covered when medically necessary due to a change in the member's condition)
- Cochlear Implants and associated supplies
- Foot orthotics (custom fitted shoe inserts) and therapeutic shoes (orthopedic), including fitting expenses, when prescribed by a physician for the condition of diabetes or for corrective purposes
- Wigs (up to \$2,000 per calendar year for alopecia caused by medical conditions or treatment for diseases)
- You may either purchase one over-the-counter breast pump or rent one hospital grade breast pump during a calendar year (one or the other, but not both), for up to the duration of breastfeeding. The pump must be for your own use. Replacement supplies may be purchased on an as needed basis. In-network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100%. Out of network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100% of allowable charge. Deductible does not apply. Batteries are not covered.
- Continuous glucose monitors and their supplies are covered at 100% of allowable charges. Deductible does not apply.

Vision hardware may be covered under the medical plan for certain medical conditions of the eye, including, but not limited to:

- Corneal ulcer/abrasion
- Bullous keratopathy
- Recurrent erosion of cornea
- Keratoconus
- Tear film insufficiency (dry-eye syndrome)
- Cataract surgery

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



A **prior authorization** is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.



Certain supplies such as hypodermic needles, test strips and glucose monitors are covered at 100% by the **preventive care** benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for medical equipment and supplies (durable medical supplies)

In addition to the plan's **exclusions and limitations**, the following durable medical equipment and supplies will not be covered by this plan when they are:

- Normally of use to persons who do not have an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition
- For use in altering air quality or temperature
- For exercise, training and use during participation in sports, recreation, or similar activities
- Equipment, such as whirlpools, portable whirlpool pumps, sauna baths, massage devices, overbed tables, elevators, vision aids, and telephone alert systems
- Special or extra-cost convenience items and/or features
- Structural modifications to your home and/or private vehicle
- Replacement of lost or stolen equipment or supplies
- Blood pressure cuffs or monitors (even if prescribed by a physician), unless otherwise provided in this SPD

Medical Foods

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This plan covers medically necessary medical foods used to supplement or replace a member's diet in order to treat inborn errors of metabolism. An example is phenylketonuria (PKU). Coverage includes medically necessary enteral formula prescribed by a physician or other provider to treat eosinophilic gastrointestinal associated disorder or other severe malabsorption disorder. Benefits are provided for all delivery methods.

Medical foods are formulated to be consumed or administered enterally under strict medical supervision. These foods generally provide most of a person's nutrition. Medical foods are designed to treat a specific problem that can be diagnosed by medical tests.

This benefit does not cover other oral nutrition or supplements not used to treat inborn errors of metabolism, even if a physician prescribes them. This includes specialized infant formulas and lactose-free foods.

Mental health counseling, mental health inpatient and outpatient services, and chemical dependency treatment

Inpatient and Outpatient:

- 100% of up to 24 sessions per calendar year for short-term counseling session for you and each eligible dependent through Spring Health, administrator for the employee assistance program. 2 of the 24 sessions can be used for medication management.
- This benefit covers outpatient care, although not required, you may wish to exhaust the [short-term counseling under Spring Health \(employee assistance program\)](#) before obtaining services from Premera under this benefit, because Microsoft pays the entire cost of EAP benefits.
- Spring Health does have providers who are in-network with Premera for treatment needed in addition to the 24 session EAP.
- Outpatient services also available through Premera at 90% after deductible.
- 90% after deductible for inpatient and outpatient services *In-network: 90%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

This benefit covers medically necessary treatment for:

- mental health conditions such as, but not limited to the diagnosis and treatment stress, anxiety, or depression, or other psychiatric disorders, eating disorders, attention deficit disorder (ADD), attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)
- chemical dependency such as substance use disorder and alcohol use disorder

To be covered, services must be furnished by an eligible provider.

All mental health and chemical dependency treatment must be medically necessary to be eligible for coverage.

Type of care	You will be covered as follows
Short-term counseling through the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) , administered by Spring Health	No deductible applies 100% of 24 sessions per person per year. Two (2) of the sessions may be used for medication management.
Inpatient and Outpatient benefits	In-network: 90%, deductible applies; out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies Spring Health services beyond the 24 session EAP benefit are covered at 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Eligible providers

Eligible providers include:

- A facility licensed as a hospital or community mental health agency to provide mental health and/or substance abuse services
- A physician, psychiatrist, psychologist, or psychiatric nurse practitioner licensed to provide mental health or substance abuse services
- A master's level mental health provider licensed, registered, or certified as legally required to provide mental health services
- Any other provider or facility who is licensed or certified by the state in which the care is rendered and who is providing care within the scope of their license or certification

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for inpatient care and residential treatment centers to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. When an emergency admission occurs, notification to Premera within two days is also recommended. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for a prior authorization.



A **prior authorization** is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

The prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for mental health and chemical dependency

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Testing must be ordered by a physician for the purpose of diagnosing or medical management

- Smoking cessation programs or materials; (Microsoft provides a separate Smoking Cessation Program. Prescription drugs for smoking cessation are covered under the prescription drug benefit.)
- Services and supplies that are court-ordered, or are related to deferred prosecution, deferred or suspended sentencing, or driving rights, if those services are not deemed medically necessary
- Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.

Nutritional therapy

This benefit covers outpatient nutritional therapy visits with a dietitian, nutritional therapist or certified lactation consultant to manage a covered condition, illness or injury.

First 12 visits per member per calendar year regardless of the diagnosis or condition:

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

After the initial 12 visits per member (in the same calendar year) benefit coverage remains available for a covered condition, illness or injury (see examples below) as follows:

- *In-network: 90%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network 70% of allowable, deductible applies*

Illnesses or conditions that would be eligible for this benefit include, but are not limited to:

- Hypertension
- Cardiac problems
- Feeding difficulties
- Gastric reflux disease

Nutritional therapy visits received in connection with a diagnosed eating disorder or diabetes are unlimited and will be covered at 100% of allowable charges.

Onsite Mammography Screening

Microsoft offers access to an onsite mammography screening in select Microsoft locations to employees and their spouse/domestic partners enrolled in a Microsoft Health Plan. The onsite mammography screening provides a multiple-view screening exam. At the discretion of the technologist performing the mammogram, additional views may be necessary to clarify imaging issues for the radiologist.

The onsite mammography screening program includes the onsite preventive screening mammogram exam only. Any additional or follow-up imaging or other services needed are considered diagnostic and will be covered as outlined in the diagnostic services benefit.

An onsite mammogram is not recommended if you have implants, a breast problem, are pregnant, or are breastfeeding. In those cases, you should consult with your doctor about obtaining an exam at an offsite breast center or other health care facility. Such an offsite exam would not be covered by the onsite mammography screening program but may be covered by the Plan's preventive or diagnostic services coverage, as applicable. As the onsite mammogram is a screening exam, the vendor is not able to provide

imaging for a breast problem such as a lump. If you have questions about mammogram screenings, talk with your primary care physician.

Who Provides the Mammograms?

In the Puget Sound area of Washington state, Mammograms are provided by Swedish Mobile Mammography Services (operated by Swedish Health Services). The mammography technologists are registered by the American Registry of Radiologic Technology, have advanced credentials in mammography, and are certified by the State of Washington. The interpreting physicians are employed by Radia, are board certified by the American College of Radiology, and specialize in breast imaging.

In other areas, Microsoft partners with local vendors who specialize in onsite mammography and have the appropriate equipment and licensure. To provide services onsite, there must be sufficient demand to fill a day of appointments and a local vendor who is qualified to provide the services. Onsite mammography events will be advertised for any locations where they are available.

When Do the Screenings Occur?

Periodically each year, usually during the fall.

Eligibility

US benefits-eligible employees and their spouse/domestic partner age 35 and over, who are enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan, are eligible to participate in onsite mammography screenings.

You are eligible to participate in the onsite screening even if you have had a routine mammogram in the past 12 months. However, you should talk with your primary care provider to determine the benefits and risks of having a second mammogram within a 12-month period. If you suspect you have a breast problem, such as a lump, you should see your primary care provider.

Women under the age of 35 are ineligible, unless they have written permission from their physician.



At some locations, women under age 35 will not be allowed to participate, even with written permission from their physician.

Dependent children (regardless of age), agency temporaries/external staff, international based employees, and any individuals who are not enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan are not eligible to participate.

Physician services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers:

- Medical and surgical services of a physician
- Urgent care visits at an urgent care facility
- Care via online and telephonic methods when medically appropriate:
 - Benefits for telemedicine are subject to standard office visit cost-shares and other provisions as stated in this booklet. Services must be medically necessary to treat a covered illness, injury or condition.

- Biofeedback services for any condition covered by the medical benefit when provided by an eligible provider



An **Urgent care** visit is billed and covered at the same rate as an office visit with your regular physician and is a cost-effective option when you have an urgent need for care. Urgent care is the best option for treatment of a sudden illness, injury or condition that:

Requires prompt medical attention to avoid serious deterioration of the member's health

Does not require the level of care provided in the emergency room or a hospital

Cannot be postponed until the member's physician is available

A **Physician** is a state licensed:

Doctor of Medicine and Surgery (M.D.)

Doctor of Osteopathy (D.O.)

In addition, professional services provided by one of the following types of providers will be treated as physician services under this plan to the extent the provider is providing a service that is within the scope of their state license and providing a service for which benefits are specified in this SPD and would be payable if the service were provided by a physician as defined above:

- Chiropractor (D.C.)
- Dentist (D.D.S. or D.M.D.)
- Optometrist (O.D.)
- Physician Assistant (P.A.)
- Podiatrist (D.P.M.)
- Psychologist (Ph.D.)
- Advanced Registered Nurse Practitioner (A.R.N.P.)
- Nurse (R.N.)
- Naturopathic physician (N.D.)

Plastic and reconstructive surgery

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers services, supplies, and procedures for plastic or reconstructive surgery purposes, along with complications of these services, supplies, or procedures, for the following:

- Repair of a defect that is the direct result of an accidental injury, providing such repair is started within 12 months of the date of the accident
- Treatment for a congenital anomaly of a covered child
- Treatment of visible birth marks of a covered child
- All stages of reconstruction of the involved breast following a mastectomy, and surgery and reconstruction of the other breast to produce a symmetrical appearance.
- Correction of physical functional disorders. Benefits may include, but are not limited to, blepharoplasty or breast reduction.

The treatment plan for any of the above conditions must be prescribed by a physician.



A **congenital anomaly** is a marked difference from the normal structure of a body part that is physically evident from birth.

A **physical functional disorder** is a limitation from normal (or baseline level) of physical functioning that may include, but is not limited to, problems with ambulation, mobilization, communication, respiration, eating, swallowing, vision, facial expression, skin integrity, distortion of nearby body parts or obstruction of an orifice. The physical functional impairment can be due to structure, congenital deformity, pain, or other causes. Physical functional impairment excludes social, emotional and psychological impairment or potential impairment.

Prescription drugs

In-network: 90%, deductible applies, up to limits provided below

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies, up to limits provided below

This benefit covers most FDA-approved, medically necessary prescription drugs, when prescribed for the member's use outside of a medical facility and dispensed by a licensed pharmacist in a pharmacy licensed by the state in which the pharmacy is located. Also, included in this benefit are injectable supplies.

Certain single-source brand and generic preventive drugs will be covered at 100% under the preventive care benefit and are not subject to the deductible. Brand-name preventive medications with an available generic equivalent will not be covered by the preventive care benefit. Review the [preventive care](#) benefit for more information.

Generic drug substitution

This plan encourages the use of appropriate generic drugs (as defined below). When available and indicated by the prescriber, a generic equivalent drug will be dispensed in place of a brand name drug. If your prescriber indicates that substituting a generic equivalent for the brand name drug is inappropriate, you'll be charged only the brand name cost share (as applicable). However, if the prescriber does not indicate that substituting a generic equivalent drug is inappropriate, and you request the brand name drug anyway, you'll be charged the difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent along with the applicable brand name cost-share. Note: The difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent will not apply to your deductible and/or coinsurance maximum. Even if you reach your deductible or coinsurance maximum, you will still be responsible for the full amount of the difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent.



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Brand-name prescriptions are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

Generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions because the patent has expired.

Prescription limits

Coverage	Up to a 90-day supply for generic maintenance medication; all others are up to a 30-day supply*	Up to 90-day supply* is covered only when using Express Scripts Pharmacy Home Delivery	Up to a 30-day supply* Additional clinical support for members using specialty drugs
In-network pharmacies	Express scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf To find an Express Scripts retail pharmacy, call the Premera customer service team at (800) 676-1411	Express scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf	Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy** will bill the plan on your behalf
Out-of-network pharmacies	You will need to submit a prescription reimbursement form, with your receipt, for reimbursement	Not covered	Not covered

* Unless the drug maker's packaging limits the supply in some other way.

** Contact Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy at (877) 223-6447 or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy at (800) 689-6592 to get started.

The dispensing limits (or days' supply) for drugs dispensed at retail and specialty pharmacies, and through the mail-order pharmacy benefit, are described in the above chart.

Members are allowed two retail grace fills for specialty drugs before being required to utilize Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and
- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



Generic maintenance medications have a common indication for the treatment of a chronic disease (such as diabetes, high cholesterol, or hypertension). Indications are obtained from the product labeling. They are used for diseases when the duration of the therapy can reasonably be expected to exceed one year.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.



Premera provides a customer service team dedicated to Microsoft employees and their dependents. You can use this service by calling (800) 676-1411 with questions regarding:

- Status of mail order prescriptions
- Plan design, including which medications are covered or not covered
- Location of retail pharmacies

Covered drugs

This benefit covers the following FDA-approved items when dispensed by a licensed pharmacy for use outside of a medical facility. Certain drugs may need a prior authorization.

- Prescription drugs (Federal Legend Drugs as prescribed by a licensed provider). This benefit includes coverage for off-label use of FDA-approved drugs as provided under this plan's definition of prescription drug.
- Compounded medications are covered when the main ingredient is a covered prescription drug. Benefits are subject to standard supply limit.
- Inhalation spacer devices and peak flow meters
- Glucagon and allergy emergency kits
- Prescribed injectable medications for self-administration (such as insulin)
- Hypodermic needles, syringes, and alcohol swabs used for self-administered injectable prescription medications
- Disposable diabetic testing supplies, including test strips, testing agents, and lancets
- Prescription contraceptive drugs and devices (for example, oral drugs, diaphragms, and cervical caps)
- Human growth hormone
- Prescription drugs for smoking cessation
- Impotence medications are limited to 15 pills at retail per 30 days: 45 pills at mail-order per 90 days

Benefits for immunization agents and vaccines, including the professional services to administer the medication, are provided under the [preventive care](#) benefit.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is **required** to determine if coverage for a certain prescription drug is available before prescription can be filled.

To determine if prior authorization is required for a particular drug, refer to the [formulary drug list](#), or either the member or the provider may contact Premera.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

In order for certain types of drugs to be covered, information from your doctor must be submitted that identifies the disease being treated and explains the role of the drug in the treatment plan to establish its medical necessity. If that information is made available prior to the prescription being filled, and it is determined that the drug is medically necessary, the prescription will be covered as described above. If

information for a drug in this category is not provided, you may pay for the prescription to be filled and submit the claim for consideration along with the clinical information. If it is determined that you do not meet medical necessity criteria needed for the drug to be eligible, you will not be reimbursed for the cost of the drug.

Benefits for some prescription drugs may be limited to one or more of the following:

- A set number of days' supply
- A specific drug or drug dose that is appropriate for a normal course of treatment
- A specific diagnosis
- Be under the care of an appropriate medical specialist
- Trying a generic drug or a specified brand name drug first

In making these determinations, Premera takes into consideration clinically evidence-based medical necessity criteria, recommendations of the manufacturer, the circumstances of the individual case, U.S. Food and Drug Administration guidelines, published medical literature and standard reference compendia.



For questions about your pharmacy benefits or quantity limits, contact Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411.

The table below provides information on how to submit information for a medical necessity review.

Drug	Information
Certain drugs require a prior authorization. Examples include but are not limited to: rheumatoid arthritis, certain cancer treatment drugs, growth hormones, anti-depressants, corticosteroid nasal sprays, diabetes, migraine therapy, multiple sclerosis, sleeping disorders, weight loss drugs, and compound medications.	Have your provider call (888) 261-1756 to start or update the benefit review process for these or other drugs needing clinical review. If you would like to find out if your drug requires review, refer to the formulary drug list or call Premera Customer Services at (800) 676-1411.



Categories of drugs on this list may be added or deleted from time to time, based on factors including FDA approval status, medical necessity, member safety, and best practices. If you have paid for a prescription of a drug in this category, you may appeal any denial of benefits for that drug through the appeals process.

Drug-usage patterns

The Plan may be provided with information from a variety of sources regarding drug-usage patterns of individual members that merit further investigation. If the conclusion of the investigation is that the drug-usage patterns are not consistent with generally accepted standards of practice, the Plan may choose to restrict access to the benefit to one prescribing physician for those members. If this action is taken, the member will be notified in advance.

Your right to safe and effective pharmacy services

State and federal laws establish standards to assure safe and effective pharmacy services, and to guarantee your right to know what drugs are covered under this Plan and what coverage limitations are in your contract.



If you want more information about the drug coverage policies under this plan, or if you have a question or a concern about your pharmacy benefit, call the Premera customer service team at (800) 676-1411.

If you have a concern about the pharmacists or pharmacies serving you, call your State Department of Health.

Pharmacy manufacturer coupons and financial assistance

In order to avoid potential adverse tax consequences, enrollees in the Health Savings Plan should not utilize pharmacy manufacturer coupons or other financial assistance for prescription drugs.

Additional exclusions and limitations for prescription drugs

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Drugs and medications not approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) except as defined in the Experimental and Investigational section
- Drugs and medicines that may be lawfully obtained over the counter (OTC) without a prescription. OTC drugs are excluded even if prescribed by a practitioner, unless otherwise stated in this benefit. These may include but are not limited to: nonprescription drugs and vitamins, food and dietary supplements, herbal or naturopathic medicines, and nutritional and dietary supplements (for example, infant formulas or protein supplements). This exclusion does not apply to emergency contraceptive methods (such as "Plan B"), aspirin for women and men, folic acid for women and iron supplements.
- Over-the-counter contraceptives, supplies, and devices (except as required by law)
- Drugs for the purpose of cosmetic use (for example, promote or stimulate hair growth, or to stop hair loss not related to alopecia areata, or prevent wrinkles)
- Growth hormone for the diagnosis of idiopathic short stature (ISS), familial short stature (FSS), or constitutional short stature (CSS)
- Drugs for experimental or investigational use
- Any prescription refilled too soon or in excess of the number of refills specified by the prescribing provider, or any refill dispensed after one year from the prescribing provider's original order
- Replacement of lost or stolen medication
- Devices and appliances, support garments, and non-medical supplies
- This plan does not cover the cost of drugs that are reimbursed under another plan or another portion of your Microsoft coverage (for example, drugs administered while hospitalized)
- Charges for prescription drugs when obtained through an unauthorized pharmacy or provider when a restriction of the prescription drug benefit is in place
- Shipping and handling charges for prescriptions drugs are not covered.

Preventive care

Preventive services:

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

This benefit covers routine exams, immunizations and health screenings, such as:

- Routine physicals for women and men
- Women's preventive care including a gynecological exam, routine pap smear (cervical cancer screening) and routine mammogram (breast cancer screening)
- Contraception management office visits
- Well-child exams, including physical exams, tests, and immunizations, through age 18
- Hearing screening for children through age 18
- Routine prenatal and postnatal care. (If the physician bills the delivery together with the routine prenatal care, 40% of the allowed amount applies to the preventive care benefit and 60% of the allowed amount applies to the [maternity care](#) benefit).
- Routine eye exams
- Flu shots
- Colorectal cancer screening
- Prostate cancer screening
- Lung cancer screening
- Immunizations, which need not be done at the same time as the routine exam

For individuals with known risk factors, such as family history of a disease with known hereditary links, the limits in the recommended guidelines for preventive screenings may not be applicable.

Preventive prescription drugs:

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100%

- This benefit covers certain single-source brand and generic prescriptions to prevent the onset of disease by a person who has risk factors for a particular condition, or those taken to prevent a recurrence of a disease. Covered preventive prescription drugs include drugs for the treatment of high cholesterol with cholesterol-lowering medications to prevent heart disease, or the treatment of recovered heart attack or stroke victims with ACE inhibitor medications to prevent a recurrence. This benefit also covers certain supplies such as hypodermic needles, test strips and glucose monitors.



For a complete list of what is considered preventive care and paid 100% by the plan, see the [Preventive Care Services list](#) and the [Preventive Drug list](#), or contact Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411. For information on how to fill your prescription, see the [prescription drug](#) section.

Rehabilitation

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers physical therapy, functional occupational therapy, and speech therapy services to:

- Restore and improve a bodily or cognitive function that was previously normal but was lost after an accidental injury or illness
- Treat disorders or delays in the development of language, cognitive, or motor skills

Inpatient services are covered when services cannot be rendered in any other setting (see inpatient benefits). Outpatient services are limited to a maximum of one hour of each specialty (physical therapy, occupational therapy and speech therapy) per day.

Physical therapy, functional occupational therapy, and speech therapy, including cardiac rehabilitation, are covered when rendered by a physician or by a licensed or registered physical or occupational therapist or a certified speech therapist that is licensed or registered as required as such by the state in which they practice, subject to the Plan's review and approval of your treatment plan for physical therapy and functional occupational therapy services. Premera or its designee may review a member's treatment plan for the purpose of verifying that the treatment is clinically safe, effective, and appropriate for the member's condition. Based on a prospective, concurrent or retrospective review, Premera may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not medically necessary.

Services rendered by a massage therapist are not covered under the rehabilitation benefit. Refer to the Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy benefit for coverage.

Respite Care (Non-Hospice)

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Limit: 672 hours per calendar year

Respite care is for covered members who need assistance with activities of daily living (ADLs) such as bathing and dressing due to a permanent or temporary disabling medical condition, such as a traumatic brain injury, advanced multiple sclerosis, and severe cerebral palsy, where the member needs assistance moving from one place to the other. This benefit covers 672 hours per calendar year in the member's residential home to provide family caregivers an opportunity to recover from the emotionally and physically demanding tasks of caring for the covered member who requires assistance with ADLs.

The respite care application form and a home assessment must be completed prior to accessing this benefit. After the home assessment, Premera will make a determination if the covered member needs assistance with ADLs related to a disabling medical condition and qualifies for respite care coverage, which may be approved for up to a 12-month period. The home assessment is covered under the [Home health care](#) benefit. For the respite care application and more information on this benefit, call Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411.

Additional exclusions and limitations for respite care:

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Respite care provided by a non-certified or non-licensed provider or agency
- Respite care provided by a family member or friend
- Travel expenses, mileage, supplies or any other personal needs of the provider of the respite care
- Instrumental ADLs – examples of instrumental ADLs that are not covered by this benefit include, but are not limited to: shopping, housework, managing finances and using the computer.

Skilled nursing facility

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 120 days per member per calendar year

This benefit covers inpatient care in a Medicare-approved skilled nursing facility for up to 120 days in each calendar year. Services must be part of a formal written treatment plan prescribed by the doctor. Custodial care is not included in this coverage.



Custodial care is provided primarily for ongoing maintenance of a person's condition or to assist a person in meeting activities of daily living, and not for therapeutic value or requiring the constant attention of trained medical personnel. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Services and supplies eligible for reimbursement include:

- Room and board, meals, and general nursing care
- Services and supplies furnished and used while you are in the skilled nursing facility, such as:
 - The use of special treatment rooms
 - Routine lab exams
 - Physical
 - Occupational or speech therapy
 - Respiratory and other gas therapy
 - Drugs and biologicals (such as blood products and solutions)
 - Gauze, cotton, fabrics, solutions, plaster, and other materials used in dressings and casts

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for skilled nursing facilities to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to

have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for skilled nursing facility

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Custodial care is not provided
- Care that is primarily for neurocognitive disorder, intellectual disability, or the treatment of substance use disorder and alcohol use disorder

Sterilization services

Elective Sterilization – Female

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

This benefit covers elective, permanent sterilization procedures, such as tubal ligation. Reversals or attempted reversals of these procedures are not covered.

Elective Sterilization – Male

In-network: 100%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers elective, permanent sterilization procedures, such as vasectomy. Reversals or attempted reversals of these procedures are not covered.

Surgical weight loss treatment

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Who is eligible

This benefit covers you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent when the criteria listed in the Premera Medical Policy on Bariatric Surgery are met.



Contact Premera at (800) 676-1411 for a copy of the policy.

Examples of qualifying criteria include:

- A Body Mass Index (BMI) greater than 40 Kilograms (kg) per square meter (m2) or BMI greater than 35 Kg per m2 in conjunction with severe diabetes, hypertension, or obstructive sleep apnea
- Physician-supervised weight reduction program which includes:
 - A program lasting at least three consecutive months within the 12-month period before surgery is considered,

- Evidence of active participation in a program documented in the member's medical records,
- A psychological evaluation and clearance by a licensed mental health provider, to help rule out other psychological disorders, inability to provide informed consent, or inability to comply with pre- and post-surgical requirements.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers treatment of temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction and other related disorders, such as myofascial pain dysfunction (MPD). Services must be rendered by a physician, hospital, licensed or registered physical therapist, or licensed dentist.

TMJ services and supplies for the treatment of TMJ dysfunction and myofascial pain dysfunction include:

- Diagnostic and follow-up examinations
- Diagnostic X-ray services
- Oral surgery
- Physical therapy
- Biofeedback
- Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation (TENS)
- TMJ splints or TMJ guards

Transfusions, blood, and blood derivatives

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

This benefit covers transfusions, blood, and blood derivatives that are not replaced by voluntary donors. The cost of donating and storing your own blood for a planned surgery is also covered.

Gender Affirming surgical services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers medically necessary gender affirming surgical services, including facility and anesthesia charges related to the surgery.

Coverage of prescription drugs and mental health treatment associated with gender reassignment surgery is available under the [prescription drugs](#) and [mental health](#) benefits.

When services are covered

Gender affirming surgical services will be covered if you are diagnosed as having gender dysphoria or gender incongruence, and the surgery is medically necessary according to the most current Standards of Care published by the World Professional Association for Transgender Health (WPATH).

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for coverage to be made available for gender affirming surgical services. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization. The most current WPATH Standards of Care outline the specific requirements that must be met in order for the gender affirming surgical services to be deemed medically necessary. Any prior authorization request must include documentation showing that all required elements under the most current WPATH Standards of Care have been met. See the [Microsoft Gender-Affirming Benefit Information](#) for additional information.

For gender affirming surgical services, the prior authorization should include:

- The surgical procedure(s) for which coverage is being requested
- The date the procedure will be performed
- Information supporting the criteria listed above has been met, based on the surgery being requested



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.



Your physician can fax this information to (800) 843-1114 or mail it to: Premera Blue Cross
Attn: Integrated Health Management
P.O. 91059
Seattle, WA
98111-09159

Transplants

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers solid organ transplants and bone marrow/stem cell reinfusion -- procedures cannot be experimental or investigational.



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.



The transplant benefit doesn't cover cornea transplantation, skin grafts, or the transplant of blood or blood derivatives (except for bone marrow or stem cells). These procedures are covered on the same basis as any other covered surgical procedure.

Eligible providers

To be eligible for coverage, the transplant or reinfusion must be furnished in an approved transplant center that has developed expertise in performing solid organ transplants, bone marrow reinfusion, or stem cell reinfusion, and is approved by Premera. Premera has contractual agreements with approved transplant centers and has access to a special network of approved transplant centers, throughout the United States. Whenever medically possible, we will direct you to an approved transplant center with which Premera has a contract. Of course, if neither a Premera-approved transplant center nor a Premera network transplant center can provide the type of transplant you need, this benefit will cover a transplant center that meets the approval standards that are set by Premera.



Approved transplant center is a hospital or other provider, located in the United States, that has developed expertise in performing covered transplant services and has a contractual agreement in place with Premera. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Donor costs

All donor acquisition costs such as selection (testing and typing), harvesting (removal) transportation of donor organ, bone marrow and stem cells, and storage costs for bone marrow and stem cells for a period of up to 12 months are covered services, including costs incurred by the surgical harvesting teams.

Additional exclusions and limitations for transplants

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Nonhuman or mechanical organs, unless they are not experimental or investigational
- Services and supplies that are payable by any government, foundation, or charitable grant. This includes services performed on potential or actual recipients or donors (living or cadaver).
- Donor costs are not covered if the recipient of the transplant service is not a Microsoft enrollee. This applies to donor costs for all types of transplant services, solid organ and bone marrow or stem cell reinfusion.
- Donor costs are not covered by Microsoft if benefits are available under other group or individual coverage
- Donor costs are not covered for transportation for typing or matching

Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit

In-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations below)

Out-of-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations below)

Limit: \$10,000 per member, per calendar year

The following travel and lodging reimbursement benefits are available when travel is necessary to obtain covered services under the Plan that are not available within 100 miles of the member's residence.

Travel Allowances: Travel expenses are reimbursed between the member's residence and the location of the covered treatment for round trip (air, train, or bus) transportation costs. Airfare, or train or bus fare, must be for a regularly scheduled commercial flight, or train or bus route (coach class only). If traveling by automobile, mileage, parking, and toll costs are reimbursed. Costs for surface transportation (rideshares, taxi, ferry, etc.) are also covered. Mileage reimbursement is based on the current IRS medical mileage reimbursement. Please refer to the IRS website, www.irs.gov, publication 502 Medical and Dental expenses, for current mileage reimbursement rates.

Lodging Allowances: Hotel or motel stays (or similar accommodations) away from the geographic area of the member's residence. Reimbursement of expenses incurred by a member and one companion for hotel or motel lodging away from home, in the geographic area where the covered treatment is performed, is provided at a rate of \$50 per night per person, or up to \$100 per night total for the member and one companion, if applicable (see below), in accordance with applicable IRS reimbursement requirements.

Overall Maximum: The travel and lodging reimbursement benefit is limited to a total of \$10,000 per member per calendar year.

Companions: The travel and lodging benefit is available for the reimbursement of eligible expenses incurred by the member, as well as a companion, to the extent that a companion is needed to accompany the member for the treatment due to medical necessity or safety concerns.

- Adult member (age 18 or older) – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 companion is permitted.
- Child member – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 parent or guardian is permitted

Limits: Eligible travel and lodging expenses under this benefit are reimbursable up to the IRS mileage

rate, lodging allowance, or other limits, as applicable, in effect on the date you incurred the expense, which are subject to change. Please visit the IRS website, www.irs.gov, for details. Nothing in this summary of the travel and lodging reimbursement benefit should be considered legal or tax advice. Please consult with a personal legal or tax advisor for more information.

Non-Covered Expenses:

- Alcohol/tobacco
- Car rental expenses
- Any airfare, train or bus fare, or upgrades, for any ticket other than a regularly scheduled commercial flight or route in coach class
- Baggage fees
- Entertainment (e.g., movies, visits to museums, additional mileage for sightseeing, etc.)
- Expenses for persons other than the patient and an eligible companion
- Lodging at a residence owned by a family member or friend
- Costs for pets or animals, other than service animals
- Meals
- Personal care items (e.g., shampoo, deodorant, toothbrush etc.)
- Souvenirs (e.g., T-shirts, sweatshirts, toys, etc.)
- Telephone calls

Limitations/exclusions:

- The travel and lodging must occur, and the treatment must be provided, within the United States
- The patient must be covered by one of Microsoft's Premera plans at the time the treatment is provided and the travel and lodging expenses are incurred
- The medical treatment for which the patient is required to travel more than 100 miles from the patient's residence must be a covered benefit under the Plan

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine in advance whether coverage is available for travel and lodging reimbursement.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Virtual Care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Virtual Care is the delivery of health-related services and information between a member and provider via telecommunications (email, telephone, video, and online) for the purpose of diagnosis, prevention, health advice, disease management and treatment.

Electronic Visits. An electronic visit ("e-visit") is a structured, secure online consultation between an approved physician and the member. This benefit will cover medically necessary e-visits for an illness or injury. Each approved physician will determine which conditions and circumstances are appropriate for e-visits in their practice.

Telehealth Services. Your plan covers access to care via online and telephonic methods when medically appropriate. Services must be medically necessary to treat a covered illness, injury or condition. Your provider will determine which conditions and circumstances are appropriate for telehealth services.

Services delivered via telehealth methods are subject to standard office visit cost-shares and other provisions as stated in this booklet. Virtual Care with a provider located outside of the United States is not covered.

Vision therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 32-visit benefit maximum, per member, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options.

This benefit covers vision training, eye training or eye exercises up to a maximum of 32 treatment visits, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options, for the following conditions only:

- Amblyopia
- Convergence insufficiency
- Esotropia or exotropia

All other uses of vision therapy are considered investigative and are not covered. Vision therapy is not a covered service under the [Vision plan](#). Costs of equipment and supplies associated with vision therapy are not covered.

Weight Management program

In-network (eligible providers): 80% up to \$6,000 maximum for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options; deductible and coinsurance maximum do not apply

Out-of-network: not applicable

This benefit covers comprehensive and clinically based weight management programs for the treatment of obesity. The 20% coinsurance you pay will not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum and will continue after the deductible and coinsurance maximum are met.

Who is eligible

Members are eligible for this benefit if they meet the following criteria:

- Have been prescribed a GLP-1 medication, or
- Diagnosed as obese (commonly Body Mass Index (BMI) greater than or equal to 30), or
- Overweight with a BMI greater than or equal to 27, and diagnosed with two or more of the following conditions:
 - Congestive heart failure
 - Coronary heart disease
 - Depression
 - Diabetes
 - Hyperlipidemia
 - Hypertension
 - Sleep Apnea

This benefit is available for members aged 18 and over.

Eligible providers

Approved [weight management providers](#) of this benefit must meet eligibility requirements set forth by Microsoft and Premera and be providing services under a weight management program that is contracted for and approved by Premera for this plan.

Approved weight management programs will be those programs that are comprehensive and clinically based. Approved programs must be based on medical oversight and include treatment from professionals in the areas of nutrition, behavioral therapy, and personal training. An approved program must include an initial minimum 10-week period of frequent sessions with the program's physician, personal trainer, dietitian, and behavioral therapist. This initial period must be followed by a minimum three-month maintenance period, which includes regular follow-up visits with these program professionals.

The Weight Management program must be contracted for and approved by Premera both at the time the participant or covered spouse/domestic partner begins the program and when they complete the program. If the program is not approved and contracted for until after the participant has started treatment under the program, no part of the cost of the program will be covered under this benefit.



To find an approved provider, review the [Weight Management providers list](#).

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

A [Weight Management Recommendation form](#) or confirmation of your BMI and co-morbid conditions must be submitted to Premera in order to receive reimbursement from Premera. Your physician's recommendation will confirm you meet the contract criteria required for this benefit to be available.

The following are the steps that you are strongly recommended to complete in advance to ensure that your treatment meets the criteria of this benefit:

1. Take the Weight Management Recommendation form to your regular physician
2. An evaluation is performed by your physician to determine if you meet the eligibility requirements set forth above
3. Your physician faxes or mails the Weight Management Recommendation Form to Premera to confirm that you meet the weight management eligibility requirements and your physician's approval



To obtain a copy of the Weight Management Recommendation form, contact Premera Blue Cross at (800) 676-1411. Your physician can fax this information to (800) 676-1477

4. Premera will review the information submitted and verify the coverage through a prior authorization

Claims payment

Final claims payment will be contingent on Premera receiving all biometric reporting information for the participant. Reimbursement for this benefit may occur in one of two ways. The program you attend will select the claims payment method used.

Method 1: Direct reimbursement to member

The provider will bill you directly for services provided. The frequency of billing should be made clear by the provider before you start the program. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program.

During the course of the program, you can submit an interim billing member claim form on a monthly or quarterly basis to Premera for reimbursement. Upon completion of the program, you must submit the weight management final billing claim form for your final payment. Final claims payment is contingent on receiving the form with all biometric information completed.

If your coverage terminates during the time you are participating in an approved program, and you do not elect COBRA, only services rendered up to the date of termination of coverage will be reimbursed.

Method 2: Direct reimbursement to provider

Reimbursement will be made directly to the weight management provider on a monthly or quarterly basis. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program but will bill Premera on a monthly or quarterly basis for your ongoing participation.

Additional exclusions and limitations for Weight Management program

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Food
- Nutritional supplements (i.e., protein shakes)
- Drugs or surgical procedures to assist in reducing weight or curbing hunger are not covered under the weight management program benefit. Refer to the [Prescription drugs](#) or [Surgical weight loss treatment](#) benefit for coverage.

Exclusions and limitations

- Services or supplies not medically necessary for diagnosis, care, or treatment of a disease, illness, injury, or medical condition, except for the following: (a) newborn nursery care covered under the hospital benefit; (b) male circumcision benefit; (c) sterilization benefit; (d) termination of pregnancy benefit; (e) infertility benefit; (f) hospice care benefit; and (g) well-child care and adult physical exam benefits
- Charges in excess of eligible charges, including out-of-network provider billed amounts over the allowable charges
- Expenses in excess of the applicable annual and lifetime benefit maximums
- Services for which a claim was not received by Premera within 12 months of the date of service. Corrected claims and COB claims need to be submitted within 12 months from the original claim submission date.
- Over-the-counter drugs (unless prescribed); food dietary supplements (for example, infant formulas or protein supplements); and herbal or naturopathic/homeopathic medicine
- Over the counter (OTC) testing and supplies (for example, OTC pregnancy test and ovulation tests) except as covered under the DME benefit

- Charges for or in connection with services or supplies that are determined to be experimental or investigational
- Benefits that overlap or duplicate benefits for which the member is eligible under any other group benefit plan; Workers' Compensation or similar employee benefit law; Medicare A or B; or government-sponsored program of any type
- Services or supplies that are covered through any type of no-fault coverage or similar type of insurance coverage or contract, including but not limited to Personal Injury Protection (PIP) coverage, motor vehicle medical (MEDPAY), motor vehicle no-fault coverage, any excess insurance coverage, Medical premises coverage for homeowners or commercial (MEDPREM), commercial liability coverage, boat coverage, homeowner policy, or school and/or athletic policies.
 - This exclusion applies when the available or existing contract or insurance is either issued to, or makes benefits available to a Participant/claimant, whether or not the Participant/claimant makes a claim under such coverage.
 - Further, the Participant is responsible for any cost-sharing required by motor vehicle coverage, unless applicable state law requires otherwise.
 - If other insurance is available for medical benefits, the Participant must put such other insurance to use towards those medical bills before coverage under the Plan is available. Once benefits under such contract or insurance have been used and exhausted or considered to no longer be Injury-related under the no-fault provisions of the contract, Benefits will be provided according to the Plan.
- Work-related Conditions: This exclusion applies whether or not a proper or timely claim for benefits has been made under the following programs. This plan does not cover services or supplies for which you are entitled to receive benefits under:
 - Occupational coverage required of, or voluntarily obtained by, the employer
 - State or federal workers' compensation acts
 - Any legislative act providing compensation for work-related illness or injury
- In the event that you do not comply with the contractual terms of subrogation, the plan will no longer be obligated to provide any benefits. The plan has the right to deduct the amount of benefits paid from any future benefits payable to the enrollee or to any other covered dependent.
- Any services or supplies for which no charge is made, or for which a charge is made because this plan is in effect, or for services or supplies for which the member is legally liable because this plan is in effect
- Services of a social worker except as provided in the hospice care benefit, the home health care benefit, and the mental health and chemical dependency benefit
- Routine or palliative foot care to treat fallen arches, flat feet, care of corns, bunions (except for bone surgery), calluses, toenails (except for ingrown toenail surgery) and other problems that are commonly treated with off-the-shelf, over-the-counter (OTC) therapy. This exclusion does not apply to medically necessary foot care.
- Foot or shoe prosthetics, appliances, orthotics or inserts except as described under the durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies benefit. This does not apply to enrollees who are diabetic.
- Massage therapy that is not medically necessary or is furnished without a prescription
- Activity therapy, such as music, dance or art therapies

- Charges to obtain, train, or maintain service animals and emotional support animals
- Any benefits or services not specifically provided for in this SPD
- Liquid diets or fasting programs, memberships in diet programs or health clubs, or wiring of the jaw
- Drugs and medications not approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) except as defined in the Experimental and Investigational section
- Procedures for sterilization reversals
- Hypnotherapy, regardless of provider
- Hippotherapy or other forms of equine or animal-based therapy
- Electronic services and/or consults, except as specifically described under the plan
- Services or supplies furnished by a member to himself or herself or by a provider who is in any way related to the member. This also includes but is not limited to a provider covered dependents under the plan (whether or not living in the household), spouse, natural or adoptive parent, child, sibling, stepparent, stepchild, stepsibling, father-in-law, mother-in-law, son-in-law, daughter-in-law, brother-in-law, sister-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, spouse of grandparent or spouse of grandchild.
- Services that are illegal, outside the scope of the provider's license or certification, or furnished by a provider that is not licensed or certified by the jurisdiction in which the services or supplies were received
- Separate charges for records or reports, except those Premera requests for utilization review
- Voluntary support or affinity groups such as patient support, diabetic support groups or Alcoholics Anonymous. Additionally, volunteer services or services provided by or through a school, books, and other training aids are also not covered.
- Non-treatment facilities, institutions or programs: Benefits are not provided for institutional care, housing, incarceration, or programs from facilities that are not licensed to provide medical or behavioral health treatment for covered conditions. Examples are prisons, nursing homes, juvenile detention facilities, group homes, foster homes and adult family homes. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that such non-treatment facilities, institutions, or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.
- Services or supplies for any of the following:
 - Education and training programs including testing or supplies/materials, including vision training supplies
 - Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.
 - Social, cultural, or vocational rehabilitation or vision training supplies
- Refractive surgery of the eye (surgery to improve vision that can be corrected with glasses or contact lenses) is covered only as specified under the vision plan
- Hospital grade breast pumps are not available for purchase; however, they may be covered for rent for up to the duration of breastfeeding
- Services for individuals not eligible for coverage under the Microsoft Plan will not be reimbursed except in the following circumstances:

- Donors for organ or bone marrow/stem cell transplantation for services specific to that procedure
- Genetic testing of relatives when the information is needed to adequately assess risk in the member; the result of the test will directly impact the treatment to the member; and there is no other coverage available to the relative
- Lodging is covered only as outlined in the Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit
- When Coordinating Benefits (COB) if you fail to follow the rules of the primary plan, this plan would pay nothing for that expense
- Benefits are not provided for services or supplies (1) for which no charge is made, (2) for which no charge would have been made if this plan were not in effect or (3) that were not received by the member while covered by the plan
- Services received in excess of a benefit limit or maximum are not covered. Any network discounts for in network providers do not apply to services received in excess of the benefit limit.

In addition, certain exclusions and limitations apply to the following benefits. CTRL+Click to navigate to the benefit information.

- [Autism/ABA therapy.](#)
- [Dental services.](#)
- [Hearing care and hardware.](#)
- [Home health care.](#)
- [Hospice care.](#)
- [Hospital inpatient care.](#)
- [Infertility](#)
- [Medical equipment and supplies](#)
- [Mental health and chemical dependency treatment](#)
- [Prescription drugs.](#)
- [Skilled nursing facility.](#)
- [Transplants.](#)
- [Weight Management program.](#)

How to file a claim

In most cases, when you receive care from an in-network provider, your provider will submit bills directly to Premera, and this submission is your claim for benefits. If your provider does not submit a bill directly to Premera, you will need to submit a claim for benefits.

If possible, you should submit the claim form within 30 days of the service. The plan will not reimburse claims submitted more than 12 months after the date of service.

To submit a claim online:

From the Benefits Site, select **View My Claims**, which will direct you to the Premera Portal. Or sign in to your account on premera.com. Next, from the top menu bar select **Claims** and then **Submit Claims**. Follow the steps and upload a copy of the itemized receipt.

To submit a claim via mail, fax or email:

1. Download the [Premera Claim Reimbursement Request Form](#). You can also email Premera from your Microsoft email address (employees) to microsoft@premera.com or through your Secure Messaging center in the Premera portal (all enrollees including dependents and COBRA members) to request a claim form.
2. Complete the claim form, including all of the following information:
 - a. Your name and the member's name
 - b. Identification numbers shown on your identification card (including the 3-digit plan prefix or MSJ)
 - c. Provider's name, address, and tax identification number
 - d. If you are seeking secondary coverage from the Microsoft health plan, information about other insurance coverage related to the claim at hand, including a copy of their Explanation of Benefits (EOB), if applicable
 - e. If treatment is as a result of an accident: the date, time, location and brief description of the accident
 - f. Date of onset of the illness or injury
 - g. Date of service
 - h. Diagnosis or ICD-10 code (this information can be found on the provider bill)
 - i. Procedure codes (CPT-4, HCPCS, ADA, or UB-92) or descriptive English language for each service (this information can be found on the provider bill)
 - j. Itemized charges for each service rendered by provider
3. Sign the form in the space provided and attach the itemized provider bill
4. Submit the completed form to:

Mail: Premera Blue Cross
P.O. Box 91059
Seattle, WA 98111-9159
Fax: (800) 676-1477
Email from Microsoft email address: claims.microsoft@premera.com
Email through the Secure Messaging center in your Premera portal



COBRA-eligibility claims should be submitted as described in the [Continuation of coverage for health benefits and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

In the following circumstances, you may submit claims according to the [appeals process](#):

If you cannot submit the claim in a timely manner due to circumstances beyond your control

If your claim regards plan eligibility for you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent child

Claim review and payment

The claim review process begins once Premera receives a claim from you or your provider or other authorized representative. Premera will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other communication notifying you of their decision on your claim. In most cases, this communication will be sent to you no more than 30 days after Premera receives the claim, although Premera may extend this 30-day period for up to 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond Premera's control.

If your claim relates to an item for which the Plan requires you to obtain approval (or “prior authorization”) before it is furnished to you, then Premera generally will send a decision no later than 15 calendar days after receipt of your request. Premera may extend this 15-day period for up to an additional 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond Premera’s control.

If Premera needs additional information from you to process your pre- or post-service claim, Premera will notify you in writing, within 30 days after receiving your claim, of the specific information required. You will have at least 45 days to provide the additional information. The determination period to respond to your claim (as provided above) will be suspended as of the date Premera sends the notice and will resume again once you have provided the additional information. If you do not provide the requested information within the specified timeframe, Premera will decide the claim without the requested information.

If your claim is for “urgent care,” meaning the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment at issue, then the following special rules apply:

- Premera will send you an EOB or other communication notifying you if they have denied your claim, in writing or electronically, within 72 hours after Premera receives all necessary information for your claim either via phone or in writing, taking into account the seriousness of your condition.
- Premera’s denial notice may be oral, with a written or electronic confirmation to follow within three days.
- If the claim was filed incorrectly, Premera will notify you of the error and how to correct it within 24 hours after the claim was received. If additional information is needed to process the claim, Premera will notify you of the information needed within 24 hours after the claim was received. You then have 48 hours to provide the requested information. You will then be notified of Premera’s determination no later than 48 hours after (1) Premera’s receipt of the requested information, or (2) the end of the 48-hour period when you were to provide the additional information if the information is not received in that timeframe.

If your claim is a request to extend an ongoing course of treatment beyond a previously approved period of time or number of treatments, and is considered an urgent care claim, Premera will decide your claim within 24 hours, provided that your claim is submitted at least 24 hours before the end of the approved treatment.



Explanation of benefits (EOB) is the statement you receive from Premera Blue Cross detailing how much the provider billed, how much (if any) the plan paid, and the amount that you owe the provider (if any).

Premera will make a payment to the employee, a dependent (age 13 or older), a provider, or another carrier. Payments are subject to applicable laws and regulations:

- Premera may make payments on behalf of an enrolled child to a non-enrolled parent or state agency to which the plan is required by applicable law to direct such payments
- Payments made will discharge the plan to the extent of the amount paid, so that the plan is not liable to anyone due to its choice of payee

Denied claims notice

If all or part of your claim is denied, Premera will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other notice with the following information:

- The specific reason or reasons for the denial
- Reference to the specific plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A description of any additional material or information needed from you and the reason it is needed
- An explanation of the appeals procedures and the applicable time limits
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol or other criterion that was relied upon in making the adverse determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the claim is for urgent care (as defined above), a description of the expedited review process applicable to such claims
- If you have filed a claim with Premera relating to plan eligibility, and this claim is denied, Premera will send you a notice explaining your appeal rights
- Notice regarding your right to bring legal action following a denial on appeal

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning
- A description of the plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal
- Contact information for Premera Customer Service or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist participants with the internal and external appeals process

Appeal for internal review

If you do not agree with the decision made by the plan, you may appeal for an internal review of the decision within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or adverse decision.



An **appeal** is a written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce or end payment, coverage or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the plan. This includes admissions to and continued stays in a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.



If you fail to file the internal appeal within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits, you will permanently lose your right to appeal the denied claim.

Submitting an appeal for internal review

You or your authorized representative* must provide the following information as part of your written appeal to the Premera Appeals Department:

- Your name,
- Your Premera member number,
- The name of this plan, and
- A concise statement of why you disagree with the decision, including facts or theories supporting your claim.

Your written request may (but is not required to) include issues, comments, documents, and other records you want considered in the review.



The appeal should be mailed or faxed to Premera:

Appeals Coordinator
Premera Blue Cross
P.O. Box 91102
Seattle, WA 98111-9202
Fax: (425) 918-5592

*You may, at your own expense, have a representative file an appeal on your behalf. Your attorney, family member, your provider, or anyone else who you wish to designate as your authorized representative may also appeal with written authorization. In order to designate an authorized representative for this purpose, you must submit a completed and signed [Microsoft Member Appeals Form](#), which includes an appeal authorization section.

In the case of an urgent care appeal, you may submit your appeal request orally or in writing and all necessary information may be transmitted between you and the plan by telephone or fax. If your provider believes your situation is urgent as defined under law and so notifies Premera, your appeal will be conducted on an expedited basis. Notification will be furnished to you as soon as possible, but not later than 72 hours after receipt of the expedited appeal. Your appeal should clearly indicate your request for an expedited appeal.

For urgent situations or if you are in an ongoing course of treatment, you may begin an external independent review at the same time as Premera Blue Cross's internal review process. The external review agency is not legally affiliated or controlled by Premera. The external review agency decision is final and is binding upon the Plan.



To file an urgent care appeal request, you may fax a request to (425) 918-5592.



The external review for non-urgent situations is available only after you have properly exhausted the internal appeal as described above.



An urgent care claim or appeal is one where the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment that is the subject of the claim.

Internal review and timeframe

All the information you submit will be taken into account on appeal, even if it was not reviewed as part of the initial decision. You may ask to examine or receive free copies of all pertinent plan documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim by asking Premera.

The plan may consult with a health care professional who has experience in the field of medicine involved in the medical judgment to decide your appeal. You may request the identity of medical experts whose advice was obtained by the plan in connection with your initial claim denial, even if their advice was not relied upon in making the initial decision.

In the event any new or additional information (evidence) is considered, relied on or generated by Premera in connection with your appeal, Premera will provide this information to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that you will have an opportunity to respond. Also, if any new or additional rationale is considered by Premera, Premera will provide the rationale to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that that you will have an opportunity to respond.

Other than urgent care appeals, described above, in most cases Premera will send a decision on your appeal no later than 60 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request. However, if the appeal relates to an item for which the Plan requires you to obtain approval before it is furnished to you, then it will be considered a pre-service appeal, and Premera will send a decision no later than 30 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request.

Denied appeal notice

If your appeal is denied, you will receive a written notice setting forth:

- The specific reason or reasons for the denial
- Reference to the specific plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A statement that you are entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records and other information relevant to your claim for benefits
- A statement explaining the external review procedures offered by the plan and your right to bring a civil action under ERISA section 502(a)
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol or other criterion that was relied upon in denying the claim (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)

- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning
- A description of the Plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal
- Contact information for Premera Customer Service or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist participants with the internal and external appeals process

Appeal for external review

If you are not satisfied with the final internal denial of your claim, you may request an external review by an independent review organization (IRO) if that denial (1) has a retroactive effect and is considered a rescission of coverage under the law, or (2) is based on medical judgment including:

- Requirements for medical necessity, appropriateness, health care setting, level of care or effectiveness of a covered benefit
- A determination that a treatment is experimental or investigational



An **independent review organization (IRO)** is an independent organization of medical experts who are qualified to review medical and other relevant information.

The external review for non-urgent situations is available only after you have properly exhausted the internal appeals process as described above. There are no fees or costs imposed on you as part of the external review.

The external review agency decision is final and is binding upon the plan.

Submitting an appeal for external review

To initiate the external review, you must send a written request to Premera at the address below no later than 120 days after the date you receive your internal appeal determination letter, which the plan deems to be seven days after the date on the internal appeal determination letter.



If you fail to submit the written request within this timeframe, you will permanently lose your right to an external review.



Mail or fax the written request to:

Premera Blue Cross
Attn: Microsoft Member Appeals – IRO Mail Stop 123
P.O. Box 91102
Seattle, WA 98111-9202
Fax: (425) 918-5592

External review and timeframe

If your appeal is eligible for external review, Premera will notify the IRO of your request for an external review and send them all the information included in your internal appeal and other relevant materials within six days of receipt.

The IRO will contact Premera directly if additional information is needed. Premera will provide the IRO with any additional information they request that is reasonably available. The external review request is considered complete when the IRO has all the requested information, and the IRO review begins.



If your provider believes your situation is urgent under law (as defined above under Appeal for internal review), your external review will be conducted on an expedited basis. For expedited external reviews, you and Premera will be notified by phone, e-mail message or fax as soon as possible, but no later than 72 hours after receipt of your external review request. A written determination will follow.

The plan agrees that any statute of limitations (including the one-year contractual limitations period described below) or other defense based on timeliness is on hold during the time that the external review is pending. Your decision whether to file the external review will have no effect on your rights to any other benefits under the plan.

The external review process does not apply to appeals of denied claims for plan eligibility or for other appeals of denied claims that are not based on medical judgment.

Decision on the external review

The plan is bound by the IRO's decision. If the IRO overturned the final internal adverse determination, the plan will implement their decision. The IRO will notify you and Premera in writing of its determination on the external review no later than 45 days after receipt of your complete external review request.

Decisions upon the external review are the final decision under the plan's appeal process, and there are no further appeals available from Premera or Microsoft or any person administering claims or appeals under the plan. However, you still have the right to file suit under ERISA Section 502(a) as a result of the external review decision.

Limits on your right to judicial review

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal before taking action in any other forum regarding a claim for benefits under the plan. Any legal action initiated under the plan must be brought no later than one year following the adverse determination on the appeal. This one-year limitations period on claims for benefits applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit claim is deemed permanently waived and barred. In addition, you must raise all issues and grounds for appealing a decision on a claim for benefits at every stage of the appeal process, or else such issues and grounds will be deemed permanently waived and barred.



If you have questions about understanding a denial of a claim or your appeal rights, you may contact Premera Customer Service for assistance at (800) 676-1411. You may also seek assistance from the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor at (866) 444-EBSA (3272).

Right to recover benefits paid in error

If Premera makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, Premera has the right to recover payment, including deducting the amount paid mistake from future benefits.

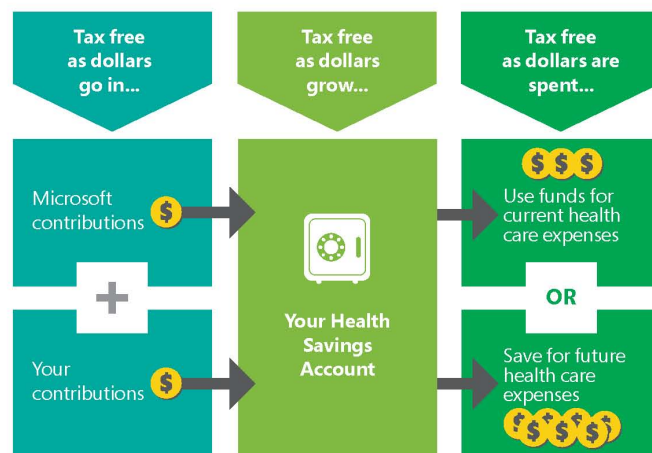
Note: Health care providers are not “beneficiaries” of the plan, and although Premera may make direct payment to health care providers for the convenience of participants and their dependents, such payments of services shall not be considered “benefits” available under the plan or confer beneficiary standing upon a health care provider.

Health Savings Account (HSA)

The Health Savings Account is an interest-bearing savings account designed to allow you to pay for medical expenses (both now and in the future) with tax-free dollars. The Health Savings Account is yours—you own, manage, and control the funds in the account. If you do not spend it, you get to keep it, and you can watch it grow over time.

The Health Savings Account is available only to those enrolled in a high-deductible health plan, such as the Health Savings Plan, that meets certain Internal Revenue Service (IRS) criteria.

The Health Savings Account features triple tax savings—tax-free contributions into your account, tax-free earnings on interest and dividends, and tax-free when you withdraw funds to pay for eligible health care expenses.



For more information visit:

Active employees/dependents go here...

[.Health Savings Plan](#) on the Benefits site

COBRA enrollees go here...

[Fidelity](#).

A Health Savings Account is not an ERISA employee benefit plan established or maintained by Microsoft. Microsoft will not: (1) limit your ability to move your funds from one Health Savings Account to another, (2) impose conditions on utilization of your Health Savings Account funds, (3) make or influence investment decisions with respect to your Health Savings Account funds, or (4) receive any payment or compensation in connection with your Health Savings Account. Your choice whether or not to participate in a Health Savings Account is completely voluntary.

Setting up your account

Microsoft and Premera work with [Fidelity](#) to administer your Health Savings Account. Once you enroll in the Health Savings Plan, Microsoft will open a Health Savings Account for you with [Fidelity](#). **There are no monthly HSA administrative fees, but you may incur fees in accordance with [Fidelity's Brokerage Commission and Fee Schedule](#).** You may also establish an account at another bank and transfer the funds from the [Fidelity](#) account.

Eligibility to contribute to an HSA

You are eligible for a Health Savings Account if:

- You are enrolled in a Health Savings Account-compatible, high-deductible health plan (such as the Premera Health Savings Plan offered by Microsoft)
- You are not covered by another health plan (other than another high-deductible health plan), including coverage under your spouse's/domestic partner's health plan or Medicare
- You are not covered by your spouse's General Purpose Healthcare Flexible Spending Account (FSA) or Health Reimbursement Arrangement (HRA) (except a limited purpose FSA or HRA)
- You cannot be claimed as a dependent on another person's tax return
- You are not enrolled in Medicare (parts A, B, C or D) or TRICARE, and you have not received medical or prescription benefits from the Veteran's Administration (VA) in the preceding three months (other than benefits for preventive care or a service-connected disability, as defined by applicable law). Note: mere eligibility for medical benefits from the Veteran's Administration does not disqualify you from participating in the HSA.



You still have medical coverage under the Health Savings Plan even if you cannot contribute to a Health Savings Account.

If you do not qualify to contribute to a Health Savings Account because you have coverage under another health plan, you or your spouse/domestic partner can take action if you wish to address your eligibility issue.

- If you are covered by your spouse's/domestic partner's health plan, you should have them remove you as a covered dependent and/or withdraw from their General Purpose Healthcare FSA/HRA
- If you are enrolled in Medicare or TRICARE (medical), or if you have received VA medical/prescription benefits in the past three months (other than for preventive care or a service-connected disability), you are not eligible for the Health Savings Account and typically you cannot take action to address your eligibility issue. In these circumstances, Microsoft will provide you with an alternative taxable cash contribution, equal to the annual Health Savings Account contribution for your coverage level, via paycheck deposit.

Microsoft will discontinue all employer contributions to the Health Savings Account when you indicate that you are no longer covered under the plan as an active Microsoft employee or if you are covered by disqualifying coverage under another health plan.



If you continue medical coverage in the Health Savings Plan through COBRA, you will not continue to receive Microsoft contributions to your Health Savings Account.

Contributions to your Health Savings Account (HSA)

Microsoft will make a pre-tax contribution* to your Health Savings Account (for active employees only) based upon your role and coverage level, as outlined in the table below. The Microsoft contribution is deposited in two equal installments in January and July. The amount of your Microsoft contribution to the Health Savings Account is adjusted based on a prorated calculation of full months of plan enrollment if you or your family members, as applicable, are enrolled in the plan for only part of the year.

Examples

1. Marco (a Microsoft employee at level 59) enrolls in the Health Savings Plan with employee only coverage during Open Enrollment. Marco's coverage effective date is January 1, 2026, and total Microsoft HSA contribution for 2026 is \$1,000, which will be contributed to Marco's account as follows:
 - \$500 deposited at the same time as the January 15th paycheck (one half of the total Microsoft contribution)
 - \$500 deposited at the same time as the July 15th paycheck (one half of the total Microsoft contribution)
2. Ana (a new Microsoft employee at level 59) enrolls in the Health Savings Plan with family (employee + 2 or more) coverage. Based on the date of hire, Ana's coverage effective date under the plan is March 7th, 2026. Ana's total Microsoft contribution for 2026 is \$1,875 and will be contributed to the account as follows:
 - \$625 will be the first Microsoft HSA contribution and will occur within 1-2 payrolls following the date Ana successfully opens the HSA account. This amount represents 3 full months of enrollment under the plan (April, May, and June)
 - \$1,250 deposited at the same time as the July 15th paycheck (one half of the full annual Microsoft contribution amount)

***IMPORTANT.** Your HSA must be fully established and in good order with Fidelity in order to receive payroll and Microsoft contributions. If you are new to Microsoft and are establishing a Fidelity HSA for the first time, your account must be fully established, open and in good order by December 1st of the calendar year, or Microsoft will not be able to fund contributions for that calendar year. It is your responsibility to read all program communications (emails, letters, postcards, etc.) from Fidelity Investments regarding your account status. Because HSAs are personal accounts, Microsoft will not know if your account is not in good order.

You may make additional tax-free contributions to your account. Changes to your employee HSA contributions will take effect as of the first day of the month following the date that you make the election change. Any changes to your HSA contribution election are prospective only, and your new annual election amount cannot be less than the amount that has already been contributed year to date. If you and your spouse both have an HSA, your combined HSA contributions may not exceed the annual family coverage contribution limit (that is, \$8,750 in 2026). Individuals age 55 or over may make an additional annual catch-up contribution as listed below.

Due to IRS regulations, the annual combined Microsoft/employee tax-free contribution to the Health Savings Account cannot exceed the maximum annual limits listed in the table below.

Annual tax-free contribution limits for the Health Savings Account				
		Microsoft contribution	Employee maximum contribution	Maximum annual limit
Level 40-49 and 59 and above	Employee only	\$1,000	\$3,400	\$4,400
	Employee + 1	\$2,000	\$6,750	\$8,750
	Employee + 2 or more	\$2,500	\$6,250	\$8,750
Level 30-39 and 50-58	Employee only	\$1,750	\$2,650	\$4,400
	Employee + 1	\$3,500	\$5,250	\$8,750
	Employee + 2 or more	\$4,375	\$4,375	\$8,750
Age 55 or over catch-up contribution		\$0	Maximum contribution plus \$1,000	Maximum contribution plus \$1,000



If you exceed the allowable maximum, excess contributions not removed before your tax filing deadline are subject to an additional 6% excise tax.

If during the year you become eligible to contribute to a health savings account, or are already eligible to contribute to a health saving account but make a mid-year change in your Health Savings Plan coverage level (e.g., from employee-only to employee-plus-one coverage) due to a qualified status change event, then in determining your employee maximum contribution for the year, you may be treated as having been for the entire year eligible to contribute to a health savings account, and enrolled in the coverage that you had as of December 1. This is called the “last month rule.” However, if you use the last month rule and then cease to be eligible to contribute to your health savings account before December 31 of the following year, you may be subject to income and additional taxes on a portion of your previous health savings account contributions.

Microsoft’s contribution to your health savings account will not be affected by the last month rule, but rather will be adjusted based on a prorated calculation of full months of plan enrollment (and/or twice annual basis, in January and July, as applicable), based upon your role and coverage level at the time of each Microsoft contribution.

If both you and your spouse/eligible domestic partner are employed by Microsoft and enroll for coverage in the Health Savings Plan, certain rules apply to your HSA contributions from Microsoft.

- If you enroll together under one plan, the primary subscriber will receive the contribution from Microsoft to their Health Savings Account for your coverage level. Health care expenses for both you and your spouse/domestic partner will count toward the same deductible and coinsurance maximum.
- If you enroll separately, you will each receive the contribution from Microsoft for your coverage level in your own separate Health Savings Accounts. Health care expenses will count toward separate deductibles and coinsurance maximum amounts. You may keep dependent children with one parent only, or if you have more than one child, you may split them between the two parents.
- If your Microsoft-employed domestic partner is not a qualifying tax dependent, you may find it more beneficial to enroll separately so that they can have access to the tax saving benefits of the Health Savings Account. You will pay taxes if you use your Health Savings Account to cover expenses for a dependent who does not qualify as a dependent according to the IRS definition.

Microsoft will discontinue all employer contributions to the Health Savings Account when you are no longer covered under the Health Savings Plan as an active Microsoft employee or if you indicate you are covered by disqualifying coverage under another health plan.

Eligible expenses

The money in your Health Savings Account can be withdrawn on a tax-free basis to pay for qualified medical expenses, as defined by IRC section 223(d)(2) and section 213(d). If the amount withdrawn is used for something other than qualified medical expenses and you are under age 65, then it will be subject to income tax and an additional 20% tax. For more information on tax treatment for Health Savings Accounts, refer to IRS Publication 969.

When you reach age 65, the funds in your Health Savings Account can be used for additional medical expenses, such as insurance premiums (such as Medicare Part A&B, but not Medicare Supplemental plans) and your share of retiree medical insurance premiums.

You are responsible for maintaining records of the medical expenses paid through the Health Savings Account. In the event of an IRS audit, you may need to provide documentation that the Health Savings Account was used for qualified medical expenses.

HMO Plan Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington (KFHPWA)

Washington only

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How the plan works

The Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington (KFHPWA) HMO Plan offers the convenience of “one-stop shop” medical care. Your Provider Network is KFHPWA’s Core Network (Network). Members are entitled to Covered Services only at Network Facilities and from Network Providers, except for Emergency services and care pursuant to a Preauthorization. Your providers are all part of the same integrated health care system, so they can quickly share your medical records to help make informed decisions about your care. There is also a pharmacy, laboratory, and X-ray facility at every Kaiser Permanente location, so it is easy and efficient to get the care you need when you need it.

Important notice under Federal Health Care Reform

KFHPWA recommends each member choose a Primary Care Physician. This decision is important since the designated Primary Care Physician provides or arranges for most of the member’s health care. The member has the right to designate any Primary Care Physician who participates in one of the KFHPWA networks and who is available to accept the member or the member’s family members. For information on how to select a Primary Care Physician, and for a list of the participating Primary Care Physicians, call the Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636 in the Seattle area, or toll-free in Washington, (888) 901-4636.

For children, the member may designate a pediatrician as the primary care provider.

The member does not need prior authorization from KFHPWA or from any other person (including a Primary Care Physician) to access obstetrical or gynecological care from a health care professional in the KFHPWA network who specializes in obstetrics or gynecology. The health care professional, however, may

be required to comply with certain procedures, including obtaining prior authorization for certain services, following a pre-approved treatment plan, or procedures for obtaining prior authorization. For a list of participating health care professionals who specialize in obstetrics or gynecology, call the Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636 in the Seattle area, or toll-free in Washington, (888) 901-4636.

Federal No Surprise Billing Protection

Out-of-network providers generally have the right to charge you more than the Plan's allowed amount or allowable charge for a covered service. This is called "balance billing." However, Federal law protects you from balance billing for the following types of services:

- Emergency Care from an out-of-network hospital or independent freestanding emergency department.
- Out-of-network air ambulance services
- Any services from an out-of-network provider at an in-network hospital, hospital outpatient department, critical access hospital, or outpatient surgical center, provided that the out-of-network provider may balance bill you if the provider gives you advance notice and you provide your written consent, except for the following services (for which balance billing is never permitted):
 - Surgery
 - Anesthesia
 - Pathology
 - Radiology
 - Laboratory
 - Hospitalist Care

Solely for purposes of determining your cost-sharing obligations for these services, the allowed amount or allowable charge is the lesser of (1) the out-of-network provider's or facility's billed charges, or (2) the Plan's median in-network rate for the same or similar service provided in the same or similar specialty in the same geographic area (or any other amount specified for this purpose under applicable law).

Please Note: These balance billing protections do not apply to any other service from an out-of-network provider or facility. If the service is not listed above, the provider or facility may bill you for, and you may be required to pay, any amounts in excess of the plan's allowed amount for the service (and any amounts that you pay in excess of the allowed amount will not count toward any applicable deductible, coinsurance, or out-of-pocket maximum).

Women's health and cancer rights

If the member is receiving benefits for a covered mastectomy and elects breast reconstruction in connection with the mastectomy, the member will also receive coverage for:

- All stages of reconstruction of the breast on which the mastectomy has been performed.
- Surgery and reconstruction of the other breast to produce a symmetrical appearance.
- Prostheses.
- Treatment of physical complications of all stages of mastectomy, including lymphedemas.

These services will be provided in consultation with the member and the attending physician and will be subject to the same cost shares otherwise applicable under the Benefits Booklet.

Statement of rights under the Newborns' and Mothers' Health Protection Act

Carriers offering KFHPWA coverage generally may not, under federal law, restrict benefits for any hospital length of stay in connection with childbirth for the mother or newborn child to less than 48 hours following a vaginal delivery, or less than 96 hours following a cesarean section. However, federal law generally does not prohibit the mother's or newborn's attending provider, after consulting with the mother, from discharging the mother or the newborn earlier than 48 hours (or 96 hours as applicable). In any case, carriers may not, under federal law, require that a provider obtain authorization from the carrier for prescribing a length of stay not in excess of 48 hours (or 96 hours). Also, under federal law, a carrier may not set the level of benefits or out-of-pocket costs so that any later portion of the 48-hour (or 96-hour) stay is treated in a manner less favorable to the mother or newborn than any earlier portion of the stay.

For more information

KFHPWA will provide the information regarding the types of plans offered by KFHPWA to members on request. Call the Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636 in the Seattle area, or toll-free in Washington, (888) 901-4636.

Where you can get care

The KFHPWA HMO Plan provides comprehensive medical care with several contracted providers, facilities and pharmacies through the KFHPWA Network in Washington. Kaiser Permanente facilities are treated as part of the KFHPWA Network if you need medical services while outside Washington State as described under receiving care in another Kaiser Foundation Health Plan Service Area, below. Benefits will not be denied for any health care service performed by a registered nurse licensed to practice under Washington regulations (Chapter 18.88 RCW), if the service performed was within the lawful scope of the nurse's license, and this plan would have covered the service if it had been performed by a Doctor of Medicine licensed to practice under Washington regulations (Chapter 18.71 RCW).



In the event of unusual circumstances such as a major disaster, epidemic, military action, civil disorder, labor disputes or similar causes, KFHPWA will not be liable for administering coverage beyond the limitations of available personnel and facilities.

Receiving Care in another Kaiser Foundation Health Plan Service Area

If you are visiting the service area of another Kaiser Permanente region, services may be available from designated providers in that region and treated as within the KFHPWA Network if the services otherwise would have been covered under this SPD. These "visiting member" services are subject to the provisions set forth in this SPD including, but not limited to, preauthorization and cost sharing. For more information about receiving visiting member services in other Kaiser Permanente regional health plan service areas, including provider and facility locations, call Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636 in the

Seattle area, or toll-free in Washington, (888) 901-4636. Information is also available online at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/html/public/services/traveling>.

Receiving Care outside the Kaiser Foundation Health Plan Network

If you choose to receive services from a non-KFHPWA HMO (Core) Network provider or facility, except as otherwise specifically provided in this SPD, those services will not be covered, and you will be responsible for the full price of the services. Any amounts you pay for non-covered services will not count toward your out-of-pocket limit.

Services provided outside the KFHPWA Network may not be covered. The plan covers select services outside of the KFHPWA Network, including:

Covered care outside the KFHPWA Network	
Emergency care	You can obtain emergency care from the closest facility to you. You must call the hospital notification line at (888) 457-9516 within 24 hours of admission to a non-contracted facility, or as soon thereafter as medically possible. Review the emergency benefits for more information.
Urgent care	If you are outside the KFHPWA service area, you may receive urgent care at any medical facility. Urgent care within the KFHPWA service area is covered at KFHPWA facilities. Review the urgent care benefits for more information. For urgent care during office hours, you can call your personal physician's office first to see if you can get a same-day appointment. If a physician is not available or it is after office hours, you may speak with a licensed care provider anytime at 1-800-297-6877 or (206) 630-2244. You may also check https://wa-doctors.kaiserpermanente.org/ or call Member Services to find the nearest urgent care facility in your network.

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

Covered care outside the KFHPWA Network	
Out of area benefit	If you are outside the KFHPWA service area, the plan covers services up to a maximum of \$2,000 per member per calendar year. All applicable costs, benefits, limitations and exclusions apply as if services were covered within the KFHPWA service area.
Travel and lodging reimbursement	Travel and lodging reimbursement benefits are available when travel is necessary to obtain covered treatment for a medical condition only when a treatment option is not available within 100 miles of your home. The plan covers services up to \$10,000 per member per calendar year.
Prior authorization	Your primary care physician may refer you to a non-contracted provider outside the KFHPWA Network. Prior authorization must be provided by your primary care physician and approved by KFHPWA. KFHPWA will generally process prior authorization requests and provide notification for benefits within the following timeframes: • Standard requests – within 5 calendar days ○ If insufficient information has been provided a request for additional information will be made within 5 calendar days. The provider or facility then will have 5 calendar days to provide the necessary information. A decision will be made within 4 calendar days of the later of (1) receipt of the requested information or (2) the deadline for receipt of the requested information. • Expedited requests – within 2 calendar days ○ If insufficient information has been provided a request for additional information will be made within 1 calendar day. The provider or facility then will have 2 calendar days to provide the necessary information. A decision will be made within 2 calendar days of the later of (1) receipt of the requested information or (2) the deadline for receipt of the requested information.
Your provider's contract with Kaiser is ending (continuity of care)	If you are receiving ongoing treatment (such as physical therapy) for certain serious and complex medical conditions or illnesses, or pregnancy, are undergoing institutional or inpatient care, or are scheduled for nonelective surgery, you may be eligible to continue to receive in-network benefits for the current course of treatment, for up to 90 days. A specific time period. During any such extension of in-network benefits, you may be required to pay any amounts over the allowable charge.
Family Health and Reproductive Support	Free virtual care and on-demand support (through Maven Clinic) for navigating family planning, parenting, perimenopause, and menopause.



Urgent care is for the sudden, unexpected onset of a medical condition that is of sufficient severity to require medical treatment within 24 hours of its onset.

Primary care physician

You and your primary care physician coordinate your care with specialists and other members of the KFHPWA care team.

You should select a primary care physician for yourself and your covered dependents when you enroll in the KFHPWA HMO Plan. You may select one physician for your entire family, or a different physician for each member. You can select or change your primary care physician by contacting Kaiser Permanente

Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636, or by visiting KFHPWA online at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/>. If your selected primary care physician is accepting patients, the change will be made within 24 hours of the request. If a primary care physician accepting new members is not available in your area, contact Kaiser Permanente Member Services, who will ensure you have access to a primary care physician by contacting a physician's office to request they accept new members.

For your personal physician, choose from these specialties:

- Family medicine
- Adult medicine/internal medicine
- Pediatrics/adolescent medicine (for children up to 18)

If you don't choose a physician when you first become a KFHPWA member, you will be matched with a physician to make sure you have one assigned to you if you get sick or injured. You can change your personal physician at any time, for any reason.

If your primary care physician no longer participates in KFHPWA's network, you can use their services for up to 60 days after you've been sent a written notice about selecting a new physician.



A **Physician** is a state licensed:

- Doctor of Medicine and Surgery (M.D.) or
- Doctor of Osteopathy (D.O.)

In addition, professional services provided by one of the following types of providers may be covered under this plan, but only when the provider is providing a service that is within the scope of their state license and for which benefits are specified in this SPD and would be payable if the service were provided by a physician as defined above:

- Chiropractor (D.C.)
- Dentist (D.D.S. or D.M.D.)
- Optometrist (O.D.)
- Podiatrist (D.P.M.)
- Psychologist (Ph.D.)
- Nurse (R.N.) licensed in Washington state
- Naturopathic physician (N.D.)



Call (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit KFHPWA online at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/> for a listing of personal physicians, referral specialists, women's health care providers, Health Care Benefit Managers and KFHPWA-designated specialists. Information available online includes each physician's location, education, credentials, and specialties.

Specialist care

Unless indicated in the table below or the [What the plan covers](#) section, you will need a prior authorization from your primary care physician before the plan will cover care from specialists. To access a KFHPWA-designated specialist, consult your KFHPWA primary care physician. For a list of KFHPWA-designated Specialists, contact Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or view the Provider Directory located at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/>.

Specialty care that doesn't require a referral	
KFHPWA designated - specialists	Preauthorization is not required for services with most specialists at Kaiser Permanente - owned or -operated medical centers. To obtain or request a complete list of these specialists, contact Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or view the Provider Directory located at https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/ .
Women's health care direct access providers	Female members may make appointments directly with specialists who are contracted by KFHPWA without a referral for the following care areas: • Medically necessary maternity care • Covered reproductive health services • Preventive care (well care) and general examinations • Gynecological care • Follow-up visits with: General and Family Practitioners, Physician's Assistants, Gynecologists, Certified Nurse Midwives, Licensed Midwives, Doctors of Osteopathy, Pediatricians, Obstetricians, or Advanced Registered Nurse Practitioners who are contracted by KFHPWA Care is covered as if your primary care physician has been consulted. However, if your provider diagnoses a condition that requires referral to other specialists or hospitalization, you must obtain prior authorization under KFHPWA requirements.

Second opinions

You can get a second opinion on a medical diagnosis or treatment plan from a KFHPWA provider by visiting a KFHPWA-designated specialist. Second opinions are covered when prior authorization is received or when obtained from a KFHPWA-designated specialist.

Prior authorization for a second opinion does not imply that KFHPWA will authorize you to return to the physician providing the second opinion for additional treatment. Your coverage is determined by your medical plan benefits. Coverage for services, drugs, devices, etc., prescribed or recommended as a result of the consultation is determined by your medical plan benefits.



The KFHPWA medical director will determine the necessity, nature, and extent of treatment to be covered in each individual case, and the judgment will be made in good faith. You may refuse any recommended services to the extent permitted by law. If you obtain care not recommended by KFHPWA, you do so with the full understanding that KFHPWA has no obligation for the cost, or liability for the outcome, of such care. Your coverage decisions may be appealed under the plan benefits.

Process for medical necessity determination

Pre-service, concurrent or post-service reviews may be conducted. Once a service has been reviewed, additional reviews may be conducted. Members will be notified in writing when a determination has been made.

First level review

First level reviews are performed or overseen by appropriate clinical staff using KFHPWA approved clinical review criteria. Data sources for the review include, but are not limited to, referral forms, admission request forms, the member's medical record, and consultation with qualified health professionals and multidisciplinary health care team members. The clinical information used in the review may include treatment summaries, problem lists, specialty evaluations, laboratory and x-ray results, and rehabilitation service documentation. The member or legal surrogate may be contacted for information. Coordination of care interventions are initiated as they are identified. The reviewer consults with the member's health care team when more clarity is needed to make an informed medical necessity decision. The reviewer may consult with a board-certified consultative specialist and such consultations will be documented in the review text. If the requested service appears to be inappropriate based on application of the review criteria, the first level reviewer requests second level review by a physician or designated health care professional.

Second level (practitioner) review

The practitioner reviews the treatment plan and discusses, when appropriate, case circumstances and management options with the attending (or referring) physician. The reviewer consults with the member's health care team when more clarity is needed to make an informed coverage decision. The reviewer may consult with board certified physicians from appropriate specialty areas to assist in making determinations of coverage and/or appropriateness. All such consultations will be documented in the review text. If the reviewer determines that the admission, continued stay or service requested is not a covered service, a notice of non-coverage is issued. Only a physician, behavioral health practitioner (such as a psychiatrist, doctoral-level clinical psychologist, certified addiction medicine specialist), dentist or pharmacist who has the clinical expertise appropriate to the request under review with an unrestricted license may deny coverage based on medical necessity.

Filling a prescription

Depending on your needs, you may fill up to a 30-day supply of your prescription at a KFHPWA-designated pharmacy or up to a 90-day supply from KFHPWA-designated mail order service. Review the [prescription drugs](#) benefit for more information on what is covered.

What you pay

When you receive care for the treatment of illnesses, injuries, and chronic conditions, you pay a portion of the cost, up to an annual out-of-pocket maximum. For most services such as office visits, outpatient surgery, and prescriptions, you pay a flat copayment at the time you receive care, and the plan pays the remainder of the cost. If you have an inpatient hospital stay, the plan pays 90% of the cost and you are

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

responsible for 10% up to an annual out-of-pocket maximum. When it comes to preventive care, the plan covers 100% when you use network providers.

What you pay		
Copayments	+	Coinsurance
For office visits, outpatient surgery, and prescriptions, you pay a flat dollar copayment at the time you receive care, and the plan pays the remainder of the charges.		If you have an inpatient hospital stay, you pay 10% of the cost, called coinsurance, and the plan pays the rest.
	=	Out-of-pocket maximum
		If you reach your annual out-of-pocket maximum, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses from that point forward. The out-of-pocket maximum is \$1,500 per person, up to a \$4,500 maximum for three or more covered family members.



Copayment is a fixed, up-front dollar amount that you're required to pay for certain covered services.

Coinsurance is the percentage amount that you are required to pay for certain covered services.

Out-of-pocket maximum is the most you could pay each plan year for covered services and supplies.

Medical care copayments

Type of visit	Copayment	Coinsurance
Primary Care Physician	\$20	None
Specialist	\$40	None
Emergency (waived if admitted)	\$75	None
Hospital – outpatient	\$100	None
Hospital – inpatient	None	10%

Prescription drug copayments

Type of prescription (30-day supply)	KFHPWA pharmacy copayment	KFHPWA mail order copayment
Value-based	\$0	\$0
Preferred generic	\$10	\$5
Preferred brand	\$25	\$20
Non-preferred generic and brand	\$50 (\$35 maximum for insulin)	\$45 (\$35 maximum for insulin)

(when prescribed by KFHPWA provider)



Value-based drugs are drugs for chronic disease management such as diabetes, hyperlipidemia, heart failure and hypertension that are considered high value and are covered on a lower cost share tier.

Preferred generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but are available at a lower cost because the patent has expired.

Preferred brand-name drugs are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

The **Preferred drug list** is the list of brand-name prescription drugs that are covered under the KFHPWA HMO Plan.



Call (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit [.KFHPWA](#) online to review the Preferred drug list.

Out-of-pocket maximum

The annual out-of-pocket maximum is capped at \$1,500 for each covered member—this means that once a member reaches his/her out-of-pocket maximum through copayments and coinsurance, the plan pays 100% for the rest of the year for that individual. Also, if you have three or more covered family members, the most you'll pay for the year is \$4,500. Member payments for the Weight Management program do not count toward the out-of-pocket limit. All cost shares for covered services apply to the out-of-pocket maximum.

Utilization Management

All benefits under this plan are limited to covered services that are medically necessary and as set forth under Plan Benefits. KFHPWA may review a member's medical records for the purpose of verifying delivery and coverage of services and items. Based on a prospective, concurrent or retrospective review, KFHPWA may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not medically necessary or do not meet all criteria specific in this SPD. Such determination shall be based on established clinical criteria.

KFHPWA will not deny coverage retroactively for services it has previously authorized and that have already been provided to the member except in the case of an intentional misrepresentation of a material fact by the patient, member, or provider of services, or if coverage was obtained based on inaccurate, false, or misleading information provided on the enrollment application, or for nonpayment of premiums.

What the plan covers

The table below summarizes the benefits of the KFHPWA HMO Plan at Kaiser Permanente facilities. You can refer to the details following this table for more information about benefit limits and cost sharing.

The KFHPWA HMO Plan provides benefits for routine patient costs of qualified individuals in approved clinical trials to the extent benefits for these costs are required by law. Routine patient costs include all

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

items and services consistent with the coverage provided in the plan that is typically covered for a qualified individual who is not enrolled in a clinical trial. Clinical trials require prior authorization.



Services and supplies must be medically necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#). You have the right to participate in decisions regarding your health care and you may refuse any recommended treatment or diagnostic plan to the extent permitted by law. If you obtain care not recommended by KFHPWA, you do so with the full understanding that KFHPWA has no obligation for the cost, or liability for the outcome, of such care. Your coverage decisions may be appealed under the plan Benefits.



CTRL+Click on the benefits below to access more information.

Common benefits

These are the most commonly used benefits in the KFHPWA HMO Plan.

Benefit	Coverage
Preventive care Including well-baby care, well-child care, routine gynecological exams, immunizations, female sterilization, FDA-approved contraceptive drugs, devices, including device removal, and counseling, preferred contraceptive drugs as recommended by the USPSTF when obtained with a prescription, and annual routine physical exams (see the Preventive Care List and the Kaiser Drug Formulary .)	100%; includes well-baby care, child and adult routine exams, and maintenance medications
Prescription drugs	No copayment preventive; \$10 copayment preferred generic; \$25 copayment preferred brand; \$50 copayment non-preferred. (\$35 maximum for insulin)
Primary care office visit	\$20 copayment
Specialist office visit	\$40 copayment
Hospital care—inpatient Including semi-private room and board, anesthesia, supporting services, testing, supplies, and intensive or coronary care	90%
Hospital care—outpatient Including minor surgery, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia, and pre-admission testing	\$100 copayment

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Common benefits	
These are the most commonly used benefits in the KFHPWA HMO Plan.	
Benefit	Coverage
Urgent care	\$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists
Rehabilitation and Habilitative Care – Physical, Occupational, Speech and Massage Therapies	Inpatient: 90%; up to 60 days combined per calendar year; Limited to a combined total of 60 inpatient days and 60 outpatient visits per calendar year for all Rehabilitation and Habilitative Care services Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists; Limited to a combined total of 60 inpatient days and 60 outpatient visits per calendar year for all Rehabilitation and Habilitative Care services
Maternity and pregnancy care	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: 100% for routine prenatal and postpartum visits; \$20 copayment for other visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment visits with specialists
Family Health and Reproductive Support	Free virtual care and on-demand support (through Maven Clinic) for navigating family planning, parenting, perimenopause, and menopause.
Mental health and wellness counseling, mental health and wellness inpatient and outpatient services, and substance use disorder	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient services through Spring Health employee assistance program administrator : 100% of 24 sessions per issue per calendar year. Outpatient services under the KFHPWA HMO Plan: \$20 copayment.

Other benefits	
The KFHPWA HMO Plan also covers these additional benefits.	
Benefit	Coverage
Acupuncture	\$20 copayment; up to a maximum of eight visits per member per medical diagnosis per calendar year without prior authorization; additional visits are covered with prior authorization No visit limit for treatment for substance use disorder
Ambulance	90%
Detoxification services for alcoholism and drug abuse	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: \$75 copayment per visit to any emergency facility (copayment waived if admitted)
Devices, equipment, and supplies	90%

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Other benefits	
The KFHPWA HMO Plan also covers these additional benefits.	
Benefit	Coverage
Diabetic needs and supplies	100% for insulin, needles, syringes, test strips and lancets covered under the prescription drug benefit 90% for external insulin pumps, blood glucose monitors, and related supplies under the devices, equipment, and supplies benefit 100% for diabetic retinal screening
Dialysis (home and outpatient)	Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care
Emergency care	\$75 copayment per visit to any emergency facility (copayment waived if admitted)
Hearing care and hardware	\$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists Hardware: 90%; \$10,000 hardware limit per member in a period of 36 consecutive (rolling) months
Home health care	100%
Hospice care	100%
Infusion therapy	Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists 100% for associated infused medications
Laboratory and radiology	100%
Manipulative therapy	\$20 copayment; up to a maximum of twenty visits per member per calendar year
Naturopathy	\$20 copayment; up to a maximum of three visits per member per medical diagnosis per calendar year without prior authorization. Additional visits are covered with prior authorization.
Neurodevelopmental therapy	Inpatient: 90%; up to 60 days per calendar year Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists; up to 60 visits per calendar year
Nutritional services	90%
Obesity-related surgery	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists
Out-of-area benefit	Prescription drugs and medical services obtained outside the KFHPWA service area are covered up to \$2,000 per member per calendar year
Skilled nursing facility	90%; up to 60 days per member per calendar year at a skilled nursing facility

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

Other benefits	
The KFHPWA HMO Plan also covers these additional benefits.	
Benefit	Coverage
Substance use disorder	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care
Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists
Tobacco cessation	100%
Transplants	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient: \$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists

Specialized benefits	
Microsoft provides these unique benefits to you through the KFHPWA HMO Plan.	
Benefit	Coverage
Autism/Applied behavior analysis (ABA) therapy	90%
Infertility	90% for coverage, within the Plan's infertility vendor (Progyny) provider network, of generally two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy; see Fertility and Family Building for more information
Gender affirming services	\$20 copayment for visits with primary care providers; \$40 copayment for visits with specialists; \$100 copay for outpatient hospital care
Travel and lodging reimbursement	In-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations) Limit: \$10,000 per calendar year
Weight management program	80% up to \$6,000 maximum for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera or KFHPWA health plan options.

Plan benefits



The following pages provide details on the plan's benefits. The plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), including the requirement of medical necessity, apply to these benefits.

Acupuncture

\$20 copayment; up to eight visits per member per diagnosis per calendar year without prior authorization.

Additional visits are covered when prior authorized. Members may make appointments without prior authorization with KFHPWA-contracted providers. Visit limit does not apply for treatment for substance user disorder.

Related laboratory and radiology services are covered only when obtained through a Kaiser Permanente facility under the [laboratory and radiology](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for acupuncture

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Herbal supplements
- Services not within the scope of the practitioner's licensure

Ambulance

Surface Ambulance (ground or water) - Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Air Ambulance: Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Coverage includes licensed surface (ground or water) and air ambulance transportation to the nearest medical facility equipped to treat the member's condition when any other mode of transportation would endanger the member's health or safety. This benefit is limited to the member that requires transportation.

Emergency ambulance services is covered only when:

- Transport is to any facility that can treat your condition
- Any other type of transport would put your health or safety at risk
- The service is from a licensed ambulance.

Emergency air or sea medical transportation is covered only when:

- The above requirements for ambulance service are met, and
- Geographic restraints prevent ground Emergency transportation to the nearest facility that can treat your condition, or ground Emergency transportation would put your health or safety at risk.

Benefits are also provided at 100% for transportation from hospital-to-hospital, as medically necessary for the member's care when approved by KFHPWA.

For ambulance services, please see [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) for special rules that apply to out-of-network air ambulance services.

Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy

Plan pays 90%

This benefit covers behavioral interventions based on the principles of Applied Behavioral Analysis (ABA) through eligible providers.

Who is eligible

This benefit will be available to members covered by KFHPWA, whose primary diagnosis is the following (*Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, 5th Edition / DSM-5*), or with any of the following Pervasive Developmental Disorders (*International Classification of Diseases, 10th Revision, Clinical Modification / ICD-10-CM*):

- Autistic Disorder
- Childhood Disintegrative Disorder
- Asperger's Disorder
- Rett's Disorder and Pervasive Development Disorder Not Otherwise Specified/Atypical Autism
- Pervasive Developmental Disorder



If you need assistance confirming the diagnosis your doctor provides is an eligible diagnosis for the Autism/Applied Behavioral Analysis benefit you may contact Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636.

Eligible providers

The benefit covers services through providers who have met established qualifications for certification (known as certified providers) and who perform services in consultation with a certified provider (known as therapy assistants).



Call (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit [KFHPWA](#) online for a list of approved Certified Autism Providers (not including Therapy Assistants) eligible for reimbursement under this benefit, to receive a copy of the certification criteria, or for an application for providers not currently on the list.

For the purpose of this benefit only, services of a certified provider will be covered even if the provider does not meet the plan's requirements as an eligible provider under the [rehabilitative services](#) or [mental health and wellness](#) benefit.

Covered services

Services must be ordered by the member's treating physician to be covered. An approved certified provider acts as the program manager for the member. Benefits are available for time used to evaluate the member and document findings and progress reports, and to create and update treatment plans; and time used to train and evaluate the work of the therapy assistants working directly with the member to implement the treatment plan. Therapy Assistant services that are provided by a Program Manager will be paid at the Therapy Assistant rate.

In most cases, therapy assistants will provide the implementation portion of the treatment plan. Therapy assistant time is eligible for face-to-face time with the member to perform the tasks described in the treatment plan and to document outcomes; and time to meet with the program manager for training and to discuss treatment plan issues. Therapy Assistant services that are provided by a Program Manager will be paid at the Therapy Assistant rate.

Claims for ABA services should clearly list the level of service (certified provider/program manager; or therapy assistant), the date the service was provided, the time the service started and ended, the hourly charge for the service, and the total charge for that service.

ABA services are not covered for the following:

- Babysitting or doing household chores
- Time spent under the care of any other professional
- Travel time
- Home schooling in academics or other academic tutoring

Benefit coverage above the allowable charge

If you obtain services from a non-KFHPWA provider or at a non-KFHPWA facility that nevertheless are covered under this SPD, you may be billed for charges assessed above the allowable charge. Any amounts you pay for charges in excess of allowable charges will not count towards satisfying any deductible requirements, or out-of-pocket maximums that may apply to other benefits provided through this plan.



An **allowable charge** where expenses incurred from a non-KFHPWA provider or facility are covered under this SPD is the negotiated amount that KFHPWA providers and facilities have agreed to accept as payment in full for those same services. Members shall be responsible for paying any difference between the non-KFHPWA provider's or facility's charge for the services and the allowable charge.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is recommended to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact KFHPWA for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by KFHPWA that the service is medically necessary, and that the members plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination is offered in certain situations where medical records must be provided to establish medical necessity

before the plan will pay for the service. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. KFHPWA and Microsoft reserve the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

For ABA/Autism benefits, the prior authorization requires the following documents:

- The treating physician's order for ABA services
- The clinical documentation of the qualifying diagnosis
- The Plan of Treatment created by the approved Program Manager

KFHPWA will issue a prior authorization that will provide services for a six-month period of time. The prior authorization process and subsequent clinical review includes the following steps:

The following is the process for a prior authorization for the autism/ABA therapy benefit and subsequent clinical review:

1. The treating physician or specialist diagnoses the member with an Autism Spectrum Disorder (Autistic Disorder, Childhood Disintegrative Disorder, Rett's Disorder, Pervasive Developmental Disorder Not Otherwise Specified, and Asperger's Disorder) and refers the child for ABA treatment.
2. An initial evaluation is performed by the approved certified provider to determine if the member is a candidate for an ABA and/or related structured behavioral program. If the member is determined to be a candidate by the evaluating approved certified provider, the approved certified provider would create and submit a treatment plan including type and frequency of services planned for the immediate six-month period. The approved certified provider must send the treatment plan to KFHPWA so that eligibility for services can be determined.
3. Every six months, the approved certified provider who is overseeing the treatment must submit an updated treatment plan to KFHPWA. The approved certified provider must determine that the treatment plan and services being provided are in accordance with ABA guidelines. If any substantial change in the frequency or type of program is necessary during the six-month treatment time, a revised Treatment Plan should be submitted to KFHPWA for notification of the revision of the treatment plan.
4. Progress reports should be created at least monthly by the certified provider to include documentation of the therapy assistant interventions and/or their own interventions with the member and a written summary of the member's progress. If the member has not made progress in the last six months, the updated treatment plan should reflect a change in approach. Progress reports should be available to KFHPWA upon request.

Services for this treatment that do not meet criteria described in the program are subject to retrospective denial of benefits. Claims for these services must be accompanied by a completed Autism/ABA Therapy Services Billing Summary signed by the certified provider and the child's parent if therapy is for a minor dependent.

Additional exclusions and limitations for autism/ABA therapy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- This benefit is not provided for rehabilitative services (which apply under the [rehabilitation services](#) benefit) or mental health services (which apply under the Mental health counseling, [mental health and wellness inpatient and outpatient services](#), and [substance use disorder](#) benefit).
- Benefits for services provided by volunteers, childcare providers, or family members, and benefits paid for by state, local, and Federal agencies will not be covered. Volunteer services or services provided by a family member of the child receiving the services by or through a school, books, and other training aids will also not be covered.
- Other unspecified developmental disorders or delays, or any other delay or disorder in a member's motor, speech, cognitive, or social development are not covered under this benefit
- This benefit covers only the allowable fees for eligible services performed by the approved certified provider and those providing interventions based on principles of ABA and/or related structured behavioral programs under the supervision of the approved certified provider. Other expenses associated with providing the treatment, such as the tuition, program fees, travel, meals, and lodging of the approved certified provider and expenses of those working under the approved certified provider's supervision, the member, and their family members will not be covered.

Circumcision

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Devices, equipment, and supplies (Durable Medical Supplies)

Plan pays 90%

The following services are covered:

- **Orthopedic Appliances:** Orthopedic appliances that are attached to an impaired body segment for the purpose of protecting the segment or assisting in restoration/improvement of its function. Excluded appliances include over-the-counter arch supports, and orthopedic shoes that are not attached to an appliance. Therapeutic shoes, modifications, and shoe inserts for severe diabetic foot disease are not excluded.
- **Durable Medical Equipment:** Equipment which can withstand repeated use, is primarily and customarily used to serve a medical purpose, is useful only in the presence of an illness or injury and is used in the member's home. Durable medical equipment includes: hospital beds, wheelchairs, walkers, crutches, canes, glucose monitors, external insulin pumps, oxygen and oxygen equipment.
- **Hearing care:** Programs or treatments for hearing loss or hearing care associated with externally worn hearing or surgically implanted hearing aids and the surgery and services necessary to implant them except as described above; hearing screening tests required under Preventive Services; replacement costs of hearing aids due to loss, breakage or theft, unless at the time of such replacement the Member is eligible under the benefit Allowance; replacement batteries.

- Prosthetic Devices: Prosthetic devices are items that replace all or part of an external body part, or function thereof
- Ostomy Supplies: Ostomy supplies for the removal of bodily secretions or waste through an artificial opening
- Post-mastectomy bras/forms: Post-mastectomy bras are limited to two every six months (replacements within this 6-month period are covered when medically necessary due to a change in the member's condition)
- Sales tax for devices, equipment, and supplies
- Custom arch supports and shoe inserts
- Wigs (up to \$2,000 per calendar year for alopecia caused by medical conditions or treatment for diseases)

Prior authorization is required for devices, equipment and supplies including repair, adjustment, or replacement of appliances and equipment.

Additional exclusions and limitations for devices, equipment, and supplies

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Take-home dressings and supplies following hospitalization
- Other supplies, dressings, appliances and devices not specifically listed as covered above
- Replacement or repair of appliances, devices, and supplies due to loss, theft, breakage from willful damage, neglect, wrongful use, or personal preference
- Structural modifications to a member's home or personal vehicle

 *KFHPWA will determine if equipment is made available on a rental or purchase basis.*

Detoxification services for alcoholism and drug abuse

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$75 copayment for emergency facility (waived if admitted)

Benefits are provided for withdrawal of alcohol and/or drugs from a member for whom consequences of abstinence are so severe that they require medical or nursing assistance in a hospital setting, which is needed immediately to prevent serious impairment to the member's health. Chemical withdrawal (detoxification) is provided without prior authorization.

The member must notify KFHPWA via the notification line at (888) 457-9516 within 24 hours following inpatient admission, or as soon as medically possible. If a member is hospitalized in a non-Kaiser Permanente facility or program, KFHPWA reserves the right to require transfer of the member to a Kaiser Permanente facility or program upon consultation between a KFHPWA provider and the attending physician. If the member refuses transfer to a Kaiser Permanente facility or program, all further costs incurred during the hospitalization are the responsibility of the member.

Diabetic needs and supplies

100% for insulin, needles, syringes, test strips and lancets covered under the [prescription drug](#) benefit.

90% for external insulin pumps, blood glucose monitors, and related supplies covered under the [devices, equipment, and supplies](#) benefit.

100% for diabetic retinal screening.

Dialysis (Home and Outpatient)

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Dialysis in an outpatient or home setting is covered for members with acute kidney failure or end-stage renal disease (ESRD)

Dialysis requires prior authorization

Emergency care

Kaiser Permanente Facility: \$75 copayment (waived if admitted)

Non-Kaiser Permanente Facility: 90% of allowable charges



An **allowable charge** is the negotiated amount that KFHPWA providers have agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. Out-of-network providers may not accept the allowable charge as payment in full. You are responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

At non-Kaiser Permanente facilities, the plan covers the allowable charge provided you:

- Pay the emergency services copayment
- Notify KFHPWA at (888) 457-9516 within 24 hours following inpatient admission, or as soon as medically possible

Emergency services include professional services, treatment and supplies, facility costs, outpatient charges for patient observation and medical screening exams required to stabilize a patient.

If the member is admitted to an inpatient facility directly from the emergency room, the emergency services copayment is waived. Inpatient hospital care will be covered at 90%. See the hospital care benefit for more information.

If a member is hospitalized in a non-Kaiser Permanente facility, KFHPWA reserves the right to require transfer of the member to a Kaiser Permanente facility, upon consultation between a KFHPWA provider and the attending physician. If the member refuses to transfer to a Kaiser Permanente facility, all further costs incurred during the hospitalization are the responsibility of the member.

Care that is a direct result of the emergency must be obtained from KFHPWA providers, unless a KFHPWA provider has previously authorized such follow-up care from a non-KFHPWA provider.

Please see the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.



Urgent care received at any hospital emergency department is not covered unless prior authorization is received by a KFHPWA provider. See the [urgent care](#) benefit for more information.

Gender health services

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

This benefit covers medically necessary gender reassignment surgical services, including facility and anesthesia charges related to the surgery.

Coverage of prescription drugs and mental health and wellness treatment associated with gender reassignment surgery is available under the prescription drugs and mental health and wellness benefits.

Who is eligible?

Surgical gender reassignment services will be considered medically necessary if all the following criteria are met:

- For all surgical procedures recognized as medically necessary in the most current Standards of Care published by the World Professional Association for Transgender Health (WPATH), other than genital and breast surgery, if you are at least 18 years old and diagnosed as having gender identity disorder
- You have been an active member in a recognized gender identity treatment program and have successfully lived and worked within the desired gender role full time for at least 12 months.
- For breast/chest surgery, have one letter of recommendation for surgery from a mental health professional
- For genital surgery, you have received recommendations for surgery from two separate mental health professionals, at least one of which includes an extensive report. One Master's degree-level professional is acceptable if the second letter is from a psychiatrist or PhD clinical psychologist.

Growth hormone

90% under the [prescription drugs](#) benefit

This benefit covers growth hormones for treatment of growth disorders.

Hearing care and hardware

Hearing care

Hospital – Inpatient: Member pays 10% plan coinsurance

Hospital – Outpatient: Member pays \$100 copayment

Outpatient Services: Member pays \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialty care provider services

Hearing exams for hearing loss and evaluation and diagnostic testing for cochlear implants are covered only when provided at KFHPWA-approved facilities.

Cochlear implants or Bone Anchored Hearing Aids (BAHA) when in accordance with KFHPWA clinical criteria.

Covered services for initial cochlear implants and BAHS include diagnostic testing, pre-implant testing, implant surgery, post-implant follow-up, speech therapy, programming, and associated supplies (such as transmitter cable, and batteries).

Hearing hardware

Plan pays 90% up to a maximum benefit of \$10,000 per member in a period of three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment.

After Allowance: Not covered; Member pays 100% of all charges

One hearing aid or a single pair of hearing aids (either prescription or over the counter) including hearing aid examinations.

Benefits cover the following:

- *Ear mold(s)*
- *Repairs, servicing, and alteration of prescription hearing aid equipment.*

Home health care

Plan pays 100% with no visit limit

Home health care services are covered when services are received from KFHPWA providers for members who meet the following criteria:

- Except for patients receiving palliative care services, the member must be unable to leave home due to their health problem or illness (unwillingness to travel and/or arrangements for transportation do not constitute inability to leave the home).
- The member requires intermittent skilled home health care services.
- A KFHPWA provider has determined that such services are medically necessary and are most appropriately rendered in the member's home.

Covered services for home health care include the following services on an intermittent basis:

- Nursing care
- Restorative physical therapy
- Restorative occupational therapy, restorative respiratory therapy
- Restorative speech therapy
- Durable medical equipment
- Medical social worker
- Limited home health aide services

Home health care services require prior authorization,

Additional exclusions and limitations for home health care

In addition to the plan's exclusions and limitations, the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Private duty nursing
- Housekeeping or meal services
- Any care provided by or for a member of the member's family
- Any other services rendered in the home that do not meet the definition of skilled home health care (such as custodial care) or are not specifically listed as covered under this plan

Hospice care

Plan pays 100%; up to five consecutive days per occurrence

- Hospice care is covered when provided by a licensed hospice care program. This program uses an interdisciplinary team of personnel to provide comfort and supportive services to a member and any family members who are caring for the member, who is experiencing a life-threatening disease with a limited prognosis. These services include acute, respite and home care to meet the physical, psychosocial and special needs of the member and their family during the final stages of illness. In order to qualify for hospice care, the member's provider must certify that the member is terminally ill and is eligible for hospice services.



Hospice care means a coordinated program of home and inpatient care, available 24 hours a day.

Respite care means continuing to provide care in the temporary absence of the member's primary caregiver or caregivers.

Inpatient hospice services

Short-term care for inpatient hospice services shall be covered when preauthorized. Respite care is covered for a maximum of five consecutive days per 3-month period of hospice.

Other covered hospice services, when billed by a licensed hospice program, include:

- Inpatient and outpatient services and supplies for injury and illness
- Semi-private room and board, except when a private room is determined to be necessary
- Durable medical equipment when billed by a licensed hospice care program

Hospice care requires prior authorization.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospice care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Private duty nursing
- Financial or legal counseling services
- Meal services
- Any services provided by family members

Hospital care

Inpatient: Plan pays 90% for inpatient medical and surgical services

Outpatient: \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital surgery including ambulatory surgical centers

Inpatient services

Inpatient services include:

- Room and board (including private room when prescribed) and general nursing services
- Hospital services (including use of operating room, anesthesia, oxygen, X-ray, laboratory, and radiotherapy services)
- Drugs and medications administered during confinement
- Medical implants
- Withdrawal management services

Alternative care arrangements may be covered as a cost-effective alternative instead of otherwise covered medically necessary hospitalization or other institutional care with the consent of the member and recommendation from the attending physician or licensed health care provider. Alternative care arrangements must be determined to be appropriate and medically necessary based upon the member's medical condition. Such care is covered to the same extent the replaced hospital care is covered. Alternative care arrangements also require prior authorization.

Members are required to notify KFHPWA by way of the notification line at (888) 457-9516 within 24 hours following any admission, or as soon as medically possible, upon receiving any of the following non-scheduled services:

- Withdrawal management services
- Emergency psychiatric services
- Labor and delivery
- Inpatient admissions needed for treatment of urgent conditions that cannot reasonably be delayed until prior authorization can be obtained

Non-emergency inpatient hospital services require prior authorization, which will be initiated with KFHPWA by your provider.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospital care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the dressings and supplies following hospitalization are excluded from this benefit, as are internally implanted insulin pumps, artificial larynx and any other implantable device that has not been approved by KFHPWA's medical director.

Continuation of Inpatient Services

A Member who is receiving covered services in a hospital on the date of termination of coverage shall continue to be eligible for covered services while an inpatient for the condition for which the Member was hospitalized, until one of the following events occurs:

- According to KFHPWA clinical criteria, it is no longer Medically Necessary for the Member to be an inpatient at the facility.
- The remaining benefits available for the hospitalization are exhausted, regardless of whether a new calendar year begins.
- The Member becomes covered under another plan with a group health plan that provides benefits for the hospitalization.
- The Member becomes enrolled under a plan with another carrier that provides benefits for the hospitalization.

Please see the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency and non-emergent services provided by an out-of-network provider.



Call the notification line at (888) 457-9516 within 24 hours of any admission or nonscheduled services.

Fertility

In-network: 90%, within the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network

Out-of-network: not applicable

Limit: Up to two Smart Cycles per household and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy. Coverage is subject to all applicable plan copay and coinsurance requirements.

This benefit covers services to assist in achieving a pregnancy for Microsoft employees and their enrolled spouse/domestic partner regardless of reason or origin of condition.

Members must contact their Progyny Patient Care Advocate at (888) 203-5066 to confirm eligibility and utilize a Progyny Network Provider to access the benefit.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit may be used to receive full coverage for the following treatments and procedures:

- Two consultations per calendar year
- Diagnostic testing
- Transvaginal ultrasounds
- Intrauterine insemination (also known as artificial insemination)

- In vitro fertilization (IVF)
- Gamete intra-fallopian transplant (GIFT)
- Intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI)
- Pre-implantation genetic screening (PGS)
- Pre-implantation genetic diagnosis (PGD)
- Embryo assessment and transfer
- Services used to preserve fertility such as cryopreservation of eggs, sperm and/or embryos. This includes oncofertility preservation.
- Up to four years of storage (egg, embryo, sperm) with annual renewal and eligibility verification
- Purchase of donor tissue (sperm, eggs) as follows:
 - Previously frozen donor sperm or donor oocytes (eggs) from a donor agency intended for the use and transfer into a covered female member (one egg cohort purchase constitutes one SMART Cycle, and one donor sperm purchase constitutes ¼ SMART Cycle). You will be required to pay for the donor sperm or oocytes out of pocket and submit the eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.
 - A fresh donor recipient cycle, whereby the egg donor undergoes an egg retrieval procedure at an in-network Progyny provider to allow for a fresh embryo transfer into a covered female member (one fresh donor recipient cycle constitutes one SMART Cycle). The treatment must occur at an in-network Progyny provider, or else you may be required to pay all expenses up front, out of pocket. If an in-network provider is not contracted for the fresh donor recipient cycle, Progyny will pursue a special case agreement. If a special case agreement request is denied, you will pay for the donor services out of pocket but may submit eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.

Medication prescribed for fertility treatment will be fulfilled by a Progyny Rx specialty pharmacy and delivered next day to ensure accurate timing with treatment. All medications, compounds, ancillary medication and equipment required for treatment are included in the shipment of medications. Progyny Rx coverage also includes the UnPack It Call where a trained pharmacy clinician will explain drug administration and storage guidelines.

Additional exclusions and limitations for infertility

The following exclusions apply to this benefit:

- Fees paid to donors for their participation in any service
- Testing and treatment for potential surrogates that would not otherwise be covered for a member enrolled in the Plan
- Home ovulation prediction kits
- Services and supplies furnished for a dependent child (under age 26) except for oncofertility preservation due to cancer or medical treatments
- Services and supplies furnished by a provider outside the Progyny network, except as otherwise provided
- Fertility Services following a voluntary sterilization procedure
- This benefit is only available to KFHPWA members, not visiting members.

Infusion therapy

\$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

This benefit covers medically necessary infusion therapy such as antibiotics, hydration, chemotherapy and pain management.

Plan pays 100% for associated infused medications.

Laboratory and radiology

Plan pays 100%

This benefit covers nuclear medicine, radiology, ultrasound and laboratory tests, including high end radiology imaging services such as CAT scan, MRI and PET which are subject to prior authorization except when associated with Emergency services or inpatient.

Services received as part of an emergency visit are covered as Emergency Services.

Preventive laboratory and radiology services are covered in accordance with the well care schedule established by KFHPWA and the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act of 2010. The well care schedule is available in Kaiser Permanente medical centers, at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org>, or upon request from Member Services.

Manipulative (chiropractic) therapy

\$20 copayment; up to twenty visits per member per calendar year

This benefit covers visits for manipulative therapy of the spine and extremities when KFHPWA clinical criteria are met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for manipulative therapy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Supportive care primarily to maintain the level of correction already achieved
- Care primarily for the convenience of the member
- Care on a non-acute, asymptomatic basis
- Charges for any other services that do not meet KFHPWA's clinical criteria as medically necessary

Maternity and pregnancy care

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: Plan pays 100% for routine prenatal and postpartum visits; \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists for non-routine maternity care, including care for complications or termination of pregnancy.

Coverage includes complications of pregnancy, in-utero treatment for the fetus, prenatal testing for the detection of congenital and heritable disorders when medically necessary and prenatal and postpartum care for all female members including dependent daughters. Preventive services related to preconception, prenatal and postpartum care are covered as Preventive Services when medically necessary, as determined by KFHPWA's medical director and in accordance with Board of Health standards for screening and diagnostic tests during pregnancy. Home births are considered outpatient services. Childbirth classes are covered at 100%. As described in the preventive care section, breastfeeding support, supplies, and counseling are covered at 100%.

The member's physician, in consultation with the member, will determine the member's length of inpatient stay following delivery. Treatment for post-partum depression or psychosis is covered only under the [mental health and wellness](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for maternity and pregnancy care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Birthing tubs
- Genetic testing of non-members
- Fetal ultrasound in the absence of medical indications

Mental health and wellness

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: 100%, up to calendar year short-term counseling session limits through Spring Health, administrator for the employee assistance program, otherwise \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists



To access Spring Health, go to [Microsoft.springhealth.com](https://microsoft.springhealth.com) to access these benefits. For counseling outside of Spring Health through Kaiser, you must contact the KFHPWA Behavioral Health Unit at (888) 287-2680 or (206) 630-1680.

Inpatient care

Benefits include coverage for acute treatment and stabilization of psychiatric emergencies, residential treatment, and partial hospitalization programs in KFHPWA-approved hospitals. Coverage for services incurred at non-Kaiser Permanente facilities exclude any charges that would otherwise be excluded for hospitalization within a Kaiser Permanente facility. Substance use disorder services are covered subject to the [substance use disorder](#) services benefit. Preauthorization is required for Residential Treatment and non-Emergency inpatient hospital services provided in out-of-state facilities.

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

Services provided under involuntary commitment statutes must be provided at facilities approved by KFHPWA. Services for any involuntary court-ordered treatment program can be covered only if determined to be medically necessary by KFHPWA's medical director.

Coverage for voluntary or involuntary emergency inpatient psychiatric services is subject to the emergency care benefit under [emergency services](#) section, including the 24-hour notification and transfer provisions.

Outpatient care

This benefit covers outpatient care, although not required, you may wish to exhaust the [short-term counseling under Spring Health \(employee assistance program\)](#) before obtaining services from Kaiser under this benefit, because Microsoft pays the entire cost of EAP benefits.

Type of outpatient care	You will be covered as follows
Short-term counseling employee assistance program (EAP) as administered by Spring Health	Outpatient services through Spring Health employee assistance program: 100% of 24 short-term counseling sessions per calendar year. A visit includes each attendance of the provider to the member, regardless of the type of professional services rendered, and whether it might otherwise be termed consultation, treatment, or described in some other manner. For benefit calculation purposes, a typical mental health visit is considered one hour.
KFHPWA	Inpatient: 90% Outpatient services under the KFHPWA HMO Plan: \$20 copayment

Mental health and wellness services provide the most clinically appropriate and medically necessary level of mental health care intervention as determined by KFHPWA's medical director. Treatment may use psychiatric, psychological, and/or psychotherapy services to achieve these objectives.

Services rendered to treat mental health conditions are covered. Mental health conditions mean those conditions covered in the most recent edition of the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders published by the American Psychiatric Association, except as otherwise excluded. Mental health and wellness services mean medically necessary outpatient services, residential treatment, partial hospitalization program, and inpatient services provided by a licensed facility or licensed providers, except as otherwise excluded.

Mental health and wellness services including medical management and prescriptions are covered the same as for any other condition. Prescriptions are covered under the [prescription drugs](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for mental health and wellness

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Covered services are limited to those services authorized by KFHPWA's medical director for covered clinical conditions for which the reduction or removal of acute clinical symptoms or stabilization can be expected, given the most clinically appropriate level of mental health care intervention
- Academic or career counseling and personal growth or relationship enhancement
- Assessment and treatment services that are primarily vocational and academic

- Court-ordered or forensic treatment not considered medically necessary, including reports and summaries
- Work- or school-ordered assessment and treatment not considered medically necessary
- Counseling for overeating not considered medically necessary
- Specialty treatment programs such as "behavior modification programs" not considered medically necessary
- Relationship counseling or phase-of-life problems (V-code only diagnoses)
- Custodial care not considered medically necessary
- Experimental or investigational therapies.
- Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools.
- All other provisions, exclusions, and limitations under this plan also apply

Naturopathy

\$20 copayment; up to three visits per member per medical diagnosis per calendar year without prior authorization

Additional visits are covered with prior authorization. Related laboratory and radiology services are covered only when obtained through a Kaiser Permanente facility under the [laboratory and radiology](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for naturopathy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), herbal supplements, nutritional supplements, and any services not within the scope of the practitioner's licensure are excluded from this benefit.

Neurodevelopmental therapy

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

Limit: up to 60 days/visits per calendar year (combined with the [rehabilitation benefit](#))

Covered services include: physical therapy, occupational therapy, and speech therapy services for the restoration and improvement of function for neurodevelopmentally disabled members. Coverage also includes maintenance of a covered member in cases where significant deterioration in the member's condition would result without the services.

Additional exclusions and limitations for neurodevelopmental therapy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- All services must be provided at a Kaiser Permanente facility or a KFHPWA-approved rehabilitation facility and outpatient services require a prescription or order from a physician that reflects a written plan of care to restore function, and must be provided by a rehabilitation team that includes a physician, nurse, physical therapist, occupational therapist, massage therapist, or speech therapist
- Services are limited to those necessary to restore or improve functional abilities when physical, sensori-perceptual and/or communication impairment exists due to injury, illness, or surgery

- Specialty treatment programs
- Inpatient residential treatment services
- Specialty rehabilitation programs including “behavior modification programs”
- Therapy for degenerative or static conditions when the expected outcome is primarily to maintain the member’s level of functioning (except as set forth in this section for treatment of neurodevelopmental conditions)
- Recreational life-enhancing relaxation or palliative therapy
- Implementation of home maintenance programs
- Any services not specifically included as covered in this section
- Any services that are excluded by the plan

Nutritional services

Plan pays 90%

Covered services include parenteral nutritional therapy, enteral therapy when Medical Necessity criteria are met and when given through a PEG, J tube or orally, or for an eosinophilic gastrointestinal disorder, and dietary formula for the treatment of phenylketonuria. Necessary equipment and supplies covered under the [devices, equipment, and supplies benefit](#).

Additional exclusions and limitations for nutritional services

In addition to the plan’s [exclusions and limitations](#), this benefit excludes any other of the following:

- Dietary formulas or medical foods
- Oral nutritional supplements that do not meet Medical Necessity criteria or are not related to the treatment of inborn errors of metabolism
- Special diets
- Prepared foods/meals

Obesity-related surgery

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

Coverage includes bariatric surgery and related hospitalizations when KHPWA criteria are met. Obesity related services require prior authorization. Services related to obesity screening and counseling are covered as Preventive Services. Weight-loss programs and related physician visits for medication monitoring are not covered, except those covered under the [weight management](#) benefit or as described in the preventive care section.

Additional exclusions and limitations for obesity-related surgery

In addition to the plan’s [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Related weight-loss programs

- Prescribing and monitoring of drugs
- Structured weight-loss and/or exercise programs or memberships
- Specialized nutritional counseling

Onsite Mammography Screening

Microsoft offers access to an onsite mammography screening in select Microsoft locations to employees and their spouse/domestic partners enrolled in a Microsoft Health Plan. The onsite mammography screening provides a multiple-view screening exam. At the discretion of the technologist performing the mammogram, additional views may be necessary to clarify imaging issues for the radiologist.

The onsite mammography screening program includes the onsite preventive screening mammogram exam only. Any additional or follow-up imaging or other services needed are considered diagnostic and will be covered as outlined in the diagnostic services benefit.

An onsite mammogram is not recommended if you have implants, a breast problem, are pregnant, or are breastfeeding. In those cases, you should consult with your doctor about obtaining an exam at an offsite breast center or other health care facility. Such an offsite exam would not be covered by the onsite mammography screening program but may be covered by the Plan's preventive or diagnostic services coverage, as applicable. As the onsite mammogram is a screening exam, the vendor is not able to provide imaging for a breast problem such as a lump. If you have questions about mammogram screenings, talk with your primary care physician.

Who Provides the Mammograms?

In the Puget Sound area of Washington state, Mammograms are provided by Swedish Mobile Mammography Services (operated by Swedish Health Services). The mammography technologists are registered by the American Registry of Radiologic Technology, have advanced credentials in mammography, and are certified by the State of Washington. The interpreting physicians are employed by Radia, are board certified by the American College of Radiology, and specialize in breast imaging.

In other areas, Microsoft partners with local vendors who specialize in onsite mammography and have the appropriate equipment and licensure. To provide services onsite, there must be sufficient demand to fill a day of appointments and a local vendor who is qualified to provide the services. Onsite mammography events will be advertised for any locations where they are available.

When Do the Screenings Occur?

Periodically each year, usually during the fall.

Eligibility

US benefits-eligible employees and their spouse/domestic partner age 35 and over, who are enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan, are eligible to participate in onsite mammography screenings.

You are eligible to participate in the onsite screening even if you have had a routine mammogram in the past 12 months. However, you should talk with your primary care provider to determine the benefits and risks of having a second mammogram within a 12-month period. If you suspect you have a breast problem, such as a lump, you should see your primary care provider.

Women under the age of 35 are ineligible, unless they have written permission from their physician.



At some locations, women under age 35 will not be allowed to participate, even with written permission from their physician.

Dependent children (regardless of age), agency temporaries/external staff, international based employees, and any individuals who are not enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan are not eligible to participate.

Out-of-area benefit

Plan pays 100%; up to a maximum of \$2,000 per member per calendar year

All applicable cost shares, contract provisions, limitations and exclusions apply the same as if services were covered within KFHPWA's service area.

Members may be asked to pay the provider at the time services are received. If the services are covered under this benefit, you will be reimbursed the reasonable charges for the care up to the maximum amount.

Submit a [claim](#) to KFHPWA for the services for Member Reimbursement. Submit the form with all necessary supporting documentation (i.e., itemized bills and receipts, explanation of the services, and the identification information from your ID card).



Send claims to:

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington, Claims Administration
P.O. Box 34585
Seattle, WA 98124-1585

Plastic and reconstructive services

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Covered services include:

- Correction of a congenital disease or congenital anomaly.
- Correction of a medical condition following an injury or resulting from surgery that has produced a major effect on the member's appearance. The service must, in the opinion of a KFHPWA provider, reasonably correct the condition.
- Reconstructive surgery and associated procedures, including internal breast prostheses, following a mastectomy, regardless of when the mastectomy was performed
- Members will be covered for all stages of reconstruction on the non-diseased breast produce a symmetrical appearance
- Complications of covered mastectomy services, including lymphedemas, are covered

Plastic and reconstructive surgery requires prior authorization.



A **congenital anomaly** is a marked difference from the normal structure of a body part that is physically evident from birth.

Additional exclusions and limitations for plastic and reconstructive services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Cosmetic services and surgery
- Treatment for complications resulting from cosmetic surgery
- Complications of non-covered services

Podiatric services

\$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

Routine foot care is covered when such care is directly related to the treatment of diabetes and, when approved by KFHPWA's medical director, other clinical conditions that affect sensation and circulation to the feet.

Additional exclusions and limitations for podiatric services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit: all other routine foot care.

Prescription drugs

This benefit covers all FDA-approved, medically necessary prescription drugs, when prescribed for the member's use outside of a medical facility and dispensed by a licensed pharmacist in a pharmacy licensed by the state in which the pharmacy is located.

All drugs, supplies, and devices must be obtained at a KFHPWA-designated pharmacy except for drugs dispensed for emergency services. Information regarding KFHPWA-designated pharmacies is reflected in the KFHPWA Provider Directory available at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org> or can be obtained by contacting the Kaiser Permanente Member Services Center at (206) 630-4636.

Prescription drug Cost Shares are payable at the time of delivery. Certain brand name insulin drugs are covered at the generic drug Cost Share. Preferred contraceptive drugs as recommended by the U.S. Preventive Services Task Force (USPSTF) are covered as Preventive Services. Contraceptive drugs may be allowed up to a 12-month supply and, when available, picked up in the provider's office.

Members may be eligible to receive an emergency fill for certain prescription drugs filled outside of KFHPWA's business hours or when KFHPWA cannot reach the prescriber for consultation. For emergency fills, members receive and pay the prescription drug cost share for up to 7-day supply or if less, the minimum packaging size available at the time the emergency fill is dispensed. A list of prescription drugs eligible for emergency fills is available on the pharmacy website at www.kp.org/wa/formulary. Members can request an emergency fill by calling (855) 505-8107.

Certain drugs are subject to prior authorization as shown in the [formulary drug list](#).

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

Certain maintenance drugs will be covered at 100% under the [preventive care benefit](#).

Weight loss drugs in accordance with criteria established by KFHPWA are covered subject to a \$50 copayment.

Prescription drug copayments

Type of prescription (30-days up to a 90-day supply)	KFHPWA pharmacy copayment	KFHPWA mail order copayment
Value-based	\$0	\$0
Preferred Generic	\$10	\$5
Preferred Brand	\$25	\$20
Non-Preferred generic and brand (when prescribed by KFHPWA provider)	\$50 (\$35 maximum for insulin)	\$45 (\$35 maximum for insulin)



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Value-based drugs are drugs for chronic disease management such as diabetes, hyperlipidemia, heart failure and hypertension that are considered high value and are covered on a lower cost share tier.

Preferred generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but are available at a lower cost because the patent has expired.

Preferred brand-name drugs are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

The **preferred drug list** is the list of prescription drugs that are covered under the KFHPWA HMO Plan.



Call (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit [KFHPWA](#) online to review the preferred drug list.



You will be charged, under the benefit, for replacing lost, stolen, or damaged prescription drugs, or devices.

Covered drugs

This benefit covers:

- Prescription drugs, including preferred generic, preferred brand, and non-preferred (if prescribed by a KFHPWA provider)
- Supplies, and devices, including diabetic supplies (insulin, needles, syringes, test strips and lancets)
- Prescription drugs, including medications and injections, for anticipated illness while traveling
- Routine costs for prescription medications provided in a clinical trial. "Routine costs" means items and services delivered to the member that are consistent with and typically covered by the plan or coverage for a member who is not enrolled in a clinical trial.

The KFHPWA Preferred drug list is a list of prescription drugs, supplies, and devices considered to have acceptable efficacy, safety and cost-effectiveness. The Preferred drug list is maintained by a committee consisting of a group of physicians, pharmacists and a consumer representative who review the scientific evidence of these products and determine the Preferred and Non-Preferred status as well as utilization

management requirements. Preferred drugs generally have better scientific evidence for safety and effectiveness and are more affordable than Non-Preferred drugs. The preferred drug list is available at www.kp.org/wa/formulary, or upon request from Member Services.

Members may request a coverage determination by contacting Member Services. Coverage determination reviews may include requests to cover non-preferred drugs, obtain prior authorization for a specific drug, or exceptions to other utilization management requirements, such as quantity limits.

Prescription drugs have been approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and can, under Federal or state law, be dispensed only pursuant to a prescription order. These drugs include off-label use of FDA-approved drugs, provided that such use is:

- Documented to be effective in one of the standard reference compendia
- Shown by a majority of well-designed clinical trials published in peer-reviewed medical literature to provide improved efficacy or safety of the agent in comparison to standard therapies (or over placebo if no standard therapies exist)
- Approved by the Federal Secretary of Health and Human Services

If a member has a new prescription for a chronic condition, the member may request a coordination of medications so that medications for chronic conditions are refilled on the same schedule (synchronized). Cost-shares for the initial fill of the medication will be adjusted if the fill is less than the standard quantity.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs prescribed by a physician that requires close supervision and monitoring for serious and/or complex conditions, such as rheumatoid arthritis, hepatitis or multiple sclerosis. Specialty drugs must be obtained through KFHPWA's preferred specialty pharmacy vendor and/or network of specialty pharmacies. For a list of specialty drugs or more information about KFHPWA's specialty pharmacy network, go to the KFHPWA website at www.kp.org/wa/formulary or contact Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or toll-free at (800) 901-4636.



Standard reference compendia refers to the American Hospital Formulary Service—Drug Information; the American Medical Association Drug Evaluation; the United States Pharmacopoeia—Drug Information, or other authoritative compendia as identified from time to time by the Federal Secretary of Health and Human Services. "Peer-reviewed medical literature" means scientific studies printed in health care journals or other publications in which original manuscripts are published only after having been critically reviewed for scientific accuracy, validity, and reliability by unbiased independent experts. Peer-reviewed medical literature does not include in-house publications of pharmaceutical manufacturing companies.

Medicare Part D coverage

This benefit is equal to or greater than the Medicare Part D prescription drug benefit. Eligible members who are also eligible for Medicare Part D pharmacy benefits can remain covered under the plan and not be subject to Medicare-imposed late enrollment penalties should they decide to enroll in a Medicare Part D pharmacy plan at a later date; however, the member could be subject to payment of higher Part D premiums if the member subsequently has a break in creditable coverage of 63 continuous days or longer before enrolling in a Part D plan.



For more information about prescription drug policies or benefits, call (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit [KFHPWA](#) online.

Additional exclusions and limitations for prescription drugs

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Drugs and injectables, except as described in this summary
- Over-the-counter drugs, supplies and devices not requiring a prescription under state law or regulation, including most prescription vitamins, except as recommended by the U.S. Preventive Services Task Force (USPSTF)
- Compounds which include a non-FDA approved drug
- Growth hormones for idiopathic short stature without growth hormone deficiency
- Prescription drugs/products available over the counter or have an over-the-counter alternative that is determined to be therapeutically interchangeable
- Administration of drugs and injectables. This exclusion does not apply to drugs and supplements in accordance with the well care schedule established by KFHPWA and the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act of 2010.

Preventive care

Plan pays 100% for services detailed in the KFHPWA well-care schedule and preventive (maintenance) medications

Covered services include, but are not limited to:

- Well-baby care
- Well-child care
- Screening and tests with A and B recommendations by the U.S. Preventive Services Task Force (USPSTF)
- Services, tests and screening contained in the U.S. Health Resources and Services Administration Bright Futures guidelines as set forth by the American Academy of Pediatricians
- Services, tests, screening and supplies recommended in the U.S. Health Resources and Services Administration women's preventive and wellness services guidelines. Flu vaccines are covered up to the Allowed Amount when provided by a non-network provider.
- Immunizations recommended by the Centers for Disease Control's Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices
- Female sterilization
- FDA-approved contraceptive drugs, devices, including device removal, and counseling
- Preferred over-the-counter contraceptives and drugs as recommended by the USPSTF when obtained with a prescription
- Routine physical exam
- Mammograms (age appropriate)

- Routine prostate screening
- Colorectal cancer screening for members who are age 50 or older or who are under age 50 and at high risk
- Routine bone density screening
- Obesity screening/counseling; healthy diet; and physical activity counseling (special services are available if the member's BMI is 30 or higher as outlined in USPSTF guidelines).

Additional preventive services for women include:

- Well-woman visits, including preconception, prenatal and postpartum care
- Preferred FDA-approved contraception methods (including sterilization) and counseling
- Breastfeeding supplies
- Human Papillomavirus (HPV) testing
- Screening for gestational diabetes, domestic violence, and sexually transmitted infections
- Breast cancer preventive medications for asymptomatic women who are at increased risk for breast cancer and at low risk for adverse medication effects

Preventive care for chronic disease management includes treatment plans with regular monitoring, coordination of care between multiple providers and settings, medication management, evidence-based care, quality of care measurement and results, and education and tools for patient self-management support. In the event that these preventive care services are not available from a KFHPWA provider, non-network providers may furnish them without cost share when preauthorized.

Value-based (maintenance) medications include prescriptions for chronic conditions and FDA-approved contraception methods in the KFHPWA preferred drug list. All preventive drugs, supplies, and devices must be obtained at a KFHPWA-designated pharmacy.

For a complete list of what is considered preventive care and paid 100% by the plan, see the Preventive Care service list and the Preventive Drug list, or contact KFHPWA at (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636.

Additional exclusions and limitations for preventive care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), laboratory services that are not in accordance with the KFHPWA well-care schedule will be excluded from this benefit and subject to cost shares.



Review the [Preventive Care Services](#) and [Formulary Drug List](#) for a full list of preventive services.

Radiation therapy

\$40 copayment for oncology, radiation therapy, and chemotherapy specialists

Chemotherapy treats cancer with one or more chemotherapeutic agents (drugs) as part of a standardized regimen. Chemotherapy may also be prescribed to treat other conditions. Oral chemotherapy drugs are covered subject to the Prescription Drug cost share.

Radiation therapy is the medical use of ionizing radiation, generally as part of cancer treatment to control or kill malignant cells. Radiation therapy is synergistic with chemotherapy, and has been used before, during, and after chemotherapy in susceptible cancers.

Respiratory therapy

\$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists.

Respiratory therapy is delivered by a respiratory therapist. Respiratory therapists are specialists and educators in cardiology and pulmonology. Respiratory therapists are also advanced-practice clinicians in airway management; establishing and maintaining the airway during management of trauma, intensive care, and may administer anesthesia for surgery or conscious sedation.

Rehabilitation and Habilitative Care

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

Limited to a combined total of 60 inpatient days and 60 outpatient visits per calendar year for all Rehabilitation and Habilitative Care services (combined with the [Neurodevelopmental therapy](#) benefit).

Services with mental health diagnoses are covered with no limit. Cardiac rehabilitation is covered for up to a total of 36 visits per cardiac event when clinical criteria are met. Prior authorization is required.

Rehabilitation services restore function following illness, injury or surgery, limited to the following restorative therapies: physical therapy, occupational therapy, massage therapy, and speech therapy.

Habilitative care, includes Medically Necessary services or devices designed to help a Member keep, learn, or improve skills and functioning for daily living. Services may include: occupational therapy, physical therapy, speech therapy is covered when prescribed by a physician.

Inpatient care

Inpatient care includes restorative physical, occupational, and speech therapy services, as well as massage therapy and services for neurodevelopmentally disabled members.

Outpatient care

Outpatient care includes restorative physical, occupational, and speech therapy services, as well as massage therapy and services for neurodevelopmentally disabled members.

Additional exclusions and limitations for rehabilitation services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), services are subject to all terms, conditions, and limitations of this plan, including the following:

- All services must be provided at a Kaiser Permanente facility or a KFHPWA-approved rehabilitation facility and outpatient services require a prescription or order from a physician that reflects a written plan of care to restore function, and must be provided by a rehabilitation team that includes a physician, nurse, physical therapist, occupational therapist, massage therapist, or speech therapist
- Services are limited to those necessary to restore or improve functional abilities when physical, sensori-perceptual and/or communication impairment exists due to injury, illness, or surgery
- Specialty treatment programs
- Inpatient Residential Treatment services
- Specialty rehabilitation programs including "behavior modification programs"

- Therapy for degenerative or static conditions when the expected outcome is primarily to maintain the member's level of functioning (except as described for neurodevelopmental therapy)
- Recreational, life-enhancing, relaxation or palliative therapy
- Implementation of home maintenance programs

Reproductive Health

Plan pays 100% for services

Medically Necessary medical and surgical services for reproductive health, including consultations, examinations, procedures and devices, including device insertion and removal.

See [Maternity and pregnancy](#) for termination of pregnancy services.

Reproductive health is the care necessary to support the reproductive system and the ability to reproduce. Reproductive health includes contraception, cancer and disease screenings, termination of pregnancy, maternity, prenatal and postpartum care.

All methods for Medically Necessary FDA-approved (over the counter) contraceptive drugs, devices, and products. Condoms are limited to 120 per 90-day supply.

Contraceptive drugs may be allowed up to a 12-month supply and, when available, picked up in the provider's office.

Skilled nursing facility

Plan pays 90%; up to 60 days per member per calendar year

Skilled nursing care in a skilled nursing facility is covered when full-time skilled nursing care is necessary in the opinion of the attending KHPWA provider.

Care may include room and board, general nursing care, drugs, biologicals, supplies, and equipment ordinarily provided or arranged by a skilled nursing facility. Short-term restorative physical therapy, occupational therapy, and speech therapy are also included.

Additional exclusions and limitations for skilled nursing facility

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Personal comfort items such as telephone and television
- Rest cures
- Domiciliary or convalescent care

Sterilization services

Elective Sterilization

Plan pays 100% for FDA-approved sterilization procedures, such as vasectomy, tubal ligation, services, and supplies.

Additional exclusions and limitations for sterilization services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), procedures and services to reverse sterilization are excluded from this benefit.

Substance use disorder

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Inpatient services

Residential treatment services are provided in a facility specifically licensed in the state where it practices as a residential treatment center. Preauthorization is required for Residential Treatment and non-Emergency inpatient hospital services provided in out-of-state facilities. The member may receive two days of treatment before being subject to medical necessity review for continued care. The member or facility must notify KFHPWA within 24 hours of admission, or as soon as possible. Members may contact Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or toll-free at (800) 901-4636 to request Preauthorization.



Residential treatment centers or services offer facility-based treatment providing active treatment in a controlled environment. At least weekly physician visits are required, and services must offer treatment by a multi-disciplinary team of licensed professionals.

Outpatient services

All alcoholism and/or drug abuse treatment services must be:

- Provided at a Kaiser Permanente facility or Kaiser Permanente-approved treatment facility
- Deemed medically necessary; the following services are covered on an inpatient or outpatient basis: inpatient residential treatment services, diagnostic evaluation and education, organized individual and group counseling, and/or prescription drugs and medicines
- Court-ordered treatment is covered only if determined to be medically necessary



Substance use disorder means an illness characterized by physiological or psychological dependency, or both, on a controlled substance and/or alcoholic beverages, and where the member's health is substantially impaired or endangered or their social or economic function is substantially disrupted.

Additional exclusions and limitations for substance use disorder

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Experimental or investigational therapies such as aversion therapy.
- Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.

- Facilities and treatment programs which are not certified by the Department of Social Health Services

Telehealth Services

Plan pays 100%

Telemedicine Services provided by the use of real time interactive audio and video communications or store and forward technology between the patient at the originating site and a Network Provider at another location. Store and forward technology means sending a Member's medical information from an originating site to the provider at a distant site for later review. The provider follows up with a medical diagnosis for the Member and helps manage their care. Services must meet the following requirements:

- Be a covered service under this SPD.
- The originating site is qualified to provide the service.
- If the service is provided through store and forward technology, there must be an associated office visit between the Member and the referring provider.
- Is Medically Necessary.
- Online (E-Visits): A Member logs into the secure Member site at www.kp.org/wa and completes a questionnaire. A KFHPWA medical provider reviews the questionnaire and provides a treatment plan for select conditions, including prescriptions. Online visits are not available to Members during in-person visits at a KFHPWA facility or pharmacy. More information is available at <https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org/html/public/services/evisit>. Exclusions: Fax and e-mail; telehealth services with non-contracted providers; telehealth services in states where prohibited by law; all other services not listed above.

Additional exclusions and limitations for telemedicine

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), fax and email; telehealth services with non-contracted providers; telehealth services in states where prohibited by law; all other services not listed above are excluded.

Temporomandibular Joint (TMJ) services

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Covered services

- Medical and surgical services related to hospital charges for the treatment of TMJ disorders. TMJ appliances are covered under Devices, Equipment, and Supplies.
- Medically necessary orthognathic (jaw) surgery for the treatment of severe TMJ disorders for which non-surgical interventions have not been successful, radiology services, TMJ specialist services, and fitting/adjustment of splints

Additional exclusions and limitations for Temporomandibular Joint (TMJ) services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Treatment for cosmetic purposes
- Bite blocks
- Dental services, including orthodontic therapy and braces for any condition
- Severe obstructive sleep apnea

Any hospitalizations related to these exclusions are also excluded.

Tobacco cessation

Plan pays 100%

This benefit covers:

- Individual and group sessions through KFHPWA-designated tobacco cessation programs
- Tobacco cessation pharmacy products
- Educational materials when provided through KFHPWA

Transplants

Inpatient: Plan pays 90%

Outpatient: \$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists; \$100 copayment for outpatient hospital care

Transplants include:

- Heart
- Heart-lung
- Single lung
- Double lung
- Kidney
- Pancreas
- Cornea
- Intestinal/multi-visceral
- Bone marrow
- Liver
- Stem cell support (obtained from allogeneic or autologous peripheral blood or marrow) with associated high-dose chemotherapy

Covered services are limited to the following:

- Inpatient and outpatient medical expenses
 - Evaluation testing to determine recipient candidacy
 - Donor matching tests
 - Hospital charges
 - Procurement center fees
 - Professional fees

- Travel costs for a surgical team, and
- Excision fees
- Donor costs for a covered organ recipient are limited to
 - Procurement center fees
 - Travel costs for a surgical team
 - Excision fees
- Follow-up services for specialty visits
- Re-hospitalization
- Maintenance medications during an inpatient stay

Additional exclusions and limitations for transplants

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Donor costs to the extent that they are reimbursable by the organ donor's insurance
- Treatment of donor complications
- Living expenses
- Transportation expenses, except as set forth under this plan

Travel and lodging reimbursement

In-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations described below)

Limit: \$10,000 per calendar year

Travel and lodging reimbursement benefits are available when travel is necessary to obtain covered treatment for a medical condition only when a treatment option is not available within 100 miles of the patient's home.

Travel Allowances: Travel is reimbursed between the patient's home and the location of the covered treatment for round trip (air, train, or bus) transportation costs. Airfare, or train or bus fare, must be for a regularly scheduled commercial flight, or train or bus route (coach class only). If traveling by automobile, mileage, parking, and toll costs are reimbursed. Costs for surface transportation (rideshares, taxi, ferry, etc.) are also covered. Mileage reimbursement is based on the current IRS medical mileage reimbursement. Please refer to the IRS website, www.irs.gov, publication 502 Medical and Dental expenses, for current mileage reimbursement rates.

Lodging Allowances: Hotel or motel stays (or similar accommodations) away from home. Reimbursement of expenses incurred by a patient and companion for hotel or motel lodging away from home, in the geographic area where the covered treatment is performed, is provided at a rate of \$50 per night per person, or up to \$100 per night total for the patient and one companion (see below), in accordance with applicable IRS reimbursement requirements.

Overall Maximum: The travel and lodging reimbursement benefit is limited to a total of \$10,000 per member per plan year.

Companions: The travel and lodging benefit is available for the patient, as well as a companion, to the extent that a companion is needed to accompany the patient for the treatment due to medical necessity or safety concerns.

- Adult Patient (age 18 or older) – 1 companion is permitted.
- Child Patient – 1 parent or guardian is permitted

Limits: Eligible travel and lodging expenses under this benefit are reimbursable up to the IRS limits, if applicable, in effect on the date you incurred the expense, which are subject to change. Please visit the IRS website, www.irs.gov, for details. Nothing in this summary of the travel and lodging reimbursement benefit should be considered legal or tax advice. Please consult with a personal legal or tax advisor for more information.

Non-Covered Expenses:

- Alcohol/tobacco
- Car rental expenses
- Any airfare, train or bus fare, or upgrades for any ticket other than a regularly scheduled commercial flight in coach class
- Baggage fees
- Entertainment (e.g., movies, visits to museums, additional mileage for sightseeing, etc.)
- Expenses for persons other than the patient and an eligible covered companion
- Lodging at a residence owned by a family member or friend
- Costs for pets or animals, other than service animals
- Meals
- Personal care items (e.g., shampoo, deodorant, toothbrush etc.)
- Souvenirs (e.g., T-shirts, sweatshirts, toys, etc.)
- Telephone calls

Limitations/exclusions:

- The travel and lodging must occur, and the treatment must be provided, within the United States
- The patient must be currently covered by the Microsoft provided KFHPWA plan
- The medical treatment for which the patient is required to travel more than 100 miles from the patient's residence must be a covered benefit under the Plan

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine in advance whether coverage is available for travel and lodging reimbursement.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by KFHPWA that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Urgent care

Inside KFHPWA's service area—\$20 copayment for primary care providers; \$40 copayment for specialists

Care for urgent conditions within the KFHPWA service area is not covered at non-Kaiser Permanente facilities except for emergency services. These emergency services will be subject to the applicable emergency care copayment of \$75, plus the difference between the non-Kaiser Permanente facility's charge and the KFHPWA allowable charge.



An **allowable charge** is the negotiated amount that KFHPWA providers have agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. Out-of-network providers may not accept the allowable charge as payment in full. You are responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

Weight Management program

Plan pays 80%; up to \$6,000 maximum for the duration of your continuous enrollment in the KFHPWA HMO Plan (out-of-pocket maximum does not apply)

This benefit provides coverage for comprehensive and clinically based weight management programs for the treatment of obesity. This benefit is available to KFHPWA HMO members but is administered by Premera Blue Cross.

Who is eligible

Members are eligible for the Weight Management program benefit if they meet the following criteria:

- Have been prescribed a GLP-1 medication, or
- Diagnosed as obese (commonly Body Mass Index (BMI) greater than or equal to 30), or
- Overweight with a BMI greater than or equal to 27, and diagnosed with two or more of the following conditions:
 - Congestive heart failure
 - Coronary heart disease
 - Depression
 - Diabetes
 - Hyperlipidemia
 - Hypertension
 - Sleep Apnea

This benefit is available for members aged 18 and over.

Eligible providers

Approved [weight management providers](#) of this benefit must meet eligibility requirements set forth by Microsoft and Premera and be providing services under a weight management program that is contracted for and approved by Premera for this plan.

Approved weight management programs will be those programs that are comprehensive and clinically based. Approved programs must be based on medical oversight and include treatment from professionals in the areas of nutrition, behavioral therapy, and personal training. An approved program must include an initial minimum 10-week period of frequent sessions with the program's physician, personal trainer, dietician, and behavioral therapist. This initial period must be followed by a minimum three-month maintenance period, which includes regular follow-up visits with these program professionals.

The Weight Management program must be contracted for and approved by Premera both at the time the member begins the program and when they complete the program. If the program is not approved and contracted for until after the member has started treatment under the program, no part of the cost of the program will be covered under this benefit.



To find an approved provider, review the [Weight Management providers](#).

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is recommended to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact KFHPWA for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by KFHPWA that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination is offered in certain situations where medical records must be provided to establish medical necessity before the plan will pay for the service. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. KFHPWA and Microsoft reserve the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

A [Weight Management Recommendation form](#) or confirmation of your BMI and co-morbid conditions should be submitted to Premera prior to receiving reimbursement from Premera. Your physician's recommendation will confirm you meet the contract criteria required for this benefit to be available.

The following are the steps that must be completed to ensure that your treatment meets the criteria of this benefit:

1. Take the Weight Management Recommendation form to your regular physician

2. An evaluation is performed by your physician to determine if you meet the eligibility requirements set forth above
3. Your physician faxes or mails the Weight Management Recommendation Form to Premera to confirm that you meet the weight management eligibility requirements and your physician's approval



Your physician can fax this information to 800-676-1477

4. Premera Blue Cross will review the information submitted and verify the coverage through a prior authorization

Participation in the program should begin within six months of the prior authorization being issued or a new prior authorization will need to be requested.

Claims payment

Final claims payment will be contingent on Premera receiving all biometric reporting information for the member. Reimbursement for this benefit may occur in one of two ways. The program you attend will select the claims payment method used.

Method 1: Direct reimbursement to member

The provider will bill you directly for services provided. The frequency of billing should be made clear by the provider before you start the program. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program.

During the course of the program, you can submit an interim weight management billing claim form on a monthly or quarterly basis to Premera for reimbursement. You may also submit a final weight management final billing claim form at the end of the program.

If your coverage terminates during the time you are participating in an approved program, and you do not elect COBRA, only services rendered up to the date of termination of coverage will be reimbursed.

Method 2: Direct reimbursement to provider

Reimbursement will be made directly to the weight management provider on a monthly or quarterly basis. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program but will bill Premera on a monthly or quarterly basis for your ongoing participation.

Additional exclusions and limitations for Weight Management program

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Food
- Nutritional supplements (i.e., protein shakes)
- Drugs or surgical procedures to assist in reducing weight or curbing hunger

Exclusions and limitations

General exclusions

In addition to [exclusions associated with specific benefits](#), the following services are not covered:

- Benefits and related services, supplies and drugs that are not medically necessary for the treatment of an illness, injury, or physical disability, that are not specifically listed as covered under the [What the plan covers](#) section, except as required by law
- Follow-up services related to a non-covered service, except as required by federal law
- Complications of non-covered services
- Cosmetic services, including treatment for complications resulting from cosmetic surgery, except as provided under the [What the plan covers](#) section
- Services for which a claim was not received by KFHPWA within 12 months of the date of service. Corrected claims and COB claims need to be submitted within 12 months from the original claim submission date.
- Devices, equipment, and supplies, except as specifically stated under the [devices, equipment, and supplies](#) benefit
- Benefits that overlap or duplicate benefits for which the member is eligible under any other group plan, workers' compensation or similar employee benefit law, Medicare Part A or B, or a government-sponsored program of any type
- Those parts of an examination and associated reports and immunizations required for employment, immigration (except for immigration exams authorized by Microsoft and provided by designated immigration exam providers), license, travel (except for medications and injections for anticipated illness while traveling), or insurance purposes that are not deemed medically necessary by KFHPWA for early detection of disease, all diagnostic services not specifically stated under Preventive Services
- Cosmetic services related to sexual reassignment surgery including treatment for complications resulting from cosmetic surgery; cosmetic surgery; complications of non-covered services; travel
- Services and supplies related to sexual reassignment surgery, such as sex-change operations or transformations and procedures, or treatments designed to alter physical characteristics, unless specifically stated under the Gender affirming service benefit
- Services or supplies not specifically listed as covered under the [What the plan covers](#) section
- The cost of services and supplies resulting from a member's loss of or willful damage to appliances, devices, supplies, and materials covered by KFHPWA for the treatment of disease, injury, or illness
- Orthoptic therapy (eye training)
- Specialty treatment programs such as weight reduction, behavior modification programs and rehabilitation
- Hypnotherapy and all services related to hypnotherapy
- Prognostic (predictive) genetic testing and related services, unless specifically provided in [hospital care](#) benefit. Testing for individuals not enrolled in the plan (for example, surrogate parent).
- Fetal ultrasound in the absence of medical indications

- Liquid diet or fasting programs, membership in diet programs or health clubs, wiring of the jaw, and complications from surgery or fasting programs; however, medically necessary surgery may be covered if specific criteria as determined by KFHPWA is met
- Services or supplies for which no charges are made, or for which a charge would not have been made if the member had no health care coverage or for which the member is not liable; services provided by a member of the member's family or self-care
- Autopsy and associated expenses
- Services provided by government agencies, except as required by federal or state law
- Services covered by the national health plan of any other country the member resides in
- Internally implanted insulin pump, artificial heart, artificial larynx, and any other implantable device that has not been approved by KFHPWA's medical director
- Travel-related vaccinations and medications are usually not covered. Visit <https://healthy.kaiserpermanente.org/washington/get-care/traveling/> for more details.
- Services that are illegal, outside the scope of the provider's license or certification, or furnished by a provider that is not licensed or certified by the jurisdiction in which the services or supplies were received

Dental benefits exclusions

Dentist's or oral surgeon's fees; dental care, surgery, services, and appliances, including: reconstructive surgery to the jaw in preparation for dental implants, dental implants, periodontal surgery, and any other dental services not specifically listed as covered in this summary.

Convalescent care exclusions

Convalescent care is excluded.

Investigational or experimental treatment exclusions



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.



The transplant benefit doesn't cover cornea transplantation, skin grafts, or the transplant of blood or blood derivatives (except for bone marrow or stem cells). These procedures are covered on the same basis as any other covered surgical procedure.

KFHPWA consults with KFHPWA's medical director and then uses the following criteria to decide if a particular service is experimental or investigational:

- A service is considered experimental or investigational for a member's condition if any of the following statements apply to it at the time the service is or will be provided to the member:
 - The service cannot be legally marketed in the United States without the approval of the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and such approval has not been granted

- The service is the subject of a current new drug or new device application on file with the FDA
 - The service is the trialed agent or for delivery or measurement of the trialed agent provided as part of a qualifying Phase I or Phase II clinical trial, as the experimental or research arm of a Phase III clinical trial
 - The service is provided pursuant to a written protocol or other document that lists an evaluation of the service's safety, toxicity, or efficacy as among its objectives
 - The service is under continued scientific testing and research concerning the safety, toxicity, or efficacy of services
 - The service is provided pursuant to informed consent documents that describe the service as experimental or investigational, or in other terms that indicate that the service is being evaluated for its safety, toxicity, or efficacy
 - The prevailing opinion among experts as expressed in the published authoritative medical or scientific literature is that (1) the use of such service should be substantially confined to research settings, or (2) further research is necessary to determine the safety, toxicity, or efficacy of the service
- The following sources of information will be exclusively relied upon to determine whether a service is experimental or investigational:
 - The member's medical records
 - The written protocol(s) or other document(s) pursuant to which the service has been or will be provided
 - Any consent document(s) the member or member's representative has executed or will be asked to execute, to receive the service
 - The files and records of the Institutional Review Board (IRB) or similar body that approves or reviews research at the institution where the service has been or will be provided, and other information concerning the authority or actions of the IRB or similar body
 - The published authoritative medical or scientific literature regarding the service, as applied to the member's illness or injury, and
 - Regulations, records, applications, and any other documents or actions issued by, filed with, or taken by, the FDA, or other agencies within the United States Department of Health and Human Services, or any state agency performing similar functions

Coverage decisions may be appealed as set forth in the [What the plan covers](#) section.

Vehicle insurance exclusions

- Any services to the extent benefits are "available" to the member as defined herein through vehicle, homeowner's, property, or other insurance policy, except for individual or KFHPWA insurance, whether the member asserts a claim or not
- Medical coverage, medical "no fault" coverage, personal injury protection coverage, or similar medical coverage in the policy
- Benefits are deemed to be "available" to the member if the member is a named insured, comes within the policy definition of insured, or otherwise has the right to receive first-party benefits under the policy

Additional exclusions and limitations

In addition, certain exclusions and limitations apply to the following benefits. CTRL+Click to navigate to the benefit information.

- [Acupuncture](#)
- [Autism/ABA therapy](#)
- [Devices, equipment, and supplies](#)
- [Home health care](#)
- [Hospice care](#)
- [Hospital care](#)
- [Infertility](#)
- [Manipulative therapy](#)
- [Maternity and pregnancy care](#)
- [Mental health and wellness](#)
- [Naturopathy](#)
- [Neurodevelopmental therapy for children](#)
- [Nutritional services](#)
- [Obesity-related surgery](#)
- [Plastic and reconstructive services](#)
- [Podiatric services](#)
- [Prescription drugs](#)
- [Preventive care](#)
- [Rehabilitation](#)
- [Skilled nursing facility](#)
- [Sterilization](#)
- [TMJ](#)
- [Transplants](#)
- [Travel and lodging reimbursement](#)
- [Weight Management program](#)

How to file a claim

In most cases, when you receive care from a KFHPWA provider or facility, your provider will submit bills directly to KFHPWA, and this submission is your claim for benefits. If your provider does not submit a bill directly to KFHPWA, you will need to submit a claim for benefits.

If possible, you should submit the claim form within 90 days of the service. The plan will not consider claims submitted more than 12 months after the date of service, except in the absence of legal capacity.

Claims for benefits may be made before or after services are obtained. For out-of-country claims (Emergency care only) – submit the claim and any associated medical records translated into English at

the member's expense, including the type of service, charges in U.S. Dollars, and proof of travel to KFHPWA, P.O. Box 34585, Seattle, WA 98124-1585.

To submit a claim:

1. Download the [KFHPWA Claim Form](#) or call Kaiser Permanente Member Services at (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 to request a form
2. Complete the form with the necessary information such as an itemization of services received including codes and conditions. Proof of payment is also required if members are seeking reimbursement.
3. Gather copies of your receipts from your covered visit
4. Send your completed form and additional paperwork to:
Claims Reimbursement
PO BOX 34585
Seattle WA 98124-1585



COBRA-eligibility claims should be submitted as described in the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

*Claims regarding plan eligibility for you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent child can be sent to:
Kaiser Foundation Plan of Washington
Member Appeal Department,
PO Box 34593,
Seattle, WA 98124-1593*

Claim review and payment

KFHPWA will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other communication notifying you of their decision on your claim within the following timeframes after KFHPWA receives your claim.

- **Pre-service claims**—KFHPWA will provide notice of a claim approval or denial within 15 days. This 15-day period may be extended for an additional 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond KFHPWA's control. You will have at least 45 days to provide any additional information requested of you by KFHPWA.
- **Urgent care**—KFHPWA will process claims and notify claimants of the decision, in immediate request situations, within 72 hours.
- **Concurrent urgent requests**—KFHPWA will process claims for concurrent urgent requests within 24 hours.
- **Concurrent non-urgent requests**—You will be notified if there is to be any reduction or termination in coverage for ongoing care sufficiently in advance of such reduction so that you will be able to appeal the decision before the coverage is reduced or terminated.
- **Urgent care review requests**—KFHPWA will process claims for urgent care review requests within 48 hours.
- **Non-urgent pre-service review requests**—KFHPWA will process claims for non-urgent pre-service review requests within 15 calendar days. Timeframes for pre-service claims can be extended by KFHPWA for up to an additional 15 days. Members will be notified in writing of such extension prior to the expiration of the initial timeframe.

- **Post-service review requests**—KFHPWA will process claims for post-service review requests within 30 calendar days. Timeframes for post-service claims can be extended by KFHPWA for up to an additional 15 days. Members will be notified in writing of such extension prior to the expiration of the initial timeframe.
- **Claims involving urgently needed care**—If your claim involves urgent care, you or your authorized representative will be notified of KFHPWA's initial decision on the claim, whether adverse or not, as soon as is feasible, but in no event more than 72 hours after receiving the claim. If the claim does not include sufficient information for the Plan Administrator to make a decision, you or your representative will be notified within 24 hours after receipt of the claim of the need to provide additional information. You will have at least 48 hours to respond to this request; KFHPWA then must inform you of its decision within 48 hours of receiving the additional information.
- **Concurrent care claims**—If your claim is one involving concurrent care, KFHPWA will notify you of its decision, whether adverse or not, within 24 hours after receiving the claim. If the claim does not include sufficient information for the Plan Administrator to make a decision, you or your representative will be notified within 24 hours after receipt of the claim of the need to provide additional information. Where urgent care is involved, you will have at least 48 hours to respond to this request. KFHPWA will respond within 24 hours of receipt of the additional information. If the claim does not involve urgent care, the request may be treated as a new benefit claim and decided within the timeframes appropriate to the type of claim, (i.e., as a pre-service claim or a post-service claim).
- **Post-service claims**—If you have filed a post-service claim for reimbursement of medical care services that already have been rendered, you will be notified of KFHPWA's decision on your claim if it is denied in whole or in part. This notification will be issued no more than 30 days after KFHPWA receives the claim. KFHPWA may extend this 30-day period for up to 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond KFHPWA's control. You will have at least 45 days to provide any additional information requested of you by KFHPWA if the need for the extension is due to KFHPWA's need for additional information from you or your health care providers.



Explanation of benefits (EOB) is the statement you receive from KFHPWA detailing how much the provider billed, how much (if any) the plan paid, and the amount that you owe the provider (if any).

In paying for services, KFHPWA may make payment to the employee, provider or another carrier. KFHPWA may also make payments on behalf of an enrolled child to a non-enrolled parent or state agency to which the plan is required by applicable law to direct such payments. Payments are subject to applicable law and regulation. Payments made will discharge the plan to the extent of the amount paid, so that the plan is not liable to anyone due to its choice of payee.

Denied claims notice

If all or part of your claim is denied, KFHPWA will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other notice with the following information:

- The reasons for the denial
- The plan provisions on which the denial is based

- Any additional material or information necessary for you to perfect the claim and an explanation of why such material or information is necessary
- An explanation of the procedure for appeals and the applicable time limits, along with a statement of your right to bring a civil action under ERISA Section 502(a) upon an adverse decision on appeal
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol, or other criterion that was relied upon in making the adverse determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If you have filed a claim with KFHPWA relating to plan eligibility, and this claim is denied, KFHPWA will send you a notice explaining your appeal rights
- Notice regarding your right to bring legal action following a denial on appeal

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning
- A description of the Plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal; and
- Contact information for Kaiser Permanente Member Services or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist members with the internal and external appeals process

Appeal for internal review

Members are entitled to appeal through the appeals process if/when coverage for an item or service is denied due to an adverse determination made by the KFHPWA medical director. Assistance is available to members who are limited-English speakers, who have literacy problems, or who have physical or mental disabilities that impede their ability to request review or participate in the review process. If the plan denies your claim, you may appeal for an internal review of the decision within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits (EOB).



An appeal is a written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce or end payment, coverage or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the plan. This includes admissions to and continued stays in a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.



If you fail to file the internal appeal within the timeframe specified above, you will permanently lose your right to appeal the denied claim.

Submitting an appeal for internal review

You must provide the following information as part of your oral or written appeal to KFHPWA's Member Appeals Department:

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington Section III: Medical and prescription drugs

- Your name
- Your KFHPWA member number
- The name of this plan, and
- A concise statement of why you disagree with the decision, including facts or theories supporting your claim

Your written request may (but is not required to) include issues, comments, documents, and other records you want considered in the review.



The appeal should be submitted to KFHPWA at the following address:

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington
Member Appeal Department,
PO Box 34593,
Seattle, WA 98124-1593

You may, at your own expense, have an attorney or other representative act on your behalf. If you want to appoint someone to act for you in the appeals process (including your provider), you must submit a completed and signed [KFHPWA Appointment of Representative form](#) with your written internal appeals request to the address above.

In the case of an urgent care claim, you may submit your appeal request orally or in writing and all necessary information may be transmitted between you and the plan by telephone, facsimile or other similarly expeditious method. If your provider believes your situation is urgent as defined under law and so notifies KFHPWA, your appeal will be conducted on an expedited basis. Notification will be furnished to you as soon as possible, but not later than 72 hours after receipt of the expedited appeal. Your appeal should clearly indicate your request for an expedited appeal.

You may also begin an external review at the same time as the internal appeals process if this is an urgent care situation or you are in an ongoing course of treatment. To request this step, you must call Member Appeals. The external review agency is not legally affiliated or controlled by KFHPWA. The external review agency decision is final and is generally binding upon the Plan.



To file an urgent care appeal request, you may call KFHPWA directly at (866) 458-5479 or you may fax a request to (206) 630-1859.

Internal review and timeframe

All of the information you submit will be taken into account on appeal, even if it was not reviewed as part of the initial decision. You may ask to examine or receive free copies of all pertinent Plan documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim by asking KFHPWA.

The plan may consult with a health care professional who has experience in the field of medicine involved in the medical judgment to decide your appeal. You may request the identity of medical experts whose advice was obtained by the plan in connection with your initial claim denial, even if their advice was not relied upon in making the initial decision.

In the event any new or additional information (evidence) is considered, relied on or generated by KFHPWA in connection with your appeal, KFHPWA will provide this information to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that you will have an opportunity to respond. Also, if any new or additional rationale is considered by KFHPWA, KFHPWA will provide the rationale to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that that you will have an opportunity to respond.

If the claim is a post-service claim, you will receive a decision within a reasonable period of time, but not later than 60 days after receipt of your appeal request.

If the claim is a pre-service claim, you will receive a decision within a reasonable period of time, but not later than 30 days after receipt of your appeal request.

Denied appeal notice

If the previous denial is upheld in whole or in part, the notice of the decision on appeal will specify:

- The reasons for the denial
- The Plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A contact point through which the member may review or receive free copies of any documents, records or other information relevant to your claim for benefits
- A statement of your right to bring a civil action under ERISA 502(a) following an adverse benefit determination upon the conclusion of your appeal
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol or other criterion that was relied upon in making the adverse determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning
- A description of the Plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal; and
- Contact information for Kaiser Permanente Member Services or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist members with the internal and external appeals process

If KFHPWA fails to grant or reject your request within the applicable required timeframe, you may proceed as if the claim had been rejected.

Appeal for external review

If you are not satisfied with the final internal denial of your claim, you may request an external review by an independent review organization (IRO) if that denial constitutes a rescission of coverage or is based on medical judgment including:

- Requirements for medical necessity, appropriateness, health care setting, level of care or effectiveness of a covered benefit
- A determination that a treatment is experimental or investigational



An **independent review organization (IRO)** is an independent organization of medical experts who are qualified to review medical and other relevant information.

The external review is available only after you have properly exhausted the internal appeal as described above. There are no fees or costs imposed on you as part of the external review.

The external review agency decision is final and is generally binding upon the plan.

Submitting an appeal for external review

An [External Review Request Form](#) will be sent with your Internal Appeal determination letter notifying you of your rights to an External Review.

To initiate the External Review, you must complete, sign the External Review Request Form, and send it to KFHPWA at the address below no later than 120 days after the date you receive your Internal Appeal determination letter, which the Plan deems to be 7 days after the date on the Internal Appeal determination letter.



If you fail to submit the completed and signed form within this timeframe, you will permanently lose your right to an External Review.



Mail the External Review Request form to:

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan Washington
Member Appeal Department
P.O. Box 34593
Seattle, WA 98124-1593

External review and timeframe

If your claim is eligible for External Review, KFHPWA will notify the IRO of your request for an External Review and send them all the information included in your Internal Appeal and other relevant materials within six days of receipt.

The IRO will contact you and/or KFHPWA directly if additional information is needed. KFHPWA will provide the IRO with any additional information the IRO requests that is reasonably available. The External Review request is considered complete when the IRO has all the requested information, and the IRO review begins.



If your provider believes your situation is urgent under law (as defined above under Appeal for internal review), your external review will be conducted on an expedited basis. For expedited external reviews, you and KFHPWA will be notified by phone, e-mail message or fax as soon as possible, but no later than 72 hours after receipt of your external review request. A written determination will follow.

The plan agrees that any statute of limitations (including the one-year contractual limitations period described below) or other defense based on timeliness is on hold during the time that the External Review is pending. Your decision whether to file the External Review will have no effect on your rights to any other benefits under the plan.

The external review process does not apply to appeals of denied claims for plan eligibility or for other appeals of denied claims that are not based on medical judgment.

Decision on the external review

The plan is bound by the IRO's decision. If the IRO overturned the final internal adverse determination, the plan will implement their decision. The IRO will notify you and KFHPWA in writing of its determination on the external review no later than 45 days after receipt of your complete external review request.

Decisions upon the external review are the final decision under the Plan's appeal process, and there are no further appeals available from KFHPWA or Microsoft or any person administering claims or appeals under the plan. However, you still have the right to file suit under ERISA Section 502(a) as a result of the external review decision.

Limits on your right to judicial review

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal before taking action in any other forum regarding a claim for benefits under the plan. Any legal action initiated under the Plan must be brought no later than one year following the adverse determination on the appeal. This one-year limitations period on claims for benefits applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit claim is deemed permanently waived and barred.



If you have questions about understanding a denial of a claim or your appeal rights, you may contact KFHPWA at (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636 or visit [KFHPWA](#) online. You may also seek assistance from the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor at (866) 444-EBSA (3272).

Right to recover benefits paid in error

If KFHPWA makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, KFHPWA has the right to recover payment including deducting the amount paid by mistake from future benefits.

Note: Health care providers are not "beneficiaries" of the plan, and although KFHPWA may make direct payment to health care providers for the convenience of participants and their dependents, such payments of services shall not be considered "benefits" available under the plan or confer beneficiary standing upon a health care provider.

Release of medical information

As part of this plan, physicians, hospitals or other providers may disclose to KFHPWA medical information necessary to administer claims. KFHPWA will keep this information confidential.

HMO Plan Kaiser Permanente

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How the plan works

The Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan offers the convenience of “one-stop shop” medical care. Your providers are all part of the same integrated health care system, so they can quickly share your medical records to help make informed decisions about your care. There’s also a pharmacy, laboratory, and X-ray facility at every Kaiser Permanente location, so it’s easy and efficient to get the care you need when you need it.

Where you can get care

The HMO Plan provides comprehensive medical care and prescription drug coverage with contracted providers, facilities, and pharmacies through the Kaiser Permanente network in California and eight other states. Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington facilities are treated as part of the Kaiser Permanente network if you need medical services while in Washington State. Services provided outside the Kaiser Permanente’s service area may not be covered. You may need a referral from your primary care physician before the plan will cover care from specialists.

 To find an in-network provider of pharmacy, go to www.KP.org or contact the Member Service Contact Center at (800) 464-4000.

What you pay

When you receive care for the treatment of illnesses, injuries, and chronic conditions, you pay a portion of the cost, up to an annual out-of-pocket maximum. For most services such as office visits, outpatient surgery, and prescriptions, you pay a flat copayment at the time you receive care, and the plan pays the remainder of the cost. If you have an inpatient hospital stay, the plan pays 90% of the cost and you are

responsible for 10% up to an annual out-of-pocket maximum. When it comes to preventive care and preventive prescriptions, the plan covers 100% when you use in-network providers.

What you pay		
Copayments	+	Coinsurance
For office visits, outpatient surgery, and prescriptions, you pay a flat dollar copayment at the time you receive care, and the plan pays the remainder of the charges.		If you have an inpatient hospital stay, you pay 10% of the cost, called coinsurance and the plan pays the rest.
	=	Out-of-pocket maximum
		If you reach your annual out-of-pocket maximum, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses from that point forward. The out-of-pocket maximum is \$1,500 per person, up to a \$4,500 maximum for three or more covered family members.



Copayment is a fixed, up-front dollar amount that you are required to pay for certain covered services in the HMO plans.

Coinsurance is the percentage amount that you are required to pay for certain covered services.

Out-of-pocket maximum is the most you could pay each plan year for covered services and supplies.

Medical care copayments

Type of visit	Copayment	Coinsurance
Primary Care Physician	\$20	None
Specialist	\$40	None
Emergency (waived if admitted)	\$75	None
Hospital – outpatient	\$100	None
Hospital – inpatient	None	10%

Prescription drug copayments

(When prescribed by a Kaiser provider and obtained at a Kaiser pharmacy)		Copayment
Generic		\$10
Brand		\$25



Generic drugs are equivalent to a brand-name drug but available at a lower cost because the patent has expired.

Brand-name drugs are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

Out-of-pocket maximum

The annual out-of-pocket maximum is capped at \$1,500 for each covered member—this means that once a member reaches his/her out-of-pocket maximum through copayments and coinsurance, the plan pays 100% for the rest of the year for that individual. Also, if you have three or more covered family members, the most you'll pay for the year is \$4,500. Most copays and coinsurance count toward the annual out-of-pocket maximum, with the exception of prescription drugs and infertility treatment.

What the plan covers

Benefits under this Kaiser Permanente HMO are detailed in the Evidence of Coverage (separate documents for Northern California and Southern California coverage, respectively), which are incorporated by reference in this SPD.

Active employees/dependents go here...

- [Evidence of Coverage – Northern California](#)
- [Evidence of Coverage – Southern California](#)

COBRA enrollees go here...

For more information, go to <http://cobra.me.microsoft.com> > Reference Center > Kaiser CA Evidence of Coverage (EOC) Documents

Exclusions and limitations

Exclusions and Limitations under this Kaiser Permanente HMO are detailed in the Evidence of Coverage (separate documents for Northern California and Southern California coverage, respectively) which are incorporated by reference in this SPD.

Active employees/dependents go here...

- [Evidence of Coverage – Northern California](#)
- [Evidence of Coverage – Southern California](#)

COBRA enrollees go here...

For more information, go to <http://cobra.me.microsoft.com> > Reference Center > Kaiser CA Evidence of Coverage (EOC) Documents



Additional exclusions that apply only to a particular benefit are listed in the description of that benefit in the Benefits and Cost Sharing section in the Evidence of Coverage.

How to file a claim

If you wish to file a claim for benefits, you should follow the claim procedures described in the Evidence of Coverage provided by your Claims Administrator. All questions regarding claims should be directed to the Claims Administrator for the Kaiser Permanente Health Plan.

Active employees/dependents go here...

- [Evidence of Coverage – Northern California](#)
- [Evidence of Coverage – Southern California](#)

COBRA enrollees go here...

For more information, go to
<http://cobra.me.microsoft.com> > Reference Center >
Kaiser CA Evidence of Coverage (EOC) Documents



For more information about filing a claim, contact the Member Services Contact Center at (800) 464-4000.

Hawaii-Only Plan (Premera)

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How the plan works

The Hawaii-Only Plan provides comprehensive medical coverage and the flexibility to see any provider you choose. Preventive care is covered at 100% with in-network providers and facilities and you pay a share of other expenses up to an annual maximum amount.

Where you can get care

With the Hawaii-Only Plan, you have the flexibility to visit the provider or facility you choose and still have coverage. However, providers in the nationwide Premera Blue Cross Blue Shield network feature certain advantages, including:

- Your claims are filed directly with Premera by your provider
- Lower, negotiated rates for care and prescriptions
- The highest coverage levels

If you seek care with an out-of-network provider or facility, your out-of-pocket costs will be higher, and you may have to pay the provider and then submit a claim for reimbursement

Review the [What you pay](#) section for information on coverage levels.

Finding an in-network provider

In Hawaii, you can maximize your savings by using providers and facilities in the Premera network.

Outside of Hawaii, you may use any Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield provider throughout the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands under the [BlueCard®](#) Program. Your Premera identification card tells contracting providers that you are covered through this inter-plan arrangement. It's important to note that receiving services through BlueCard does not change covered benefits, benefit levels, or any stated residence requirements of this plan.

Visit the online Premera Medical Directory to find an in-network provider in the United States or call Premera Blue Cross at (800) 676-1411.

Active employees go here...

[Premera Medical Directory](#).

Active dependents or COBRA enrollees go here...

[Premera.com](#).



Additionally, both active employees and COBRA enrollees also have access to the [Embold Health Provider Guide](#), a tool that helps you find highly rated healthcare providers in your area and insurance network. Embold uses healthcare claims data to score how well a doctor makes the correct diagnosis, chooses the right treatment plan, and delivers the best health outcome. These scores are developed using common and accepted measures in the medical community.

Travel outside the United States

If you are traveling outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands and need care, you may be able to take advantage of [Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core](#), which provides referrals to doctors and other health care providers.



Call (800) 810-BLUE (2583) for Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core referrals to health care providers outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Jamaica, and the British and U.S. Virgin Islands.

If you are not using a Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core provider, you will need to submit claim forms to Premera for reimbursement of services received outside the United States. When you submit a claim, clearly detail the services received, diagnosis (including standard medical procedure and diagnosis code, or English nomenclature), dates of service, and the names and credentials for the attending provider. Benefits reimbursement will be calculated in U.S. dollars.

Care received outside the United States will be covered as long as the services are:

- Medically necessary
- Provided by a licensed provider performing within the scope of their license and practice
- Not deemed experimental or investigational based on the terms of this plan, or medical standards in the United States

Services received outside the United States that are considered urgent or emergent including services received on a cruise ship will be paid as [emergency care](#). Non-emergent facility and professional services are considered out-of-network and covered at 70% of billed charges. Standard deductible and coinsurance would apply. Virtual Care services with a provider located outside of the United States are not covered.



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.



Review the [What you pay](#) section for information on coverage levels.

Filling a prescription

Depending on your needs, you may fill your prescription at a retail pharmacy, pharmacy home delivery, or specialty pharmacy. Review the [prescription drug](#) benefit for more information on what is covered.



Microsoft reserves the right to change pharmacy networks at any time. Such changes will take effect on the date set by the Company, even if this information has not been revised to show the changes.

Coverage	Up to a 90-day supply for generic maintenance medication ; all others are up to a 30-day supply*	Up to 90-day supply* only using Express Scripts Pharmacy Home Delivery	Up to a 30-day supply* Additional clinical support for members using specialty drugs
In-network pharmacies	Express Scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf To find an Express Scripts retail pharmacy, call (800) 676-1411	Express Scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf	Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy** will bill the plan on your behalf
Out-of-network pharmacies	You will need to submit a prescription reimbursement form, with your receipt, for reimbursement	Not covered	Not covered

* Unless the drug maker's packaging limits the supply in some other way.

** Contact Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy at (877) 223-6447 or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy at (800) 689-6592 to get started.

The dispensing limits (or days' supply) for drugs dispensed at retail and specialty pharmacies, and through the mail-order pharmacy benefit, are described in the chart above.

Members are allowed two retail grace fills for specialty drugs before being required to utilize Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and
- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Generic maintenance medications have a common indication for the treatment of a chronic disease (such as diabetes, high cholesterol, or hypertension). Indications are obtained from the product labeling. They are used for diseases when the duration of the therapy can reasonably be expected to exceed one year. A generic prescription drug is manufactured and distributed after the brand-name drug patent of the innovator company has expired and is available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions. Generic drugs have obtained an AB rating from the U.S. Food and Drug Administration and are considered by the FDA to be therapeutically equivalent to the brand-name product.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for some services and prescriptions to determine that coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Refer to the specific plan benefit for additional details.

What you pay

You pay nothing for preventive care when you use in-network providers. When you receive care or prescription drugs in other situations, such as for the treatment of illnesses, injuries, and chronic conditions, you pay a portion of the cost up to an annual maximum amount. That annual amount, called your out-of-pocket maximum, includes a deductible and coinsurance. If you use in-network providers, you'll receive the lower Premera-negotiated rate, called the allowable charge, and higher coverage levels. Examples of how the plan pays for in- and out-of-network care follow on the next page.

Premera utilizes medical and payment policies in administering coverage under this plan. The medical policies generally are used to further define medical necessity, experimental and investigative status, and other aspects for specific procedures, drugs, biologic agents, devices, and other items and services and levels of care. These medical policies are available at <http://premera.com> or by calling Customer Service. The payment policies are used to define provider billing and payment rules and adjustments that can apply in various different settings and circumstances. These payment policies are available to you by calling Customer Service and to your provider by calling Customer Service or going to <http://premera.com> and logging into Premera's provider portal.

What you pay		
Deductible	+	Coinsurance = Out-of-pocket maximum
You pay 100% of your eligible expenses for medical care and prescriptions until you spend up to the amount of the deductible. Only the Premera allowable charge is applied to your deductible if you seek out-of-network care. You pay nothing for in-network preventive care.	If you reach the deductible, then you begin to pay coinsurance up to a capped amount called the coinsurance maximum. That means you pay only a portion of your health care costs and the plan pays the rest. The coinsurance amount you pay depends on where you seek care: • In-network, you pay 10% • Out-of-network, you pay 30% of the allowable charge plus the difference between the provider's bill and the allowable charge; only the allowable charge is applied to your coinsurance maximum.	If you meet your deductible and then you reach your coinsurance maximum, you've reached your out-of-pocket maximum. From that point forward, the plan pays 100% of eligible expenses and you pay nothing for in-network health care services for the rest of the year. You will still be responsible for the difference between the allowable charge and the provider's billed charges if you seek out-of-network care.
\$300 per person, up to \$900 family maximum		\$1,200 per person, up to \$3,600 family maximum
		\$1,500 per person, up to \$4,500 family maximum



The **allowable charge** is defined differently for in-network and out-of-network providers.

- For in-network providers, the allowable charge is the negotiated amount that the provider has agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service.
- For out-of-network providers, the allowable charge is the lowest of three amounts as outlined in the definition of "allowable charge" in the Glossary. If you choose to use out-of-network providers, you may be responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

Example

Jakob needs to visit an allergist. Jakob can choose an in-network or an out-of-network provider. Both charge \$115. The in-network provider accepts Premera's allowable charge of \$100 as full payment. Jakob hasn't yet met the deductible, so will pay the allowable charge of \$100 to the in-network provider. The out-of-network provider does not have a negotiated agreement with Premera, so Jakob would pay the full \$115. If the allowable charge for the out-of-network provider is also \$100, then only that \$100 amount would apply to Jakob's deductible.

Example

Mimi needs to see a podiatrist. The visit costs \$125. Mimi has met the deductible, so will pay just \$10 for the visit if an in-network provider is used with a \$100 allowable charge (\$100 x 10% coinsurance). If Mimi visits an out-of-network provider for whom the allowable charge is also \$100, Mimi would pay \$55: 30% of the \$100 Premera allowable charge (\$100 x 30% coinsurance = \$30) Plus, the difference between the out-of-network provider's bill and the allowable charge (\$125-\$100=\$25)

Example

Kunji sees a doctor about an ear infection. The provider visit costs \$175, and the allowable charge is \$150. Kunji has met the out-of-pocket maximum, so will pay nothing if the provider is in-network.
If Kunji visits an out-of-network provider for whom the allowable charge is also \$150, Kunji will pay \$25, the difference between the out-of-network provider's bill and the allowable charge (\$175-\$150=\$25)

Expenses covered at 100% and NOT applied to the deductible or coinsurance maximum

The following services are covered by the plan at 100% with in-network providers and do not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum.

- Preventive care
- Care received through the [Spring Health employee assistance program](#)

Certain other expenses are your responsibility to pay and do not count toward the annual deductible or coinsurance maximum. They include:

- Expenses incurred while the member was not covered under the Plan
- Expenses for services, supplies, settings, or providers that are not covered under the Plan
- Expenses in excess of annual or lifetime benefit maximums that apply to certain plan benefits
- Amounts for out-of-network care in excess of the allowable charge for the service or supply
- Coinsurance for services covered under the [Weight Management program](#)

Additionally, charges for medical services received during business travel that are applied to the deductible or coinsurance are not reimbursable business expenses.

Out-of-network care with in-network coverage

You may seek out-of-network care and receive in-network coverage levels in the following situations:

Emergency care	Benefits are provided regardless of network status	Go to the nearest emergency facility
You cannot find the provider specialty that you need in the Premera network	If the Premera network does not include a provider specialty (such as a speech therapist) anywhere in your state, treatment at out-of-network providers may be paid at the in-network level	To confirm this coverage is available, and the length of available coverage extension, contact Premera at (800) 676-1411
Your provider's contract with Premera is ending	If you are receiving ongoing treatment for certain serious and complex medical conditions or illnesses, or pregnancy, are undergoing institutional or inpatient care, or are scheduled for nonelective surgery, you may be	To confirm this continued in-network coverage is available, and the length of the available in-network coverage extension, contact Premera at (800) 676-1411 prior to the end of your provider's contract with Premera

eligible to continue to receive in-network benefits for the current course of treatment, for up to 90 days.

Annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums

There is no overall annual or lifetime maximum in the Hawaii-Only Plan. However, annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums apply to certain benefits. Review the [What the plan covers](#) section for details on annual, lifetime, and other benefit maximums.



A **lifetime benefit maximum** is the most a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.
An annual or other benefit maximum is the most a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member for services within a specified time period. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Example

There is a \$6,000 weight management program benefit maximum for the duration of the member’s continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft’s Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options.

Example

There is a \$10,000 hearing hardware maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft’s Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options.

Utilization Management

All benefits under this plan are limited to covered services that are medically necessary and as set forth under Plan Benefits. Premera or its designee may review a member’s medical records for the purpose of verifying delivery and coverage of services and items. Based on a prospective, concurrent, or retrospective review, Premera may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not medically necessary or do not meet all criteria specified in this SPD. Such determination shall be based on established clinical criteria as described in Premera’s medical policies. The medical policies are on Premera’s website. You or your provider may review them at [premera.com](#). You or your provider may also request a copy of the criteria used to make a medical necessity decision for a particular condition or procedure. To obtain this information by mail, send your request to Medical Policies Coordinator, 7001 220th Street SW MS 438, Mountlake Terrace, WA 98043-2160.

Premera will not deny coverage retroactively for services it has previously authorized and that have already been provided to the member except in the case of fraud or an intentional misrepresentation of a material fact.

What the plan covers

The tables below summarize what the Hawaii-Only Plan covers, including what the plan pays for in-network and out-of-network care.



Services and supplies must be medically necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#).



CTRL+Click on the benefits below to access more information.

Common benefits

These are the most commonly used benefits in the Hawaii-Only Plan.

Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Preventive Care Including well-child care through age 18, routine gynecological exams, immunizations and preventive prescription drugs (See the Preventive Care Services list and Preventive Drug list)	Preventive services: 100% Preventive prescription drugs: 100%	Preventive services: 70% of allowable charges after deductible; well-child care through age 6 covered at 100% Preventive prescription drugs: 100%
Prescription drugs Including brand-name preventive with available generic equivalent (see the Hawaii-Only Plan Drug Formulary and preventive care above)	90% after deductible	90% after deductible* *Home delivery and Specialty medications are not covered.
Physician services Including specialists and second surgical opinions rendered in the office, hospital, or other medical facility	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Diagnostic Services Benefits are provided for diagnostic services (including lab and imaging services) for health conditions or symptoms.	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Hospital inpatient care Including semi-private room and board, anesthesia, supporting services, testing, supplies, and intensive or coronary care	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible

Common benefits		
These are the most commonly used benefits in the Hawaii-Only Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Hospital outpatient care/ambulatory surgical care center Including minor surgery, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia, and pre-admission testing	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Urgent care	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Rehabilitation – Physical, Occupational and Speech Therapies	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Contraception Contraceptive devices and injections administered by a physician and prescription forms of contraception.	100%	100%
Maternity care (Other than hospital inpatient or outpatient care)	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Family Health and Reproductive Support	Free virtual care and on-demand support (through Maven Clinic) for navigating family planning, parenting, perimenopause, and menopause.	Not applicable
Mental health counseling, mental health inpatient and outpatient services, Attention Deficit Disorder, and chemical dependency treatment	Outpatient services through Spring Health, administrator of the employee assistance program : 100% of 24 sessions per calendar year	Not applicable
	90% after deductible for inpatient and outpatient services	90% of allowable charges, after deductible for inpatient and outpatient services

Other benefits		
The Hawaii-Only Plan also covers these additional benefits.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Ambulance (Ground or Water)	90% after deductible	90% after deductible
Air Ambulance	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	Combined 24-visit limit per member per calendar year	
Diabetes health education	100%	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Emergency room care and professional services	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Hearing care and hardware	Exams: 90% after deductible	Exams: 70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	Hardware: 90% after deductible; \$10,000 maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options	
Home health care	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Hospice care	90% after deductible	90% after deductible
Medical equipment and supplies	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Nutritional therapy	100%	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	First 12 visits per member per calendar year, calendar year visit limit waived for nutritional therapy for a diagnosed eating disorder or diabetes.	
Skilled nursing facility	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
	120-day limit per member per calendar year	
Surgical weight loss treatment Covered when criteria listed in the Premera Medical Policy on Surgery for Morbid Obesity are met	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible

Other benefits

The Hawaii-Only Plan also covers these additional benefits.

Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Transplants	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
Vision therapy	90% after deductible	70% of allowable charges, after deductible
32-visit maximum, per member, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options		

Specialized benefits

Microsoft provides these unique benefits to you through the Hawaii-Only Plan.

Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage (may be subject to balance billing)
Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible
Fertility	90% after deductible for coverage, within the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network, of generally two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, KFHPWA health plan options and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy	Not applicable
Gender Affirming services	90% after deductible	90% of allowable charges, after deductible

Weight Management program Including comprehensive and clinically based weight management programs approved by Premera for the treatment of obesity	80% of charges up to a \$6,000 maximum for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options. Deductible and coinsurance maximum do not apply. The 20% coinsurance you pay will not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum and will continue after the deductible and coinsurance are met.	Not applicable
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Plan benefits



The following pages provide details on what the plan covers. The plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), including the requirement of medical necessity, apply to these benefits.

24-Hour Nurse Line

The Microsoft 24-Hour Nurse Line is a confidential health-care information service for you and your dependents. The Nurse Line is available 24 hours a day, seven days a week. It provides useful, easy-to-understand health-care information that will help you to make appropriate health-care decisions.

The 24-Hour Nurse Line cannot diagnose illnesses, prescribe treatment, or give medical advice, but they can do the following:

- Provide information, coaching, and support regarding a wide range of health issues, including:
 - Aches and pains
 - Diabetes
 - High blood pressure
 - Illnesses and infections
 - Infant care
 - Immunizations
- Provide information about Microsoft-sponsored health programs such as:
 - Disability leave
 - Ergonomic assistance
 - On-site flu shots
 - On-site mammogram screenings
 - Smoking cessation
 - Weight management
- Offer suggestions about appropriate next steps or available resources.

The average call to the 24-Hour Nurse Line lasts approximately five minutes, so that you can obtain information quickly and can move on to the next step, as advised by the 24-Hour Nurse Line nurse.

The 24-Hour Nurse Line is a service provided by Premera Blue Cross. All Microsoft covered employees and their dependents can access the 24-Hour Nurse Line. **The 24-Hour Nurse Line cannot be accessed while traveling outside of the United States.**

Accessing the 24-Hour Nurse Line

The toll-free phone number for the 24-Hour Nurse Line is a consolidated phone line. From this one number, Microsoft covered employees and their dependents can access several health-care services, such as the 24-Hour Nurse Line staff of nurses, a professional counselor with the Microsoft Counseling, Assistance, Referral and Education Services (CARES) Employee Assistance Program and health-care coverage information. When you call, listen carefully to the entire greeting before you make your selection.



You can reach an experienced, registered nurse 24 hours a day, seven days a week by calling one of the following options:

- (800) 676-1411
- For deaf or hard-of-hearing access (TTY), call (800) 676-1411 then provide the number 711

Ambulance

Ground or Water:

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Air:

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers licensed surface (ground or water) and air ambulance transportation to the nearest medical facility equipped to treat the condition when any other mode of transportation would endanger the member's health or safety. This benefit is limited to the member that requires transportation.

For air ambulance services, please see [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) (above) for special rules that apply to out-of-network air ambulance services.

Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers behavioral interventions based on the principles of Applied Behavioral Analysis (ABA) through eligible providers.

Who is eligible

This benefit is available for members who are diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder (*Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, 5th Edition / DSM-5*), or with any of the following Pervasive

Developmental Disorders (*International Classification of Diseases, 10th Revision, Clinical Modification / ICD-10-CM*):

- Autistic Disorder
- Childhood Disintegrative Disorder
- Asperger's Syndrome
- Rett's Syndrome
- Other Pervasive Development Disorder/Atypical Autism
- Pervasive Developmental Disorder unspecified

Eligible providers

Licensed providers — Medical doctors (MD); doctors of osteopathic medicine (DO); nurse practitioners (NP, ANP, ARNP, etc.); and master's-level or above mental health clinicians and occupational, physical, and speech therapists; provided that they are providing the ABA services within the scope of their practice and licensure.

Board Certified Behavioral Analysts — BCBAs are certified by the Behavior Analyst Certification Board. These providers have master's or doctoral degrees. For ABA services, typically a BCBA functions as a "Program Manager." The Program Manager conducts behavioral assessments, including functional analyses, and provides behavior analytic interpretations of the results. The Program Manager also designs and periodically reviews behavior analytic interventions (program development and treatment planning) and may supervise Therapy Assistants. Therapy Assistant services must be billed by the Program Manager.

Covered services

Services must be ordered by the member's treating physician to be covered. Program Manager benefits are available for time used to evaluate the member and document findings and progress reports, and to create and update treatment plans; and time used to train and evaluate the work of the Therapy Assistants working directly with the member to implement the treatment plan.

In most cases, Therapy Assistants will provide the implementation portion of the treatment plan. Therapy Assistant time may be covered for face-to-face, in-person or virtual visits with the member to perform the tasks described in the treatment plan and to document outcomes, and for time to meet with the Program Manager for training and to discuss treatment plan issues. Therapy Assistant services that are billed by a Program Manager will be paid at the Therapy Assistant rate.

ABA services are not covered for the following:

- Babysitting or doing household chores
- Time spent under the care of any other professional
- Travel time
- Home schooling in academics or other academic tutoring
- Activity therapy, such as music, dance or art therapies

Out of network providers

You may be billed for charges assessed above the allowable charges since these providers have not agreed to offer discounts to members covered by this plan. Any amounts you pay for charges in excess of

allowable charges will not count towards satisfying any deductible requirements, or the coinsurance maximum that applies under this plan.



The **allowable charge** is defined differently for in-network and out-of-network providers. For in-network providers, the allowable charge is the negotiated amount that the provider has agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. For out-of-network providers, the allowable charge is the lowest of three amounts, as outlined in the definition of "allowable charge" in the Glossary. If you choose to use out-of-network providers, you may be responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges.

Additional exclusions and limitations for autism/ABA therapy

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- This benefit is not provided for rehabilitation services (which apply under the [rehabilitation](#) benefit) or mental health services (which apply under the [mental health and chemical dependency](#) benefit)
- Benefits for services provided by volunteers, childcare providers, family members and benefits paid for by state, local and Federal agencies will not be covered. Volunteer services or services provided by a family member of the child receiving the services by or through a school, books and other training aids will also not be covered.
- Other unspecified developmental disorders or delays, or any other delay or disorder in a child's motor, speech, cognitive, or social development are not covered under this benefit
- This benefit covers only the allowable fees for eligible services performed by the provider and those providing interventions based on principles of ABA and/or related structured behavioral programs under the supervision of the provider. Other expenses associated with providing the treatment, such as the tuition, program fees, travel, meals, and lodging of the provider, expenses of those working under the provider's supervision, the member, and their family members will not be covered.

Cancer Support (Personalized by Thyme Care)

Microsoft provides access to Thyme Care at no cost to all employees and their eligible dependents aged 18 and older with a suspected or confirmed cancer diagnosis who are covered under a Microsoft U.S. Premera health plan. Thyme Care is a 24/7 evidence-based virtual cancer advocacy and navigation program offering individualized support in-between visits with your oncologist.

If you have cancer, or are caring for someone with cancer, Thyme Care provides:

- **24/7 access:** A Thyme Care expert is available anytime through confidential calls. You can also use Thyme Care Connect or text them for support with your questions or concerns.
- **On-demand nurse support:** Whether you're concerned about potential side effects, need help understanding test results or medications, or simply want more guidance. Thyme Care can translate what the doctors are telling you and provide information to help plan for the road ahead.

- **Collaborative care focused on you:** Thyme Care takes care of your needs between visits and keeps your doctors and care teams updated, so you can rest assured that all the details are connected and nothing gets lost.
- **Support beyond the clinic:** Get connected to the support and services you need. These may include financial help, transportation, in-home care, food assistance or community groups dedicated to supporting cancer patients.
- **Evidence-based resources:** Receive clinically informed content tailored to you with trusted information and expert tips on preparing for treatment, handling worries, talking to doctors, strategies for improving your sleep, exercise routine, and emotional well-being.
- **Support for life after cancer treatment:** Regular check-ins provide tips on ongoing care and helpful wellness information, including sleep, nutrition, exercise, mindfulness, and getting back to normal.

Navigate cancer with confidence. With Thyme Care, you can:

- Learn about your diagnosis and treatment options
- Address urgent concerns and unexpected challenges
- Manage symptoms and side effects
- Get emotional and mental health support
- Identify financial assistance and get help with insurance navigation
- Find in-network doctors or get help seeking a second opinion
- Connect with other helpful Microsoft benefits

To enroll:

Visit thymecare.com/Microsoft and click “Enroll Now” then follow the steps to get started.

If you have any issues or questions, call the Thyme Care team at 1-833-849-6300, and they can help you set up your account.

Thyme Care does not diagnose oncologic conditions or provide cancer-directed therapies, treatments, or prescription of medications.

Thyme Care will not share your medical records or medical information with anyone, including Microsoft or your health plan, unless you specifically authorize such disclosure.

Chemotherapy and Radiation Therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers the following services:

- Outpatient chemotherapy and radiation therapy services, including proton beam radiation therapy when medically necessary
- FDA approved scalp cooling devices (such as DigniCap and Paxman Scalp Cooling System) may be considered medically necessary when used during chemotherapy to prevent hair loss.

- Supplies, solutions and drugs (See the [Prescription Drugs](#) benefit for oral chemotherapy drugs)

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Childbirth / Maternity Classes

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers childbirth and pregnancy educational classes, including pre-pregnancy planning, pregnancy, childbirth and Lamaze, breastfeeding and infant education classes. The benefit is for covered employees and dependents only, although a spouse/domestic partner not covered on the medical plan can attend with the covered individual.

Additional exclusions and limitations for childbirth / maternity classes

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), exercise classes, such as maternity yoga, are excluded from this benefit.

Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 24 visits per member per calendar year chiropractic, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy (combined)

This benefit (1) covers chiropractic service from a licensed chiropractor or other provider licensed to perform chiropractic services, (2) acupuncture services provided when medically necessary to relieve pain or to treat a covered illness, injury, or condition from a licensed acupuncturist or other provider licensed to perform acupuncture, and (3) medical massage therapy from a provider licensed to perform medical massage therapy, with a physician's prescription. To be covered, these services must be rendered to restore or improve a previously normal physical function and delivered within the provider's scope of practice guidelines.

These covered services must be medically necessary and will be covered only when the provider is providing the service within the scope of their state license.

These covered services (chiropractic services, acupuncture, medical massage therapy) will accrue cumulatively toward the 24-visit annual maximum. For example, if you visit a chiropractor for covered services 20 times in a calendar year, you will have four visits available for covered medical massage and/or acupuncture services in that calendar year. Covered Massage Therapy services are limited to a maximum of one hour per day.

Clinical Trials

This plan covers the routine costs of a qualified clinical trial. Routine costs are the medically necessary care that is normally covered under this plan for a member who is not enrolled in a clinical trial. The trial must be appropriate for the health condition according to the trial protocol and participating provider or information submitted by the member, and the member must be enrolled in the trial at the time of treatment for which coverage is requested.

Benefits are based on the type of service received. For example, benefits for an office visit are covered under the Professional Visits and Services benefit and lab tests are covered under the Diagnostic Services benefit.

A qualified clinical trial is a phase I, II, III or IV clinical trial that is conducted on the prevention, detection or treatment of cancer or other life-threatening diseases or conditions. The trial must also be funded or approved by a federal body, such as the National Institutes of Health (NIH), the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention; the Agency for Health Care Research and Quality; the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services; a cooperative group or center of any of the above entities or the Department of Defense (DOD) or the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA); the VA, DOD, and Department of Energy if peer-reviewed and approved as per the Secretary of HHS; or a qualified private research entity that meets the standards for NIH support grant eligibility.

Routine patient costs in connection with a "clinical trial" does not include expenses for:

- Costs for treatment that are not primarily for the care of the patient (such as lab tests performed solely to collect data for the trial)
- The investigational item, device or service itself
- A service that is clearly not consistent with widely accepted and established standards of care for a particular condition

Those interested in this coverage are encouraged to contact customer service at 800-676-1411 before enrolling in a clinical trial. Customer service can help the member or provider verify that the clinical trial is a qualified clinical trial.

Contraception

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100%

This benefit covers FDA-approved contraceptive devices and injections for contraceptive purposes for women when prescribed by a physician. Included are diaphragms, IUDs, and Depo Provera injections.

Removal of contraceptive devices by a physician is also covered. This benefit also covers office visits and consultations related to contraception management.

All FDA-approved generic birth control medications are covered under the [prescription drug](#) benefit at 100%.

Dental services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers certain services from a dental provider that would otherwise be covered by this plan if performed by a physician, as long as these services are provided within the scope of the dental provider's license.



Review the [Dental plan](#) section for information on your dental benefits.

Covered services

This benefit covers treatment of serious dental issues, such as a fractured jaw, excision of a tumor or cyst of the mouth, and incision or drainage of an abscess or cyst of the mouth, when not part of the dentition (gums, teeth, teeth supporting structure).

Hospital or outpatient facility fees and skilled observation for anesthesia administration related to dental treatments may be covered by the medical benefit when the following criteria are met.

Dental treatment in a hospital or outpatient facility is required because of any of the following:

- A physician has determined that the member's medical condition would place them at undue risk if the dental treatment were performed in a dental office. Some examples, though not all inclusive, are:
 - Cardiac conditions
 - Chronic respiratory disease, such as emphysema
 - Hemophilia or other blood disease
 - History of allergy to local anesthesia
 - Severe anemia
 - Severe hypertension
 - Uncontrolled diabetes
- The severity of the dental condition prevents treatment in the dental office setting.
- General anesthesia in a dental office, hospital or outpatient facility is required because of any of the following:
 - The member has a physical or mental disability and cannot be managed with local anesthesia, intravenous (IV) or non-intravenous conscious sedation.
 - The member has tried and failed other means of patient management (including premedication) in the office setting.
 - Other means of patient management are contraindicated for the member.

Orthodontia services may be eligible for payment under the medical plan for dependents born with cleft/lip palate or other severe craniofacial anomalies. To qualify for benefits the condition must meet medically necessary criteria in Premera's medical policy addressing orthodontia for repair of cleft palate and other severe congenital anomalies.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for dental services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Services or supplies not medically necessary for diagnosis, care, or treatment of a disease, illness, or injury
- Dental care and services of a dentist, except as provided in the dental benefit. Hospital and physician services in support of all other dental care are covered only if the care meets two conditions: (1) adequate dental treatment cannot be rendered without the use of the hospital, and (2) the member has a health problem that makes it medically necessary to do the dental work at the hospital.
- Dental services for accidental injuries to the oral and maxillofacial region are covered only when the needed corrective dental repairs are certified in writing by the dental care provider as dentally necessary and are directly related to the accidental injury. Covered dental services include the repair or replacement of existing crowns, inlays, onlays, bridgework, and dentures. The treatment must be started within one year from the date of the accident.
- Benefits for services or supplies for treatment of temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction or myofascial pain dysfunction (MPD); benefits may be available under the Microsoft temporomandibular dysfunction benefit
- The medical plan does not cover any other preventive or restorative dental procedures, regardless of origin of condition

Teladoc Health Condition Management – Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs and Diabetes health education

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers outpatient self-management training and education for diabetes, including medical nutritional therapy by a dietitian or nutritionist with expertise in diabetes.

Teladoc Health Condition Management - Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: n/a

Teladoc Health Condition Management for Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Hypertension Programs provide monitoring and health management support to individuals within the programs. If you qualify and enroll in any of the programs, you will receive the following benefits:

Diabetes Management

For members 13 and older who have Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A blood glucose meter that uses cellular technology to automatically upload blood sugar readings to a personal online account.
- A lancing device and unlimited lancets at no cost to you.
- Unlimited test strips for this meter at no cost to you. You can reorder test strips using the meter or online. The strips will be sent to you directly.
- Real-time feedback and tips based on your blood sugar readings that can help keep your levels within a healthy range.
- Coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail, or the program manager's mobile app.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Diabetes Prevention

For members 18 and older who meet pre-diabetes criteria followed by the Centers for Disease Control. The program's duration is 12 months, with an additional 12 months of access for maintenance. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A cellular-connected scale that uploads readings to a personal online account.
- Real-time tips and personalized feedback on health, nutrition or lifestyle changes to help you learn and improve.
- Unlimited coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail or the mobile app.
- Complete CDC-recognized weight management curriculum based on in-app content and online resources.
- Periodic review of plan, self-monitoring data, and feedback from expert coach.
- Experiential learning missions covering nutrition, activity, motivation, sleep, and stress management.

- A mobile app, and device for tracking weight, steps, and achievement of health goals for food and physical activity.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Hypertension

For members 18 and older who have hypertension. If you qualify and join the program, you will get:

- A cellular-enabled blood pressure cuff that uploads blood pressure readings to a personal online account.
- Real-time tips and personalized feedback based on your blood pressure readings that can help keep your pressure within a healthy range.
- Unlimited coaching and support via phone, text, e-mail, or the mobile app. Access to online information.
- Digital tools that support your mental health.

Additional support

If you are 18 and older who qualify for more than one of the above programs you may be eligible for additional tools and devices to help you live healthier:

- For members with hypertension, a connected blood pressure monitors to help track your numbers.
- Members who qualify for the Diabetes Prevention or the Weight Loss Program may receive a smart scale

These programs are available to you and your eligible dependents who qualify. The full cost of these programs will be covered by the Plan. To learn more, see if you qualify and enroll, go to teladohealth.com/microsoft-ccm, or call Premera customer service.

Diagnostic Services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Benefits are provided for diagnostic services (including lab and imaging services) for health conditions or symptoms. Included in the coverage are charges for the test or scan itself, and charges to interpret the results. Some examples of what's covered under this benefit are:

- Diagnostic imaging and scans (including x-ray, MRI, PET, CAT and EKGs)
- Services that are medically necessary to diagnose infertility
- Laboratory services
- Pathology tests

Diagnostic surgeries, including scope insertion procedures, can only be covered under the Surgical Services benefit.



Prior authorization is strongly recommended for some diagnostic services. Some examples of these include but are not limited to: Genetic Testing, CAT scan, and MRI. Have your provider contact Premera to see if your service needs this pre-service review.

Emergency room care and professional services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers hospital emergency room and provider charges for an emergent condition—regardless of the network status—including related services and supplies, such as diagnostic imaging (including X-ray) and laboratory services, and surgical dressings and drugs furnished by and used while at the hospital.

Following discharge from the emergency room or hospital, eligible services will be paid based on the contracting status of the provider.

Regardless of network status, after being treated in the emergency department for an emergent condition and admitted to a hospital inpatient care (as defined by the [hospital inpatient care](#) benefit), along with provider charges, will be covered at the in-network level.

For emergency substance abuse treatment, see the [mental health and chemical dependency](#) benefit.

Please see the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

Hearing care and hardware

Hearing exams and testing

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers one routine hearing examination and one routine hearing test (or screening) per member each calendar year.

Hearing exam services include:

- Examination of the inner ear and exterior of the ear
- Observation and evaluation of hearing, such as whispered voice and tuning fork
- Case history and recommendations
- The use of calibrated equipment

Hearing hardware

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Limit: up to \$10,000 maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling calendar) years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options

This benefit covers one FDA approved hearing hardware (either an over-the-counter or prescribed hearing aid) up to a maximum benefit of \$10,000 per member every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of

continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options. Before obtaining a prescribed hearing aid, you must be examined by a licensed physician (M.D. or D.O.) or audiologist (CCC-A or CCC-MSPA).

Benefits cover the following:

- The hearing aid(s) (monaural or binaural) prescribed as a result of an exam or an FDA approved over-the-counter hearing aid(s) (monaural or binuarl)
- Ear mold(s)
- Hearing aid rental while the primary unit is being repaired
- The initial batteries, cords, and other necessary ancillary equipment
- A follow-up consultation within 30 days following delivery of the prescribed hearing aid with either the prescribing physician or audiologist
- Repairs, servicing, and alteration of hearing aid equipment

Additional exclusions and limitations for hearing care and hardware

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Hearing aids purchased before your effective date of coverage under this plan
- A prescription or over-the-counter hearing aid, for any reason, more often than once in a period of three consecutive calendar years during which you are continuously enrolled in a Premera-administered health plan option
- Batteries or other ancillary equipment other than that obtained upon purchase of the hearing aid
- A prescription hearing aid that exceeds the specifications prescribed for correction of hearing loss
- Expenses incurred after your coverage ends under this plan unless a prescribed hearing aid was ordered before that date and was delivered within 90 days after the date your coverage ended
- Charges in excess of this benefit; these expenses are also not eligible for coverage under other benefits of this plan

Home health care and Nursing care

In-home care, other than Hospice Care and Respite Care (non-hospice), can be broken into two categories for purposes of benefit coverage:

Benefit	Description	Care Duration	Coverage
Home health care	Short-duration, intermittent care to complete specific tasks by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, social worker (MSW) working for home health agency, or a certified respiratory therapist.	The length of home health care visits varies depending on the tasks to be accomplished, but typically these visits last up to 2 hours.	In-network: 90%, deductible applies Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Benefit	Description	Care Duration	Coverage
Nursing care	Longer-duration, skilled hourly nursing care in the home by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN).	Generally needed for more than 4 hours per day.	In-network: 90%, deductible applies Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Read below for additional in-home care coverage details.

Home health care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers home visits for short-duration, intermittent care to complete specific tasks by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, social worker (MSW) working for home health agency, or a certified respiratory therapist. The length of home health care visits varies depending on the tasks to be accomplished, but typically these visits last up to 2 hours. The benefit includes the cost of a home health aide when acting under the direct supervision of one of the before-mentioned therapists and while performing services specifically ordered by the doctor in the treatment plan. The benefit also includes disposable medical supplies and eligible medication prescribed by a physician when provided by the home health care agency.



Intermittent care is care provided due to the medically predictable recurring need for skilled home health care services.

Home health care services provided and billed by a Medicare-approved or state-licensed home health care agency for treatment of an illness or injury are covered. The services must be part of a formal written treatment plan prescribed by your doctor.

One postpartum home health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center will be eligible for coverage.

Additional exclusions and limitations for home health care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Normal living expenses, such as food, clothing, and household supplies; housekeeping services, except for those of a home health aide as prescribed by the plan of care; and transportation services
- Materials such as handrails and ramps
- Services performed by family members and volunteer workers
- Psychiatric care
- Unnecessary and inappropriate services
- Maintenance or [custodial care](#)

- Diversional therapy
- Services or supplies not included in the written treatment plan
- Over-the-counter drugs, solutions, and nutritional supplements
- Dietary assistance, such as Meals on Wheels
- Services provided to someone other than the ill or injured enrollee

Nursing care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

This benefit covers longer-duration, skilled hourly nursing care in the home by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN) working under a licensed home health agency. Skilled hourly nursing care is provided in lieu of hospitalization and generally is needed for more than 4 hours per day. The nurse who is providing the care cannot be a permanent resident in the member's home.



Skilled nursing care is provided by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN) and the care must require the technical proficiency, scientific skills, and knowledge of an RN or LPN. The need for skilled nursing is determined by the condition of the patient, the nature of the services required, and the complexity or technical aspects of the services provided. Nursing care is not skilled simply because an RN or LPN delivers it or because a physician orders it.

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for nursing care to determine if coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Hospice care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

The hospice care benefit allows a terminally ill member to remain at home or to use the services of a hospice center instead of using hospital inpatient services. The plan covers services provided through a state-licensed hospice or other hospice program that meets the standards of the National Hospice and Palliative Care Organization. The services must be part of a written treatment plan prescribed by a licensed physician.

This benefit covers visits for intermittent care by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN), a licensed physical or occupational therapist, a certified speech therapist, a certified respiratory therapist or a Master of Social Work. Also included is the cost of a home health aide who acts under the direct supervision of one of the before-mentioned therapists and who is performing services specifically ordered by the member's doctor in the treatment plan. The benefit also includes disposable medical supplies and medications prescribed by the physician, and the rental of durable medical equipment.

In addition, the hospice care benefit covers care in a hospice, and up to 672 hours of respite care for each six-month period of hospice care. The respite care provision allows family members of the terminally ill patient an opportunity to recover from the emotionally and physically demanding tasks of caring for the patient.



Hospice care is a coordinated program of palliative and supportive care for dying members by an interdisciplinary team of professionals and volunteers centering primarily in the member's home.

Intermittent care is care provided due to the medically predictable recurring need for skilled home health care services.

Respite care is continuing to provide care in the temporary absence of the member's primary caregiver or caregivers.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospice care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Bereavement or pastoral counseling
- Financial or legal counseling, including real-estate planning or drafting of a will
- Funeral arrangements
- Diversional therapy
- Services that are not related solely to the member, such as transportation, house cleaning, or sitter services

Hospital inpatient care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers the following inpatient medical and surgical services:

- Room and board, including general duty nursing and special diets
- Use of an intensive care or coronary care unit equipped and operated according to generally recognized hospital standards
- Operating room, surgical supplies, hospital anesthesia services and supplies, drugs, dressings, equipment, and oxygen
- Diagnostic and therapeutic services
- Blood, blood derivatives, and their administration

Regardless of network status, after being treated in the emergency department for an emergent condition and admitted to a hospital, inpatient care (as defined by the hospital inpatient care benefit), along with provider charges for that emergent condition, will be covered at the in-network level.

Please see [the Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency and non-emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

For substance abuse treatment, see the [mental health and chemical dependency](#) benefit.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospital inpatient care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Hospital admissions for diagnostic purposes only, unless the services cannot be provided without the use of inpatient hospital facilities, or unless the member's medical condition makes inpatient care medically necessary
- Any days of inpatient care that exceed the length of stay required to treat the member's condition

Hospital outpatient care and ambulatory surgical center care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers operating, procedure, and recovery rooms; plus, services and supplies, such as diagnostic imaging (including X-ray) and laboratory services, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia and its administration, surgical dressings and drugs, furnished by and used while at the hospital or ambulatory surgical center.

Please see [the Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency and non-emergency services provided by an out-of-network provider.

Fertility

In-network: 90% after deductible for coverage, within the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network

Out-of-network: not applicable

Limit: Up to two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Microsoft health plan options, and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy, subject to certain restrictions described below



Members must contact their **Progyny Patient Care Advocate** at (888) 203-5066 to confirm eligibility and utilize a Progyny Network Provider to access the benefit.

This benefit covers services to assist in achieving a pregnancy for Microsoft employees and their enrolled spouse/domestic partner regardless of reason or origin of condition.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit allows for:

- Two (2) Smart Cycles per household, with an additional Smart Cycle available if the first two do not result in a successful pregnancy, for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options, subject to the restrictions described below for certain members who received fertility benefits of less than \$15,000 under the Health Savings Plan prior to 2018. Coverage is subject to all applicable plan copay, coinsurance, and deductible requirements.
- One (1) Smart Cycle per household, with an additional Smart Cycle available if the first does not result in a successful pregnancy, for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options, for members who (1) have been enrolled continuously in one or more Premera-administered health plan options (such as the Health Savings Plan) since before 2018, and (2) incurred \$15,000 or more in fertility benefits under the Plan during such continuous enrollment period prior to 2018. Coverage is subject to all applicable plan copay, coinsurance, and deductible requirements.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit may be used to receive full coverage for the following treatments and procedures:

- Two consultations per calendar year
- Diagnostic testing
- Transvaginal ultrasounds
- Intrauterine insemination (also known as artificial insemination)
- In vitro fertilization (IVF)
- Gamete intra-fallopian transplant (GIFT)
- Intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI)
- Pre-implantation genetic screening (PGS)
- Pre-implantation genetic diagnosis (PGD)
- Embryo assessment and transfer
- Services used to preserve fertility such as cryopreservation of eggs, sperm and/or embryos. This includes oncofertility preservation.
- Up to four years of storage (egg, embryo, sperm) with annual renewal and eligibility verification
- Purchase of donor tissue (sperm, eggs) as follows:
 - Previously frozen donor sperm or donor oocytes (eggs) from a donor agency intended for the use and transfer into a covered female member (one egg cohort purchase constitutes one SMART Cycle, and one donor sperm purchase constitutes ¼ SMART Cycle). You will be required to pay for the donor sperm or oocytes out of pocket and submit the eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.
 - A fresh donor recipient cycle, whereby the egg donor undergoes an egg retrieval procedure at an in-network Progyny provider to allow for a fresh embryo transfer into a covered female member (one fresh donor recipient cycle constitutes one SMART Cycle). The treatment must occur at an in-network Progyny provider, or else you may be required to pay all expenses up front, out of pocket. If an in-network provider is not contracted for the fresh donor recipient cycle, Progyny will pursue a special case agreement. If a special case agreement request is denied, you will pay for the donor services out of pocket but may submit eligible charges, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.

Medication prescribed for fertility treatment will be fulfilled by a Progyny Rx specialty pharmacy and delivered next day to ensure accurate timing with treatment. All medications, compounds, ancillary medication and equipment required for treatment are included in the shipment of medications. Progyny Rx coverage also includes the UnPack It Call where a trained pharmacy clinician will explain drug administration and storage guidelines.

Additional exclusions and limitations for infertility

The following exclusions apply to this benefit:

- Fees paid to donors for their participation in any service
- Testing and treatment for potential surrogates that would not otherwise be covered for a member enrolled in the Plan
- Home ovulation prediction kits
- Services and supplies furnished for a dependent child (under age 26), except for oncofertility preservation due to cancer or medical treatments
- Services and supplies furnished by a provider outside the Progyny network, except as otherwise provided
- Fertility Services following a voluntary sterilization procedure

Maternity care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers maternity benefits provided for you, your enrolled spouse/domestic partner, and your eligible dependent children. Benefits are for maternity care in a hospital, alternative birthing center, or at home, including:

- Prenatal testing when required to diagnose conditions of the unborn child
- Normal deliveries and cesarean sections
- Services of a licensed nurse or midwife (non-medical services, such as non-medical services performed by a doula are not covered)
- Miscarriages and terminations of pregnancy
- Hospital nursery care for benefits-eligible infant while the mother is hospitalized and receiving benefits; services are covered under the hospital services benefit
- Male circumcision by a physician or mohel for a benefits-eligible dependent; services are covered under the physician services benefit
- One postpartum home health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center
- Home births include an allowance of up to \$500 for eligible supplies and/or equipment used for home delivery; for example, birthing packs, birthing tubs, monitoring devices, local anesthetics, and comfort aids. Services for the newborn including hospital services and professional services are covered under the hospital services and physician services benefit.

The [home health care](#) benefit covers one postpartum health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center.

Medical equipment and supplies (durable medical supplies)

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Covered services

This benefit covers charges for durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies (DME). Benefits cover rental or purchase (including shipping and handling fees) of DME for treatment of an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition. Rental equipment will not be reimbursed above the purchase price of the equipment. The Plan reserves the right to require a period of rental prior to covering the purchase of equipment. Benefits for DME purchases will be reduced by any prior Plan benefits for renting the same equipment, unless (and to the extent that) the Plan required such prior rental.

Allowed charges to repair or replace covered items are also covered due to a change in the injury, illness, disease, or medical condition, the growth of a child, or when worn out by normal use. Replacement is covered only if needed due to a change in the member's physical condition or if it is less costly to replace than to repair existing equipment or to rent similar equipment.

No more than one item of DME per year will be covered for the same or similar purpose, and in order to be covered the equipment and accessories to operate it must be:

- Made to withstand prolonged use
- Made for and mainly used in the treatment of an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition
- Suited for use in the home

This list of covered DME includes, but is not limited to:

- Braces
- Crutches
- Wheelchairs
- Wheelchair seat lift mechanism and/or a power seat elevation device when a member meets the applicable medical necessity requirements for a power wheelchair
- Prostheses
- Post-mastectomy bras/forms: Post-mastectomy bras are limited to two every six months (replacements within this 6-month period are covered when medically necessary due to a change in the member's condition)
- Cochlear Implants and associated supplies

- Foot orthotics (custom fitted shoe inserts) and therapeutic shoes (orthopedic), including fitting expenses, when prescribed by a physician for the condition of diabetes or for corrective purposes
- Wigs (up to \$2,000 per calendar year for alopecia caused by medical conditions or treatment for diseases)
- You may either purchase one over-the-counter breast pump or rent a hospital grade breast pump during a calendar year (one or the other, but not both), for up to the duration of breastfeeding. The pump must be for your own use. Replacement supplies may be purchased on an as needed basis. In-network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100%. Out-of-network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100% of allowable charge. Deductible does not apply. Batteries are not covered.
- Continuous glucose monitors and their supplies are covered at 100% of allowable charges. Deductible does not apply.

Vision hardware may be covered under the medical plan for certain medical conditions of the eye, including, but not limited to:

- Corneal ulcer/abrasion
- Bullous keratopathy
- Recurrent erosion of cornea
- Keratoconus
- Tear film insufficiency (dry-eye syndrome)
- Cataract surgery

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



A **prior authorization** is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Additional exclusions and limitations for medical equipment and supplies (durable medical supplies)

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following DME and supplies will not be covered by this plan when they are:

- Normally of use to persons who do not have an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition
- For use in altering air quality or temperature
- For exercise, training and use during participation in sports, recreation, or similar activities
- Equipment, such as whirlpools, portable whirlpool pumps, sauna baths, massage devices, overbed tables, elevators, vision aids, and telephone alert systems
- Special or extra-cost convenience items and/or features

- Structural modifications to your home and/or private vehicle
- Replacement of lost or stolen equipment or supplies
- Blood pressure cuffs or monitors (even if prescribed by a physician), unless otherwise provided in this SPD

Medical Foods

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This plan covers medically necessary medical foods used to supplement or replace a member's diet in order to treat inborn errors of metabolism. An example is phenylketonuria (PKU). Coverage includes medically necessary enteral formula prescribed by a physician or other provider to treat eosinophilic gastrointestinal associated disorder or other severe malabsorption disorder. Benefits are provided for all delivery methods.

Medical foods are formulated to be consumed or administered enterally under strict medical supervision. These foods generally provide most of a person's nutrition. Medical foods are designed to treat a specific problem that can be diagnosed by medical tests.

This benefit does not cover other oral nutrition or supplements not used to treat inborn errors of metabolism, even if a physician prescribes them. This includes specialized infant formulas and lactose-free foods.

Mental health counseling, mental health inpatient and outpatient services, Attention Deficit Disorder, and chemical dependency treatment

Inpatient and Outpatient:

- 100%, up to calendar year short-term counseling limits through Spring Health, administrator of the employee assistance program
- *In-network: 90%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

This benefit covers medically necessary treatment for:

- mental health conditions such as, but not limited to the diagnosis and treatment stress, anxiety, or depression, or other psychiatric disorders, eating disorders, attention deficit disorder (ADD), attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)
- chemical dependency such as substance use disorder and alcohol use disorder

To be covered, services must be furnished by an eligible provider.

All mental health and chemical dependency treatment must be medically necessary to be eligible for coverage.

Type of care	You will be covered as follows
Short-term counseling employee assistance program (EAP) as administered by Spring Health	No deductible applies 100% of 24 sessions per person per calendar year A visit includes each attendance of the provider to the member, regardless of the type of professional services rendered, and whether it might otherwise be termed consultation, treatment, or described in some other manner. For benefit calculation purposes, a typical mental health visit is considered one hour.
Inpatient and Outpatient benefits	In-network: 90%, deductible applies; out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Eligible providers

Eligible providers include:

- A facility licensed as a hospital or community mental health agency to provide mental health and/or substance abuse services
- A physician, psychiatrist, psychologist, or psychiatric nurse practitioner licensed to provide mental health or substance abuse services
- A master's level mental health provider licensed, registered, or certified as legally required to provide mental health services
- Any other provider or facility who is licensed or certified by the state in which the care is rendered and who is providing care within the scope of their license or certification

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for inpatient care and residential treatment centers to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. When an emergency admission occurs, notification to Premera within two days is also recommended. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for a prior authorization.



A **prior authorization** is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

The prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for mental health and chemical dependency

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Testing must be ordered by a physician for the purpose of diagnosing or medical management
- Smoking cessation programs or materials; (Microsoft provides a separate Smoking Cessation Program. Prescription drugs for smoking cessation are covered under the prescription drug benefit.)

- Services and supplies that are court-ordered, or are related to deferred prosecution, deferred or suspended sentencing, or driving rights, if those services are not deemed medically necessary
- Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.

Nutritional therapy

This benefit covers outpatient nutritional therapy visits with a dietitian, nutritional therapist or certified lactation consultant to manage a covered condition, illness or injury.

First 12 visits per member per calendar year regardless of the diagnosis or condition:

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

After the initial 12 visits per member (in the same calendar year) benefit coverage remains available for a covered condition, illness or injury (examples below) as follows:

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network 70% of allowable, deductible applies

Illnesses or conditions that would be eligible for this benefit include, but are not limited to:

- Hypertension
- Cardiac problems
- Feeding difficulties
- Gastric reflux disease

Nutritional therapy visits received in connection with a diagnosed eating disorder or diabetes is unlimited and will be covered at 100% of allowable charges.

Onsite Mammography Screening

Microsoft offers access to an onsite mammography screening in select Microsoft locations to employees and their spouse/domestic partners enrolled in a Microsoft Health Plan. The onsite mammography screening provides a multiple-view screening exam. At the discretion of the technologist performing the mammogram, additional views may be necessary to clarify imaging issues for the radiologist.

The onsite mammography screening program includes the onsite preventive screening mammogram exam only. Any additional or follow-up imaging or other services needed are considered diagnostic and will be covered as outlined in the diagnostic services benefit.

An onsite mammogram is not recommended if you have implants, a breast problem, are pregnant, or are breastfeeding. In those cases, you should consult with your doctor about obtaining an exam at an offsite breast center or other health care facility. Such an offsite exam would not be covered by the onsite mammography screening program but may be covered by the Plan's preventive or diagnostic services coverage, as applicable. As the onsite mammogram is a screening exam, the vendor is not able to provide

imaging for a breast problem such as a lump. If you have questions about mammogram screenings, talk with your primary care physician.

Who Provides the Mammograms?

In the Puget Sound area of Washington state, Mammograms are provided by Swedish Mobile Mammography Services (operated by Swedish Health Services). The mammography technologists are registered by the American Registry of Radiologic Technology, have advanced credentials in mammography, and are certified by the State of Washington. The interpreting physicians are employed by Radia, are board certified by the American College of Radiology, and specialize in breast imaging.

In other areas, Microsoft partners with local vendors who specialize in onsite mammography and have the appropriate equipment and licensure. To provide services onsite, there must be sufficient demand to fill a day of appointments and a local vendor who is qualified to provide the services. Onsite mammography events will be advertised for any locations where they are available.

When Do the Screenings Occur?

Periodically each year, usually during the fall.

Eligibility

US benefits-eligible employees and their spouse/domestic partner age 35 and over, who are enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan, are eligible to participate in onsite mammography screenings.

You are eligible to participate in the onsite screening even if you have had a routine mammogram in the past 12 months. However, you should talk with your primary care provider to determine the benefits and risks of having a second mammogram within a 12-month period. If you suspect you have a breast problem, such as a lump, you should see your primary care provider.

Women under the age of 35 are ineligible, unless they have written permission from their physician.



At some locations, women under age 35 will not be allowed to participate, even with written permission from their physician.

Dependent children (regardless of age), agency temporaries/external staff, international based employees, and any individuals who are not enrolled in medical coverage under the Plan are not eligible to participate.

Physician services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers:

- Medical and surgical services of a physician
- Urgent care visits at an urgent care facility
- Care via online and telephonic methods when medically appropriate:
 - Benefits for telemedicine are subject to standard office visit cost-shares and other provisions as stated in this booklet. Services must be medically necessary to treat a covered illness, injury or condition.

- Coverage for psychiatric conditions is medically appropriate for crisis and emergency evaluations or when the member is temporarily confined to bed for medical reasons only
- Biofeedback services for any condition covered by the medical benefit when provided by an eligible provider



An **Urgent care** visit is billed and covered at the same rate as an office visit with your regular physician and is a cost-effective option when you have an urgent need for care. Urgent care is the best option for treatment of a sudden illness, injury or condition that:

Requires prompt medical attention to avoid serious deterioration of the member's health

Does not require the level of care provided in the emergency room or a hospital

Cannot be postponed until the member's physician is available

A **Physician** is a state licensed:

Doctor of Medicine and Surgery (M.D.)

Doctor of Osteopathy (D.O.)

In addition, professional services provided by one of the following types of providers will be treated as physician services under this plan to the extent the provider is providing a service that is within the scope of their state license and providing service for which benefits are specified in this SPD and would be payable if the service were provided by a physician as defined above:

Chiropractor (D.C.)

Dentist (D.D.S. or D.M.D.)

Optometrist (O.D.)

Physician Assistant (P.A.)

Podiatrist (D.P.M.)

Psychologist (Ph.D.)

Advanced Registered Nurse Practitioner (A.R.N.P.)

Nurse (R.N.)

Naturopathic physician (N.D.)

Plastic and reconstructive surgery

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers services, supplies, and procedures for plastic or reconstructive surgery purposes, along with complications of these services, supplies, or procedures, for the following:

- Repair of a defect that is the direct result of an accidental injury, providing such repair is started within 12 months of the date of the accident
- Treatment for a congenital anomaly of a child
- Treatment of visible birth marks of a covered child
- All stages of reconstruction of the involved breast following a mastectomy, and surgery and reconstruction of the other breast to produce a symmetrical appearance.
- Correction of physical functional disorders. Benefits may include, but are not limited to, blepharoplasty or breast reduction.

The treatment plan for any of the above conditions must be prescribed by a physician.



A **congenital anomaly** is a marked difference from the normal structure of a body part that is physically evident from birth.

A **physical functional disorder** is a limitation from normal (or baseline level) of physical functioning that may include, but is not limited to, problems with ambulation, mobilization, communication, respiration, eating, swallowing, vision, facial expression, skin integrity, distortion of nearby body parts or obstruction of an orifice. The physical functional impairment can be due to structure, congenital deformity, pain, or other causes. Physical functional impairment excludes social, emotional and psychological impairment or potential impairment.

Prescription drugs

In-network: 90%, deductible applies, up to limits provided below

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies, up to limits provided below

This benefit covers most FDA-approved, medically necessary prescription drugs, when prescribed for the member's use outside of a medical facility and dispensed by a licensed pharmacist in a pharmacy licensed by the state in which the pharmacy is located. Also included in this benefit are injectable supplies.

Certain single-source brand and generic preventive drugs will be covered at 100% under the preventive care benefit and are not subject to the deductible. Brand-name preventive medications with an available generic equivalent will not be covered by the preventive care benefit. Review the preventive care benefit for more information.

Generic drug substitution

This plan encourages the use of appropriate generic drugs (as defined below). When available and indicated by the prescriber, a generic equivalent drug will be dispensed in place of a brand name drug. If your prescriber indicates that substituting a generic equivalent for the brand name drug is inappropriate, you'll be charged only the brand name cost share (as applicable). However, if the prescriber does not indicate that substituting a generic equivalent drug is inappropriate, and you request the brand name drug anyway, you'll be charged the difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent along with the applicable brand name cost-share. Note: The difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent will not apply to your deductible and/or coinsurance maximum. Even if you reach your deductible or coinsurance maximum, you will still be responsible for the full amount of the difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent.



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Brand-name prescriptions are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

Generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions because the patent has expired.

Prescription limits

Coverage	Up to a 90-day supply for generic maintenance medication; all others are up to a 30-day supply*	Up to 90-day supply* only when using Express Scripts Pharmacy Home Delivery	Up to a 30-day supply* Additional clinical support for members using specialty drugs
In-network pharmacies	Express scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf To find an Express Scripts retail pharmacy, call the Premera customer service team at (800) 676-1411	Express scripts pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf	Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy** will bill the plan on your behalf
Out-of-network pharmacies	You will need to submit a prescription reimbursement form, with your receipt, for reimbursement	Not covered	Not covered

* Unless the drug maker's packaging limits the supply in some other way.

** Contact Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy at (877) 223-6447 or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy at (800) 689-6592 to get started.

The dispensing limits (or days' supply) for drugs dispensed at retail and specialty pharmacies, and through the mail-order pharmacy benefit, are described in the above chart.

Members are allowed two retail grace fills for specialty drugs before being required to utilize Walgreen's Specialty Pharmacy or Accredo Specialty Pharmacy.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and
- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



Generic maintenance medications have a common indication for the treatment of a chronic disease (such as diabetes, high cholesterol, or hypertension). Indications are obtained from the product labeling. They are used for diseases when the duration of the therapy can reasonably be expected to exceed one year.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.



Premera provides a customer service team dedicated to Microsoft employees and their dependents. You can use this service by calling (800) 676-1411 with questions regarding:

- Status of mail order prescriptions
- Plan design, including which medications are covered or not covered
- Location of retail pharmacies

Covered drugs

This benefit covers the following FDA-approved items when dispensed by a licensed pharmacy for use outside of a medical facility. Certain drugs may need a prior authorization:

- Prescription drugs (Federal Legend Drugs as prescribed by a licensed provider). This benefit includes coverage for off-label use of FDA-approved drugs as provided under this plan's definition of prescription drug.
- Compounded medications are covered when the main ingredient is a covered prescription drug. Benefits are subject to standard supply limit.
- Inhalation spacer devices and peak flow meters
- Glucagon and allergy emergency kits
- Prescribed injectable medications for self-administration (such as insulin)
- Hypodermic needles, syringes, and alcohol swabs used for self-administered injectable prescription medications
- Disposable diabetic testing supplies, including test strips, testing agents, and lancets
- Prescription contraceptive drugs and devices (for example, oral drugs, diaphragms, and cervical caps)
- Human growth hormone
- Prescription drugs for smoking cessation
- Birth control medications
- Immunization agents and vaccines
- Impotence medications are limited to 15 pills at retail per 30 days: 45 pills at mail-order per 90 days.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is **required** to determine if coverage for a certain prescription drug is available before the prescription can be filled.

To determine if prior authorization is required for a particular drug, refer to the [formulary drug list](#), or either the member or the provider may contact Premera.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

In order for certain types of drugs to be covered, information from your doctor must be submitted that identifies the disease being treated and explains the role of the drug in the treatment plan to establish its medical necessity. If that information is made available prior to the prescription being filled, and it is determined that the drug is medically necessary, the prescription will be covered as described above. If

information for a drug in this category is not provided, you may pay for the prescription to be filled and submit the claim for consideration along with the clinical information. If it is determined that you do not meet medical necessity criteria needed for the drug to be eligible, you will not be reimbursed for the cost of the drug.

Benefits for some prescription drugs may be limited to one or more of the following:

- A set number of days' supply
- A specific drug or drug dose that is appropriate for a normal course of treatment
- A specific diagnosis
- Be under the care of an appropriate medical specialist
- Trying a generic drug or a specified brand name drug first

In making these determinations, Premera takes into consideration clinically evidence-based medical necessity criteria, recommendations of the manufacturer, the circumstances of the individual case, U.S. Food and Drug Administration guidelines, published medical literature and standard reference compendia.



For questions about your pharmacy benefits or quantity limits, contact Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411.

The table below provides information on how to submit information for a medical necessity review.

Drug	Information
Certain drugs require prior authorization. Examples include but are not limited to: rheumatoid arthritis, certain cancer treatment drugs, growth hormones, anti-depressants, corticosteroid nasal sprays, diabetes, migraine therapy, multiple sclerosis, sleeping disorders, weight loss drugs, and compound medications.	Have your provider call (888) 261-1756 to start or update the benefit review process for these or other drugs needing clinical review. If you would like to find out if your drug requires review, refer to the formulary drug list or call Premera Customer Services at (800) 676-1411.



Categories of drugs on this list may be added or deleted from time to time, based on factors including FDA-approval status, medical necessity, member safety, and best practices. If you have paid for a prescription of a drug in this category, you may appeal any denial of benefits for that drug through the appeals process.

Drug-usage patterns

The Plan may be provided with information from a variety of sources regarding drug-usage patterns of individual members that merit further investigation. If the conclusion of the investigation is that the drug-usage patterns are not consistent with generally accepted standards of practice, the Plan may choose to restrict access to the benefit to one prescribing physician for those members. If this action is taken, the member will be notified in advance.

Your right to safe and effective pharmacy services

State and federal laws establish standards to assure safe and effective pharmacy services, and to guarantee your right to know what drugs are covered under this Plan and what coverage limitations are in your contract.



If you want more information about the drug coverage policies under this plan, or if you have a question or a concern about your pharmacy benefit, call the Premera customer service team at (800) 676-1411.

If you have a concern about the pharmacists or pharmacies serving you, call your State Department of Health.

Additional exclusions and limitations for prescription drugs

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Drugs and medications not approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) except as defined in the Experimental and Investigational section
- Drugs and medicines that may be lawfully obtained over the counter (OTC) without a prescription. OTC drugs are excluded even if prescribed by a practitioner, unless otherwise stated in this benefit. These may include, but are not limited to, nonprescription drugs and vitamins, food and dietary supplements, herbal or naturopathic medicines, and nutritional and dietary supplements (for example, infant formulas or protein supplements). This exclusion does not apply to emergency contraceptive methods (such as "Plan B"), aspirin for women and men, folic acid for women and iron supplements.
- Over-the-counter contraceptives, supplies and devices (except as required by law)
- Drugs for the purpose of cosmetic use (for example, promote or stimulate hair growth, or to stop hair loss not related to alopecia areata, or prevent wrinkles)
- Growth hormone for the diagnosis of idiopathic short stature (ISS), familial short stature (FSS), or constitutional short stature (CSS)
- Drugs for experimental or investigational use
- Any prescription refilled too soon or in excess of the number of refills specified by the prescribing provider, or any refill dispensed after one year from the prescribing provider's original order
- Replacement of lost or stolen medication
- Devices and appliances, support garments, and non-medical supplies
- This plan does not cover the cost of drugs that are reimbursed under another plan or another portion of your Microsoft coverage (for example, drugs administered while hospitalized)
- Charges for prescription drugs when obtained through an unauthorized pharmacy or provider when a restriction of the prescription drug benefit is in place
- Shipping and handling charges for prescriptions drugs are not covered.

Preventive care

Preventive services:

- *In-network: 100%*

- *Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies; well-child care through age 6 is covered at 100%*

This benefit covers routine exams, immunizations and health screenings, such as:

- Routine physicals for women and men
- Women's preventive care including a gynecological exam, routine pap smear (cervical cancer screening) and routine mammogram (breast cancer screening)
- Well-child exams, including physical exams, tests, and immunizations, through age 11 and annual physical exams for age 12 through 18
- Hearing screening for children through age 18
- Routine eye exams
- Flu shots
- Colorectal cancer screening
- Prostate cancer screening
- Lung cancer screening
- Immunizations, which need not be done at the same time as the routine exam

For individuals with known risk factors, such as family history of a disease with known hereditary links, the limits in the recommended guidelines for preventive screenings may not be applicable.

Preventive prescription drugs:

- *In-network: 100%*
- *Out-of-network: 100%*

This benefit covers certain single-source brand and generic prescriptions to prevent the onset of disease by a person who has risk factors for a particular condition, or those taken to prevent a recurrence of a disease. Covered preventive prescription drugs include drugs for the treatment of high cholesterol with cholesterol-lowering medications to prevent heart disease, or the treatment of recovered heart attack or stroke victims with ACE inhibitor medications to prevent a recurrence. This benefit also covers certain supplies such as hypodermic needles, test strips and glucose monitors.



For a complete list of what is considered preventive care and paid 100% by the plan, see the [Preventive Care Services list](#) and the [Preventive Drug list](#), or contact Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411. For information on how to fill your prescription, see the [prescription drug](#) section.

Rehabilitation

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers physical therapy, functional occupational therapy, and speech therapy services to:

- Restore and improve a bodily or cognitive function that was previously normal but was lost after an accidental injury or illness
- Treat disorders or delays in the development of language, cognitive, or motor skills

Inpatient services are covered when services cannot be rendered in any other setting (see inpatient benefits). Outpatient services are limited to a maximum of one hour of each specialty (physical therapy, occupational therapy and speech therapy) per day.

Physical therapy, functional occupational therapy, and speech therapy, including cardiac rehabilitation, are covered when rendered by a physician or by a licensed or registered physical or occupational therapist or a certified speech therapist that is licensed or registered as required as such by the state in which they practice, subject to the Plan's review and approval of your treatment plan for physical therapy and functional occupational therapy services. Premera or its designee may review a member's treatment plan for the purpose of verifying that the treatment is clinically safe, effective, and appropriate for the member's condition. Based on a prospective, concurrent or retrospective review, Premera may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not medically necessary.

Services rendered by a massage therapist are not covered under the rehabilitation benefit. Refer to the Chiropractic services, acupuncture, and medical massage therapy benefit for coverage.

Respite Care (Non-Hospice)

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

Limit: 672 hours per calendar year

Respite care is for covered members who need assistance with activities of daily living (ADLs) such as bathing and dressing due to a permanent or temporary disabling medical condition, such as a traumatic brain injury, advanced multiple sclerosis, and severe cerebral palsy, where the member needs assistance moving from one place to the other. This benefit covers 672 hours per calendar year in the member's residential home to provide family caregivers an opportunity to recover from the emotionally and physically demanding tasks of caring for the covered member who requires assistance with ADLs.

The respite care application form and a home assessment must be completed prior to accessing this benefit. After the home assessment, Premera will make a determination if the covered member needs assistance with ADLs related to a disabling medical condition and qualifies for respite care coverage, which may be approved for up to a 12-month period. The home assessment is covered under the [Home health care](#) benefit. For the respite care application and more information on this benefit, call Premera Customer Service at (800) 676-1411.

Additional exclusions and limitations for respite care:

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Respite care provided by a non-certified or non-licensed provider or agency
- Respite care provided by a family member or friend
- Travel expenses, mileage, supplies or any other personal needs of the provider of the respite care
- Instrumental ADLs – examples of instrumental ADLs that are not covered by this benefit include, but are not limited to: shopping, housework, managing finances and using the computer.

Skilled nursing facility

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 120 days per member per calendar year

This benefit covers inpatient care in a Medicare-approved skilled nursing facility for up to 120 days in each calendar year. Services must be part of a formal written treatment plan prescribed by the doctor. Custodial care is not included in this coverage.



Custodial care is provided primarily for ongoing maintenance of a person's condition or to assist a person in meeting activities of daily living, and not for therapeutic value or requiring the constant attention of trained medical personnel. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Services and supplies eligible for reimbursement include:

- Room and board, meals, and general nursing care
- Services and supplies furnished and used while you are in the skilled nursing facility, such as:
 - The use of special treatment rooms
 - Routine lab exams
 - Physical
 - Occupational or speech therapy
 - Respiratory and other gas therapy
 - Drugs and biologicals (such as blood products and solutions)
 - Gauze, cotton, fabrics, solutions, plaster, and other materials used in dressings and casts

Prior authorization

A prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for skilled nursing facilities to determine coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition, based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Additional exclusions and limitations for skilled nursing facility

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Custodial care is not provided
- Care that is primarily for neurocognitive disorder, intellectual disability, or the treatment of substance use disorder and alcohol use disorder

Sterilization services

Elective Sterilization – Female

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers elective, permanent sterilization procedures, such as tubal ligation. Reversals or attempted reversals of these procedures are not covered.

Elective Sterilization – Male

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers elective, permanent sterilization procedures, such as vasectomy. Reversals or attempted reversals of these procedures are not covered.

Surgical weight loss treatment

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Who is eligible

This benefit covers you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent when the criteria listed in the Premera Medical Policy on Bariatric Surgery are met.



Contact Premera at (800) 676-1411 for a copy of the policy.

Examples of qualifying criteria include:

- A Body Mass Index (BMI) greater than 40 Kilograms (kg) per square meter (m²) or BMI greater than 35 Kg per m² in conjunction with severe diabetes, hypertension, or obstructive sleep apnea
- Physician-supervised weight reduction program which includes:
 - A program lasting at least three consecutive months within the 12-month period before surgery is considered,
 - Evidence of active participation in a program documented in the member's medical records,

- A psychological evaluation and clearance by a licensed mental health provider, to help rule out other psychological disorders, inability to provide informed consent, or inability to comply with pre- and post-surgical requirements.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers treatment of temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction and other related disorders, such as myofascial pain dysfunction (MPD). Services must be rendered by a physician, hospital, licensed or registered physical therapist, or licensed dentist.

TMJ services and supplies for the treatment of TMJ dysfunction and myofascial pain dysfunction include:

- Diagnostic and follow-up examinations
- Diagnostic X-ray services
- Oral surgery
- Physical therapy
- Biofeedback
- Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation (TENS)
- TMJ splints or TMJ guards

Transfusions, blood, and blood derivatives

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90%, deductible applies

This benefit covers transfusions, blood, and blood derivatives that are not replaced by voluntary donors. The cost of donating and storing your own blood for a planned surgery is also covered.

Gender Affirming surgical services

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 90% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers medically necessary gender affirming surgical services, including facility and anesthesia charges related to the surgery.

Coverage of prescription drugs and mental health treatment associated with gender reassignment surgery is available under the [prescription drugs](#) and [mental health](#) benefits.

When services are covered

Gender affirming surgical services will be covered if you are diagnosed as having gender dysphoria or gender incongruence, and the surgery is medically necessary according to the most current Standards of Care published by the World Professional Association for Transgender Health (WPATH).

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended for coverage to be made available for gender affirming surgical services. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization. The most current WPATH Standards of Care outline the specific requirements that must be met in order for the gender affirming surgical services to be deemed medically necessary. Any prior authorization request must include documentation showing that all required elements under the most current WPATH Standards of Care have been met. See the [Microsoft Gender-Affirming Benefit Information](#) for additional information.

For gender affirming surgical services, the prior authorization should include:

- The surgical procedure(s) for which coverage is being requested
- The date the procedure will be performed
- Information supporting the criteria listed above has been met, based on the surgery being requested



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.



Your physician can fax this information to (800) 843-1114 or mail it to:

Premera Blue Cross
Attn: Integrated Health Management
P.O. 91059
Seattle, WA
98111-09159

Transplants

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers solid organ transplants and bone marrow/stem cell reinfusion^{3/4} procedures cannot be experimental or investigational.



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.



The transplant benefit doesn't cover cornea transplantation, skin grafts, or the transplant of blood or blood derivatives (except for bone marrow or stem cells). These procedures are covered on the same basis as any other covered surgical procedure.

Eligible providers

To be eligible for coverage, the transplant or reinfusion must be furnished in an approved transplant center that has developed expertise in performing solid organ transplants, bone marrow reinfusion, or stem cell reinfusion, and is approved by Premera. Premera has contractual agreements with approved transplant centers and has access to a special network of approved transplant centers throughout the United States. Whenever medically possible, we will direct you to an approved transplant center with which Premera has a contract. Of course, if neither a Premera-approved transplant center nor a Premera network transplant center can provide the type of transplant you need, this benefit will cover a transplant center that meets the approval standards that are set by Premera.



Approved transplant center is a hospital or other provider, located in the United States, that has developed expertise in performing covered transplant services and has a contractual agreement in place with Premera. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Donor costs

All donor acquisition costs such as selection (testing and typing), harvesting (removal) transportation of donor organ, bone marrow and stem cells, and storage costs for bone marrow and stem cells for a period of up to 12 months are covered services, including costs incurred by the surgical harvesting teams.

Additional exclusions and limitations for transplants

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Nonhuman or mechanical organs, unless they are not experimental or investigational
- Services and supplies that are payable by any government, foundation, or charitable grant. This includes services performed on potential or actual recipients or donors (living or cadaver).
- Donor costs are not covered if the recipient of the transplant service is not a Microsoft enrollee. This applies to donor costs for all types of transplant services, solid organ and bone marrow or stem cell reinfusion.

- Donor costs are not covered by Microsoft if benefits are available under other group or individual coverage
- Donor costs are not covered for transportation for typing or matching

Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit

In-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations below)

Out-of-network: 100%, deductible applies (additional IRS limitations below)

Limit: \$10,000 per member, per calendar year

The following travel and lodging reimbursement benefits are available when travel is necessary to obtain covered services under the Plan that are not available within 100 miles of the member's residence.

Travel Allowances: Travel expenses are reimbursed between the member's residence and the location of the covered treatment for round trip (air, train, or bus) transportation costs. Airfare, or train or bus fare, must be for a regularly scheduled commercial flight, or train or bus route (coach class only). If traveling by automobile, mileage, parking, and toll costs are reimbursed. Costs for surface transportation (rideshares, taxi, ferry, etc.) are also covered. Mileage reimbursement is based on the current IRS medical mileage reimbursement. Please refer to the IRS website, www.irs.gov, publication 502 Medical and Dental expenses, for current mileage reimbursement rates.

Lodging Allowances: Hotel or motel stays (or similar accommodations) away from the geographic area of the member's residence. Reimbursement of expenses incurred by a member and one companion for hotel or motel lodging away from home, in the geographic area where the covered treatment is performed, is provided at a rate of \$50 per night per person, or up to \$100 per night total for the member and one companion, if applicable (see below), in accordance with applicable IRS reimbursement requirements.

Overall Maximum: The travel and lodging reimbursement benefit is limited to a total of \$10,000 per member per calendar year.

Companions: The travel and lodging benefit is available for the reimbursement of eligible expenses incurred by the member, as well as a companion, to the extent that a companion is needed to accompany the member for the treatment due to medical necessity or safety concerns.

- Adult member (age 18 or older) – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 companion is permitted.
- Child member – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 parent or guardian is permitted

Limits: Eligible travel and lodging expenses under this benefit are reimbursable up to the IRS mileage rate, lodging allowance, or other limits, as applicable, in effect on the date you incurred the expense, which are subject to change. Please visit the IRS website, www.irs.gov, for details. Nothing in this summary of the travel and lodging reimbursement benefit should be considered legal or tax advice. Please consult with a personal legal or tax advisor for more information.

Non-Covered Expenses:

- Alcohol/tobacco
- Car rental expenses
- Any airfare, train or bus fare, or upgrades, for any ticket other than a regularly scheduled commercial flight or route in coach class
- Baggage fees

- Entertainment (e.g., movies, visits to museums, additional mileage for sightseeing, etc.)
- Expenses for persons other than the patient and an eligible companion
- Lodging at a residence owned by a family member or friend
- Costs for pets or animals, other than service animals
- Meals
- Personal care items (e.g., shampoo, deodorant, toothbrush etc.)
- Souvenirs (e.g., T-shirts, sweatshirts, toys, etc.)
- Telephone calls

Limitations/exclusions:

- The travel and lodging must occur, and the treatment must be provided, within the United States
- The patient must be covered by one of Microsoft's Premera plans at the time the treatment is provided and the travel and lodging expenses are incurred
- The medical treatment for which the patient is required to travel more than 100 miles from the patient's residence must be a covered benefit under the Plan

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine in advance whether coverage is available for travel and lodging reimbursement.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Virtual Care

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Virtual Care is the delivery of health-related services and information between a member and provider via telecommunications (email, telephone, video, and online) for the purpose of diagnosis, prevention, health advice, disease management and treatment

Electronic Visits. An electronic visit ("e-visit") is a structured, secure online consultation between an approved physician and the member. This benefit will cover medically necessary e-visits for an illness or injury. Each approved physician will determine which conditions and circumstances are appropriate for e-visits in their practice.

Telehealth Services. Your plan covers access to care via online and telephonic methods when medically appropriate. Services must be medically necessary to treat a covered illness, injury or condition. Your provider will determine which conditions and circumstances are appropriate for telehealth services.

Services delivered via telehealth methods are subject to standard office visit cost-shares and other provisions as stated in this booklet. Virtual Care with a provider located outside of the United States is not covered.

Vision therapy

In-network: 90%, deductible applies

Out-of-network: 70% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limit: up to 32-visit benefit maximum, per member, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment

This benefit covers vision training, eye training or eye exercises up to a maximum of 32 treatment visits, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan option, for the following conditions only:

- Amblyopia
- Convergence insufficiency
- Esotropia or exotropia

All other uses of vision therapy are considered investigative and are not covered. Vision therapy is not a covered service under the [Vision plan](#). Costs of equipment and supplies associated with vision therapy are not covered.

Weight Management program

In-network (eligible providers): 80%, up to \$6,000 maximum for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more Premera-administered health plan options; deductible and coinsurance maximum does not apply.

Out-of-network: not applicable

This benefit covers comprehensive and clinically based weight management programs for the treatment of obesity. The 20% coinsurance you pay will not count toward the deductible or coinsurance maximum and will continue after the deductible and coinsurance maximum are met.

Who is eligible

Members are eligible for this benefit if they meet the following criteria:

- Have been prescribed a GLP-1 medication, or
- Diagnosed as obese (commonly Body Mass Index (BMI) greater than or equal to 30), or
- Overweight with a BMI greater than or equal to 27, and diagnosed with two or more of the following conditions:
 - Congestive heart failure
 - Coronary heart disease
 - Depression
 - Diabetes
 - Hyperlipidemia
 - Hypertension
 - Sleep Apnea

This benefit is available for members aged 18 and over.

Eligible providers

Approved [weight management providers](#) of this benefit must meet eligibility requirements set forth by Microsoft and Premera and be providing services under a weight management program that is contracted for and approved by Premera for this plan.

Approved weight management programs will be those programs that are comprehensive and clinically based. Approved programs must be based on medical oversight and include treatment from professionals in the areas of nutrition, behavioral therapy, and personal training. An approved program must include an initial minimum 10-week period of frequent sessions with the program's physician, personal trainer, dietitian, and behavioral therapist. This initial period must be followed by a minimum three-month maintenance period, which includes regular follow-up visits with these program professionals.

The Weight Management program must be contracted for and approved by Premera both at the time the participant or covered spouse/domestic partner begins the program and when they complete the program. If the program is not approved and contracted for until after the participant has started treatment under the program, no part of the cost of the program will be covered under this benefit.



To find an approved provider, review the [Weight Management providers list](#).

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is strongly recommended to determine whether coverage is available before the service occurs. Either the member or the provider may contact Premera for prior authorization.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Premera that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Prior authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Premera reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

A [Weight Management Recommendation form](#) or confirmation of your BMI and co-morbid conditions must be submitted to Premera in order to receive reimbursement from Premera. Your physician's recommendation will confirm you meet the contract criteria required for this benefit to be available.

The following are the steps that you are recommended to complete in advance to ensure that your treatment meets the criteria of this benefit:

1. Take the Weight Management Recommendation form to your regular physician
2. An evaluation is performed by your physician to determine if you meet the eligibility requirements set forth above
3. Your physician faxes or mails the Weight Management Recommendation Form to Premera to confirm that you meet the weight management eligibility requirements and your physician's approval



Your physician can fax this information to (800) 676-1477

4. Premera will review the information submitted and verify the coverage through a prior authorization

Claims payment

Final claims payment will be contingent on Premera receiving all biometric reporting information for the participant. Reimbursement for this benefit may occur in one of two ways. The program you attend will select the claims payment method used.

Method 1: Direct reimbursement to member

The provider will bill you directly for services provided. The frequency of billing should be made clear by the provider before you start the program. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program.

During the course of the program you can submit an interim billing member claim form on a monthly or quarterly basis to Premera for reimbursement. Upon completion of the program you must submit the weight management billing claim form for your final payment. Final claims payment is contingent on receiving the form with all the biometric information completed.

If your coverage terminates during the time you are participating in an approved program, and you do not elect COBRA, only services rendered up to the date of termination of coverage will be reimbursed.

Method 2: Direct reimbursement to provider

Reimbursement will be made directly to the weight management provider on a monthly or quarterly basis. The weight management provider may collect a deposit from you to initiate your participation in the program but will bill Premera on a monthly or quarterly basis for your ongoing participation.

Additional exclusions and limitations for Weight Management program

In addition to the plan's [exclusions](#) and [limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Food
- Nutritional supplements (i.e., protein shakes)
- Drugs or surgical procedures to assist in reducing weight or curbing hunger are not covered under the weight management program benefit. Refer to the [Prescription drugs](#) or [Surgical weight loss treatment](#) benefit for coverage.

Exclusions and limitations

- Services or supplies not medically necessary for diagnosis, care, or treatment of a disease, illness, injury, or medical condition, except for the following: (a) newborn nursery care covered under the hospital benefit; (b) male circumcision benefit; (c) sterilization benefit; (d) termination of pregnancy benefit; (e) infertility benefit; (f) hospice care benefit; and (g) well-child care and adult physical exam benefits
- Charges in excess of eligible charges, including out-of-network provider billed amounts over the allowable charges
- Expenses in excess of the applicable annual and lifetime benefit maximums
- Services for which a claim was not received by Premera within 12 months of the date of service. Corrected claims and COB claims need to be submitted within 12 months from the original claim submission date.
- Over-the-counter drugs (unless prescribed), food dietary supplements (for example, infant formulas or protein supplements), and herbal or naturopathic/homeopathic medicine
- Over the counter (OTC) testing and supplies (for example, OTC pregnancy test and ovulation tests) except as covered under the DME benefit
- Charges for or in connection with services or supplies that are determined to be experimental or investigational
- Benefits that overlap or duplicate benefits for which the member is eligible under any other group benefit plan; Workers' Compensation or similar employee benefit law; Medicare A or B; or government-sponsored program of any type
- Services or supplies that are covered through any type of no-fault coverage or similar type of insurance coverage or contract, including but not limited to Personal Injury Protection (PIP) coverage, motor vehicle medical (MEDPAY), motor vehicle no-fault coverage, any excess insurance coverage, Medical premises coverage for homeowners or commercial (MEDPREM), commercial liability coverage, boat coverage, homeowner policy, or school and/or athletic policies.
 - This exclusion applies when the available or existing contract or insurance is either issued to, or makes benefits available to a Participant/claimant, whether or not the Participant/claimant makes a claim under such coverage.
 - Further, the Participant is responsible for any cost-sharing required by motor vehicle coverage, unless applicable state law requires otherwise.
 - If other insurance is available for medical benefits, the Participant must put such other insurance to use towards those medical bills before coverage under the Plan is available. Once benefits under such contract or insurance have been used and exhausted or considered to no longer be Injury-related under the no-fault provisions of the contract, Benefits will be provided according to the Plan.
- Work-related Conditions: This exclusion applies whether or not a proper or timely claim for benefits has been made under the following programs. This plan does not cover services or supplies for which you are entitled to receive benefits under:
 - Occupational coverage required of, or voluntarily obtained by, the employer
 - State or Federal workers' compensation acts
 - Any legislative act providing compensation for work-related illness or injury

- In the event that you do not comply with the contractual terms of subrogation, the plan will no longer be obligated to provide any benefits under this plan. The plan has the right to deduct the amount of benefits paid from any future benefits payable to the enrollee or to any other covered dependent.
- Any services or supplies for which no charge is made, or for which a charge is made because this plan is in effect, or for services or supplies for which the member is legally liable because this plan is in effect
- Services of a social worker except as provided in the hospice care benefit, the home health care benefit and the mental health, substance use disorder, and alcohol use disorder treatment benefit
- Routine or palliative foot care to treat fallen arches, flat feet, care of corns, bunions (except for bone surgery), calluses, toenails (except for ingrown toenail surgery) and other problems that are commonly treated with off-the-shelf, over-the-counter (OTC) therapy. This exclusion does not apply to medically necessary foot care.
- Foot or shoe prosthetics, appliances, orthotics or inserts except as described under the durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies benefit. This does not apply to enrollees who are diabetic.
- Massage therapy that is not medically necessary or is furnished without a prescription
- Activity therapy, such as music, dance or art therapies
- Charges to obtain, train, or maintain service animals and emotional support animals
- Any benefits or services not specifically provided for in this SPD
- Liquid diets or fasting programs, memberships in diet programs or health clubs, or wiring of the jaw
- Drugs and medications not approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) except as defined in the Experimental and Investigational section
- Procedures for sterilization reversals
- Hypnotherapy, regardless of provider
- Hippotherapy or other forms of equine or animal-based therapy
- Electronic services and/or consults, except as specifically described under the plan
- Services or supplies furnished by a member to himself or herself or by a provider who is in any way related to the member. This also includes but is not limited to a provider who is a covered dependent under the plan (whether or not living in the household), spouse, natural or adoptive parent, child, sibling, stepparent, stepchild, stepsibling, father-in-law, mother-in-law, son-in-law, daughter-in-law, brother-in-law, sister-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, spouse of grandparent or spouse of grandchild.
- Services that are illegal, outside the scope of the provider's license or certification, or that are furnished by a provider that is not licensed or certified by the jurisdiction in which the services or supplies were received
- Separate charges for records or reports, except those Premera requests for utilization review
- Voluntary support or affinity groups such as patient support, diabetic support groups or Alcoholics Anonymous. Additionally, volunteer services or services provided by or through a school, books, and other training aids are also not covered.
- Non-treatment facilities, institutions or programs: Benefits are not provided for institutional care, housing, incarceration or programs from facilities that are not licensed to provide medical or behavioral health treatment for covered conditions. Examples are prisons, nursing homes, juvenile detention facilities, group homes, foster homes and adult family homes. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible

provider, provided that such non-treatment facilities, institutions, or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.

- Services or supplies for any of the following:
 - Education and training programs including testing or supplies/materials, including vision training supplies
 - Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.
 - Social, cultural, or vocational rehabilitation or vision training supplies
- Refractive surgery of the eye (surgery to improve vision that can be corrected with glasses or contact lenses) is covered only as specified under the vision plan
- Hospital grade breast pumps are not available for purchase; however, they may be covered for rent for up to the duration of breastfeeding
- Services for individuals not eligible for coverage under the Microsoft Plan will not be reimbursed except in the following circumstances:
 - Donors for organ or bone marrow/stem cell transplantation for services specific to that procedure
 - Genetic testing of relatives when the information is needed to adequately assess risk in the member; the result of the test will directly impact the treatment to the member; and there is no other coverage available to the relative
- Lodging is covered only as outlined in the Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit
- When Coordinating Benefits (COB) and you fail to follow the rules of the primary plan, this plan would pay nothing for that expense
- Benefits are not provided for services or supplies (1) for which no charge is made, (2) for which no charge would have been made if this plan were not in effect or (3) that were not received by the member while covered by the plan
- Services received in excess of a benefit limit or maximum are not covered. Any network discounts for in-network providers do not apply to services received in excess of the benefit limit.

In addition, certain exclusions and limitations apply to the following benefits. CTRL+Click to navigate to the benefit information.

- [Autism/ABA therapy](#)
- [Dental services](#)
- [Hearing care and hardware](#)
- [Home health care](#)
- [Hospice care](#)
- [Hospital inpatient care](#)
- [Infertility](#)
- [Medical and surgical equipment and supplies](#)
- [Mental health and chemical dependency](#)

- Prescription drugs
- Skilled nursing facility
- Transplants
- Weight Management program

How to file a claim

In most cases, when you receive care from an in-network provider, your provider will submit bills directly to Premera, and this submission is your claim for benefits. If your provider does not submit a bill directly to Premera, you will need to submit a claim for benefits.

If possible, you should submit the claim form within 30 days of the service. The plan will not reimburse claims submitted more than 12 months after the date of service.

To submit a claim online:

From the Benefits Site, select **View My Claims**, which will direct you to the Premera Portal. Or sign in to your account on premera.com. Next, from the top menu bar select **Claims** and then **Submit Claims**. Follow the steps and upload a copy of the itemized receipt.

To submit a claim via mail, fax or email:

1. Download the [Premera Claim Reimbursement Request Form](#). You can also email Premera from your Microsoft email address (employees) to microsoft@premera.com or through your Secure Messaging center in the Premera portal (all enrollees including dependents and COBRA members) to request a claim form.
2. Complete the claim form, including all of the following information:
 - a. Your name and the member's name
 - b. Identification numbers shown on your identification card (including the 3-digit plan prefix or MSJ)
 - c. Provider's name, address, and tax identification number
 - d. If you are seeking secondary coverage from the Microsoft health plan, information about other insurance coverage related to the claim at hand, including a copy of their Explanation of Benefits (EOB), if applicable
 - e. If treatment is as a result of an accident: the date, time, location and brief description of the accident
 - f. Date of onset of the illness or injury
 - g. Date of service
 - h. Diagnosis or ICD-10 (this information can be found on the provider bill)
 - i. Procedure codes (CPT-4, HCPCS, ADA, or UB-92) or descriptive English language for each service (this information can be found on the provider bill)
 - j. Itemized charges for each service rendered by provider
3. Sign the form in the space provided and attach the itemized provider bill
4. Submit the completed form to:

Mail: Premera Blue Cross
P.O. Box 91059
Seattle, WA 98111-9159
Fax (800) 676-1477

Email from Microsoft email address: claims.microsoft@premera.com

Email through the Secure Messaging center in your Premera portal



COBRA-eligibility claims should be submitted as described in the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

In the following circumstances, you may submit claims according to the [appeals process](#):

- *If you cannot submit the claim in a timely manner due to circumstances beyond your control*
- *If your claim regards plan eligibility for you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent child*

Claim review and payment

The claim review process begins once Premera receives a claim from you or your provider or other authorized representative. Premera will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other communication notifying you of their decision on your claim. In most cases, this communication will be sent to you no more than 30 days after Premera receives the claim, although Premera may extend this 30-day period for up to 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond Premera's control.

If your claim relates to an item for which the Plan requires you to obtain approval (or "prior authorization") before it is furnished to you, then Premera generally will send a decision no later than 15 calendar days after receipt of your request. Premera may extend this 15-day period for up to an additional 15 days if the extension is required due to matters beyond Premera's control.

If Premera needs additional information from you to process your pre- or post-service claim, Premera will notify you in writing, within 30 days after receiving your claim, of the specific information required. You will have at least 45 days to provide the additional information. The determination period to respond to your claim (as provided above) will be suspended as of the date Premera sends the notice and will resume again once you have provided the additional information. If you do not provide the requested information within the specified timeframe, Premera will decide the claim without the requested information.

If your claim is for "urgent care," meaning the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment at issue, then the following special rules apply:

- Premera will send you an EOB or other communication notifying you if they have denied your claim, in writing or electronically, within 72 hours after Premera receives all necessary information for your claim either via phone or in writing, taking into account the seriousness of your condition.
- Premera's denial notice may be oral, with a written or electronic confirmation to follow within three days.
- If the claim was filed incorrectly, Premera will notify you of the error and how to correct it within 24 hours after the claim was received. If additional information is needed to process the claim, Premera will notify you of the information needed within 24 hours after the claim was received. You then have 48 hours to provide the requested information. You will then be notified of Premera's determination no later than 48 hours after (1) Premera's receipt of the requested information, or (2) the end of the 48-hour period when you were to provide the additional information if the information is not received in that timeframe.

If your claim is a request to extend an ongoing course of treatment beyond a previously approved period of time or number of treatments, and is considered an urgent care claim, Premera will decide your claim within 24 hours, provided that your claim is submitted at least 24 hours before the end of the approved treatment.



Explanation of benefits (EOB) is the statement you receive from Premera Blue Cross detailing how much the provider billed, how much (if any) the plan paid, and the amount that you owe the provider (if any).

Premera will make a payment to the employee, a dependent (age 13 or older), a provider, or another carrier. Payments are subject to applicable law and regulation:

- Premera may make payments on behalf of an enrolled child to a non-enrolled parent or state agency to which the plan is required by applicable law to direct such payments
- Payments made will discharge the plan to the extent of the amount paid, so that the plan is not liable to anyone due to its choice of payee

Denied claims notice

If all or part of your claim is denied, Premera will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other notice with the following information:

- The specific reason or reasons for the denial
- Reference to the specific plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A description of any additional material or information needed from you and the reason it is needed
- An explanation of the appeals procedures and the applicable time limits
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol or other criterion that was relied upon in making the adverse determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the claim is for urgent care (as defined above), a description of the expedited review process applicable to such claims
- If you have filed a claim with Premera relating to plan eligibility, and this claim is denied, Premera will send you a notice explaining your appeal rights
- Notice regarding your right to bring legal action following a denial on appeal

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning

- A description of the plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal
- Contact information for Premera Customer Service or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist participants with the internal and external appeals process

Appeal for internal review

If you do not agree with the decision made by the plan you may appeal for an internal review of the decision within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or adverse decision.



An **appeal** is a written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce or end payment, coverage or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the plan. This includes admissions to and continued stays in a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.



If you fail to file the internal appeal within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits, you will permanently lose your right to appeal the denied claim.

Submitting an appeal for internal review

You or your authorized representative* must provide the following information as part of your written appeal to the Premera Appeals Department:

- Your name,
- Your Premera member number,
- The name of this plan, and
- A concise statement of why you disagree with the decision, including facts or theories supporting your claim.

Your written request may (but is not required to) include issues, comments, documents, and other records you want considered in the review.



The appeal should be mailed or faxed to Premera:

Appeals Coordinator
Premera Blue Cross
P.O. Box 91102
Seattle, WA 98111-9202
Fax: (425) 918-5592

*You may, at your own expense, have a representative file an appeal on your behalf. Your attorney, family member, your provider, or anyone else who you wish to designate as your authorized representative may also appeal with written authorization. In order to designate an authorized representative for this purpose, you must submit a completed and signed [Microsoft Member Appeal form](#) which includes an appeal authorization section.

In the case of an urgent care appeal, you may submit your appeal request orally or in writing and all necessary information may be transmitted between you and the plan by telephone or fax. If your provider believes your situation is urgent as defined under law and so notifies Premera, your appeal will be conducted on an expedited basis. Notification will be furnished to you as soon as possible, but not later than 72 hours after receipt of the expedited appeal. Your appeal should clearly indicate your request for an expedited appeal.

For urgent situations or if you are in an ongoing course of treatment you may begin an external independent review at the same time as Premera Blue Cross's internal review process. The external review agency is not legally affiliated or controlled by Premera. The external review agency decision is final and is binding upon the Plan.



To file an urgent care appeal request, you may fax a request to (425) 918-5592.



The external review for non-urgent situations is available only after you have properly exhausted the internal appeal as described above.



An urgent care claim or appeal is one where the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment that is the subject of the claim.

Internal review and timeframe

All the information you submit will be taken into account on appeal, even if it was not reviewed as part of the initial decision. You may ask to examine or receive free copies of all pertinent plan documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim by requesting these from Premera.

The plan may consult with a health care professional who has experience in the field of medicine involved in the medical judgment to decide your appeal. You may request the identity of medical experts whose advice was obtained by the plan in connection with your initial claim denial, even if their advice was not relied upon in making the initial decision.

In the event any new or additional information (evidence) is considered, relied on or generated by Premera in connection with your appeal, Premera will provide this information to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that you will have an opportunity to respond. Also, if any new or additional rationale is considered by Premera, Premera will provide the rationale to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that that you will have an opportunity to respond.

Other than urgent care appeals, described above, in most cases Premera will send a decision on your appeal no later than 60 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request. However, if the appeal relates to an item for which the Plan requires you to obtain approval before it is furnished to you, then it will be considered a pre-service appeal, and Premera will send a decision no later than 30 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request.

Denied appeal notice

If your appeal is denied, you will receive a written notice setting forth:

- The specific reason or reasons for the denial
- Reference to the specific plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A statement that you are entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records and other information relevant to your claim for benefits
- A statement explaining the external review procedures offered by the plan and your right to bring a civil action under ERISA section 502(a)
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol or other criterion that was relied upon in denying the claim (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)
- If the denial is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment that led to this determination (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)

For medical and transplant benefits, the denial will also include:

- Information sufficient to identify the claim involved, including the date of service, health care provider and claim amount, if applicable
- The denial code and its meaning
- A description of the Plan's standard for denying the claim
- Information regarding available internal and external appeals, including how to initiate an appeal
- Contact information for Premera Customer Service or the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor to assist participants with the internal and external appeals process

Appeal for external review

If you are not satisfied with the final internal denial of your claim, you may request an external review by an independent review organization (IRO) if that denial 1) has a retroactive effect and is considered a rescission of coverage under the law, or (2) is based on medical judgment including:

- Requirements for medical necessity, appropriateness, health care setting, level of care or effectiveness of a covered benefit
- A determination that a treatment is experimental or investigational



An **independent review organization (IRO)** is an independent organization of medical experts who are qualified to review medical and other relevant information.

The external review for non-urgent situations is available only after you have properly exhausted the internal appeals process as described above. There are no fees or costs imposed on you as part of the external review.

The external review agency decision is final and is binding upon the plan.

Submitting an appeal for external review

To initiate the external review, you must send a written request to Premera at the address below no later than 120 days after the date you receive your internal appeal determination letter, which the plan deems to be seven days after the date on the internal appeal determination letter.



If you fail to submit the written request within this timeframe, you will permanently lose your right to an external review.



Mail or fax the written request to:

Premera Blue Cross
Attn: Microsoft Member Appeals – IRO Mail Stop 123
P.O. Box 91102
Seattle, WA 98111-9202
Fax: (425) 918-5592

External review and timeframe

If your appeal is eligible for external review, Premera will notify the IRO of your request for an external review and send them all the information included in your internal appeal and other relevant materials within six days of receipt.

The IRO will contact Premera directly if additional information is needed. Premera will provide the IRO with any additional information they request that is reasonably available. The external review request is considered complete when the IRO has all the requested information and the IRO review begins.



If your provider believes your situation is urgent under law (as defined above under Appeal for internal review), your external review will be conducted on an expedited basis. For expedited external reviews, you and Premera will be notified by phone, e-mail message or fax as soon as possible, but no later than 72 hours after receipt of your external review request. A written determination will follow.

The plan agrees that any statute of limitations (including the one-year contractual limitations period described below) or other defense based on timeliness is on hold during the time that the external review is pending. Your decision whether to file the external review will have no effect on your rights to any other benefits under the plan.

The external review process does not apply to appeals of denied claims for plan eligibility or for other appeals of denied claims that are not based on medical judgment.

Decision on the external review

The plan is bound by the IRO's decision. If the IRO overturned the final internal adverse determination, the plan will implement their decision. The IRO will notify you and Premera in writing of its determination on the external review no later than 45 days after receipt of your complete external review request.

Decisions upon the external review are the final decision under the plan's appeal process, and there are no further appeals available from Premera or Microsoft or any person administering claims or appeals under the plan. However, you still have a right to file suit under ERISA Section 502(a) as a result of the external review decision.

Limits on your right to judicial review

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal before taking action in any other forum regarding a claim for benefits under the plan. Any legal action initiated under the plan must be brought no later than one year following the adverse determination on the appeal. This one-year limitations period on claims for benefits applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit claim is deemed permanently waived and barred. In addition, you must raise all issues and grounds for appealing a decision on a claim for benefits at every stage of the appeal process, or else such issues and grounds will be deemed permanently waived and barred.



If you have questions about understanding a denial of a claim or your appeal rights, you may contact Premera Customer Service for assistance at (800) 676-1411. You may also seek assistance from the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor at (866) 444-EBSA (3272).

Right to recover benefits paid in error

If Premera makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, Premera has the right to recover payment, including deducting the amount paid mistake from future benefits.

Note: Health care providers are not “beneficiaries” of the plan, and although Premera may make direct payment to health care providers for the convenience of participants and their dependents, such payments of services shall not be considered “benefits” available under the plan, or confer beneficiary standing upon a health care provider.

Surest Health Plan

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How the plan works

The Surest Health Plan ("Surest Plan") allows you to make informed choices about your health care, cost, and coverage needs – in advance of receiving care. With the Surest mobile app and the Surest website [Benefits.Surest.com](#), members can search for available care, cost, and coverage options from any geographic location to choose the best option for them, or members can call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 for assistance navigating their coverage options. Capitalized terms in this section of the SPD are defined in the Surest Glossary (or elsewhere in the Glossary).

The Surest Plan features comprehensive coverage; no deductible; simple copayments for Covered Health Services; and an annual out-of-pocket maximum.

Where you can get care

With the Surest Health Plan, you have the flexibility to visit the provider or facility you choose and still have coverage. However, providers in the nationwide United Healthcare network feature certain advantages, including:

- Your provider files claims directly with Surest
- Lower, negotiated rates for care and prescriptions
- The highest coverage levels

If you seek care with an out-of-network provider or facility, your out-of-pocket costs will be higher, and you may have to pay the provider and then submit a claim for reimbursement.

Finding an in-network provider

You can maximize your savings by using providers and facilities in UnitedHealthcare's Choice Plus network. Members in California have access to UnitedHealthcare's Select Plus network.

Visit the online Surest provider directory (<https://benefits.surest.com>) to find an in-network provider or call Surest at (866) 222-1298.



Additionally, both active employees and COBRA enrollees also have access to the [Embold Health Provider Guide](#), a tool that helps you find highly rated healthcare providers in your area and insurance network. Embold uses healthcare claims data to score how well a doctor makes the correct diagnosis, chooses the right treatment plan, and delivers the best health outcome. These scores are developed using common and accepted measures in the medical community.

As a member enrolled in the Surest Plan, you may choose any eligible Provider each time you need to receive a Covered Health Service. The choices you make may affect the amount you pay, as well as the level of benefits you receive. You will receive the highest level of benefits from the Surest Plan (and in most instances, your out-of-pocket expenses will be substantially less) when you receive care from in-network Providers. The Surest Plan features a large network of in-network Providers through UnitedHealthcare's network which can be found in the Surest mobile app or at [Benefits.Surest.com](#) website, or you can call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for assistance.

Claims for benefits under the Surest Plan are payable only for Covered Health Services that are Medically Necessary.

The total cost of Covered Health Services is shared between you and the Surest Plan. Your share consists of copayments, which Surest assigns to Covered Health Services. Your copayments for Covered Health Services are listed in the Benefit Features section, Prescription Drugs section, and on the Surest mobile app and Surest website [Benefits.Surest.com](#).

The Surest Plan does not have a deductible or coinsurance and will cover the remainder of the Eligible Expense for Covered Health Services after any copayments are applied. The Surest Plan does have an out-of-pocket maximum, which is the maximum total amount of copayments you will be required to pay each calendar year for Covered Health Services.

If you use an in-network Provider, you generally will be responsible for lower copayments, and the Provider may not charge you any additional fees or amounts. If you use an out-of-network Provider, your costs generally will be higher. In addition to your higher out-of-network copayment, in many cases you may be responsible for the Provider's total billed amounts that exceed the Eligible Expenses that the Surest Plan pays for a Covered Health Service (known as out-of-network Provider "balance billing"), which can be significant.

Once your total copayments reach your applicable out-of-pocket maximum, the Surest Plan will cover 100% of Eligible Expenses for the remainder of the calendar year, not including any out-of-network Provider balance billing amounts, when applicable. Out-of-network Provider balance billing amounts are NOT Eligible Expenses and are not counted towards your out-of-pocket maximums.

In-Network Benefits

In-network Providers are responsible for obtaining Prior Authorization and completing all notification requirements for you, when applicable. Therefore, it is important that you confirm the Provider's current status before you receive services, as a Provider's network status may change from time to time. For current in-network Provider information, refer to the Surest mobile app or go to [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com), or call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for assistance.

If you receive Covered Health Services from an out-of-network Provider because Surest incorrectly informed you that the Provider was an in-network Provider, either through the Surest mobile app, the [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website, or in response to your request to Surest Member Services for that information, you may be eligible for the same coverage and copayment (with no out-of-network Provider balance billing) that would have applied if the Covered Health Service had been provided from an in-network Provider.

Do not assume that all services furnished by an in-network Provider are Covered Health Services. In some cases, in-network Providers may furnish services that are not Covered Health Services under the Surest Plan. Refer to the Surest mobile app or the [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for assistance.

Out-of-Network Benefits

The Surest Plan generally provides benefits for medical Claims incurred with an out-of-network Provider or facility at a lower level. In addition to potentially owing a higher copayment, if you choose to seek Covered Health Services out-of-network, except as described below, you may also be responsible for the difference between the amount billed by the out-of-network Provider or facility and the amount Surest determines to be the Eligible Expense for reimbursement. The amount in excess of the Eligible Expense could be significant, and this amount will NOT apply to the out-of-network out-of-pocket maximum. You may want to ask the out-of-network Provider about their billing practices before you receive care.

For Covered Health Services provided by an out-of-network Provider, the Eligible Expenses generally will be calculated based on 140% of the applicable Medicare reimbursement rate except as provided below.

If Surest determines that care is not reasonably available to you from an in-network Provider, Surest will work with you to coordinate care through an out-of-network Provider in accordance with Surest's policies. In those cases, the Covered Health Services rendered by the specified out-of-network Provider will be processed as in-network benefits, subject to an applicable in-network copayment and no out-of-network Provider balance billing. Requests for this arrangement should be made by calling Surest Member Services at the number on your member ID card **before** you obtain such services.

For ground or water ambulance transportation provided by an out-of-network Provider, the Eligible Expense, which includes mileage, is determined based on the median amount negotiated with in-network Providers for the same or similar service, unless a different rate is agreed upon by the out-of-network Provider and Surest, or a different amount is required by applicable law.

In some cases involving out-of-network Providers and facilities, listed below, special “surprise billing” rules apply under federal law. In these cases, you will be required to pay the in-network copayment only, which will accumulate toward your in-network out-of-pocket maximum, and may not be balance billed by the out-of-network Provider.

- Covered Health Services that are ***non-Emergency Ancillary Services received from an out-of-network Provider at an in-network hospital, hospital outpatient department, critical access hospital, or ambulatory surgery center.***
- Covered Health Services that are ***non-Emergency, non-Ancillary Services received at an in-network hospital, hospital outpatient department, critical access hospital, or ambulatory surgery center, from an out-of-network Provider who has not satisfied advance patient notice and consent requirements required by law.***
- Covered Health Services received from an out-of-network Provider at an in-network ***hospital, hospital outpatient department, critical access hospital, or ambulatory surgery center due to unforeseen, urgent medical needs.***
- Covered Health Services that are ***Emergency Health Services provided by an out-of-network Provider or facility.***
- Covered Health Services that are ***air ambulance services provided by an out-of-network Provider.***

Eligible Expenses are determined in accordance with Surest’s reimbursement policy guidelines or as required by law.

If you are using an out-of-network Provider, you are also responsible for ensuring that any necessary Prior Authorizations have been obtained, or the services may not be covered by the Surest Plan.

Out-of-network Providers are not required to file Claims with Surest, and except as required by law, Surest may issue payment on an out-of-network Claim to the member, and not to the out-of-network Provider or facility directly. In those cases, you will be responsible for paying the Surest payment amount to the out-of-network Provider or facility, in addition to any applicable copayment and balance billing amounts. If you obtain Covered Health Services from an out-of-network Provider and/or facility that requires that you remit the full amount billed, contact Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for a Claim form to file a Claim for reimbursement. This may require an itemized bill from the Provider.

Prior Authorization

Select services require Prior Authorization whether provided by in-network or out-of-network Providers.

In-network Providers are responsible for obtaining Prior Authorization when required for Covered Health Services, including planned inpatient admissions, as well as providing post-admission notification within 24 hours of Emergency inpatient admissions. Inpatient stays will be reviewed for Medical Necessity, length of stay, and level of care. All acute inpatient rehabilitation (AIR) admissions, long-term acute care (LTAC) admissions, and Skilled Nursing Facility (SNF) admissions are subject to Medical Necessity review pre-admission. If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Important: If you are using an out-of-network Provider, you are responsible for ensuring that any necessary Prior Authorizations have been obtained or the services may not be covered by the Surest Plan. Contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 prior to obtaining out-of-network services to determine whether Prior Authorization is required or ask your Provider to contact the pre-certification number on your member ID card.

If your Prior Authorization is denied, you will receive an explanation of why it was denied and how you can appeal (including how to request expedited review, if applicable). This information can also be found in the ["If Your Medical Claim is Denied"](#) section.

The Prior Authorization list is subject to change without advance notice. The most current Prior Authorization list can be obtained by contacting (or having your Provider contact) the pre-certification number on your member ID card or calling Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Prior Authorization is **required** for the following services:

- Acute care hospitalizations (planned)
- Acute inpatient rehabilitation
- Applied behavioral analysis
- Non-Emergency air transportation
- Bariatric surgery
- Bone growth stimulators
- BRCA testing
- Select cardiovascular procedures
- Select chemotherapy
- Clinical trials
- Cochlear implant surgery
- Coverage with Evidence Development
- Potentially Cosmetic and Reconstructive surgery
- Select durable medical equipment, orthotics, and prosthetics
- Select genetic and molecular tests
- Select injectable medications
- Intensity-modulated radiation therapy
- Long-term acute care
- MR-guided focused ultrasound
- Organ transplants
- Orthognathic surgery
- Partial hospitalization
- Proton beam therapy
- Residential treatment facilities
- Skilled Nursing Facilities

- Sleep apnea procedures
- Sleep studies
- Select spinal surgeries
- Vein procedures
- Ventricular assist devices

If you have questions about Prior Authorization or need to confirm whether or not Prior Authorization is required, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Utilization Management

Utilization Management processes are conducted by Surest to ensure that certain services are Medically Necessary. Utilization Management processes include clinical, medical, pre-service review (e.g., Prior Authorization), concurrent review (e.g., during a hospital stay), and post-service review. Based on a pre-service, concurrent, or post-service review, Surest may deny coverage if, in its determination, such services are not Medically Necessary or do not meet all criteria specified in this SPD. Such determination shall be based on established clinical criteria as described in Surest’s medical policies.

Travel outside the United States

For members traveling outside the United States, only Emergency Care is covered. Non-emergent care outside of the U.S. will be processed as out-of-network based on billed charges. If you receive Emergency Care outside the United States, you will need to submit a Claim for reimbursement using [this form](#).

Filling a prescription

Depending on your needs, you may fill your prescription at a retail pharmacy, home delivery pharmacy, or specialty pharmacy. Review the Surest prescription drug benefit below for more information on what is covered.



The pharmacy network may change from time to time, and the SPD might not show the latest changes that are in effect. For the most updated pharmacy network information, please refer to the Surest mobile app or the [Benefits.Surest.com](#) website, or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Coverage	Up to a 90-day supply for generic medications; all others are up to a 30-day supply*	Up to a 90-day supply* only when using Optum Home Delivery	Up to a 30-day supply* Additional clinical support for members using specialty drugs
In-network pharmacies	Optum Rx pharmacies bill the plan on your behalf To find an Optum Rx retail pharmacy, refer to the Surest	Optum Home Delivery Pharmacy*** will bill the plan on your behalf	Optum Specialty Pharmacy ** will bill the plan on your behalf

	mobile app or Benefits.Surest.com website or call Surest Member Services		
Out-of-network pharmacies	You will need to submit a prescription reimbursement form, with your receipt, for reimbursement	Not covered	Not covered

* Unless the drug maker's packaging otherwise limits the supply.

** Contact Optum Specialty Pharmacy at 1-855-427-4682 to get started.

*** Contact Optum Home Delivery at 1-800-356-3477 to get started.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and
- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but are available at a lower cost because the patent has expired.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.

Prior Authorization

Prior Authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, may be required for some services and prescriptions to determine that coverage is available before the service occurs. Where Prior Authorization is required but not obtained, coverage may be denied on that basis alone. In-Network Providers are required to obtain Prior Authorization on your behalf. For out-of-network Covered Health Services, however, you are required to ensure that Prior Authorization is obtained (either by yourself or the Provider on your behalf).



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is Medically Necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service. If you have questions or need to obtain Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

See below additional details about specific benefits coverage under the Surest Plan.

What you pay

You pay nothing for preventive care when you use in-network Providers. When you receive care or prescription drugs for other, non-preventive care, such as for the treatment of illnesses, injuries, and chronic conditions, you pay a portion of the cost as a copayment, up to an annual out-of-pocket maximum amount.

Copayments

A copayment is the amount you pay each time you receive certain Covered Health Services, until you reach the applicable out-of-pocket maximum under the Plan. The table below describes how your coverage works and includes copayments applicable to the Covered Health Services you receive. Some copayments for in-network Providers are listed as a range. Surest assigns Provider copayments within the ranges based on Surest’s analysis of treatment outcome and cost information that identifies Physicians, clinics, and hospitals that provide cost-efficient care.

The full range of in-network copayments displayed may not be available in all geographic areas or for all services. You can find in-network Provider-specific copayment amounts by utilizing the ‘Search tool’ on the Surest mobile app or at [Benefits.Surest.com](#) website, or by calling Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298. If possible, you should confirm the specific copayment that applies before you receive any Covered Health Services from a Provider.

The following chart shows the cost-sharing provisions that apply under the Surest Plan.

Benefit Features

The Surest Plan	In-Network	Out-of-Network
Deductible	\$0	\$0
Out-of-Pocket Maximum per calendar year		
Employee Only (“Individual”)		\$2,750
Employee + 1		\$5,500
Employee + 2		\$6,875

If you enroll in individual coverage, once you reach the out-of-pocket maximum for a calendar year, benefits are payable at 100% of the Eligible Expense during the rest of that calendar year. If you have other family members enrolled (Employee + 1 or Employee + 2 coverage) in the Surest Plan, each family member must meet their own individual out-of-pocket maximum until the overall family out-of-pocket maximum has been met.

Once any enrolled family member has reached the applicable individual out-of-pocket maximum, the Surest Plan will pay 100% of that individual’s Eligible Expenses for Covered Health Services for the rest of the calendar year, even if the family out-of-pocket maximum has not been met.

You are responsible for paying for any Covered Health Services that exceed the day, visit, or other applicable maximums under the Surest Plan, and for health care services that are not Covered Health Services, even if you have already reached the out-of-pocket maximum.

Out-of-network Provider balance billing amounts will not apply towards satisfaction of the applicable out-of-pocket maximum.

Except as specifically noted in the schedule of benefits in the **“What the Plan Covers”** section below, the amount applied to your in-network out-of-pocket maximum also applies to your out-of-network out-of-pocket maximum and the amounts applied to your out-of-network out-of-pocket maximum also applies to your in-network out-of-pocket maximum.

Out-of-network care with in-network coverage

You may seek out-of-network care and receive in-network coverage levels in the following situations:

You are new to the Surest plan and actively receiving treatment from a Provider or facility who is not in-network (Transition of Care)	Transition of Care benefits allow you the option to request coverage from your current out-of-network Provider or facility on an in-network basis for a limited time, due to a qualifying medical condition, until the safe transfer to an in-network Provider or facility can be arranged.	To confirm this coverage is available and the length of available in-network coverage extension, and to request an application, contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 or Benefits.Surest.com. The application must be completed and returned within 30 days of the effective date of coverage. Transition of Care benefits are managed on a case-by-case basis.
Your provider’s contract with Surest is ending or changing in a way that affects your care (Continuity of Care)	If you are receiving ongoing treatment for certain serious and complex medical conditions or illnesses, or pregnancy, are undergoing institutional or inpatient care, or are scheduled for nonelective surgery, you may be eligible to continue to receive in-network benefits for the current course of treatment, for up to 90 days.	To confirm this continued in-network coverage is available, and the length of the available in-network coverage extension, and to request an application contact Surest at (866) 222-1298 or Benefits.Surest.com. The application must be completed and returned 30 days of the Provider leaving the network or experiencing a change in its network agreement for existing members.

Continuity of Care benefits are managed on a case-by-case basis.

What the plan covers

The tables below summarize what the Surest Plan covers, including what the plan pays for in-network and out-of-network care.

For some Covered Health Services, copayments may vary based on Provider and location and are displayed as a range below. Please refer to the Surest mobile app or the [Benefits.Surest.com](#) website, or call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298, for more information and specific copayment amounts.

 Services and supplies must be medically necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#).

Common benefits		
These are the most commonly used benefits in the Surest Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage* (may be subject to balance billing)
Preventive Care Including well-child visits through age 18, routine gynecological exams, immunizations and preventive prescription drugs (See the Preventive Care Services list and Preventive Drug list)	Preventive services: 100% Preventive prescription drugs: 100%	Preventive services: \$100 copay* Preventive prescription drugs: 100% of Eligible Expenses
Prescription drugs Including preventive, generic, and brand-name drugs. (see the Surest Prescription Drug List (PDL) or visit Benefits.Surest.com or the Surest mobile app	<i>Surest (Optum Rx) Retail (up to 90-day supply for generics, 30-day supply for all other medications): Generic \$10 copay, Preferred Drugs \$50 copay, Non-Preferred Drugs \$90 copay</i> <i>Optum Rx Mail Order Pharmacy (90-day supply): Generic \$10 copay, Preferred Drugs \$100 copay, Non-Preferred Drugs \$180 copay</i>	<i>Retail (30-day-supply)*: Generic \$10 copay, Preferred Drugs \$50 copay, Non-Preferred Drugs \$90 copay</i> .*Home delivery and Specialty medications are not covered.

Physician Services – Office Visit	Primary care provider office visit: \$20 - \$75 copay Specialist provider office visit: \$20 - \$75 copay	Primary care provider office visit: \$120 copay* Specialist provider office visit: \$120 copay*
Diagnostic services Including lab and imaging services To see the cost of a specific diagnostic test, visit the Surest website (https://benefits.surest.com) or call member services at (866) 222-1298.	Routine diagnostic test (e.g. x-ray, blood work): \$0 copay Non-routine diagnostic test (e.g. sleep study \$75 - \$450 copay, cardiac stress test \$50 - \$310 copay): \$10 - \$750 copay Imaging (CT/PET scans, MRIs): \$60 - \$450 copay	Routine diagnostic test (e.g. x-ray, blood work): \$0 copay* Non-routine diagnostic test (e.g. sleep study, genetic testing): Up to \$2,250 copay* Imaging (CT/PET scans, MRIs): up to \$1,350 copay*
Hospital inpatient care Including semi-private room and board, anesthesia, supporting services, testing, supplies, and intensive or coronary care	\$125 - \$2,000 copay	Up to \$2,500 copay*
Hospital outpatient care/ambulatory surgical care center Including minor surgery, X-ray and radium therapy, anesthesia, and pre-admission testing	\$15 - \$2,000 copay	Up to \$2,500 copay*
Urgent Care	\$40 copay	\$120 copay*
Rehabilitation – Physical, Occupational and Speech Therapies	\$5 - \$60 copay	Up to \$180 copay*
Contraception Contraceptive devices and injections administered by a physician. Prescription forms of contraception are covered under preventive care.	100%	\$100 copay
Maternity care	Routine Prenatal and Postnatal Office Visits, including Labs and Tests - \$0 copay Inpatient Delivery: \$500 - \$1,300 copay/stay	Routine Prenatal and Postnatal Office Visits, including Labs and Tests - \$100 copay* Inpatient Delivery: \$2,000 copay/stay*

Family Planning and Menopause Support (Maven)	Free virtual care and on-demand support (through Maven Clinic) for new and expecting parents as well as employees and their partners who are navigating perimenopause and menopause.	Not applicable
Behavioral Health: Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder treatment	Outpatient behavioral health services are available through the Surest network and through Spring Health (administrator for the employee assistance program) . Spring Health (EAP): - Provides up to 24 sessions per calendar year at no cost to the member. - Up to two (2) of the 24 sessions may be used for medication management - Services received beyond the EAP session limit are covered under the Surest plan when provided by in-network providers, including Spring Health providers who participate in the Surest network.	Not applicable
	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an office setting: \$20 copay	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an office setting: \$60 copay*
	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an outpatient setting: \$75 copay	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an outpatient setting: \$225 copay*
	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an inpatient setting: \$1,300 copay	Mental Health & Substance Use Disorder in an inpatient setting: \$2,000 copay *



*If you use an out-of-network Provider, your costs generally will be higher. In addition to your higher out-of-network copayment, in many cases you may be responsible for the Provider's total billed amounts that exceed the Eligible Expenses that the Surest Plan pays for a Covered Health Service (known as out-of-network Provider "balance billing"), which can be significant.

Other benefits		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage* (may be subject to balance billing)
Ambulance	\$160 copay/transport	\$160 copay*/transport
Chiropractic services and acupuncture	\$30 copay	\$90 copay*
	Combined 24-visit limit per member per calendar year	
Diabetes health education	100%	\$210 copay*
Durable Medical Equipment (DME) and supplies	\$0 - \$500 copay	Up to \$1,000*
Emergency room care and professional services	\$350 copay	\$350 copay*
Hearing care and hardware	Exams: \$20 - \$75 copay	Exams: \$120 copay*
	Hardware: \$10,000 maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premiera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options	
Home Health Care	\$30 copay	\$90 copay*
Hospice Care	Home Hospice Visit: \$30 copay	Home Hospice Visit: \$90 copay*
	Inpatient Hospice Care: \$1,300 copay	Inpatient Hospice Care: \$2,000 copay*
Nutritional therapy	100%	\$100 copay*
	12-visit maximum, per member per calendar year, which is waived for nutritional therapy for a diagnosed eating disorder or diabetes.	
Skilled nursing facility	\$1,000 copay/stay	\$2,000 copay*/stay
	120-day limit per member per calendar year	
Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction surgery	\$350 copay	\$1,050 copay*
Vision therapy	\$20 copay	\$120 copay*
	32-visit maximum, per member, for the duration of the member's continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premiera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options	



*If you use an out-of-network Provider, your costs generally will be higher. In addition to your higher out-of-network copayment, in many cases you may be responsible for the Provider's total billed amounts that exceed the Eligible Expenses that the Surest Plan pays for a Covered Health Service (known as out-of-network Provider "balance billing"), which can be significant.

Specialized benefits		
Microsoft provides these unique benefits to you through the Surest Plan.		
Benefit	In-network coverage	Out-of-network coverage* (may be subject to balance billing)
Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy	\$20 copay	\$100 copay*
Fertility and Family Building Benefit	\$50 - \$2,000 copay Must use the Plan's fertility vendor (Progyny) provider network, of generally two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KPHPWA health plan options, and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy	Not applicable
Gender Affirming Surgical Services	\$20 - \$1,300 copay	\$60 - \$2,000 copay*
Weight Management program comprehensive and clinically based weight management program through Virta, a Surest provider.	100%	Not applicable



*If you use an out-of-network Provider, your costs generally will be higher. In addition to your higher out-of-network copayment, in many cases you may be responsible for the Provider's total billed amounts that exceed the Eligible Expenses that the Surest Plan pays for a Covered Health Service (known as out-of-network Provider "balance billing"), which can be significant.

Plan benefits



The following pages provide details on what the Surest Plan covers, if Medically Necessary, subject to the [exclusions and limitation](#) section.

The SPD is intended to provide a summary of the Surest Plan's coverage.

For some Covered Health Services copayments may vary based on Provider and location and are displayed as a range.

Please refer to the Surest mobile app, the [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website, or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 for specific copay amounts and additional coverage information.

Ambulance Services

Ground or Air

In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
\$160 copayment/transport	\$160 copayment/transport

Out-of-network Ambulance Services copayment applies to the in-network out-of-pocket maximum.

Ground or air ambulance, as the Claims Administrator determines appropriate. Air ambulance is medical transport by helicopter or airplane.

Emergency ambulance services and transportation provided by a licensed ambulance service (either ground or air ambulance) to the nearest hospital that offers Emergency health services.

Ambulance service by air is covered in an Emergency if ground transportation is impossible or would put your life or health in serious jeopardy. If special circumstances exist, the Claims Administrator may approve benefits for Emergency air transportation to a hospital that is not the closest facility to provide Emergency health services.

Ambulance services for non-Emergency: the Surest Plan also covers transportation provided by a licensed professional ambulance (either ground, water, or air ambulance, as Surest determines appropriate) between facilities when the transport is, as determined by Surest:

- From an out-of-network hospital to an in-network hospital
- To a hospital that provides the required care that was not available at the original hospital
- To a more cost-effective acute care facility
- From an acute care facility to a sub-acute care setting

Non-Emergency air ambulance services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization or need to confirm whether or not Prior Authorization is required, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

For air ambulance services, please see [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) for special rules that apply to out-of-network air ambulance services.

Autism/Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) therapy

This benefit covers behavioral interventions based on the principles of Applied Behavioral Analysis (ABA) through eligible Providers.

In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
\$20 copayment/visit	\$100 copayment/visit

The Surest Plan provides benefits for behavioral services for Autism Spectrum Disorder, including Intensive Behavioral Therapies (IBT) such as Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) that are the following:

- Focused on the treatment of core deficits of Autism Spectrum Disorder.
- Focused on treating maladaptive/stereotypic behaviors that are posing danger to self, others, property, or impairment in daily functioning.
- Provided by a Board-Certified Applied Behavior Analyst (BCBA) or other qualified Provider under the appropriate supervision.

Intensive Behavioral Therapy (IBT) is outpatient behavioral care services that aim to reinforce adaptive behaviors, reduce maladaptive behaviors, and improve the mastery of functional age-appropriate skills in members with Autism Spectrum Disorder.

These benefits describe only the behavioral component of treatment for Autism Spectrum Disorder. Medical treatment of Autism Spectrum Disorder is a Covered Health Service for which benefits are available under the applicable medical Covered Health Services categories as described in this section.

- Applied Behavioral Analysis for Autism Spectrum Disorder services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member’s plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Behavioral Health: Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Services

Type of care	You will be covered as follows
Short-term counseling employee assistance program (EAP) as administered by Spring Health	- Up to 24 sessions per person per calendar year, at no cost to the member. - Up to two (2) of the 24 sessions may be used for medication management Services received beyond the 24-session EAP limit are covered under the Surest plan when provided by in-network providers, including Spring Health providers participating in the Surest network. A visit includes each attendance of the provider to the member, regardless of the type of professional services rendered, and whether it might otherwise be termed consultation, treatment, or described in some other manner. For benefit calculation purposes, a typical mental health visit is considered one hour.
Inpatient and Outpatient benefits	Covered under the Surest plan benefits include a range of behavioral health and substance use disorder services, as outlined in the chart below.

Behavioral Health: Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Mental Health Office Visit (including Telehealth Visit)	\$20 copayment / visit	\$60 copayment / visit
Mental Health Biofeedback	\$20 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Mental Health Habilitative, Cognitive, Occupational Therapy	\$10 copayment / visit	\$30 copayment / visit
Mental Health Physical Therapy	\$5 copayment / visit	\$15 copayment / visit
Mental Health Speech Therapy	\$10 copayment / visit	\$30 copayment / visit
Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)	\$75 copayment / visit	\$225 copayment / visit
Intensive Outpatient Treatment Program (IOP)	\$40 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Outpatient Alcohol and Drug Treatment Program	\$75 copayment / visit	\$225 copayment / visit
Partial Hospitalization (PHP)/Day Treatment	\$75 copayment / day	\$225 copayment / day
Substance Use Disorder Medication Therapy	\$10 copayment / visit	\$30 copayment / visit
Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS) Therapy	\$75 copayment / visit	\$225 copayment / visit
Residential Treatment Facility Care	\$1,000 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay
Outpatient Mental Health (in a hospital setting)	\$75 copayment / visit	\$225 copayment / visit
Inpatient Hospital	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

Virtual Care

See Virtual Care
section for details

Not Applicable

The Surest plan provides benefits for Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder. Benefits under the Surest Plan include:

- Diagnostic evaluations, assessment, medication management and treatment planning.
- Individual, family, and group therapy.
- Provider-based case management services.
- Crisis intervention.
- Intensive Outpatient Treatment program (IOP) (a structured outpatient mental health or substance use treatment program at a freestanding or hospital-based facility and provides services for at least three hours per day, two or more days per week).
- Residential treatment.
- Partial hospitalization (PHP)/Day treatment (a structured ambulatory program that may be freestanding or hospital-based and provides services for at least 20 hours per week).
- Other Outpatient treatment.

Mental Health Office Visit refers to a face-to-face visit with your Provider; Mental Health Telehealth visits refers to a non-face-to-face visit with your Provider.

All inpatient services require Prior Authorization if non-emergent or planned, and notification within 24 hours of admission if emergent.

Inpatient residential and partial hospitalization services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.

Refer to the Gender Affirming Care section for additional coverage information.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Additional exclusions and limitations for behavioral health benefits

The following additional exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Services that are solely educational in nature or otherwise paid under state or federal law for purely educational purposes.
- Inpatient or intermediate or outpatient care services for which Prior Authorization was not obtained.

- Non-medical 24-hour withdrawal management which is an organized residential service, including those defined in the *American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM)* criteria providing 24-hour supervision, observation, and support for patients who are intoxicated or experiencing withdrawal, using peer and social support rather than medical and nursing care.
- Outside of initial assessment, services as treatments for the primary diagnoses of learning disabilities, pyromania, kleptomania, and paraphilic disorders.
- School-based Intensive Behavioral Therapies (IBT) service or services that are otherwise covered under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).
- Services performed in connection with conditions not classified in the current edition of the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders by the American Psychiatric Association.
- Transitional living services.
- Tuition for services that are school based for children and adolescents required to be provided by, or paid for by, the school under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act.
- Intense Early Intervention Using Behavioral Therapy (IEIBT) and Lovaas. This exclusion does not apply when required for the treatment of autism spectrum disorders.
- Vagus nerve stimulator treatment for the treatment of depression and quantitative electroencephalogram treatment of behavioral health conditions.
- Marriage counseling, couples counseling, or relationship counseling that is not provided for the treatment of an identified patient with a diagnosed mental health condition.

Chiropractic services and Acupuncture

In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
\$30 copayment/visit	\$90 copayment/visit
Limited to 24 visits or services combined (chiropractic and acupuncture), per member per Plan Year for in-network and out-of-network Providers combined	

These services must be performed by a Physician or by a licensed chiropractic or acupuncture therapy Provider. Benefits include services provided in a Physician's office or on an outpatient basis at a hospital, or alternate facility. Services provided in your home are covered only as described under the Home Health Care section.

Chiropractic Services are limited to manipulative services including chiropractic care and osteopathic manipulation rendered to diagnose and treat acute neuromuscular-skeletal conditions.

Clinical Trials

Clinical trials are research studies designed to find ways to improve health care or to improve prevention, diagnosis, or treatment of health problems. The purpose of many clinical trials is to find out whether a medicine or treatment is safe and effective for treating a certain condition or disease. Clinical trials

compare the effectiveness of medicines or treatments against standard, accepted treatment, or against a placebo if there is no standard treatment.

Members in clinical trials are typically randomized to different treatment arms and based on that randomization may receive either the study intervention or the control intervention.

Services provided in a clinical trial typically include the interventions being evaluated (study agent and control agent) and other clinical services required to evaluate the effectiveness and safety of the interventions being compared.

In compliance with federal law, the Surest Plan covers routine health care costs for qualifying individuals participating in certain qualifying, approved clinical trials relating to the treatment of cancer or another life-threatening disease of condition, even if the expenses otherwise would be considered Experimental or Investigational, if you have been properly referred the clinical trial by a participating Provider and can provide medical and scientific information establishing that your participation in the trial is appropriate. For more information call Surest Member Services at the number on your member ID card.

Clinical Trial services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Colonoscopy – Non-Screening

In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
\$0 to \$850 copayment/visit	\$2,000 copayment/visit

A non-screening colonoscopy is a procedure performed to diagnose disease symptoms. Benefits include Physician services and facility charges. Coverage is available for a non-screening colonoscopy received on an outpatient basis at a hospital, alternate facility, or in a Physician's office.

Services for preventive colonoscopy screenings are provided under the Preventive Care Services section.

Complex Imaging

Complex Imaging	In-Network
MRI (Magnetic Resonance Imaging)	\$75 to \$450 copayment / visit
CT (Computed Tomography)	\$60 to \$450 copayment / visit

Nuclear Imaging (e.g., Bone scan)	\$75 to \$450 copayment / visit	
PET scan	\$75 to \$550 copayment / visit	\$1,350 copayment / visit

Complex Imaging benefits include Physician services and facility charges. If imaging occurs on multiple areas of the body, such as the lumbar spine and the cervical spine, on the same date of services and using only one type of machine (e.g., MRI or CT), one copayment applies. If imaging occurs using different types of imaging machines (e.g., MRI and a CT), on the same date of services, more than one copayment applies. If your Physician suggests a low-dose CT scan (LDCT) for lung cancer screening, refer to Preventive Care Services, in this section, for coverage notes.

Dental Services

Dental and Oral Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Orthognathic (Jaw) Surgery	\$1,800 copayment / visit	\$2,250 copayment / visit
Accidental Injury and Medical Dental – All Other Services		
Office Visit	\$20 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Outpatient Hospital Visit	\$75 to \$525 copayment / visit	\$1,575 copayment / visit
Inpatient Hospital	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

The Surest Plan provides benefits for the treatment of serious dental issues, such as a fractured jaw, excision of a tumor or cyst of the mouth, and incision or drainage of an abscess or cyst of the mouth, when not part of the dentition (gums, teeth, teeth supporting structure). Treatment and repair for services required due to an accidental injury must be started within six months and completed within twelve months of the date of injury.

The Surest Plan also covers dental services, required for treatment of an underlying medical condition such as a cleft palate or other congenital defect, oral reconstruction after invasive oral tumor removal, preparation for or as a result of radiation therapy for oral or facial cancer.



Review the [Dental plan](#) section for information on your dental benefits.

Routine diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the Dental Services copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service has a \$0 copayment. Returning home from a visit with durable medical equipment, such as an oral appliance, may result in an additional copayment.

Eligible Expenses for hospitalizations are those incurred by a member who: (1) is a child under age five; (2) is severely disabled; or (3) has a medical condition, unrelated to the dental procedure that requires

hospitalization or anesthesia for dental treatment. Coverage is limited to facility and anesthesia charges. Oral surgeon/dentist or dental Specialist professional fees are not covered for dental services provided.

The following are examples, though not all-inclusive, of medical conditions that may require hospitalization for dental services: severe asthma, severe airway obstruction, or hemophilia. Care must be directed by a Physician, dentist, or dental Specialist.

Accidental injury dental services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Additional exclusions and limitations for dental services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Dental braces (orthodontics).
- Dental care (which includes dental x-rays, supplies, and appliances and all associated expenses, including hospitalizations and anesthesia). This exclusion does not apply to accidental-related dental services for which benefits are provided as described above. This exclusion does not apply to dental care (oral exam, x-rays, extractions and non-surgical elimination of oral infection) required for the direct treatment of a medical condition for which benefits are available under the Plan.
- Dental care that is required to treat the effects of a medical condition, but that is not necessary to directly treat the medical condition, is excluded. Examples include treatment of dental tooth decay or cavities resulting from dry mouth after radiation treatment or as a result of medication.
- Preventive care, diagnosis, and treatment of or related to the teeth, jawbones, or gums.
- Removal of erupted or impacted teeth.
- Mandibular staple implant provided the procedure is not done to prepare the mouth for dentures.
- The correction of a non-dental physiological condition which has resulted in a severe functional impairment.
- Treatment of congenitally missing, malpositioned or supernumerary (extra) teeth, even if part of a congenital anomaly.
- Dental implants, bone grafts, and other implant-related procedures.
- Endodontics, periodontal surgery, and restorative treatment.
- Oral surgery and anesthesia for removal of impacted teeth, removal of a tooth root (with or without removal of the whole tooth), and root canal therapy.

- Facility, Provider, and anesthesia services in conjunction with non-covered dental procedures.

Diabetes

Diabetes	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Diabetes Health Education	\$0	\$210 copayment
Virta – Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Weight Management Programs	\$0	n/a

This benefit covers outpatient self-management training and education for diabetes, including medical nutritional therapy by a dietitian or nutritionist with expertise in diabetes.

Virta – Diabetes Management, Diabetes Prevention, and Weight Management

The Virta digital program for diabetes management, diabetes prevention, and weight management offers a personalized virtual diabetes control program focused on nutritional changes, medication changes, and biomarker feedback with the goal of helping implement lifestyle changes to reverse diabetes. If you qualify and enroll in any of the programs, you will receive the following benefits:

Eligibility Criteria

- **Type 2 diabetes reversal:** available for members aged 18 and older with an A1c of 6.5 or higher and a diagnosis of type 2 diabetes
- **Prediabetes Reversal:** available for members aged 18 and older with an A1c between 5.7 – 6.4.
- **Obesity reversal and sustainable weight loss:** available for members aged 18 and older with a BMI of 25 or higher without a diagnosis of type 2 diabetes or prediabetes.

If you qualify and join one of the programs, you will get:

- 1:1 health coaching, motivational support, behavior-based guidance, personalized nutrition based on low-carb, moderate protein and high healthy fats, while customizing it to the member's individual budget, food preferences, cultural preference and lifestyle.
- A Virta provider supports and oversees intensive medication management, and the option to safely off-ramp medications while reversing their condition and sustaining weight loss.
- Bluetooth connected weight scale, Bluetooth connected glucometer, unlimited glucose and ketone strips, food scale, and recipe packet.
- 24/7 access to in-app texting, the Virta member community, resources, educational videos, and behavior change health content.

These programs are available to you and your eligible dependents who qualify. The full cost of these programs will be covered by the Plan. To learn more, see if you qualify and enroll, go to [Virta for Microsoft](#) or call Surest Members Services at (866) 222-1298.

Dialysis (Outpatient and Home)

Dialysis Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network
		(may be subject to balance billing)
Outpatient Dialysis	\$30 to \$200 copayment / visit	\$600 copayment / visit
Home Dialysis	\$40 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit

The Surest plan provides benefits for therapeutic treatments received in an office, home, outpatient hospital, or alternate facility. This benefit includes services and supplies for renal dialysis, including both hemodialysis and peritoneal dialysis. Benefit also includes training of the patient.

Dialysis Services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Durable Medical Equipment (DME)

The Surest Plan benefit covers charges for durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies (DME). Benefits cover rental or purchase (including shipping and handling fees) of DME for treatment of an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition. Surest generally follows Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) guidelines on rental vs purchase.

Coverage is provided for eligible DME that meets the minimum medically appropriate equipment standards needed for the patient's medical condition.

Select DME require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review. For more information, please refer to the Surest mobile app, the Benefits.Surest.com website, or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.



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If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

All durable medical equipment and supplies are assigned to a tier, which corresponds to a copayment as shown in the table below:

Durable Medical Equipment (DME) and Supplies				
DME Tier	In-Network		Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)	
	Purchase	Rental	Purchase	Rental
Tier 1	\$0 copay	\$0 copay/month	\$20 copay	\$2 copay/month
Tier 2	\$20 copay	\$2 copay/month	\$40 copay	\$4 copay/month
Tier 3	\$40 copay	\$4 copay/month	\$80 copay	\$8 copay/month
Tier 4	\$60 copay	\$6 copay/month	\$120 copay	\$12 copay/month
Tier 5	\$80 copay	\$8 copay/month	\$160 copay	\$16 copay/month
Tier 6	\$100 copay	\$10 copay/month	\$200 copay	\$20 copay/month
Tier 7	\$150 copay	\$15 copay/month	\$300 copay	\$30 copay/month
Tier 8	\$200 copay	\$20 copay/month	\$400 copay	\$40 copay/month
Tier 9	\$250 copay	\$25 copay/month	\$500 copay	\$50 copay/month
Tier 10	\$300 copay	\$30 copay/month	\$600 copay	\$60 copay/month
Tier 11	\$400 copay	\$40 copay/month	\$800 copay	\$80 copay/month
Tier 12	\$500 copay	\$50 copay/month	\$1,000 copay	\$100 copay/month

The list and tiers of covered DME and supplies subject to periodic review and modification.

A breakdown of the tiers and corresponding copayments can be found on the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.surest.com/benefits) website.

This list of covered DME includes, but is not limited to:

- Braces
- Crutches
- Wheelchairs
- Wheelchair seat lift mechanism and/or a power seat elevation device
- Prostheses
- Cochlear Implants and associated supplies
- Shoes as prescribed by a Provider for a member. Limited to one pair per Plan Year.
- Wigs (up to \$2,000 per calendar year for alopecia caused by medical conditions or treatment for diseases)
- . You may either purchase one over-the-counter breast pump or rent a hospital grade breast pump during a calendar year (one or the other, but not both), for up to the duration of breastfeeding. The pump must be for your own use. Replacement supplies may be purchased on an as needed basis. In-network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100%. Out of network purchase/rental for the pump and replacement supplies is covered at 100% of allowable charge. Batteries are not covered.
- Enteral Nutrition and low protein modified food products administered either orally or by tube feeding as the primary source of nutrition, for certain conditions which require specialized nutrients or

formulas. The formula or product must be administered under the direction of a Physician or registered dietitian. *Enteral Nutrition that is administered at home will have multiple copayments (such as for formula, nursing visit and administration)*

- Vision hardware such as eyeglasses or contacts; limited to a \$250 allowance for one frame and one pair of lenses and one pair of contact lenses, or a one-year supply of disposable contact lenses may be covered under the medical plan after cataract surgery or for aphakia.

In addition to the plan’s [exclusions and limitations](#), the following durable medical equipment and supplies will not be covered by this plan when they are:

- Normally of use to persons who do not have an injury, illness, disease, or medical condition
- For use in altering air quality or temperature
- For exercise, training and use during participation in sports, recreation, or similar activities
- Equipment, such as whirlpools, portable whirlpool pumps, sauna baths, massage devices, jacuzzis, recliners, overbed tables, elevators, vision aids, and telephone alert systems
- Special or extra-cost convenience items and/or features
- Structural modifications to your home and/or private vehicle
- Replacement of lost or stolen equipment or supplies
- Blood pressure cuffs or monitors (even if prescribed by a physician), unless otherwise provided in this SPD

Emergency Room Services

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Emergency Room Visit	\$350 copayment/visit	\$350 copayment/visit
Observation Stay	\$350 copayment/stay	\$350 copayment/stay

This benefit covers hospital emergency room and provider charges for an emergent condition—regardless of the network status. The copayment applies to Emergency room facility, professional expenses, and includes related expenses. **Routine** diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the Emergency Room visit copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service is \$0 copayment.

If you are admitted as an inpatient directly from the Emergency room for the same condition, the Emergency room services copayment will be waived, and you will be responsible for the Inpatient Hospital Services copayment.

If you are admitted to observation directly from the Emergency room for the same condition, the Emergency room services copayment will be waived, and you will be responsible for the Observation Stay copayment.

Out-of-network Emergency Room Visit or Observation Stay copayment applies to the in-network out-of-pocket maximum.

Returning home from an Emergency Room visit with durable medical equipment, such as crutches, may result in an additional copayment.

Refer to Hospital Services section for additional coverage notes

Please see the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#) section for more information about certain legal protections when you receive emergency services provided by an out-of-network Provider.

Fertility

Fertility Treatments – Designated Provider: Progyny	In-Network	Out-of-Network
Two (2) Smart Cycles per family (employee and spouse) & One (1) additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two result in a pregnancy	Progyny Network	
Two (2) Consultations per Plan Year	Up to \$2,000 copayment per Smart Cycle	Not Covered
Fertility preservation – Egg and sperm freezing coverage		
Tissue storage (specific treatment), included in treatment cycles for the first year		
Progyny Rx – fertility medications	\$50 copayment/script	

Limit: Up to two Smart Cycles per household for the duration of your continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Surest, Premera, or KFHPWA administered health plan options, and one additional Smart Cycle if neither of the first two results in a successful pregnancy, subject to certain restrictions described below

This benefit covers services to assist in achieving a pregnancy for Microsoft employees and their enrolled spouse/domestic partner regardless of reason or origin of condition.



Members must contact their **Progyny Patient Care Advocate** at **(888) 203-5066** to confirm eligibility and utilize a Progyny Network Provider to access the benefit.

Members may also contact Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for additional coverage information regarding what specific services are covered and what copayment applies to a procedure/service or refer to the Surest mobile app for additional coverage information.

The Progyny SMART cycle benefit may be used to receive full coverage for the following treatments and procedures:

- Two consultations per calendar year
- Diagnostic testing
- Transvaginal ultrasounds
- Intrauterine insemination (also known as artificial insemination)
- In vitro fertilization (IVF)
- Gamete intra-fallopian transplant (GIFT)

- Intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI)
- Pre-implantation genetic screening (PGS)
- Pre-implantation genetic diagnosis (PGD)
- Embryo assessment and transfer
- Services used to preserve fertility such as cryopreservation of eggs, sperm and/or embryos. This includes oncofertility preservation.
- Up to four years of storage (egg, embryo, sperm) with annual renewal and eligibility verification
- Purchase of donor tissue (sperm, eggs) as follows:
 - Previously frozen donor sperm or donor oocytes (eggs) from a donor agency intended for the use and transfer into a covered female member (one egg cohort purchase constitutes one SMART Cycle, and one donor sperm purchase constitutes ¼ SMART Cycle). You will be required to pay for the donor sperm or oocytes out of pocket and submit the eligible expenses, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.
 - A fresh donor recipient cycle, whereby the egg donor undergoes an egg retrieval procedure at an in-network Progyny provider to allow for a fresh embryo transfer into a covered female member (one fresh donor recipient cycle constitutes one SMART Cycle). The treatment must occur at an in-network Progyny provider, or else you may be required to pay all expenses up front, out of pocket. If an in-network provider is not contracted for the fresh donor recipient cycle, Progyny will pursue a special case agreement. If a special case agreement request is denied, you will pay for the donor services out of pocket but may submit eligible expenses, with appropriate supporting documentation, to Progyny for reimbursement.

Medication prescribed for fertility treatment will be fulfilled by a Progyny Rx specialty pharmacy and delivered next day to ensure accurate timing with treatment. All medications, compounds, ancillary medication and equipment required for treatment are included in the shipment of medications. Progyny Rx coverage also includes the UnPack It Call where a trained pharmacy clinician will explain drug administration and storage guidelines.

There are some services that are not covered by Progyny; however, they may be covered under the Surest Plan (e.g., corrective surgeries like hysteroscopies, laparoscopies, myomectomies, and testicular sperm extractions).

Treatment for the diagnosis and treatment of the underlying cause of infertility is covered under the Surest Plan as described in this SPD.

Additional exclusions and limitations for infertility

The following exclusions apply to this benefit:

- Fees paid to donors for their participation in any service
- Testing and treatment for potential surrogates that would not otherwise be covered for a member enrolled in the Plan
- Home ovulation prediction kits
- Services and supplies furnished for a dependent child (under age 26) except for oncofertility preservation due to cancer or medical treatments

- Services and supplies furnished by a provider outside the Progyny network, except as otherwise provided
- Fertility Services following a voluntary sterilization procedure

Gender Affirming surgical services

This benefit covers medically necessary gender affirming surgical services, including facility and anesthesia charges related to the surgery.

Coverage of prescription drugs and mental health treatment associated with gender reassignment surgery is available under the [prescription drugs](#) and [mental health](#) benefits.

Gender Affirming Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Mental Health Office Visit	\$20 copayment / visit	\$60 copayment / visit
Gender Affirming Voice Therapy	\$10 copayment / visit	\$30 copayment / visit
Gender Affirming Surgery	\$75 to \$1,300 copayment / visit	\$225 to \$2,000 copayment / visit
Gender Affirming Reconstructive	\$10 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$30 to \$225 copayment / visit

The Surest Plan covers the following service for Gender Dysphoria, in accordance with the current applicable medical standards of care:

- Psychotherapy for Gender Dysphoria and associated co-morbid psychiatric diagnoses.
- Hormone therapy as appropriate to the patient's gender goals: Hormone therapy administered by a medical Provider (for example, during an office visit).
- Laboratory testing to monitor the safety of continuous hormone therapy as appropriate to the patient's gender goals.
- Hair transplantation.
- Permanent hair removal for purposes of genital reconstruction.
- Voice lessons and voice therapy.

Members must be 18 years of age or older for the surgical treatment of Gender Dysphoria. Surgical treatment for Gender Dysphoria includes, when Medically Necessary:

- Abdominoplasty
- Calf augmentation
- Gluteal augmentation
- Liposuction
- Genital surgeries
- Chest surgeries
- Face and neck surgeries

In addition to the Surest Plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following cosmetic procedures are excluded from this benefit:

- o Buttock lift
- o Dermabrasion
- o Ear reduction (Otoplasty).
- o Fertility preservation services
- o Laser or electrolysis hair removal not related to genital reconstruction
- o Neurotoxins
- o Scalp tissue transfer (scalp advancement)
- o Treatment for hair growth
- o Treatment received outside the United States

Services for the treatment of Gender Dysphoria require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Hearing care and hardware

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Hearing Exams and Testing (21 and older)	Exams: \$20- \$75 copay	Exams: \$120 copay*
Hearing Screening (up to age 21)	Screening: \$0 copay	Screening: \$100 copay*

This benefit covers one routine hearing examination and one routine hearing test (or screening) per member each calendar year.

Hearing exam services include:

- Examination of the inner ear and exterior of the ear
- Observation and evaluation of hearing, such as whispered voice and tuning fork
- Case history and recommendations
- The use of calibrated equipment

Hearing hardware

This benefit covers one FDA approved hearing hardware (either an over-the-counter or prescribed hearing aid) up to a maximum benefit of \$10,000 per maximum, per member, every three consecutive (rolling) calendar years of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options

Before obtaining a prescribed hearing aid, you must be examined by a licensed physician (M.D. or D.O.) or audiologist (CCC-A or CCC-MSPA).

Benefits cover the following:

- The hearing aid(s) (monaural or binaural) prescribed as a result of an exam, or an FDA approved over-the-counter hearing aid(s) (monaural or binaural)
- Ear mold(s)
- Hearing aid rental while the primary unit is being repaired
- The initial batteries, cords, and other necessary ancillary equipment
- A follow-up consultation within 30 days following delivery of the prescribed hearing aid with either the prescribing physician or audiologist
- Repairs, servicing, and alteration of hearing aid equipment

Additional exclusions and limitations for hearing care and hardware

In addition to the Surest Plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Hearing aids purchased before your effective date of coverage under this plan
- A prescription or over-the-counter hearing aid, for any reason, more often than once in a period of three consecutive calendar years during which you are continuously enrolled in one or more of Microsoft's Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options
- Batteries or other ancillary equipment other than that obtained upon purchase of the hearing aid
- Bone-anchored hearing aids except when either of the following applies:
 - a) For members with craniofacial anomalies whose abnormal or absent ear canals preclude the use of a wearable hearing aid.
 - b) For members with hearing loss of sufficient severity that it would not be adequately remedied by a wearable hearing aid.

The Surest Plan will not pay for more than one bone-anchored hearing aid per member who meets the above coverage criteria during the entire period of time the member is enrolled in the Surest Plan. In addition, repairs and/or replacement for a bone-anchored hearing aid for members who meet the above coverage are not covered, other than for malfunctions.

- Expenses incurred after your coverage ends under this plan unless a prescribed hearing aid was ordered before that date and was delivered within 90 days after the date your coverage ended
- Charges in excess of this benefit; these expenses are also not eligible for coverage under other benefits of this plan

Home Health Services

Home Health Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Home Health Care Visit	\$30 copayment / visit	\$90 copayment / visit

This benefit covers home visits for short-duration, part-time intermittent care when services are received from a Home Health Agency (an organization authorized by law to provide health care services in the home) or an independent Provider. The services must be ordered by a Physician and provided in your home by a registered nurse or provided by either a home health aide or licensed practical nurse and supervised by a registered nurse.

Home Health Care Visits do not have a visit limit.

For Enteral Nutrition administered at home, multiple copayments will apply (such as for formula and nursing visit).

Occupational therapy, physical therapy, and/or speech therapy visits performed in the home, billed by the Home Health Agency, will apply to the Home Health Services visit limits.

Occupational therapy, physical therapy, and/or speech therapy visits performed in the home, not administered by a Home Health Agency will apply to the Rehabilitative/Habilitative Services visit limits.

Select Home Health Services require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Additional exclusions and limitations for home health care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Domiciliary Care
- Services of a doula not listed as covered in Covered Health Services. Examples include babysitting or doing household chores or travel time.
- Multi-disciplinary pain management programs provided on an inpatient basis for acute pain or for exacerbation of chronic pain.

- Private Duty Nursing
- Respite care, except as defined under Hospice Care in Covered Health Services.
- Rest cures
- Services of personal care attendants
- Work hardening (individualized treatment programs designed to return a person to work or to prepare a person for specific work).

Hospice Care

Hospice Care	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Home Hospice Visit	\$30 copayment / visit	\$90 copayment / visit
Inpatient Hospice Care	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

The hospice care benefit is an integrated program recommended by a Physician which provides comfort and support services for the terminally ill.

Hospice care can be provided in the home or an inpatient setting and includes physical, psychological, spiritual, and respite care for the terminally ill person, and short-term grief counseling for immediate family members while the member (terminally ill person) is receiving hospice care.

Benefits are only available when hospice care is received from a licensed hospice agency, which can include a hospital.

Inpatient Hospice Care requires Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Additional exclusions and limitations for hospice care

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Bereavement or pastoral counseling
- Financial or legal counseling, including real-estate planning or drafting of a will
- Funeral arrangements

- Diversional therapy
- Services that are not related solely to the member, such as transportation, house cleaning, or sitter services

Hospital Services - Other

Hospital Services - Other	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Outpatient Hospital Visit	\$75 to \$525 copayment / visit	\$1,575 copayment / visit
Inpatient Hospital	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

This benefit covers Hospital Services. The above copayments apply for Covered Health Services not otherwise listed in this SPD, Surest mobile app or Benefits.Surest.com website.

Multiple copayments may apply if more than one treatment or procedure is performed during a visit.

Routine diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the Hospital Services copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service is \$0 copayment.

Inpatient hospitalization/stay benefits include:

- Physician and non-Physician services, supplies, and medications received during an inpatient stay.
- Facility charges, including room and board in a semi-private room (a room with two or more beds).
- Physician services for lab tests, anesthesiologists, pathologists, radiologists, and Emergency room Physicians.
- The Surest Plan will allow a private room and cover the cost difference from a semi-private room, only if a private room is Medically Necessary.
- If you are admitted to inpatient from the Emergency department or from observation, the Emergency room copayment or Observation Stay copayment will be waived, and you will be responsible for the Inpatient Hospital Services copayment

Outpatient hospital care includes services such as Radiation Device Placement, Abdominal paracentesis, Peritoneal dialysis procedure, Thoracentesis, Percutaneous drain and stent placement, Surgical Biopsy of the Breast and Inferior Vena Cava Filter Placement (IVC).

- Returning home from an outpatient visit or hospital with durable medical equipment, such as crutches, may result in an additional copayment.

All inpatient services **require Prior Authorization** if planned, and notification within 24 hours of admission if emergent



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Laboratory Services, X-Rays, and Diagnostic Tests – Outpatient

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Routine Diagnostic Laboratory Services / X-Rays / Ultrasounds	\$0 copayment / visit	\$0 copayment / visit
Non-Routine Tests	\$10 to \$750 copayment / visit	\$180 to \$2,250 copayment / visit
Sleep Study	\$75 - \$450 copayment/visit	Up to \$2,250 copayment/visit
Cardiac Stress Test	\$50 - \$310 copayment/visit	Up to \$2,250 copayment/visit
Electroencephalogram (EEG).	\$50 - \$330 copayment/visit	Up to \$2,250 copayment/visit

The Surest Plan covers Routine Diagnostic services as well as Non-Routine tests.

Refer to the Surest mobile app for additional coverage information and the copayment that has been assigned to your procedure/service.

Routine diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the facility service or surgery copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service is \$0 copayment.

Routine diagnostic services received on an outpatient basis at a hospital, alternate facility or in a Physician's office include:

- Diagnostic labs, pathology tests, and interpretation charges, such as blood tests, analysis of tissues, or liquids from the body.
- Diagnostic ultrasounds and X-rays, such as fluoroscopic tests and interpretation.

Non-Routine diagnostic testing services received on an outpatient basis at a hospital, alternate facility or in a Physician's office including, but not limited to:

- Angiography (Arteriography).
- Cardiac Event Monitoring.
- Coronary Calcium Score (Heart Scan).
- Cystometrogram (CMG).
- Echocardiogram Exercise Stress Test.
- EKG Exercise Stress Test.
- Electroencephalogram (EEG).
- Electromyography (EMG) and Nerve Conduction Studies (NCS).
- Gastrointestinal Motility Testing.
- Genetic Testing
 - The following categories of Genetic Testing services are covered; genetic tests for cancer susceptibility, genetic tests for hereditary diseases, unspecified molecular pathology, and fetal aneuploidy testing
- Facility-based Sleep Study.
- Home-based Sleep Study.
- Non-cardiac Angiography, Arthrography, and Myelography.
- Tilt Table Testing.
- Transthoracic Echocardiogram (TTE).
-

If more than one type of imaging occurs (such as an x-ray and ultrasound), or more than one type of diagnostic testing occurs (such as an EKG exercise stress test and EEG) on the same date of service, more than one copayment may apply.

Select laboratory services and diagnostic testing require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



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If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Maternity care

This benefit covers maternity benefits provided for you, your enrolled spouse/domestic partner, and your eligible dependent children.

Maternity Care and Delivery

In-Network

Out-of-Network

		(may be subject to balance billing)
Routine Prenatal and Postnatal Office Visits, including Labs and Tests	\$0 copayment / visit	\$100 copayment / visit
Newborn Nursery Care	\$0 copayment / test	\$0 copayment / test
Inpatient Delivery	\$500 to \$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay
Home Birth/Delivery	\$500 copayment / visit	\$1,200 copayment / visit
Amniocentesis	\$300 copayment / test	\$900 copayment / test
Chorionic Villus Sampling (CVS)	\$300 copayment / test	\$900 copayment / test

For women's preventive care visits during and after pregnancy, see the preventive care benefit.

There will be one copayment for all Covered Health Services related to childbirth/delivery, including the newborn, unless the newborn is discharged after the mother. If a newborn baby is discharged after the mother, another copayment will apply to the baby's services. See Hospital Services section for benefits.

Benefits are for maternity care in a hospital, alternative birthing center, or at home, including:

- Prenatal testing when required to diagnose conditions of the unborn child
- Services of a licensed nurse or midwife (non-medical service, such as non-medical services performed by a doula are not covered)
- Miscarriages and terminations of pregnancy
- Hospital nursery care for benefits-eligible infant while the mother is hospitalized and receiving benefits; services are covered under the hospital services benefit
- Male circumcision by a physician or mohel for a benefits-eligible dependent; services are covered under the physician services benefit
- One postpartum home health visit within 30 days of the discharge of the baby from the hospital or alternative birthing center
- Home births include an allowance of up to \$500 for eligible supplies and/or equipment used for home delivery, for example, birthing packs, birthing tubs, monitoring devices, local anesthetics, and comfort aids. Services for the newborn, including hospital services and professional services are covered under the hospital services and physician services benefit.
- Doula services covered include in-person, phone, and email support throughout the pregnancy and post-partum; birth support; and lactation support. Birth doula services coverage is limited to a maximum benefit of \$1,000 per pregnancy. Members will be responsible for any amounts that exceed this limit. Before seeking doula services, you must be examined by a licensed Physician, registered nurse or midwife and have a confirmed pregnancy. Eligible doula providers: a doula who is state-licensed if the state requires a license. If the state does not require a license, then the doula must have a current certification under a recognized doula certification organization (e.g., DONA International and PALS Doulas).

Hospital visits or admissions that do not result in delivery including false labor and tests or services not considered "routine" will follow the inpatient or outpatient hospital services benefit.

Inpatient deliveries do not require Prior Authorization or notification unless the mother is hospitalized more than 48-hours following a normal vaginal delivery and 96-hours following normal cesarean section delivery. Stays beyond these time periods require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Medical Infusions, Injectables, and Chemotherapy

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Cancer Chemotherapy	\$15 to \$520 copayment / visit	\$105 to \$1,560 copayment / visit
Provider Administered Drugs	\$20 to \$1,950 copayment / visit	\$375 to \$2,450 copayment / visit

These copayments apply to specific drugs that must be administered in a medical setting or under medical supervision. Call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 to learn which medical drug (e.g., infusions and injections) are subject to these copayments.

Benefits are available for certain medical infusions, injectables, and cancer chemotherapy administered on an outpatient basis in a hospital facility, alternate facility, in a Physician's office, or in the home. This includes intravenous chemotherapy or other intravenous infusion therapy.

Medical Infusions and injectables require supervision and follow up with a medical professional. The Provider Administered Drugs will be dispensed and administered by a medical professional. Certain drugs are dispensed by a medical professional and may require special handling and storage and are generally considered Specialty Drugs.

If a mixture of drugs is needed for a chemotherapy visit, the copayment of the highest cost drug will apply to that visit.

Select Injectable Drugs (or their non-injectable equivalents) that can be safely self-administered may not be covered under the medical benefit but may be covered under the pharmacy. See the [pharmacy benefits](#) section for more information.

Select medical infusions and injectables and chemotherapy require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Cancer Support (Ardynn)

Ardynn is a patient navigation service providing 1-on-1 support with an experienced advocate who guides and supports you every step of your cancer journey. The Cancer Patient Navigators are trained to identify and help resolve common frustrations and can help guide members throughout their cancer experience.

It is powered by PotentiaMetrics, a decision support service that helps people and their families understand survival statistics and the likely outcomes of different treatment options for a cancer diagnosis. Ardynn's big data platform leverages the largest cancer outcomes dataset of its kind to help cancer patients find answers to questions about cancer that can affect their quality of life.

This program is available to you and your eligible dependents who qualify. The full cost of this program will be covered by the Plan. For additional information, visit the Surest mobile app or website or call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298, or go to [Surest - Ardynn](https://ardynn.com/surest) (<https://ardynn.com/surest>).

Office Visit

Visit Type	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Office Visit (including Telehealth Visit) – PCP & Specialist	\$20 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Mental Health Office Visit (including Telehealth Visit)	\$20 copayment / visit	\$60 copayment / visit
Convenience Care / Retail Visit	\$20 copayment / visit	Not Covered
Allergy Injection Visit	\$0 copayment / visit	\$100 copayment / visit

Allergy Testing and Treatment	\$70 copayment / visit	\$210 copayment / visit
E-Visit and Telephone Consult with Your Physician	\$20 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Travel Vaccines	\$0 copayment / visit	\$100 copayment / visit

The Surest Plan provides benefits for services provided in an office for the diagnosis and treatment of an illness or injury.

Routine Diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the Office Visit copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service is \$0 copayment. Multiple copayments may apply if a treatment or procedure is also performed during a visit

Mental Health Office Visit refers to a face-to-face visit with your Provider.

Mental Health Telehealth Visit refers to a non-face-to-face visit with your Provider.

Convenience Care/Retail Clinics are walk-in clinics in retail stores, supermarkets, and pharmacies that treat uncomplicated minor illnesses and injuries, and provide preventive care services.

If your Provider refers you for a test or service within a hospital or other facility, the Outpatient Hospital copayment may apply

Palliative Care

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Office Visit	\$20 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Home Health Care Visit	\$30 copayment / visit	\$90 copayment / visit
Outpatient Hospital Visit	\$75 to \$525 copayment / visit	\$1,575 copayment / visit

The Surest Plan provides benefits for palliative care for members with a new or established diagnosis of progressive debilitating illness. This includes services for pain management received as part of a palliative care treatment plan. The services must be within the scope of the Provider's license to be covered.

Select services performed in the office and outpatient hospital setting require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity Review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish

medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

See the [Home Health Services](#) section for services related to Home Health Care.

See the [Hospice Care](#) section for services related to Hospice Care

Prescription drugs

Your prescription drug benefit under the Surest plan is operated by Optum Rx. This benefit covers most FDA-approved, medically necessary prescription drugs, when prescribed for the member's use outside of a medical facility and dispensed by a licensed pharmacist in a pharmacy licensed by the state in which the pharmacy is located. Also included in this benefit are injectable supplies.

Certain single-source brand and generic preventive drugs will be covered at 100% under the preventive care benefit. Brand-name preventive medications with an available generic equivalent may be covered by the preventive care benefit. Review the [preventive care](#) benefit for more information. The information in this section describes the benefits available under your prescription drug plan.

Generic drug substitution

This plan encourages the use of appropriate generic drugs (as defined below). When available and indicated by the prescriber, a generic equivalent drug will be dispensed in place of a brand name drug. If your prescriber indicates that substituting a generic equivalent for the brand name drug is inappropriate, you'll be charged only the brand name cost share (as applicable). However, if the prescriber does not indicate that substituting a generic equivalent drug is inappropriate, and you request the brand name drug anyway, you'll be charged the difference in price between the brand name drug and the generic equivalent (called an "Ancillary charge") along with the applicable brand name cost-share. In the event a generic drug becomes available for a brand drug, the tier placement of the brand drug may change, or you may no longer have access to that brand drug.



A **prescription drug** is any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Brand drugs are sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

Generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but typically available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions because the patent has expired.

Specialty drugs are high-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.

Ancillary charges are a charge, in addition to the Copayment, that you must pay when a covered drug is dispensed at your request, when a chemically equivalent drug is available.

The Surest Plan includes coverage for prescription drugs dispensed at network pharmacies with the copayments listed below. A Formulary is used to determine which prescription drugs are covered. The Formulary is subject to regular review and modification. You can use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website or contact Surest Member Services to find network pharmacies, drug tiers, and Formulary medications and Specialty Drugs.

The Surest Plan works with the following vendors to administer the pharmacy Benefits.

- OptumRx is the Pharmacy Benefits Manager (PBM) for retail pharmacies.
- OptumRx is the specialty pharmacy.
- OptumRx is the mail-order pharmacy.

Prescription Drug Tiers

If your copayment is higher than the retail price, you pay the lower amount.

Use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services to determine the tier of your drug or to learn more about preventive medications.

Retail Drug Tiers

	30-Day Supply		90-Day Supply	
	Network Pharmacies	Out-of-Network	Network Pharmacies	Out-of-Network
Preventive	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment
Tier 1	\$10 copayment	\$10 copayment	\$10 copayment	\$10 copayment
Tier 2	\$50 copayment	\$50 copayment	Not Covered	Not Covered
Tier 3	\$90 copayment	\$90 copayment	Not Covered	Not Covered

Mail Order Drug Tiers

OptumRx Home Delivery Pharmacy (In-Network Only)		
	30-Day Supply	90-Day Supply
Preventive	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment
Tier 1	\$10 copayment	\$10 copayment
Tier 2	\$50 copayment	\$100 copayment
Tier 3	\$90 copayment	\$180 copayment

Specialty Drug Tiers

OptumRx Specialty Pharmacy (In-Network Only)	
30-Day Supply	
Tier 1	\$10 copayment
Tier 2	\$50 copayment
Tier 3	\$90 copayment

Microsoft Onsite Pharmacy (Redmond Only) Drug Tiers

Living Well Health Center Pharmacy*		
	30-Day Supply	90-Day Supply
Preventive	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment
Tier 1	\$10 copayment	\$10 copayment
Tier 2	\$50 copayment	\$100 copayment
Tier 3	\$90 copayment	\$180 copayment

*Members can fill 30-day supplies of specialty medications at the Microsoft Onsite Pharmacy (Living Well Health Center)

Notes:

- **General**

- There is no coverage for out-of-network pharmacies.
- You pay the listed copayment or price of the prescription, whichever is less.
- As written by the provider, members can receive up to a consecutive 90-day supply of a tier 1 Prescription Drug product at a retail pharmacy, unless adjusted based on the drug manufacturer's packaging size, or based on supply limits. Tier 2 and Tier 3 Prescription Drug Products are limited

to a 30-day supply at a retail pharmacy.

- You must present your Surest member ID card or otherwise provide notice of coverage at the time of purchase to receive the highest level of benefits. If you do not present your member ID card or otherwise provide notice of coverage at the time of purchase, the pharmacy may charge you the full amount of the prescription drug as well as require payment prior to rendering a service. To request reimbursement, contact Surest Member Services.
- Prescription drugs and diabetic supplies are generally covered up to a 90-day supply. Some medications may be subject to a quantity limitation, per-day supply, or a maximum dosage per day. More information can be found on the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or by contacting Surest Member Services.
- Drugs that require the prescriber to submit a Prior Authorization are indicated as such within the Formulary. Use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services to determine if a particular drug requires a Prior Authorization.
- Drugs that require step therapy or that may be subject to a quantity limitation, per-day supply, or a maximum dosage per day are indicated on the Formulary and can be also obtained by using the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services.
- When identical chemical entities are from different manufacturers or distributors, the PBM's clinical coverage committee may determine that only one of those drug products is covered and the other equivalent products are not covered.
- Surest applies health principles to prescription drug benefits with the objective of discounting copayments for the most appropriate medication(s) for a given member, based on the Surest Clinical Policy Committee review. The Surest Clinical Policy Committee reviews evidence-based guidelines, real-world evidence, peer-reviewed studies, etc., to determine treatment pathways that improve long-term health outcomes and target specific members.
- Members will see eligible benefit adjustments in the 'search app' on the Surest mobile app or at the pharmacy when picking up their prescription. Use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services to learn more.

- **Specialty Drugs**

- OptumRx is the specialty pharmacy.
- In addition to OptumRx Specialty pharmacy, members may fill specialty prescriptions at the Microsoft Onsite Pharmacy (Living Well Health Center).
- Specialty Drugs are designated complex injectable and oral drugs that have very specific manufacturing, storage, and/or dilution requirements, and include, but are not limited to, drugs used for growth hormone treatment, multiple sclerosis, rheumatoid arthritis, hepatitis C, and hemophilia.
- Specialty Drugs are generally only covered up to a 30-day supply.
- A current list of designated Specialty Drugs and suppliers is available on the Surest mobile app or the [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services.
- Members are allowed two retail grace fills for specialty drugs before being required to utilize OptumRx Specialty Pharmacy

- **Other Drugs/Supplies**

- Prescription Benefits will cover prescription tobacco cessation drugs and products, and over-the-counter (OTC) tobacco cessation drugs and products obtained with a Physician's prescription at a \$0-dollar copayment. Some quantity limitations may apply. Use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services to learn more.
- OptumRx applies medical management in determining which contraceptives are included on your specified preferred drug list, as well as a subset of contraceptive medications where a \$0

copayment applies as indicated on the Formulary. To view a current list of contraceptive medications that are eligible for coverage with \$0 member cost-sharing under the Surest Plan use the Surest mobile app or [Benefits.Surest.com](https://www.benefits.surest.com) website or call Surest Member Services.

- When you pay for any reimbursement-eligible prescriptions yourself, you are required to submit the drug receipt(s) with the Claim form for reimbursement. For prescription drugs dispensed and used during a covered hospital stay, refer to Medical Infusions, Injectables, and Chemotherapy.
- Drugs that are excluded from the Formulary are not covered under the Surest Plan unless approved in advance through an exception to coverage process managed by OptumRx on the basis that the drug requested is (1) Medically Necessary and essential to the patient's health and safety and/or (2) all Formulary drugs comparable to the excluded drug have been tried by the patient. If approved through that process, the Tier 3 copayment would apply. Without this approval, if you or a covered dependent selects drugs excluded from the Formulary, you will be required to pay the full cost of the drug without any reimbursement under the Surest Plan. If your Physician believes that an excluded drug meets the requirements described above, your Physician should take the necessary steps to initiate an exception to coverage review.

Refills for a medication will be covered only when the member has used 75% of the supply of that medication, based on both of the following:

- The number of units and days' supply dispensed on the last fill or refill, and
- The total units or days' supply dispensed for the same medication in the 180 days immediately before the last refill, if applicable



Surest provides a customer service team dedicated to Microsoft employees and their dependents. You can use this service by calling member services at (866) 222-1298 with questions regarding:

- Status of mail order prescriptions
- Plan design, including which medications are covered or not covered
- Location of retail pharmacies

Covered drugs

This benefit covers the following FDA-approved items when dispensed by a licensed pharmacy for use outside of a medical facility. Certain drugs may need a Prior Authorization.

Prescription drugs (Federal Legend Drugs as prescribed by a licensed provider). This benefit includes coverage for off-label use of FDA-approved drugs as provided under this plan's definition of prescription drug.

Compounded medications are covered when the main ingredient is a covered prescription drug. Benefits are subject to a standard supply limit.

Inhalation spacer devices and peak flow meters

Glucagon and allergy emergency kits

Prescribed injectable medications for self-administration (such as insulin)

Hypodermic needles, syringes, and alcohol swabs used for self-administered injectable prescription medications

Disposable diabetic testing supplies, including test strips, testing agents, and lancets

Prescription contraceptive drugs and devices (for example, oral drugs, diaphragms, and cervical caps)

Human growth hormone

Prescription drugs for smoking cessation

Impotence medications are limited to 15 pills at retail per 30 days; 45 pills at mail-order per 90 days

Benefits for immunization agents and vaccines, including the professional services to administer the medication, are provided under the [preventive care](#) benefit.

Prior authorization

Prior authorization, also referred to as a pre-service review, is **required** to determine if coverage for certain prescription drug is available before prescription can be filled.

To determine if Prior Authorization is required for a particular drug, refer to the Surest mobile app or the [Benefits.Surest.com](#) website or call Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance, to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Prior Authorization confirms that the treatment plan submitted by the treating provider is medically necessary for the condition based on national, evidence-based guidelines. Surest reserves the right to have appropriate medical professionals review current treatment at any time to determine if medical necessity criteria continue to be met.

In order for certain types of drugs to be covered, information from your doctor must be submitted that identifies the disease being treated and explains the role of the drug in the treatment plan to establish its medical necessity. If that information is made available prior to the prescription being filled, and it is determined that the drug is medically necessary, the prescription will be covered as described above. If information for a drug in this category is not provided, you may pay for the prescription to be filled and submit the claim for consideration along with the clinical information. If it is determined that you do not meet medical necessity criteria needed for the drug to be eligible, you will not be reimbursed for the cost of the drug.

Benefits for some prescription drugs may be limited to one or more of the following:

A set number of days' supply

A specific drug or drug dose that is appropriate for a normal course of treatment

A specific diagnosis

Be under the care of an appropriate medical specialist

Trying a generic drug or a specified brand name drug first

In making these determinations, Surest takes into consideration clinically evidence-based medical necessity criteria, recommendations of the manufacturer, the circumstances of the individual case, U.S. Food and Drug Administration guidelines, published medical literature and standard reference compendia.



For questions about your pharmacy benefits or quantity limits, contact Surest Customer Service at (866) 222-1298

The table below provides information on how to submit information for a medical necessity review.

Drug	Information
Certain drugs require Prior Authorization. Examples include but are not limited to rheumatoid arthritis, certain cancer treatment drugs, growth hormones, anti-depressants, corticosteroid nasal sprays, diabetes, migraine therapy, multiple sclerosis, sleeping disorders, weight loss drugs, and compound medications.	Have your provider call (800) 711-4555 to start or update the benefit review process for these or other drugs needing clinical review and Prior Authorization. If you would like to find out if your drug requires Prior Authorization, refer to the https://benefits.surest.com website, call the telephone number on your ID card, or access the Surest mobile app



Categories of drugs on the drug list may be added or deleted from time to time, based on factors including FDA approval status, medical necessity, member safety, and best practices. If you have paid for a prescription of a drug in this category, you may appeal any denial of benefits for that drug through the appeals process.

How to file a Pharmacy Claim

Generally, you do not need to file a pharmacy Claim for services from in-network pharmacies, the pharmacy will handle the filing of the pharmacy Claim. If you receive Emergency care outside the United States and are seeking reimbursement from the Plan, you can submit a pharmacy Claim using the procedure below.

Please note, manual submission of pharmacy Claims does not guarantee reimbursement. If the prescription drug(s) is non-Formulary, has Prior Authorization, step therapy, quantity limit requirements, or is restricted in some other way, OptumRx will make a coverage determination according to the coverage determination and exceptions process. Requests which require an exception to coverage, such as Prior Authorization, should be submitted to OptumRx for review.

You can submit a post-service pharmacy Claim by mail or fax to OptumRx:

OptumRx
Claims Address
P.O. Box 650540
Dallas, TX 75265-0540

Online Claim Form (eForm): <https://dmrforms.optumrx.com/online-claim-form>

You will need to provide several pieces of information for OptumRx to be able to process your pharmacy Claim and determine the appropriate benefits:

- The Participant ID listed on the member ID card.
- Copies of receipts showing proof of out-of-pocket payment.
- Information about any other health coverage the Participant has.
- Proof of payment may be requested to substantiate your pharmacy Claim but is not required upon initial submission.

Drug-usage patterns

The Plan may be provided with information from a variety of sources regarding drug-usage patterns of individual members that merit further investigation. If the conclusion of the investigation is that the drug-usage patterns are not consistent with generally accepted standards of practice, the Plan may choose to restrict access to the benefit to one prescribing physician for those members. If this action is taken, the member will be notified in advance.

Your right to safe and effective pharmacy services

State and federal laws establish standards to assure safe and effective pharmacy services, and to guarantee your right to know what drugs are covered under this Plan and what coverage limitations are in your contract.



If you want more information about the drug coverage policies under this plan, or if you have a question or a concern about your pharmacy benefit, call the Surest customer service team at (866) 222-1298

If you have a concern about the pharmacists or pharmacies serving you, call your State Department of Health.

The pharmacy plan’s [exclusions and limitations](#), can be found in the [exclusions and limitations](#) section.

Preventive Care Services

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Preventive Care Services	\$0 copayment / visit	\$100 copayment / visit
Preventive Drugs	\$0 copayment	\$0 copayment

Services include evidence-based items or services that have in effect a rating of “A” or “B” in the current recommendations of the United States Preventive Services Task Force, Bright Futures, Health Resources and Services Administration, and Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices.

This benefit covers routine exams, immunizations and health screenings, such as:

- Routine physicals for women and men
- Women’s preventive care including a gynecological exam, routine pap smear (cervical cancer screening) and routine mammogram (breast cancer screening)
- Contraception management office visits
- Well-child exams, including physical exams, tests, and immunizations, through age 18
- Hearing screening for children through age 18
- Routine prenatal and postnatal care
- Routine eye exams
- Flu shots
- Colorectal cancer screening
- Prostate cancer screening
- Lung cancer screening (Low dose CT Scan (LDCT) for lung cancer screening requires Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review)
- Immunizations, which need not be done at the same time as the routine exam

For individuals with known risk factors, such as family history of a disease with known hereditary links, the limits in the recommended guidelines for preventive screenings may not be applicable.

Preventive prescription drugs:

- This benefit covers certain single-source brand and generic prescriptions to prevent the onset of disease by a person who has risk factors for a particular condition, or those taken to prevent a recurrence of a disease. Covered preventive prescription drugs include drugs for the treatment of high cholesterol with cholesterol-lowering medications to prevent heart disease, or the treatment of recovered heart attack or stroke victims with ACE inhibitor medications to prevent a recurrence.
- This benefit also covers certain supplies such as hypodermic needles, test strips and glucose monitors.



For a complete list of what is considered a preventive care drug and paid 100% by the plan see the [Preventive Drug list](#) , or contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.
For information on how to fill your prescription, see the [prescription drug](#) section.

Radiation Therapy and Other High Intensity Therapy

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Radiation Therapy & Other High Intensity Therapy	\$30 to \$1,400 copayment / visit	\$120 to \$2,000 copayment / visit

The Surest Plan provides benefits for radiation therapy and other high intensity therapy services received on an outpatient basis. Benefits include Physician services and facility charges, and services such as, but not limited to:

- Apheresis.
- Blood Transfusion.
- Brachytherapy.
- Conventional External Beam Radiation Therapy (EBRT).
- Proton Therapy.

Select Radiation Therapies require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity Review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

See [Hospital Services – Other](#) for services related to Radiation Device Placement.

Reconstructive Surgery

Place of Service	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Office Visit	\$20 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Outpatient Hospital	\$75 to \$525 copayment / visit	\$1,575 copayment / visit
– Total Mastectomy	\$500 to \$1,400 copayment/visit	\$2,000 copayment/visit
– Partial Mastectomy	\$400 to \$1,250 copayment/visit	\$2,000 copayment/visit
Inpatient Hospital	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

Reconstructive procedures are services performed when the primary purpose of the procedure is either to treat a medical condition or to improve or restore psychologic function of an organ or body part. Reconstructive procedures include surgery or other procedures which are associated with an illness, injury, or congenital anomaly. The primary result of the procedure is not a changed or improved physical appearance.

This benefit covers services, supplies, and procedures for reconstructive surgery purposes, along with complications of these services, supplies, or procedures, for the following:

- Repair of a defect that is the direct result of an accidental injury, providing such repair is started within 12 months of the date of the accident
- Treatment for a congenital anomaly of a covered child
- Treatment of visible birth marks of a covered child
- All stages of reconstruction of the involved breast following a mastectomy, and surgery and reconstruction of the other breast to produce a symmetrical appearance.
- Correction of physical functional disorders. Benefits may include, but are not limited to, blepharoplasty or breast reduction.

The treatment plan for any of the above conditions must be prescribed by a physician.

Multiple copayments may apply if more than one treatment or procedure is performed during a visit/stay

Additional exclusions and limitations for reconstructive services

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following services and supplies are excluded from this benefit:

- Cosmetic services and surgery such as:
 - Hair removal or replacement
 - Removal of scar or tattoo
 - Treatments for hair loss
 - Treatment for spider veins, or varicose veins when considered cosmetic
 - Breast reduction surgery that is determined to be a cosmetic procedure except as required by the Women's Health and Cancer Rights Act of 1998
 - Excision or removal of hanging skin on any part of the body, unless determined to be Medically Necessary. Examples include plastic surgery procedures called abdominoplasty, brachioplasty and panniculectomy
- Treatment for complications resulting from cosmetic surgery
- Complications of non-covered services
- Physical conditioning programs such as athletic training, bodybuilding, diversion or general motivation, exercise, fitness, flexibility, health club memberships and programs, and spa treatments.
- Reconstructive surgery where there is another more appropriate covered surgical procedure or when the proposed Reconstructive surgery offers minimal improvement in your appearance. This exclusion shall not apply to breast reconstruction when performed subsequent to a mastectomy, including surgery on either breast to achieve or restore symmetry.
- Weight loss programs, whether or not they are under medical supervision or for medical reasons, even if for morbid obesity, except as described in the Virta Weight Management program.

Reconstructive Surgery requires Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Rehabilitative/Habilitative Services

Type of Service	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Aural Therapy – Post Cochlear Implant	\$15 to \$60 copayment / visit	\$180 copayment / visit
Cardiac Rehabilitation Therapy	\$30 copayment / visit	\$90 copayment / visit
Cognitive Therapy	\$10 to \$55 copayment / visit	\$165 copayment / visit
Occupational Therapy	\$10 to \$55 copayment / visit	\$165 copayment / visit
Physical Therapy	\$5 to \$45 copayment / visit	\$135 copayment / visit
Pulmonary Rehabilitation Therapy	\$50 copayment / visit	\$150 copayment / visit
Speech Therapy	\$10 to \$55 copayment / visit	\$165 copayment / visit

This benefit includes services provided in a Physician's office or on an outpatient basis at a hospital or alternate facility. Rehabilitative and habilitative services must be performed by a Physician or by a licensed therapy Provider. Refer to the Surest mobile app for additional coverage and copayment information.

The copayments for certain therapies may vary based on Provider and location (e.g., aural, cognitive, occupation, physical, and speech therapy).

Therapies provided in your home are provided as described under the Home Health Care section and will be assigned the home health care visit copayment. See Home Health Services for coverage notes.

Aural, Occupational, Cardiac Rehabilitation, Cognitive, Physical, Pulmonary Rehabilitation, and Speech therapy do not have visit limits.

Cognitive rehabilitation therapy following traumatic brain Injury or cerebral vascular accident is covered when Medically Necessary

Therapies related to the treatment of a mental health condition, such as [Autism Spectrum Disorder](#), are provided under [Behavioral Health – Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder](#) services section.

Skilled Nursing Facility

Skilled Nursing Facility Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Skilled Nursing Facility	\$1,000 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay
Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility	\$1,000 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

This benefit covers inpatient care in a Medicare-approved skilled nursing facility for up to 120 days in each calendar year. Services must be part of a formal written treatment plan prescribed by the doctor. Custodial care is not included in this coverage.

This benefit covers an Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility, such as a long-term acute rehabilitation center, a hospital, or a special unit of a hospital designated as an inpatient rehabilitation facility, that provides occupational therapy, physical therapy, and/or speech therapy as authorized by law.

All Skilled Nursing Facility and Rehabilitation Facility admissions require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Benefits are available only if both of the following are true:

- The initial confinement in a Skilled Nursing Facility or inpatient rehabilitation facility was or will be a cost-effective alternative to an inpatient stay in a hospital.
- You will receive skilled care services that are not primarily Custodial Care
-

Benefits include:

- Facility services for an inpatient stay in a Skilled Nursing Facility or inpatient rehabilitation facility.
- Supplies and non-Physician services received during the inpatient stay.
- Room and board in a semi-private room (a room with two or more beds).
- Physician services for anesthesiologists, pathologists, and radiologists.
- Benefits are available when skilled nursing and/or inpatient rehabilitation facility services are needed on a daily basis. Benefits are also available in a Skilled Nursing Facility or inpatient rehabilitation facility for treatment of an illness or injury that would have otherwise required an inpatient stay in a hospital.

Skilled care is skilled nursing, skilled teaching, and skilled rehabilitation services when all of the following are true:

- Services must be delivered or supervised by licensed technical or professional medical personnel in order to obtain the specified medical outcome and provide for the safety of the patient.
- Services are ordered by a Physician.
- Services are not delivered for the purpose of assisting with activities of daily living, including dressing, feeding, bathing, or transferring from a bed to a chair.
- Services require clinical training in order to be delivered safely and effectively.

You are expected to improve to a predictable level of recovery. Benefits can be denied or shortened for Participants who are not progressing in goal-directed rehabilitation services or if discharge rehabilitation goals have previously been met.

Returning home from a Skilled Nursing Facility or Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility stay with durable medical equipment, such as a walker, may result in an additional copayment.

All Skilled Nursing Facility and Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility admissions require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.

See Hospital Services for other coverage notes

Additional exclusions and limitations for skilled nursing facility

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Custodial care is not provided
- Care that is primarily for neurocognitive disorder, intellectual disability, or the treatment of substance use disorder and alcohol use disorder
- Private Duty Nursing
- Services of personal care attendants

Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction

TMJ Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
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Accidental and Medical Dental:

Temporomandibular joint (TMJ) dysfunction surgery	\$350 copayment / visit	\$1,050 copayment / visit
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All Other Services:

Office Visit	\$20 to \$75 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit
Outpatient Hospital Visit	\$75 to \$525 copayment / visit	\$1,575 copayment / visit
Inpatient Hospital	\$1,300 copayment / stay	\$2,000 copayment / stay

The Surest Plan provides benefits for services for the evaluation and treatment of TMJ and associated muscles. Routine diagnostic services, including diagnostic lab, x-ray, and ultrasound are included in the TMJ copayment. When the routine diagnostic service is prescribed by a doctor and received on a different date of service and location, the service is \$0 copayment.

This benefit includes orthodontic services and supplies, and surgical and non-surgical options for the treatment of TMJ. Benefits for surgical services also include FDA-approved TMJ prosthetic replacements when all other treatments have failed.

Orthognathic surgery and select services for TMJ Disorder Select services for TMJ Disorder require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Transplant Services

Transplant Services	In-Network	Out-of-Network
Bone Marrow and Solid Organ Transplant	\$1,400 copayment / visit	Not Covered
Corneal Transplant	\$1,600 copayment / visit	Not Covered
Cellular and Gene Therapy	\$1,400 copayment / visit	Not Covered

This benefit covers bone marrow (including CAR T-cell therapy for malignancies), heart, heart/lung, lung, kidney, kidney/pancreas, pancreas, liver, liver/intestine, intestine, and corneal transplants. Procedures cannot be experimental or investigational.

All Participants undergoing transplant services (except for corneal transplant) must enroll in Transplant Resource Services, which is a care coordination program for patients undergoing transplants. The Transplant Resource Services program provides Benefits for travel and lodging expenses.

Benefits are available to the donor and the recipient when the recipient is covered under the Surest Plan. Donor costs that are directly related to organ removal or procurement are Covered Health Services for which Benefits are payable through the organ recipient's coverage.

Copayments for outpatient hospital visits may vary based on Provider and location.

Benefits are also available for cellular and gene therapy received on an inpatient basis at a hospital or on an outpatient basis at an alternate facility



Experimental or investigational services, equipment, and drugs have not been approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the specified use. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Eligible providers

Surest has identified quality Designated Providers for transplant services (except for corneal transplant) that are accessible through Transplant Resource Services. ***Transplant services (except for corneal transplant) must be rendered at a Designated Provider.*** All members undergoing transplant services (except for corneal transplant) must enroll in Transplant Resource Services, which is a care coordination program for patients undergoing transplants. The Transplant Resource Services program provides benefits for travel and lodging expenses. See Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit section for more information

Additional exclusions and limitations for transplants

In addition to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#), the following exclusions and limitations apply to this benefit:

- Nonhuman or mechanical organs, unless they are not experimental or investigational
- Services and supplies that are payable by any government, foundation, or charitable grant. This includes services performed on potential or actual recipients or donors (living or cadaver).
- Donor costs are not covered if the recipient of the transplant service is not a Microsoft enrollee. This applies to donor costs for all types of transplant services, solid organ and bone marrow or stem cell reinfusion.
- Donor costs are not covered by Microsoft if benefits are available under other group or individual coverage
- Donor costs are not covered for transportation for typing or matching
- Health services connected with the removal of an organ or tissue from you for purposes of a transplant to another person. (Donor costs that are directly related to organ removal are payable for a transplant through the organ recipient's medical coverage.)

Transplant Resource Services

For a solid organ and blood/marrow transplant to be a Covered Health Service, you must be enrolled in Transplant Resource Services and use a designated provider. Contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 for more information on Transplant Resource Services and access to designated providers.

Once you are enrolled in Transplant Resource Services, a dedicated nurse case manager who specializes in transplant cases will provide assistance in:

- Selecting the transplant facility.
- Scheduling your evaluation at the transplant facility.
- Following up with you routinely while you are on the transplant list.
- Discharge planning, post-transplant support, and ongoing help with your care needs.

Organs included in the program are heart, heart/lung, lung, kidney, kidney/pancreas, pancreas, liver, liver/intestine, intestine, and bone marrow (blood forming stem cell transplants). While corneal transplant is a solid tissue transplant, it is not considered part of the Transplant Resource Services program.

The Transplant Resource Services provides benefits for travel and lodging expenses.

Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit

The Surest Plan provides you with Travel and Lodging assistance for certain Covered Health Services. Travel and Lodging assistance is only available for you or your eligible family member if you meet the qualifications for the benefit, including receiving care at a Designated Provider and the necessary distance from your residence to the facility is at least 100 miles. Eligible expenses are reimbursed after the expense forms have been completed and submitted with the appropriate receipts.

If you have specific questions regarding the Travel and Lodging Assistance Program, please call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Travel and Lodging Expenses

Travel Allowances: Travel expenses are reimbursed between the member's residence and the location of the covered treatment for round trip (air, train, or bus) transportation costs. Airfare, or train or bus fare, must be for a regularly scheduled commercial flight, or train or bus route (coach class only). If traveling by automobile, mileage, parking, and toll costs are reimbursed. Costs for surface transportation (rideshares, taxi, ferry, etc.) are also covered. Mileage reimbursement is based on the current IRS medical mileage reimbursement. Please refer to the IRS website, www.irs.gov, publication 502 Medical and Dental expenses, for current mileage reimbursement rates.

Lodging Allowances: Hotel or motel stays (or similar accommodations) away from the geographic area of the member's residence. Reimbursement of expenses incurred by a member and one companion for hotel or motel lodging away from home, in the geographic area where the covered treatment is performed, is provided at a rate of \$50 per night per person, or up to \$100 per night total for the member and one companion, if applicable (see below), in accordance with applicable IRS reimbursement requirements.

Overall Maximum: The travel and lodging reimbursement benefit is limited to a total of \$10,000 per member per calendar year.

Companions: The travel and lodging benefit is available for the reimbursement of eligible expenses incurred by the member, as well as a companion, to the extent that a companion is needed to accompany the member for the treatment due to medical necessity or safety concerns.

- Adult member (age 18 or older) – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 companion is permitted.
- Child member – travel and lodging reimbursement for 1 parent or guardian is permitted

Limits: Eligible travel and lodging expenses under this benefit are reimbursable up to the IRS mileage rate, lodging allowance, or other limits, as applicable, in effect on the date you incurred the expense, which are subject to change. Please visit the IRS website, www.irs.gov, for details. Nothing in this summary of the travel and lodging reimbursement benefit should be considered legal or tax advice. Please consult with a personal legal or tax advisor for more information.

Non-Covered Expenses:

- Alcohol/tobacco
- Car rental expenses
- Any airfare, train or bus fare, or upgrades, for any ticket other than a regularly scheduled commercial flight or route in coach class
- Baggage fees
- Entertainment (e.g., movies, visits to museums, additional mileage for sightseeing, etc.)
- Expenses for persons other than the patient and an eligible companion
- Lodging at a residence owned by a family member or friend
- Costs for pets or animals, other than service animals
- Meals
- Personal care items (e.g., shampoo, deodorant, toothbrush etc.)
- Souvenirs (e.g., T-shirts, sweatshirts, toys, etc.)
- Telephone calls

Limitations/exclusions:

- The travel and lodging must occur, and the treatment must be provided, within the United States
- The patient must be currently covered by the Surest Plan at the time the treatment is provided and the travel and lodging expenses are incurred

- The medical treatment for which the patient is required to travel more than 100 miles from the patient's residence must be a Covered Health Service.

Treatment/Test/Therapies

Treatment/test/therapies have been tiered based on type and level (minor vs. major) of care. Some minor treatments or procedures are either included in the office visit copayment or may have a specific copayment based on the Provider and location selected. Some surgical procedures also have specific copayments based on the Provider or location selected.

The table below is illustrative of how treatment/test/therapies are tiered and the range of copayments assigned to them.

Treatment / Tests / Therapies	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Level 1: Generally, minor procedures or treatments that are typically performed in an outpatient office setting (e.g., biofeedback, needle biopsy, pain management procedures, etc.)	\$15 to \$1,800 copayment / visit	\$105 to \$2,250 copayment / visit
Level 2: Generally, minor procedures, surgeries, or treatments that are typically performed in an outpatient hospital setting (e.g., bronchoscopy, glaucoma surgery, etc.)	\$0 to \$1,950 copayment / visit	\$525 to \$2,450 copayment / visit
Level 3: Generally, major procedures, surgeries, or treatments that are typically performed in an outpatient hospital setting but may be performed in an inpatient hospital setting (e.g., thyroid surgery, prostate surgery, etc.)	\$125 to \$2,000 copayment / visit / stay	\$1,050 to \$2,500 copayment / visit / stay
Level 4: Generally, major procedures, surgeries, or treatments that are typically performed in an inpatient hospital but may be performed in an outpatient hospital setting (e.g., colon surgery, small bowel surgery, etc.)	\$125 to \$2,000 copayment / visit / stay	\$2,000 to \$2,500 copayment / visit / stay
Level 5: Generally, major procedures, surgeries, or treatments that require intensive monitoring and are performed in an inpatient hospital setting (e.g., bone marrow and solid organ transplant, brain tumor surgery, coronary artery bypass graft surgery, etc.)	\$500 to \$2,000 copayment / visit / stay	\$2,000 to \$2,500 copayment / visit / stay

Other Treatments/Tests/Therapies: Refer to the Surest mobile app or Benefits.Surest.com website for coverage and copayment information or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298. Copayments may vary based on Provider, location and treatment, test, or therapy.

	\$20 to \$75	\$120
Office Visits	copayment / visit	copayment / visit
	\$75 to \$525	\$1,575
Outpatient Hospital Visit	copayment / visit	copayment / visit
	\$1,300	\$2,000
Inpatient Hospital	copayment / stay	copayment / stay

Multiple copayments may apply if more than one treatment or procedure is performed during a visit/stay.

Procedures in Level 1 - Level 5 may vary based on Provider and location.

- Level 1 is a category of minor procedures typically performed in an outpatient office setting.
- Level 2 is a category of minor surgeries and procedures or services typically performed in an outpatient hospital setting.
- Level 3 is a category of major surgeries and procedures typically performed in an outpatient hospital setting.
- Level 4 is a category of major surgeries and procedures typically performed in an inpatient hospital setting.
- Level 5 is a category of major surgeries and procedures that require intensive monitoring and are typically performed in an inpatient hospital setting. Transplant services must be rendered at a location specified as a Designated Provider

Bariatric Surgery does not have a limit.

Biofeedback therapy is a non-drug treatment in which patients learn to control bodily processes that are normally involuntary, such as muscle tension, blood pressure, or heart rate.

Copayments for office visits or outpatient hospital visits may vary based on Provider and location. Refer to the Surest mobile app or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 to determine the copayment assigned to your procedure/service.

Inpatient Hospitalization/Stay benefits include:

- Physician and non-Physician services, supplies, and medications received during an inpatient stay.
- Facility charges, including room and board in a semi-private room (a room with two or more beds).
- Physician services for lab tests, anesthesiologists, pathologists, radiologists, and Emergency room Physicians.
- The Surest Plan will allow the difference in cost between a semi-private room and a private room only if a private room is necessary according to generally accepted medical practice.

All inpatient services require Prior Authorization if planned, and notification within 24 hours of admission if emergent.

Select office-based and outpatient procedures require Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity review.



Prior authorization is an advance determination by Surest that the service or prescription is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination gives claimants an opportunity to submit medical records in advance to establish medical necessity and determine their potential financial responsibility, before the service is provided. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

If you have questions about Prior Authorization, please contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Urgent Care

Urgent Care	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Urgent Care Visit	\$40 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit

Benefits include visits at a walk-in Urgent Care center that treats illnesses and injuries requiring immediate care, but not serious enough to require an Emergency department visit. If the Urgent Care facility is unable to treat you, you may be referred to the Emergency Room or other Provider, you will be responsible for both the Urgent Care and Emergency Room copayments. Returning home from a visit with durable medical equipment, such as crutches, may result in an additional copayment.

Virtual Care

Virtual Care – Designated Provider	In-Network	Out-of-Network
Virtual Primary and Urgent Care	\$0 copayment / visit	Not Covered
Virtual Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Care	\$20 to \$40 copayment / visit	Not Covered
Virtual Specialty Care	\$0 to \$75 copayment / visit	Not Covered

The Surest Plan provides benefits for Virtual Care. Please visit the Surest mobile app or Benefits.Surest.com website or call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 to locate a Designated Virtual Network Provider

Virtual Care is for Covered Health Services that includes the diagnosis and treatment of medical and mental health conditions for members that can be appropriately managed virtually within the scope of practice of the virtual providers, through the use of interactive audio and video telecommunication and

transmissions, and audio-visual communication technology, or through federally compliant secure messaging applications with, or supervised by, a licensed and qualified practitioner.

Copayments vary based on Provider. If you choose a Provider that is not a Designated Virtual Network Provider (Other Virtual Provider), see the Office Visit section for additional Telehealth Visit copayment information. Virtual Care benefits are available only when services are delivered through a Designated Virtual Network Provider that are specified by your Surest Plan. There is no virtual care coverage for out-of-network Providers.

Please note that not all medical conditions can be treated through virtual care. The Designated Virtual Network Provider will identify any condition for which in-person Physician contact is needed.

Vision therapy

	In-Network	Out-of-Network (may be subject to balance billing)
Vision Therapy	\$20 copayment / visit	\$120 copayment / visit

This benefit covers vision training, eye training or eye exercises, up to a maximum of 32 treatment visits, for the duration of continuous enrollment in one or more of Microsoft’s Premera, Surest, or KFHPWA health plan options, for the following conditions only:

- Amblyopia
- Convergence insufficiency
- Esotropia or exotropia

All other uses of vision therapy are considered investigative and are not covered. Vision therapy is not a covered service under the [Vision plan](#). Costs of equipment and supplies associated with vision therapy are not covered.

Exclusions and limitations

The Surest Plan does not provide benefits for the following services, treatments, or supplies (including items or services that are related to the services, treatments, or supplies listed below, but which are not specifically listed below) even if they are recommended or prescribed by a Provider or are the only available treatment for your condition, unless specifically described or listed in **What the Plan Covers**.

- Services or supplies that are not medically necessary for diagnosis, care, or treatment of a disease, illness, injury, or medical condition, except for the following in accordance with the terms of the Surest Plan: (a) newborn nursery care covered under the hospital benefit; (b) male circumcision benefit; (c) sterilization benefit; (d) termination of pregnancy benefit; (e) infertility benefit; (f) hospice care benefit; and (g) well-childcare and adult physical exam benefits

- Charges in excess of eligible expenses, including out-of-network provider billed amounts over the allowable charges
- Expenses in excess of the applicable annual and lifetime benefit maximums
- Over-the-counter drugs (unless prescribed), food dietary supplements (for example, infant formulas or protein supplements), and herbal or naturopathic/homeopathic medicine
- Over the counter (OTC) testing and supplies (for example, OTC pregnancy test and ovulation tests) except as covered under the DME benefit
- Devices and computers to assist in communication and speech except as described in the section for DME and Supplies. Examples of non-covered items include iPads and Android tablets.
- Charges for or in connection with services or supplies that are determined to be experimental or investigational
- Benefits that overlap or duplicate benefits for which the member is eligible under any other group benefit plan; Workers' Compensation or similar employee benefit law; Medicare A or B; or government-sponsored program of any type
- Services or supplies that are covered through any type of no-fault coverage or similar type of insurance coverage or contract, including but not limited to Personal Injury Protection (PIP) coverage, motor vehicle medical (MEDPAY), motor vehicle no-fault coverage, any excess insurance coverage, Medical premises coverage for homeowners or commercial (MEDPREM), commercial liability coverage, boat coverage, homeowner policy, or school and/or athletic policies.
 - This exclusion applies when the available or existing contract or insurance is either issued to, or makes benefits available to a Participant/claimant, whether or not the Participant/claimant makes a claim under such coverage.
 - Further, the Participant is responsible for any cost-sharing required by motor vehicle coverage, unless applicable state law requires otherwise.
 - If other insurance is available for medical benefits, the Participant must put other insurance to use towards those medical bills before coverage under the Plan is available. Once benefits under such contract or insurance have been used and exhausted or considered to no longer be Injury-related under the no-fault provisions of the contract, benefits will be provided according to the Plan.
- Work-related Conditions: This exclusion applies whether or not a proper or timely claim for benefits has been made under the following programs. This plan does not cover services or supplies for which you are entitled to receive benefits under:
 - Occupational coverage required of, or voluntarily obtained by, the employer
 - State or Federal workers' compensation acts
 - Any legislative act providing compensation for work-related illness or injury
- In the event that you do not comply with the contractual terms of subrogation, the plan will no longer be obligated to provide any benefits under this plan. The plan has the right to deduct the amount of benefits paid from any future benefits payable to the enrollee or to any other covered dependent.
- Any services or supplies for which no charge is made, or for which a charge is made because this plan is in effect, or for services or supplies for which the member is legally liable because this plan is in effect
- Services of a social worker except as provided in the hospice care benefit, the home health care benefit and the mental health, substance use disorder, and alcohol use disorder treatment benefit

- Routine or palliative foot care to treat fallen arches, flat feet, care of corns, bunions (except for bone surgery), calluses, toenails (except for ingrown toenail surgery) and other problems that are commonly treated with off-the-shelf, over-the-counter (OTC) therapy. This exclusion does not apply to medically necessary foot care.
- Foot or shoe prosthetics, appliances, orthotics or inserts except as described under the durable medical and surgical equipment and supplies benefit. This does not apply to enrollees who are diabetic.
- Massage therapy that is not medically necessary or is furnished without a prescription
- Activity therapy such as art therapy, dance therapy, horseback therapy, music therapy, and other forms of alternative treatment as defined by the National Center for Complementary and Alternative Medicine (NCCAM) of the National Institutes of Health
- Any benefits or services not specifically provided for in this SPD
- Liquid diets or fasting programs, memberships in diet programs or health clubs, or wiring of the jaw
- Drugs and medications not approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) except as defined in the Experimental and Investigational section
- Services that are considered Experimental or Investigational as determined by Surest. The fact that a treatment, device, or pharmacological regimen is the only available treatment for a particular condition will not result in benefits if the procedure is considered Experimental or Investigational in the treatment of that particular condition. For additional information, call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298
- Procedures for sterilization reversals
- Hypnotherapy, regardless of provider
- Hippotherapy or other forms of equine or animal-based therapy
- Electronic services and/or consults, except as specifically described under the plan
- Services or supplies furnished by a member to himself or herself or by a provider who is in any way related to the member. This also includes but is not limited to a provider who is a covered dependent under the plan (whether or not living in the household), spouse, natural or adoptive parent, child, sibling, stepparent, stepchild, stepsibling, father-in-law, mother-in-law, son-in-law, daughter-in-law, brother-in-law, sister-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, spouse of grandparent or spouse of grandchild.
- Services that are illegal, outside the scope of the provider's license or certification, or that are furnished by a provider that is not licensed or certified by the jurisdiction in which the services or supplies were received
- Separate charges for records or reports, except those Surest requests for utilization review
- Voluntary support or affinity groups such as patient support, diabetic support groups or Alcoholics Anonymous. Additionally, volunteer services or services provided by or through a school, books, and other training aids are also not covered.
- Multi-disciplinary pain management programs provided on an inpatient basis for acute pain or for exacerbation of chronic pain.
- Private Duty Nursing.
- Respite care, except as provided under Hospice Care in the Plan Benefits section.
- Non-treatment facilities, institutions or programs: benefits are not provided for institutional care, housing, incarceration or programs from facilities that are not licensed to provide medical or behavioral health treatment for covered conditions. Examples are prisons, nursing homes, juvenile

detention facilities, group homes, foster homes and adult family homes. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider, provided that such non-treatment facilities, institutions, or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.

- Wilderness, adventure, camping, outdoor, or other similar programs, provided that otherwise-covered services will not be excluded solely because they are furnished in a wilderness or outdoor setting.
- Residential facilities or programs that are not licensed as Residential Treatment Centers (RTC) facilities under state law.
- Outpatient cognitive rehabilitation therapy except as Medically Necessary following traumatic brain Injury or cerebral vascular accident.
- Investigational therapies for treatment of autism spectrum disorders.
- Rehabilitation services for speech therapy, except as required for treatment of a speech impediment or speech dysfunction that results from injury, stroke, cancer, or congenital anomaly.
- Any type of communicator, electronic voice producing machine, voice enhancement, voice prosthesis, or any other language assistive devices, unless otherwise provided under the DME and Supplies section.
- Services or supplies for any of the following:
 - Education and training programs including testing or supplies/materials, including vision training supplies
 - Educational or recreational therapy or programs; this includes, but is not limited to, boarding schools. Benefits may be provided for medically necessary treatment received in these locations if treatment is provided by an eligible provider provided that educational or recreational therapy or programs, themselves, are not eligible providers for this purpose.
 - Social, cultural, or vocational rehabilitation or vision training supplies
- Reconstructive surgery where there is another more appropriate covered surgical procedure or when the proposed Reconstructive surgery offers minimal improvement in your appearance. This exclusion shall not apply to breast reconstruction when performed subsequent to a mastectomy, including surgery on either breast to achieve or restore symmetry.
- Refractive surgery of the eye (surgery to improve vision that can be corrected with glasses or contact lenses) is covered only as specified under the vision plan
- Preventive care, diagnosis, and treatment of or related to the teeth, jawbones, or gums, unless otherwise explicitly provided in this SPD
- Routine eye exams (including refractions), eyeglasses, contact lenses and any fittings associated with them
- Surgery and other related treatment that is intended to correct farsightedness, nearsightedness, presbyopia, and astigmatism, including but not limited to, procedures such as laser and other refractive eye surgery and radial keratotomy.
- Hospital grade breast pumps are not available for purchase; however, they may be covered for rent for up to the duration of breastfeeding
- Reversal of voluntary sterilization.
- Treatments considered Experimental by the American Society of Reproductive Medicine.
- Services for individuals not eligible for coverage under the Microsoft Plan will not be reimbursed except in the following circumstances:

- Donors for organ or bone marrow/stem cell transplantation for services specific to that procedure
- Genetic testing of relatives when the information is needed to adequately assess risk in the member; the result of the test will directly impact the treatment to the member; and there is no other coverage available to the relative
- Long-term (more than 30 days) storage of blood, umbilical cord, or other material (e.g., cryopreservation of tissue, blood, and blood products)
- Lodging is covered only as outlined in the Travel and Lodging Reimbursement Benefit
- Transitional living services
- When Coordinating Benefits (COB) and you fail to follow the rules of the primary plan, this plan would pay nothing for that expense
- Benefits are not provided for services or supplies (1) for which no charge is made, (2) for which no charge would have been made if this plan were not in effect or (3) that were not received by the member while covered by the plan
- Services received in excess of a benefit limit or maximum are not covered. Any network discounts for in-network providers do not apply to services received in excess of the benefit limit.
- Health care services related to a non-Covered Health Service, unless the service treats complications that arise from the non-Covered Health Service. For the purpose of this exclusion a "complication" is an unexpected or unanticipated condition that is superimposed on an existing disease and that affects or modifies the prognosis of the original disease or condition.
- Items or services for which an out-of-network Provider waives, does not pursue, or fails to collect, copayments or other amount owed
- Charges for giving injections that can be self-administered.
- Drugs dispensed by a Physician or Physician's office for outpatient use.
- Self-administered or self-infused medications. This exclusion does not apply to medications which, due to their traits (as determined by Surest), must typically be administered or directly supervised by a qualified Provider or licensed/certified health professional in an outpatient setting. This exclusion does not apply to certain hemophilia treatment centers that are contracted with a specific hemophilia treatment center fee schedule that allows medications used to treat bleeding disorders to be dispensed directly to members for self-administration.
- Certain new prescription medications or products and/or new dosage forms until the date as determined by the Claims Administrator or the Claims Administrator's designee, but no later than December 31st of the following calendar year.

This exclusion does not apply if you have a life-threatening sickness or condition (one that is likely to cause death within one year of the request for treatment). If you have a life-threatening sickness or condition, under such circumstances, benefits may be available for the new prescription medications or product to the extent provided in the Plan Benefits section. Selected drugs or classes of drugs which have shown no additional benefit, with regard to efficacy, safety, or side effects, as compared to other covered drugs.

In addition, the exclusions listed below apply specifically to the pharmacy benefit.

When an exclusion applies to only certain Prescription Drug Products, you can contact Surest at <https://benefits.surest.com>, the telephone number on your ID card, or the Surest mobile app for information on which Prescription Drug Products are excluded.

- Coverage for Prescription Drug Products for the amount dispensed (days' supply or quantity limit) which exceeds the supply limit.
- Coverage for Prescription Drug Products for the amount dispensed (days' supply or quantity limit) which is less than the minimum supply limit.
- Prescription Drug Products dispensed outside the United States, except as required for Emergency treatment.
- Drugs which are prescribed, dispensed or intended for use during an Inpatient Stay.
- Experimental or Investigational or Unproven Services and medications; medications used for experimental treatments for specific diseases and/or dosage regimens determined by the Claims Administrator to be experimental, investigational or unproven.
- Prescription Drug Products furnished by the local, state or federal government. Any Prescription Drug Product to the extent payment or benefits are provided or available from the local, state or federal government (for example, Medicare) whether or not payment or benefits are received, except as otherwise provided by law.
- Prescription Drug Products for any condition, injury, sickness or mental illness arising out of, or in the course of, employment for which benefits are available under any workers' compensation law or other similar laws, whether or not a claim for such benefits is made or payment or benefits are received.
- A Pharmaceutical Product for which benefits are provided under the medical benefits portion of the Plan in this SPD. This includes certain forms of vaccines/immunizations. This exclusion does not apply to Depo Provera and other injectable drugs used for contraception.
- Durable Medical Equipment, including insulin pumps and related supplies for the management and treatment of diabetes, for which benefits are provided in this SPD. Prescribed and non-prescribed outpatient supplies. This does not apply to diabetic supplies, including certain insulin pumps and related supplies for the management and treatment of diabetes and inhaler spacers specifically stated as covered.
- General vitamins, except the following, which require a Prescription Order or Refill:
 - Prenatal vitamins.
 - Vitamins with fluoride.
 - Single entity vitamins.
- Certain unit dose packaging or repackaged prescription drugs.
- Medications used for cosmetic or convenience purposes.
- Prescription Drug Products, including New Prescription Drug Products or new dosage forms, that the Claims Administrator determines do not meet the definition of a Covered Health Care Service.
- Prescription Drug Products as a replacement for a previously dispensed Prescription Drug Product that was lost, stolen, broken or destroyed.
- Prescription Drug Products when prescribed to treat infertility.
- Certain Prescription Drug Products for tobacco cessation.

- Compounded drugs that contain certain bulk chemicals. (Compounded drugs that contain at least one ingredient that requires a Prescription Order or Refill are assigned to Tier 3.) Compounded drugs that are available as a similar commercially available Prescription Drug Product.
- Certain New Prescription Drug Products and/or new dosage forms until the date they are reviewed and placed on a tier by the Claims Administrator's PDL Management Committee.
- Growth hormone for children with familial short stature (short stature based upon heredity and not caused by a diagnosed medical condition).
- Any product for which the primary use is a source of nutrition, nutritional supplements, or dietary management of disease, and prescription medical food products even when used for the treatment of sickness or injury.
- A Prescription Drug Product that contains (an) active ingredient(s) available in and Therapeutically Equivalent to another covered Prescription Drug Product. Such determinations may be made up to six times during a calendar year. The Claims Administrator may decide at any time to reinstate benefits for a Prescription Drug Product that was previously excluded under this provision.
- A Prescription Drug Product that contains (an) active ingredient(s) which is (are) a modified version of and Therapeutically Equivalent to another covered Prescription Drug Product. Such determinations may be made up to six times during a calendar year. The Claims Administrator may decide at any time to reinstate benefits for a Prescription Drug Product that was previously excluded under this provision.
- Certain Prescription Drug Products for which there are Therapeutically Equivalent alternatives available, unless otherwise required by law or approved by the Claims Administrator. Such determinations may be made up to six times during a calendar year. The Claims Administrator may decide at any time to reinstate benefits for a Prescription Drug Product that was previously excluded under this provision.
- Certain Prescription Drug Products that have not been prescribed by a Specialist.
- A Prescription Drug Product that contains marijuana, including medical marijuana.
- Certain Prescription Drug Product with either:
 - An approved biosimilar.
 - A biosimilar and Therapeutically Equivalent to another covered Prescription Drug Product.
 - For the purpose of this exclusion a "biosimilar" is a biological Prescription Drug Product approved based on both of the following:
 - It is highly similar to a reference product (a biological Prescription Drug Product).
 - It has no clinically meaningful differences in terms of safety and effectiveness from the reference product.
 - Such determinations may be made up to six times during a calendar year. The Claims Administrator may decide at any time to reinstate benefits for a Prescription Drug Product that was previously excluded under this provision.
- Diagnostic kits and products including associated services.
- Publicly available software applications and/or monitors that may be available with or without a Prescription Order or Refill.
- Certain Prescription Drug Products that are FDA approved as a package with a device or application, including smart package sensors and/or embedded drug sensors. This exclusion does not apply to a device or application that assists you with the administration of a Prescription Drug Product.

In addition, certain exclusions and limitations apply to the following benefits. CTRL+Click to navigate to the benefit information.

- [Behavioral Health](#)
- [Dental Services](#)
- [Durable Medical Equipment \(DME\)](#)
- [Fertility](#)
- [Gender Affirming Services](#)
- [Hearing Care & Hardware](#)
- [Home Health Services](#)
- [Hospice Care](#)
- [Reconstructive Surgery](#)
- [Skilled Nursing Facility](#)
- [Transplant Services](#)

How to file a claim

Claims Procedures

This section summarizes the procedures you must follow to submit a medical Claim for payment, and the procedures the Surest Plan will use to determine whether and how much to pay for that medical Claim.

If you would like more details about medical Claims procedures and your rights and responsibilities, contact Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298.

Claims for medical (non-pharmacy) benefits will be reviewed by Surest and claims for pharmacy benefits will be reviewed by Optum.

All Claims should be submitted as soon as possible, in accordance with this section, and in all cases must be submitted within one year from the date you received the health care services. If your Claim relates to an inpatient stay, the date you were discharged counts as the date you received the health care service for Claims submission purposes.

Separate schedules apply to the timing of benefit requests and medical Claim appeals, depending on the type of request. There are four types of requests:

Urgent Care Request for Benefits	Concurrent Care Requests	Pre-Service Request for Benefits	Post-Service Medical Claim Request for Benefits
A request for benefits provided in connection with urgent care services If your urgent care request for benefits is denied, you will receive an explanation of why it was denied and how you can appeal (including how to request an expedited review, if applicable).	A request to extend an already approved ongoing course of treatment that was approved for a specific period of time or a specific number of treatments. If the request is urgent, we will follow the urgent care request for benefits and appeals processes and timeframes, except that if the request was received at least 24 hours before expiration of the current approved course of treatment, we will decide the claim within 24 hours of receipt. If it is not urgent, it will be treated like a new request for services and will follow the Pre-Service or Post-Service Request for Benefits and Appeal processes, as applicable.	A request for benefits for which the Surest Plan requires Prior Authorization. If your pre-service request for benefits is denied, you will receive an explanation of why it was denied and how you can appeal (including how to request an expedited review, if applicable).	A medical Claim for reimbursement of the cost of non-urgent care for which the Surest Plan does not require Prior Authorization. You can submit a post-service medical Claim through the Surest website at https://benefits.surest.com or on the mobile app or by mail to the address on your member ID card

Notice of Adverse Benefit Determination

If your medical Claim is denied in whole or in part, you will receive a written notice of denial. The notice will be written in an understandable and, where required by law, in a culturally and linguistically appropriate manner and will include all of the following:

- Information sufficient to identify the medical Claim involved (including the date of service, the healthcare Provider, and the medical Claim amount (if applicable)).
 - The specific reason or reasons for the denial, the denial code and its meaning and a description of the Plan standard, if any, that was used in denying the Claim.
 - The specific reference to the relevant Plan provision on which the decision is based
- A description of additional information needed to support your medical Claim and an explanation of why it is needed.
- Information about to appeal your Claim and any time limits, should you want to pursue it further and your right to bring a civil action under ERISA if your appeal is denied.
- A statement about available external review processes, including information on how to initiate the review.

- If an internal rule, guideline, protocol, or other similar criterion was relied upon in making the decision, either a copy of the document or a statement that such a document was relied on and that a copy will be provided (free of charge) upon request.
- Either an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgement for the decision (applying the Plan terms to your medical circumstances) or a statement that such an explanation was relied on and that a copy will be provided (free of charge) upon request, if the decision was based on Medical Necessity, Experimental or Investigational, or a similar limit or exclusion.
- A description of the expedited review process in the case of a denial concerning a Claim involving urgent care. If we tell you about our decision orally within the timeframes required, we will follow up within three business days with a written or electronic notice.
- A description of any voluntary dispute resolution processes the Plan offers.

Denied claims notice

If your Medical Claim is Denied

If a medical Claim for benefits is denied in part or in whole, you are encouraged to call Surest Member Services before requesting a formal appeal. If Surest Member Services cannot resolve the issue to your satisfaction over the phone, you have the right to file a formal appeal as described below.

To submit a medical Claim appeal:

1. Contact Surest Member Services to request a medical Appeal Filing Form or refer to the medical Appeal Filing Form included with your Explanation of Benefits.
2. Complete the medical Appeal Filing Form.
3. Submit the completed medical Appeal Filing Form along with your denial notice and any supporting documentation to:
Surest Consumer Affairs (Member Appeals)
P.O. Box 31270
Salt Lake City, UT 84131

Review of a Medical Appeal

Surest will conduct a full and fair review of your medical Claim appeal.

You can send written comments, documents, records, and any other information you think will help decide the medical Claim appeal.

You are entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonable access to and copies of all documents, records, and other information relevant to the member's medical Claim for benefits.

When we review your medical Claim appeal, we will take into account all comments, documents, records, and other information you give, even if we did not have that information when we denied the medical Claim.

Surest adheres to the following review practices:

- The appeal will be reviewed by an appropriate individual(s) who did not make the initial benefit determination and who does not report to the person who did make the initial benefit determination.
- If your medical Claim involves a medical judgement or whether the medical Claim is about investigational or Experimental services, the appeal will be reviewed by a health care professional with appropriate expertise who was not consulted during the initial benefit determination process.
- Surest will review all medical Claims in accordance with the rules established by the U.S. Department of Labor and applicable state law.
- Our reviewers avoid conflicts of interest and act independently and impartially.

Once the review is complete, if Surest upholds the denial, you will receive a written explanation of the reasons and facts relating to the denial.

If you are not satisfied with the first-level medical Claim appeal decision, you have the right to request a second-level medical Claim appeal within 60 days of receipt of the first-level medical Claim appeal determination.

Access to New or Additional Information

If you ask us, we will give you the identification of any medical expert who gave an opinion – whether or not we used that opinion to decide your medical Claim. Any member will be automatically provided, free of charge, and sufficiently in advance of the date on which the notice of final internal Adverse Benefit Determination is required, with: (i) any new or additional evidence considered, relied upon, or generated by the Surest Plan in connection with the medical Claim; and (ii) a reasonable opportunity for any member to respond to such new evidence or rationale.

Timing of Medical Claim Appeals Determinations

You may have the right to external review through an Independent Review Organization (IRO) upon completion of the internal appeal process. Instructions regarding any such rights, and how to access those rights, will be provided in a decision letter to you from Surest.

The tables below describe the time frames which you and Surest are required to follow.

Urgent Care Request for Medical Benefits and Appeal*

Request for Urgent Care Benefits	Claims Timing
If your request for medical benefits is incomplete, Surest must notify you within:	24 hours and advise you what information is needed

Request for Urgent Care Benefits	Claims Timing
You must then provide a completed request for medical benefits to Surest within:	48 hours after receiving notice of additional information required
Surest must notify you of the medical benefit determination within:	48 hours of receiving the needed information, or of expiration of the 48-hour period for you to provide the completed request
If your request for medical benefits is complete when it is filed, Surest must notify you within:	72 hours
If Surest denies your request for medical benefits, you must appeal an Adverse Benefit Determination no later than:	180 days after receiving the Adverse Benefit Determination
Concurrent Care Benefits Claims	Claims Timing
If Surest reduces or terminates an approved ongoing course of treatment before its expiration, Surest must notify you:	Sufficiently in advance to allow you to appeal before the reduction or termination takes effect
If (i) you are requesting to extend an approved course of treatment beyond the approved period of time or number of treatments, (ii) your request is for urgent care, and (iii) your request is made at least 24 hours before expiration of the approved period of time or number of treatments, Surest must notify you within:	24 hours <u>after receipt of the claim</u>
All other cases where you are requesting to extend an approved course of treatment beyond the approved period of time or number of treatments, Surest must notify you within:	The urgent care, pre-service, or post-service timeframe <u>as applicable, depending on the nature of the claim</u>
Expedited Appeals (Urgent Care or Concurrent Care)	Appeals Timing
Surest must notify you of the medical Claim appeal decision within:	72 hours after receiving the medical Claim appeal — if the medical Claim appeal is still urgent. If services have already been provided, we follow the Post-service medical Claim appeals process.

*Follow the procedure for an Expedited Appeal provided in your denial of coverage letter.

Pre-Service Request for Medical Benefits and Appeal*

Request for Pre-Service Benefits	Claims Timing
If your request for medical benefits is filed improperly, Surest must notify you within:	5 days
If your request for medical benefits is incomplete, Surest must notify you within:	15 days
You must then provide a completed request for medical benefits information to Surest within:	45 days

Request for Pre-Service Benefits	Claims Timing
Surest must notify you of the medical benefit determination:	
• If the initial request for medical benefits is complete, within:	15 days*
• After receiving the completed request for medical benefits (if the initial request for medical Benefits is incomplete), within:	15 days*
*Surest may require a one-time extension for the request for Pre-Service benefits, of no more than 15 days, only if more time is needed due to circumstances beyond control of the Surest Plan. Surest will notify you if we determine that additional time is needed before the 15 days expires.	
You must appeal an Adverse Benefit Determination no later than:	180 days after receiving the Adverse Benefit Determination
Appeals (Pre-Service)	Appeals Timing
Surest must notify you of the first-level medical Claim appeal decision within:	15 days after receiving a complete first-level medical Claim appeal
You must appeal the first-level medical Claim appeal (file a second-level medical Claim appeal) within:	60 days after receiving the first-level medical Claim appeal decision
Surest must notify you of the second-level medical Claim appeal decision within:	15 days after receiving a complete second-level medical Claim appeal

Post-Service Medical Claim Request for Benefits and Appeal*

Post-Service Claim	Claims Timing
If your medical Claim is incomplete, Surest must notify you within:	30 days
You must then provide completed medical Claim information to Surest within:	45 days
Surest must notify you of the benefit determination:	
• If the initial medical Claim is complete, within:	30 days*
• After receiving the completed medical Claim (if the initial medical Claim is incomplete), or at the expiration of the 45-day period if a completed medical claim is not received, within:	30 days*
*Surest may require a one-time extension for the initial Post-Service Claim determination, of no more than 15 days, only if more time is needed due to circumstances beyond control of the Surest Plan. Surest will notify you if we determine that additional time is needed before the 30 days expires.	
You must appeal an Adverse Benefit Determination no later than:	180 days after receiving the Adverse Benefit Determination

Appeals (Post-Service)	Appeals Timing
Surest must notify you of the first-level medical Claim appeal decision within:	30 days after receiving the first-level medical Claim appeal

You must appeal the first-level medical Claim appeal (file a second-level medical Claim appeal) within:	60 days after receiving the first-level medical Claim appeal decision
Surest must notify you of the second-level medical Claim appeal decision within:	30 days after receiving the second-level medical Claim appeal

Notice of Claim Denial on Appeal

If your Claim is denied on review, the reviewer will provide you with a notice of the Adverse Benefit Determination that will:

- Be written in a manner designed to be understood by an average individual and, where required by law, in a culturally and linguistically appropriate manner.
- Include information sufficient to identify the Claim involved (including the date of service, the health care Provider, and the Claim amount [if applicable]); you can also request from the reviewer the diagnosis and treatment codes and their explanation.
- Include the specific reasons for Adverse Benefit Determination (including the denial code and its meaning and a description of the Plan's standard, if any, that was used in denying the Claim and a discussion of the decision).
- Refer to the specific Plan provisions on which the determination was based.
- Inform you that, upon request and free of charge, you are entitled to reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records, and other information relevant to the Claim for benefits.
- Notify you of your right to bring legal action under ERISA
- Include a copy of any internal rule, protocol or criterion that was relied on in making the determination or indicate that a copy of such material is available (free of charge) upon request.
- Either explain the scientific or clinical judgment made or indicate that such an explanation is available upon request, free of charge, if the determination was based on Medical Necessity or similar exclusion or limit.
- Contain a statement about the availability of contact information for any applicable office of health insurance consumer assistance or ombudsman established to assist individuals with the internal claims and appeals and external review processes.
- Include a statement about voluntary appeal procedures your Plan may offer.

The reviewer's decision on appeal is the final internal Adverse Benefit Determination.

Federal External Review Program

If, after exhausting your internal appeals, you are not satisfied with the determination made by Surest, and the Adverse Benefit Determination was based on any of the following, you may be entitled to request an external review. The process is available at no charge to you.

- Medical judgement and/or Clinical reasons - for example Medical Necessity, appropriateness, health care setting, level of care, and effectiveness of a covered benefit.
- A determination that a treatment, service, drug, or device is an Experimental or Investigational Service(s) or Unproven Service(s).
- A determination as to whether a member is entitled to a reasonable alternative standard for a reward under a wellness program.
- A determination as to whether the Surest Plan is complying with federal mental health parity requirements regarding non-quantitative treatment limitations.
- A rescission of coverage (generally, coverage that was cancelled or discontinued retroactively).
- Consideration of whether the Surest Plan is compliant with the federal rules relating to surprise billing for out-of-network Providers.
- As otherwise required by applicable law.

You or your representative may request a standard external review by sending a written request to the address set out in the determination letter. You or your representative may request an expedited external review, in urgent situations as detailed below, call Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298 or by sending a written request to the address set out in the determination letter.

A request must be made within **120 days** after the date you received the final internal Adverse Benefit Determination letter from Surest.

An external review request should include all of the following:

- A specific request for an external review.
- The member's name, address, and member ID number.
- Your designated representative's name and address, when applicable.
- The service that was denied.
- Any new, relevant information that was not provided during the internal appeal.

An external review will be performed by an Independent Review Organization (IRO). Surest has entered into agreements with three or more IROs that have agreed to perform such reviews. There are two types of external reviews available, and both are free to you.

Standard External Review

A standard external review comprises of all of the following:

- A preliminary review by Surest of the request completed within five business days following Surest's receipt of the request.
- A referral of the request by Surest to the IRO.
- A decision by the IRO.

Within the applicable timeframe after receipt of the request, Surest will complete a preliminary review to determine whether all of the following criteria are satisfied:

- You are or were covered under the Surest Plan at the time the health care service or procedure that is at issue in the request was provided.
- The denial does not relate to your eligibility to participate in the Plan.
- You have exhausted the applicable internal appeals process or are deemed to have exhausted the internal appeals process.
- You have provided all the information and forms required for Surest to process the request.

After completing the preliminary review, Surest will issue a notification in writing to you within one business day. If the request is eligible for external review, Surest will assign an IRO to conduct such review. Surest will assign requests by either rotating assignments among the IROs or by using a random selection process.

If the request is complete but not eligible for external review, Surest will provide notification that includes the reasons for ineligibility and contact information for the Employee Benefits Security Administration. If the request is not complete, the notification will describe the information or materials needed to make the request complete; you will have at least 48 hours (or, if longer, until the end of the four-month filing period) to complete the request.

The IRO will timely notify you in writing whether the request is eligible for external review. Within 10 business days following the date of receipt of the notice, you may submit in writing to the IRO additional information for the IRO to consider in conducting the external review. The IRO is not required to, but may, accept and consider additional information submitted by you after 10 business days.

Surest will provide to the assigned IRO the documents and information considered in making the determination, including:

- All relevant medical records.
- All other documents relied upon by Surest.
- All other information or evidence that you or your Physician submitted. If there is any information or evidence you or your Physician wish to submit that was not previously provided, you may include this information with your external review request and Surest will include it with the documents forwarded to the IRO.

In reaching a decision, the IRO will review the Claim as new and not be bound by any decisions or conclusions reached by Surest. The IRO will provide written notice of its determination (the "Final External

Review Decision”) within 45 days after receiving the request for the external review (unless they request additional time, and you agree). The IRO will deliver the notice of Final External Review Decision to you and Surest, and it will include the clinical basis for the determination.

Upon receipt of a Final External Review Decision reversing the determination made by Surest, the Surest Plan will immediately provide coverage or payment for the benefit Claim at issue, if applicable, in accordance with the terms and conditions of the Surest Plan, and any applicable law regarding Plan remedies. If the Final External Review decision is that payment or referral will not be made, the Surest Plan will not be obligated to provide benefits for the health care service or procedure.

Expedited External Review

An expedited external review is similar to a standard external review. The time for completing the review process is much shorter, and in some instances, you may file an expedited external review before completing the internal appeals process.

You may make a written or verbal request for an expedited external review if you receive either of the following:

- An Adverse Benefit Determination of a Claim or appeal if the Adverse Benefit Determination involves a medical condition for which the time frame for completion of an expedited internal appeal would seriously jeopardize the life or health of the individual or would jeopardize the individual's ability to regain maximum function and you have filed a request for an expedited internal appeal.
- A final appeal decision, if the determination involves a medical condition where the timeframe for completion of a standard external review would seriously jeopardize the life or health of the individual or would jeopardize the individual's ability to regain maximum function, or if the final appeal decision concerns an admission, availability of care, continued stay, or health care service, procedure, or product for which the individual received Emergency services, but has not been discharged from a facility.

Immediately upon receipt of the request, Surest will determine whether the individual meets both of the following criteria:

- Is or was covered under the Surest Plan at the time the health care service or procedure that is at issue in the request was provided.
- Has provided all the information and forms required so that Surest may process the request.

After completing the review, Surest will immediately send a notice in writing to you. Upon a determination that a request is eligible for expedited external review, Surest will assign an IRO in the same manner Surest utilizes to assign standard external reviews to IROs.

In reaching a decision, the IRO will review the Claim as new and not be bound by any decisions or conclusions reached by Surest. The IRO will provide notice of the final external review decision for an expedited external review as expeditiously as the claimant's medical condition or circumstances require, but in no event more than 72 hours after the IRO receives the request. If the initial notice is not in writing, within 48 hours after the date of providing the initial notice the assigned IRO will provide written confirmation of the decision to you and to Surest.

You may contact Surest Member Services (866) 222-1298 for more information regarding external review rights, or if you are making a verbal request for an expedited external review.

Limitation on Your Right to Legal Action

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal (including external review, if applicable) before taking action in any other forum regarding a Claim or appeal under the Surest Plan. Any legal action initiated under the Surest plan must be brought no later than one year following the final adverse determination on the appeal. This one-year limitations period applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit Claim is deemed permanently waived and barred. In addition, you must raise all issues and grounds for appealing a decision on a Claim at every stage of the appeal process, or else such issues and grounds will be deemed permanently waived and barred.

Right to Recover Benefits Paid in Error

If the Surest Plan makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a Provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, we have the right to recover payment, including deducting the mistaken amount paid from future benefits. Note: Neither Providers nor any other third-parties are "beneficiaries" of the Surest Plan, and although we may make direct payment to Providers in many instances, such payments shall not be considered "benefits" available under the Surest Plan or confer beneficiary standing upon a Provider or any other third-party.

Section IV: Vision

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✓ *COBRA enrollees – the Vision section applies*

How the plan works

Microsoft Corporation (hereinafter, "Employer") has selected EyeMed Vision Care, LLC ("EyeMed") as your vision care services provider (the "Benefit"). The Benefit provides coverage for routine vision exams, as well as eyeglasses and contact lenses.

This Summary reflects the Plan that will be in effect beginning January 1, 2025. As issues arise which are not specifically addressed in this Summary, the Claims Administrator will review whether coverage for such services will be included as a covered service under the Benefit.

Employer has delegated the responsibility of its claims determinations under the Benefit to First American Administrators, Inc., ("FAA"), a wholly-owned subsidiary of EyeMed. FAA has the discretionary authority to decide claims and appeals, including the authority to interpret the relevant provisions of the Benefit and the authority to grant and/or deny any and all claims for the vision Benefits.

This Summary is based on the official Benefit documents. If there is a disagreement between the information contained in this Summary and the official Benefit documents, the Benefit documents will govern. This Summary describes the current vision Benefit. Except as prohibited by law, or by the terms of a collective bargaining agreement, Employer may amend or terminate the Benefit.



You have a right to apply for continued vision coverage for you or your covered dependents if your coverage ends because you leave Microsoft or otherwise become ineligible. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Where you can get care

EyeMed's network of providers includes private practitioners, as well as the nation's premier retailers, LensCrafters®, Target Optical, and most Pearle Vision locations. To locate EyeMed Vision Care providers near you, visit www.eyemed.com and choose the Access Network. You may also call EyeMed's Customer Care Center at 1-844-844-0920. EyeMed's Customer Care Center can be reached Monday through Friday from 8:00 am to 11:00 pm, on Saturdays from 8:00 am until 11:00 pm and on Sundays from 11:00 am to 8:00 pm EST.

Online options

You can also use your in-network benefits to purchase glasses, contacts and prescription sunglasses online. Simply visit eyemed.com to see a list of participating online options where you can instantly apply your benefits at checkout.

Using In-Network Providers

When making an appointment with the provider of your choice, identify yourself as an EyeMed member and provide your name and the name of your organization or Group number, located on the front of your ID card. Confirm the provider is an in-network provider for the Network. While your ID card is not necessary to receive services, it is helpful to present your EyeMed Vision Care ID card to identify your membership.

When you receive services at a participating EyeMed Network Provider, the provider will file your claim. You will have to pay the cost of any services or eyewear that exceeds any allowances, and any applicable co-payments.

You will also owe state tax, if applicable, and the cost of non-covered expenses (for example, vision perception training).

Using Out-of-Network Providers

If you receive services from an out-of-network Provider, you will pay for the full cost at the point of service. You will be reimbursed up to the maximums as outlined in the Summary of Vision Benefits. To receive your out-of-network reimbursement, complete and sign an out-of-network claim form and attach your itemized receipts. For your convenience, you may submit your claim form in one of the three (3) following options:

- 1) Online: FAA/EyeMed out-of-network claims can be completed online. To access the out-of-network form or to check the status of a claim, log in to Member Web and navigate to the Claims tab. Remember to upload an itemized paid receipt with your name included.
- 2) Mail: First American Administrators, Inc., ("FAA"), a wholly-owned subsidiary of EyeMed Vision Care:
FAA/EyeMed Vision Care Attn: OON Claims
P.O. Box 8504
Mason, OH 45040-7111
- 3) Email: You may also print a claim form and email it to us at oonclaims@eyemed.com or call the EyeMed's Customer Care Center at 1-844-844-0920.

What the plan covers



Services and supplies must be medically necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's exclusions and limitations.

	Your In-Network Cost	Your Out-of-Network Reimbursement*
EXAM SERVICES		
Exam	\$0 copay	Up to \$75
Retinal Imaging	Up to \$39	Not covered
CONTACT LENS FIT AND FOLLOW-UP		
Fit and Follow-Up - Standard	\$0 copay	Up to \$55
Fit and Follow-Up - Premium	\$0 copay	Up to \$55
MATERIAL ALLOWANCE (DECLINING BALANCE)	\$500 Allowance	Up to \$350
Frame, Lens, and Lens Options	\$0 copay; 20% off balance over allowance	N/A
Contact Lenses - Conventional	\$0 copay; 15% off balance over allowance	N/A
Contact Lenses - Disposable	\$0 copay; 100% of balance over allowance	N/A
Contacts Lenses - Medically Necessary	\$0 copay; 100% of balance over allowance	N/A
EYE SURGERY		
Any elective, refractive procedure that is approved by the FDA. This would include but is not limited to: Pre- and post-operative exams LASIK (LASIK, Custom LASIK, Bladeless LASIK) Photorefractive Keratectomy (PRK) Elective Refractive Lens Exchange	\$1000 Allowance	Up to \$1000
OTHER		
Additional Pairs Allowance	40% off additional pairs of glasses**	Not covered
Any items not covered by the plan, including non-prescription sunglasses	20% off retail price	Not covered
LASIK or PRK from U.S. Laser Network	15% off retail price or 5% off promotional price	Not covered
Hearing Care from Amplifon Network	Discounts on hearing aids	Not covered
FREQUENCY (based on calendar year)		
Exam	Once every calendar year	Once every calendar year
Material Allowance - Frame, Lens, Lens Options, Contact	Once every calendar year	Once every calendar year

Section IV: Vision

Lenses (Declining Balance)		
Eye Surgery	Once per lifetime	Once per lifetime

*You are responsible to pay the out-of-network provider in full at time of service and then submit an out-of-network claim for reimbursement. You will be reimbursed up to the amount shown on the chart.

**Complete pair (frame & lens with or without lens options) purchase required to receive 40% discount. 20% discount applied if complete pair not purchased.

Additional Discounts

Under the Plan, you may receive benefits for eyeglasses (frame and lenses) or contact lenses as outlined on the Summary of Vision Benefits. In addition, EyeMed provides an in-network discount on products and services once your in-network benefits for the applicable Plan Year have been used. The in-network discounts are as follows:

- 40% off additional complete pair of eyeglasses (including prescription sunglasses)
- 15% off conventional contact lenses
- 20% off items not covered by the Plan at network providers

These in-network discounts may not be combined with any other discounts or promotional offers. Discounts do not apply to EyeMed Provider's professional services, disposable contact lenses or certain brand name vision materials in which the manufacturer imposes a no-discount practice or policy.

Discounts on services may not be available at all participating providers. Prior to your appointment, please confirm with your provider whether discounts are offered.

Medically Necessary Contact Lenses

The Plan provides coverage for medically necessary contact lenses when one of the following conditions exists:

- **Anisometropia** of 3D in meridian powers
- **High Ametropia exceeding** -10D or +10D in meridian powers
- **Keratoconus mild/moderate** - when keratoconus is present and the member's vision is not correctable to 20/ 25 in either or both eyes using standard spectacle lenses
- **Keratoconus advanced/ectasia** – when keratoconus is present and one or more specified conditions are met
- **Vision Improvement** for members whose vision can be corrected two lines of improvement on the visual acuity chart when compared to best corrected standard spectacle lenses

The benefit may not be expanded for other eye conditions even if you or your providers deem contact lenses necessary for other eye conditions or visual improvement.

Retinal Imaging

Retinal imaging has been provided as a discount to your vision care benefit. Retinal imaging is a diagnostic tool that provides high-resolution, permanent digital records of your inner eye. Please consult with your Provider to determine if you are a candidate for retinal imaging.

Savings on Laser Vision Correction

EyeMed Vision Care, in connection with the U.S. Laser Network, owned and operated by LCA Vision, offers savings to you for LASIK and PRK. You are entitled to the following discounts:

LASIK at Featured Provider LasikPlus - or - at any other in-network provider you can receive 15% off standard price or 5% off any promotional price.

For additional information or to locate a network provider, visit www.eyemedlasik.com or call 1-800-988-4221. Once you choose your provider, make sure to identify yourself as an EyeMed member to receive your discount and get further member instructions.

Hearing Discount Benefit with Amplifon Hearing Health Care

At EyeMed, we're all eyes and ears about your health and wellness. That's why we teamed up with Amplifon – the world's largest distributor of hearing aids and services to add affordable hearing care to your EyeMed vision benefits package.

Members receive a discount on hearing aids with a low-price guarantee. For additional information call 1-877-203-0675

Exclusions and limitations

Refraction, when not provided as part of a Comprehensive Eye Examination; services provided as a result of any Workers' Compensation law, or similar legislation, or required by any governmental agency or program whether federal, state or subdivisions thereof; orthoptic or vision training, subnormal vision aids and any associated supplemental testing; Aniseikonic lenses; any Vision Examination or any corrective Vision Materials required as a condition of employment; safety eyewear; solutions, cleaning products or frame cases; non-prescription sunglasses; plano (non-prescription) lenses; plano (non-prescription) contact lenses; services rendered after the date a member ceases to be covered under the EyeMed Benefit, except when Vision Materials ordered before coverage ended are delivered, and the services are rendered to the member within 31 days from the date of such order; or lost or broken lenses, frames, glasses, or contact lenses that are replaced before the next Plan Year when Vision Materials would next become available, except where a remaining balance is available; or Vision Materials that are replaced before the next Plan Year when Vision Materials would next become available. Fees charged by a Provider for services other than a covered benefit and any local, state, or Federal taxes must be paid in full by the member to the Provider. Such fees, taxes or materials are not covered under the Benefit. Some provisions, benefits, exclusions, or limitations listed herein may vary by state. Plan discounts cannot be combined with any other discounts or promotional offers. In certain states, members may be required to pay the full retail rate and not the negotiated discount rate with certain participating providers. Please see the online [provider locator](#) to determine which participating providers have agreed to the discounted rate. Discounts on services or materials may not be available at all participating providers. Prior to your appointment, please confirm with your provider whether discounts are offered.

How to file a claim

You may authorize someone else to file and pursue a claim for benefits or an appeal on your behalf. If you do so, you must notify EyeMed Vision Care in writing of your choice of an authorized representative. Your notice must include the representative's name, address, phone number, and a statement indicating the extent to which he or she is authorized to act on your behalf. A consent form that you may use for this purpose will be provided to you upon request.

Time Frames for Processing Claims

FAA will decide claims within the time permitted by applicable state law, but generally no longer than 30 days after receipt. If FAA needs additional time to decide a claim, it will send you a written notice of the extension, which will not exceed 15 days. If FAA needs additional information from you in order to decide the claim, FAA will send you a written notice explaining the information needed. You will have 45 days to provide the information to FAA. If your claim is denied, in whole or in part, FAA will inform you of the denial in writing.

Time Frames and Procedures for Appealing Claims

If your claim is denied, in whole or in part, you may file an appeal. The appeal must be in writing and received by FAA within 180 days of your notice of the denial. If you do not receive an EOB within 30 days of submission of your claim, you may submit an appeal within 180 days after this 30-day period has expired. Your written letter of appeal should include the following:

- The applicable claim number or a copy of the written denial or a copy of the EOB, if applicable.
- The item of your vision coverage that the member feels was misinterpreted or inaccurately applied.
- Additional information from the member's eye care provider that will assist FAA in completing its review of the member's first-level appeal, such as documents, records, questions or comments.

The appeal should be mailed or faxed to the following address: FAA/EyeMed Vision Care

Attn: Quality Assurance Dept. 4000 Luxottica Place
Mason, OH 45040
Fax: 1-513-492-3259

FAA/EyeMed will review your appeal and notify you in writing of its decision.

Complaint Procedure

If you are dissatisfied with an EyeMed Provider's quality of care, services, materials or facility or with EyeMed's Plan administration, you should first call EyeMed Customer Care Center at 1-844-844-0920 to request resolution. The EyeMed Customer Care Center will make every effort to resolve your matter informally.

Section IV: Vision

If you are not satisfied with the resolution from the Customer Care Center service representative, you may file a formal complaint with EyeMed's Quality Assurance Department at the address noted above. You may also include written comments or supporting documentation.

The EyeMed Quality Assurance Department will resolve your complaint within thirty (30) days after receipt, unless special circumstances require an extension of time. In that case, resolution shall be achieved as soon as possible, but no later than one hundred twenty (120) days after EyeMed's receipt of your complaint. Upon final resolution, EyeMed will notify you in writing of its decision.

Section V: Dental

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✓ *COBRA enrollees – the Dental section applies*

How the plan works

Microsoft Corporation has selected Delta Dental of Washington (DDWA) as your dental care services provider. The Delta Dental Plus plan allows you to seek services from in-network or out-of-network providers. In-network preventive care and accidental injury care are covered at 100% and out-of-network preventive care and accidental injury care are covered at 100% of allowable charges. For all other care, you must pay an annual deductible before the plan pays a share of the cost.

All of the dental benefits are subject to the plan's exclusions and limitations. Each benefit may have additional eligibility criteria and exclusions and limitations. Specific coverage is outlined on the following pages.

To be covered under the plans, dental services and supplies must be dentally necessary and provided by a licensed dental provider practicing within the scope of their license. Services may also be provided by a dental hygienist under the supervision of and billed by a licensed dentist.



Necessary vs. Not Covered Treatment

Your Dentist may recommend a treatment plan that includes services which may not be covered by this Plan. DDWA does not specify which treatment should be performed, only which treatment will be paid for under your Plan. While a treatment may be appropriate for managing a specific condition, it must still meet the provisions of the dental Plan in order to be a paid Covered Dental Benefit. Prior to treatment, you and your Dentist should discuss which services may not be covered as well as any fees that are your responsibility. For further information see the "Confirmation of Treatment and Cost" section.



You have a right to apply for continued dental coverage for you or your covered dependents if your coverage ends because you leave Microsoft or otherwise become ineligible. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Where you can get care

You may seek dental care from any licensed dental provider and still have coverage. However, you will receive the lower, negotiated rates and the highest coverage levels by staying within the Delta Dental PPO Plus Premier network. Review the [What you pay](#) section for information on coverage levels.

If you have questions regarding your dental benefits Plan, you can call, text, chat, or email our Customer Service Department at:

Phone: 833-642-8800

Text: 833-642-8800

Online Chat: www.DeltaDentalWA.com

Email: Microsoft@DeltaDentalWA.com

Written inquiries may be sent to:

Delta Dental of Washington
Customer Service Department
P.O. Box 75983
Seattle, WA 98175-0983



Visit the online Delta Dental of Washington Directory to find an in-network provider in the United States or call Delta Dental of Washington at 833-642-8800.

Active employees go here...

<https://aka.ms/deltadental>

Active dependents or COBRA enrollees go here...

<https://www.deltadentalwa.com>

Choosing a Dentist

Your Provider Network: **Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Network.**

You may select any licensed Dentist to provide services under this Plan; however, if you choose a Dentist outside of the Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Network, your costs may be higher than if you were to choose a Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Dentist. Dentists that do not participate in the Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Network have not contracted with DDWA to charge our established PPO plus Premier fees for covered services. As a result, your choice of Dentists could substantially impact your out-of-pocket costs.

Once you choose a Dentist, tell them that you are covered by a DDWA dental plan and provide them the name and number of your Group and your member identification number. This information can be found on your identification card which can be accessed by logging in to your MySmile® account at <https://www.deltadentalwa.com>. You may also obtain this information by calling DDWA's Customer Service Department at 833-642-8800.

DDWA uses randomly selected identification numbers or universal identifiers to ensure the privacy of your information and to help protect against identity theft.

Please note that ID cards are **not** required to see your Dentist but are provided for your convenience.

Delta Dental Participating Dentists

Dentists who have entered into an agreement to provide treatment to patients covered by a DDWA plan at a negotiated discount rate are called "Participating" Dentists. For your Plan, Participating Dentists are either Delta Dental Premier Dentists, Delta Dental PPO Dentists, or Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Dentists. You can find the most current listing of Participating Dentists by going online to the DDWA website at <https://www.deltadentalwa.com>. You may also call Delta Dental at 833-642-8800.

Delta Dental Premier Dentists

Premier Dentists have agreed to provide services for their Filed Fee under DDWA's standard agreement.

Delta Dental PPO Dentists

PPO Dentists have agreed to provide services at a fee lower than their original Filed Fee.

Delta Dental PPO plus Premier Dentists

PPO plus Premier Dentists have agreed to provide services at a fee lower than their original Filed Fee.

Because of this, selecting a PPO or PPO plus Premier Dentist may be a more cost-effective option for you.

If you select a Participating Dentist, they will complete and submit claim forms and receive payment directly from DDWA on your behalf. Payment will be based on the pre-approved fees your Dentist has filed with their local Delta Dental Plan. You will not be charged more than the Participating Dentist's approved fee. You will be responsible only for stated cost shares (e.g., Coinsurance, Deductible), any amount in excess of the Plan Maximum, and any amount for elective care you choose to receive outside the Covered Dental Benefits.

Non-Participating Dentists

If you select a Dentist who has not entered into an agreement to provide treatment to patients covered by a DDWA plan at a negotiated discount rate (a "Non-Participating" Dentist), you are responsible for ensuring either you or your Dentist completes and submits a claim form. DDWA accepts any American Dental Association-approved claim form that you or your Dentist may provide. You can also download a claim form by logging on to your MySmile® account on DDWA's website at <https://www.deltadentalwa.com> or obtain a form by calling Delta Dental at 833-642-8800.

Payment for services performed by a Non-Participating Dentist will be based on their actual charges or the Maximum Allowable Fees for Non-Participating Dentists in the state in which the services are performed, whichever is less. You will be responsible for paying any balance remaining to the Dentist. Please be aware that DDWA has no control over Non-Participating Dentist's charges or billing practices.

Hospital and physician services

Dental care is covered when provided by a hospital or a physician only if the following two conditions are met:

- When adequate dental treatment cannot be rendered without the use of the hospital
- A health problem makes it medically necessary to perform the dental work at the hospital

Any charges for the hospital facility or ambulatory surgical center facility and anesthesia charges will be considered under the benefits of your medical plan.

What you pay

You pay nothing for diagnostic and preventive services (Class I), when you use Participating Dentists. Amounts that the plan pays for your diagnostic and preventive services do not apply toward the annual limit.

For other care, you pay 100% of your eligible expenses until you spend up to the amount of the deductible, which is \$25 per individual or \$75 combined for all individuals enrolled in family coverage (if applicable). No one family member can account for more than the individual deductible amount toward the combined family deductible. If you reach the deductible, then you begin to pay a percentage of the

allowable charges, called coinsurance, and the plan pays the rest. The amount paid by the plan depends on the type of care you seek.

Benefit coverage after you pay deductible (\$25 individual / \$75 family)	
	Dental Plus
Class I - Diagnostic and preventive services	Plan pays 100% of allowable charges
Class II - Basic services Basic restorative services, endodontics, periodontics, and oral surgery	Plan pays 85% of allowable charges, after deductible
Class III - Major services Major restorative services, installation of bridges, and dentures	Plan pays 50% of allowable charges, after deductible
Orthodontia benefits One-time \$50 deductible per member; \$2,500 lifetime benefit maximum benefit per member	Plan pays 50% of allowable charges, after deductible

If you use Participating Dentists, you'll receive the lower Delta Dental negotiated rate, called the allowable charge. If you use Non-Participating Dentists, only the Delta Dental allowable charge is applied to your deductible. You are responsible for the provider charge over the allowable charge. Examples of how the plan pays for in- and out-of-network care follow below.

The plan pays up to a Plan Maximum amount of \$2,500 for Delta Dental Plus benefits per member each calendar year. After the plan pays this annual limit, you are responsible for 100% of the cost when you seek care. The Delta Dental Plus plan also includes a \$2,500 lifetime orthodontia benefit Plan Maximum per member.

Services received in excess of the annual maximums are not covered by this benefit. However, if you receive services from a Participating Dentist after reaching the annual maximum, you will still benefit from the DDWA Participating Dentist discount, even though the services themselves are not covered by the Plan.



The **allowable charge** is defined differently for Participating and Non-Participating Dentists. For Participating Dentists, the allowable charge is the negotiated amount that the provider has agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. For Non-Participating Dentists, payment for services performed will be based on their actual charges or the maximum allowable charge for Non-Participating Dentists in the state in which services are performed, whichever is less. If you choose to use Non-Participating Dentists, you may be responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your Non-Participating provider charges.

A **deductible** is the amount of covered dental costs you must pay each calendar year before the Plan begins to pay its share of allowable charges.

A **lifetime benefit maximum** is the most a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member. Review the [glossary](#) for a full definition.

Example

Pradip needs a crown, which is a Class III service. Pradip can choose a Participating or Non-Participating Dentist. Both charge \$975, but the Participating Dentist accepts the lower DDWA negotiated rate of \$700.

Pradip has employee-only coverage in the Delta Dental Plus plan and hasn't met the deductible yet. If a Participating Dentist is chosen, Pradip pays:

- The \$25 deductible, plus
- 50% of the remaining charge ($\$675 \times 50\% = \337.50)

If Pradip had chosen Non-Participating Dentist, for whom the allowable charge was also \$700, Pradip would have paid \$275 more (the difference between the Non-Participating Dentist's bill and the allowable charge ($\$975 - \$700 = \$275$)).

Example

Mary's child Judith needs a nightguard which is a Class II service. The charge is \$490, but the allowable charge for Participating Dentist A is \$300.

Mary has family coverage in the Delta Dental Plus Plan and takes a covered child to a Non-Participating Dentist, for whom the allowable charge is also \$300. Mary pays:

- The \$25 deductible
- 15% of the remaining allowable charge ($\$275 \times 15\% = \41.25)
- The difference between the Non-Participating Dentist's bill and the allowable charge ($\$490 - \$300 = \$190$)
- Mary's cost for the visit is \$231.25

If Mary had chosen Participating Dentist A, Mary would have saved \$190.

Confirmation of Treatment and Cost

A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost, also known as a predetermination of benefits, is a request made by your Dentist to DDWA to determine your benefits for a particular service. This Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not required, but it will provide you and your Dentist with general coverage information regarding your benefits and your potential out-of-pocket cost for services.

A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not an authorization for services but a notification of Covered Dental Benefits available at the time the Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is made and is not a guarantee of payment (please see the "Initial Benefit Determination" section regarding claims requirements).

A standard Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is processed within 15 days from the date of receipt of all appropriate information. If the information received is incomplete, DDWA will notify you and your Dentist in writing that additional information is required in order to process the Confirmation of Treatment and Cost. Once the additional information is available your Dentist should submit a new request for a Confirmation of Treatment and Cost to DDWA.

In the event your benefits are changed or terminated, or you are no longer covered under the Delta Dental Plus Plan, the Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is no longer valid. DDWA cover your claim based on your coverage at the time treatment is provided.

Urgent Confirmation of Treatment and Cost Requests

Although a Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not required under your plan, DDWA will review any urgent request, where a delay in the standard process may seriously jeopardize life, health, or the ability

to regain maximum function, or could cause severe pain in the opinion of a physician or Dentist who has knowledge of the medical condition. DDWA will review the request within 72 hours from the receipt of the request and all supporting documentation. When practical, DDWA may provide notice of the determination orally with written or electronic confirmation to follow within 72 hours.

Out-of-Country Coverage

All Dentists who are located outside of the United States (this does not include US Territories – Guam, Puerto Rico, the US Virgin Islands, and Marianna Islands) are Non-Participating Dentists. If you receive treatment outside of the United States, you are responsible for ensuring either you or your Dentist completes and submits a claim form. We will accept an "Out of The Country Claim Form" which can be downloaded from DDWA's website at www.DeltaDentalWA.com or obtained by calling 833-642-8800. You may submit the claim by email at outofcountry@deltadentalwa.com, by mail at the following address: Delta Dental of Washington, P.O. Box 75983, Seattle, WA 98175-0983, or by fax at 509-685-6599. When submitting the claim, you must include a copy of the payment receipt showing treatment has been paid. For more information, please call DDWA at 833-642-8800.

What the plan covers

This section provides details on the major benefits of the dental plan, including coinsurance coverage for in-network and out-of-network care in three categories:

- [Class I services – Diagnostic and preventive services](#)
- [Class II services – Basic restorative, endodontics, periodontics, and oral surgery](#)
- [Class III services – Major restorative services and installation of bridges and dentures](#)



Services and supplies must be dentally necessary and are subject to all benefit exclusions and limitations and the plan's exclusions and limitations.



Prescription drugs prescribed by your dentist are covered under your medical plan.

[Health Savings Plan](#)

[Health Connect Plan](#)

[Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington HMO](#)

[Kaiser Permanente HMO](#)

[Hawaii Only Plan](#)

[Surest](#)

Class I services—Diagnostic and preventive services

Dental cleaning (Prophylaxis)

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Two prophylaxes are covered in each calendar year. Services include cleaning, removal of plaque, calculus, and stains from the tooth surface (excluding bleaching or whitening). Third and fourth occurrences for Adult Prophylaxis (cleaning) are allowed if your gums have Pocket Depth readings of 5mm or greater.

Dental X-rays

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Covered dental X-rays include:

- Either a full mouth X-ray or panoramic X-ray or Cone Beam Film, once in a 36-month period, except as covered under the [orthodontia](#) benefit
- Bitewing X-rays
- Periapical X-rays
- Occlusal X-rays

The frequency of full mouth X-rays or panoramic X-ray or cone beam film may be allowed when it is for the diagnosis of a specific condition requiring treatment.

Emergency treatment for dental pain relief

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Emergency treatment for dental pain relief, palliative treatment, is covered. Chart notes, office records, and/or a description of the services provided are required from your provider.

Full mouth debridement

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Full mouth debridement (the removal of plaque and tartar that have accumulated on the teeth) to enable a comprehensive evaluation and diagnosis is covered once per lifetime per member.

Oral evaluation

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Two preventive oral evaluations, or "checkups," are covered in each calendar year.

Emergency oral evaluations are covered when a member is in pain or needs immediate care due to a dental emergency, trauma, or acute infections. Emergency oral evaluations will not count toward the preventive oral evaluation limit of two per calendar year.

Oral pathology laboratory

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Oral pathology laboratory procedures are covered. Coverage for the removal of the tissue samples is under the [Class II Services](#) benefit.

Periodontal maintenance

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Periodontal maintenance (a deeper cleaning that may include removal of bacterial plaque and calculus from above and below the gum line) is a covered service.

Prescription-strength Fluoride toothpaste and prescription-strength antimicrobial rinse is covered following covered periodontal procedures when dispensed in a dental office. Proof of a periodontal procedure must accompany the claim or the patient's history with DDWA must show a periodontal procedure within the previous 180 days.

Prescription-strength antimicrobial rinse may be dispensed once per course of periodontal treatment, which may include several visits.

Prescription-strength Fluoride toothpaste and prescription-strength antimicrobial rinse is available during pregnancy without any periodontal procedure.

Prescription Drugs

- *In-network: 100%**
- *Out-of-network: 100%**

The Plan covers prescription medications and drugs, when dispensed by your dentist for in office use.

*If you receive a written prescription from your dentist and have it filled at a retail pharmacy, your prescription benefits under your medical plan will apply. Refer to your medical plan for additional information regarding prescription drugs filled at a retail pharmacy.

Preventive resin restoration

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Preventive resin restorations are covered on primary and permanent teeth.

Professional consultation

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Professional consultations by dental specialists, such as endodontists and periodontists, are covered when requested by the dentist. Consultations by a dental specialist, will not count toward the preventive dental evaluation limit of two per calendar year. Consultations by a general dentist will count towards the preventive dental evaluation limit of two per calendar year.

A professional consultation performed by an orthodontist is not covered under Class I Benefits.

Sealants

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

This benefit covers sealants for permanent and primary teeth that have no restorations.

Space maintainers

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Space maintainers are covered when designed to preserve the space between teeth caused by the premature loss of a primary tooth (also called a baby tooth). This benefit is available for members only under the age of 18.

Topical fluoride or fluoride varnish

In-network: 100%

Out-of-network: 100% of allowable charges

Topical fluoride or fluoride varnish treatment is covered twice in each calendar year.

Note: Some benefits are available only under certain conditions of oral health. It is strongly recommended that you have your Dentist submit a Confirmation of Treatment and Cost request to determine if the treatment is a Covered Dental Benefit. A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not a guarantee of payment. See the "Confirmation of Treatment and Cost" section for additional information.

Class II services—Basic restorative, endodontics, periodontics, and oral surgery

Anesthesia provided in a dental provider's office

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

General Anesthesia is covered only in conjunction with certain covered oral surgery procedures, as determined by DDWA, or when medically necessary, for children through age six, or for a physically or developmentally disabled person, when in conjunction with Class I, II, III, or Orthodontic Covered Dental Benefits.

Intravenous moderate sedation is covered in conjunction with certain covered oral surgery procedures, as determined by DDWA.

Sedation, which is either General Anesthesia or intravenous moderate sedation, is not covered more than once per day.

General Anesthesia or intravenous moderate sedation for routine post-operative procedures is covered only for children through the age of six, or a physically or developmentally disabled person.

Crown, bridge and denture repair

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

This benefit covers repairs to crowns, bridges, and full and partial dentures when services are performed at least six months after the initial placement.

Crown posts and core build-up

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Crown posts and core build-ups are covered.

A Crown buildup is covered for a non-endodontically treated posterior (back) tooth only when one cusp is missing down to, or closer than, 2mm from the gum tissue in preparation for a Restorative Crown.

A Crown buildup is covered for an endodontically or a non-endodontically treated anterior (front) tooth only when more than 1/2 of the mesial-distal width of the incisal edge is missing down past the junction of the incisal and middle third of the tooth in preparation for a Restorative Crown.

Crown buildups or post and cores are Not a Paid Covered Dental Benefit within two years of a restoration on the same tooth from the date of service.

Endodontic treatment

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Covered services for the treatment of diseases of the tooth pulp and root canal include the following:

- Pulpotomy and endodontic (root canal) therapy
- Direct Pulp Cap
- Endodontic retreatment
- Apexification/recalcification and apicoectomy/periradicular surgery
- Retrograde filling

Fillings (restorations)

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Fillings using amalgam and resin-based composite filling materials are covered to restore decayed, cracked, broken, or fractured teeth.

Fillings (restorations) are covered for the following reasons:

- Treatment of carious lesions (visible destruction of hard tooth structure resulting from the process of dental decay).
- Fracture resulting in significant loss of tooth structure (missing cusp).
- Fracture resulting in significant damage to an existing restoration.

Nightguards

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Nightguards are covered for treatment of bruxism and other occlusal factors. Adjustments to nightguards are covered in lieu of replacement.

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Fillings using amalgam and resin-based composite filling materials are covered to restore decayed, cracked, broken, or fractured teeth.

Fillings (restorations) are covered for the following reasons:

- Treatment of carious lesions (visible destruction of hard tooth structure resulting from the process of dental decay).
- Fracture resulting in significant loss of tooth structure (missing cusp).

Fracture resulting in significant damage to an existing restoration

Limited Occlusal adjustments

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Limited occlusal adjustments are covered once in a 12-month period from date of service and only when not part of a primary procedure.

Oral surgery

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Coverage includes customary postoperative treatment furnished in connection with oral surgery, as follows:

- Surgical extraction of one or more teeth
- Surgical removal of erupted or impacted teeth
- Surgical removal of residual tooth roots
- Bone Replacement graft for ridge augmentation, ridge preservation or repair of bony defect
- Alveolectomy, vestibuloplasty, and frenectomy
- Reimplantation of natural tooth or transplantation of a natural tooth
- Incision and drainage of an abscess related to the tooth structure or gingival tissue
- Excision or removal of a tumor or cyst related to the tooth structure or gingival tissue
- Biopsy of soft or hard tissue related to the tooth structure or gingival tissue
- Post-operative care and treatment of routine post-surgical complications when performed within 30 days.
-

Periodontal scaling and root planing

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Scaling and root planing are covered, but not more often than twice per quadrant of the mouth per calendar year.

Periodontal surgery

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies

Covered periodontal surgical services include the following services:

- Osseous surgery that includes gingivectomy, gingivoplasty, and gingival flap procedures
- Clinical crown lengthening
- Guided tissue regeneration
- Bone replacement and tissue grafts
- Biological materials to aid in tissue regeneration (approved and indicated for use by the FDA)
- Localized delivery of antimicrobial agents

Pin retention for fillings

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

Pin retention services for fillings are covered.

Re-cementing bridges, inlays, onlays, and crowns

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

The re-cementing of bridges, inlays, onlays, and crowns is covered.

Simple extractions (one or more teeth)

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

Simple extraction of one or more teeth is covered.

Therapeutic parenteral medication

- *In-network: 85%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 85% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

The single or multiple administrations within the dental office by the treating dentist of antibiotics, steroids, and anti-inflammatory drugs and other therapeutic medications are covered.

Note: Some benefits are available only under certain conditions of oral health. It is strongly recommended that you have your Dentist submit a Confirmation of Treatment and Cost request to determine if the treatment is a Covered Dental Benefit. A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not a guarantee of payment. See the "Confirmation of Treatment and Cost" section for additional information.

Class III services—Major restorative services and installation of bridges and dentures

Prosthetic services and supplies

- *In-network: 50%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 50% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

The plan covers the following prosthetic services and supplies:

- Teeth with cavities where a significant amount of tooth structure has been destroyed by decay and can't reasonably be treated with a direct restoration.
- Teeth with fractured off/broken off tooth structure not replaced with an existing restoration and can't reasonably be treated with a direct restoration.
- Teeth with a fractured or broken existing restoration that can't reasonably be replaced with a direct restoration.
- Endodontically treated posterior teeth without an existing restorative crown.
- Confirmed diagnosis of cracked tooth syndrome on posterior teeth.
- Teeth with existing indirect restorations with new decay, fractured off tooth structure or fracture of the existing restorations

Payment for a Crown, Veneer, Inlays (when not used as a retainer for a fixed Bridge), and Onlays will be paid based upon the date that the treatment or procedure is completed.

Stainless steel Crowns or prefabricated Crowns are covered on primary and permanent teeth

A Crown used for purposes of re-contouring or repositioning a tooth to provide additional retention for a removable partial Denture is Not a Paid Covered Dental Benefit unless the tooth is decayed to the extent that a Crown would be required to restore the tooth whether or not a removable partial Denture is part of the treatment.

Ceramic substrate/porcelain or cast metal Crowns and Onlays are Not a Paid Covered Dental Benefit for children under 12 years of age.

Fixed Prosthodontics for children less than 16 years of age are Not a Paid Covered Dental Benefit.

Payment for Dentures, Fixed Partial Dentures (fixed Bridges), Inlays (only when used as a retainer for a fixed Bridge), and removable partial Dentures shall be paid upon the Seat/Delivery Date.

Implant maintenance procedures are covered, including:

- Removal of prosthesis.
- Cleansing of prosthesis and abutments.
- Reinsertion of prosthesis.

Denture adjustments and relines - Denture adjustments done more than six months after the initial placement are covered two times in a calendar year. Relines or rebases (but not both) done more than six months after the initial placement are covered once in a calendar year.

Complete Occlusal adjustments

- *In-network: 50%, deductible applies*
- *Out-of-network: 50% of allowable charges, deductible applies*

Complete occlusal adjustments (more than eight teeth) are covered once in a lifetime per member.

Note: Some benefits are available only under certain conditions of oral health. It is strongly recommended that you have your Dentist submit a Confirmation of Treatment and Cost request to determine if the treatment is a Covered Dental Benefit. A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost is not a guarantee of payment. See the "Confirmation of Treatment and Cost" section for additional information.



Confirmation of Treatment and Cost. A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost (also called a predetermination) is a request your dentist sends to DDWA to estimate your benefits and potential out-of-pocket costs for a specific service. It is not a guarantee of payment or authorization for treatment. Processing typically takes 15 days once all required information is received. If your coverage changes before treatment, the confirmation may no longer apply.

Orthodontia

- *In-network: 50%, \$50 orthodontia deductible applies, up to \$2,500 lifetime benefit maximum per enrolled member.*
- *Out-of-network: 50% of allowable charges, \$50 orthodontia deductible applies, up to \$2,500 lifetime benefit maximum per enrolled member.*
- The dental deductible does not apply to this benefit.
- There is a \$2,500 combined lifetime benefit maximum for both in-network and out-of-network services. This maximum continues to apply and rolls over with the transition from Premera to DDWA. Even after the vendor change to DDWA, any remaining balance from the lifetime maximum with Premera will carry forward.

Covered dental charges include services and supplies provided by a licensed dentist or orthodontist in connection with orthodontic treatment (other than for extractions) to correct malposed teeth; fixed or removable appliance therapy for the treatment of teeth or jaws; and Orthodontic records: exams (initial, periodic, comprehensive, detailed and extensive), X-rays (intraoral, extraoral, diagnostic radiographs, panoramic), diagnostic photographs, diagnostic casts (study models) or cephalometric films.

Payment is limited to:

- Completion of the treatment plan, or any treatment that is completed while you are eligible for the Orthodontic benefit under the Plan, whichever occurs first.
- Treatment received after coverage begins (claims must be timely submitted to DDWA). For orthodontia claims, the initial banding date is considered the treatment date in a timely filing.

Covered treatment that began prior to the start of coverage under the Plan will be prorated as necessary. The allowable payment will be calculated based on the balance of treatment costs beginning on the date of eligibility for Orthodontia coverage under the Plan.

In the event of termination of the treatment plan prior to completion of the case, or termination of coverage under this Plan, no payments will be made for any treatment received or incurred after such termination date.

Orthodontia services may be eligible for payment under the medical plan for dependents born with cleft/lip palate or other severe craniofacial anomalies. To qualify for benefits, the condition must meet medically necessary criteria in your medical plan's policy. Prior authorization is strongly recommended for members to determine medical benefit eligibility for this service.



Contact your medical plan for a copy of their medical policy addressing orthodontia for repair of cleft palate and other severe congenital anomalies.



Confirmation of Treatment and Cost A Confirmation of Treatment and Cost (also called a predetermination) is a request your dentist sends to DDWA to estimate your benefits and potential out-of-pocket costs for a specific service. It is not a guarantee of payment or authorization for treatment. Processing typically takes 15 days once all required information is received. If your coverage changes before treatment, the confirmation may no longer apply.

TotalHealth Wellness

Members diagnosed as having one or more qualifying medical conditions that fall within the categories listed below are eligible to receive additional cleaning benefits under this Plan. Please refer to the benefit sections above to determine the class of coverage for each cleaning.

Qualifying Medical Conditions

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| ◆ Pregnancy | ◆ Huntington's disease | ◆ Opioid misuse and addiction |
| ◆ Alzheimer's | ◆ Joint Replacement | ◆ Parkinson's disease |
| ◆ Cancer | ◆ Sjögren's syndrome | ◆ Rheumatoid arthritis |
| ◆ Chronic Kidney Disease | ◆ Stroke | ◆ Periodontal disease |
| ◆ Diabetes | ◆ Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS) | ◆ Other neurological diseases |
| ◆ Dementia | ◆ Lupus | ◆ Other auto immune diseases |
| ◆ Heart disease | | |

Note: In order to receive the additional benefits, you must notify DDWA through your MySmile® account at www.DeltaDentalWA.com or by calling 833-642-8800.

Covered Additional Cleaning Benefits

- Prophylaxis or,

- Periodontal Maintenance or,
- Scaling in presence of generalized moderate or severe gingival inflammation.

Limitations

Periodontal maintenance procedures are covered only if a patient has completed active periodontal treatment.

Additional cleanings for pregnancy will be available in the current Plan Year after you notify DDWA of your pregnancy and for one Plan Year thereafter.

For all other qualifying conditions besides pregnancy, additional cleanings are available in the current Plan Year and for each Plan Year thereafter, as long as you continue to have one or more qualifying medical conditions.

A maximum of up to four Prophylaxis (cleanings) are allowed in a Plan Year.

Accidental Bodily Injury

DDWA will pay 100 percent of the Filed Fee, or the Maximum Allowable Fee if there is no Filed Fee or the provider is a Non-Participating provider, for Class I, Class II, and Class III Covered Dental Benefit expenses arising as a direct result of an accidental bodily injury. However, DDWA's payment for accidental injury claims will not exceed the member's unused Plan Maximum. A bodily injury does not include teeth broken or damaged during the act of chewing or biting on foreign objects. Coverage includes necessary procedures for dental diagnosis and treatment rendered within 180 days following the date of the accident, as long as you are covered by the Plan on the date of treatment. You have up to 180 days from the date of the accident to complete such covered treatment. Coverage and payment by DDWA is based on the actual treatment date, not the date of the accident.

Dental coverage extended

Dental coverage will be extended for covered services that are ordered before your coverage ends if the covered service is delivered or completed within 30 days. This includes:

- Dentures
- Fixed bridgework
- Crown
- Root canal therapy



To be **considered an "ordered service"** the following must have been done:

1. Impressions used to form the dentures, crowns, or fixed bridgework have been taken
2. The teeth have been fully prepared for fixed bridgework and crowns

This is also described in the [When benefits coverage ends](#) section.

Exclusions and limitations

This Plan may not cover every part of the dental care you might need. The benefits covered under this Plan are subject to limitations listed above which affect the type or frequency of procedures that will be reimbursed. Additionally, there are Exclusions to the types of services covered. Please read this section carefully.

These items are not Covered Dental Benefits under this Plan:

- Dentistry for cosmetic reasons.
- Restorations or appliances necessary to correct vertical dimension or to restore the occlusion, which include restoration of tooth structure lost from attrition, abrasion or erosion, and restorations for malalignment of teeth.
- Services for injuries or conditions that are compensable under Worker's Compensation or Employers' Liability laws, and services that are provided to the covered person by any federal, state or provincial government agency or provided without cost to the covered person by any municipality, county, or other political subdivision, other than medical assistance in this state, under medical assistance RCW 74.09.500, or any other state, under 42 U.S.C., Section 1396a, section 1902 of the Social Security Act.
- Application of desensitizing agents (treatment for sensitivity or adhesive resin application).
- Experimental services or supplies.
 - (1) This includes:
 - (a) Procedures, services or supplies are considered experimental if their use and acceptance for treating a specific dental condition are still under investigation or observation. DDWA cannot make this determination independently and must consult with the American Dental Association (ADA). The following criteria are used to assess whether a service is experimental:
 - (i) The services are in general use in the dental community in the state of Washington;
 - (ii) The services are under continued scientific testing and research;
 - (iii) The services show a demonstrable benefit for a particular dental condition; and
 - (iv) The services are proven to be safe and effective.
- Injections of anesthetic not in conjunction with a dental service.
- Injection of any medication or drug not associated with the delivery of a covered dental service.
- Prescription of euphoric drugs.
- Hospitalization charges and any additional fees charged by the Dentist for hospital treatment.
- Charges for missed appointments.
- Behavior management.
- Completing claim forms.
- TMJ services or supplies.

- This Plan does not provide benefits for services or supplies to the extent that those services and supplies are payable under any motor vehicle medical, motor vehicle no-fault, uninsured motorist, underinsured motorist, personal injury protection (PIP), commercial liability, homeowner's policy, or other similar type of coverage.
- Services that are incomplete, temporary, interim, or provisional.
- Charges for replacement or repair of an orthodontic appliance
- Direct-to-Consumer Orthodontics
- General Anesthesia or intravenous moderate sedation for routine post-operative procedures for children over the age of seven or for persons who are not physically or developmentally disabled.
- Plaque control program (oral hygiene instruction, dietary instruction, and home Fluoride kits)
- A Crown or Onlay placed because of weakened cusps, when used to repair micro-fractures (cracks) of tooth structure when the tooth is asymptomatic (displays no symptoms), or there is an existing restoration with no evidence of decay, fractured (broken) off tooth structure, or other significant pathology.

DDWA will determine whether services are Covered Dental Benefits in accordance with standard dental practice and the limitations and exclusions shown in this SPD.

How to file a claim

When you receive care from a Participating Dentist, the Dentist should submit bills directly to DDWA, and this submission is your claim for benefits. You generally should not submit claims for care received from Participating Dentists, as they are required to submit claims as part of their Delta Dental Provider agreement. If your provider does not submit a bill directly to DDWA, however, you will need to submit a claim for benefits.

If you see a Non-Participating Dentist, you generally will need to submit a claim for benefits. You can find a claim form by signing into your MySmile account and under QuickLinks click on **ADA Claim Form** or you can access the form here: DeltaDentalWa.com/microsoftdeltadentalwa.com/microsoft/first-timer

If possible, you should submit the claim form within 30 days of the service. The plan will not reimburse claims submitted more than 12 months after the date of service. For orthodontia claims, the initial banding date, which is the date the appliance is placed, is the treatment date used to start this 12-month period.

To submit a claim via mail or email:

1. Download the ADA Claim Form in your MySmile account or at DeltaDentalWa.com/microsoftdeltadentalwa.com/microsoft/first-timer, as noted above. You can also email DDWA at Microsoft@DeltaDentalWA.com to request a claim form.
2. Complete the claim form, including all of the following information:
 - a. Your name and the member's name
 - b. Identification numbers shown on your identification card
 - c. Provider's name, address, and tax identification number
 - d. If you are seeking secondary coverage from the Microsoft health plan, information about other insurance coverage related to the claim at hand, including a copy of their Explanation of Benefits (EOB), if applicable
 - e. If treatment is as a result of an accident: the date, time, location and brief description of the accident
 - f. Date of onset of the illness or injury
 - g. Date of service
 - h. Diagnosis or ICD-10 code (this information can be found on the provider's bill)
 - i. Procedure codes (CPT-4, HCPCS, ADA, or UB-92) or descriptive English language for each service (this information can be found on the provider's bill)
 - j. Itemized charges for each service rendered by provider
3. Sign the form in the space provided and attach the itemized provider's bill
4. Submit the completed form to:

Mail: Delta Dental of Washington
P.O. Box 75983
Seattle, WA 98175-0983
Email: Microsoft@DeltaDentalWA.com [mailto:](#)

In making a claim determination, DDWA will interpret the relevant Plan provisions in good faith and in the best interest of participants and beneficiaries and will not take into account either the amount of benefits at issue or the financial impact on Microsoft.



COBRA-eligibility claims should be submitted as described in the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section.

In the following circumstances, you may submit claims according to the [appeals process](#):

If you cannot submit the claim in a timely manner due to circumstances beyond your control

If your claim regards plan eligibility for you, your spouse/domestic partner, or dependent child

Claim review and payment

In accordance with regulatory requirements, DDWA will process and issue a decision on all clean claims within 30 days from the date of receipt. Clean claims are claims that have no defect or impropriety, including a lack of any required substantiating documentation, or particular circumstances requiring special treatment that prevents timely determination and payment from being made on the claim. For claims not meeting this definition, the deadline to issue a determination may be extended for up to 15 days, and you will be notified before the end of the initial 30-day period of the circumstances requiring the extension and the date by which a decision is expected. If the extension is due to your failure to submit all information necessary to decide the claim, the extension notice will describe the additional required information, and you will be given at least 45 days to provide that information. The deadline for

DDWA to issue a determination will be suspended for the lesser of 45 days or until the date you provide the additional required information.

If your claim is for “urgent care,” meaning the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment at issue, then the following special rules apply:

- DDWA will issue a determination on your claim, in writing or electronically, within 72 hours after receiving all necessary information for your claim either via phone or in writing, taking into account the seriousness of your condition.
- DDWA’s denial notice may be oral, with a written or electronic confirmation to follow within three days.
- If the claim was filed incorrectly, DDWA will notify you of the error and how to correct it within 24 hours after the claim was received. If additional information is needed to process the claim, DDWA will notify you of the information needed within 24 hours after the claim was received. You then have 48 hours to provide the requested information. You will then be notified of DDWA’s determination no later than 48 hours after (1) DDWA’s receipt of the requested information, or (2) the end of the 48-hour period when you were to provide the additional information if the information is not received in that timeframe.

If your claim is a request to extend an ongoing course of treatment beyond a previously approved period of time or number of treatments, and is considered an urgent care claim, DDWA will decide your claim within 24 hours, provided that your claim is submitted at least 24 hours before the end of the approved treatment.



Explanation of benefits (EOB) is the statement you receive from DDWA detailing how much the provider billed, how much (if any) the plan paid, and the amount that you owe the provider (if any).

Denied claims notice

If all or part of your claim is denied, DDWA will send you an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) or other notice with the following information:

- The specific reason for the denial or modification
- Reference to the specific plan provision on which the determination was based
- A description of any additional material or information needed for you to perfect the claim and an explanation of why such material or information is necessary
- Your Appeal rights should you wish to dispute the original determination, including a description of the applicable time limits and your right to bring a civil action under ERISA following an adverse benefit determination on review

- A statement that you are entitled to receive, free of charge upon request, any specific rule, guideline, protocol, or other similar criterion that was relied upon in making the adverse determination
- If DDWA's decision is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, either an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination, applying the terms of the plan to your medical circumstances, or a statement that such explanation will be provided free of charge upon request

Appeals of Denied Claims

If you have received an adverse benefit determination, you have the right to initiate an appeal. An appeal is a request for DDWA to reconsider the prior determination, and your opportunity to provide DDWA with any additional comments or information you would like them to consider.

The appeals process includes two levels of review, informal and formal. An informal review of your appeal is when DDWA staff evaluates the claim and the terms of your Plan to determine if the claim processed consistently with the terms of the Plan. A formal review of your appeal is when DDWA's Appeals Committee evaluates your claim, the terms of the Plan, any existing or new information, all correspondence and communications between you and DDWA, and any clinical considerations in order to determine if a claim processed consistently with the terms of the plan.



An **appeal** is a written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce, or end payment, coverage or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the plan. This includes admissions to and continued stays in a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.

How to Contact Delta Dental of Washington

DDWA will accept notice of an appeal submitted by you, your covered dependent, or an authorized representative of you or your covered dependent by contacting DDWA via email at membersappeal@deltadentalwa.com, by mail at the following address: Delta Dental of Washington, P.O. Box 75983, Seattle, WA 98175-0983. You may also contact DDWA by telephone at 1-833-642-8800 for assistance submitting an appeal, or for more information. When submitting an appeal, you may include any written comments, documents, or other information that you believe supports your claim.



The appeal should be submitted to DDWA by email or the following address:

Email: memberappeals@deltadentalwa.com

Delta Dental of Washington
P.O. Box 75983
Seattle, WA 98175-0983

Authorized Representative

You may authorize another person to represent you or your dependent (if applicable) and receive communications from DDWA regarding the appeal. To do this, you must complete and sign an authorized representative form. If an appeal is submitted by another party without this authorization, a request will be made to obtain a completed authorized representative form. The appeal process will not commence until this form, or appropriate written authorization in another format, is received. Should the form, or any other document confirming the right of the individual to act on your behalf, i.e. power of attorney, not be returned, the appeal will be closed.

Informal Review

Your first step in the Appeal process is to request an informal review of the decision. Either you, or your authorized representative (see the "Authorized Representative" section), must submit your request for a review within 180 days from the date of the adverse benefit determination (please see your EOB form). A request for a review may be made orally or in writing and must include the following information:

- Your name, the patient's name (if different) and ID number
- The claim number (from your EOB)
- The name of the Dentist

DDWA will review your request and generally send you a notice within 14 days of receiving your request. This notice will either be the determination of our review or a notification that we will require an additional 16 days, for a total of 30 days. When our review is completed DDWA will send you a written notification of the review decision and provide you information regarding any further appeal rights available should you disagree with the result. Upon request, you will be granted access to, and copies of, all relevant information used in making the review decision. Informal reviews of wholly or partially denied claims are conducted by persons not involved in their initial claims determination. You must first complete an informal review prior to submitting a formal review.



If you fail to file the informal review within 180 days of receiving the EOB, you will permanently lose your right to appeal the denied claim.

Formal Review

If you are dissatisfied with the outcome of the informal review, you may request a formal appeal. Your formal appeal will be reviewed by the DDWA Appeals Committee. This Committee includes only persons who were not involved in either the original decision or the previous (informal) review.

Your request for a formal review by the Appeals Committee must be made within 90 days of the date of the letter notifying you of the Informal review decision. Your request should include the information submitted with your informal review request plus a copy of the informal review decision letter. You may also submit any other documentation or information you believe supports your case.

The Appeals Committee generally will review your claim within 30 days of receiving your request. Upon completion of their review the Appeals Committee will send you written notification of their decision. Upon request, you will be granted access to, and copies of, all relevant information used in making the review decision.

Whenever DDWA makes an adverse determination on an urgent claim as described above, DDWA will expedite and process either a written or an oral appeal and issue a decision no later than 72 hours after receipt of the appeal. If the treating licensed professional determines that delay could jeopardize the claimant's health or ability to regain maximum function, DDWA will deem the claim to be urgent for this purpose. Your appeal nevertheless should clearly indicate your request for an expedited urgent appeal.



To file an urgent care appeal request, you may call to initiate a request to (833) 642-8800.

Decisions upon the formal review are final under the plan's appeal process, and there are no further appeals available from DDWA or Microsoft or any person administering claims or appeals under the plan. However, you still have a right to file suit under ERISA Section 502(a) as a result of the decision.

Limits on your right to judicial review

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal before taking action in any other forum regarding a claim for benefits under the plan. Any legal action initiated under the plan must be brought no later than one year following the adverse determination on the formal appeal. This one-year limitations period on claims for benefits applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit claim is deemed permanently waived and barred.



If you have questions about understanding a denial of a claim or your appeal rights, you may contact DDWA Customer Service for assistance at (833) 642-8800. You may also seek assistance from the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor at (866) 444-EBSA (3272).

Right to recover benefits paid in error

If DDWA makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, DDWA has the right to recover payment, including deducting the amount paid mistake from future benefits.

Note: Health care providers are not "beneficiaries" of the plan, and although DDWA may make direct payment to health care providers for the convenience of participants and their dependents, such payments of services shall not be considered "benefits" available under the plan or confer beneficiary standing upon a health care provider.

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✓ COBRA enrollees – the FSA section may apply, read below for details

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Your FSA options

✓ *COBRA enrollees – the Your FSA options section applies, with regard to the Dental & Vision and Health Care FSAs*

Flexible spending accounts (FSAs) can help you reduce your tax bill by letting you set aside pre-tax dollars to pay for eligible healthcare and dependent care expenses. If you are enrolled in the Health Savings Account, your health care FSA participation is limited to vision and dental expenses (per IRS rules).

Account type	Eligibility	Expenses covered	Maximum contribution per year
Limited Purpose* FSA	For employees with a Health Savings Account	Dental and vision only	\$3,300
General Purpose* FSA	For employees who don't have a Health Savings Account	Medical, prescription, dental, vision	\$3,300
Dependent Care FSA	For employees with eligible dependent care expenses	Child and elder care	\$7,500

* For the 2026 calendar year, you may carry over up to \$660 in unused General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA funds to the following plan year. Any remaining balance above \$660 is forfeited, pursuant to IRS rules.

i If you leave Microsoft during the year, you will lose any remaining balance in your FSA accounts. However, you can extend the General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA through COBRA coverage. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

When you enroll

✗ *COBRA enrollees – the When you enroll section does not apply*

You decide how much you would like to contribute to your FSA for the year, up to the maximum amount. You must reenroll during the open enrollment period each year if you want to continue participating in

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

the next plan year unless you have a carryover from the prior plan year. The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year.

The amount you elect will be deducted on a prorated basis each pay period throughout the year to fund your account. The following general purpose, limited purpose, and dependent care FSA sections provide additional information about contributions.



Estimate your expenses carefully. The FSAs generally can reimburse only services that you use or items that you purchase by December 31 of each year. All claims must be received within 90 days of the end of the plan year.

You may carry over up to \$660 in unused General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA funds to the following plan year. Any remaining balance above \$660 is forfeited, pursuant to IRS rules.



To estimate your potential costs and tax savings under the FSAs, use the decision support tools on the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#).

Making changes



COBRA enrollees – the Making changes section does not apply

The annual open enrollment period is your only opportunity to make changes to your FSA elections unless you have a qualifying life event. The open enrollment period takes place in the fall each year, typically in the first few weeks of November, prior to Thanksgiving week. The specific dates will be communicated to you each year.

Changes to add one or more dependents to General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA coverage will take effect as of the date of the special enrollment event (marriage, birth, legal adoption, etc.), such that eligible expenses incurred by the newly-added dependent(s) after that date may be reimbursed from the FSA. However, any change in the amount of your FSA election, and resulting payroll contributions, will take effect prospectively only, for pay periods following the date that you make the election change.

Example

Melissa just gave birth to a second baby and increased the Dependent Care FSA election from \$2,500 to \$5,000 on June 1. The plan will not reimburse expenses incurred before June 1 in excess of \$2,500.



For more information, see the [Life event enrollment](#) section.

Using your FSAs



COBRA enrollees – the Using your FSAs section applies

To be eligible for reimbursement, expenses must meet IRS criteria and be incurred during the period of coverage. Services prior to your date of hire are not eligible for reimbursement.

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

You pay for expenses and then seek reimbursement from your FSA. You may receive your reimbursement via direct deposit or check. Alternatively, you can use your General Purpose or Limited Purpose Fidelity Debit Card to pay for qualified expenses at the point of sale. When using your Fidelity Debit Card, you may still be required to submit documentation to substantiate the expense. You can not use your Fidelity Debit Card for dependent care expenses.



To check the balance of your FSAs, log into your account at <https://netbenefits.com>.

All required documentation for eligible expenses must be received within 90 days following the end of the year in order to be considered for reimbursement.

The IRS allows you to carry over up to \$660 in unused General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA funds to the following calendar year. Any funds over \$660 remaining in your General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA following 90 days after the end of the plan year will be forfeited, as required by IRS rules.

There is no carryover provision for the dependent care FSA, so all unused funds remaining in your account following 90 days after the end of the plan year will be forfeited, as required by IRS rules.



In accordance with Internal Revenue Service (IRS) regulations, health care or dependent care expenses from your domestic partner or your domestic partner's children are not eligible for reimbursement under this plan, unless they meet the definition of "dependent" under the tax rules.

Review the [General Purpose and Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA](#) and [dependent care FSA](#) sections for more information about eligible expenses and the reimbursement process.

If you're on leave of absence



COBRA enrollees – the If you're on leave of absence section does not apply

Payroll deductions for your General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA or dependent care FSA will continue while you are on a paid leave of absence. For unpaid leaves of absence, payroll deductions that would have otherwise been taken during that period will be deducted from your first paycheck upon your return to work. If you are returning from unpaid FMLA leave, you can instead resume your participation at a reduced level and resume contributions in effect before the FMLA leave.

You may be reimbursed for eligible health care expenses during a paid or unpaid leave of absence. Your eligibility to be reimbursed for eligible dependent care expenses depends upon your particular leave situation. For more information, refer to IRS Publication 503.

If you change your election amount as part of a qualified life event while you are on leave, the new amount will be deducted from the first paycheck after the effective date of the change. For more information, see the [Life event enrollment](#) section.

If you are on leave for the entire annual open enrollment period, you will receive information in the mail, including an enrollment form. If you wish to continue your FSA participation, you must submit your election on the Benefits Enrollment tool or return the completed enrollment form by the end of the open enrollment period.

General Purpose and Limited Purpose Healthcare FSAs

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Contributions

 *COBRA enrollees – the Contributions section does not apply*

For 2026, you may contribute up to \$3,300 to your General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA.

 *Estimate your expenses carefully. You must use all the money in your FSA by December 31 of each year or any remaining balance above the \$660 for plan year 2026 that the IRS allows you to carry over to the following calendar year is forfeited, as required by IRS rules. You have 90 days from the end of the year to file claims for reimbursement for services received during the plan year.*

Eligible expenses

 *COBRA enrollees – the Eligible expenses section applies*

If you are enrolled in the Health Savings Account, your FSA participation is limited to vision and dental expenses (per IRS rules) in the Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA. All other eligible employees may participate in the General Purpose health care FSA, even if they are not enrolled in a Microsoft medical plan.

 *In accordance with Internal Revenue Service (IRS) regulations, health care expenses from your domestic partner or your domestic partner's children are not eligible for reimbursement under this plan, unless they are filed as dependents on your tax return.*

To be eligible for reimbursement, expenses must:

- Meet the eligibility criteria defined under the Internal Revenue Code. Examples of eligible expenses are provided in the table below.
- Be incurred during the FSA period of coverage

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

- If your contributions begin after January 1 (for example, if you are a new hire), expenses incurred on or after your date of hire or date of your [special enrollment event](#) are eligible for reimbursement
- If your contributions end before December 31 (for example, due to termination of employment), expenses incurred after your last day of participation will not be eligible for reimbursement unless you elect COBRA coverage
- Otherwise, your expenses must be incurred from January 1 to December 31

Account type	Eligibility	Examples of eligible expenses
Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA	For employees with a Health Savings Account	• Dental expenses that are not fully covered by a group dental plan, including orthodontia • Vision care and hardware expenses, such as glasses
General Purpose Healthcare FSA	For employees who don't have current year contributions into a Health Savings Account	• Medical plan and dental plan deductibles • Coinsurance and copayments • Medical expenses that are not fully covered by a group medical plan (such as private duty nursing) • Dental expenses that are not fully covered by a group dental plan, including orthodontia and temporomandibular joint disorder (TMJ) • Vision or hearing care and hardware, such as glasses or hearing aids, that are not fully covered by a medical plan • Lamaze classes for mother only



For a complete list of eligible expenses, refer to IRS Publication 502. IRS Publication 502 does not mention: 1) that COBRA premiums may not be reimbursed from a General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA. 2) that certain menstrual care products (like tampons and pads) are eligible to be reimbursed from a General Purpose Healthcare FSA and 3) that certain over-the-counter medications can be reimbursed from a Limited Purpose or General Purpose Healthcare FSA. Contact Fidelity at 888-810-6738 for more information about these reimbursements.

Fidelity FSA Debit Card

If you enroll in the General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA, you will receive a Fidelity debit card which you can use to pay for qualified medical expenses at eligible merchants and service providers that accept Visa debit cards.

If you are enrolled in both a Microsoft FSA and an HSA, purchases will be deducted first from your available FSA balance, then from your available HSA balance based on the merchant and expense type. For example, if you are enrolled in the Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA and HSA, dental/vision expenses will pull from your Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA until funds are exhausted before pulling from your HSA.

Log into [NetBenefits](#) to manage your debit card, including if you need to order an additional card, add a PIN, or report a lost or stolen card.

How to use your Fidelity Debit Card

Per the Internal Revenue Service (IRS), you can use your Fidelity debit card at participating pharmacies, mail-order pharmacies, discount stores, and supermarkets that can identify specific HSA-/FSA-eligible items at the point of sale, and accept Visa prepaid cards. FSA transactions made in these locations are fully substantiated.

IRS rules also allow you to use your card in pharmacies that have certified that 90% of the merchandise they sell is HSA-/FSA-eligible. However, since these pharmacies cannot identify the specific eligible items at the point of sale, another form of substantiation may be required.

In addition, you can use your card to pay a hospital, doctor, dentist, or vision provider that accepts prepaid Visa cards.

Fidelity Debit Card Substantiation

Substantiation is documentation that confirms an expense can be paid for with funds from your FSA. Most FSA debit card transactions are automatically substantiated, and no further action will be required.

For transactions that cannot be auto-substantiated, Fidelity will first look to the related plan administrator's FSA claim to substantiate your purchase. If a claim is not received from the plan administrator after 60 days, Fidelity will ask you for documentation to substantiate the purchase. Fidelity will send two more reminders, one every 30 days, until documentation is received. If documentation is not received within 10 days of the third and final reminder, your Fidelity debit card will be suspended until the purchase is substantiated or the amount is repaid to the plan. You can repay expenses on NetBenefits via ACH (Automated Clearing House) electronic bank transfers or by mailing a check.

Log into [NetBenefits](#) or call Fidelity at 888-810-6738 to learn more.

How to file a claim



COBRA enrollees – the How to file a claim section applies

You may be reimbursed for eligible health care expenses up to the total amount you have elected to contribute for the year, regardless of the amount contributed to the account to date.

If you participate in the Health Savings Plan, Hawaii Only Plan, or Surest Health Plan, you can elect to have your eligible, in-network claims sent from the plan administrator to Fidelity to simplify your claim reimbursement process. Claims that cannot be sent to Fidelity for FSA reimbursement include the following:

- Claims for members with other coverage (COB)
- Claims for domestic partners or your domestic partner's children
- Sensitive claims for dependents (for example, mental health)

For all other expenses, you have 90 days following the end of the plan year to submit claims and required documentation to your FSA for reimbursement of expenses that were incurred the previous year. Claims that are submitted more than 90 days after the end of the plan year are not eligible for reimbursement.

Online claim reimbursement

If you did not use your Fidelity debit card for your qualified medical expense purchase, you can file a claim online at Fidelity. To file a claim for reimbursement, log into your **NetBenefits** account and select the **Flexible Spending and Reimbursement Accounts** tile from the home page. From there, Select **Reimburse Myself**. In order to fully substantiate your claim, your receipt must contain:

- The date of service (must be within your coverage period)
- Description of service
- Name of provider
- Total out-of-pocket expense
- The name of the dependent who incurred the service or expense.



To submit your claim online, log into [NetBenefits.com](https://netbenefits.com).

Reimbursements are issued as either a check mailed to your home or, if you have a personal bank account linked to your NetBenefits account, an electronic funds transfer is initiated to your bank account. Once the claim has been reviewed, you will receive an e-mail notification to the email address you specified as your preferred email address within the Fidelity system.

Appeal for internal review

If the plan denies your claim, you may appeal for an internal review of the decision within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits (EOB).



An **appeal** is a written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce, or end payment, coverage, or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the plan. This includes admissions to and continued stays in a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.



If you fail to file the internal appeal within 180 days of receiving the Explanation of Benefits, you will permanently lose your right to appeal the denied claim

Submitting an appeal for internal review

You or your authorized representative* must provide the following information as part of your written appeal to your plan administrator's Appeals Department.

For Premera Members:

- Your name,
- Your Premera member number,
- The name of this plan, and
- A concise statement of why you disagree with the decision, including facts or theories supporting your claim.

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

Your written request may (but is not required to) include issues, comments, documents, and other records you want considered in the review.



The appeal should be submitted to Premera at the following address:

Appeals Coordinator
Premera Blue Cross
P.O. Box 91102
Seattle, WA 98111-9202

*You may, at your own expense, have a representative act on your behalf. If you want to appoint someone to act for you in the appeals process (this may be your attorney or your provider), you must submit a completed and signed [Microsoft Member Appeal form](#), which includes an appeal authorization section.

For Surest Members:



The appeal should be submitted to Surest at the following address:

Surest Consumer Affairs (Member Appeals)
PO Box 31270
Salt Lake City, UT 84131

For Delta Dental of Washington (DDWA) Members:



The appeal should be submitted to DDWA at the following email or mailing address:

Email: memberappeals@deltadentalwa.com

Delta Dental of Washington
P.O. Box 75983
Seattle, WA 98175-0983

Internal review and timeframe

All the information you submit will be taken into account on appeal, even if it was not reviewed as part of the initial decision. You may ask to examine or receive free copies of all pertinent plan documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim by asking your plan administrator.

In the event any new or additional information (evidence) is considered, relied on, or generated by the plan administrator, in connection with your appeal, the plan administrator will provide this information to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that you will have an opportunity to respond. Also, if any new or additional rationale is considered by the plan administrator, the plan

administrator will provide the rationale to you as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the decision so that that you will have an opportunity to respond.

Other than urgent care appeals, described above, in most cases the plan administrator will send a decision on your appeal no later than 60 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request. If the appeal relates to an item for which the Plan requires you to obtain approval before it is furnished to you, then it will be considered a pre-service appeal, and the plan administrator will send a decision no later than 30 calendar days after receipt of your appeal request.

Denied appeal notice

If your appeal is denied, you will receive a written notice setting forth:

- The specific reason or reasons for the denial
- Reference to the specific plan provisions on which the denial is based
- A statement that you are entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim for benefits
- A statement explaining the external review procedures offered by the plan and your right to bring a civil action under ERISA section 502(a)
- A statement regarding any internal rule, guideline, protocol, or other criterion that was relied upon in denying the claim (a copy of which will be provided free upon request)

Decisions upon the internal review are the final decision under the plan's appeal process, and there are no further appeals available from the plan administrator or Microsoft or any person administering claims or appeals under the plan. However, you still have a right to file suit under ERISA Section 502(a) as a result of the decision.

Limits on your right to judicial review

You must follow the appeals process described above through the decision on the appeal before taking action in any other forum regarding a claim for benefits under the plan. Any legal action initiated under the plan must be brought no later than one year following the adverse determination on the appeal. This one-year limitations period on claims for benefits applies in any forum where you initiate legal action. If a legal action is not filed within this period, your benefit claim is deemed permanently waived and barred. In addition, you must raise all issues and grounds for appealing a decision on a claim for benefits at every stage of the appeal process, or else such issues and grounds will be deemed permanently waived and barred.



If you have questions about understanding a denial of a claim or your appeal rights, you may contact Premiera Customer Service for assistance at (800) 676-1411 or Surest Member Services at (866) 222-1298. You may also seek assistance from the Employee Benefits Security Administration (EBSA) of the U.S. Department of Labor at (866) 444-EBSA (3272).

Right to recover benefits paid in error

If the plan administrator makes a payment in error on your behalf to you or a provider, and you are not eligible for all or a part of that payment, the plan administrator has the right to recover payment, including deducting the amount paid mistake from future benefits.

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

Note: Health care providers are not “beneficiaries” of the plan, and although the plan administrator may make direct payment to health care providers for the convenience of participants and their dependents, such payments of services shall not be considered “benefits” available under the plan or confer beneficiary standing upon a health care provider.

Dependent care FSA

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Dependent care FSA section does not apply*

Contributions

Your dependent care FSA contribution cannot exceed the least of the following amounts:

- \$7,500 annually per household if you are married, filing jointly, or single and filing as head of household
- \$3,750 annually if you are married and filing separately
- The lesser of your or your spouse's earned income
- \$250 per month for one dependent or \$500 per month for two or more dependents up to the plan maximum (if your spouse is an unemployed, full-time student or incapable of self-care due to disability)

 *Estimate your expenses carefully. You must use all the money in your FSA by December 31 of each year, or any remaining balance is forfeited, as required by IRA rules. You have 90 days from the end of the plan year to file claims for reimbursement for services received during the plan year.*

Expenses reimbursed from your dependent care FSA cannot be used for the child and dependent care tax credit on your personal income tax return at the end of the year. In certain situations, it may be advantageous to use a combination of the tax credit and dependent care account, regardless of your income level. You should seek the opinion of a tax advisor regarding your personal financial situation.

Eligible expenses

Your dependent care expenses are eligible for reimbursement from your dependent care FSA if you and your spouse/domestic partner both work or if your spouse/domestic partner meets one of the following criteria:

- Is a full-time student
- Is physically or mentally incapable of self-care

You may be reimbursed for eligible dependent care expenses for the following dependents:

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

- Your children age 12 and under that you claim as dependents for income tax purposes
- Certain other dependents, such as parents or your spouse, who are physically or mentally unable to care for themselves, who live with you for more than half a year, and for non-spouses, receive over half of their support from you

To be eligible for reimbursement, expenses must:

- Meet the eligibility criteria defined under the Internal Revenue Code
- Be for care inside your home, except for your children age 12 and under (regardless of the number of hours they spend in your home each day) and other dependents who normally spend at least eight hours in your home each day
- Be incurred during the same period in which amounts are credited to your FSA
 - If your contributions begin after January 1 (for example, if you are a new hire), expenses incurred on or after your date of hire or date of your [special enrollment event](#) are eligible for reimbursement
 - If your contributions end before December 31 (for example due to termination of employment), expenses incurred after your last day of participation will not be eligible for reimbursement
 - Otherwise, your expenses must be incurred from January 1 to December 31

Examples of eligible expenses include:

- Childcare or baby-sitting services inside your home or someone else's home to enable both spouses to work
- Expenses for dependent care centers (that is, a center that cares for more than six people at a time and meets all state and local licensing requirements)
- Certain expenses for a full-time, live-in housekeeper to take care of your dependent who is age 12 or under or who is physically or mentally unable to care for themselves
- School-related costs for your children who are not yet in kindergarten
- Expenses for day camps



For a complete list of eligible child and dependent care expenses, refer to IRS Publication 503.

How to file a claim

You may be reimbursed for eligible dependent care expenses for services you have incurred up to the total amount you have elected to contribute for the year, regardless of the amount contributed to the account to date.

You have 90 days following the end of the plan year to submit claims and required documentation for reimbursement of expenses that were incurred the previous plan year. Claims that are submitted more than 90 days after the end of the plan year are not eligible for reimbursement and any funds left in the account will be forfeited.

To file a claim for reimbursement, log into your **NetBenefits** account and select the **Flexible Spending and Reimbursement Accounts** tile from the home page. From there, Select **Reimburse Myself**. In order to fully substantiate your claim, your receipt must contain:

Section VI: Flexible spending accounts (FSAs)

- The date of service (must be within your coverage period)
- Description of service
- Name of provider
- Total out-of-pocket expense
- The name of the dependent who incurred the service or expense.



To submit your claim online, log into NetBenefits.com.

Reimbursements are issued as either a check mailed to your home or, if you have a personal bank account linked to your NetBenefits account, an electronic funds transfer is initiated to your bank account. Once the claim has been reviewed, you will receive an e-mail notification to the email address you specified as your preferred email address within the Fidelity system.

Section VII: Wellbeing at Microsoft

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 COBRA enrollees – the Wellbeing at Microsoft section applies

How the program works

The **Wellbeing at Microsoft** program provides a suite of integrated services supporting employees' physical, mental, and overall wellbeing through tools like:

- Spring Health (Employee Assistance Program)
- Teladoc (Expert Medical Opinion)
- Thrive Global
- Maven (Family Health and Menopause Support)

Employees and eligible family members can access digital platforms (including Microsoft Teams–embedded apps), counseling, coaching, and expert consultations to address health, stress, caregiving, and work-life needs. The program emphasizes confidential, personalized support—ranging from short-term counseling and care navigation to self-guided wellbeing resources and specialist support services. Overall, it delivers a holistic, multi-channel approach to help employees build healthy habits, manage life challenges, and improve wellbeing outcomes.

Spring Health Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

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✓ COBRA enrollees – the Spring Health (EAP) section applies

How the program works

Spring Health is our confidential, free, short-term counseling and work-life resource and referral provider (employee assistance program).

Eligibility: Employees and eligible dependents (spouse/partner, children ages 6-26).

Note: for children under six (6) Spring Health will help with referrals.

Create your online account at aka.ms/SpringHealth to access their services. You may add dependents under 18 to yours, or your spouse/partner's account.

Adult dependents (spouse/partner, *child 18+) can create accounts in one of two ways:

- From your Spring Health account, you can send your adult dependent (spouse/partner, child 18+) an invitation to create their own Spring Health account. Login to your account and to your profile and settings to send the invitation.

- Adult dependents (spouse/partner, *child 18+) can create their own accounts by going to www.microsoft.springhealth.com. They will need your full name and full email with your alias to create an account.
- You will not have access to or know if your adult dependent has created an account, as it's confidential.

Note: In some states, dependents *under* 18 may be able to create their own accounts based on local state law regarding parental consent.

 *Microsoft respects your right to privacy in your personal and family life. No record of your use of the Spring Health program will be kept or made available to anyone within Microsoft. This also applies to your health care plans.*

 To schedule an appointment with a Spring Health counselor, call (855) 629-0554. You can also visit [Spring Health](#).
If you leave Microsoft or otherwise become ineligible, you will continue to have access to Spring Health, short-term counseling, resource & referral (EAP) benefits if you elect to continue your coverage. For more information, see the [When coverage ends](#) section.

What the plan covers

Spring Health short-term counseling, work-life resources and referrals, access to the Spring Health Platform and services.

Counseling services

The short-term counseling services covered through Spring Health are described below.

Service	Description	Coverage
Individual, couples, or family counseling	Emotional, psychological, social, or work-related stress; brief problem resolution and/or referral for behavioral health treatment. For couples and/or families, issues related to relationship building, conflict resolution, and decision making within the family unit. You can choose in-person or video/virtual-based therapy.	Up to 24 sessions per calendar year. <i>Up to 2 of these appointments can be used for medication management.</i>

 Additional mental health coverage may be available under your [medical plan](#). The Spring Health EAP is separate from the mental health services covered under Microsoft's medical plans.

 **Cancellation policy:** The cancellation policy permits cancellation/reschedules up to 24 hours in advance of an appointment. The first instance of a no-show, late cancellation/reschedule is paid for by Microsoft and the session is deducted from your 24 sessions. Any following no-shows, late cancellations, and/or late reschedules are the responsibility of the member and will result in members being responsible for the full appointment cost (\$195).

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Access to Spring Health includes the following:

- 24x7 phone line for in-the-moment crisis support at (855) 629-0554
- Access to Spring Health via Web and App (microsoft.springhealth.com)
- Personalized care plan: 5-minute mental health assessment creates a customized care plan
- Counseling: up to 24 free counseling sessions per person per calendar year with a Spring Health provider per year. Members can filter by provider specialty, background, etc. and schedule direct on platform. Up to 2 of these appointments can be used for medication management.
- Care Navigator (Concierge) Support: Unlimited appointments with Care Navigators who are licensed clinicians to help you determine the best care options for you.
- Mental & Emotional Wellbeing Coaching to help you set and achieve personal or professional goals.
- Moments: self-guided exercises for mental wellbeing, covering topics like anxiety, burnout, better sleep, and more in an on-demand library. You have unlimited access to Moments which are wellness exercises for everyone, for your continued overall wellbeing from anywhere at any time.
- Work-life Resources & Referrals: Covers a variety of childcare, eldercare, financial, legal, and daily life topics. Spring Health will do the research for you to find options, including a list of referrals for childcare, eldercare, pet care, and more. Browse information or connect with subject-matter experts. Use online tools, articles, audio/video information, resources, and skill builders that provide practical tips on parenting, aging, balancing, thriving, working, living, as well as U.S./international immigration/relocation.
- Monthly and on-demand webinars based on various mental and emotional wellbeing topics.
Gottman Workshops: As a Microsoft employee based in the US, you are eligible for one live virtual workshop and one on-demand workshop at no cost to you. These workshops are a standalone benefit covered by Microsoft through your EAP provider, Spring Health.
 - **The Art and Science of Love Workshop (live virtual workshop or on-demand):** Improve your relationship in 2 days! This live workshop teaches you the key habits and behaviors found in happy, stable relationships and how to identify and eliminate patterns that lead to unhealthy relationships. You will dramatically improve the intimacy and friendship in your relationship and learn how to manage conflict in a healthy, positive way. It has been shown to achieve results similar to those of 6 months of marital therapy and has produced positive results for 94% of those who attend.
 - **New Parent Workshop: Bringing Baby Home (on-demand):** Research has shown that the relationship with your partner is critical for your baby's healthy development. The Bringing Baby Home parent workshop helps parents enhance their relationship satisfaction while bringing a new baby into their lives. Learn how to strengthen your friendship, increase intimacy and regulate conflict- thereby improving your wellbeing and that of your new baby.
 - **Emotional Coaching (on-demand):** Dr. John and Dr. Julie Gottman present a 5-step method that builds emotional intelligence and creates positive, long lasting effects in children from toddler to teens. Easy to learn, and used by parents, educators and care-

Section VII: Wellbeing at Microsoft

givers, it supports kids through life's ups and downs in a way that builds confidence and helps them grow socially, emotionally and intellectually.

- **Lessons in Love Singles Workshop (Live Virtual):** Learn the essential skills to make your next relationship a successful one with this singles workshop. Based on Dr. John Gottman's Seven Principles you will improve your communication and gain the essential skills to approach dating and relationship building.

To learn more about the workshops above or to register for one of the live/on-demand workshops, please go to the [Gottman Institute's Microsoft Employee Page](#).



For more information on Spring Health services and resources, or to schedule an appointment, go to microsoft.springhealth.com, or call (855) 629-0554.

Teladoc (Expert Medical Opinion)



COBRA enrollees – the Expert Medical Opinion section applies

How the program works

Microsoft's Expert Medical Opinion Program, administered by TeladocHealth, an independent third-party vendor, offers expert medical advice when you or a family member is facing an important medical decision. The program is a voluntary and confidential service provided at no additional cost to all Microsoft U.S. benefits-eligible employees, along with their spouses, domestic partners, children, and extended family members. The Expert Medical Service is ideally suited to help complex patients with conditions such as cancer, surgical candidates, and those with complicated or sensitive medical questions.

Teladoc Health is a global health services provider of physician-driven programs offering advocacy and support to employees experiencing medical confusion and/or crisis. The Expert Medical Service is delivered only by actively practicing, board certified physicians with access to 50,000 leading consulting experts worldwide.

Teladoc Health Medical Experts will support all medical specialties including but not limited to:

- Orthopedic Surgery
- Oncology
- Psychiatry
- Cardiology
- Internal Medicine
- Radiology
- Obstetrics/Gynecology
- Nephrology
- Urology
- Ophthalmology
- Emergency Medicine
- Pediatrics
- Family Medicine
- Mental Health
- Hematology
- Pulmonology
- Critical Care
- Pathology

To get started

- Contact Teladoc Health in one of three ways:
- Call (800) 676-1411 and follow the prompts to speak with a Teladoc Health Medical Expert representative. Calls are answered by live representatives twenty-four hours a day, seven days a week, 365 days a year. Any non-covered dependents or extended family members will need to provide a Promo Code (Promo Code is **MSFT-Family**) to access this service.
- Register on the [Teladoc Health Microsite](#) member portal and receive a response the same day or next business day.
 - Send an email to memberservices@Teladochealth.com and receive a response the same day or next business day.
- A dedicated Teladoc Health representative will verify your eligibility, collect all necessary authorizations and consents, and open a case to be reviewed.
- Within one business day of verifying your eligibility, a Physician Case Manager will be assigned to you, and they will contact you to:
 - Discuss Teladoc Health Medical Experts Services
 - Review your medical history including current and previous treating provider's information
 - Clarify and document your questions and concerns
 - Offer treatment decision support as needed
 - Determine gender, language, preferred contact times and other personal preferences
- After the discussions with you, your new Physician Case Manager will develop an initial report based on the information gathered.
- Your Physician Case Manager will then determine whether to initiate an Expert Medical Opinion, Coaching or Physician Navigation services.



Each person's case is unique, and the components of the services provided by Teladoc Health Medical Experts may vary. The exact service that any eligible employee or family member receives will be determined by a mix of the following: your preferences and objectives, the amount of data available for expert review, and the medical necessity determined by the Medical Directors.

Expert Medical Opinion

When you need a second, medical opinion from an expert regarding a recent, complex diagnosis or treatment plan.

- If determined your case needs an expert medical opinion, a Physician Navigation Associate will initiate the collection of medical records for your entire medical history, from all of your providers. Teladoc Health Medical Experts will use their best efforts to collect all necessary records for you within three (3) business days. Collected Records will include, but are not limited to:
 - Physician notes
 - Consult reports
 - Imaging, labs, and testing
 - Pathology tissue and reports
- Your Physician Case Manager will consolidate and review your records for any gaps in care and significant medical issues to be explored while working with you and the medical expert that is assigned to your case.

- All collected medical records will be uploaded to your Teladoc Health Medical Experts Microsite member portal for easy access by you.
- Once the Teladoc Health Medical Experts Clinical Committee has reviewed your medical records, they will evaluate your case, determine the appropriate medical expertise to engage, and assign the appropriate expert(s).
- The expert(s) assigned will then review your case, make their assessment, and create your final report within a few weeks; depending on the complexities of your case.
- Your Physician case manager will call you every week to update you on the progress and status of your case.
- After your final report is created, your Physician Case Manager will call you on your preferred day and time to discuss the results.
- With your consent, your Physician Case Manager will also contact your treating physician(s) to discuss the final report.
 - The expert(s) and Physician Case Manager will not serve as treating physicians, but only serve as a resource for you and your treating physician(s).
- Your Physician Case Manager will follow up with you within six (6) months of the final report review to discuss and initiate activity as needed to support:
 - Implementation of expert recommendations
 - Resolution and/or ongoing nature of medical concerns
 - New symptoms, conditions, testing, or records requiring expert review
 - Interest in pursuing new or additional treating physicians (via Physician Navigation)
 - Anecdotal data about participation satisfaction recorded

Coaching

When you need additional help navigating the medical system or want answers from a specialist physician to basic questions about health conditions and treatment options.

- After an in-depth discussion with you over your current care and treatment, your Physician Case Manager will coach you on how to interact with the medical system and/or discuss other programs available to you.
- Some or all your medical records may be collected depending on the needs and complexities of your case.
- Teladoc Health Medical Experts will provide direct and unlimited access for you to get questions and answers from your Physician Case Manager by phone, email, video, and chat.
- Your Physician Case Manager will recommend and/or provide articles, books, and medical literature relevant to your reported condition. Such information may be provided through the Microsite, direct email, and mail.

Physician Navigation

When you need additional help finding a leading, recognized physician in your local area network.

- Teladoc Health Medical Experts will deliver Physician Navigation support upon your request. After collecting your preferences, a Physician Navigation Associate will compile a "Physician Navigation List" of physicians close to you that are best suited for your situation. This list includes the physician's

Section VII: Wellbeing at Microsoft

certifications, patient satisfaction, education, training, practice area, a sanctions/malpractice check, contact information, in-network status, and availability to see new patients.

- Your Physician Navigation Associate will call all identified physicians to confirm the doctor's specialty, sub-specialty, acceptance of new patients, acceptance of member's insurance, appointment availability, referral requirements, contact info and the new patient process, including what to bring to the first appointment, and update the Physician Navigation List accordingly.
- The finalized Physician Navigation List, typically including three physicians, will be reviewed by your Physician Case Manager for quality assurance and then provided to you. Your Physician Case Manager will then verbally review the results on the Physician Navigation List with you.
- At your request, the Physician Navigation Associate will provide appointment facilitation by documenting your preferred appointment days and times and setting up an appointment on your behalf with the newly identified treating physician. Upon your request and permission, your Physician Case Manager will communicate with your new treating physician.



Although the Teladoc Health Expert Medical Opinion Services are provided at no additional cost to you, any treatment or services obtained in accordance with your Teladoc Health Medical Experts report will be subject to the terms, conditions, and provisions of your selected medical plan. Prior to receiving any additional treatment or service, review the coverage details of your medical plan or contact Premiera at (800) 676-1411, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington at (888) 901-4636 or Kaiser Permanente at (800) 464-4000.

Eligibility

All U.S. benefits-eligible employees as well as their spouses, domestic partners, and children (regardless of age or eligibility for other coverage under the Plan), and extended family members (who are otherwise ineligible for benefits under the Plan) may participate in the Expert Medical Services Program. For this purpose, extended family members include siblings, parents, grandparents, aunts, uncles, nieces, nephews or cousins of a U.S. benefits-eligible employee or the employee's spouse or domestic partner. Any non-covered dependents or extended family members will need to provide a Promo Code (Promo Code is **MSFT-Family**) to utilize this service.

Participants who are eligible at the initiation of their case will receive full service throughout the program regardless of their eligibility status (i.e., if an eligible employee uses the services but then terminates their employment at Microsoft before completion of the case, they would still be permitted to use the services until their case is completed).



For more information about the Teladoc Health Expert Medical Services or if you are unsure if your case can be reviewed by Teladoc Health, call (800) 676-1411 and follow the prompts to speak with a Teladoc Health representative.



Teladoc Health will NOT share your medical records, medical information or the contents of your Teladoc Health report with anyone, including Microsoft or your health plan, unless you specifically authorize such disclosure. In addition, Teladoc Health endeavors to comply with all relevant state, national, and international laws and regulations including the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA). Unless required by law, your specific name and medical information will NOT be shared with anyone, including Microsoft, without your written consent. Only de-identified and aggregate information will be used for program evaluation and improvement purposes.

Thrive Global



COBRA enrollees – the Thrive Global section applies

How the program works

The Thrive Global platform offers physical, mental, and financial wellbeing activities, programs, and resources, as well as wellbeing seminars on topics that support your wellbeing. Log into your Wellbeing at Microsoft account with Thrive Global to learn more to help you care for your body, nurture your mind, and invest in your future.

Under Wellbeing at Microsoft employees and adult dependents have access to the following programs:

Thrive Global: Thrive Global is an easy-to-use wellbeing app built directly into Microsoft Teams. Thrive Global focuses on daily behaviors - food, movement, sleep, finance, stress management, and connection - to help people adopt healthy habits, driving better health outcomes, engagement, and productivity. Thrive Global can also be accessed through the web browser or mobile app. Thrive Global also offers access to RethinkCare once you create your Thrive Global account.

- **RethinkCare at Home** – This program and platform provides support to families caring for children with learning or behavior challenges, or developmental disabilities, at no cost. Parents/Caregivers can take advantage of live teleconsultation (6 free one-hour sessions) with master's and PhD-level behavior experts to answer questions and provide guidance. In addition, Rethink provides parents with a variety of resources, training, and support.
- **RethinkCare Professional:** This program and platform provide evidence based online training courses on professional development, emotional intelligence, managing stress, and fostering environments to support neurodivergent and neurotypical team members. Employees have access to 1:1 consultation with on-staff neurodiversity experts to address your specific needs.



The Wellbeing at Microsoft online platform and programs is available to employees, spouses, domestic partners and children age 18 and over.

Active employees go here...

[Wellbeing at Microsoft](#)

COBRA enrollees go here...

Email benefits@microsoft.com

Maven (Family Health, Reproductive, and Menopause Support)



COBRA enrollees – the Family Health, Reproductive, and Menopause Support section applies

How the program works

Microsoft provides access to Maven to all employees and their dependents who are covered under a Microsoft U.S. health plan (including all Premera, Surest, and Kaiser plans). Maven is a digital health platform to help navigate preconception, pregnancy, postpartum, adoption, surrogacy, parenting, menopause, and returning to work.

Family Health Support

This program provides support for reproductive and family health:

- Meet with a Care Advocate 24/7, who can answer questions about your benefits, recommend the best practitioners on Maven for your needs, and refer you to in-person, in-network doctors.
- Get on-demand support from providers and coaches across more than 35 specialties, including midwives; doulas; mental health providers; nutritionists; reproductive endocrinologists; egg donor consultants; lactation consultants; infant sleep coaches; adoption and surrogacy specialists; parenting coaches; sex coaches, and many others.
- Receive clinically informed content tailored to your journey, take classes with Maven experts, and connect with others through supportive community forums.

Menopause Support

This program provides support for menopause education and support:

- Meet with a Care Advocate 24/7, who can help address symptoms and will provide specialized virtual care and personalized guidance.
- Book video appointments or chat with providers spanning 35+ specialties, including gynecologists, sex therapists, mental health providers, career coaches, and more.
- Connect with others going through menopause.
- Learn more about perimenopause and menopause with access to clinically-approved education resources.

To enroll:

1. Go to [Maven](https://mavenclinic.com/join/msft) (<https://mavenclinic.com/join/msft>)
2. Set up an account (you and/or your spouse/partner will need your Microsoft employee ID number).

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3. Complete a health assessment to create a specialized care team based on your (or your partner's) needs and interests.

Section VIII: Employee and dependent life insurance

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 COBRA enrollees – the Employee and dependent life insurance section does not apply

Employee life insurance

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How the plan works

Employee life insurance provides financial security to your beneficiaries in the event of your death. Information about your coverage options through Prudential and what you pay is provided in the table below.

Amount of coverage	What you pay
You may elect life insurance in the amount of one to 10 times your annual base pay, up to a maximum of \$4,000,000, whichever is less. The minimum coverage amount you may elect is \$50,000.	Microsoft pays for the cost of insurance that is equal to three times your annual base pay. The value of this coverage above \$50,000 is considered taxable income to you. You may purchase additional employee life insurance coverage using post-tax dollars. Coverage rates are provided in the Benefits Enrollment tool and depend on your age and the amount of coverage you elect.

 *The IRS regulates the taxable value of life insurance coverage above \$50,000. The IRS taxable value will appear as taxable income on your annual W-2 form and will be reflected on your Microsoft payroll check stubs as W2GRP. How this impacts your Federal Income and Social Security taxes will depend on your age, tax situation, and the amount of Microsoft paid life insurance over \$50,000 you elect.*

Your coverage will be based on your annual base pay as of the first day of the calendar year for coverage elected during the annual open enrollment period. For employees hired during the calendar year, coverage will be based on your annual base pay as of the first day of enrollment. Annual base pay is defined as follows:

Employee type	Definition of annual base pay
Full-time salary employee	Base salary (not including bonus)
Full-time hourly employee	Hourly wage multiplied by 2080
Part-time hourly employee	Hourly wage multiplied by regularly scheduled hours in a year

Certain coverage levels may require evidence of insurability (EOI) before your coverage election takes effect. If you are on a disability leave of absence when your election to increase coverage is to take effect,

Section VIII: Employee and dependent life insurance

the coverage effective date for that increased amount will be delayed until you are actively at work and request to increase coverage upon your return from disability leave (and, if applicable, Prudential has deemed your EOI to be satisfactory). Choose your level of coverage carefully, as you may not make changes to your coverage level outside of the annual open enrollment period. However, your life insurance coverage amount will automatically change as your pay changes. These changes to your life insurance coverage will be effective the first day of the month following the change of your base pay.



For more information about the benefits covered under the Microsoft employee and dependent life insurance plans, see the [Employee & Dependent Life Insurance Certificate](#). If you have additional questions, contact Benefits.



All benefits and coverages described in this SPD are subject to the terms of the insurance policies under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between this SPD and the insurance policies, the insurance policies will always govern.



If you leave the company or become otherwise ineligible for coverage, you have the right to apply for continued life insurance coverage. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Evidence of Insurability

Prudential may require satisfactory (EOI) if one of the following criteria applies:

- You are a new employee, and you elect coverage exceeding \$750,000
- You increase coverage, at open enrollment or mid-year pursuant to a qualifying life event, by more than one times your base pay or by an amount that would cause your total coverage to exceed \$750,000
- You request any increase in coverage after having previously provided unsatisfactory EOI to Prudential

The EOI form is accessible via the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#). You will need to complete and return the EOI to Prudential within 30 days of making your election requiring EOI.



If you do not complete and return an EOI form to Prudential within 30 days of making your election, your coverage will be set at the highest available amount that does not require EOI.



To contact Prudential directly, e-mail microsoft@prudential.com or call (800) 778-3827 or TDD (800) 493-1214.

Assignment of your life insurance rights

You may assign your life insurance to another person or entity (such as a trust) as a gift, including any right you have to choose a beneficiary or to convert to another contract of insurance. If you wish to do this, you will need to alert Prudential of this assignment and the contract holder. This assignment is irrevocable.

If you become disabled

Prudential will waive your employee life insurance premiums if you become disabled, provided your disability meets all of the following criteria:

- You became disabled before your sixtieth birthday and while insured for life insurance under this plan
- Your disability results from sickness or injury and occurs while you are insured
- You are not working at any job for wage or profit, and your disability prevents you from performing the material and substantial duties, for wage or profit, of any job for which you are reasonably suited by education, training, or experience

Prudential must receive notice and proof of your disability within 12 months after you have been continuously disabled. Prudential must also receive annual written medical proof that you remain disabled in order for the premium waiver to continue for successive one-year periods. The premium waiver will end after one year unless, before the end of that one-year period, you provide Prudential with written proof that you meet all of the above conditions, and your disability has continued for at least 9 months. Prudential may, at its own cost, require you to have physical examinations as often as is reasonably required while a claim is pending.

The waiver of life insurance premiums will end on the date that you meet any of the following criteria:

- Are no longer disabled
- Fail to submit the required proof that the disability continues
- Refuse to be examined when required by Prudential
- Reach the age of 65

If your insurance ends due to your employment and (if applicable) waiver of premium ending, and you do not return to active work within 31 days, you may convert your Microsoft coverage to a self-paid individual life insurance policy.

If you have converted to an individual life insurance policy, and Prudential later approves your waiver of premium claim, Prudential will cancel the conversion policy and refund any conversion policy premiums you have paid and retroactively reinstate your life insurance coverage under the plan.



For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

How the plan pays

In the event of your death, benefits will be paid as a lump sum to your beneficiaries according to the following guidelines:

- If you name two or more beneficiaries, each will receive an equal share of your life insurance benefit payment unless you indicate a different payment allocation in the Benefits Enrollment tool. In addition, if a beneficiary dies before you, that beneficiary's portion of your benefit will be divided equally among the remaining beneficiaries who survive you.
- If a beneficiary is a minor or otherwise incapable of giving a valid release, Prudential will pay the benefit according to state laws governing payments to such individual

Section VIII: Employee and dependent life insurance

- If there is no living named beneficiary, Prudential will pay the employee's estate or, at Prudential's option, to any one or more of these surviving relatives of the dependent:
 - Your surviving spouse/registered domestic partner
 - Your surviving child (children)
 - Your surviving parents
 - Your surviving siblings



It's important to keep your beneficiary designations up to date. Prudential will make a payment only to the most recently named beneficiary or beneficiaries.



A beneficiary is the person(s) named as the recipient of the plan benefits in the event of your death.



To select or change your beneficiary, use the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#).

Accelerated payment

If you become chronically or terminally ill while insured under the plan, you can request benefit payment before your death. Prudential will pay 75% of the benefit, up to a maximum of \$500,000, in a lump sum or in 24 monthly installments. The amount will be paid to you and remaining benefits will be reduced by this accelerated payment.

Prudential will pay the accelerated benefit only if:

- You complete and submit a claim form provided by Prudential
- Your employee term life insurance has not been assigned
- For a benefit payment due to a chronic illness while insured under the plan, you require Substantial Supervision (defined for this purpose as continual supervision to protect yourself and/or others) or are not able to perform at least 2 Activities of Daily Living

Prudential will pay the accelerated benefit only if:

You provide a doctor's certification indicating that you are either (1) chronically ill or (2) terminally ill with a life expectancy of 24 months or less. For a chronically ill employee, the certification must state that you either require Substantial Supervision or are incapable of performing at least 2 activities of daily living for the rest of your lifetime. If Prudential disagrees with a doctor's certification, you have the right to mediation or binding arbitration conducted by an independent third party.

The accelerated payment proceeds will be made available to you on a voluntary basis only. You are not eligible if you elect the benefit involuntarily to meet the claims of creditors and others.

Premium contributions must continue for the remaining benefit until the earlier of one of the following:

- The date you are no longer eligible for coverage
- The date that Microsoft coverage under this policy ends

If it appears to Prudential that a person incurs expenses in connection with your last illness, death, or burial, that person may receive part of your life insurance proceeds. Prudential, at its option, may pay that person up to the greater of: (a) 10% of the amount for which you are insured, and (b) \$1,000. If an amount

is so paid, the remaining life insurance proceeds payable by Prudential will be reduced by the amount so paid.

! *The accelerated benefit may be taxable. You should seek assistance from a personal tax advisor since reporting and consequences are the sole responsibility of the recipient of the benefit funds.*

! *There are state-specific requirements that may change the provisions under the Coverage(s) described in this SPD. If you live in a state that has such requirements, those requirements will apply to your Coverage(s) and are made a part of the plan.*
To review these state-specific requirements, visit Prudential's website at www.prudential.com/etonline. You will need to enter your state of residence and Access Code 43994.

Dependent life insurance

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How the plan works

Dependent life insurance helps provide support in the event of a death in your family. Information about your coverage options through Prudential and what you pay are provided in the table below.

Amount of coverage	What you pay
Spouse/domestic partner life insurance from \$5,000 to \$750,000 (not to exceed 50% of the coverage of your employee life insurance election)	You may purchase optional dependent life insurance coverage using post-tax dollars. Coverage rates are provided in the Benefits Enrollment tool and depend on the amount of coverage you elect and your age.
Dependent child life insurance in the amounts of \$5,000, \$10,000 or \$15,000 (for each child under age 26)	

You have 30 days from the initial date of eligibility to enroll your newly eligible Spouse/Domestic Partner or Dependent child in Dependent Term Life Coverage. Your Spouse/Domestic Partner or Dependent child will be automatically enrolled in default coverage of \$5,000 if you do not make an active enrollment election within those first 30 days, unless and until you subsequently elect a different coverage amount (or no coverage) pursuant to a future qualifying life event or open enrollment period.

If a child is an eligible dependent of more than one Microsoft employee, only one Microsoft employee can claim the child for child life insurance. If two or more Microsoft employees claim the same eligible dependent child, the child will be considered the dependent of:

1. the Microsoft employee who first enrolled in dependent life insurance coverage under the Plan while the child was a dependent of that employee; and otherwise
2. the Microsoft employee who has the longest continuous service with Microsoft, based on our records.

Section VIII: Employee and dependent life insurance

Certain coverage levels may require evidence of insurability before your dependents' coverage elections take effect. You may not make changes to your coverage level outside of the annual open enrollment period unless you experience a qualifying life event. If a dependent is confined for medical care or treatment, any increases in the dependent's life insurance will be delayed until a final medical release from confinement is received. This limitation does not apply to your newborn child.



For a list of qualifying life events, see the [Life event enrollment](#) section.



For more information about the current benefits that are covered under the Microsoft employee and dependent life insurance plans, see the [Employee & Dependent Life Insurance Certificate](#). For further questions, contact Benefits.



All benefits and coverages described in this plan description are subject to the terms of the insurance policies under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between this summary and the insurance policies, the insurance policies will always govern.



If you leave the company or become otherwise ineligible for coverage, you have the right to apply for continued life insurance coverage for your covered dependent. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Evidence of Insurability (EOI)

Depending on the level of coverage you elect, Prudential may require satisfactory evidence of insurability (EOI). The EOI form is accessible via the Benefits Enrollment tool. You will need to complete and return this medical history questionnaire to Prudential within 30 days of making the following elections:

- You elect coverage of more than \$100,000 for your spouse or domestic partner
- You increase coverage during annual open enrollment
- You increase coverage due to a qualifying change in employment or family status
- You elect more than \$750,000 in coverage during annual open enrollment, unless your election is based on a multiple of your base pay that is not increasing from the previous year



If you do not complete and return an EOI form to Prudential within 30 days of making your elections, your coverage will be set at an amount that does not require EOI.

Assignment of your life insurance rights

You may assign your dependent life insurance to another person or entity (such as a trust) as a gift, including any right you have to choose a beneficiary or to convert to another contract of insurance. If you wish to do this, you will need to alert Prudential of this assignment and the contract holder.

How the plan pays

Benefits are paid to you upon the death (from any cause) of a covered spouse or domestic partner, or dependent child. You may receive the plan payment in a lump sum.

Accelerated payment

If your spouse/domestic partner becomes terminally ill, you may request accelerated payment of your dependent life insurance benefits. Prudential will pay 75% of the benefit, up to a maximum of \$500,000. Benefits will be paid as a lump sum and remaining benefits will be reduced by the accelerated payment.

 *You or your spouse/domestic partner can only receive the accelerated benefit once. This benefit is not available for child dependents.*

Prudential will pay the accelerated benefit only if:

- You complete and submit a claim form provided by Prudential.
- Your spouse or domestic partner benefit is not assigned.
- You provide a certification by a doctor that your spouse or domestic partner's life expectancy is 24 months or less. The doctor will need to complete the Attending Physician's Certification part of the claim form. If Prudential disagrees with a doctor's certification, you have the right to mediation or binding arbitration conducted by an independent third party.
- Terminal illness proceeds will be made available on a voluntary basis only. You are not eligible if you elect the benefit involuntarily to meet the claims of creditors and others.

Premium contributions must continue for the reduced benefit amount until the earliest of the date that:

- You are no longer eligible for spouse or domestic partner coverage
- Microsoft coverage under this policy ends
- Spouse or domestic partner coverage for an entire class ends
- This policy ends

 *The accelerated benefit may be taxable. You should seek assistance from a personal tax advisor since reporting and consequences are the sole responsibility of the recipient of the benefit funds.*

 *There are state-specific requirements that may change the provisions under the Coverage(s) described in this Group Insurance Certificate. If you live in a state that has such requirements, those requirements will apply to your Coverage(s) and are made a part of your Group Insurance Certificate.*
To review these state-specific requirements, visit Prudential's website at www.prudential.com/etonline. You will need to enter your state of residence and Access Code 43994.

Section IX: Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D) section does not apply*

How the plan works

Accidental death and dismemberment (AD&D) insurance protects you and your family in the event of an accident-related death or injury that causes the loss of limbs or certain senses. This is an optional benefit provided through Prudential and doesn't require evidence of insurability (proof of good health).

You may purchase coverage for yourself using pre-tax dollars. However, if you enroll one or more eligible dependents, then the full cost of the family AD&D coverage must be purchased with after-tax dollars. Coverage rates are provided in the Benefits Enrollment tool and depend on the amount of coverage you elect.

Exception: Your spouse, Domestic Partner, or child is not eligible for dependent AD&D coverage while on active duty in the armed forces of any country.

If a child is an eligible dependent of more than one Microsoft employee, only one Microsoft employee can claim the child under AD&D insurance. If two or more Microsoft employees claim the same eligible dependent child, the child will be considered the dependent of:

1. the Microsoft employee who obtained AD&D coverage for the child, under the Plan, while the child was a dependent of only that employee; and otherwise
2. the Microsoft employee who has the longest continuous service with Microsoft, based on our records.

Information about your coverage options is provided in the table below. The amount of coverage you elect for yourself determines the amount that is available to your eligible dependents. Child dependents are covered to age 26.

Beneficiaries	Coverage
You (Microsoft employee)	One to 10 times your annual base pay, up to a maximum of \$1,500,000, whichever is less.
Spouse/domestic partner only	65% of employee coverage, up to a \$500,000 maximum
Spouse/domestic partner and children	For spouse/domestic partner, 50% of employee coverage amount, up to a \$500,000 maximum For each child, 15% of employee coverage amount, up to \$75,000 maximum
Children only	For each child, 25% of employee coverage amount, up to \$75,000 maximum

Your coverage will be based on your annual base pay as of the first day of the calendar year for coverage elected during the annual open enrollment period. For employees hired during the calendar year, coverage will be based on your annual base pay as of the first day of enrollment. Annual base pay is defined as follows:

Employee type	Definition of annual base pay
Full-time salary employee	Base salary (not including bonus)
Full-time hourly employee	Hourly wage multiplied by 2080
Part-time hourly employee	Hourly wage multiplied by regularly scheduled hours in a year

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

Because your AD&D coverage is based on your pay, your coverage will change automatically as your pay changes. These changes to your AD&D insurance coverage will be effective the day your pay changes as long as you are actively at work, or you return to work. You may change your coverage level only during the annual open enrollment period or if you have a qualifying life event.

All AD&D benefits are subject to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#). Each benefit may have additional eligibility criteria and exclusions and limitations. More information on what is covered is provided on the following pages.



For more information about conditions of coverage and payable benefits, see the [Employee and Dependent AD&D Certificate](#).



All benefits and coverages described in this plan description are subject to the terms of the insurance policies under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between this summary and the insurance policies, the insurance policies will always govern.



You have a right to apply for continued AD&D coverage through the Portability Plan for you or your covered dependents if your coverage ends because you leave Microsoft or otherwise become ineligible. For more information, see the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

How the plan pays

Benefits are payable if you (or a covered dependent) die or suffer certain serious injuries as the direct result of a covered accident. Benefits are paid to your designated beneficiary upon your death. If a covered dependent dies, you are the beneficiary.



A beneficiary is the person(s) named as the recipient of the plan benefits in the event of the member's death or injury.



To update your beneficiary information, use the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#).

Benefits will be paid as a lump sum according to the following guidelines:

- If a covered dependent dies, you are the beneficiary of any amounts paid from the plan
- If you die in a covered accident, AD&D benefits are paid to your named beneficiaries. Contingent beneficiaries will receive the plan benefits if the primary beneficiary dies while you are living.
- If you name two or more beneficiaries, each will receive an equal share of your AD&D benefit payment^{3/4}unless you indicate a different allocation. If a beneficiary dies before you, that portion of your benefit will be divided equally among the beneficiaries who survive you.
- If you do not name a beneficiary or do not have current beneficiary information on file, your AD&D benefit would be payable to the first survivor on the following list:
 - Your spouse/domestic partner

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

- Your children, in equal shares
- Your parents, in equal shares
- Your sisters and brothers, in equal shares
- Your estate

If you are age 70 or older, your benefits will be reduced according to the following schedule:

Reduction schedule	
Age	Coverage
Age 69 or younger	100% of coverage amount
70-74	65% of coverage amount
75-79	45% of coverage amount
80-84	30% of coverage amount
85 and older	15% of coverage amount

What the plan covers

The following table indicates the percentage of your coverage that is payable in the event of your death or injury due to a covered accident. A percentage of these amounts would be payable for similar losses suffered by a covered dependent. Coverage for your dependent depends upon whether you elected family tier coverage and your family structure. See the beneficiary table in the [How the plan works](#) section for more information. Additional benefits, such as counseling and childcare, are provided following the table.



Benefits are not payable for injury or death from certain events described in the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#). Benefits must be claimed within 365 days after the date of the accident.

Loss	Benefit (percentage of coverage purchased)
Life (see additional benefit details below)	100%
Sight in both eyes (total and permanent)	100%
Speech and hearing in both ears (total and permanent)	100%
Both hands	100%
Both feet	100%
One hand and one foot	100%
One hand and sight in one eye	100%
One foot and sight in one eye	100%
Both arms and both legs (Quadriplegia)	100%
Both arms and one leg or both legs and one arm (Triplegia)	75%
Both legs (Paraplegia)	75%

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

Loss	Benefit (percentage of coverage purchased)
One arm and one leg (Hemiplegia)	66.6%
Sight of one eye (total and permanent)	50%
One arm or one leg (Uniplegia)	50%
Speech (total and permanent)	50%
Hearing in both ears (total and permanent)	50%
One hand	50%
One foot	50%
Thumb and index finger of the same hand	25%
Loss of hearing in one ear (total and permanent)	25%
Coma (see additional criteria below)	1% per month, up to 100 months

Example

Marissa is in a car accident and loses their foot. Marissa has elected coverage of 3 times Marissa's salary of \$80,000, which is \$240,000. The AD&D plan pays 50% for the loss of a foot, so Marissa would receive a lump sum payment of \$120,000 (\$240,000 x 50%).



- *Total loss of use must be determined by a licensed physician to be permanent, complete, and irreversible*
- *A benefit is not payable for both loss of thumb and index finger of the same hand and the loss of one hand as the result of any one accident*
- *In no event will the total of all benefits payable under the above benefits exceed your amount of AD&D coverage*

Additional benefits

Bereavement and trauma counseling

The plan pays up to \$50 per visit for up to 50 visits for bereavement and trauma counseling if it is:

- Required because of a loss
- Provided within one year of the loss

Additional counseling benefits may be provided under your [medical plan](#) or the [Spring Health employee assistance program \(EAP\)](#).

Child's injury

If a child who is covered by AD&D insurance suffers a covered loss other than a loss of life, you will receive an additional benefit equal to the lesser of 200% of the amount payable or the one largest amount to which the child is entitled and \$75,000. This benefit is not payable if the child dies within 90 days of the accident.

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

Childcare

If you or your insured spouse/domestic partner dies in a covered accident, an additional benefit is paid to cover childcare expenses. Eligible children must:

- Be under the age of 13
- Be covered under AD&D insurance
- Be enrolled at a childcare center or become enrolled at a childcare center within 90 days after the covered accident

The benefit is the lesser of \$5,000, the actual cost charged by the childcare center, or five percent of the benefit amount for the member whose loss of life is the basis of the claim. Benefits are payable each year that the child is enrolled in a childcare center until the age of 13 or a maximum of four years of payment.

This benefit is payable only if the childcare center is a facility or individual that operates pursuant to law, is locally required, is not a family member, and that primarily provides care and supervision for children in a group setting on a regular, daily basis.

If no dependent children qualify, a lump sum amount of \$3,000 will be paid to your beneficiary or beneficiaries. The benefit is paid only once, either for the loss of your life or that of your spouse/domestic partner, but not for both.

Coma

If you or your covered eligible dependent lapse into a coma as the result of a covered accident, an amount of up to 100 percent of the full AD&D benefit will be paid in installments of 1 percent per month. To be eligible for this benefit, coma must:

- Occur within one year of a covered accident
- Continue for one month
- Be diagnosed to be total, continuous, and permanent at the end of that 31-day period.

Continuation of medical coverage

If you must take a leave of absence from work or your employment ends as a result of a covered loss, you may receive payments to help you pay for continuation of medical coverage through COBRA for 24 months. Payments will stop if you become covered under another medical plan. Each payment will equal the lesser of 3% of your benefit or \$125. Proof that the payment will be used for continuation of medical coverage will be required. For more information on continuation of medical coverage, review the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.

Felonious assault

If you suffer a loss that is the result of a felonious assault, the benefit amount payable will increase by an amount equal to the lesser of 5% of the benefit or \$5,000. The assault must occur:

- Because of your employment and while you are working for Microsoft
- On an authorized business trip

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

Home alteration and vehicle modification

In the event of a loss that requires home alteration or vehicle modification, you may receive an amount equal to the lesser of:

- The actual cost of the alteration or modification
- 5% of your benefit amount
- \$2,000

Loss of life

If you or your covered spouse/domestic partner suffers a loss of life due to a covered accident, an additional benefit equal to 1% for six consecutive months will be paid to the surviving spouse/domestic partner; if there is no spouse/domestic partner, then the benefit will be paid to the dependent children. No benefit is payable if there is no surviving spouse/domestic partner or child.

If you and your covered spouse/domestic partner both suffer loss of life due to covered injuries by the same accident or separate accidents within 48 hours of each other, the benefit amount payable to your surviving dependent child or children of your spouse/domestic partner will be the lesser of the difference between (1) the amount payable for your loss of life and the amount payable for your spouse/domestic partner's loss of life; and (2) \$500,000. This benefit is available if you elect AD&D coverage for yourself, spouse/domestic partner, and dependent children.

Rehabilitation

If within one year and as a result of a covered accident, a doctor determines that you or your covered eligible dependent require necessary training to help you return to normal activities, a monthly benefit of 1% of your benefit amount, subject to a maximum of \$500 per month, will be paid for up to 24 months while you need rehabilitation. This benefit will cease if you do not furnish proof of the continuing need for the rehabilitation or fail to undergo a doctor's examination requested by Prudential. Additional rehabilitation benefits may be provided under your [medical plan](#).

Safe driving

If you or a dependent dies from an injury while driving or as a passenger in an automobile, your benefit will be increased by the lesser of 10% or \$25,000 if the member was wearing a properly fastened seat belt and/or protected by a side air bag.

This benefit is not paid if the death results from the following:

- Driving or riding in an automobile used in a race or a speed or endurance test, for acrobatic or stunt driving or for any illegal purpose

Tuition benefits

If you or your insured spouse/domestic partner dies in a covered accident, certain dependent children can continue their education. The lesser of 5% of your benefit or \$5,000, or the actual annual tuition fee (excluding room and board) will be paid per year for up to four consecutive years. Eligible dependent children include:

- Your child who wholly depends on you for support and maintenance on the date of death;

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

- Children below the age of 25 enrolled as a full-time student in a university, college, or trade school; and
- Children in the 12th grade who enroll as a full-time student in a university, college, or trade school within 365 days after the insured individual's death.

If no dependent children qualify, a lump sum benefit of \$3,000 will be paid. The benefit is paid only once, either for the loss of your life or that of your spouse/domestic partner, but not for both.

If you die in a covered accident, your AD&D insured spouse/domestic partner will be paid a tuition reimbursement benefit if they enroll in a professional or trade program within 30 months after the date of death for the purposes of obtaining an independent source of support or enriching their ability to earn a living. The benefit will equal the lesser of 5% of your benefit, \$5,000, or the actual tuition amount and is payable for one year.



For more information about conditions of coverage and payable benefits, see the [Employee and Dependent AD&D Certificate](#).



There are state-specific requirements that may change the provisions under the Coverage(s) described in the Group Insurance Certificate. If you live in a state that has such requirements, those requirements will apply to your Coverage(s) and are made a part of your Group Insurance Certificate.

Prudential has a website that describes these state-specific requirements. You may access the website at <http://www.prudential.com/etonline>. When you access the website, you will be asked to enter your state of residence and your Access Code. Your Access Code is 43994.

Exclusions and limitations

This plan does not cover any loss caused by or resulting from the following:

- Suicide or attempted suicide while sane or insane
- Intentionally self-inflicted injuries, or any attempt to inflict such injuries
- Sickness, whether the loss results directly or indirectly from the sickness
- Medical or surgical treatment of sickness, whether the loss results directly or indirectly from the treatment
- Any bacterial or viral infection; however, this exclusion does not include a pyogenic infection resulting from an accidental cut or wound or a bacterial infection resulting from accidental ingestion of a contaminated substance
- Taking part in any insurrection
- War or any act of war, except as provided by any War Risk Hazard provision; war refers to declared or undeclared war and includes resistance to armed aggression
- An accident that occurs while the person is serving on full-time active duty for more than 30 days in any armed forces. However, this does not include Reserve or National Guard active duty for training.
- Travel or flight in any vehicle used for aerial navigation in any of the following cases:
 - The person is riding as a passenger in any aircraft not intended or licensed for the transportation of passengers

Section IX: Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D)

- The person is performing as a pilot or a crew member of any aircraft
- You are riding as a passenger in an aircraft owned, operated, controlled, or leased by Microsoft, its subsidiaries, or affiliates. This includes getting in, out, on, or off any such vehicles.
- Commission of or attempt to commit a felony
- While operating an air, land, or water vehicle, being legally intoxicated or under the influence of any narcotic unless administered or consumed on the advice of a doctor

Section X: Long-term disability (LTD)

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 COBRA enrollees- the Long-term disability (LTD) section does not apply

How the plan works

The long-term disability (LTD) plan is designed to provide income replacement in the event you experience a prolonged injury or illness. The LTD plan also offers additional benefits to support you and your family. The plan is administered by Prudential.

You can choose one of three coverage levels, as shown in the table below. If you don't elect coverage, your coverage level will default to 60% coverage.

Election	Coverage
40% Coverage	Covers 40% of your monthly earnings, up to a maximum of \$10,000 per month
50% Coverage	Covers 50% of your monthly earnings, up to a maximum of \$12,500 per month
60% Coverage (default if no coverage elected)	Covers 60% of your monthly earnings, up to a maximum of \$15,000 per month



Monthly earnings are your gross monthly income just prior your date of disability. For a complete definition, review the [glossary](#).

Regardless of which coverage level you choose, Microsoft pays the full cost of your LTD coverage. The monthly premium amount of this coverage is considered taxable income to you. You do not pay taxes on Microsoft's contribution to your coverage while you are receiving monthly payments. Any long-term disability benefits that you receive under the Plan generally will be federal tax-free.

If you become disabled while covered by this plan, you may receive a monthly payment and other LTD benefits after an elimination period and provided you meet certain eligibility criteria. Your monthly payments may be reduced by other sources of income or if you continue working while you are disabled. Prudential will send you a payment each month up to a maximum period.

All LTD benefits are subject to the plan's [exclusions and limitations](#). Each benefit may have additional eligibility criteria and exclusions and limitations. More information on what is covered is provided on the following pages.



For more information about conditions of coverage and payable benefits, see the [Long-term Disability Insurance Certificate](#).



All benefits and coverages described in this plan description are subject to the terms of the insurance policies under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between this summary and the insurance policies, the insurance policies will always govern.

When LTD benefits begin

Following an elimination period, you will be eligible for monthly payments and other LTD benefits if you meet the criteria described below.

Elimination period

The elimination period is the longer of 182 days, beginning from your injury or onset of your illness, or the date you exhaust short-term disability benefits from Microsoft. You can satisfy your elimination period while working, provided you meet Prudential's definition of disability including the additional criteria for [eligibility while working](#) described below.



Short-term disability (STD) provides up to 26 weeks of leave for a non-work-related illness or injury. For information about STD leave, visit [HR Web](#)

You may have one or more periods of recovery during the elimination period without having to restart the elimination period if both of the following occur:

- You become disabled again from the same or a related medical condition
- You complete the 182-day elimination period within one year (365 days) from the date the disability commenced

If you do not satisfy the elimination period within 365 days, any new period of disability from the same or a related medical condition will be treated as a new claim.

Eligibility criteria

You are considered eligible for monthly payments, subject to exhaustion of the elimination period described above, when Prudential determines that, due to your illness or injury, you are:

- Unable to perform the material and substantial duties of your regular occupation, or you have a 20% or more loss in your monthly earnings; and
- Under the regular care of a doctor



Material and substantial duties are those duties normally required as part of your job that cannot be reasonably omitted or modified. If you are required to work on average more than 40 hours per week, you are considered able to meet this duty if you are able to work 40 hours per week.

Regular care of a doctor means you visit a doctor as frequently as is medically required to manage and treat your condition. For a complete definition, review the [glossary](#).

Example

Caitlin earned \$6,000 a month before experiencing a disability, and continued to work part-time thereafter, earning less than \$4,800 a month. Caitlin would be eligible for partial monthly payments as long as Caitlin can no longer perform the material and substantial job duties and is under a doctor's care.

Your LTD benefits will continue after 24 months if Prudential determines that, due to the same illness or injury, you are:

- Unable to perform the duties of any gainful occupation for which you are reasonably fitted by education, training, or experience that provides income exceeding your monthly payment, if you are not working; or exceeding 80% of your indexed monthly earnings, if you are working, and
- Under the regular care of a doctor



Your **indexed monthly earnings** are your monthly earnings, adjusted by the lesser of 10% or the current annual percentage increase in the Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W). Adjustments are made on each July 1, provided you were disabled for all of the 12 months before that date. Your indexed monthly earnings may increase or remain the same but will never decrease.

Example

After two years, Caitlin's indexed monthly earnings are \$7,260. If Caitlin is working, Caitlin will continue to receive partial monthly payments if that income is lower than \$5,808 (80% of \$7,260), and Caitlin is (1) unable to perform any occupation that provides a greater income, and (2) under a doctor's care.



The loss of a professional or occupational license or certification does not, in itself, constitute disability.

Prudential will assess your ability to work and the extent to which you are able to work by considering the facts and opinions from your doctors. Prudential may require you to be examined as often as it is reasonable by doctors, other medical practitioners, or vocational experts of Prudential's choosing. Prudential will pay for these exams. Prudential may require you to be interviewed by an authorized Prudential representative. Refusal to be examined or interviewed may result in denial or termination of your claim.



*If you are unable to perform at least two daily activities without substantial assistance or have severe cognitive impairment, you may be eligible for additional monthly payments under the **catastrophic disability** benefit.*

If you are working while disabled

In certain situations, you may be able to work in a different job than you had when you became disabled (or, during the first 24 months of receiving LTD benefits, in a limited capacity in the same job that you had when you became disabled). If you meet the above criteria and are working, you are eligible for monthly payments. However, your monthly payments may be reduced if your income from working while disabled exceeds 20% of your indexed monthly earnings. If you become covered under any other LTD plan while working, you won't be eligible for payments under this LTD plan.



You must notify Prudential immediately when you return to work in any capacity.

If you get better within 30 days

If, after satisfying the elimination period, you are disabled for less than one month, Prudential will send you 1/30 of your payment for each day of disability.

Example

If you recover from your disability 15 days after of satisfying the elimination period, your monthly payment will be reduced by half to cover the number of days you were disabled.

If your disability recurs

If you return to work full time after receiving monthly payments and your disability occurs again, Prudential will treat your disability as part of your prior claim, and you will not have to complete another elimination period if both of the following is true:

- You were continuously insured under this plan for the period between your prior claim and your current disability
- Your recurrent disability occurs within six months of the end of your prior claim

Your recurrent disability will be subject to the same terms of the plan as your prior claim. Any disability which occurs after six months from the date your prior claim ended will be treated as a new claim.



A **recurrent disability** is an injury or illness that worsens and is due to one or more of the same causes as a prior disability for which Prudential made a monthly payment.

What the plan pays

Your monthly payments are calculated using your gross monthly income from Microsoft as of your earnings calculation date, which is:

- The date you meet the eligibility requirements above
- The date immediately preceding the beginning of your most recent elimination period, if you have to restart your elimination period as described above
- Your last full day of employment if you become disabled while you are on a covered layoff or an approved leave of absence

Gross monthly income from Microsoft, for this purpose, includes base salary and the average commissions, bonuses, and overtime pay earned per month from Microsoft during the 12-month period preceding your date of disability (or, if shorter, your period of employment with Microsoft). Gross monthly income does not include any other compensation or amounts of any kind, including any amounts received from sources other than Microsoft.

Monthly payments may be reduced if:

- You have deductible sources of income, such as workers' compensation payments or disability income payments from Social Security or another retirement plan. For a complete list, review [deductible sources of income](#) later in this section.

Section X: Long-term disability

- You have disability earnings, which are any income you receive while working and any additional income you could receive if you work to your greatest extent possible, as follows:
 - For the first 24 months, your disability earnings are from your regular occupation.
 - After 24 months, disability earnings are from any available occupation for which you are reasonably fitted by education, training or experience.

! If your disability earnings exceed 80% of your [indexed monthly earnings](#) Prudential will stop sending you payments and your claim will end. If your disability earnings fluctuate, your indexed monthly earnings will be averaged over a period of 3 months to determine continued eligibility for payment.

For the first twelve months of your disability, your monthly payment is calculated as follows:

Step	Calculation	Example
1	Determine your gross monthly payment, which is the lesser of the following: Your coverage level multiplied by your monthly income just prior to your earnings calculation date The maximum monthly payment for your coverage level	Emrah earned \$7,000 a month before experiencing a disability, and Emrah elected the 60% coverage level. $\$7,000 \times 60\% = \$4,200$ Since \$4,200 is less than the maximum monthly payment of \$15,000, Emrah's gross monthly payment is \$4,200.
2	Subtract any deductible sources of income from your gross monthly payment to calculate your monthly payment.	Emrah has no deductible sources of income, so the monthly payment is \$4,200.
3	If your disability earnings are more than 20% of your monthly earnings, your monthly payment will be reduced as follows: Add your gross monthly payment and your return-to-work earnings Subtract your indexed monthly earnings from the result if you are disabled and working If the result is a positive number, you will continue to receive the full monthly payment If the result is a negative number, that amount will be subtracted from your monthly payment	Emrah's return to work earnings are \$3,000. Emrah's also working while disabled. Adding Emrah's gross monthly payment and monthly return to work earnings, Emrah gets \$7,200 (\$4,200 + \$3,000) Subtracting this amount (\$7,200) from Emrah's indexed monthly earnings (\$7,000) results in a negative number (-\$200) Emrah's adjusted monthly payment is \$4,000 (\$4,200 - \$200). If Emrah works to full potential and earns \$3,000, Emrah's total income would be \$7,000.

! The minimum monthly payment is 10% of the gross monthly payment or \$100, whichever is less. If your benefit is subject to offset(s) resulting in a minimum monthly payment while working, you may be eligible to receive a partial minimum monthly payment.

After 12 months, the disability earnings adjustment to your monthly payment will be calculated as follows:

Step	Calculation
1	Calculate your lost earnings by subtracting your disability earnings from your indexed monthly earnings. $\text{Indexed monthly earnings (pre-disability)} - \text{Disability earnings} = \text{Lost earnings}$

Step	Calculation
	Your actual and potential income from working with a disability
2	Calculate your percentage of lost earnings by dividing the result by your indexed monthly earnings Lost earnings / Indexed monthly earnings (pre-disability) = Percentage of lost earnings Income lost due to disability
3	Multiply the result by your unadjusted monthly payment. Monthly payment X Percentage of lost earnings = Monthly payment after 12 months Gross monthly payment adjusted for deductible sources of income Percentage of income lost due to disability

Example

After a year, Emrah's indexed monthly earnings go up to \$7,700. Emrah's monthly payment would be calculated as follows:

- Subtracting disability earnings from Emrah's indexed monthly earnings, we get lost earnings of \$4,700 (\$7,700-\$3,000).
- Dividing lost earnings by indexed monthly earnings, we get a percentage of lost earnings of 61% (\$4,700/\$7,700).
- Multiplying this percentage by the monthly payment that would be received if Emrah was not working, we get a monthly payment of \$2,562 (61% x \$4,200)

Emrah's total income from employment and monthly payment would be \$5,562.

Proof of income

Prudential may require you to send proof of your income from employment while receiving monthly payments, including copies of your IRS federal income tax return, W-2 and 1099 forms.

Income fluctuation

If your income from employment while receiving monthly payments is expected to fluctuate widely from month to month, Prudential may average your disability earnings over the most recent three months to determine if your claim should continue subject to all other terms and conditions in the plan. In this situation, Prudential will terminate your claim if the average of your disability earnings from the last three months exceeds 80% of indexed monthly earnings. Prudential will not pay you for any month during which disability earnings exceed the above amounts.

Deductible sources of income

Prudential will deduct the following sources of income from your gross LTD amount to calculate your monthly payment:

Deductible sources of income	
1	The amount you receive or are entitled to receive as loss-of-time benefits under: • A workers' compensation law • An occupational disease law • Any other act or law with similar intent
2	The amount you receive or are entitled to receive as loss-of-time disability income payments under any: • State compulsory benefit act or law • Automobile liability insurance policy required by law • Insurance or a health or welfare plan or other group insurance plan where Microsoft, directly or indirectly, has paid all or part of the cost or has made payroll deductions • Governmental retirement system as the result of your job with Microsoft
3	The gross amount that you, your spouse, and children receive or are entitled to receive as loss-of-time disability payments because of your disability under: • The United States Social Security Act • The Railroad Retirement Act • The Canada Pension Plan • The Quebec Pension Plan • Any similar plan or act Amounts paid to your former spouse or to your children living with such spouse will not be included.
4	The gross amount that you receive as retirement payments or the gross amount your spouse and children receive as retirement payments because you are receiving payments under: • The United States Social Security Act • The Railroad Retirement Act • The Canada Pension Plan • The Quebec Pension Plan • Any similar plan or act Benefits paid to your former spouse or to your children living with such spouse will not be included.
5	The amount that you: • Receive as disability payments under the Microsoft retirement plan if any • Voluntarily elect to receive as retirement or early retirement payments under the Microsoft retirement plan • Receive as retirement payments when you reach normal retirement age, as defined in the Microsoft retirement plan. Disability payments under a retirement plan will be those benefits that are paid due to disability and do not reduce the retirement benefits that would have been paid if the disability had not occurred. Retirement payments will be those benefits that are paid based on the amount that Microsoft contributes to the retirement plan. Disability benefits which reduce the retirement benefits under the Plan will also be considered as a retirement benefit. Amounts received do not include amounts rolled over or transferred to any eligible retirement plan. Prudential will use the definition of eligible retirement plan as defined in Section 402 of the Internal Revenue Code, including any future amendments which affect the definition.
6	The amount you receive under the maritime doctrine of maintenance, wages, and cure. This includes only the wages part of such benefits.
7	The amount of loss-of-time benefits that you receive or are entitled to receive under any salary continuation or accumulated sick leave that exceed or would exceed 100 % of your monthly earnings. Salary continuation and accumulated sick leave include continued payments to you by Microsoft of all or part of your monthly earnings after you become disabled. This continued payment must be part of an established plan maintained by Microsoft for the benefit of an employee. Salary continuation or

Deductible sources of income

accumulated sick leave does not include compensation paid to you by Microsoft for work you actually perform after your disability begins.

8 The amount that you receive from a partnership, proprietorship, or any similar draws.

9 The amount that you receive or are entitled to receive under any unemployment income act or law due to the end of employment with Microsoft.

With the exception of retirement payments or amounts that you receive from a partnership, proprietorship, or any similar draws, Prudential will subtract only deductible sources of income which are payable as a result of the same disability.

Prudential will not reduce your payment by your Social Security retirement payments if your disability begins after age 65 and you were already receiving Social Security retirement payments.

If Prudential determines you qualify for benefits under item one, two, or three

If Prudential determines that you may qualify for benefits under item one, two, or three in the list of deductible sources of income above, Prudential will estimate your entitlement to these benefits. Prudential can reduce your payment by the estimated amount even if such benefits have not been awarded. However, Prudential will not reduce your payment if you do all of the following:

- Apply for the benefits
- Appeal any denial to all administrative levels that Prudential feels are necessary
- Sign Prudential's Reimbursement Agreement form. This form states that you promise to pay Prudential any overpayment caused by an award.



If your payment has been reduced by an estimated amount, your payment will be adjusted when Prudential receives proof of one of the following:

- *The amount awarded*
- *That benefits have been denied and all appeals that Prudential feels are necessary have been completed*

In this case, a lump sum refund of the estimated amount will be made to you.

If Prudential determines you qualify for benefits under item seven or nine

If Prudential determines that you may qualify for benefits under item seven or nine in the list of deductible sources of income above, Prudential will estimate your entitlement to these benefits. Prudential can reduce your payment by the estimated amount if such benefits have not been received.



If you receive a lump sum payment from any deductible source of income, the lump sum will be prorated on a monthly basis over the time period for which the sum was given. If no time period is stated, Prudential will use a reasonable one.

Minimum monthly payment

If subtracting deductible sources of income results in a zero benefit, the minimum monthly payment is the greater of (a) 10% of the gross disability payment otherwise payable, and (b) \$100. Prudential may apply this amount toward an outstanding overpayment.

After Prudential has subtracted any deductible source of income from your gross disability payment, Prudential will not further reduce your payment due to a cost-of-living increase from that source.

Non-deductible sources of income

Prudential will not deduct from your gross disability payment income you receive from, but not limited to, the following sources:

- 401(k) plans
- Profit sharing plans
- Thrift plans
- Tax-sheltered annuities
- Stock ownership plans
- Non-qualified plans of deferred compensation
- Pension plans for partners
- Military pension and disability income plans
- Credit disability insurance
- Franchise disability income plans
- A retirement plan from another employer
- Individual Retirement Accounts (IRAs)

When monthly payments stop

Prudential will stop monthly payments while you are incarcerated as a result of a conviction.

Prudential will stop payments and your claim will end on the earliest of the following:

- During the first 24 months of payments, when you are able to work in your regular occupation on a part-time basis and earn 20% or more of your indexed monthly earnings but you choose not to
- After 24 months of payments, when you are able to work in any gainful occupation on a part-time basis and earn 20% or more of your indexed monthly earnings but you choose not to
- The end of the maximum period of payment as described below
- The date you are no longer disabled under the terms of the plan
- The date you fail to submit proof of continuing disability satisfactory to Prudential
- The date your disability earnings exceed the amount allowable under the plan
- The date you decline to participate in a rehabilitation program that Prudential considers appropriate for your situation and that is approved by an independent doctor
- The date you die

Maximum period of payment

Prudential will provide you a monthly payment each month up to the maximum period of payment as shown in the table below:

Section X: Long-term disability

Your age on date of disability begins	Your maximum period of benefits
Under age 61	To your normal retirement age*, but not less than 60 months
Age 61	To your normal retirement age*, but not less than 48 months
Age 62	To your normal retirement age*, but not less than 42 months
Age 63	To your normal retirement age*, but not less than 36 months
Age 64	To your normal retirement age*, but not less than 30 months
Age 65	24 months
Age 66	21 months
Age 67	18 months
Age 68	15 months
Age 69 and over	12 months

* Your normal retirement age is your retirement age under the Social Security Act, where retirement age depends on your year of birth.

The LTD plan limits the maximum pay period to a combined 36 months during your lifetime for the following disabilities:

- Disabilities based on self-reported symptoms, determined by Prudential as manifestations of your condition that are not verifiable using tests, procedures, and clinical examinations standardly accepted in the practice of medicine. Examples of self-reported symptoms include, but are not limited to: headache, pain, fatigue, stiffness, soreness, ringing in ears, dizziness, numbness, and loss of energy.
- Disabilities due in whole or part to mental illness, determined by Prudential as a psychiatric or psychological condition regardless of cause. Mental illness includes but is not limited to schizophrenia, depression, manic depressive or bipolar illness, anxiety, somatization, substance-related disorders, and/or adjustment disorders or other conditions. These conditions are usually treated by a mental health provider or other qualified provider using psychotherapy, psychotropic drugs, or other similar methods of treatment as standardly accepted in the practice of medicine.

The limitation of 36 months for mental illness does not apply if you meet one of the following conditions:

- If you are confined to a hospital or institution for at least eight hours a day at the end of the 36-month period. If you are still disabled when you are discharged, Prudential will send you payments for a recovery period of up to 90 days. If you become reconfined for at least eight hours a day at any time during the recovery period and remain confined for at least 14 days in a row, Prudential will send payments during that additional confinement and for one additional recovery period up to 90 more days.
- If, after the 36-month period, you continue to be disabled and subsequently become confined for at least eight hours a day to a hospital or institution for at least 14 days in a row, Prudential will send payments during the length of the confinement.
- If you have dementia as a result of the following:
 - Stroke
 - Trauma
 - Viral infection
 - Alzheimer's disease

- Other conditions which are not usually treated by a mental health provider or other qualified provider using psychotherapy, psychotropic drugs, or other similar methods of treatment as standardly accepted in the practice of medicine



Prudential will not pay beyond the limited pay period as indicated above, or the maximum period of payment, whichever occurs first.

Other benefits

In addition to the monthly payments, this plan provides the following benefits in the event of your disability.

Survivor benefit

If you should die within 365 days of your disability and are receiving monthly payments from this plan at the time of your death, Prudential will pay a benefit equal to six months of your gross monthly payment to your eligible survivors, which include your spouse/domestic partner, if living; otherwise, your children under age 25. Your survivor will need to provide proof of your death.

If a benefit is payable to a minor or a person incapable of receiving payment, Prudential may pay the amount to any person or institution that appears to have assumed custody and main support of that person. If you have no eligible survivors, payment will be made to your estate.

Survivor benefit prior to death

If you are receiving monthly payments and you become terminally ill, you may elect to receive the survivor benefit prior to your death. Prudential will pay the survivor benefit if:

- You elect this option in writing in a form that satisfies Prudential
- You provide proof that you are a terminally ill employee, including certification by your doctor that your life expectancy is six months or less
- Your long-term disability coverage is not assigned
- You elect this benefit only on a voluntary basis



You are not eligible for this benefit if:

- *You are required by law to use this benefit to meet the claims of creditors, whether in bankruptcy or otherwise*
- *You are required by a government agency to use this benefit in order to apply for, get, or keep a government benefit or entitlement*

You may elect the survivor benefit prior to death option only once during your lifetime. If you elect to receive this benefit prior to your death, no survivor benefit will be paid upon your death. However, Prudential will first apply the survivor benefit to any overpayment which may exist on your claim.

Catastrophic disability

You are catastrophically disabled when Prudential determines that, due to the same sickness or injury that caused your disability, the following is true:

- You are unable to perform, without substantial assistance, at least two activities of daily living. For a complete definition, review the [glossary](#).



Substantial assistance includes:

The physical assistance of another person without which one would not be able to perform an activity of daily living; or

The constant presence of another person within arm's reach who is necessary to prevent, by physical intervention, injury while performing an activity of daily living

Cognitive impairment is a loss or deterioration in intellectual capacity that is comparable to and includes Alzheimer's disease and similar forms of irreversible dementia. For a complete definition, review the [glossary](#).

Substantial supervision means continual oversight that may include cueing by verbal prompting, gestures, or other demonstrations by another person, and which is necessary to protect one from threats to their health or safety.

You will receive catastrophic disability payments when Prudential approves your claim, providing:

- You are receiving monthly payments under the plan
- You have had your catastrophic disability for a period of at least 30 consecutive days

Your monthly catastrophic disability payment, which is an additional benefit on top of the regular monthly payment, is equal to 20% of your monthly earnings, but not more than \$5,000. It will not be reduced by any deductible sources of income.

You will stop receiving payments and your catastrophic disability claim will end on the earliest of the following:

- The date you no longer have a catastrophic disability under the terms of the plan
- The date you fail to submit proof of continuing catastrophic disability satisfactory to Prudential
- The date you are no longer receiving monthly payments under the plan

Worksite modification

A worksite modification might allow you to perform the material and substantial duties of your regular job. One of Prudential's designated professionals will work with you to identify a modification to help you remain at work or return to work. This modification must be documented in writing and signed by you, Microsoft, and Prudential. This modification benefit is available to you one time only.

Prudential will reimburse Microsoft for the cost of the modification up to the greater of:

- \$1,000
- The equivalent of two months of your gross monthly payment

Social Security advice

Prudential can arrange for expert advice regarding your Social Security disability benefits claim and assist you with your application or appeal if you are disabled under the plan. Receiving Social Security disability benefits may enable the following:

- You to receive Medicare after 24 months of disability payments
- You to protect your retirement benefits
- Your family to be eligible for Social Security benefits

Prudential can assist you in obtaining Social Security disability benefits by:

- Helping you find appropriate legal representation
- Obtaining medical and vocational evidence
- Reimbursing pre-approved case management expenses



If you are enrolled for life insurance when you become disabled, you may be eligible for a waiver of your life insurance premiums. For more information, see the [Employee and Dependent life insurance](#) section.

Continuing health care coverage

Prudential will send you a payment each month for continued health care coverage costs up to the maximum period of continued health care payments while:

- You are receiving long-term disability benefits under the plan
- You are continuing your health care coverage under COBRA or similar state law
- Prudential has written proof of the cost to you of this coverage

The maximum period of continued health care payments is 29 months. Continued health care payments will end on the earliest of the following:

- The end of the maximum period of continued health care payments
- The date you return to work or become eligible for KHPWA insurance
- The date you are enrolled in Medicare
- The date you no longer receive long term-disability benefits under the Plan
- The date you fail to provide proof of COBRA continuation

The monthly continued health care payment is \$800. But your monthly continued health care payment will not exceed the actual costs to you for continued health care coverage.



Continued health care coverage costs means the actual costs to you for continued health care coverage provided through your employer, and which you elect under COBRA or similar state law.

Rehabilitation services

Prudential may review your file to determine if rehabilitation services might help you return to work. Once the review is completed by our rehabilitation specialists, working along with your doctor and other appropriate specialists, Prudential may pay for a rehabilitation program. If the program is not developed by Prudential's rehabilitation specialists, you must receive written approval from Prudential before beginning the program.

The rehabilitation program may include, but is not limited to:

- Coordination with Microsoft to assist you to return to work
- Evaluation of adaptive equipment to allow you to work
- Vocational evaluation to determine how your disability may impact your employment options
- Job placement services
- Resume preparation
- Job seeking skills training
- Retraining for a new occupation
- Assistance with relocation that may be part of an approved rehabilitation program

If, at any time, you decline to take part in or cooperate in a rehabilitation evaluation/assessment or program that Prudential feels is appropriate for your disability and that has been approved by your doctor, Prudential will cease your monthly payment.

Prudential will send you a rehabilitation payment each month up to the maximum period of rehabilitation payment while you are doing all of the following:

- Receiving LTD payments under the plan
- Participating in a rehabilitation program that has been approved by Prudential

Your maximum period of rehabilitation payment is six months. The monthly rehabilitation payment is equal to 10% of your monthly LTD payment. But the monthly rehabilitation payment, together with your monthly LTD payment, will not exceed the maximum monthly LTD payment.

Childcare

Prudential will send you a monthly childcare payment for up to six months while you are doing all of the following:

- Receiving LTD payments under the plan
- Participating in a rehabilitation program that has been approved by Prudential

The monthly daycare payment is equal to the amount of your eligible daycare expenses up to the maximum monthly daycare amount of \$500 multiplied by the number of eligible children, which are children age 12 or under who live with you, including your legally adopted children, your stepchildren and foster children.

Eligible daycare expenses are:

- Charged by a childcare provider who is not a member of your immediate family (you, your spouse/domestic partner, or a child, brother, sister, or parent of you or your spouse/domestic partner)
- Documented by receipts from the childcare provider that include the childcare provider's Social Security number or taxpayer identification number
- Specified in the Prudential-approved rehabilitation program as needed in order for you to participate in the program

Spouse/domestic partner and elder care

Prudential will send you a monthly payment for up to six months while you are doing all of the following:

- Receiving LTD payments under the plan
- Participating in a rehabilitation program that has been approved by Prudential
- The monthly spouse/domestic partner and elder care payment is equal to the amount of your eligible spouse/domestic partner and elder care expenses up to the maximum monthly spouse/domestic partner and elder care amount of \$500 multiplied by the number of eligible family members, which include family members who have a chronic illness or disability, including your spouse/domestic partner, parents, your grandparents who live with you, and your spouse/domestic partner's parents and grandparents who live with you.

Eligible spouse/domestic partner and elder care expenses are:

- Charged by a licensed adult care provider who is not a member of your immediate family (you, your spouse/domestic partner, or a child, brother, sister or parent of you or your spouse/domestic partner)
- Documented by receipts from the licensed adult care provider that include the provider's Social Security number or taxpayer identification number
- Specified in the Prudential-approved rehabilitation program as needed in order for you to participate in the program



A **chronic illness** is one of the following:

A loss of the ability to perform, without substantial assistance, at least two activities of daily living for a period of at least 30 consecutive days.

A severe cognitive impairment, which requires substantial supervision to protect the family member from threats to health and safety, for a period of at least 30 consecutive days.



There are state-specific requirements that may change the provisions under the Coverage(s) described in the Group Insurance Certificate. If you live in a state that has such requirements, those requirements will apply to your Coverage(s) and are made a part of your Group Insurance Certificate.

Prudential has a website that describes these state-specific requirements. You may access the website at www.prudential.com/etonline. When you access the website, you will be asked to enter your state of residence and your Access Code. Your Access Code is 43994.

Exclusions and limitations

The plan does not cover any disabilities caused by, contributed to by, or resulting from the following:

- Intentionally self-inflicted injuries
- Active participation in a riot
- Commission of a crime for which you have been convicted under state or federal law
- The plan does not cover a disability due to a preexisting condition
- The plan does not cover a disability due to war, declared or undeclared, or any act of war



Prudential considers you to have a **preexisting condition** if both are true:

- You received medical treatment, consultation, care, or services, including diagnostic measures, or took prescribed drugs or medicines, or followed treatment recommendation in the three months prior to your effective date of coverage or the date an increase in benefits would be available
- Your date of disability begins within 12 months of the date your coverage under the plan becomes effective
- You do not have a preexisting condition if, after the date your coverage under the plan becomes effective or the date an increase in benefits would otherwise be available, there is a period of six months or more during which you do not receive the care described above.

How to file a claim

If you are on an approved paid Short-Term Disability (STD) leave and remain out of work for 18 weeks, Prudential will automatically review your case to determine if you are eligible for LTD benefits. You may submit any additional information for Prudential to review. If you are not on a paid Short-Term Disability leave, you must provide Prudential proof of your disability claim no later than 90 days after your elimination period ends. If it is not possible to give proof within 90 days, it must be given no later than one year after the time proof is otherwise required, except in the absence of legal capacity.



Absence of legal capacity means an individual is no longer able to act on their own behalf. Ultimately, the individual is not able to execute legal documents.

Prudential will review an existing STD claim for medical documentation but may request additional documentation from you and/or your medical provider(s). Your proof of claim, provided at your expense, must show the following:

- That you are under the regular care of a doctor
- The appropriate documentation of your monthly earnings
- The date your disability began
- Appropriate documentation of the disabling disorder
- The extent of your disability, including restrictions and limitations preventing you from performing your regular occupation or any gainful occupation or an activity of daily living
- The name and address of any hospital or institution where you received treatment, including all attending doctors
- The name and address of any doctor you have seen

Proof of continuing disability

Prudential may request that you send proof of continuing disability, satisfactory to Prudential, indicating that you are under the regular care of a doctor. In some cases, you will be required to give Prudential authorization to obtain additional medical information, and to provide non-medical information (for example, copies of your IRS federal income tax return, W-2 forms and 1099 forms) as part of your proof of claim, or proof of continuing disability. This proof, provided at your expense, must be received within 30 days of a request by Prudential. Prudential will deny your claim or stop sending you payments if the appropriate information is not submitted.



Prudential will not recognize any relative including, but not limited to, you, your spouse/domestic partner, or a child, brother, sister, or parent of you or your spouse/domestic partner as a doctor for a claim that you send to us.

Payments

Prudential will make payments to you. Prudential has the right to recover any overpayments due to the following:

- Fraud
- Any error Prudential makes in processing a claim
- Your receipt of deductible sources of income

You must reimburse Prudential in full. Prudential will determine the method by which the repayment is to be made. Prudential will not recover more money than the amount Prudential paid you.



In some jurisdictions, if you knowingly and with intent defraud Prudential, file an application or a statement of claim containing any materially false information or conceal, for the purpose of misleading, information concerning any fact material thereto, you commit a fraudulent insurance act, which is a crime and subjects you to criminal and civil penalties. These actions will result in denial or termination of your claim, and, where such laws apply, are subject to prosecution and punishment to the full extent under any applicable law. Prudential will pursue all appropriate legal remedies in the event of insurance fraud.

Determination of Benefits

Prudential will notify you of the claim determination within 45 days of the receipt of your claim. This period may be extended by 30 days if such an extension is necessary due to matters beyond the control of the plan. A written notice of the extension, the reason for the extension and the date by which the plan expects to decide your claim, will be furnished to you within the initial 45-day period. The claim determination period may be extended for an additional 30 days, beyond the original 30-day extension, if necessary due to matters beyond the control of the plan. A written notice of the additional extension, the reason for the additional extension and the date by which the plan expects to decide on your claim, will be furnished to you within the first 30-day extension period if an additional extension of time is needed.

If the claim determination period is extended due to your failure to submit information necessary to decide the claim, Prudential's period for making the benefit determination will be tolled (i.e., suspended) from the date the notification of extension is sent to you until the date you respond to the request for additional information.

If your claim for benefits is denied

If your claim for benefits is denied, in whole or in part, you or your authorized representative will receive a written notice from Prudential of your denial. The notice will include:

- One or more specific reasons for the denial
- A discussion of the decision, including, if applicable, the basis for disagreeing with or not following (i) the views of your treating providers, (ii) the views of medical or vocational experts whose advice was obtained on behalf of the plan in connection with your adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the benefit determination, and (iii) a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration
- References to the specific plan provisions on which the benefit determination was based
- A description of any additional material or information necessary for you to perfect a claim and an explanation of why such information is necessary
- A statement that you are entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records, and other information relevant to your claim for benefits
- A description of Prudential's appeals procedures and applicable time limits, including a statement of your right to bring a civil action under section 502(a) of ERISA following your appeals
- If an adverse benefit determination is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, a statement that an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination will be provided free of charge upon request
- Either the specific internal rules, guidelines, protocols, standards, or other similar criteria of the plan relied upon in making the adverse benefit determination, or a statement that such rules, guidelines, protocols, standards, or other similar criteria of the plan do not exist

Appeals of Adverse Determination

If your claim for benefits is denied, or if you do not receive a response to your appeal within the appropriate timeframe (in which case the appeal is deemed to have been denied), you or your representative may appeal your denied claim in writing to Prudential within 180 days of your receipt of the written notice of denial, or 180 days from the date the claim is deemed denied, as applicable. Similarly, if Prudential does not decide your claim within the time described under "Determination of Benefits," above, you may appeal, although you are not required to do so.

You may submit with your appeal any written comments, documents, records, and any other information relating to your claim. Upon your request, you will also have access to, and the right to obtain copies of, all documents, records, and information relevant to your claim free of charge.

Prudential will conduct a full review of the information in the claim file and any new information submitted to support the appeal, utilizing individuals not involved in the initial benefit determination. This review will not afford any deference to the initial benefit determination.

Prudential will make a determination on your appeal within 45 days of the receipt of your appeal request. This period may be extended by up to an additional 45 days if Prudential determines that special circumstances require an extension of time. A written notice of the extension, the reason for the extension and the date that Prudential expects to render a decision will be furnished to you within the initial 45-day period. However, if the period of time is extended due to your failure to submit information necessary to decide the appeal, the period for making the benefit determination will be tolled (i.e., suspended) from the date the notification of the extension is sent to you until the date you respond to the request for additional information.

Prudential will provide you, free of charge and prior to any adverse decision on appeal, with any new or additional evidence considered, relied upon, or generated in connection with the claim (including evidence that may be the basis for denial as well as any evidence that may support granting the claim), and any new or additional rationale that will form the basis for Prudential's decision on appeal. Any such evidence or rationale will be provided as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the date the notice of the adverse decision on appeal is provided, in order to give you a reasonable opportunity to respond prior to that date.

If your appeal for benefits is denied

If the claim on appeal is denied in whole or in part, you will receive a written notice from Prudential. The notice will include:

- One or more specific reasons for the adverse determination
- A discussion of the decision, including, if applicable, the basis for disagreeing with or not following (i) the views of your treating providers, (ii) the views of medical or vocational experts whose advice was obtained on behalf of the plan in connection with your adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the benefit determination, and (iii) a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration
- References to the specific plan provisions on which the determination was based
- A statement that you are entitled to receive upon request and free of charge reasonable access to, and make copies of, all records, documents, and other information relevant to your benefit claim upon request

- A description of Prudential's review procedures and applicable time limits
- If an adverse benefit determination is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, a statement that an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination will be provided free of charge upon written request
- Either the specific internal rules, guidelines, protocols, standards, or other similar criteria of the plan relied upon in making the adverse benefit determination, or a statement that such rules, guidelines, protocols, standards, or other similar criteria of the plan do not exist
- A statement describing any voluntary appeals procedures offered by the plan, and your right to bring a civil suit under ERISA

Submitting a second appeal

If the appeal of your benefit claim is denied or if you do not receive a response to your appeal within the appropriate timeframe (in which case the appeal is deemed to have been denied), you or your representative may make a second, voluntary appeal in writing to Prudential within 180 days of the receipt of the written notice of denial, or 180 days from the date the claim is deemed denied, as applicable. You may submit with your second appeal, any written comments, documents, records, and any other information relating to your claim. Upon your request, you will also have access to, and the right to obtain copies of, all documents, records, and information relevant to your claim free of charge.

Prudential will make a decision on your second claim appeal within 45 days of the receipt of your request. This period may be extended by up to an additional 45 days if Prudential determines that special circumstances require it. Within the initial 45-day period, you will receive a written notice of the extension, the reason for the extension and the date by which Prudential expects to render a decision. However, if the time is extended due to your failure to submit information necessary to decide the appeal, the period for making the benefit determination will be tolled (*i.e.*, suspended) from the date the notice of the extension is sent to you until the date on which you respond to the request for additional information.

Submitting a benefit dispute

Your decision to submit a benefit dispute to this voluntary second level of appeal has no effect on your right to any other benefits under this plan. If you elect to initiate a lawsuit without submitting to a second level of appeal, the plan waives any right to assert that you failed to exhaust administrative remedies. If you elect to submit the dispute to the second level of appeal, the plan agrees that any statute of limitations or other defense based on timeliness is tolled (*i.e.*, suspended) during the time that the appeal is pending.

If the claim on appeal is denied in whole or in part for a second time, you will receive a notice of the denial from Prudential. The notice will include the same information that was included in the first adverse determination letter. If a decision on appeal is not furnished to you within the timeframes mentioned above, the claim will be deemed denied on appeal.

Time Limit to File Suit

If your claim for benefits and any required appeals are denied (or not decided within the time periods described above, and therefore deemed denied), you may file suit in federal court. However, no suit or other legal action may be initiated more than three years after proof of your claim was first due, unless otherwise provided under federal law.

Section XI: Supplemental Long-term disability (LTD)

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Help protect your income and lifestyle with Supplemental Long Term Disability

 COBRA enrollees – the Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D) section does not apply

How the plan works

Supplemental Long Term Disability (“LTD”) coverage can help provide additional financial security to supplement the portion of your income covered by Microsoft’s group LTD insurance.

You can purchase Supplemental LTD coverage that is designed to replace a greater percentage of lost income, in the event a covered sickness or accident prevents you from returning to work in your regular occupation. The Supplemental LTD coverage is insured under an insurance policy that you enter into with MetLife directly.

This section is intended to provide a general summary of the Supplemental LTD coverage, but the terms and conditions of coverage are set forth in your Supplemental LTD policy with MetLife, which will control in the event of any conflict with this SPD. Terms that are capitalized but not defined in this section will have the meaning set forth in your Supplemental LTD policy with MetLife.

Features:

- Income Replacement: Federal tax-free monthly supplemental disability benefits equal to 70% of your eligible compensation, minus any Microsoft LTD benefits you receive, up to a maximum monthly benefit of \$20,000. Eligible compensation consists of your monthly base salary plus the monthly equivalent of all bonuses and vested stock income you received in a specified 12-month lookback period prior to your enrollment in the Supplemental LTD program.
- Elimination (waiting) Period: 180 Days
- Benefits are generally payable to age 65 or 67, depending on the state of issue, or for up to 24 months for policies that have a 2-year maximum benefit period (see below). The maximum benefit period may change based on your age at the time of the claim. Please reference the "Duration of Benefits" tables below.
- Residual/Partial Disability Benefits
- Catastrophic Disability Benefits
- No reduction in benefits for disabilities resulting from Mental Health and/or Substance Use Disorders
- Fixed rates: Premiums are initially determined based on your current age, and do not change for a specified period of time, namely through age 65 or 67, or on the fifth policy anniversary if later, depending on your state
- No benefit offsets
- Guaranteed Standard Issue: Coverage is available upon answering a few short health questions, with no medical exams
- No pre-existing condition limitations
- Fully Portable Policies: Ability to continue coverage at the same discounted premium rates and subject to the same terms and conditions, even if you leave Microsoft.

Enrollment

Enrollment in the Supplemental LTD Plan is voluntary and is offered on a one-time basis during a special enrollment period. Eligible employees will receive communications with instructions on how to enroll during this special enrollment period. Microsoft does not contribute to Supplemental LTD coverage, and employee premiums are paid via after-tax payroll deductions.

Eligibility to Enroll

You're eligible to enroll in the Supplemental LTD Plan if you meet all the following requirements:

- You're classified by the Company as a U.S. benefits-eligible full-time employee;
- You have a permanent U.S. residence address;
- You completed and signed MetLife's Supplemental LTD Benefit application in the U.S. and are approved by MetLife;
- You're actively at work. Actively at work means the following: for the 90 days prior to and including the date of your application, (i) you have been performing all of the material duties of your occupation at: (a) your usual place of business; or (b) some other location that the Company

required you to be; (ii) you have worked the usual number of hours; and (iii) you have been absent from work solely due to vacation days or holidays, if applicable. If you are not actively at work, or have not been actively at work at any time during the previous 90 days, you may be subject to full underwriting.

Elimination period

The elimination (waiting) period before Supplemental LTD benefits commence is 180 days, beginning from your injury or onset of your illness.

If you live in any state except California, the policy has a 360-day accumulation period. This means that different periods of disability due to the same or related cause, within that accumulation period, can count towards satisfying the 180-day elimination period.

If you do not satisfy the 180-day elimination period within 360 days, any new period of Disability for the same or a related medical condition will be treated as a new claim, subject to a new elimination period.

If you live in California, there is no 360-day accumulation period, and each period of disability must satisfy the 180-day elimination period.

Disability Benefits

Supplemental LTD Benefits for Total Disability begin to be paid after you have satisfied the elimination period if, due solely to an injury or sickness, you are:

For states except California

- Prevented from performing the material and substantial duties of Your Regular Occupation;
- Not gainfully employed; and
- Receiving appropriate care from a physician who is appropriate to treat the condition causing the impairment

For California

- Unable to perform with reasonable continuity the substantial and material acts necessary to pursue your usual occupation in the usual or customary way.

Your eligibility for Supplemental LTD benefits is determined separately from, and is not dependent upon, your eligibility for Microsoft Group LTD benefits.

What the plan pays

After satisfying the elimination period, the plan provides for federal tax-free monthly supplemental disability benefits equal to 70% of your eligible compensation, minus any Microsoft group LTD benefits you receive, up to a maximum monthly benefit of \$20,000.

Section XI: Supplemental Long-term disability

Supplemental LTD	Group LTD
70% of Base Salary, Bonus and Stock Income Less Maximum Eligible Group LTD Benefit Maximum Monthly Benefit is \$20,000	60% of Base Salary and Bonus Maximum Monthly Benefit is \$15,000

Unlike Microsoft’s group LTD benefit, the Supplemental LTD benefit is based on the monthly benefit amount determined at the time of your enrollment in the Supplemental LTD coverage (based on your eligible compensation received in a specified 12-month lookback period prior to your enrollment in the Supplemental LTD program). There are no adjustments to the monthly Supplemental LTD benefit at the time of claim.

 Policyholders are provided with an individual policy document from MetLife that lists their benefit amount within the schedule of benefits section.

Duration of Benefits

For policies with the Age 67 maximum benefit period

Age when disability begins	Maximum Benefit Period
Before Age 63	To Age 67
At Age 63, before Age 64	48 months
At Age 64, before Age 65	42 months
At Age 65, before Age 66	36 months
At Age 66, before Age 67	30 months
At Age 67, before Age 75	24 months
At or after Age 75	12 months

For policies with the Age maximum 65 benefit period

Age when disability begins	Maximum Benefit Period
Before Age 61	To Age 65
At Age 61, before Age 62	48 months
At Age 62, before Age 63	42 months
At Age 63, before Age 64	36 months
At Age 64, before Age 65	30 months
At Age 65, before Age 75	24 months

At or after Age 75	12 months
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For policies with the 2-year maximum benefit period

Age when disability begins	Maximum Benefit Period
Before Age 75	24 month
At or after Age 75	12 months

The following states do not have the "To Age 67 Benefit Period" available:

- California
- Florida
- Maryland
- Ohio
- Vermont

Recurring Disabilities

A disability arising from the same or related cause either (1) within 12 months of a prior period of disability for which disability benefits had been paid, where the benefit period is to age 65 or longer, or (2) within 6 months of a prior period of disability for which disability benefits had been paid, where the benefit period is shorter than to age 65, will be considered a continuation of the prior period of disability. Your benefit period will not start anew, you will not be required to meet a new elimination period, and benefits will begin accruing (resuming) immediately.

You will not be eligible for this recurring disability benefit if you have been gainfully employed as follows for the duration of at least the 12 or 6 months (as noted above) following the end of the preceding period of disability:

- If you are a current Microsoft employee: The lesser of (i) 30 hours per week, or (ii) the number of hours per week that you were working immediately before your disability began, or
- If you are no longer a Microsoft employee: 30 hours per week.

Residual or Partial Disability Benefits

If you are not Totally Disabled, you may still be eligible for Residual or Partial Disability benefits (depending on the state of issue). Residual and Partial Disability benefits may pay a portion of your Total Disability benefit, after satisfaction of the elimination period, that is proportionate to your loss of earnings while you are residually or partially disabled, as described below.

Residual Disability Benefits (For policies issued in all states except California)

Residual Disability or Residually Disabled means that due solely to Impairment caused by Injury or Sickness:

1. Your Earnings are reduced by at least 20 percent of Your Prior Earnings; and
2. You are receiving appropriate care from a Physician who is appropriate to treat the condition causing the Impairment; and
3. You are not Totally Disabled, and are Gainfully Employed, but You are:
 - a. Prevented from performing one or more of the material and substantial duties of Your Regular Occupation; or
 - b. Performing the material and substantial duties of Your Regular Occupation, but are not able to perform them for more than 80 percent of the time normally required of You; or
 - c. Engaged in another occupation.

Partial Disability Benefits (For policies issued only in California) – Partial Disability

Partial disability means you are not Totally Disabled, but while actually working in an occupation, as a result of injury or sickness, you are unable to earn 80% or more of your pre-injury or sickness earnings.

Earnings means compensation, according to generally accepted accounting standards, for services you perform. It includes salary, fees, commissions, bonuses and other payment for services which you render — after deduction of normal and customary unreimbursed business expenses, but before deduction of any income taxes.

Earnings do not include:

1. Income from dividends, interest, rent, royalties, annuities, or investments;
2. Income from deferred compensation plans, formal sick pay benefits, disability income policies, or retirement plans; or
3. Any other forms of unearned income not derived from your job activities.

For example, if you have pre-disability earnings of \$300,000, become residually or partially disabled and are working part-time, and as a result your income decreases to \$150,000, you would have a 50% loss of earnings. If your total disability monthly benefit otherwise would have been \$10,000 per month, you would receive 50% of that amount as a residual or partial disability benefit, or \$5,000 per month.

Catastrophic Disability Benefits (For policies issued in all states except California, Hawaii, and Connecticut)

Catastrophic Disability benefits provide an additional monthly benefit, in excess of the monthly benefit for Total Disability, if your medical condition meets the criteria for a "catastrophic disability," defined as:

A complete, irrecoverable and irreparable loss of:

- Use of both hands, or both feet, or one hand and one foot; or
- The sight in both eyes; or
- Speech; or
- Hearing in both ears,

OR

Total Disability, along with Alzheimer's disease or other irreversible form of senility or dementia, Aphasia, Hemiparesis, Paraplegia or Quadriplegia.

The catastrophic benefit is 125% of your eligible compensation, less your existing Group LTD and Supplemental LTD benefits, up to a maximum catastrophic benefit of \$16,000 per month. The net catastrophic disability benefit amount for New Jersey residents cannot be larger than their Supplemental LTD benefit amount.



Policyholders are provided with an individual policy document from MetLife that lists their eligible benefit amounts within the schedule of benefits section.

Full Benefits for Mental Health Conditions and/or Substance Use Disorders

Your Supplemental LTD benefits will not be reduced merely because your Disability is due to a mental illness condition and/or substance use disorder. Those Supplemental LTD benefits will be covered on the same basis as any other Disability.

Disabilities Not Covered

General Exclusions¹

MetLife will not pay Supplemental LTD benefits for a Disability:

1. Due to an act of war, whether declared or undeclared;
2. Due to any loss MetLife has excluded by name or specific description;
3. Due to your committing, or attempting to commit, a felony;
4. Existing while you are legally incarcerated or detained; or
5. Caused by an intentionally self-inflicted Injury.

¹ Exclusions are subject to state variations. Please review your policy with MetLife for details.

Filing a Claim

Report your claim in three easy steps.

Filing a disability insurance claim can be confusing during an already difficult time. That's why MetLife created an easy-to-follow Supplemental LTD insurance claim process –we're here to help.

Step 1: Start your claim

Call MetLife at **1-855-234-1844**. Notice of a claim should be provided as soon as possible, even if the elimination (waiting) period stated in your policy has not been satisfied.

You may also initiate your claim by reaching out to MetLife through one of the following:

- Email: SupplementalLTD@metlife.com SupplLTDclaims@metlife.com
- Fax: 1-855-250-4539
- Mail: MetLife Disability Income Business Center P.O. Box 30372 Tampa, FL 33630-3372

Step 2: Speak with a MetLife claim specialist

A claims specialist from MetLife will contact you to obtain some basic information. You will be asked to provide the following:

- Your name, address and telephone number.
- MetLife policy number.
- Your occupation and name of your employer.
- Your claimed date of disability.
- Cause of disability/diagnosis.

Step 3: Complete a claim packet

After receiving notice of your claim, MetLife will send you a claim packet including the following forms for you to complete: Claimant's Statement, Description of Occupation/Activities, and an Authorization.

The completed claim packet must be sent to MetLife, in accordance with the instructions in the claim packet.

Please note: The claim packet also includes forms for your physician (Attending Physician's Statement) and employer (Employer's Statement) to complete.

When Coverage Ends

You can discontinue your Supplemental LTD benefit at any time by signing a cancellation form or calling 1-855-234-1844.

This benefit is portable. You can maintain your Supplemental LTD policy after leaving Microsoft by continuing to pay premiums directly to MetLife, subject to all applicable terms and conditions of the policy (including minimum working requirements if you have exceeded the policy's noncancelable and guaranteed renewable period described below).

The policy is noncancelable and guaranteed renewable to age 65 or 67, or 5 years if later, depending on the state of issue (age 65 for CA; age 65 or after 5 years (if later) for FL, LA, MD, MN, OH, VT; age 67 or after 5 years (if later) for all other states). Your policy can be conditionally renewed after the end of the noncancelable and guaranteed renewable period from the preceding sentence by paying the premiums on time as long as you are benefits eligible at Microsoft or working at least 30 hours per week if you are no longer working for Microsoft subject to certain restrictions.

See your policy for complete details.

Not all features are available in all states and variations may apply.

ERISA Summary Plan Description Information

Supplemental Long Term Disability Insurance Benefits Claims

Claim Submission

For claims for Supplemental LTD benefits, the claimant must complete the appropriate claim form and submit the required proof as described in the "Claims" Section of the policy.

Initial Determination

After you submit a claim for Supplemental LTD benefits to MetLife, MetLife will review your claim and notify you of its decision to approve or deny your claim.

Such notification will be provided to you within a reasonable period, not to exceed 45 days from the date you submitted your claim; except for situations requiring an extension of time because of matters beyond the control of the Plan, in which case MetLife may have up to two (2) additional extensions of 30 days each to provide you such notification. If MetLife needs an extension, it will notify you prior to the expiration of the initial 45 day period (or prior to the expiration of the first 30 day extension period if a second 30 day extension period is needed), state the reason why the extension is needed, and state when

it will make its determination. If an extension is needed because you did not provide sufficient information or filed an incomplete claim, the time from the date of MetLife's notice requesting further information and the extension until MetLife receives the requested information does not count toward the time period MetLife is allowed to notify you as to its claim decision. You will have 45 days to provide the requested information from the date you receive the extension notice, requesting further information, from MetLife.

If MetLife denies your claim in whole or in part, the notification of the claims decision will include a discussion of the decision, state the reason why your claim was denied and reference the specific Policy provision(s) on which the denial is based. The discussion will include the basis for disagreeing with or not following (i) the views of your treating providers, (ii) the views of medical or vocational experts whose advice was obtained on behalf of the plan in connection with your adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the benefit determination, and (iii) a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration, as applicable. If the claim is denied because MetLife did not receive sufficient information, the claims decision will describe the additional information needed and explain why such information is needed. Further, if an internal rule, protocol, guideline or other criterion was relied upon in making the denial, the claims decision will state the rule, protocol, guideline or other criteria or indicate that such rule, protocol, guideline or other criteria was relied upon and that you may request a copy thereof free of charge.

Any such claim denial, in whole or in part, will include a description of MetLife's appeals procedures and applicable time limits, including a statement of your right to bring a civil action under Section 502(a) of ERISA after exhausting your appeal rights. If the decision is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, the denial will include a statement that an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination will be provided free of charge upon request.

Please note that the definition of disability under the Supplemental LTD policy issued by MetLife and the Microsoft Group LTD coverage may differ. Approval of payment under one policy does not ensure payment under the other.

Appealing the Initial Determination

If MetLife denies your claim, you may appeal the decision. Upon your written request, MetLife will provide you free of charge with copies of documents, records and other information relevant to your claim. You must submit your appeal to MetLife at the address indicated on the claim form within 180 days of receiving MetLife's decision. Appeals must be in writing and must include at least the following information:

- Name of Insured
- Name of the Plan
- Reference to the initial decision
- An explanation why you are appealing the initial determination

As part of your appeal, you may submit any written comments, documents, records, or other information relating to your claim.

Section XI: Supplemental Long-term disability

After MetLife receives your written request appealing the initial determination, MetLife will conduct a full and fair review of your claim. Deference will not be given to the initial denial, and MetLife's review will look at the claim anew. The review on appeal will take into account all comments, documents, records, and other information that you submit relating to your claim without regard to whether such information was submitted or considered in the initial determination. The person who will review your appeal will not be the same person as the person who made the initial decision to deny your claim. In addition, the person who is reviewing the appeal will not be a subordinate of the person who made the initial decision to deny your claim. If the initial denial is based in whole or in part on a medical judgment, MetLife will consult with a health care professional with appropriate training and experience in the field of medicine involved in the medical judgment. This health care professional will not have consulted on the initial determination, and will not be a subordinate of any person who was consulted on the initial determination.

MetLife will notify you in writing of its final decision within a reasonable period of time, but no later than 45 days after MetLife's receipt of your written request for review, except that under special circumstances MetLife may have up to an additional 45 days to provide written notification of the final decision. If such an extension is required, MetLife will notify you prior to the expiration of the initial 45 day period, state the reason(s) why such an extension is needed, and state when it will make its determination. If an extension is needed because you did not provide sufficient information, the time period from MetLife's notice to you of the need for an extension to when MetLife receives the requested information does not count toward the time MetLife is allowed to notify you of its final decision. You will have 45 days to provide the requested information from the date you receive the notice from MetLife.

If MetLife denies the claim on appeal, MetLife will send you a final written decision that includes a discussion of the decision, states the reason(s) why the claim you appealed is being denied, and references any specific policies provision(s) on which the denial is based. The discussion will include the basis for disagreeing with or not following (i) the views of your treating providers, (ii) the views of medical or vocational experts whose advice was obtained on behalf of the plan in connection with your adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the benefit determination, and (iii) a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration, as applicable. If an internal rule, protocol, guideline or other criterion was relied upon in denying the claim on appeal, the final written decision will state the rule, protocol, guideline or other criteria or indicate that such rule, protocol, guideline or other criteria was relied upon and that you may request a copy free of charge. Upon written request, MetLife will provide you free of charge with copies of documents, records and other information relevant to your claim. . If the decision is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, the denial will include a statement that an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination will be provided free of charge upon request.

In addition, MetLife will provide you, free of charge and prior to any adverse benefit determination on appeal, with any new or additional evidence considered, relied upon, or generated in connection with the claim, and any new or additional rationale that will form the basis of MetLife's decision on appeal. Any such evidence or rationale will be provided as soon as possible and sufficiently in advance of the date the notice of the decision on appeal is provided, in order to give you a reasonable opportunity to respond prior to that date.

Exhaustion of Appeal Rights and Time Limit to File Suit

If your claim for benefits is denied, and the denial is upheld on appeal (in whole or in part), you may file suit in federal court to challenge that decision. However, no suit or other legal action may be initiated unless you have fully exhausted all of your claims and appeals rights described above, and any such suit or legal action may not be initiated more than one year after MetLife issues a final decision on appeal.

Section XII: Group legal

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Group legal section does not apply*

How the plan works

Group Legal from MetLife® offers assistance with many routine legal services for you, your spouse/domestic partner, and eligible dependents. The plan pays 100% of network attorneys' fees for most covered (and not excluded) services. Any interactions you have with your attorney are confidential. Microsoft will have access only to the enrollment information needed to administer your coverage.

If you select this optional coverage, you will pay the monthly premiums with after-tax dollars. The cost of coverage is available in the [Benefits Enrollment tool](#). Once you elect to participate, you may not cancel this coverage except during the annual [open enrollment](#) period.



If you have been enrolled in the plan for at least one year and you leave Microsoft, you may be eligible to purchase a separate plan through MetLife. For more information, visit the [Coverage if you leave Microsoft](#) section.



To review your Certificate of Insurance, find a network attorney, or get more information about the benefits under this plan, call MetLife at (855) 234-1844, [mailto:](#), or log onto the Microsoft Benefits site and visit the [MetLife Legal Plan](#).

Where you can get legal help

Group Legal covers services from any attorney. You can also get help by phone and online from MetLife. Although you can receive services from any attorney, you generally pay less when you use a MetLife network attorney.

- If you use a network attorney, the plan pays 100% of the attorney's fees for most covered (and not excluded) services. In addition, you can save money even if your legal situation is not fully covered and not excluded, as MetLife provides 15 hours of network attorney time and services for non-covered matters.
- If you use an out-of-network attorney for covered (and not excluded) services, the plan will reimburse you based on the allowed indemnity benefit amount provided in the [What the plan covers](#) section.



Remember, any interaction you have with your attorney through MetLife is confidential. Microsoft will have access only to basic enrollment information needed to administer your coverage.

Finding an attorney

To locate a network attorney in your area, members can:

- Log in to the Microsoft Benefits site and go to the [MetLife website](#)
- You will have access to a guided experience to see your coverages and find an attorney, as well as access to a digital estate planning solution to create wills, living wills and powers of attorney.
- Call the MetLife Legal Plan at 855-234-1844.:

- The Client Service Representative will verify your eligibility for services, make an initial determination of whether and to what extent your case is covered, and provide attorney referrals. You also have the option of working with the MetLife Attorney Scheduling team for assistance in setting up your initial consultation.

After you select a network attorney from the list, call the attorney's office and indicate you are a member of MetLife Group Legal. The attorney will:

- Explain your coverage and advise if there are any third-party costs, such as filing fees or court costs, associated with your legal matter.
- If your legal matter is not fully covered, and you have exhausted your 15 hours for non-covered services, the attorney must provide you with a fee agreement prior to providing any non-covered services.



You do not pay the attorney's fees or file a claim for covered (and not excluded) legal services with in-network attorneys. You will be responsible for out-of-pocket expenses such as filing fees, court costs, title work, and photocopies.

If you use an out-of-network attorney, you will need to file a claim for indemnity reimbursement. See the [How to file a claim](#) section for more information.

Additional Benefits

Caregiving

Your MetLife Legal Plan benefit includes unlimited access to Family First, a robust caregiving solution, at no additional cost. With Family First, you get digital tools and a confidential, multi-disciplinary team of highly trained experts who will examine your unique caregiving situations, create holistic care plans and provide the resources and guidance needed to make care-related decisions, delivering better outcomes for all.

This benefit covers a wide range of caregiving challenges, including but not limited to:

- Eldercare
- Child and adolescent wellbeing
- Cognitive issues and dementia
- Aging in place
- Homecare and placement
- Crisis intervention
- Mental health and emotional support
- Substance abuse and addiction
- New and chronic diagnosis
- Financial challenges, such as bill pay
- Insurance and Medicare navigation
- Powers of Attorney & wills

Identity and Fraud Protection

MetLife offers comprehensive and proactive identity theft, financial fraud and online protection through Aura. Aura is an all-in-one digital safety solution that helps keep employees' assets, identity, family, and tech safe from online threats.

Your plan provides you with assistance online and over the phone with the following services:

- Financial Fraud Protection (including credit monitoring)
- Identity Theft Protection
- Privacy and Device Protection
- Family Safety
- And more.

Your plan covers up to 10 adults no matter their relationship, age, or whether they live at the same address. Each enrolled adult gets their own private, full-feature Aura account and their own \$5M insurance policy.

Parents and legal guardians can add unlimited children under 18 years old.

Tax Preparation and Filing

MetLife has partnered with TurboTax to offer tax preparation and filing services.

This offering includes preparing and filing one individual or joint federal and state tax return with any TurboTax "Do It Yourself" online product at no additional cost.

- TurboTax Deluxe
- TurboTax Premier
- TurboTax Self-Employed

Additionally, you can:

- Get advice from a TurboTax expert or have a dedicated TurboTax Professional prepare and file taxes on your behalf at a discount.
 - Enjoy easy access to various tax resources such as a tax refund estimator, tax bracket calculator, planning checklist, and tax tips.
- Access your Tax Preparation benefit via your online account at members.legalplans.com.

Plus Parents

With your Plus Parents plan, in addition to the legal help you receive, your parents, parents-in-law, and grandparents have access to legal help for the issues they face, from estate planning to elder care matters and identity theft issues. The Plus Parents plan allows up to eight additional people to have coverage.

The full list of coverages can be found in the [What the plan covers covers section](#).

Online resources

To help you better manage today's common legal and financial matters, visit the MetLife Legal member site where you have access to a variety of tools and resources, including:

Law Firm E-Panel®

MetLife Legal Plan has lawyers available to answer your questions by email. You can access this benefit through the MetLife Legal Plan website. You can submit a question directly through the site and receive a response from a network Attorney the next business day.

Self Help Documents

The self-help document library is available through the MetLife Legal Plan website. Once logged in, click on the menu options under your name on the right side and choose "Self-help documents." The self-help library, offered by Standard Legal, provides you with some of the most commonly used legal documents to deal with legal issues quickly and easily. In the library, you'll find over 1,700 documents including:

- living wills
- powers of attorney
- deeds and promissory notes
- premarital agreements and more

What the plan covers

Family law

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Adoption and Legitimization		
This service covers all legal services and court work in a state or federal court for an adoption for the plan member and spouse. Legitimization of a child for the plan member and spouse, including reformation of a birth certificate, is also covered.		
Uncontested	Fully Covered	\$1,300
Contested	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Divorce, Dissolution and Annulment		
This service is available to the Plan Member only, not to a spouse or dependents. This service includes preparing and filing all necessary pleadings, motions and affidavits, drafting		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
settlement or separation agreements, and representation at the hearing or trial, whether the Plan Member is a plaintiff or a defendant. This service does not include disputes that arise after a decree is issued.		
Uncontested	Fully Covered	\$1,800
Contested	Fully Covered	\$4,400
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Change or Establishment of Custody Order		
This service is available to the Participant and spouse, and covers preparation of petitions, consent forms and waivers, and representation at any court hearings to modify or enforce a child custody order.		
Uncontested	Fully Covered	\$1,300
Contested	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Enforcement or Modification of Support Order		
This service is available to the Plan Member and spouse, and covers representation after a judgment has been entered to enforce or modify a court's award of support or alimony, whether the Plan Member or spouse is a plaintiff or a defendant. This service does not cover transfer of a divorce decree from one state to another, the division of property, or collection activities after a judgment.	Fully Covered	\$1,500
Family First - Caregiving		
Family First provides personalized solutions to solve the most urgent caregiving challenges. Backed by AI-powered Expert Caregiving Platform (ECP), Family First combines 30 years of hands-on experience, a multi-disciplinary team of experts and an artificial intelligence engine that analyzes data from millions of people to ensure members and their loved ones have the caregiving solutions they need. Their comprehensive approach addresses physical and mental health, family dynamics, financial challenges, and clinical and home care needs, and offers guidance around difficult decision-making – all of which help to deliver a unique, personalized experience and better outcomes for families. This benefit provides the Participant and their family a highly-trained Care Team, provided by Family First, to	Fully Covered	

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
navigate caregiving challenges. Family First is not a corporate affiliate of MetLife Legal Plans.		
Guardianship/Conservatorship		
This service covers establishing a guardianship or conservatorship over a person and their estate when the plan member or spouse is being appointed as guardian or conservator. It includes obtaining a permanent and/or temporary guardianship or conservatorship, gathering any necessary medical evidence, preparing the paperwork, attending the hearing and preparing the initial accounting. This service does not include representation of the person over whom guardianship or conservatorship is sought, any annual accountings after the initial accounting, or terminating the guardianship or conservatorship once it has been established.		
Uncontested	Fully Covered	\$1,300
Contested	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Inheritance Rights		
This coverage provides legal services for a Plan Member and Spouse claiming the right to inherit from or assert a claim against a deceased person's estate including the filing of a claim in court.	Fully Covered	TBD
Name Change		
This service covers the participant for all necessary pleadings and court hearings for a legal name change.	Fully Covered	\$800
Personal Safety Orders		
This service provides a Participant with legal advice and representation to obtain a personal safety order against a third party, including: preparing the paperwork, and attending all court appearances. This service does not include representation when the Plan Member is the offender.	Fully Covered	\$850
Postnuptial Agreement		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
This service provides for the negotiation, preparation, review and execution of an agreement by a Plan Member's parents and their former partner/spouse during or after marriage or legal union (where allowed by law), outlining how property is to be divided. Representation is provided only to the Plan Member. The other party must have separate counsel or waive representation. It does not include subsequent litigation arising out of a postnuptial agreement.	Fully Covered	\$1,500
Prenuptial Agreement		
This service covers representation of the participant and includes the negotiation, preparation, review and execution of a prenuptial agreement between the participant and their fiancé/partner prior to their marriage or legal union (where allowed by law). It does not include subsequent litigation arising out of a prenuptial agreement. The fiancé/partner must either have separate counsel or waive his/her right to representation.	Fully Covered	\$1,500
Protection from Domestic Violence		
This service covers the participant only, not the spouse or dependents, as the victim of domestic violence. It provides the participant with representation to obtain a protective order, including all required paperwork and attendance at all court appearances. The service does not include representation in suits for damages, defense of any action or representation for the offender.	Fully Covered	\$850
Reproductive Assistance Law		
This service covers the Participating Employee and/or spouse for the legal services and court work related to reproductive assistance matters. Reproductive assistance matters may include, but shall not be limited to, as permitted by law, surrogacy, egg donation, sperm donation, gamete donation, embryo donation and embryo adoption. This service includes reviewing and preparing any necessary agreements or documents, the preparation and filing of any pleadings or other documentation to obtain any necessary orders or decrees, and representation at any hearing or other proceeding related to the matter as may be required by law. This service does not include representation of any party other than the Participating Employee and/or spouse, even if the Participating Employee	Fully Covered	\$8,000

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
and/or spouse may be required to pay that party's legal fees or expenses.		

Financial Matters

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Debt Collection Defense		
This benefit provides participants with an attorney's services for negotiation with creditors for a repayment schedule and to limit creditor harassment, and representation in defense of any action for personal debt collection, tax agency debt collection, foreclosure, repossession or garnishment, up to and including trial if necessary. It includes a motion to vacate a default judgment. It does not include counter, cross or third party claims, bankruptcy, any action arising out of family law matters including support and post decree issues or any matter where the creditor is affiliated with the sponsor or employer.		
Debt Collection Defense (Consumer Debts)		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$700
Negotiation and Settlement after Complaint and Answer Filed	Fully Covered	\$1,200
Trial	Fully Covered	\$2,100
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Debt Collection Defense (Foreclosures)		
Negotiation	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Complaint and Answer Filed, Settlement Negotiations	Fully Covered	\$1,700
Trial	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service		\$100,000
Identity & Fraud Protection		
This service provides the Participant and their enrolled family members with access to Identity Restoration Services, plus Aura's award-winning all-in-one solution that helps proactively prevent fraud before it happens. Participants can proactively protect their identity, assets, privacy, finances, family and connected devices with simple, easy-to-use digital security features accessible across their devices. Participants get alerted at the first signs of fraud so they can act quickly before extensive damage is done. Plus, each enrolled adult is backed	Fully Covered	

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
by a \$5M insurance policy* to reimburse them for covered losses and expenses resulting from an identity theft incident.		
Identity Restoration		
This service provides the Participant and their enrolled family members with access to Identity Restoration Services, plus Aura's award-winning all-in-one solution that helps proactively prevent fraud before it happens. Participants can proactively protect their identity, assets, privacy, finances, family and connected devices with simple, easy-to-use digital security features accessible across their devices. Participants get alerted at the first signs of fraud so they can act quickly before extensive damage is done. Plus, each enrolled adult is backed by a \$5M insurance policy* to reimburse them for covered losses and expenses resulting from an identity theft incident	Fully Covered	
Identity Theft Defense		
This service provides the participant with consultations with an attorney regarding potential creditor actions resulting from identity theft and attorney services as needed to contact creditors, credit bureaus and financial institutions. It also provides defense services for specific creditor actions over disputed accounts. The defense services include limiting creditor harassment and representation in defense of any action that arises out of the identity theft such as foreclosure, repossession or garnishment, up to and including trial if necessary. The service also provides the participant with online help and information about identity theft and prevention. It does not include counter, cross or third party claims, bankruptcy, any action arising out of family law matters, including support and post-decree matters or any matter where the creditor is affiliated with the sponsor or employer.	Fully Covered	\$500
Personal Bankruptcy or Wage Earner Plan:		
This service covers the participant and spouse in pre-bankruptcy planning, the preparation and filing of a personal bankruptcy or Wage Earner petition, and representation at all court hearings and trials. This service is not available if a creditor is affiliated with the sponsor or employer, even if the participant or spouse chooses to reaffirm that specific debt.		
Chapter 7 Individual or Member/Spouse	Fully Covered	\$1,700
Chapter 13 Individual or Member/Spouse	Fully Covered	\$2,800
Tax Audit Representation		
This service covers reviewing tax returns and answering questions the IRS or a state or local taxing authority has		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
concerning the participant's tax return, negotiating with the agency advising the participant on necessary documentation, and attending an IRS or a state or local taxing authority audit. The service does not include prosecuting a claim for the return of overpaid taxes or the preparation of any tax returns.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Audit Hearing	Fully Covered	\$2,400
Tax Preparation and Filing		
This service provides the Plan Member with access to one free individual or joint self-guided online federal and state tax preparation and filing per year. If the Member prefers to prepare and file their taxes with a professional from our service provider, the legal plan will provide a discount in the amount of the appropriate online product value.		

Estate planning documents

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Living Wills		
This service covers the preparation of a living will for the participant.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$150
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$160
Powers of Attorney		
This service covers the preparation of any power of attorney when the participant is granting the power.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$130
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$150
Wills and Codicils		
This service covers the preparation of a simple or complex will for the participant. The creation of any testamentary trust is covered. The benefit includes the preparation of codicils and will amendments. It does not include tax planning.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$300
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$400
Trusts		

This service covers the preparation of revocable and irrevocable living trusts for the participant. It does not include tax planning or services associated with funding the trust after it is created.

Individual	Fully Covered	\$650
Individual	Fully Covered	\$900

Immigration

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Immigration Assistance		
This service covers advice and consultation, preparation of affidavits and powers of attorney, review of any immigration documents and helping the participant prepare for hearings.	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Immigration Representation		
This service covers advice and consultation, preparation of affidavits and powers of attorney, review of any immigration documents, attendance at hearings, and helping the Participant prepare for hearings.	Fully Covered	\$1,000

Consumer Protection Matters

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Consumer Protection Matters		
This service covers the participant as the plaintiff for representation, including trial, in disputes over consumer goods and services where the amount being contested exceeds the small claims court limit in that jurisdiction and is documented in writing. The service does not include disputes over real estate, construction, insurance or collection activities after a judgment		
Correspondence and Negotiation	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Filing of Suit, Ending in Settlement or Judgment	Fully Covered	\$4,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Personal Property Protection		
This service covers counseling the Participant over the phone or in the office on any personal property issue such as consumer credit reports, contracts for the purchase of personal property, consumer credit agreements or installment sales agreements. Counseling on pursuing or defending small claims actions is also included. The service also includes reviewing any personal	Fully Covered	\$250

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
legal documents and preparing promissory notes, affidavits and demand letters.		
Small Claims Assistance		
This service covers counseling the Participant on prosecuting a small claims action; helping the Participant prepare documents; advising the Participant on evidence, documentation and witnesses; and preparing the Participant for trial. The service does not include the Plan Attorney's attendance or representation at the small claims trial, collection activities after a judgment or any services relating to post-judgment actions.	Fully Covered	\$400

Insurance Matters

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Insurance Claims		
This service provides the Participant with assistance in making insurance claims with the Participant's own carrier, provided the carrier is not affiliated with the Plan Member's Sponsor or Employer. Litigation of coverage issues is included. Litigation of damages is not included.	Fully Covered	\$600

Social Security Disability

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Social Security Disability		
This service covers representation for a Plan Member or spouse through the administrative process including preparing initial forms, requests for reconsideration, hearing requests, attendance at hearings and review of decision order.		
Preparation and Attendance at One Hearing	Fully Covered	\$1,100
Filing for Reconsideration and Attendance at Hearing	Fully Covered	\$1,800

Juvenile Court Defense

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Juvenile Court Defense		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
This service covers the defense of a Participant and a Participant's dependent child in any juvenile court matter, provided there is no conflict of interest between the Participant and the dependent child. When a conflict exists, or where the court requires separate counsel for the child, this service provides an attorney for the Plan Member only, including services for Parental Responsibility.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$2,400
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000

Probate

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Probate Proceedings		
This service provides representation for the Plan Member and spouse when the Plan Member or spouse is probating an estate and has been appointed executor or administrator. The service includes all of the court proceedings to transfer probate assets from the decedent to the heirs; the correspondence necessary to transfer non-probate assets such as proceeds from insurance policies, joint bank accounts, stock accounts or a house; and any tax filings. This service does not include prosecuting or defending any litigation including a will contest.		
Affidavit/Simple Procedure/Tax Only	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Standard Probate/Court Supervised Probate	Fully Covered	\$3,000

Personal Injury

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Personal Injury (25% Network Maximum)		
Subject to applicable law and court rules, plan attorneys will handle personal injury matters (where the participant is the plaintiff) at a maximum fee of 25% of the gross award. It is the participant's responsibility to pay this fee and all costs.		

Defense of Civil Lawsuits

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Administrative Hearing Representation		
This service covers Participants in defense of civil proceedings before a municipal, county, state or federal administrative board, agency or commission. It includes the hearing before an administrative board or agency over an adverse governmental action. It does not apply where services are available or are being provided by virtue of an insurance policy. It does not include family law matters, post judgment matters or litigation of a job-related incident.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Contested Hearings Ending in Settlement or Judgment	Fully Covered	\$3,600
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Civil Litigation Defense		
This service covers the Participant in defense of an arbitration proceeding or civil proceeding before a municipal, county, state or federal administrative board, agency or commission, or in a trial court of general jurisdiction. It does not apply where services are available or are being provided by virtue of an insurance policy. It does not include family law matters, post judgment matters, matters with criminal penalties or litigation of a job-related incident. Services do not include bringing counterclaims, third party or cross claims.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,300
Filing Answer, Litigation Ending in Settlement or Judgment	Fully Covered	\$4,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Incompetency Defense		
This service covers the Participant in the defense of any incompetency action, including court hearings when there is a proceeding to find the Participant incompetent.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$3,600
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000

Real Estate Matters

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Boundary or Title Disputes		
This service covers negotiations and litigation arising from boundary or real property title disputes involving a Participant's residence, where coverage is not available under the Participant's homeowner or title insurance policies. The service includes filing to remove a mechanic's lien.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Boundary or Title Disputes (including residential property)		
This service covers negotiations and litigation arising from boundary or real property title disputes involving a Participant's residential rental property, where coverage is not available under the Participant's homeowner or title insurance policies. The service includes filing to remove a mechanic's lien.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$3,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Disputes and Tenant Problems (Landlord Only)		
This service covers the Participant as a landlord for matters involving leases, security deposits and disputes with a residential tenant. The service includes attorney services for the eviction of a tenant up to and including trial.		
Correspondence and Negotiations	Fully Covered	\$560
Eviction Trial	Fully Covered	\$1,680
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Eviction and Tenant Problems (Tenant Only)		
This service assists the Participant as a tenant with matters involving leases, security deposits or other disputes with a residential landlord. The benefit also covers trial, if necessary.		
Correspondence and Negotiations	Fully Covered	\$560
Eviction	Fully Covered	\$1,680

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Home Equity Loan		
This service covers the review or preparation of a home equity loan on the Participant's residence.	Fully Covered	\$700
Property Tax Assessments		
This service covers the Participant for review and advice on a property tax assessment on the Participant's residence. It also includes filing the paperwork; gathering the evidence; negotiating a settlement; and attending the hearing necessary to seek a reduction of the assessment.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$540
File Request for Hearing with Attendance at Hearing	Fully Covered	\$1,240
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Refinancing of Residence		
This service provides the Covered Person with counsel in the refinancing of or obtaining a home equity loan on the Covered Person's primary or secondary residence. It includes the review or preparation of all relevant documents, including the mortgage, deed, and documents pertaining to title, insurance, recordation and taxation. It does not include: services provided by an attorney representing a lending institution or title company; the sale or purchase of a home; or the refinancing of or obtaining a home equity loan on: rental property; or property held for business or investment.	Fully Covered	\$700
Sale or Purchase of Residence		
This service covers the review or preparation, by an attorney representing the Participant, of all relevant documents (including the construction documents for a new home, the purchase agreement, mortgage and deed, and documents pertaining to title, insurance, recordation and taxation), which are involved in the purchase or sale of a Participant's residence or of a vacant property to be used for building a residence. The benefit also includes attendance of an attorney at closing. It does not include services provided by any attorney representing a lending institution or title company. The benefit does not include the sale or purchase of a rental property, property held for business or investment or leases with an option to buy.	Fully Covered	\$1,000

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Sale or Purchase of Rental Property		
This service covers the review or preparation, by an attorney representing the Plan Member and their Spouse, of all relevant documents (including the construction documents for a new home, the purchase agreement, mortgage and deed, and documents pertaining to title, insurance, recordation and taxation), which are involved in the purchase or sale of a Plan Member or Spouse's residential rental property or of a vacant property to be used for building a rental property. The benefit also includes attendance of an attorney at closing. It does not include services provided by any attorney representing a lending institution or title company. The benefit does not include the sale or purchase of a second home, vacation property, or commercial or investment property or leases with an option to buy. This benefit is limited to a lifetime maximum of 4 residential properties.	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Security Deposit Assistance (Tenant only)		
This service covers counseling the Participant as a tenant in recovering a security deposit from the Participant's residential landlord; reviewing the lease and other relevant documents; and preparing a demand letter to the landlord for the return of the deposit. It also covers assisting the Participant in prosecuting a small claims action; helping prepare documents; advising on evidence, documentation and witnesses; and preparing the Participant for the small claims trial. This service does not include the Plan Attorney's attendance or representation at the small claims trial, collection activities after a judgment or any services relating to post-judgment actions.		
Demand Letter/Negotiations	Fully Covered	\$500
Counseling on Preparing Small Claims Complaint and Trial Preparation	Fully Covered	\$300
Zoning Applications		
This service provides the Participant with the services of a lawyer to help get a zoning change or variance for the Participant's residence. Services include reviewing the law, reviewing the surveys, advising the Participant, preparing applications, and preparing for and attending the hearing to change zoning.		
Preparation of Documentation	Fully Covered	\$500
Documentation/Attending Hearing	Fully Covered	\$1,000

Traffic & Other Matters

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Driving Under the Influence Defense		
This service covers representation of the Participant in defense of any driving under the influence or driving while intoxicated charge, including court hearings, negotiation with the prosecutor and trial. It does not cover vehicular homicide. This service does not include any post-sentencing proceeding, probation violation hearing or appeals by either party.		
Negotiated Plea	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$2,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Expungement		
Where permitted by law, this service covers the filing of a petition and appearance at any necessary hearing to expunge convictions from a Participant's criminal record.	Fully Covered	\$700
Felony Defense		
This service covers representation for Participants in defense of any criminal felony charge. Representation includes court hearings, negotiation with the prosecutor and trial. This service does not cover any post-sentencing proceeding, probation violation hearing or appeals by either party.		
Negotiated Plea	Fully Covered	\$1,300
Trial	Fully Covered	\$3,500
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Habeas Corpus		
This service covers the Participant for the preparation of all paperwork needed, and attendance at the hearing to pursue a habeas corpus proceeding to obtain the release of a Participant who is being unlawfully imprisoned.	Fully Covered	\$840
Misdemeanor Defense		
This service covers representation for Participants in defense of any criminal misdemeanor charge except those relating to traffic or driving under influence charges. Representation includes court hearings, negotiation with the prosecutor and trial. It does not include representation of a felony charge that is subsequently reduced to a misdemeanor. This service also		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
does not cover any post-sentencing proceeding, probation violation hearing or appeals by either party.		
Negotiation and Settlement	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Trial	Fully Covered	\$2,500
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000
Restoration of Driving Privileges		
This service covers the participant with representation in proceedings to restore the participant's driving license.	Fully Covered	\$770
Traffic Ticket Defense (No DUI)		
This service covers representation of the participant in defense of any traffic ticket including traffic misdemeanor offenses, except driving under the influence or vehicular homicide, including court hearings, negotiation with the prosecutor and trial.		
Plea or Trial at Court for Minor Moving Violations	Fully Covered	\$500
Plea or Trial at Court for Serious Moving Violations Resulting in Jail Time or License Suspension	Fully Covered	\$1,000
Plus Trial Supplement for Out-of-Network Service*		\$100,000

Document Preparation and Review

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Affidavits		
This service covers preparation of any affidavit in which the Participant is the person making the statement.	Fully Covered	\$150
Deeds		
This service covers the preparation of any deed for which the Participant is either the grantor or grantee.	Fully Covered	\$200
Demand Letters		
This service covers the preparation of letters that demand money, property or some other property interest of the Participant, except an interest that is an excluded service. It also covers mailing them to the addressee and forwarding and explaining any response to the Participant. Negotiations and representation in litigation are not included.	Fully Covered	\$150

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Document Review		
This service covers the review of any personal legal document of the participant, such as letters, leases or purchase agreements.	Fully Covered	\$200
Elder Law Matters		
This service covers counseling the participant over the phone or in the office on any personal issues relating to the participant's parents as they affect the participant. The service includes reviewing documents of the parents to advise the participant on the effect on the participant. The documents include Medicare or Medicaid materials, prescription plans, leases, nursing home agreements, powers of attorney, living wills and wills. The service also includes preparing deeds involving the parents when the participant is either the grantor or grantee, and preparing promissory notes involving the parents when the participant is the payor or payee.	Fully Covered	\$280
Mortgages		
This service covers the preparation of any mortgage or deed of trust for which the participant is the mortgagor.	Fully Covered	\$140
Promissory Notes		
This service covers the preparation of any promissory note for which the participant is the payor or payee.	Fully Covered	\$140
Rental Property Leases		
This service covers the Participant as a residential landlord for matters involving leases. The service includes the preparation or review of a lease for a Participant's residential rental property. Coverage is not provided for commercial rental properties or properties not in the name of the Participant.	Fully Covered	\$150

Advice and Consultation

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Office Consultation and Telephone Advice		
This service provides the opportunity to discuss with an attorney any personal legal problems that are not specifically excluded. The Plan Attorney will explain the Participant's rights, point out their options and recommend a course of action. The Plan Attorney will identify any further coverage available under the Plan and will undertake representation if the Participant so	Fully Covered	\$140

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
requests. If representation is covered by the Plan, the Participant will not be charged for the Plan Attorney's services. If representation is recommended, but is not covered by the Plan, the Plan Attorney will provide a written fee statement in advance. The Participant may choose whether to retain the Plan Attorney at their own expense, seek outside counsel, or do nothing. There are no restrictions on the number of times per year a Participant may use this service; however, for a non-covered matter, this service is not intended to provide the Participant with continuing access to a Plan Attorney in order to seek advice that would allow the Participant to undertake their own representation.		
Supplemental Coverage - 15 Hours Maximum		
For non-covered matters that are not otherwise excluded, this benefit provides fifteen hours of attorney time and services per year. The Participant is responsible to pay fees beyond the 15 hours. No more than a combined maximum total of fifteen hours of attorney time and service are provided for the member, spouse, and qualified dependents annually.	Fully Covered	\$100 per hour to max of \$1,500

Plus Parents

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Office Consultation and Telephone Advice		
This service provides the opportunity to discuss with an attorney any personal legal problems that are not specifically excluded. The Plan Attorney will explain the Participant's rights, point out their options and recommend a course of action. The Plan Attorney will identify any further coverage available under the Plan, and will undertake representation if the Participant so requests. If representation is covered by the Plan, the Participant will not be charged for the Plan Attorney's services. If representation is recommended, but is not covered by the Plan, the Plan Attorney will provide a written fee statement in advance. The Participant may choose whether to retain the Plan Attorney at their own expense, seek outside counsel, or do nothing. There are no restrictions on the number of times per year a Participant may use this service; however, for a non-covered matter, this service is not intended to provide the Participant with continuing access to a Plan Attorney in order to seek advice that would allow the Participant to undertake their own representation.	Fully Covered	\$140

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
Document Review		
This service covers the review of any personal legal document of the Participant Plus Parents, such as letters, leases or purchase agreements.	Fully Covered	\$200
Deeds		
This service covers the preparation of any deed for which the Participant is either the grantor or grantee.	Fully Covered	\$200
Mortgages		
This service covers the preparation of any mortgage or deed of trust for which the Participant is the mortgagor. This service does not include documents pertaining to business, commercial or rental property.	Fully Covered	\$140
Promissory Notes		
This service covers the preparation of any promissory note for which the Participant is the payor or payee.	Fully Covered	\$140
Affidavits		
This service covers preparation of any affidavit in which the Participant is the person making the statement.	Fully Covered	\$150
Demand Letters		
This service covers the preparation of letters that demand money, property or some other property interest of the Participant, except an interest that is an excluded service. It also covers mailing them to the addressee and forwarding and explaining any response to the Participant. Negotiations and representation in litigation are not included	Fully Covered	\$150
Identity Restoration		
This service provides the Participant and their enrolled family members with access to full-service Identity Restoration support provided by Aura's U.S.-based White Glove Fraud Resolution Specialists. Fraud experts will work with Participants to navigate bureaus and financial institutions, make phone calls, and complete forms to quickly quickly restore your identity and secure your assets and information. Aura's experienced agents will take care of the heavy lifting, saving the Participant countless hours of their precious time.	Fully Covered	
Living Wills		

Category definition	Network Attorney	Non-Network Attorney
This service covers the preparation of a living will for the participant.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$150
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$160
Powers of Attorney		
This service covers the preparation of any power of attorney when the participant is granting the power.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$130
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$150
Trusts		
This service covers the preparation of revocable and irrevocable living trusts for the participant. It does not include tax planning or services associated with funding the trust after it is created.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$650
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$900
Wills and Codicils		
This service covers the preparation of a simple or complex will for the participant. The creation of any testamentary trust is covered. The benefit includes the preparation of codicils and will amendments. It does not include tax planning.		
Individual	Fully Covered	\$300
Member and Spouse	Fully Covered	\$400

* Trial Supplement — In addition to fees indicated, we will pay the attorney's fees for representation in trial, beyond the third day of trial, up to a maximum of \$800 per day, subject to a total trial supplement maximum of \$100,000.

Exclusions and limitations

Excluded services are those legal services that are not provided under the Plan. No services, not even a consultation, can be provided for the following matters:

- Employment-related matters, including company or statutory benefits
- Matters involving the employer, MetLife® and affiliates, and Plan Attorneys

- Matters in which there is a conflict of interest between the employee and spouse/domestic partner or dependents or Parent in which case services are excluded for the spouse/domestic partner, dependents, and/or Parent (as applicable)
- Appeals and class actions
- Farm, business, or investment matters, matters involving property held for investment or rental, or issues when the Participant or Parent is the landlord
- Patent, trademark and copyright matters
- Costs or fines
- Frivolous or unethical matters
- Matters for which an attorney-client relationship exists prior to the Participant or Parent becoming eligible for Plan benefits

Waiver of premium

Upon the death of the named insured, coverage for the surviving spouse or domestic partner and the insured dependents continues under the policy for one year, and MetLife waives further premium payments during this time. Coverage terminates prior to the end of that one-year period if the policyholder cancels the policy during that time frame, and in such case, coverage shall cease as of the date the policyholder cancels the policy.

Deployment Waiver of premium

Should a named insured be deployed for a period of more than 30 consecutive days for the purposes of military service or of responding to a declared national emergency, coverage for the spouse and the insured dependents will continue, with the payment of premium waived for the length of the named insured's absence and for so long as the named insured remains eligible for benefits through the policyholder.

Reduced contingency fees

This service provides you access to a network attorney for a legal matter the network attorney deems to be appropriately handled through the use of a contingency fee. The network attorney will represent you under a contingent fee arrangement where the contingent fee will not exceed 25% of the net recovery. The initial consultation for each legal matter will be provided at no cost. If you retained the services of a network attorney prior to the effective date of your group legal membership, the reduced fee benefit is not available.



For a complete list of covered services and exclusions and limitations, call MetLife at (855) 234-1844.

How to file a claim

Benefits provided by in-network attorneys will be paid directly by MetLife on your behalf and you do not need to submit a claim.

If you use an out-of-network attorney, follow these steps to file an indemnity claim and be reimbursed, up to the allowed benefit amount, for covered benefits from the plan:

- Contact the MetLife Legal Client Service Center at 855-234-1844
- Request an out of network reimbursement packet
- To receive reimbursement, complete, sign and return the reimbursement form, along with the attorney's itemized fee statement.

If you want the reimbursement paid to you (and not the attorney), you must also provide proof of your payment to the attorney. Acceptable proof of payment includes one of the following:

- Cancelled check
- Credit card receipt
- Receipt or letter from the attorney
- Attorney's bill marked "paid"
- HUD statement from a real estate transaction, or a bankruptcy trustee report with attorney's fees listed

If you want the attorney paid directly, you do not need to include proof of payment. However, you must authorize payment to the attorney on page 2 of the reimbursement form and include the law firm's federal tax ID number (EIN) or the attorney's social security number (SSN).

The plan will reimburse you according to the indemnity fee schedule provided in the [What the plan covers](#) section.

If MetLife denies a claim, the plan member/attorney has an opportunity to provide additional information to support why they feel a denied claim should be covered. The plan member/attorney has 60 days in which to send in an appeal and additional supporting documentation.

If benefits are denied on appeal, the determination will include the reasons for the denial with reference to the specific Plan provisions on which the denial is based and a description of any additional information that might cause MetLife Legal Plans to reconsider the decision, an explanation of the review procedure and notice of the right to bring a civil action under Section 502(a) of ERISA. You may not bring a lawsuit against the Plan, MetLife Legal Plans or the Plan sponsor until you have exhausted the Plan's internal review process. Any lawsuit must be filed in court within 12 months of the date of any final eligibility or benefits denial notice you receive, or else it will be permanently waived and barred.



Submit your written request for review to:

MetLife Legal Plans, Inc.
Director of Administration
1111 Superior Ave E
Cleveland, OH 44114

Section XIII: Group legal survivor support

What is in this section

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Group legal survivor support section does not apply*

How the plan works

This customized legal program administered by MetLife provides assistance when an employee or dependent is faced with end-of-life decisions or immediately following the death of an employee or dependent. Eligibility includes employees, their spouses/domestic partners, or dependents, in addition to non-Plan participants who are acting as the official executor of the estate of an employee, spouse/domestic partner, or dependent who is covered under this Plan (the "Eligibles").

MetLife network attorneys are available to provide services to Eligibles. The fees for MetLife network attorneys are fully paid and unless otherwise stated, the Eligible will be responsible for payment of associated costs, such as filing fees, court costs or postage.

If an Eligible chooses not to use a network attorney for the stated benefits, the Eligible may be eligible for an indemnity benefit as shown in the schedule below.

Eligibles are able to use the following services for a one-year time period from the date that Microsoft indicates member eligibility in the Microsoft Survivor Support Legal Program. A dedicated MetLife team member is available to provide assistance to Eligibles.

What the plan covers

Legal issue	Available service	Network attorney	Indemnity benefit
Wills and Codicils	This service covers the preparation of a simple or complex will for the participant. The creation of any testamentary trust is covered. The benefit includes the preparation of codicils and will amendments. It does not include tax planning.	Fully Covered	\$300 Individual \$400 Member and Spouse
Living Wills	This service covers the preparation of a living will for the participant.	Fully Covered	\$150 Individual \$160 Member and Spouse
Powers of Attorney	This service covers the preparation of any power of attorney when the participant is granting the power.	Fully Covered	\$130 Individual \$150 Member and Spouse
Sale or Purchase of Residence	This service covers the review or preparation, by an attorney representing the Participant, of all relevant documents (including the construction documents for a new home, the purchase agreement, mortgage and deed, and documents	Fully Covered	\$1,000

Section XIII: Group Legal survivor support

Legal issue	Available service	Network attorney	Indemnity benefit
	pertaining to title, insurance, recordation and taxation), which are involved in the purchase or sale of a Participant's residence or of a vacant property to be used for building a residence. The benefit also includes attendance of an attorney at closing. It does not include services provided by any attorney representing a lending institution or title company. The benefit does not include the sale or purchase of a rental property, property held for business or investment or leases with an option to buy.		
Probate Proceedings	This service provides representation for the Plan Member and spouse when the Plan Member or spouse is probating an estate and has been appointed executor or administrator. The service includes all of the court proceedings to transfer probate assets from the decedent to the heirs; the correspondence necessary to transfer non-probate assets such as proceeds from insurance policies, joint bank accounts, stock accounts or a house; and any tax filings. This service does not include prosecuting or defending any litigation including a will contest.	Fully Covered	\$1,000 Affidavit/Simple Procedure/Tax Only \$3,000 Standard Probate/Court Supervised Probate
General in-office services	General in-office legal services from an attorney for any legal issue that is not otherwise covered or excluded under this plan. Limited to 10 hours per year.	10 hours	\$100 per hour to max of \$1,000
Office Consultation and Telephone Advice	This service provides the opportunity to discuss with an attorney any personal legal problems that are not specifically excluded. The Plan Attorney will explain the Participant's rights, point out their options and recommend a course of action. The Plan Attorney will identify any further coverage available under the Plan, and will undertake representation if the Participant so requests. If representation is covered by the Plan, the Participant will not be charged for the Plan Attorney's services. If representation is recommended, but is not covered by the Plan, the Plan Attorney will provide a written fee statement in advance. The Participant may choose whether to retain the Plan Attorney at their own expense, seek	Fully Covered	\$140

Legal issue	Available service	Network attorney	Indemnity benefit
	outside counsel, or do nothing. There are no restrictions on the number of times per year a Participant may use this service; however, for a non-covered matter, this service is not intended to provide the Participant with continuing access to a Plan Attorney in order to seek advice that would allow the Participant to undertake their own representation.		

Exclusions and limitations

Excluded services are those legal services that are not provided under the Plan. No services, not even a consultation, can be provided for the following matters:

- Employment-related matters, including company or statutory benefits
- Matters involving the employer, MetLife® and affiliates, and Plan Attorneys
- Matters in which there is a conflict of interest between the employee and spouse/domestic partner or dependents or Parent in which case services are excluded for the spouse/domestic partner, dependents, and/or Parent, as applicable
- Appeals and class actions
- Farm, business or investment matters, and matters involving property held for investment or rental or issues when the Participant or Parent is the landlord
- Patent, trademark and copyright matters
- Costs or fines
- Frivolous or unethical matters
- Matters for which an attorney-client relationship exists prior to the Participant or Parent becoming eligible for Plan benefits

Section XIV: Coverage if you leave Microsoft

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COBRA enrollees – the When benefit coverage ends section does not apply



Microsoft reserves the right to [terminate](#) or [amend](#) these plans at any time and for any reason.

Medical, vision and prescription drugs

For employees

Your benefit coverage ends when any one of the following occurs:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an eligible employee
- The first day following the maximum length of an applicable leave of absence, should you not return to work

For dependents

Coverage for dependents will end on the earliest of the following dates:

- The date your coverage ends
- The date the plan is terminated
- The date your dependent no longer meets the definition of an eligible dependent, including the following situations:
 - Divorce, legal separation, or annulment (for spouses)
 - The dissolution of a domestic partnership

- The end of the month in which a child no longer meets the age requirement for dependent status
- The date coverage for all dependents under the plan is cancelled



If your coverage terminates as a result of your death, your dependent's coverage will continue through the end of the month you die if you die before the 15th of that month, or through the 15th of the next month if you die on or after the 15th of the month. If your coverage terminates as a result of your death Microsoft will provide your covered dependents, who elect COBRA, a subsidy for 365 days from the date of their medical or dental coverage ends.

You may be eligible to continue your medical, vision, and dental coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section for more information.

If you live in Hawaii

If your principal residence is in Hawaii and you would otherwise lose medical coverage under the Hawaii Only Plan (Premera) while hospitalized or otherwise prevented by sickness from working, your medical coverage will not be terminated before whichever occurs later:

- The end of the third month following the month in which you first became unable to work due to hospitalization or sickness
- The date Microsoft ceases to pay you regular wages in such a case

During such period of continued coverage, Microsoft will contribute the same amount per month toward your cost of medical coverage that it contributed per month for you before you became sick.

Proof of coverage

Following the end of your employment from Microsoft, you will receive proof of your health coverage under the Microsoft plan in the mail. If you enroll in another health plan that has an exclusion period for preexisting conditions, you may need this proof of coverage to reduce the exclusion period. Your new plan will let you know if your new plan's exclusion period can be shortened and, if so, by how much.

Dental

Dental coverage will be extended for covered services that are ordered before your coverage ends if the covered service is delivered or completed within 30 days. This includes:

- Dentures
- Fixed bridgework
- Crown
- Root canal therapy



To be **considered an “ordered service”** the following must have been done:

1. Impressions used to form the dentures, crowns, or fixed bridgework have been taken
2. The teeth have been fully prepared for fixed bridgework and crowns

For employees

Your benefit coverage ends when any one of the following occurs:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an eligible employee
- The first day following the maximum length of an applicable leave of absence, should you not return to work

For dependents

Coverage for dependents will end on the earliest of the following dates:

- The date your coverage ends
- The date the plan is terminated
- The date your dependent no longer meets the definition of an eligible dependent, including the following situations:
 - Divorce, legal separation, or annulment (for spouses)
 - The dissolution of a domestic partnership
 - The end of the month in which a child no longer meets the age requirement for dependent status
- The date coverage for all dependents under the plan is cancelled



If your coverage terminates as a result of your death, your dependent's coverage will continue through the end of the month you die if you die before the 15th of that month, or through the 15th of the next month if you die on or after the 15th of the month. If your coverage terminates as a result of your death Microsoft will provide your covered dependents, who elect COBRA a subsidy for 365 days from date their medical or dental coverage ends.

You may be eligible to continue your dental coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section for more information.

Flexible spending accounts

Your coverage ends on the earliest of:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an eligible employee

You can claim eligible expenses that were incurred through your coverage end date for up to 90 days following the end of the plan year. Claims submitted more than 90 days after the end of the plan year are not eligible for reimbursement, and any money left in the account will be forfeited.

You may be eligible to continue participation in the General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare FSA after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section for more information.

Employee or dependent life insurance



All benefits and coverages are subject to the terms of the [insurance certificates](#) under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between the insurance certificates and this SPD, the certificate will always govern.

For employees

Your coverage ends on the earliest of:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an eligible employee
- The date the coverage or policy ends
- The date your employment ends
- The date you fail to make a required premium contribution

If your life insurance premium is waived because you become disabled, your coverage will not end solely because of either of the following:

- Your employer's coverage under the Group Contract ends
- The Employee Term Life coverage ends

For dependents

Your dependent's coverage will end on the earliest of the following dates:

- The date your coverage ends
- The date your dependent fails to meet this plan's definition of an eligible dependent

You may be eligible to continue coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for other benefits](#) section for more information.

Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)

A covered loss that started before the termination of coverage date will not be affected by the termination date.



All benefits and coverages are subject to the terms of the [insurance certificate](#) under which the benefits are provided. If there is any conflict between the insurance certificates and this SPD, the certificate will always govern.

For employees

Your coverage ends on the earliest of:

- The date this policy is terminated
- The end of the grace period if you do not pay the required premium
- The premium due date that falls on or follows the date you are no longer eligible for coverage

For dependents

Your child's coverage will continue as long as your coverage remains in effect and the child remains a dependent child incapable of self-sustaining employment.

Your dependent's coverage will end on the earliest of the following dates:

- The date your coverage ends
- The premium due date that falls on or follows the date your dependent is no longer eligible for coverage

If your child is no longer eligible for AD&D coverage, your dependent child can continue coverage if:

- On the date your child's coverage would otherwise terminate due to age, the child is then mentally or physically incapable of earning a living
- Proof of incapacity is provided within 31 days after the normal termination date
- Your coverage remains in effect.

You may be eligible to continue coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for other benefits](#) section for more information.

Long-term disability (LTD)

Your coverage ends on the earliest of:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an eligible employee

You may be eligible to continue coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for other benefits](#) section for more information.

Group Legal

Coverage will continue for legal matters that began while the plan was still in effect until each covered matter is resolved, regardless of the length of time it takes to reach a resolution.

Your coverage ends on the earliest of:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The last day of the month in which you leave Microsoft
- The last day of the month in which you no longer qualify as an eligible employee



If you are a participant in the plan and you die, your spouse and dependents remain covered under the plan for one year from the date of death.

If you have been enrolled in the Group Legal plan for at least one year, and your coverage ends, you may be eligible to purchase a separate legal insurance plan through MetLife. See the [Continuation of other coverage for other benefits](#) section for more information.

Wellbeing at Microsoft

Your Wellbeing at Microsoft benefit coverage ends when any one of the following occurs:

- The date this plan is terminated
- The date you no longer qualify as an employee eligible for the benefit
- The first day following the maximum length of an applicable leave of absence, should you not return to work

For dependents

Coverage for dependents, if applicable, will end on the earliest of the following dates:

- The date your coverage ends
- The date the plan is terminated
- The date your dependent no longer meets the definition of an eligible dependent, including the following situations:
 - Divorce, legal separation, or annulment (for spouses)
 - The dissolution of a domestic partnership
- The date coverage for all dependents under the plan is cancelled



If your coverage terminates as a result of your death, your dependent's coverage will continue through the end of the month you die if you die before the 15th of that month, or through the 15th of the next month if you die on or after the 15th of the month.

You may be eligible to continue your Wellbeing at Microsoft benefits coverage after you leave Microsoft. See the [Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits \(COBRA\)](#) section for more information.

Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits (COBRA)

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COBRA enrollees – the Continuation of coverage for health and FSA benefits (COBRA) applies

How COBRA works

If you are no longer eligible for benefits under the Plan, you may be able to continue coverage of the following benefits on a self-pay basis under COBRA:

- Medical and prescription drugs
- Dental
- Vision
- Wellbeing at Microsoft
- In some cases, a General Purpose or Limited Purpose Healthcare flexible spending account (FSA)

Note: You may also have other health coverage options available to you through the Health Insurance Marketplace. Visit www.healthcare.gov for further information.

You can continue coverage under COBRA for up to 18 months, or, for dependents who are eligible for COBRA other than due to an employee’s termination of employment, up to 36 months. In some cases, you may have the option to extend COBRA coverage.

With regard to benefits, COBRA enrollees have the same rights as employees. COBRA coverage is administered by the Microsoft COBRA Service Center.



Your rights to COBRA coverage may change as further amendments to COBRA are made by Congress or as interpretations of COBRA are made by the courts and by federal regulatory agencies.

Who is eligible

COBRA coverage is available for you (and your dependents, if applicable) **if**:

- You (and your dependents, if applicable) were covered by Plan benefits on the day before a qualifying event occurs (or, for dependents in particular, you removed your dependents from coverage at Open Enrollment in anticipation of a future qualifying event), or
- A child is born to you or adopted by you, or you are named the legal guardian of the child, while you are covered under COBRA

And a qualifying event (described above) occurs which results in the loss of benefit coverage for you or for your dependents under the Plan. The qualifying events include:

- The end of your employment with Microsoft (not including transfers to US Microsoft subsidiaries) for any reason other than gross misconduct
- Additional qualifying events for dependents only:
 - Your death (if your coverage terminates as a result of your death Microsoft will provide your covered dependents who elect COBRA a subsidy for 365 days from date their medical or dental coverage ends)
 - Your divorce, legal separation, or annulment
 - The legal dissolution of your domestic partnership
 - The fact that the dependent is no longer an eligible dependent as defined by the Plan

You are eligible for COBRA continuation of coverage for the General Purpose or Limited Purpose healthcare flexible spending account (FSA) if you have a positive balance in your FSA at the time of the qualifying event. At the end of the plan year, you may carryover any unused balance up to \$660 to the next plan year, and you do not have to pay COBRA premiums in the next plan year. Any unused amounts over \$660 are forfeited at the end of the plan year. If you do not have a balance at the end of the plan year, you may not continue FSA coverage for the next plan year.

You may elect separate COBRA coverage for you and each of your eligible dependents. If elected, separate coverage will apply to all of your COBRA benefits and separate premiums will apply to each member. If you are interested in this alternative, contact the [Microsoft COBRA Service Center](#) at (833) 253-4929 for more information.



If you elect COBRA medical coverage because you take a leave of absence from work or your employment ends as a result of an injury or illness covered by the accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D) benefit, you may receive up to 24 equal monthly payments to help you pay for COBRA continuation of medical coverage. Payments will stop if you become covered under another group medical plan. Each payment will equal the lesser of 3% of your benefit or \$125. Proof that the payment will be used for continuation of medical coverage will be required.



*For active employees, removing a dependent during Open Enrollment is not a COBRA qualifying event so COBRA coverage will not be made available to the removed dependent when they lose coverage on January 1st. However, if you remove a dependent from coverage during Open Enrollment in anticipation of a future qualifying event (such as a divorce, legal separation, annulment, or dissolution of domestic partnership), the dependent will be **deemed** to have been enrolled in Microsoft benefits coverage on the day before the qualifying event, and therefore may become eligible for COBRA coverage after the qualifying event.*

How to start COBRA coverage

If your employment with Microsoft is ending and you or your dependents are eligible for COBRA coverage, the Microsoft COBRA Service Center will send you or your dependent a notice about your right to COBRA coverage as well as an election form and instructions to elect COBRA coverage. This notice and form will be mailed to your last known address or the last known address of your dependent within 44 days of your last day of employment (or the notification of your death, if applicable).

If coverage for you or your dependents is ending due to any other qualifying event (including divorce, legal separation, dissolution of a domestic partnership, or dependent becoming ineligible), or your dependent was removed from coverage at Open Enrollment in anticipation of a future qualifying event, you or your dependent must inform Microsoft no more than 60 days* after the latest of any one of the following events:

- The date of the qualifying event
- The date that benefits would be terminated as a result of the qualifying event
- The date you or your dependent is informed, through the SPD, the general COBRA notice, or otherwise, of the obligation to provide this notice to Microsoft and the procedures for providing such notice (stated below)



To notify Microsoft of a qualifying event contact Benefits at (833) 253-4929 or go to the [Microsoft COBRA Service Center](#).

If you report a qualifying event to Microsoft, but COBRA coverage is not made available at that time, either due to late reporting by you or your termination of employment due to gross misconduct, the Microsoft COBRA Service Center will send you a notice of unavailability of COBRA coverage within 14 days of receiving your notice of the event (or your termination of employment, as applicable).

You must enroll for COBRA coverage within 60 days of the date your benefits end with Microsoft, or the date you are mailed your COBRA notification and enrollment form, whichever date is later. Through COBRA, you can continue coverage for yourself and any eligible dependent in your current COBRA-eligible plan(s). You do not have to cover the same dependents as you had as an active employee.



If you do not notify Microsoft within the 60-day period, you and your covered dependents will lose your right to elect COBRA coverage. If you do not choose COBRA coverage or do not pay for COBRA coverage within the time limits set by COBRA, you may not be eligible for COBRA coverage in the future for the same qualifying event.

Cost of COBRA coverage

If you enroll for COBRA coverage, you must pay the full cost of the coverage plus an administrative fee. Generally, this cost is 102% of the cost of coverage for similarly situated active full-time employees and/or dependents. The cost is actuarially determined based on the level of coverage. Separate rates are established for:

Section XIV: Coverage if you leave Microsoft

- A single employee or single spouse/domestic partner, or a child who enrolls in COBRA after “aging out” of coverage at age 26
- An employee and spouse/domestic partner
- An employee and children
- An employee, spouse/domestic partner, and children
- A child only (other than a child who enrolls in COBRA after aging out of coverage at age 26)

If the cost of active employee coverage changes after your COBRA coverage starts, the cost of COBRA coverage may also change.

If you are disabled and qualify for an additional 11 months of coverage, the cost for those extra 11 months of coverage is 150% (instead of 102%) of the cost of coverage for similarly situated active full-time employees and/or dependents.

You must send your first COBRA payment to the Microsoft COBRA Service Center postmarked within 45 days* following the date you elect COBRA coverage.



After you have elected and paid your initial COBRA premium payment, your subsequent monthly COBRA payments must be postmarked no more than 30 days following the due date. If your payments are late, your COBRA coverage will be terminated retroactive to the last payment date.

In the event of your death, Microsoft will provide your covered dependents a COBRA subsidy for medical and dental coverage (but not premiums for flexible spending account coverage) for up to the first 365 days from the date that they lose such coverage. Your dependents must elect COBRA continuation coverage under a Microsoft health care plan in order to avail of this benefit.



For more information about COBRA rates, contact Benefits at (833) 253-4929 or go to the [Microsoft COBRA Service Center](http://cobra.me.microsoft.com) (<http://cobra.me.microsoft.com>).

Section XIV: Coverage if you leave Microsoft

The following table summarizes the monthly COBRA rates for 2026. These rates are subject to change. (All currency amounts are expressed in U.S. dollars)

2026 COBRA Rates							
Type of coverage	Employee Only	Employee and Spouse / Domestic Partner	Employee and Children	Employee and Spouse / Domestic Partner and Children	Spouse / Domestic Partner Only	Children Only	Family Only
Medical and prescription drugs							
Health Savings Plan (Premera)	\$836.40	\$1,672.80	\$1,254.60	\$2,425.56	\$836.40	\$418.20	\$1,589.16
Hawaii Only Plan (Premera)	\$896.58	\$1,793.16	\$1,345.38	\$2,599.98	\$896.58	\$448.80	\$1,703.40
Surest PPO Plan (Surest)	\$918.00	\$1,853.34	\$1,455.54	\$2,584.68	\$935.34	\$537.54	\$1,666.68
HMO Plan (Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington)	\$789.48	\$1,578.96	\$1,184.22	\$2,289.90	\$789.48	\$394.74	\$1,500.42
HMO Plan (Kaiser Permanente CA)	\$823.58	\$1,647.15	\$1,235.36	\$2,058.93	\$823.57	\$411.78	\$1,235.35
Vision							
EyeMed Vision Plan	\$20.40	\$40.80	\$30.60	\$59.16	\$20.40	\$10.20	\$38.76
Dental							
Delta Dental	\$72.42	\$144.84	\$109.14	\$210.12	\$72.42	\$36.72	\$137.70
Wellbeing at Microsoft							
Wellbeing at Microsoft (Spring Health EAP, Thrive Global, Expert Medical Opinion, Maven)	\$45.52	\$45.52	\$45.52	\$45.52	\$45.52	\$4.39	\$45.52

Benefit coverage is subject to the terms and conditions set forth by Microsoft corporate policies, benefit plan documents, and summary plan descriptions.

Filing an appeal for COBRA coverage

If you believe your right to enroll in COBRA coverage should not have been denied, you may file an appeal as follows:

1. Write an appeal in which you explain why you believe your right to COBRA coverage was improperly denied. Include your name, address, and the names of other covered individuals you wish to include in your appeal, along with any additional information you wish to be reviewed.
2. Send your written appeal within 30 days of your receipt of the declination to:

Microsoft (c/o Businessolver, Inc.)
ATTN: COBRA Administration
P.O. Box 310512
Des Moines IA 50331-0512
(833) 253-4929

The Microsoft COBRA Service Center will respond within 30 days after the receipt of your written appeal. This is the exclusive process for appeals of COBRA rights declinations. Appeals for COBRA coverage are not subject to the general plan and ERISA rules for benefit claims and appeals. The Microsoft COBRA Service Center's determination is final. You cannot appeal further.

Extending COBRA coverage

If a second qualifying event occurs during the 18-month COBRA period that results from the loss of coverage due to your termination of employment (other than for gross misconduct), your covered dependents may continue their coverage for up to a maximum of 36 months from the date of your termination of employment (i.e., first qualifying event). Second qualifying events may include the death of a covered employee, divorce or legal separation from the covered employee, the covered employee becoming enrolled in Medicare Part A, Part B, or both, or a dependent child ceasing to be eligible for coverage as a dependent under the Plan (e.g., turning age 26).

Your dependents **must notify the Microsoft COBRA Service Center at 833-253-4929** of this change within 60 days after the latest of: (1) the date on which the second qualifying event occurs; (2) the date on which the dependent(s) lose (or would lose) coverage under the Plan as a result of the second qualifying event; or (3) the date on which the dependent(s) are informed, through the furnishing of the SPD or the COBRA general notice, of the responsibility to notify the Plan of the second qualifying event and the procedures for doing so.

If the initial qualifying event is your termination of employment and you or a covered dependent become disabled during the first 60 days of your 18-month COBRA period, COBRA coverage may be extended for up to 29 months total for you and your dependents if you or a covered dependent receive a determination of disability from the Social Security Administration within this timeframe. You must send this Social Security Administration notice indicating the disability onset date to the Microsoft COBRA Service Center no more than 60 days after the latest of any one of the following events:

- The date of the notice from the Social Security Administration

- The date of the qualifying event
- The date benefits are terminated
- The date you are informed, through the SPD or the general COBRA notice, of the obligation to provide this notice, and the procedures for providing such notice

Note: If you enroll in Medicare effective less than 18 months before a qualifying event due to termination of employment, your eligible dependents can elect COBRA for a period of not more than 36 months from the effective date of your enrollment in Medicare.

In addition, individuals enrolled in the Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan for California employees may be eligible for an additional, extended period of healthcare continuation coverage, beyond the maximum COBRA period, for themselves and their covered dependents, in accordance with California state law ("Cal-COBRA"). For more information, see:

Active employees/dependents go here...	COBRA enrollees go here...
• Evidence of Coverage – Northern California • Evidence of Coverage – Southern California	Go to http://cobra.me.microsoft.com > Reference Center > Kaiser CA Evidence of Coverage (EOC) Documents

Employees who participate in the Microsoft Corporation Voluntary Retirement Program may be eligible for an additional, extended period of healthcare continuation coverage, beyond the maximum COBRA period, for themselves and their covered dependents, in accordance with the terms and conditions of the Microsoft Corporation Voluntary Retirement Program.

When COBRA coverage ends

COBRA coverage ends on the date of the earliest of the following events:

- The date the maximum COBRA coverage period ends, as described above
- The last date for which premiums were paid, in the event that you fail to make the next required premium payment either in full or within the grace period required by COBRA
- The date you become covered under another group plan or the effective date of your enrollment under Medicare Part A or B, after the date of your COBRA election
- The date Microsoft ceases to offer the plan in which you are enrolled. However, COBRA coverage may be available under other Microsoft plans. If all Microsoft plans are terminated, all COBRA coverage is also terminated
- If you add dependents to your coverage while on COBRA, their coverage ends when your coverage ends

! If the qualified beneficiary is determined by the Social Security Administration to no longer be disabled, they must notify the Microsoft COBRA Service Center of that fact within 30 days after the Social Security Administration's determination. All other rules still apply. COBRA qualified beneficiaries will be notified of their COBRA termination date.

! If the qualified beneficiary becomes covered under another group health plan or covered by Medicare Parts A or B, they must notify the Microsoft COBRA Service Center of that fact within 30 days of being so enrolled. All other rules still apply. COBRA qualified beneficiaries will be notified of their COBRA termination date.

Continuation of coverage for other benefits

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 *COBRA enrollees – the Continuation of coverage for other benefits section does not apply*

You may be able to extend the following benefits if your coverage ends with Microsoft for reasons other than gross misconduct.

Employee or dependent life insurance

If your coverage under the Microsoft plan ends, you may convert your Microsoft insurance (a group policy) to an individual policy or apply for similar coverage under the portability plan. You may not choose both options. You and your qualified dependents must have been covered under the Microsoft life insurance plan when your coverage ends.

Conversion to individual policy

Your coverage may be converted to an individual policy if your employment ends. Dependent coverage may be converted to an individual policy if your employment ends, you die, or you divorce. Evidence of Insurability (EOI) is not required, but you must apply and pay for your converted coverage within 31 days after your employment ends.

The maximum amount you can convert to an individual life policy is the face amount of your employee or dependent term life insurance coverage when your group insurance coverage ends. Rates are based on your age and your class of risk. Dependent rates are based on your dependent's age and class of risk.

 For more information about converting to an individual policy, contact Prudential (800) 778-3827.

Continuation of coverage through the portability plan

You may be eligible to continue coverage through the portability plan if your coverage ends because you leave Microsoft, or you otherwise become ineligible for continuing coverage. This coverage is not available if you fail to make contributions for the coverage, or the Prudential AD&D policy is replaced for all employees with a new policy for which you become eligible within 31 days.

You must be age 79 or younger to continue employee life insurance. You may continue dependent life insurance coverage only if you elect to continue your employee life insurance. If you die or divorce, your spouse or domestic partner will have the right to apply for continued life insurance coverage under the portability plan.

Portability is not available for the following dependents:

- Spouses or domestic partners age 80 or over
- Dependent children older than age 19, or 23 if enrolled as a full-time student in a school and wholly dependent on you for support and maintenance
- Dependents who are confined for medical care or treatment

The amount of insurance coverage that you can continue is:

- For employee coverage: from \$20,000 to \$1,000,000
- For dependent coverage: from \$20,000 to \$500,000

To continue coverage, submit your request in writing to Prudential within 31 days of when your coverage under the Microsoft plan ends. If you elect to continue your life insurance, coverage is effective at the end of the election period. You do not have to provide EOI to qualify for this continued insurance coverage; however, if you do provide EOI, you may pay lower premium rates.



For more information about the portability plan, contact Prudential (800) 778-3827.

Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)

You may be eligible to continue AD&D coverage under the portability plan if your insurance ends because you leave Microsoft, or you otherwise become ineligible for continuing coverage. This coverage is not available if you fail to make contributions for the coverage, your employment ends because you retire, or the Prudential AD&D policy is replaced for all employees with a new policy for which you become eligible within 31 days.

Portability is not available for the following dependents:

- Spouses/domestic partners age of 80 or older
- Dependent children older than age 19, or 23 if wholly dependent on you for support and maintenance
- Dependents who are confined for medical care or treatment

The amount of insurance coverage that you can continue is:

- For employee coverage: from \$20,000 to five times your base pay or \$1,000,000, whichever is less
- For dependent coverage: from \$20,000 to \$500,000 or the coverage the dependent had when coverage with Microsoft ends, whichever is less

To continue coverage, submit your request in writing to Prudential within 31 days of when your coverage under the Microsoft plan ends.

If you elect to continue your life insurance, coverage is effective as of the date your coverage under the Microsoft Plan ends.



For more information about the portability plan, contact Prudential (800) 778-3827.

Long-term disability (LTD)

If your coverage under the Microsoft plan ends, you may purchase LTD coverage under Prudential's group conversion plan. You must have been covered under the Microsoft LTD plan for at least 12 consecutive months when your coverage ends.

You are not eligible to apply for coverage under Prudential's group conversion policy if:

- You are or become insured under another group long-term disability plan within 60 days after your employment ends
- You are disabled under the terms of the plan
- You are age 70 or more when your employment ends
- Your coverage under the plan ends for any of the following reasons:
 - The plan is canceled
 - You retire (applies when retirement is self-reported to Prudential)
 - The plan is changed to exclude the group of employees to which you belong
 - You are no longer in an eligible group
 - You fail to pay the required premium under this plan

You must apply for insurance under the conversion policy and pay the first premium to Prudential within 60 days after the date your employment ends. Evidence of insurability will be required for certain levels of coverage.

Your coverage under the conversion plan will not be more than your coverage under the Microsoft LTD plan, but it may be lower. The benefits will comply with any state laws or regulations that may apply.

Your rates for the conversion plan will be based on the form and amount of insurance provided, the period and your age at the time of conversion. Your premiums will not be due less often than quarterly unless you agree to another frequency.



For more information about the conversion plan, contact Prudential (800) 778-3827.

Group legal

If you have been enrolled in the Group Legal plan for at least one year, and your coverage ends, you may be eligible to purchase a new legal insurance plan through MetLife. You will be responsible for payment of premiums from your previous policy's end date through your enrollment date in the new plan. Your

Section XIV: Coverage if you leave Microsoft

premium for coverage will be deducted from your checking or savings account or charged to your credit card each month.



To enroll call MetLife at (855) 234-1844 within 90 days of your last day of employment.



Following the death of an insured employee, spouse and dependents are covered under the plan for one year from when the death occurred.

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Glossary

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General terms

Activities of daily living—

- Bathing—Washing oneself by sponge bath, or in either a tub or shower, including the task of getting into or out of the tub or shower
- Continence—The ability to maintain control of bowel and bladder function; or, when unable to maintain control of bowel and bladder function, the ability to perform associated personal hygiene (including caring for catheter or colostomy bag)
- Dressing—Putting on and taking off all items of clothing and any necessary braces, fasteners or artificial limbs
- Eating—Feeding oneself by getting food into the body from a receptacle (such as a plate, cup or table) or by feeding tube or intravenously
- Toileting—Getting to and from the toilet, getting on and off the toilet, and performing associated personal hygiene
- Transferring—Sufficient mobility to move into or out of a bed, chair, or wheelchair or to move from place to place, either by walking, using a wheelchair, or by other means
- You have a severe cognitive impairment, which requires substantial supervision to protect you from threats to health and safety

Eligible employee—For purposes of determining eligibility to participate in the plan under this SPD, an eligible employee is an employee who is in an approved headcount regular employment position with Microsoft, is on the Microsoft U.S. payroll and is not a Microsoft retail store employee.

An approved headcount regular employment position is one that is:

- Authorized in writing during the Microsoft annual or out-of-cycle budgeting process as a regular employment position and is approved by an officer of Microsoft (or by a regional director for positions in subsidiaries of Microsoft) and
- Reflected in the official Human Resources (HR) database of Microsoft or one of its subsidiaries as a regular employment position (for example, as hourly regular or salaried regular)

You are on the Microsoft U.S. payroll if you are paid from the Microsoft payroll department located in the United States, and Microsoft withholds and pays U.S. employment taxes on your payroll amounts. For purposes of eligible employee status, the term Microsoft includes those subsidiaries and affiliates of the Microsoft Corporation that participate in the Plan. The current participating employers are listed in the [Administrative Information](#) section of this Summary Plan Description. Contact Benefits if you would like a current list of the Microsoft subsidiaries and affiliates that participate in the Plan.

Notwithstanding the above, the following persons are not eligible employees and are not eligible to participate as employees in the plan under this SPD, even if they meet the definition of a regular employee of Microsoft:

- Interns and visiting researchers
- Cooperatives
- Apprentices
- Nonresident aliens receiving no U.S. source income from Microsoft
- Employees covered by a collective bargaining agreement resulting from negotiations with Microsoft in which retirement benefits were the subject of good faith bargaining and participation in this plan was not provided for
- Persons providing services to Microsoft pursuant to an agreement between Microsoft and any other individual or entity, such as a staff leasing organization (leased employees)
- Temporary workers engaged through or employed by temporary or leasing agencies
- Temporary employees of Microsoft. For purposes of the plan, a temporary employee of Microsoft is one who is hired by Microsoft as an employee to work on a specific project or series of projects that in the aggregate is not expected to exceed six months.
- Workers who hold themselves out to Microsoft as being independent contractors or as being employed by or engaged through another company while providing services to Microsoft
- Project-based employees. For purposes of the plan, a project-based employee is one who is hired to work on a project or series of projects, is employed for a limited term, and has signed a Project-Based Employment Agreement.
- All other workers who Microsoft does not classify as being either a full-time or part-time employee on the Microsoft U.S. payroll, even if that classification is later determined to be incorrect or is retroactively revised.

Dependent children under age 26—Includes your:

- Biological child and/or your spouse's/domestic partner's biological child
- Child for whom you or your spouse/domestic partner has been named legal guardian as appointed by the courts (or recognized as guardian by the state of residence)
- Legally adopted child, or child who has been placed with you for adoption, but not a foster child
- A child's eligibility as a dependent does not rely on the child's financial dependency (on you or any other person), residency with you or with any other person, student status, employment, eligibility for other health plan coverage, or any combination of these factors.

Incapacitated dependent children age 26 or over—An incapacitated dependent resides with the employee for more than half the year, and is unable to sustain employment due to a developmental or physical disability that existed before the child reached age 26. The individual is chiefly dependent on the employee (or the employee's spouse or domestic partner) for support.

Spouse—You must be married (whether same or opposite sex) under the laws of any state, possession, or territory of the U.S. in which the marriage is entered into, regardless of domicile, and not legally separated

Domestic Partner—You and your domestic partner (either of the same or opposite sex) must meet all of the following requirements:

- You are each other's sole domestic partner and intend to remain so indefinitely
- Neither of you is legally married
- You are both at least 18 years of age and are mentally competent to consent to contract
- You are not related by blood to a degree of closeness that would prohibit legal marriage in the state in which you legally reside
- You reside together in the same residence and intend to do so indefinitely (excepting a temporary residence change of not more than 90 days during which you and your domestic partner reside in separate homes)
- You are mutually responsible (financially and legally) for each other's common welfare

For life and accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D), a domestic partner includes any person who satisfies the requirements for being a domestic partner, registered domestic partner, or civil union partner of an eligible employee under the law of your jurisdiction of residence.

Health plan terms

Medical Care

Adverse Benefit Decision - An Adverse Benefit Determination is a denial, reduction of or a failure to provide or make payment, in whole or in part, for a Benefit, including those based on a determination of eligibility, application of utilization review, or Medical Necessity, as well as any coverage rescission.

Ancillary Charge - a charge, in addition to the Copayment, that you must pay when a covered Prescription Drug Product is dispensed at your or the provider's request, when a Chemically Equivalent Prescription Drug Product is available.

For Prescription Drug Products from Network Pharmacies, the Ancillary Charge is the difference between:

- The Prescription Drug Charge for the Prescription Drug Product; and
- The Prescription Drug Charge for the Chemically Equivalent Prescription Drug Product.

Ancillary Services - Items and services provided by out-of-network Providers at an in-network facility that are any of the following, as defined under federal law (the federal No Surprises Act):

- Related to emergency medicine, anesthesiology, pathology, radiology, and neonatology;
- Provided by assistant surgeons, hospitalists, and intensivists;
- Diagnostic services, including radiology and laboratory services; and
- Provided by an out-of-network Provider when no other in-network Provider is available at the facility

Approved transplant center—A hospital or other provider, located in the United States, that has developed expertise in performing solid organ transplants, bone marrow reinfusion, or stem cell reinfusion, and is approved by your insurance plan. Your plan has contractual agreements with approved

transplant centers and has access to a special network of approved transplant centers, throughout the United States. Whenever medically possible, they will direct you to an approved transplant center with which they have a contract. Of course, if neither a plan-approved transplant center nor a network transplant center can provide the type of transplant you need, this benefit will cover a transplant center that meets the approval standards that are set by the plan.

Authorized Representative - A person you revocably appoint to assist you in submitting a Claim or appealing a Claim denial, in a form and manner prescribed by the applicable Component Plan. However, for urgent care Claims and expedited appeals, a treating Provider may act as your Authorized Representative without your designation.

BlueCard – BlueCard Program and other inter-plan arrangements (Premera Plans Only)

Premera Blue Cross has relationships with other Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield Licensees generally called "Inter-Plan Arrangements." They include "the BlueCard Program," negotiated National Account arrangements, and arrangements for payments to non-network providers. Whenever you obtain healthcare services outside Washington and Alaska or in Clark County, Washington, the claims are processed through one of these arrangements. You can take advantage of these Inter-Plan Arrangements when you receive covered services from hospitals, doctors, and other providers that are in the network of the local Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield Licensee, called the "Host Blue" in this section. At times, you may also obtain care from non-network providers. Our payment calculation practices in both instances are described below.

It's important to note that receiving services through these Inter-Plan Arrangements does not change covered benefits, benefit levels, or any stated residence requirements of this plan.

Network Providers

When you receive care from a Host Blue's network provider, you will receive many of the conveniences you're used to from Premera Blue Cross. In most cases, there are no claim forms to submit because network providers will do that for you. In addition, your out-of-pocket costs may be less, as explained below.

BlueCard in California

We have made an arrangement for you as a Premera Blue Cross member with Anthem Blue Cross. In order for you to maximize your in-network savings under the BlueCard Program, you will need to choose only Anthem Blue Cross network providers for services received in California. **Note:** Blue Shield of California network providers are not considered in-network for purposes of the Health Savings Plan, unless (and to the extent that) they are also Anthem Blue Cross network providers.

Negotiated National Account Arrangement in Arizona

Members' claims for covered healthcare services in Arizona are processed through an Inter-Plan Program called a negotiated National Account arrangement with the Host Blue in Arizona. Our responsibilities and those of the Arizona Host Blue and its network providers under this arrangement are the same as under the BlueCard Program.

Allowable charge calculations under the negotiated National Account arrangement are the same as described above in the "Network Providers" section for the BlueCard Program.

Non-Network Providers

The allowable charge for Washington or Alaska providers that don't have a contract with us is the least of the three amounts shown below. The allowable charge for providers outside Washington or Alaska that don't have a contract with us or the local Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield Licensee is also the least of the three amounts shown below:

- An amount that is no less than the lowest amount we pay for the same or similar service from a comparable provider that has a contracting agreement with us
- 125% of the fee schedule determined by the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (Medicare), if available
- The provider's billed charges

Notwithstanding any provision of the plan to the contrary, the plan will pay any amounts required by applicable law.

Exceptions Required by Law

In some cases, federal law or the laws in a small number of states may require the Host Blue to include a surcharge as part of the liability for your covered services. If either federal law or any state laws mandate other liability calculation methods, including a surcharge, we would then use the surcharge and/or other amount that the Host Blue instructs us to use in accordance with those laws as a basis for determining the plan's benefits and any amounts for which you are responsible.

Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core (Premiera Plans Only)

If you're outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, and the U.S. Virgin Islands, you may be able to take advantage of Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core when accessing covered health services. Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core is unlike the BlueCard Program available in the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, and the U.S. Virgin Islands in certain ways. For instance, although Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core provides a network of contracting inpatient hospitals, it offers only referrals to doctors and other outpatient providers. Also, when you receive care from doctors and other outpatient providers outside the United States, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico and the U.S. Virgin Islands, you'll typically have to submit the claims yourself to obtain reimbursement for these services.

Further Questions?

If you have questions or need more information about Inter-Plan Arrangements, including the BlueCard Program, call our Customer Service Department. To locate a provider in another Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield Licensee service area, go to our Web site or call the toll-free BlueCard number; both are shown on the back cover of your booklet. You can also get Blue Cross Blue Shield Global Core information by calling the toll-free phone number.

Brand-name prescription drug—A prescription drug that is sold under a trademark name. An equivalent generic drug may or may not be available at lower cost, depending upon whether the patent on the brand-name drug has expired.

Brand formulary (KFHPWA) —The brand-name prescription drugs that are covered under the KFHPWA HMO Plan.

Chemical dependency—This is an illness characterized by a physiological or psychological (or both) dependency on a controlled substance and/or on alcoholic beverages, and where the member's health is substantially impaired or endangered or their social or economic function is substantially disrupted.

Claim (Surest) - A request for Benefits made by a member or his/her Authorized Representative in accordance with the procedures described in this SPD. A Claim includes Prior Authorization requests for Benefits and appeals; urgent care requests for Benefits and appeals; concurrent care request for Benefits and appeals; and post-services Claims and appeals

Claims Administrator (Surest) - Surest, in its role of administering and deciding Claims and Appeals under the Surest Plan, for which Surest acts as a fiduciary that has been delegated final discretionary authority.

Congenital anomaly—A marked difference from the normal structure of a body part that is physically evident from birth

Continuous care (Premera Plans Only) —Skilled nursing care provided in the home during a period of crisis in order to maintain the terminally ill member at home.

Cosmetic - Services, medications, and procedures that improve physical appearance but are not Medically Necessary.

Covered Health Service (Surest) - Health care services, including supplies or pharmaceutical products, which are determined to be all of the following:

- Provided for the purpose of preventing, evaluating, diagnosing or treating a sickness, injury, illness, disorder, condition, disease or its symptoms, whether medical/surgical or behavioral health
- Medically Necessary
- Described as a Covered Health Service in this SPD
- Not excluded in this SPD

Custodial care—Any service, procedure or supply that is provided primarily:

- For ongoing maintenance of a person's condition, not for therapeutic value, in the treatment of an illness or injury
- To assist a person in meeting activities of daily living for example, assistance in walking, bathing, dressing, eating and preparation of special diets and supervision over self-administration of medication not requiring the constant attention of trained medical personnel

Such services and supplies are regarded as custodial without regard to the following:

- Who prescribes the service and supplies
- Who recommends the service and supplies
- Who performs the service or the method in which such services are performed

Designated Provider (Surest) - A provider and/or facility that:

- Has entered into an agreement with the Claims Administrator, or with an organization contracting on the Claims Administrator's behalf, to provide Covered Health Service for the treatment of specific diseases or conditions; or
- The Claims Administrator has identified through the Claims Administrator's designation programs as a Designated Provider. Such designation may apply to specific treatments, conditions and/or procedures.

A Designated Provider may or may not be located within your geographic area. Not all network hospitals or network physicians are Designated Providers.

Designated Virtual Network Provider (Surest) - A provider or facility that has entered into an agreement with the Claims Administrator, or with an organization contracting on the Claims Administrator's behalf, to deliver Covered Health Services through live audio with video technology or audio only, and/or through federally compliant secure messaging applications.

Domiciliary Care - Living arrangements designed to meet the needs of people who cannot live independently but do not require Skilled Nursing Facility services.

Durable Medical Equipment (DME) - Medical equipment that is all of the following:

- Ordered or provided by a Physician for outpatient use primarily in a home setting.
- Used for medical purposes.
- Not consumable or disposable except as needed for the effective use of covered DME.
- Not of use to a person in the absence of a disease or disability.
- Serves a medical purpose for the treatment of a sickness or injury.
-

Eligible Expenses (Surest) - The amount of charges that the Claims Administrator determines to be reimbursable under the Surest Plan for Covered Health Services that are provided while the Surest Plan is in effect. Eligible Expenses are determined solely in accordance with the Claims Administrator's reimbursement policy guidelines.

Network Providers are reimbursed based on contracted rates. Out-of-network Providers are reimbursed at a percentage of the published rates allowed by the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) for Medicare for the same or similar service within the geographic market.

Note: Out-of-network Providers may bill you for any difference between the Provider's billed charges and the Eligible Expense described above, except as required under the No Surprises Act or other applicable law, or provided in this SPD.

Eligible provider—A health care practitioner or facility that is in a licensed or certified provider category regulated by the state in which the practitioner or facility provides care, and that practices within the scope of such licensure or certification. Also included is an employee or agent of such practitioner or facility, acting in the course of and within the scope of their employment.

Health care facilities that are owned and operated by an agency of the U.S. government are included as required by federal law. Health care facilities owned by the political subdivision or instrumentality of a state are also covered.

For more information on eligible providers, refer to the section of this SPD describing the specific benefit and plan at issue.

Emergency - The sudden onset or change of a medical condition manifesting itself by acute symptoms of sufficient severity, including severe pain, such that the absence of immediate medical attention could reasonably be expected by a prudent layperson to result in:

1. Placing the health of the member's health (or, with respect to a pregnant woman, the health of the woman or her unborn child) in serious jeopardy
2. Serious impairment to bodily functions
3. Serious dysfunction of any bodily organ or part

Emergency Health Care Services - With respect to an Emergency:

- An appropriate medical screening exam (as required under section 1867 of the Social Security Act or as would be required under such section if such section applied to an Independent Freestanding Emergency Department) that is within the capability of the emergency department of a hospital, or an Independent Freestanding Emergency Department, as applicable, including ancillary services routinely available to the emergency department to evaluate such Emergency, and
- Such further medical exam and treatment, to the extent they are within the capabilities of the staff and facilities available at the Hospital or an Independent Freestanding Emergency Department, as applicable, as are required under section 1867 of the Social Security Act, or as would be required under such section if such section applied to an Independent Freestanding Emergency Department, to stabilize the patient (regardless of the department of the Hospital in which such further exam or treatment is provided). For the purpose of this definition, "to stabilize" has the meaning as given such term in section 1867(e)(3) of the Social Security Act (42 U.S.C. 1395dd(e)(3)).
- Emergency Health Care Services include items and services otherwise covered under the Plan when provided by an out-of-network Provider or facility (regardless of the department of the hospital in which the items and services are provided) after the patient is stabilized and as part of outpatient observation or an inpatient stay or outpatient stay that is connected to the original Emergency, unless each of the following conditions are met:
 - a) The attending Emergency Physician or treating Provider or facility determines the patient is able to travel using non-medical transportation or non-Emergency medical transportation to an available Network provider or facility located within a reasonable distance taking into consideration the patient's medical condition.
 - b) The provider furnishing the additional items and services satisfies notice and consent criteria in accordance with applicable law.
 - c) The patient is in such a condition to receive information as stated in b above and to provide informed consent in accordance with applicable law.
 - d) The provider or facility satisfies any additional requirements or prohibitions as may be imposed by state law.
 - e) Any other conditions as specified by the Secretary of the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services.

E-Visit and Telephone Consult - Services provided by a Physician without physical face to face interaction, but through electronic (including telephonic) communication through an online portal or telephone. Examples are emails, texts, or patient portal messages

Experimental or investigational—

Premere Experimental or investigational:

Experimental or investigational services include a treatment, procedure, equipment, drug, drug usage, medical device or supply that meets one or more of the following criteria:

A drug or device that can't be lawfully marketed without the approval of the U.S. Food and Drug Administration ("FDA") and hasn't been granted such approval on the date the service is provided.

The service is subject to oversight by an Institutional Review Board

No reliable evidence demonstrates that the service is effective, in clinical diagnosis, evaluation, management or treatment of the condition.

The service is the subject of ongoing clinical trials to determine its maximum tolerated dose, toxicity, safety or efficacy.

Evaluation of reliable evidence indicates that additional research is necessary before the service can be classified as equally or more effective than conventional therapies.

Reliable evidence includes but is not limited to reports and articles published in authoritative peer reviewed medical and scientific literature, and assessments and coverage recommendations published by the Blue Cross Blue Shield Association Technical Evaluation Center (TEC).

Kaiser Experimental or investigational services:

KFHPWA consults with KFHPWA's medical director and then uses the criteria described below to decide if a particular service is experimental or investigational.

a. A service is considered experimental or investigational for a Member's condition if any of the following statements apply to it at the time the service is or will be provided to the Member:

- 1) The service cannot be legally marketed in the United States without the approval of the FDA and such approval has not been granted.
- 2) The service is the subject of a current new drug or new device application on file with the FDA.
- 3) The service is the trialed agent or for delivery or measurement of the trialed agent provided as part of a qualifying Phase I or Phase II clinical trial, as the experimental or research arm of a Phase III clinical trial.
- 4) The service is provided pursuant to a written protocol or other document that lists an evaluation of the service's safety, toxicity or efficacy as among its objectives.
- 5) The service is under continued scientific testing and research concerning the safety, toxicity or efficacy of services.
- 6) The service is provided pursuant to informed consent documents that describe the service as experimental or investigational, or in other terms that indicate that the service is being evaluated for its safety, toxicity or efficacy.
- 7) The prevailing opinion among experts, as expressed in the published authoritative medical or scientific literature, is that (1) the use of such service should be substantially confined to research settings, or (2) further research is necessary to determine the safety, toxicity or efficacy of the service.

b. The following sources of information will be exclusively relied upon to determine whether a service is experimental or investigational:

- 1) The Member's medical records.
- 2) The written protocol(s) or other document(s) pursuant to which the service has been or will be provided.
- 3) Any consent document(s) the Member or Member's representative has executed or will be asked to execute, to receive the service.
- 4) The files and records of the Institutional Review Board (IRB) or similar body that approves or reviews research at the institution where the service has been or will be provided, and other information concerning the authority or actions of the IRB or similar body.
- 5) The published authoritative medical or scientific literature regarding the service, as applied to the Member's illness or injury.

6) Regulations, records, applications and any other documents or actions issued by, filed with or taken by, the FDA or other agencies within the United States Department of Health and Human Services, or any state agency performing similar functions.

Appeals regarding KFHPWA denial of coverage can be submitted to the Member Appeal Department, or to KFHPWA's medical director at P.O. Box 34593, Seattle, WA 98124-1593.

Surest Plan Experimental or investigational services:

A procedure, study, test, drug, equipment, or supply will be considered Experimental and/or Investigational if it is any of the following criteria/guidelines is met, unless otherwise provided in the Surest Plan:

- It is being provided pursuant to a written protocol that describes among its objectives the determination of safety, efficacy, toxicity, maximum tolerated dose, or effectiveness in comparison to conventional treatments.
- It is being delivered or should be delivered subject to approval and supervision of an institutional review board (IRB) as required and defined by federal regulations or other official actions (especially those of the FDA or DHHS).
- Other facilities/Providers/etc. studying substantially the same drug, device, medical treatment, or procedure refer to it as Experimental or as a research project, a study, an invention, a test, a trial, or other words of similar effect.
- The predominant opinion among experts as expressed in published, authoritative medical literature is that usage should be confined to research settings.
- It is not Experimental or Investigational itself pursuant to the above criteria but would not be Medically Necessary except for its use in conjunction with a drug, device or treatment that is Experimental or Investigational (e.g., lab tests or imaging ordered to evaluate the effectiveness of an Experimental therapy).
- It cannot lawfully be marketed without the approval of the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and such approval has not been granted at the time of its use or proposed use.
- It is the subject of a current investigation of new drug or new device (IND) application on file with the FDA.
- Except as otherwise provided in this SPD, it is the subject of an ongoing Clinical Trial (Phase I, II or the research arm of Phase III) as defined in regulations and other official publications issued by the FDA and Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS).
- It is being used for off-label therapies for a non-indicated condition – even if FDA approve for another condition – unless otherwise provided under the Surest Plan.

Generic maintenance medications have a common indication for the treatment of a chronic disease (such as diabetes, high cholesterol, or hypertension). Indications are obtained from the product labeling. They are used for diseases when the duration of the therapy can reasonably be expected to exceed one year. A generic prescription drug is manufactured and distributed after the brand-name drug patent of the innovator company has expired and is available at a lower cost than brand-name prescriptions. Generic drugs have obtained an AB rating from the U.S. Food and Drug Administration and are considered by the FDA to be therapeutically equivalent to the brand-name product.

Generic drugs are equivalent to brand-name drugs but are available at a lower cost because the patent has expired.

Hospice care (Kaiser Plan): A hospice care program is a coordinated program of home and inpatient care, available 24 hours a day. This program uses an interdisciplinary team of personnel to provide comfort and supportive services to a Member and any family members who are caring for the Member, who is experiencing a life-threatening disease with a limited prognosis. These services include acute, respite and home care to meet the physical, psychosocial and special needs of the Member and their family during the final stages of illness. In order to qualify for hospice care, the Member's provider must certify that the Member is terminally ill and is eligible for hospice services.

(Premera Plan) A coordinated program of palliative and supportive care for dying members by an interdisciplinary team of professionals and volunteers centering primarily in the member's home.

Independent Freestanding Emergency Department - A health care facility that:

- Is geographically separate and distinct and licensed separately from a hospital under applicable state law; and
- Provides Emergency Health Care services

Intermittent care—Care provided due to the medically predictable recurring need for skilled home health care services.

Maintenance Medication (Surest) - a Prescription Drug Product expected to be used for six months or more to treat or prevent a chronic condition. You may find out if a Prescription Drug Product is a Maintenance Medication by contacting the Claims Administrator at <https://benefits.surest.com>, the telephone number on your ID card, or the Surest mobile app.

Network Provider (Kaiser Plan): A Network Hospital, Physician, Pharmacy, Skilled Nursing Facility, Medical Group, or any other health care provider under contract with Kaiser Permanente to provide Covered Services. Network Providers are subject to change at any time without notice. For current locations of Network facilities please visit ww.kp.org to find a Kaiser Pharmacy.

Network Hospital (Kaiser Plan): A licensed hospital that provides inpatient, outpatient and ambulatory surgical care and other related services for surgery, acute medical conditions, or injuries usually for a short-term illness or condition, and which is owned and operated by Kaiser Foundation Hospitals or another hospital which contracts with Kaiser Foundation Hospitals to provide Covered Services. Note: Ancillary providers at Kaiser owned facilities are always in-network providers.

Network Pharmacy (Premera and Surest) - A retail or mail order pharmacy that has:

- Entered into an agreement with an organization contracting on its behalf to dispense prescription drugs to members
- Agreed to accept specified reimbursement rates for dispensing prescription drugs
- Been designated by the Plan Administrator as a Network Pharmacy

Network Pharmacy (Kaiser Plan): A pharmacy owned and operated by Kaiser Permanente or another pharmacy that Kaiser Permanente designates.

Network Physician (Kaiser Plan): A licensed physician who is a partner, shareholder, or employee of the Medical Group, or another licensed physician who contracts with the Medical Group to provide Covered Services.

Network Ancillary Providers (Kaiser Plan): Non-MD providers such as Psychologists, Marriage Family and Child Counseling (MFCC), Licensed Clinical Social Worker (LCSW), Optometrists, Physical, Speech, and Occupational Therapy. Such providers will be subject to the primary care Cost Share. Verify referral requirements at KP.org in the How to Obtain Services section.

Network Primary Care Provider (Kaiser Plan): Family Practice, Internal Medicine and Pediatrics. Note: Physician Assistants and Nurse Practitioners may be treated as Primary Care Providers or Specialists based on the supervising physicians' provider status.

Network Specialist (Kaiser Plan): Medical Doctor with a specialty not considered primary care. Note: Physician Assistants and Nurse Practitioners may be treated as Primary Care Providers or Specialists based on the supervising physicians' provider status.

Network Skilled Nursing Facility (Kaiser Plan): A licensed facility that provides inpatient skilled nursing care, rehabilitation services, or other related health services that contracts with Kaiser Permanente to provide Covered Services. The facility's primary business is the provision of 24-hour-a-day skilled nursing care. The term "Skilled Nursing Facility" does not include convalescent nursing homes, rest facilities, or facilities for the aged, if those facilities furnish primarily custodial care, including training in routines of daily living. A "Skilled Nursing Facility" may also be a unit or section within another facility if it continues to meet the definition. **Physical functional disorder**—A limitation from normal (or baseline level) of physical functioning that may include, but is not limited to, problems with ambulation, mobilization, communication, respiration, eating, swallowing, vision, facial expression, skin integrity, distortion of nearby body parts or obstruction of an orifice. The physical functional impairment can be due to structure, congenital deformity, pain, or other causes. Physical functional impairment excludes social, emotional and psychological impairment or potential impairment.

New Prescription Drug Product - a Prescription Drug Product or new dosage form of a previously approved Prescription Drug Product, for the period of time starting on the date the Prescription Drug Product or new dosage form is approved by the *U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA)* and ending on the earlier of the following dates:

- The date it is placed on a tier by the Claims Administrator PDL Management Committee.
- December 31st of the following calendar year.

Observation Stay – Observation Stay care consists of evaluation, treatment, and monitoring services (beyond the scope of the usual outpatient care episode) that are reasonable and necessary to determine whether the patient will require further treatment as an inpatient or can be discharged from the hospital.

Physician—A state-licensed:

- Doctor of Medicine and Surgery (M.D.)
- Doctor of Osteopathy (D.O.)

In addition, professional services provided by one of the following types of providers will be treated as physician services under this plan to the extent the provider is providing a service that is within the scope of their state license and providing a service for which benefits are specified in this SPD and would be payable if the service were provided by a physician as defined above:

- Chiropractor (D.C.)
- Dentist (D.D.S. or D.M.D.)
- Optometrist (O.D.)
- Podiatrist (D.P.M.)
- Psychologist (Ph.D.)

- Advanced Registered Nurse Practitioner (A.R.N.P.)
- Nurse (R.N.)
- Naturopathic physician (N.D.)

Preventive Care—This plan covers preventive care as described below. “Preventive care” is a specific set of evidence-based services expected to prevent future illness. These services are based on guidelines established by government agencies and professional medical societies as required under the Affordable Care Act.

Preventive services have limits on how often you should get them and many of these limits are specific to gender, age or your personal risk factors for disease or condition. These limits are based on your age and gender. Some of the services you get as part of a routine exam may not meet preventive guidelines and would be covered as part of medical benefits.

The plan covers the following as preventive services:

- Covered preventive services include those with a Services with an “A” or “B” rating by the United States Preventive Task Force (USPTF);
- immunizations recommended by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention and as required by state law; and
- preventive care and screening recommended by the Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA).

Prescription drug—Any medical substance that cannot be dispensed without a prescription according to federal law. Only medically necessary prescription drugs are covered by this plan.

Prescription Drug Charge (Surest) - the rate the Plan has agreed to pay the Claims Administrator on behalf of its Network Pharmacies for a Prescription Drug Product dispensed at a Network Pharmacy. The rate includes any applicable dispensing fee and sales tax.

Prescription Drug List (Surest) - a list that places into tiers medications or products that have been approved by the *U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA)*. This list is subject to the Claims Administrator's review and change from time to time. You may find out to which tier a particular Prescription Drug Product has been placed by contacting the Claims Administrator at <https://benefits.surest.com>, the telephone number on your ID card, or the Surest mobile app.

Prescription Order or Refill (Surest) - the directive to dispense a Prescription Drug Product issued by a duly licensed health care provider whose scope of practice allows issuing such a directive.

Private Duty Nursing - Nursing care that is provided to a patient on a one-to-one basis by licensed nurses in an inpatient or an office/home setting when any of the following are true:

- Services exceed the scope of intermittent care in the home.
- Skilled nursing resources are available in the facility.
- The skilled care can be provided by a Home Health Agency on a per visit basis for a specific purpose
- The service is provided to a member by an independent nurse who is hired directly by the member or his/her family. This includes nursing services provided on an inpatient or a home care basis, whether the services is skilled or non-skilled independent nursing.

Provider Administered Drug – Medications that are typically given by a healthcare professional in a clinical setting, such as a physician's office or outpatient clinic. These drugs often require special handling, complex dosing regimens, or specific administration methods, such as injections or infusions.

Reconstructive - Surgery or procedure to restore or correct:

- A defective body part when such defect is incidental to or follows surgery resulting from illness, injury, or other diseases of the involved body part.
- A congenital disease or anomaly which has resulted in a functional defect as determined by a Physician.
- A physical defect that directly adversely affects the physical health of a body part, and the restoration of correction is determined by the Claim Administrator to be Medically Necessary

Respite care—Continuing to provide care in the temporary absence of the member's primary caregiver or caregivers.

Skilled home health care (Premera Plan)—Skilled home health care is reasonable and necessary care for treatment of an illness or injury that requires the skill of a nurse or therapist, based on the complexity of the service and the condition of the member. Services are performed directly by an appropriately licensed professional provider.

Skilled home health care (Kaiser Plan)—Covered Services for skilled home health care may include the following when rendered pursuant to a KFHPWA-approved home health care plan of treatment: nursing care; restorative physical, occupational, respiratory and speech therapy; durable medical equipment; medical social worker and limited home health aide services.

Skilled nursing care (Premera Plan) —Care provided by a registered nurse (RN) or licensed practical nurse (LPN) and the care must require the technical proficiency, scientific skills, and knowledge of an RN or LPN. The need for skilled nursing is determined by the condition of the patient, the nature of the services required, and the complexity or technical aspects of the services provided. Nursing care is not skilled simply because an RN or LPN delivers it or because a physician orders it.

Skilled nursing facility - A hospital or nursing facility that is licensed and operated as required by law. Medicare licensed bed or facility (including an extended care facility, a long-term acute care facility, a hospital swing-bed, and a transitional care unit) that provides skilled care.

Specialist - A Physician who has a majority of their practice in areas other than those practicing in the areas of family practice, general medicine, internal medicine, obstetrics/gynecology or general pediatrics

Specialty drugs—High-cost drugs, often self-injected and used to treat complex or rare conditions, including rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and hepatitis C. Specialty drugs may also require special handling or delivery. These medications can be dispensed only for up to a 30-day supply.

Surest Plan -The Surest health plan option described in the applicable sections the SPD.

Telehealth visit - Live, interactive audio with visual transmissions, and/or transmissions through federally compliant secure messaging applications of a Physician-patient encounter from one site to another using telecommunications technology. Telehealth/Telemedicine does not include virtual care services provided by a Designated Virtual Network Provider.

Therapeutically Equivalent (Surest) - when Prescription Drug Products have essentially the same efficacy and adverse effect profile.

Unproven Services (Surest) - Services, including medications and devices regardless of U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approval, that are not determined to be effective for treatment of the medical condition or not determined to have a beneficial effect on health outcomes due to insufficient and

inadequate clinical evidence from well-conducted randomized controlled trials or cohort studies in the prevailing published peer-reviewed medical literature:

- Well-conducted randomized controlled trials, (Two or more treatments are compared to each other, and the patient is not allowed to choose which treatment is received.
- Well-conducted cohort studies from more than one institution, (Patients who receive study treatment are compared to a group of patients who receive standard therapy. The comparison group must be nearly identical to the study treatment group.)

Surest has a process by which it compiles and reviews clinical evidence with respect to certain health services. From time-to-time Surest issues medical and drug policies that describe the clinical evidence available with respect to specific health care services. These medical and drug policies are subject to change without prior notice. You can contact Surest Member Services for additional information.

Please note: If you have a life-threatening sickness or condition (one that is likely to cause death within one year of the request for treatment), Surest may, at its discretion, consider an otherwise Unproven service to be a Covered Health Service for that sickness or condition. Prior to such a consideration, Surest must first establish that there is sufficient evidence to conclude that, even though Unproven, the service has significant potential as an effective treatment for that sickness or condition.

Urgent care—

- In the Premera health plans, a visit that is billed and covered at the same rate as an office visit with your regular physician and is a cost-effective option when you have an urgent need for care. Urgent care is the best option for treatment of a sudden illness, injury, or condition that:
 - Requires prompt medical attention to avoid serious deterioration of the member's health
 - Does not require the level of care provided in the emergency room or a hospital
 - Cannot be postponed until the member's physician is available

In the KFHPWA plan, inside the KFHPWA Service Area, urgent care is covered at a Kaiser Permanente medical center, Kaiser Permanente urgent care center or Network Provider's office. Outside the KFHPWA Service Area, urgent care is covered at any medical center.

Usual and Customary Charge (Surest) - the usual fee that a pharmacy charges individuals for a Prescription Drug Product without reference to reimbursement to the pharmacy by third parties. This fee includes any applicable dispensing fee and sales tax.

Value-based drugs—Drugs for chronic disease management such as diabetes, hyperlipidemia, heart failure and hypertension that are considered high value and are covered on a lower cost share tier.

Dental Care

Apicoectomy – Surgery on the root of the tooth.

Covered Dental Benefits - Those dental services that are covered under the Delta Dental Plus plan, subject to the Limitations set forth in the applicable "What the Plan Covers" section.

Deductible - The Deductible is the dollar amount you must pay to the provider for Covered Dental Benefits before your Plan begins paying benefits subject to the designated Coinsurance. The Deductible will reset and therefore need to be met each Plan Year.

Dentist – A licensed Dentist legally authorized to practice dentistry at the time and in the place where services are performed. This Plan provides for covered services only if those services are performed by or under direction of a licensed Dentist or other Licensed Professional operating within the scope of their license. .

Delivery Date – The date a prosthetic appliance is permanently cemented into place.

Emergency Dental Condition – The emergent and acute onset of a symptom or symptoms, including severe pain, that would lead a prudent layperson acting reasonably to believe that a dental condition exists that requires immediate dental attention, if failure to provide dental attention would result in serious impairment to oral functions or serious dysfunction of the mouth or teeth, or would place the person's oral health in serious jeopardy.

Emergency Oral Evaluation - Also known as a "limited oral evaluation – problem focused." Otherwise covered dental care services medically necessary to evaluate and treat an Emergency Dental Condition.

Endodontics - The diagnosis and treatment of dental diseases, including root canal treatment, affecting dental nerves and blood vessels.

Filed Fees - Approved fees that Delta Dental Participating Dentists have agreed is the maximum amount they will accept as the total fees for the specific services performed.

Licensed Professional - An individual legally authorized to perform services as defined in their license. Licensed Professional includes, but is not limited to a denturist, hygienist and radiology technician. Benefits under this Contract will not be denied for any health care service performed by a registered nurse or nurse practitioner licensed to practice under chapter 18.88 RCW, if first, the service performed was within the lawful scope of such nurse's license, and second, this Contract would have provided benefits if such service had been performed by a Doctor of Medicine licensed to practice under chapter 18.71 RCW.

Lifetime Maximum - The maximum amount DDWA will pay in the specified Covered Dental Benefit class for an individual during the time that individual is enrolled in this Plan or any other Plan offered by Microsoft.

Limitations - An exception or condition of coverage for a particular Covered Dental Benefit.

Maximum Allowable Fees - The maximum dollar amount that will be allowed toward the reimbursement for any service provided for a Covered Dental Benefit.

Non-Participating Dentist - A licensed Dentist who has not agreed to render services and receive payment in accordance with the terms and conditions of a written Member Dentist Agreement between a member of the Delta Dental Plans Association and such Dentist.

Not a Paid Covered Dental Benefit - Any dental procedure that is otherwise listed as a Covered Dental Benefit under the Delta Dental Plus Plan, but is not covered if certain conditions are not satisfied, such as clinical criteria or guidelines. The dental procedure would be a Covered Dental Benefit only if such applicable condition(s) were satisfied.

Occlusal Adjustment - Modification of the occluding surfaces of opposing teeth to develop harmonious relationships between the teeth themselves and neuromuscular mechanism, the Temporomandibular Joints and the structure supporting the teeth.

Orthodontia - Diagnosis, prevention, and treatment of irregularities in tooth and jaw alignment and function, frequently involving braces.

Palliative Treatment - Services provided for emergency relief of dental pain.

Plan Maximum The Plan Maximum is the maximum dollar amount DDWA will pay toward the cost of dental care per member within a specific calendar year, for the member's lifetime, or for another specified period, as applicable. The Plan Maximum for Covered Dental Benefits, including orthodontia, is listed in the Dental section of the SPD. Charges for dental procedures requiring multiple treatment dates are considered incurred on the date the services are completed, also known as the Seat Date. Amounts paid for such procedures will be applied to the Plan Maximum based on the incurred date.

Preventive Oral Evaluation – (Routine Examination) - An evaluation performed on a patient of record to determine any changes in the patient's dental and medical health status following a previous comprehensive or periodic evaluation.

Periodontics - The diagnosis, prevention, and treatment of diseases of gums and the bone that supports teeth.

Pocket Depth - An internal measurement from the top of the gum tissue to its attachment on the root of a tooth.

Prophylaxis - Cleaning and polishing of teeth.

Prosthodontics - The replacement of missing teeth by artificial means such as Bridges and Dentures.

Pulpotomy - The removal of nerve tissue from the crown portion of a tooth.

Seat Date - The date a Crown, Veneer, Inlay, or Onlay is permanently cemented into place on the tooth.

Specialist - A licensed Dentist who has successfully completed an educational program accredited by the Commission of Dental Accreditation, two or more years in length, as specified by the Council on Dental Education or holds a diploma from an American Dental Association recognized certifying board.

Plan Management

Allowable charge or allowed amount—

- In the Premera health plans, the negotiated amount that in-network providers have agreed to accept as payment in full for a covered service. The allowable charge for Washington or Alaska providers that don't have a contract with us is the least of the three amounts shown below. The allowable charge for providers outside Washington or Alaska that don't have a contract with us or the local Blue Cross and/or Blue Shield Licensee is also the least of the three amounts shown below:
 - An amount that is no less than the lowest amount we pay for the same or similar service from a comparable provider that has a contracting agreement with us
 - 125% of the fee schedule determined by the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (Medicare), if available
 - The provider's billed charges

Notwithstanding any provision of the plan to the contrary, the plan will pay any amounts required by applicable law. Out-of-network providers may not accept the allowable charge as payment in full. You are generally responsible for paying the difference between the allowable charge and the amount your out-of-network provider charges, unless otherwise provided under the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#). In the Premera medical and dental plans, only the allowable charge will be applied to your deductible, coinsurance maximum, and out-of-pocket maximum, as applicable.

- In the KFHPWA HMO plan, where expenses incurred from a non-KFHPWA provider or facility are covered under this SPD and the EOC, the negotiated amount that KFHPWA providers and facilities have agreed to accept as payment in full for those same services. The charges must be consistent with those normally charged to others by the provider or organization for the same services or supplies, and within the general range of charges made by other providers in the same geographical area for the same services or supplies. Members generally are responsible to pay any difference between the non-KFHPWA provider's or facility's charge for the services and the allowed amount, unless otherwise provided under the [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#).

For both Premera health plans and the KFHPWA HMO plan, solely for purposes of determining your cost-sharing obligations for claims subject to [Federal No Surprise Billing Protection](#), the allowed amount or allowable charge is the lesser of (1) the out-of-network provider's or facility's billed charges, or (2) the Plan's median in-network rate for the same or similar service provided in the same or similar specialty in the same geographic region (or any other amount specified for this purpose under applicable law).

Annual maximum (Premera Plans)—is the most the plan will pay for services for a member within a calendar year. If your employment or dependent status under the plan ends and you are hired or rehired within the same calendar year, the accumulated amount for that benefit carries over to your new enrollment.

Appeal—A written request to reconsider a written or official verbal adverse determination to deny, modify, reduce or end payment, coverage or authorization of health care coverage or eligibility to participate in the Plan. This includes admissions to, and continued stays in, a facility. The process also applies to Flexible Spending Account appeals for reimbursement but does not apply to appeals of denied COBRA eligibility claims.

Coinsurance—The percentage of the allowable charge that you are required to pay for certain covered services.

Coinsurance maximum—The maximum amount that you could pay each year in coinsurance amounts for covered services. If you seek care with out-of-network providers, only the allowable charge applies to the coinsurance maximum.

Copayment—A fixed, up-front dollar amount that you're required to pay for certain covered services.

Deductible—The amount of covered medical costs you must pay each calendar year before the plan begins to pay its share of allowable charges.

Evidence of Coverage (EOC)—A document outlining details of benefits coverage under the Kaiser Permanente HMO Plan.

Explanation of benefits statement (EOB)—The statement you receive from Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Delta Dental of Washington, EyeMed, KFHPWA, or Kaiser Permanente detailing how much the provider billed, how much (if any) the plan paid, and the amount that you owe the provider (if any).

Health Maintenance Organization (HMO)—A health care plan such as Microsoft offers with KFHPWA or Kaiser Permanente that covers only those services and supplies that are received from in-network providers and facilities. Out-of-network care is covered only under a few circumstances. Providers are all part of the same integrated health care system, so they can quickly share your medical records to help make informed decisions about care.

Independent review organization (IRO)—An independent organization of medical experts who are qualified to review medical and other relevant information.

In-network—Physicians, hospitals and other providers who have contracted with your plan administrator (Premera, Surest, KFHPWA or Kaiser Permanente) to provide services at a negotiated discount rate. In-network providers agree to accept network rates and will not bill you for any amount in excess of those rates. In-network providers also agree to bill your medical plan directly, so you will not have to pay up front and submit your own claim to Premera or Surest for reimbursement.

Lifetime benefit maximum—Generally the maximum amount a plan will pay toward a benefit for a member. For more information, refer to the section of this SPD describing the specific benefit and plan at issue.

Medically necessary—A covered service or supply that meet certain criteria including:

- It is essential to the diagnosis or the treatment of an illness, accidental injury, or condition that is harmful or threatening to the enrollee's life or health, unless it is provided for preventive services when specified as covered under this plan.
- It is appropriate for the medical condition as specified in accordance with authoritative medical or scientific literature and generally accepted standards of medical practice.
- It is a medically effective treatment of the diagnosis as demonstrated by the following criteria:
 - There is sufficient evidence to draw conclusions about the positive effect of the health intervention on health outcome
 - The evidence demonstrates that the health intervention can be expected to produce its intended effects on health outcomes
 - The expected beneficial effects of the health intervention on health outcomes outweigh the expected harmful effects of the health intervention.
- It is cost-effective, as determined by being the least expensive of the alternative supplies or levels of service that are medically effective and that can be safely provided to the enrollee. A health intervention is cost-effective if no other available health intervention offers a clinically appropriate benefit at a lower cost.
- It is not primarily for research or data accumulation.
- It is not primarily for the comfort or convenience of the enrollee, the enrollee's family, the enrollee's physician or another provider.
- It is not recreational, life-enhancing, relaxation or palliative therapy, except for treatment of terminal conditions.

For these purposes, "generally accepted standards of medical practice" means standards that are based on credible scientific evidence published in peer-reviewed medical literature that is generally recognized by the relevant medical community, Physician Specialty Society recommendations, the views of physicians practicing in relevant clinical areas, and any other relevant factors.

Other benefit maximum—is the most the plan will pay for services for a member within the time specified for that benefit. If your employment or dependent status under the plan ends and you are hired or rehired within such specified time, the accumulated amount for that benefit carries over to your new enrollment.

Out-of-pocket maximum—The maximum amount that you could pay each plan year for covered services and supplies, including deductibles, copayments, and coinsurance, as applicable, unless otherwise provided in this SPD.

Personal Health Support (Premera Plan)—The plan offers participation in Premera's personal health support services to help members with such things as managing complex medical conditions, a recent surgery, or admission to a hospital. Services include:

- Helping to overcome barriers to health improvement or following providers' treatment plan
- Coordinating care services including access
- Helping to understand the health plan's coverage
- Finding community resources

Participation is voluntary. To learn more about the personal health support programs, contact Customer Service at the phone number listed on the back of your ID card.

Plan Year - The calendar year.

Prior Authorization (Surest) – Pre-service, urgent care request, pre-admissions notification, concurrent care benefit coverage decision for a service, procedure or test that has been subject to an evidence-based review resulting in a Medical Necessity determination. Select services require Prior Authorization.

Prior authorization—An advance determination by Premera or KFHPWA that the service is medically necessary, and that the member's plan has benefits available for the service being requested. This determination is offered in certain situations where medical records must be provided to establish medical necessity before the plan will pay for the service. Services are subject to eligibility and benefits at the time of service.

Although not required, prior authorization is available and strongly recommended to ensure that coverage will be provided for services that include (but are not limited to) the following:

- Scheduled admission into hospitals or skilled nursing facilities
- Advanced imaging, such as MRIs and CT scans
- Some planned outpatient procedures, such as facility sleep studies and varicose vein treatment
- Some injectable medications you get in a health care provider's office, such as Interferon, Synagis and Xolair
- Knee arthroscopy or knee arthroplasty
- Home medical equipment costing \$500 or more

Qualified Medical Child Support Order (QMCSO)—An order or judgment from a court or administrative body directing the plan to cover the child of a member as required by applicable law.

Residential Treatment (Surest) - Treatment in a facility which provides Mental Health or Substance Use Disorder treatment. The facility must meet all of the following requirements:

- It is established and operated in accordance with applicable state law for Residential Treatment programs.
- It provides a program of treatment under the active participation and direction of a Physician.
- It offers organized treatment services that feature a planned and structured regimen of care in a 24-hour setting and provides at least the following basic services:
 - Room and board.
 - Evaluation and diagnosis.
 - Counseling.
 - Referral and orientation to specialized community resources.

A Residential Treatment facility that qualifies as a hospital is considered a hospital

Residential treatment center or services—Facility-based treatment providing active Residential Treatment in a controlled environment. At least weekly physician visits are required, and services must offer treatment by a multi-disciplinary team of licensed professionals.

Standard reference compendia—Refers to the American Hospital Formulary Service—Drug Information; the American Medical Association Drug Evaluation; the United States Pharmacopoeia—Drug Information, or other authoritative compendia as identified from time to time by the Federal Secretary of Health and Human Services. "Peer-reviewed medical literature" means scientific studies printed in health care journals or other publications in which original manuscripts are published only after having been critically reviewed for scientific accuracy, validity, and reliability by unbiased independent experts. Peer-reviewed medical literature does not include in-house publications of pharmaceutical manufacturing companies.

Urgent situation—When an appeal is under consideration, a situation in which your provider concludes that the application of the standard time periods for making determinations could seriously jeopardize your life or health or your ability to regain maximum function or would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without the care or treatment.

Coordination of benefits terms

Coordination of benefits (COB)—A process where you or your covered dependents who have health benefit coverage through another employer, a government plan, or other motor vehicle or liability insurance, combine coverage to maximize benefits. Your Microsoft medical and dental benefits are subject to COB. The two plans coordinate their payment of benefits to ensure the total paid by both plans will not exceed the total amount charged.

Primary plan—The health plan that pays benefits first when a member has coverage from more than one health plan.

Secondary plan—The health plan that pays benefits second when a member has coverage from more than one health plan. The secondary plan pays the balance for eligible expenses, subject to its plan benefits and limitations.

Long-term disability (LTD) terms

Absence of legal capacity—An individual is no longer able to act on their own behalf. Ultimately, the individual is not able to execute legal documents.

Chronic illness or disability—One in which there is one of the following:

- A loss of the ability to perform, without substantial assistance, at least two activities of daily living for a period of at least 30 consecutive days
- A severe cognitive impairment, which requires substantial supervision to protect the family member from threats to health and safety, for a period of at least 30 consecutive days

Confined or confinement—As related to the Maximum Period of Payment benefit, a hospital stay of at least eight hours per day.

Continued health care coverage costs means the actual costs to you for continued health care coverage provided through your employer, and which you elect under COBRA or similar state law.

Cognitive impairment—A loss or deterioration in intellectual capacity that is:

- Comparable to and includes Alzheimer's disease and similar forms of irreversible dementia
- Measured by clinical evidence and standardized tests that reliably measure impairment in the individual's short-term or long-term memory, orientation as to person, place, or time; and deductive or abstract reasoning

Disability earnings—The earnings you receive while you are disabled and working, plus the earnings you could receive if you were working to your greatest extent possible. This would be, based on your restrictions and limitations, as follows:

- During the first 24 months of disability payments, the greatest extent of work you are able to do in your regular occupation that is reasonably available
- Beyond 24 months of disability payments, the greatest extent of work you are able to do in any occupation that is reasonably available, for which you are reasonably fitted by education, training, or experience

Earnings calculation date—Your Earnings Calculation Date is defined as the latest of (1) the date you meet the definition of disability under the Group Contract; (2) the date you commence an approved disability leave of absence or workers' compensation leave of absence; or (3) if you do not complete the 182-day elimination period within one year (365 days) from the date you met the definition of disability, and as a result you have to start a new 182-day elimination period, the date immediately preceding commencement of the new 182-day elimination period.

Elimination period—182 days of continuous disability from your injury or onset of your illness or when you've exhausted your short-term disability benefits, whichever is later, which must be satisfied before you are eligible to receive benefits from Prudential. If you become covered under a group LTD plan that replaces this plan during your elimination period, your elimination period under this plan will not be met.

Gainful occupation—An occupation, including self-employment, that can be expected to provide you with an income within 12 months of your return to work that exceeds your LTD payment, if you are not working, or 80% of your monthly earnings, if you are working.

Gross LTD payment—The benefit amount before Prudential subtracts deductible sources of income and disability earnings.

Indexed monthly earnings—Your monthly earnings, adjusted by the lesser of 10% or the current annual percentage increase in the Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W). Adjustments are made on each July 1, provided you were disabled for all of the 12 months before that date. Your indexed monthly earnings may increase or remain the same but will never decrease.

Material and substantial duties—Those duties normally required as part of a job that cannot be reasonably omitted or modified. If you are required to work on average more than 40 hours per week, you are considered able to meet this duty if you are able to work 40 hours per week.

Monthly earnings—Is your gross monthly income just prior to the Earnings Calculation Date. Monthly earnings include your base salary and the average commissions, bonuses and overtime pay earned per month during the shorter of: (i) the 12-month period just prior to the later of your Earnings Calculation Date; or (ii) your period of employment. Monthly earnings income does not include income received from any other extra compensation, or income received from sources other than Microsoft. If you become disabled while you are on a covered layoff or leave of absence, we will use your monthly earnings from your Employer in effect just prior to the date your absence begins.

Monthly payment—The payment you may receive if you become disabled while covered by this plan.

Preexisting Condition—You have a preexisting condition if both 1 and 2 are true:

1. You received medical treatment, consultation, care or services, including diagnostic measures, or took prescribed drugs or medicines, or followed treatment recommendation in the three months just prior to your effective date of coverage or the date an increase in benefits would otherwise be available
2. Your date of disability begins within 12 months of the date your coverage under the Plan becomes effective.

Recurrent disability—An injury or illness that worsens and is due to one or more of the same causes as a prior disability for which Prudential made an LTD payment.

Regular care—

- You personally visit a doctor as frequently as is medically required, according to generally accepted medical standards, to effectively manage and treat your disabling condition or conditions
- You are receiving the most appropriate treatment and care, which conforms with generally accepted medical standards, for your disabling condition or conditions by a doctor whose specialty or experience is the most appropriate for your disabling condition or conditions, according to generally accepted medical standards

Salary continuation or accumulated sick leave—Continued payments to you by Microsoft of all or part of your monthly earnings after you become disabled as defined by the Group Contract. This continued payment must be part of an established plan or program maintained by Microsoft for the benefit of an employee covered under the Group Contract. Salary continuation or accumulated sick leave does not include compensation paid to you by Microsoft for work you actually perform after your disability begins. Such compensation is considered disability earnings, and would be taken into account as such, in calculating your monthly payment.

Substantial assistance—One of the following:

- The physical assistance of another person without which the family member would not be able to perform an activity of daily living
- The constant presence of another person within arm's reach who is necessary to prevent, by physical intervention, injury to the family member while the family member is performing an activity of daily living

Substantial supervision—Continual oversight that may include cueing by verbal prompting, gestures, or other demonstrations by another person, and that is necessary to protect you or the family from threats to your or the family member's health or safety.

How to get help

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General benefits questions

Benefits contact information	Active employees/dependents	COBRA enrollees
Email address	benefits@microsoft.com	n/a
Website	http://benefits.me.microsoft.com	http://cobra.me.microsoft.com
Telephone number	(425) 706-8853	(833) 253-4929

Medical

Premera plans

Premera plans contact information	
Email address	microsoft@premera.com
Website	https://www.premera.com/
Telephone number	(800) 676-1411
Group Number	1000010

Surest

Surest plans contact information	
Website	https://benefits.surest.com
Telephone number	1-866-222-1298

Group Number	78800680
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HMO plan (Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington)—Washington only

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington contact information	
Email address	Email Member Services
Website	https://wa.kaiserpermanente.org
Telephone number	(206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636
Group Number	172300

HMO plan (Kaiser Permanente)—California only

Kaiser Permanente California contact information	
Website	https://healthy.kaiserpermanente.org/health/care/consumer/member-assistance
Telephone number	(800) 464-4000
Group Number	Northern California 603873 Southern California 231325

Dental

Delta Dental of Washington contact information	
Email address	Microsoft@DeltaDentalWA.com
Website	www.deltadentalwa.com
Telephone number	(833) 642-8800
Group Number	06250

Vision

EyeMed contact information	
Email address	
Website	eyemed.com/microsoft
Telephone number	1-844-844-0920
Group Number	

Spring Health employee assistance program (EAP)

Spring Health contact information

Website	https://microsoft.springhealth.com/
Telephone number	(855) 629-0554

Health Savings Accounts and Flexible Spending Accounts

Fidelity contact information

Website	www.netbenefits.com
Telephone number	(888) 810-MSFT (6738)

Life insurance

If you want to...	Go here...
Learn more about your life insurance coverage or Evidence of Insurability (EOI)	Contact Prudential at (800) 778-3827 or microsoft@prudential.com Group Number: 43994
Change or designate a beneficiary	Benefits Enrollment tool (aka.ms/benefitsenroll)

Accidental death & dismemberment (AD&D)

Prudential contact information

Email address	microsoft@prudential.com
Website	https://www.prudential.com/wps/portal/production/prudential/gimicro/microsoft
Telephone number	(800) 778-3827
Group Number	43994

Group legal

MetLife contact information

Email address	
Website	Active employees MetLife Legal Plans COBRA enrollees https://login.legalplans.com/register?
Telephone number	855-234-1844 8:00 AM-8:00 PM, Pacific Time Monday through Friday

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COBRA enrollees – the Important notices section applies

Administrative information

ERISA requires that certain information be furnished to each participant in an employee benefit plan.

- **Plan name**
Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan
- **Plan number**
501
- **Plan year**
January 1 to December 31
- **Plan sponsor**
Microsoft Corporation
- **Employer identification number**
91-1144442
- **Type of plan**
Welfare benefit plan providing health and welfare benefits
- **Plan administrator and named fiduciary**
Microsoft Corporation
One Microsoft Way
Redmond, WA 98052-6399
(425) 882-8080

• **Participating employers**

Participating employer name	Company code
Vexcel Corporation	1693
Microsoft Payments, Inc	1888
Microsoft Open Technologies, Inc	1899
Microsoft Operations Licensing Corporation	1654
Microsoft Online, Inc	1548
Microsoft Technology Licensing	1988

- **Source of contributions**
Pre-tax and after-tax employee contributions, and employer contributions

• **Funding**

Health care and dependent care reimbursement benefits	Funded through the employer's general assets
Health, vision, and dental benefits	Funded from the general assets of Microsoft Corporation and employee contributions
Group term life insurance Long-term disability benefits	Provided through the purchase of insurance from Prudential Life Insurance Provided through the purchase of insurance from Prudential Insurance Provided through the purchase of insurance from Prudential Insurance

Section XVI: Important notices

Health care and dependent care reimbursement benefits	Funded through the employer's general assets
Accidental death and dismemberment benefits	
Employee assistance benefits	Funded through the employer's general assets
Group legal benefits	Provided through the purchase of insurance from MetLife

- **Type of administration**

The Plan is administered by Microsoft according to the terms of the plan documents. Under the terms of the plan, Microsoft has the authority to delegate the day-to-day administrative duties to a third party. Microsoft shall have complete discretion to interpret and construe the provisions of the plan options, programs, and policies described in this SPD, to determine eligibility for participation and for benefits, make findings of fact, correct errors and supply omissions. All decisions and interpretations Microsoft made pursuant to the plan options, programs and policies described in this SPD shall be final, conclusive and binding on all persons and may not be overturned unless found by a court to be arbitrary and capricious, or unless found by an independent medical review organization, after external review, to be made in error. Microsoft may delegate this discretionary authority to select service providers, and hereby delegates such authority to each service provider to the extent that the service provider is responsible for reviewing and issuing claims and appeals determinations under the respective plan options, programs, and policies described in this SPD.

- **Agent for legal process**

Senior Vice-President, Law and Corporate Affairs
Microsoft Corporation
One Microsoft Way
Redmond, WA 98052-6399
Service of process may also be made upon the Plan Administrator.

Microsoft, as plan sponsor, has reserved the right to amend or terminate the Welfare Plan and any Component Plan, in whole or in part, at any time and for any reason, including contributions to the Plan. See [Right to amend or terminate plan](#) section for more information.



If you have questions regarding the Plan's administration, contact Benefits by e-mail at benefits@microsoft.com or by phone at (425) 706-8853.

False or misleading statements

Any falsification, misrepresentation, or omission of facts or information by you on your enrollment form, benefits enrollment tool, or claim form may result in your loss of coverage and in disciplinary action, up to and including your dismissal from employment at Microsoft. Electronic communications on enrollment or claims are considered written and signed representations. If you lose your coverage, you will not be eligible for any continuation of coverage except to the extent required by the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act of 1985 ("COBRA"). The company retains the right to request confirmation of a dependent relationship by way of birth and/or marriage certificate, domestic partnership affidavit, court documents, and so on, and to recoup any payments made to you in error or in reliance on inaccurate or incomplete information.

Fraud and abuse

Any participant who willfully and knowingly engages in an activity intended to defraud the plan will face disciplinary action that may include Microsoft rescinding the participant's coverage under this plan, the termination of employment, and prosecution. Examples of fraud include falsifying a claim to obtain benefits or trying to obtain services for someone who is not an eligible dependent or who is no longer enrolled in the plan. The company retains the right to request confirmation of a dependent relationship by way of birth and/or marriage certificate, domestic partnership affidavit, court documents, and so on, to deny coverage for any dependents if such confirmation is not provided, and to recoup any payments made to you in error or in reliance on inaccurate or incomplete information.

If you have questions regarding the Plan's administration, contact Benefits.



Active employees/dependents go here...

e-mail benefits@microsoft.com

phone (425) 706-8853

COBRA enrollees go here...

e-mail benefits@benefits.microsoft.com

phone (833) 253-4929

Right to review

The plan may have any patient examined by an appropriate health care professional when there is a question of fraud or abuse of plan benefits.

How to report suspicious activity to Premera, Surest, or Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington

If you suspect fraud or abuse, there are several reporting options available to you. All reports are confidential and can be anonymous, if you choose. You are not required to include your name, address, or other identifying information.

For Premera, you may contact the Special Investigations Unit 24 hours a day by leaving a telephone message on the confidential fraud hotline or by mail.

Hotline: (800) 848-0244

Mailing address:

Attention Special Investigations Unit
Premera Blue Cross
7001 220th Street SW
Mail Stop 219
Mountlake Terrace, WA 98043

For Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington, you may contact the Fraud, Waste and Abuse (FWA) Department by e-mail, phone or mail.

E-mail: FWA@kp.org

Confidential, toll-free hotline: (888) 774-9100

FWA Department: (206) 988-2967

Mailing address:

Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington
Regional Fraud Control

PO Box 9813
Mailstop RCP-C3W-08
Renton, WA 98057-9813

For Surest, you may contact the Fraud, Waste and Abuse (FWA) Department by e-mail, phone or mail.

Surest
PO Box 211758
Eagan, MN 55121
Member Services: (866) 222-1298

For Delta Dental of Washington, you may contact the Fraud, Waste and Abuse (FWA) Department by phone at 800-554-1907.

When reporting suspected fraud, remember to include the names of all applicable parties involved. Specify which person you believe is committing the fraud, identify the dates of service or issues in question, and describe in detail why you believe a fraudulent act may have occurred. If possible, include your name and telephone number so Premiera, Surest, Delta Dental of Washington, or Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington may contact you if they have any questions during their investigation.

Right to amend or terminate plan

Microsoft has reserved the right to amend or terminate the Welfare Plan and any Component Plan, in whole or in part, at any time and for any reason, including contributions to the Plan. Payment of claims incurred at the time of such amendment or termination will not be adversely affected.

Coverage under the Dependent Care Reimbursement Plan, Health Care Reimbursement Plan, and Limited Purpose Health Care Reimbursement Plan will provide reimbursement of Eligible Expenses incurred prior to the date of termination of such Component Plan. Such Expenses will be reimbursed only if the Request for Reimbursement is submitted within ninety (90) days after date of termination.

Participant rights under ERISA

The Employee Retirement Income Security Act (ERISA) provides that all plan participants are entitled to the following:

- Examine, without charge, all documents that govern the plan including insurance contracts and a copy of the latest annual report (Form 5500 Series), which the plan files with the U.S. Department of Labor and is available at the Public Disclosure Room of the Employee Benefits Security Administration, at the plan administrator's office, and at other specified locations, such as worksites
- Obtain, upon written request to the plan administrator, copies of documents that govern the operation of the plan, including insurance contracts, copies of the latest annual report (Form 5500 Series), and updated summary plan descriptions. The administrator may make a reasonable charge for the copies.
- Receive the **Summary Annual Report** for Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan. The plan administrator is required by law to furnish each participant with a copy of this summary financial report.
- Continue health care coverage for yourself, spouse, or dependents if there is a loss of coverage under the plan as a result of a qualifying event. You or your dependents will have to pay for such coverage. Review this summary plan description and the documents that govern the plan about the rules governing your COBRA continuation coverage rights.

In addition to creating rights for plan participants, ERISA imposes obligations on those responsible for the operation of an employee benefit plan. The people who operate the plan, called "fiduciaries" of the plan, have a duty to do so prudently and in the interest of all plan participants and beneficiaries.

No one, including Microsoft or any other person, may terminate you or otherwise discriminate against you in any way to prevent you from obtaining a benefit or exercising your rights under ERISA.

If a claim for a benefit is denied or ignored, in whole or in part, you have the right to know why this was done, to obtain copies of documents that relate to the decision (without charge), and to appeal any denial all within certain time schedules.

Under ERISA, there are steps you can take to enforce the previously stated rights. For instance, if you request materials from the plan and do not receive them within 30 days, you may file suit in federal court. In such a case, the court may require the plan administrator to provide the materials and pay you up to US\$110 a day until you receive the materials, unless the plan administrator did not send the materials because of reasons beyond the control of the administrator.

If you have a claim for benefits that is denied or ignored, in whole or in part, you may file suit in a state or federal court. In addition, if you disagree with the plan's decision or lack thereof concerning the qualified status of a domestic relations order or a medical child support order, you may file suit in federal court. If plan fiduciaries misuse the plan's money, or if you are discriminated against for asserting your rights, you may seek assistance from the U.S. Department of Labor, or file suit in a federal court. The court will decide who should pay court costs and legal fees. If you are successful, the court may order the person sued to pay these costs and fees. If you lose, the court may order you to pay these costs and fees; for example, if it finds the claim to be frivolous.

If you have any questions about your plan, you should contact Microsoft. If you have any questions about this statement or about your rights under ERISA, contact the nearest office of the Employee Benefits

Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor that your telephone directory lists, or you can contact the Division of Technical Assistance and Inquiries, Employee Benefits Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor, 200 Constitution Avenue NW, Washington, DC 20210. You may also obtain certain publications about your rights and responsibilities under ERISA by calling the publications hotline of the Employee Benefits Security Administration.



To access plan administrator information, see [Administrative Information](#) or contact Benefits.

Special notice about Newborns' and Mothers' Health Protection Act

Group health plans and health insurance issuers that offer group insurance coverage generally may not, under federal law restrict benefits for any hospital length of stay in connection with childbirth for the mother or newborn child to less than 48 hours following a vaginal delivery or less than 96 hours following a cesarean section. However, federal law generally does not prohibit the mother's or newborn's attending provider, after consulting with the mother, from discharging the mother or her newborn earlier than 48 hours (or 96 hours as applicable). In any case, plans and issuers may not, under federal law, require that a provider obtain authorization from the plan or the insurance issuer for prescribing a length of stay not in excess of 48 hours (or 96 hours).

This plan complies with these requirements.

Special notice about Women's Health and Cancer Rights Act

As required by the Women's Health and Cancer Rights Act of 1998, the plan provides benefits for mastectomy-related services including all stages of reconstruction and surgery to achieve symmetry between the breasts, prostheses, and complications resulting from a mastectomy, including lymphedemas. You can contact Benefits or call (425) 706-8853 for more information.

The Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) of 1996

Notice of your right to documentation

Prior to the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act (ACA), federal law allowed employers to apply limitations on paying benefits for preexisting medical conditions for newly hired or newly eligible employees and covered family members. The ACA outlawed this practice as of 1/1/2014 for most health insurance plans. If you terminate employment with Microsoft and begin to work for another employer, you should receive the full benefit for any covered condition, subject to your new plan's standard cost sharing or other limitations, as applicable once you meet the employer's eligibility criteria and enroll in benefits. Should you need a statement confirming you previously had coverage under a Microsoft plan, you can obtain one by contacting Benefits.

Notice of your special enrollment rights

If you decline enrollment for yourself or your dependents (including your spouse) because of other health insurance or group health plan coverage, you may be able to enroll yourself and your dependents in this plan if you or your dependents lose eligibility for that other coverage (or if the employer stopped contributing towards your or your dependents' other coverage). However, you must request enrollment within 30 days* after your or your dependents' other coverage ends (or after the employer stops contributing toward the other coverage).

If you or any of your dependents were covered under a Medicaid or State child health plan and you or your dependents lose eligibility for that coverage, or if you or any of your dependents become eligible for assistance with respect to coverage under this plan due to a Medicaid or State child health plan, you may be able to enroll yourself and your dependents in this plan. However, you must request enrollment within 60 days after your or your dependents' other coverage ends, or within 60 days* of becoming eligible for assistance.

In addition, if you have a new dependent as a result of marriage, birth, adoption, placement for adoption, or legal guardianship, or establishment of a domestic partnership, you may be able to enroll yourself and your dependents. However, you must request enrollment within 90 days after the marriage, birth, adoption, placement for adoption, or legal guardianship.



To request special enrollment or obtain more information, see the [Life event enrollment](#) section or contact Benefits.

HIPAA Notice of Privacy Practices

Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan HIPAA Notice of Privacy Practices

THIS NOTICE DESCRIBES HOW MEDICAL INFORMATION ABOUT YOU MAY BE USED AND DISCLOSED AND HOW YOU CAN GET ACCESS TO THIS INFORMATION. PLEASE REVIEW IT CAREFULLY.

Effective Date: April 14, 2003, revised effective February 16, 2026

This Notice is from the Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan (the "Plan"), which is sponsored by Microsoft Corporation. A federal regulation, known as the HIPAA Privacy Rule, requires that a health plan provide detailed notice in writing of its privacy practices. You may receive other notices of privacy practices from other parties that are considered "covered entities" under HIPAA (for instance, physicians, the Living Well Health Center, Kaiser Permanente).

The Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan includes health care benefits, making it a health plan covered by the HIPAA Privacy Rule. Health care benefits under the Plan include the medical, prescription drug, vision, and dental benefits; the employee assistance program; and the flexible spending arrangements (namely the Microsoft Health Care and Dental & Vision Care Reimbursement Plans). Non-health care benefits under the Plan, including long-term and short-term disability plans, are not covered by the HIPAA Privacy Rule.

I. OUR COMMITMENT TO PROTECTING HEALTH INFORMATION ABOUT YOU

The HIPAA Privacy Rule requires that we protect the privacy of health information that identifies a participant or beneficiary under the Plan, or where there is a reasonable basis to believe the information can be used to identify a participant or beneficiary under the Plan. This information is called "protected health information" or "PHI." Generally, PHI also includes genetic and demographic information, collected from you or created or received by the Plan, that relates to (1) your past, present or future physical or mental health or condition; (2) the provision of health care to you; or (3) the past, present or future payment for the provision of health care to you.

This Notice describes your rights as a health plan participant and our obligations regarding the use and disclosure of PHI. We are required by law to comply with all of the following:

- Maintain the privacy of PHI about you
- Provide you with certain rights with respect to your PHI
- Give you this Notice of our legal duties and privacy practices with respect to PHI
- Comply with the terms of our Notice of Privacy Practices that is currently in effect

- Notify you of a breach of your unsecured PHI

In some situations, federal and state laws that are more stringent than HIPAA provide special protections for specific kinds of PHI and may require authorization from you before we can disclose that specially protected PHI. Examples of PHI that is sometimes specially protected include PHI involving mental health, HIV/AIDS, reproductive health, or substance use disorder treatment records. We may refuse to disclose the specially protected PHI or otherwise comply with the applicable law, or we may contact you for the necessary authorization.

We will never use or disclose any substance use disorder treatment records (nor testimony relaying the contents of those records), which were received from a federally-assisted treatment program subject to 42 C.F.R. Part 2, in any civil, criminal, administrative, or legislative proceedings against you, unless you have provided written consent or we receive a valid court order accompanied by a subpoena or other legal requirement that compels us to make the use or disclosure.

We reserve the right to make changes to this Notice, which will be incorporated and published in the Plan's SPD as soon as reasonably practicable, and to make such changes effective for all PHI we may already have about you.

II. HOW WE MAY USE AND DISCLOSE PROTECTED HEALTH INFORMATION ABOUT YOU

We may use or disclose your PHI under certain circumstances as permitted or required by law or if you (or your authorized representative) give us permission. Any such PHI that we disclose under these circumstances may be subject to redisclosure by the recipient and no longer protected by HIPAA. The following describes the different ways we may use and disclose your PHI. However, if the PHI consists of substance use disorder treatment records from a federally-assisted treatment program subject to 42 C.F.R. Part 2, then we generally cannot use or disclose the PHI without your consent, except in the event of an emergency.

Treatment: We may use and disclose PHI about you to assist your health care provider in coordinating or managing your health care and related services. For example, a doctor may send us information about your diagnosis and treatment plan, so we can arrange additional services.

Payment: We may use or disclose PHI to pay or deny your claims, to collect premiums, or for the payment activities of your health care providers or your other insurer(s). For example, we may use and disclose PHI to tell you, your health care providers, or your other caregivers whether a particular type of health care service is covered under your policy.

Health Care Operations: We may use and disclose PHI in performing business activities that are called "health care operations." For example, we may use and disclose PHI about you in reviewing and improving the quality, efficiency, and cost of our operations, or for purposes of analyzing the quality and effectiveness of different Plan benefits in which you may or may not participate. We may disclose PHI to other entities, if any, in an organized health care arrangement with the Plan. For example, if a health care provider, company, or other health plan that is required to comply with the HIPAA Privacy Rule has or

once had a relationship with you, we may disclose PHI about you for certain health care operations of that health care provider or company.

Business Associates: We may contract with individuals or entities known as "business associates" to perform various functions on the Plan's behalf or to provide certain types of services. In order to perform these functions or to provide these services, business associates will receive, create, maintain, use and/or disclose your PHI, but only after they agree in writing with us to implement appropriate safeguards regarding your PHI. For example, we may disclose your PHI to a business associate to administer claims or to provide support services, such as utilization management, pharmacy benefit management or subrogation.

Individuals Involved in Your Care or Payment for Your Care: If you do not object after an opportunity to do so, or if you are incapacitated or if it is an emergency situation, we may disclose to your family member, close friend, or any other person identified by you, PHI about you that is directly relevant to that person's involvement in your care or payment for your care. We may also use and disclose PHI necessary to notify these persons of your location, general condition, or death. State laws will vary, but in many states a teenage minor must consent to use, or disclosure of PHI related to their mental health, chemical dependency, HIV/AIDS, or sexual health. Therefore, the Plan may require the child's authorization before releasing PHI to anyone, including their parents.

Disaster Relief: We also may share PHI about you with disaster relief agencies such as the Red Cross for disaster relief purposes.

Required by Law: We may use and disclose PHI to the extent required by law.

Incidental Disclosures: Disclosures that are incidental to permitted or required uses or disclosures under HIPAA are permissible so long as we implement safeguards to avoid such disclosures and limit the PHI exposed through these incidental disclosures.

Health Plan Sponsor: Under certain conditions, we may disclose PHI to the Plan Sponsor of this Plan (Microsoft Corporation) as permitted by HIPAA, but only after the Plan Sponsor certifies that it will take certain steps to protect the confidentiality of your PHI. This may include disclosures to the Plan Sponsor of basic enrollment/disenrollment and participation information, summary health information, and other PHI in furtherance of Plan administration functions such as eligibility, enrollment, and claims administration.

Public Health or Oversight Activities: We may use and disclose PHI to authorized persons to carry out certain activities related to public health. We may disclose PHI to a health oversight agency to monitor the health care system, government health care programs, and compliance with certain laws.

Abuse, Neglect, or Domestic Violence: We may disclose PHI in certain cases to proper government authorities if we reasonably believe that a participant has been a victim of domestic violence, abuse, or neglect.

Lawsuits and Other Legal Proceedings: We may use or disclose PHI when required by a court order, administrative agency order, subpoenas, discovery requests, or other lawful process, when efforts have been made to advise you of the disclosure or to obtain an order protecting the information requested.

To Law Enforcement or to Avert a Serious Threat to Health or Safety: Under certain conditions, we may disclose PHI to law enforcement officials. We may use and disclose your PHI under limited circumstances when necessary to prevent a threat to the health or safety of a person or to the public.

Coroners, Medical Examiners, Funeral Directors: We may disclose PHI to a coroner or medical examiner to identify a deceased person and determine the cause of death, or to funeral directors, as authorized by law, so that they may carry out their jobs.

Organ and Tissue Donation: If you are an organ donor, we may use or disclose PHI to facilitate an organ, eye, or tissue donation and transplantation.

Research: We may use and disclose PHI about you for research purposes under certain limited circumstances.

Specialized Government Functions: Under certain conditions, we may disclose PHI for military activities, national security, or other specialized government functions.

Workers' Compensation: We may disclose PHI to the extent necessary to comply with laws that provide benefits for work-related injuries or illness.

Disclosures Required by HIPAA Privacy Rule: We are required to disclose PHI to the Secretary of the United States Department of Health and Human Services when requested by the Secretary to review our compliance with the HIPAA Privacy Rule.

Other Uses and Disclosures: All other uses and disclosures of your PHI will be made only with your written permission (an "authorization"). We generally may not use or disclose your PHI for marketing purposes or sell your PHI without your authorization. If you have given us authorization to use or disclose your PHI, you may later take back ("revoke") your authorization at any time, except to the extent we have already acted based on your permission.

Genetic Information: We may not use or disclose PHI that is genetic information for underwriting purposes.

III. YOUR RIGHTS REGARDING PROTECTED HEALTH INFORMATION ABOUT YOU

Under federal law, you have the following rights regarding PHI about you. Unless otherwise noted, you may exercise any of these rights by contacting the Privacy Operations Official or Privacy Official identified in Section V below.

Right to Request Restrictions: You have the right to request additional restrictions on the use of your PHI for treatment, payment, and health care operations, or on the disclosure of your PHI to individuals involved in your care. We are not required to agree to your request unless the disclosure is to a health plan for purposes of carrying out payment or health care operations (not treatment), and the PHI pertains solely to a health care item or service for which the health care provider has been paid out of pocket in full.

Right to Receive Confidential Communications: If you tell us that disclosure of your PHI could endanger you, you have the right to request in writing that we communicate your PHI to you in a certain manner or at a certain location. For example, you may request that we contact you at home, rather than at work. We are required to meet only reasonable requests.

Right to Inspect and Copy: You can request the opportunity to inspect and receive a copy of your PHI in certain records that we maintain. We may charge you reasonable fees for the cost of providing a copy.

Right to Amend: You have the right to request that we amend your health plan PHI if you give us an appropriate reason for the request.

Right to Receive an Accounting of Disclosures: You have the right to request an "accounting" of certain disclosures that we have made of your PHI. This is a list of disclosures made by us during a specified period of up to six years prior to the request, other than disclosures made for treatment, payment, and health care operations; to family members or friends involved in your care; to you directly; pursuant to an authorization of you or your personal representative; for certain notification purposes (including national security, intelligence, and law enforcement purposes); of a "limited data set" in compliance with our policies and procedures for this kind of data; or incidental to otherwise permitted or required uses and disclosures. The first list you request in a 12-month period will be free, but we may charge you for our reasonable costs of providing additional lists in the same 12-month period. We will tell you about these costs, and you may choose to cancel your request at any time before costs are incurred.

Right to a Paper Copy of this Notice: You have a right to receive a paper copy of this Notice at any time even if you have agreed to receive this notice electronically. Email Benefits@Microsoft.com or call 425-706-8853 for a paper copy.

IV. COMPLAINTS

If you believe your privacy rights have been violated, you may file a complaint with us. To file a complaint with us, contact our HIPAA Privacy Operations Official. You may also file a complaint directly with the Office for Civil Rights of the United States Department of Health and Human Services ("OCR"). We will not retaliate or take action against you for filing a complaint.

V. PRIVACY OPERATIONS OFFICIAL AND PRIVACY OFFICIAL CONTACT INFORMATION

If you have questions, you may contact our Privacy Operations Official or Privacy Official at the following addresses and phone numbers:

HIPAA Privacy Operations Official

c/o Benefits
Microsoft Corporation
One Microsoft Way
Redmond, WA 98052
(425) 707-0531

HIPAA Privacy Official

c/o Benefits
Microsoft Corporation
One Microsoft Way
Redmond, WA 98052
(425) 421-4459

CHIP Notice

If you or your children are eligible for Medicaid or CHIP and you're eligible for health coverage from your employer, your state may have a premium assistance program that can help pay for coverage, using funds from their Medicaid or CHIP programs. If you or your children aren't eligible for Medicaid or CHIP, you won't be eligible for these premium assistance programs but you may be able to buy individual insurance coverage through the Health Insurance Marketplace. For more information, visit www.healthcare.gov.

If you or your dependents are already enrolled in Medicaid or CHIP and you live in a State listed below, contact your State Medicaid or CHIP office to find out if premium assistance is available.

If you or your dependents are NOT currently enrolled in Medicaid or CHIP, and you think you or any of your dependents might be eligible for either of these programs, contact your State Medicaid or CHIP office or dial **1-877-KIDS NOW** or www.insurekidsnow.gov to find out how to apply. If you qualify, ask your state if it has a program that might help you pay the premiums for an employer-sponsored plan.

If you or your dependents are eligible for premium assistance under Medicaid or CHIP, as well as eligible under your employer plan, your employer must allow you to enroll in your employer plan if you aren't already enrolled. This is called a "special enrollment" opportunity, and **you**

must request coverage within 60 days of being determined eligible for premium assistance. If you have questions about enrolling in your employer plan, contact the Department of Labor at www.askebsa.dol.gov or call **1-866-444-EBSA (3272)**.

If you live in one of the following states, you may be eligible for assistance paying your employer health plan premiums. The following list of states is current as of July 31, 2025. Contact your State for more information on eligibility –

ALABAMA – Medicaid	ALASKA – Medicaid
Website: http://myalhipp.com/ Phone: 1-855-692-5447	The AK Health Insurance Premium Payment Program Website: http://myakhipp.com/ Phone: 1-866-251-4861 Email: CustomerService@MyAKHIPP.com Medicaid Eligibility: https://health.alaska.gov/dpa/Pages/default.aspx
ARKANSAS – Medicaid	CALIFORNIA – Medicaid
Website: http://myarhipp.com/ Phone: 1-855-MyARHIPP (855-692-7447)	Health Insurance Premium Payment (HIPP) Program Website: http://dhcs.ca.gov/hipp Phone: 916-445-8322 Fax: 916-440-5676 Email: hipp@dhcs.ca.gov
COLORADO – Health First Colorado (Colorado's Medicaid Program) & Child Health Plan Plus (CHP+)	FLORIDA – Medicaid
Health First Colorado Website: https://www.healthfirstcolorado.com/ Health First Colorado Member Contact Center: 1-800-221-3943/State Relay 711 CHP+: https://hcpf.colorado.gov/child-health-plan-plus CHP+ Customer Service: 1-800-359-1991/State Relay 711 Health Insurance Buy-In Program (HIBI): https://www.mychohibi.com/ HIBI Customer Service: 1-855-692-6442	Website: https://www.flmedicaidtplrecovery.com/flmedicaidtplrecovery.com/hipp/index.html Phone: 1-877-357-3268

Section XVI: Important notices

GEORGIA – Medicaid	INDIANA – Medicaid
GA HIPP Website: https://medicaid.georgia.gov/health-insurance-premium-payment-program-hipp Phone: 678-564-1162, Press 1 GA CHIPRA Website: https://medicaid.georgia.gov/programs/third-party-liability/childrens-health-insurance-program-reauthorization-act-2009-chipra Phone: 678-564-1162, Press 2	Healthy Indiana Plan for low-income adults 19-64 Website: http://www.in.gov/fssa/hip/ Phone: 1-877-438-4479 All other Medicaid Website: https://www.in.gov/medicaid/ Phone: 1-800-457-4584
IOWA – Medicaid and CHIP (Hawki)	KANSAS – Medicaid
Medicaid Website: https://dhs.iowa.gov/ime/members Medicaid Phone: 1-800-338-8366 Hawki Website: http://dhs.iowa.gov/Hawki Hawki Phone: 1-800-257-8563 HIPP Website: https://dhs.iowa.gov/ime/members/medicaid-a-to-z/hipp HIPP Phone: 1-888-346-9562	Website: https://www.kancare.ks.gov/ Phone: 1-800-792-4884 HIPP Phone: 1-800-967-4660

KENTUCKY – Medicaid	LOUISIANA – Medicaid
Kentucky Integrated Health Insurance Premium Payment Program (KI-HIPP) Website: https://chfs.ky.gov/agencies/dms/member/Pages/kihipp.aspx Phone: 1-855-459-6328 Email: KIHIP.PPROGRAM@ky.gov KCHIP Website: https://kidshealth.ky.gov/Pages/index.aspx Phone: 1-877-524-4718 Kentucky Medicaid Website: https://chfs.ky.gov/agencies/dms	Website: www.medicaid.la.gov or www.ldh.la.gov/lahipp Phone: 1-888-342-6207 (Medicaid hotline) or 1-855-618-5488 (LaHIPP)
MAINE – Medicaid	MASSACHUSETTS – Medicaid and CHIP

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Enrollment Website: https://www.mymaineconnection.gov/benefits/s/?language=en_US Phone: 1-800-442-6003 TTY: Maine relay 711 Private Health Insurance Premium Webpage: https://www.maine.gov/dhhs/ofi/applications-forms Phone: 1-800-977-6740 TTY: Maine relay 711	Website: https://www.mass.gov/masshealth/pa Phone: 1-800-862-4840 TTY: 711 Email: masspremassistance@accenture.com
MINNESOTA – Medicaid	MISSOURI – Medicaid
Website: http://mn.gov/dhs/people-we-serve/seniors/health-care/health-care-programs/programs-and-services/medical-assistance.jsp https://mn.gov/dhs/people-we-serve/children-and-families/health-care/health-care-programs/programs-and-services/other-insurance.jsp Phone: 1-800-657-3739	Website: http://www.dss.mo.gov/mhd/participants/pages/hipp.htm Phone: 573-751-2005
MONTANA – Medicaid	NEBRASKA – Medicaid
Website: http://dphhs.mt.gov/MontanaHealthcarePrograms/HIPP Phone: 1-800-694-3084 Email: HSHIPPProgram@mt.gov	Website: http://www.ACCESSNebraska.ne.gov Phone: 1-855-632-7633 Lincoln: 402-473-7000 Omaha: 402-595-1178
NEVADA – Medicaid	NEW HAMPSHIRE – Medicaid
Medicaid Website: http://dhcfp.nv.gov Medicaid Phone: 1-800-992-0900	Website: https://www.dhhs.nh.gov/programs-services/medicaid/health-insurance-premium-program Phone: 603-271-5218 Toll free number for the HIPP program: 1-800-852-3345, ext. 5218
NEW JERSEY – Medicaid and CHIP	NEW YORK – Medicaid

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Medicaid Website: http://www.state.nj.us/humanservices/dmahs/clients/medicaid/ Medicaid Phone: 609-631-2392 CHIP Website: http://www.njfamilycare.org/index.html CHIP Phone: 1-800-701-0710	Website: https://www.health.ny.gov/health_care/medicaid/ Phone: 1-800-541-2831
NORTH CAROLINA – Medicaid	NORTH DAKOTA – Medicaid
Website: https://medicaid.ncdhhs.gov/ Phone: 919-855-4100	Website: https://www.hhs.nd.gov/healthcare Phone: 1-844-854-4825
OKLAHOMA – Medicaid and CHIP	OREGON – Medicaid
Website: http://www.insureoklahoma.org Phone: 1-888-365-3742	Website: http://healthcare.oregon.gov/Pages/index.aspx Phone: 1-800-699-9075
PENNSYLVANIA – Medicaid and CHIP	RHODE ISLAND – Medicaid and CHIP
Website: https://www.dhs.pa.gov/Services/Assistance/Pages/HIPP-Program.aspx Phone: 1-800-692-7462 CHIP Website: Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP) (pa.gov) CHIP Phone: 1-800-986-KIDS (5437)	Website: http://www.eohhs.ri.gov/ Phone: 1-855-697-4347, or 401-462-0311 (Direct Rite Share Line)
SOUTH CAROLINA – Medicaid	SOUTH DAKOTA - Medicaid
Website: https://www.scdhhs.gov Phone: 1-888-549-0820	Website: http://dss.sd.gov Phone: 1-888-828-0059
TEXAS – Medicaid	UTAH – Medicaid and CHIP
Website: Health Insurance Premium Payment (HIPP) Program Texas Health and Human Services Phone: 1-800-440-0493	Medicaid Website: https://medicaid.utah.gov/ CHIP Website: http://health.utah.gov/chip Phone: 1-877-543-7669
VERMONT– Medicaid	VIRGINIA – Medicaid and CHIP

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Website: Health Insurance Premium Payment (HIPP) Program Department of Vermont Health Access Phone: 1-800-250-8427	Website: https://coverva.dmas.virginia.gov/learn/premium-assistance/famis-select https://coverva.dmas.virginia.gov/learn/premium-assistance/health-insurance-premium-payment-hipp-programs Medicaid/CHIP Phone: 1-800-432-5924
WASHINGTON – Medicaid	WEST VIRGINIA – Medicaid and CHIP
Website: https://www.hca.wa.gov/ Phone: 1-800-562-3022	Website: https://dhhr.wv.gov/bms/http://mywvhipp.com/ Medicaid Phone: 304-558-1700 CHIP Toll-free phone: 1-855-MyWVHIPP (1-855-699-8447)
WISCONSIN – Medicaid and CHIP	WYOMING – Medicaid
Website: https://www.dhs.wisconsin.gov/badgercareplus/p-10095.htm Phone: 1-800-362-3002	Website: https://health.wyo.gov/healthcarefin/medicaid/programs-and-eligibility/ Phone: 1-800-251-1269

To see if any other states have added a premium assistance program since July 31, 2023, or for more information on special enrollment rights, contact either:

U.S. Department of Labor
Services

Employee Benefits Security Administration

www.dol.gov/agencies/ebsa

1-866-444-EBSA (3272)

U.S. Department of Health and Human

Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services

www.cms.hhs.gov

1-877-267-2323, Menu Option 4, Ext. 61565

Notice of Creditable Coverage

Important Notice from Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington and Kaiser Permanente About Your Prescription Drug Coverage and Medicare

Please read this notice carefully and keep it where you can find it. This notice has information about your current prescription drug coverage with Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington and Kaiser Permanente and about your options under Medicare's prescription drug coverage. This information can help you decide whether or not you want to join a Medicare drug plan. If you are considering joining, you should compare your current coverage, including which drugs are covered at what cost, with the coverage and costs of the plans offering Medicare prescription drug coverage in your area. Information about where you can get help to make decisions about your prescription drug coverage is at the end of this notice.

There are two important things you need to know about your current coverage and Medicare's prescription drug coverage:

1. Medicare prescription drug coverage became available in 2006 to everyone with Medicare. You can get this coverage if you join a Medicare Prescription Drug Plan or join a Medicare Advantage Plan (like an HMO or PPO) that offers prescription drug coverage. All Medicare drug plans provide at least a standard level of coverage set by Medicare. Some plans may also offer more coverage for a higher monthly premium.
2. Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington and Kaiser Permanente have determined that the prescription drug coverage offered by them, under the Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan, is, on average for all plan participants, expected to pay out as much as standard Medicare prescription drug coverage pays and is therefore considered Creditable Coverage. Because your existing coverage is Creditable Coverage, you can keep this coverage and not pay a higher premium (a penalty) if you later decide to join a Medicare drug plan.

When Can You Join A Medicare Drug Plan?

You can join a Medicare drug plan when you first become eligible for Medicare and each year from October 15th to December 7th. However, if you lose your current creditable prescription drug coverage, through no fault of your own, you will also be eligible for a two (2) month Special Enrollment Period (SEP) to join a Medicare drug plan.

What Happens To Your Current Coverage If You Decide to Join A Medicare Drug Plan?

If you decide to join a Medicare drug plan, your current Premera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington or Kaiser Permanente coverage will not be affected. You can keep your current

coverage, and Premiera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington or Kaiser Permanente will coordinate benefits with your Medicare Part D coverage so as not to duplicate payments. If you do decide to join a Medicare drug plan and drop your current Premiera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington or Kaiser Permanente coverage, be aware that you and your dependents will be able to get this coverage back, but only during limited specified times.

When Will You Pay A Higher Premium (Penalty) To Join A Medicare Drug Plan?

You should also know that if you drop or lose your current coverage with Premiera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington or Kaiser Permanente and don't join a Medicare drug plan within 63 continuous days after your current coverage ends, you may pay a higher premium (a penalty) to join a Medicare drug plan later.

If you go 63 continuous days or longer without creditable prescription drug coverage, your monthly premium may go up by at least 1% of the Medicare base beneficiary premium per month for every month that you did not have that coverage. For example, if you go nineteen months without creditable coverage, your premium may consistently be at least 19% higher than the Medicare base beneficiary premium. You may have to pay this higher premium (a penalty) as long as you have Medicare prescription drug coverage. In addition, you may have to wait until the following October to join.

For More Information About This Notice Or Your Current Prescription Drug Coverage...

For further information, contact:

- Premiera: (800) 676-1411
- Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington (206) 630-4636 or (888) 901-4636
- Kaiser Permanente: (800) 464-4000
- Surest (866) 222-1298

NOTE: You'll get this notice each year. You will also get it before the next period you can join a Medicare drug plan, and if coverage through Premiera Blue Cross, Surest, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan of Washington or Kaiser Permanente changes. You also may request a copy of this notice at any time.

For More Information About Your Options Under Medicare Prescription Drug Coverage...

More detailed information about Medicare plans that offer prescription drug coverage is in the "Medicare & You" handbook. You'll get a copy of the handbook in the mail every year from Medicare. You may also be contacted directly by Medicare drug plans.

For more information about Medicare prescription drug coverage:

- Visit www.medicare.gov
- Call your State Health Insurance Assistance Program (see the inside back cover of your copy of the "Medicare & You" handbook for their telephone number) for personalized help
- Call 1-800-MEDICARE (1-800-633-4227). TTY users should call 1-877-486-2048.

If you have limited income and resources, extra help paying for Medicare prescription drug coverage is available. For information about this extra help, visit Social Security on the web at www.socialsecurity.gov, or call them at 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778).

Remember: Keep this Creditable Coverage notice. If you decide to join one of the Medicare drug plans, you may be required to provide a copy of this notice when you join to show whether or not you have maintained creditable coverage and, therefore, whether or not you are required to pay a higher premium (a penalty).

Summary Annual Report for Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan

This is a summary of the annual report for Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan (the "Plan"), Plan Number 501, EIN: 91-1144442 for the period 01/01/2024 to 12/31/2024. This is a welfare benefit plan offering Health (other than vision or dental), Life Insurance, Dental, Vision, Prepaid legal, Long-term disability, Accidental Death & Dismemberment, Paid Leave, Employee Assistance plan and Death benefits (including travel accident but not life insurance).

The annual report has been filed with the Employee Benefits Security Administration, as required under the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 (ERISA).

Microsoft Corporation has committed itself to pay all medical, vision, and dental claims incurred under the terms of the plan.

Insurance Information

The Plan has contracts with Arag Insurance Company, Kaiser Foundation Health Plan Inc, and Prudential Insurance Company of America to pay certain health, life insurance, long-term disability, group legal plan, AD&D and paid leave claims incurred under the terms of the Plan. The total premiums paid for the Plan year ending 12/31/2024 were \$165,661,195.

Your Rights to Additional Information

You have the right to receive a copy of the full annual report, or any part thereof, on request. The items listed below are included in that report.

- Insurance information, including sales commissions paid by insurance carriers

To obtain a copy of the full annual report, or any part thereof, write or call the office of Microsoft Corporation, Microsoft Corporation Welfare Plan Sponsor, One Microsoft Way, Redmond, WA 98052, and at the main office phone of (425) 882-8080.

You also have the right to receive from the plan administrator, on request and at no charge, a statement of the assets and liabilities of the Plan and accompanying notes, or both. If you request a copy of the full annual report from the Plan administrator, these two statements and accompanying notes will be included as part of that report. The charge to cover copying costs given above does not include a charge for the copying of these portions of the report because these portions are furnished without charge.

You also have the legally protected right to examine the annual report at the main office of the plan One Microsoft Way, Redmond, WA 98052, and at the U.S. Department of Labor in Washington, D.C. or to obtain a copy from the U.S. Department of Labor upon payment of copying costs.

Requests to the Department should be addressed to:

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Public Disclosure Room, N1513
Employee Benefits Security Administration
U.S. Department of Labor
200 Constitution Avenue, N.W.
Washington, DC 20210

OMB Control Number 1210-0040 (expires 03/31/2026)

Paperwork Reduction Act Statement

According to the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995 (Pub. L. 104-13) (PRA), no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless such collection displays a valid Office of Management and Budget (OMB) control number. The Department notes that a Federal agency cannot conduct or sponsor a collection of information unless it is approved by OMB under the PRA, and displays a currently valid OMB control number, and the public is not required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a currently valid OMB control number. See 44 U.S.C. 3507. Also, notwithstanding any other provisions of law, no person shall be subject to penalty for failing to comply with a collection of information if the collection of information does not display a currently valid OMB control number. See 44 U.S.C. 3512.

The public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average less than one minute per notice (approximately 3 hours and 11 minutes per plan). Interested parties are encouraged to send comments regarding the burden estimate or any other aspect of this collection of information, including suggestions for reducing this burden, to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of the Chief Information Officer, Attention: Departmental Clearance Officer, 200 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Room N-1301, Washington, DC 20210 or email DOL_PRA_PUBLIC@dol.gov and reference the OMB Control Number 1210-0040.